

THE TATTVAYOGABINDU OF RĀMACANDRA

A Critical Edition and Annotated Translation of an Early
Modern Text on Rājayoga, with a Comparative Analysis of
the Complex Yoga Taxonomies from the Same Period

by Nils Jacob Liersch



रा. यो.
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श्रीगणेशाय नमः॥ ॥ अथ राजयोगप्रकारैर्लिख्यते॥ राजयोगस्य इदं फलं॥ येन रायोगेन अनेकान् भोगसमयसु ब्रज
नेकपार्थिवविनोदप्रेक्षणसमयसु ब्रजत्तरकालं शरीरस्थितिर्भवति स एव राजयोगः॥ ॥ तस्य सत्ते भेदाः॥ क्रियायोगः ज्ञा
नयोगः चर्यायोगः रुठयोगः कर्मयोगः लययोगः ध्यानयोगः मंत्रयोगः लक्ष्ययोगः वासनायोगः शिद्वयोगः वृत्तयोगः अ
द्वैतयोगः राजयोगः सिद्धयोगः॥ सत्ते पंचदशयोगाः॥ ॥ इदानीं क्रियायोगस्य लक्षणं कथ्यते॥ क्रियासु क्लिययोगः
स्वपिण्डे सिद्धिरायकः॥ यं यं करोति कलालकार्यं रंभे मनः सदा॥ १॥ तदृत्तः कूर्चनं कुर्वन् क्रियायोगसतो भव॥ क्ष
माविदेकवैराग्यं शान्तिः संतोषनिस्पृहा॥ २॥ सतः भुक्तिमुतो यो सौ क्रियायोगी निगद्यते॥ मात्सर्यममतामाया किं सा
शमदगर्वता॥ ३॥ कामक्रोभोभयं लज्जालोभमोहोत्थाश्रुविः॥ रागद्वेषौ घृणा लस्य भ्रान्तिर्दंभो क्षमाभ्रमः॥ ४॥
यस्यैतानि न विद्यन्ते क्रियायोगी स उच्यते॥ ॥ यस्यान्तरागोक्षमादिविदेकवैराग्यं शान्तिः संतोष उत्पादीनि उत्पद्यं
ते स एव ब्रह्मक्रियायोगी स कथ्यते॥ कापमं मायावित्ते हिंसा तृष्णा मात्सर्यं अहंकारः स्वोभयं लज्जा लोभमोह
असत्त्विरागद्वेषः आलस्यं पार्थिवं दित्वं भ्रान्तिः इन्द्रियविकारः॥ कामसते यस्य मनसि प्रतिदिनं नृना भवन्ति॥
स एव ब्रह्मक्रियायोगी कथ्यते॥ ॥ इदानीं राजयोगस्य भेदा कथ्यते॥ क्रियते॥ एकः सिद्धकुण्डलनीयोगः मंत्रयो

शुक्र
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Figure 1: Folio iv of Ms. N₂. National Archives, Kathmandu. Ms. No.: B 38/35 = A 1327-14. Acc No.: NAK 3/750.

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नको॥ इत्याद्यनिष्ठसंस्पर्शे संवलवणादिको॥ २॥ प्रत्यासावपि गंधं वक्राणो बोधादि वर्जिते॥ सर्वदेवसदाभासः मनस्यात्सुख
दुःखयोः॥ ३॥ एवं भूतस्य कर्मणि संकल्प रहितानि वा॥ गच्छन्त्याणां संस्पर्शात्पायं कुर्वन्त लिप्यन्ते॥ ४॥ उत्पन्नतत्त्वबोध
स्य उदासीनस्य सर्वदा॥ तदा दृष्टि विशेषः स्याद्विधाया स नानि॥ ५॥ अंतःकरणाभावायोगिनो नोपयोगिनः॥ सर्वदा
सहजस्थस्य तिष्ठत्वात्मा तदेदिता॥ यद्यप्ययमनिपाद्यंत तत्सर्वं नकारणा॥ ६॥ विलासिनी नाम नो हारिणी तत्र वणात् अ
ति सुंदरकामिनी नाम कस्य दर्शनात्॥ कल्पी कर्पूरगंधागंधयुग्मात् मनःश्री तुलकारी अतिकोमल परवल्लभस्य शक्ति
तज्जति धर्म्यं चित्रं करोति तादृशस्वादनात् अनेक देशानां साध्यसाधुस्थानान्दर्शनान् मैत्रेयासदकोमलवदनात् शत्रूणां
रुक्विन्दवदनाद्यस्य मनसि हर्षो बाधेन भवति स पुरुषश्चरे पदेशको ज्ञेयः सलीलस्य थावदति वलति वभावाभावा
धि त्रमुदासीनं भवति॥ कस्यां विधात्रायां हठं न करोति यस्य मनसि हजानं देमग्नं भवति तेन पुरुषे दृष्टिः स्थिरा कर्तुं
आसन्नं दृष्टं कर्तुं पवनस्थिरः कर्तुं सतादृशकश्चिन्तियमः सिद्धस्य नोक्तः मनः प्रवनाभाय रत हजानं दः स्वस्वरूपेण
प्रकाशते स सहजो योग कथ्यते॥ राजयोग मध्ये इति वक्रवर्ती नाम कथनम्॥ इति श्री परमरूपे श्री रामचंद्रविरचि
ता या न त्वयोग विन्दु समाप्ता॥ ॥ धुभम्॥ यदक्षरपदमुद्यं मात्राहीनं वयं वेत्तुं तत्सर्वं ध्यात्वा मेव प्रसीद परमेश्वर॥ १॥
सूर्ये तुरङ्गे न वेद दुष्टे ज्ञेयात्त्वहस्ते भुगुहारे पुक्तम्॥ तत्र प्रयोग यदहं सर्वं संजं लिखितं सुहेतोः भवती हरे हि॥ भूयान्॥

पुस्त
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Figure 2: Folio 11r of Ms. N₂. National Archives, Kathmandu. Ms. No.: B 38/35 = A 1327-14. Acc No.: NAK 3/750.

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¹For more information about the ERC-funded hyp-website (2015–2020), see <http://hyp.soas.ac.uk/> (Alternatively: <https://web.archive.org/web/20240516171430/http://hyp.soas.ac.uk/>; saved on archive.org: 04.10.2023).

World Sanskrit Conference 2018 in Vancouver, Canada, I also met Dr. James Mallinson. Soon after, I found myself on the island of Procida in southern Italy, fortunate to be invited to the two-week *Amṛtasiddhi* workshop of the HYP. In Procida, Dr. Jason Birch inspired me to work on the *Tattvayogabindu* and provided me with the first manuscripts of the text he had collected. The exploration of the overarching theme of complex yoga taxonomies, presented right at the beginning of the text, seemed very promising for advancing Indological yoga research. At another HYP workshop in spring 2019, focused on the *Yogabija* at the University of Marburg, I met Prof. Dr. Jürgen Hanneder, who promptly agreed to supervise my dissertation on the *Tattvayogabindu*. I am very grateful for his continuous support, philological expertise, and encyclopedic knowledge.

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Chapter I

Introduction

1.1 General remarks

THE *Tattvayogabindu* of Rāmacandra² is an early modern Sanskrit text on Rājayoga that was written in the first half of the sixteenth century³ in northern India.⁴ The most salient feature of the work that makes it historically significant is its highly differentiated taxonomy of types of yoga. In the *Tattvayogabindu*'s introduction, most manuscripts name fifteen types of yoga, presented as methods of Rājayoga. These are 1. Kriyāyoga, 2. Jñānayoga, 3. Caryāyoga, 4. Haṭhayoga, 5. Karmayoga, 6. Layayoga, 7. Dhyānayoga, 8. Mantrayoga, 9. Lakṣyayoga, 10. Vāsanāyoga, 11. Śivayoga, 12. Brahmayoga, 13. Advaitayoga, 14. Siddhayoga, and 15. Rājayoga itself.⁵ The text is a yogic compendium written mainly in prose, incorporating 47 verses, and organised into thematically defined sections of varying length, many of which are introduced by recurring formulaic expressions. The sections deal with the methods of Rājayoga and their effects, but others also cover topics like yogic physiology, the Avadhūta, the importance of the guru, cosmogony, and a *yogaśāstrarahasya*.

The *Tattvayogabindu* has not been discussed comprehensively or considered in the secondary literature on yoga. The only exception is birch2014 (2014: 415–416) who briefly described its list of fifteen yogas in the context of the “fifteen medieval yogas” and noted that a similar taxonomy occurs in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (17th century), a commentary on the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* that integrates fifteen medieval yogas within its *aṣṭāṅga* format. An incomplete account of the fifteen yogas is found within the Sanskrit yoga text *Yogasvarodaya*, which is known only through quotations in the *Prāṇatoṣinī*, the *Yogakarnīkā* and the *Śabdakalpadruma*. The *Yogasvarodaya* announces a total of fifteen yogas but names only eight of them in its introductory *śloka*s. It is the primary source and template for the compilation of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Besides several passages, Rāmacandra, in many in-

²For a discussion of the author Rāmacandra, see p. 21.

³The dating of the text is discussed on p. 6.

⁴The detailed discussion of the place of origin is found on p. 223, n. 383.

⁵This is a remarkable increase in the number of declared yogas compared to the standard medieval tetrad of Mantra, Laya, Haṭha and Rājayoga.

stances, follows its content and structure by rewriting the *Yogasvarodaya*'s *ślokas* into prose or quoting them directly without attribution. Due to the incomplete transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya*, Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* provides a natural and valuable starting point for the first in-depth study of the complex yoga taxonomies of the early modern period, a phenomenon that, as I will show, can be situated with considerable precision in both time and place. The other source text that Rāmacandra used is the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* whose content he draws on, particularly in the second half of his composition. Another text that includes a somewhat similar taxonomy of twelve yogas divided into three tetrads⁶ is Sundardās's *Brajbhāṣā* yoga text named *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (17th century), which not only shares most of these types of yoga but also offers a different and valuable perspective on their classification and interpretation.⁷

These complex taxonomies that emerged during the 16th and 17th centuries crossed sectarian divides and were adapted to the specific needs of different authors and traditions. The *Tattvayogabindu* thus documents a substantial part of the diversity of yoga types and teachings that emerged after the *Hathapradīpikā* (15th century) and were adopted and practised across a broad range of religious traditions and social strata in India. In the particular case of the *Tattvayogabindu*, there are various statements throughout the text that reveal a strategy to detach yoga from its ascetic and renunciate connotations and to stylise Rājayoga as a practice that can bring the desired soteriological benefits even to practitioners who enjoy worldly pleasures and luxurious lifestyles. Textual evidence suggests that the *Tattvayogabindu* is an important example of a text that provides an early modern adaptation of Rājayoga for *kṣatriyas* in a courtly environment. In fact, the *Tattvayogabindu* is currently the earliest known work to address its teachings on Rājayoga to actual monarchs, ranging from kings (*rājan*) to the idealised universal ruler (*cakravartin*). This strongly suggests that the term *rājayoga* is conceived here as a "yoga for kings."

⁶ See p. 311 for a detailed discussion of the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

⁷ For a comparative table of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies see table 2 on p. 301.

One printed edition of the *Tattvayogabindu*, accompanied by a Hindi translation, was published in 1905 on the basis of one or more unidentified manuscripts.⁸ This publication has the title “*Binduyoga*” confirmed by the printed text’s final rubric.⁹ However, as I will discuss in the introduction, the text was originally known as *Tattvayogabindu*. The consulted manuscripts contain significant discrepancies, structural differences and variant readings between them and the printed edition.¹⁰ Furthermore, the manuscripts are scattered over the northern half of the Indian subcontinent and Nepal, which suggests that the text was widely transmitted at some point. Lengthy passages of the *Tattvayogabindu* are quoted without attribution in a text called the *Yogasamgraha* and Sundaradeva’s *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*.

The first chapter of this study contains a general introduction to Rāmacandra’s *Tattvayogabindu*. The chapter gives a brief overview of the content of the text and discusses its origin, the author and the author’s intended audience. Subsequently, the textual witnesses, source texts and testimonies of the *Tattvayogabindu* are described. A stemmatic analysis of the text is then presented, based on manual philological methods and computer-assisted stemmatics to present a *stemma codicum*. The chapter concludes with a presentation of the editorial policies, which form the basis for the second chapter of this thesis. The second chapter, the core of this study, is a critical edition and annotated translation of the *Tattvayogabindu*. The critical edition significantly improves the text and sheds new light on its historical significance. The third chapter contains a comparative analysis of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies based on hermeneutics of difference.¹¹ Using the new critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu* and the texts mentioned above, *Yogasvarodaya*, *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, the complex

⁸type.

⁹To avoid terminological confusion, I consistently follow Camillo Formigatti’s usage in distinguishing between the final rubric—the string of words marking the end of a textual unit, often including an assertion of authorship and title—and the colophon proper of a manuscript, that is, the statement providing information on the date, place, agency, or purpose of the manuscript’s production. See **colophon2022formigatti**.

¹⁰For example, the printed edition does not contain the complex yoga taxonomy presented in the manuscripts of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

¹¹The concept of hermeneutics of difference is discussed on p. 302, n. 477.

yogic taxonomies of the four texts are compared in detail. Based on this comparative analysis, a differentiated hypothesis on the emergence of the complex yoga taxonomies was developed, and the complex yoga taxonomies were located and explained in the broader context of the historical development of the yoga traditions. The comparison includes a nuanced description of each yoga category used by the authors of the texts with complex yoga taxonomies. While the authors of the four texts often use identical terms for the individual yoga categories, they interpret these categories in accordance with their respective religious backgrounds and agendas, producing significant differences in meaning and emphasis. Contrasting the comparanda, i.e., the authors, the texts, the yoga taxonomies, and the yoga categories, therefore, provides a deep insight into the discursive negotiation processes of the Indian yoga traditions during the 16th and 17th centuries.

1.2 Dating the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*

THE oldest dated extant manuscript of the *Tattvayogabindu*, N₂, was written in the running year Nepal Saṃvat 712, that is in 1591 CE.¹² The second oldest surviving dated manuscript V, was written in Vikrama Saṃvat 1751, that is, in 1693 CE.¹³ The third-oldest preserved manuscript N₁¹⁴ was written in Nepal Saṃvat 837, i.e. in 1716 CE.

Both Nepalese manuscripts N₁ and N₂ exhibit a substantial lacuna amounting to approximately 23.50% of the total text. Since N₂ is dated earlier than N₁, it must be assumed either that N₁ is a direct copy of N₂, or that both derive from the same exemplar. A comparison of the distribution of errors, shared readings, and divergences suggests that the latter scenario is the more likely. The presence of such a large lacuna in both manuscripts points to either the loss or deterioration of the corresponding folios of the exemplar. Furthermore, both manuscripts contain various corruptions. In light of these observations, it appears that the textual transmission had already undergone substantial degradation by the end of the sixteenth century.

¹²For a detailed description of manuscript N₂ and a discussion of its dating, see p. 37.

¹³For a description of the manuscript V see p. 46.

¹⁴For a description of the manuscript N₁ see p. 36.

Consequently, the work was most likely composed several decades before the exemplar of the oldest dated extant manuscript N₂ was written, that is, sometime in the sixteenth century, probably in its second half.

The latter assumption is corroborated by witness V, the second-oldest available dated witness, which is by far one of the poorest in the tradition. It contains no significant variants, and the sheer number of scribal errors and editorial interventions compelled me to exclude it from the collation.

The earliest quotation of the *Tattvayogabindu* is Sundaradeva's *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*. Sundaradeva quotes from the *Tattvayogabindu* without attribution. The two lengthy passages quoted from the *Tattvayogabindu* include the teachings on the sixteen *ādhāras*¹⁵ as well as those on Lakṣyayoga and its subtypes.¹⁶

The dating of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* has only recently been revised due to the discovery that certain first-hand annotations surrounding the main text of the Ujjain *Yogacintāmaṇi* were, in all likelihood, borrowed from Sundaradeva's work, which currently is the text's *terminus ante quem*.¹⁷ **birch2018proliferation** (2018) dated the Ujjain *Yogacintāmaṇi* to 1659 CE.¹⁸ Thus, the citations within the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* represent the second oldest transmitted textual evidence of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

In the case of the *Tattvayogabindu*, based on the colophon of N₂, the current *terminus ante quem* is 1591 CE, which similarly applies to its source text the hitherto undated *Yogasvarodaya*, and as will be later discussed in more detail for the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.

We may therefore safely assume that the *Tattvayogabindu* was composed in the second half of the sixteenth century or earlier. Consequently, Rāmacandra's source texts, the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* must have been composed even earlier.

¹⁵hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244, f. 95r l. 3 to f. 96r l. 4).

¹⁶hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244, f. 124r l. 7 to f. 125r l. 3).

¹⁷birch2024.

¹⁸birch2018proliferation.

1.3 Synopsis of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s contents

RĀMACANDRA'S *Tattvayogabindu* can be divided into 59 sections. Many of these sections are brief, consisting of only a few sentences or lists of specific contents or concepts the author wishes to convey. However, some sections are significantly longer. Almost every section is introduced with clearly identifiable section markers. In these cases, a section begins with recognisable phrases such as *atha*, *idānīm* or *idam*. Sometimes, sections start without section markers. Nevertheless, the thematic shifts were so significant that I, as the editor, felt obliged to mark these passages as separate sections.¹⁹ The wording of the text remains entirely unchanged.

By far the largest part of the text deals with explaining various yogas. Of the fifteen yogas presented as methods of Rājayoga²⁰ mentioned in the introduction, Rāmacandra explains only eight in the course of the text. These are Rājayoga, Kriyāyoga, Siddha[kuṇḍalīnī]yoga, Mantrayoga, Lakṣyayoga, Haṭhayoga, and Jñānayoga. Surprisingly, there are also three additional yogas not listed among the fifteen initially mentioned: Aṣṭāṅgayoga, Satyayoga, and Sahajayoga. The individual yogas, both those explicitly described and those merely mentioned in the taxonomy, are discussed in detail from p. 299 onwards. This chapter analyses and compares them with the three other texts containing complex yoga taxonomies, particularly to determine the significance of the complex yoga taxonomies in the history of yoga.

The other major subject concerns (yogic) reality (*tattva*) in all its dimensions, from the yogic body and cosmogenesis to the role of the *guru*. In sections XXV–XXVI, Rāmacandra names, describes and explains the functions of the ten physical channels (*nāḍīs*) and the ten vital winds (*vāyus*). In sections XXXII–XLI, he postulates the identity of the universe (*brahmāṇḍa*) and the body (*piṇḍa*). Following this, Rāmacandra lists numerous macrocosmic elements within the body: the worlds (*lokas*), rulers of the worlds (*lokaśvāmins*), seven islands (*dvīpas*), seven oceans (*samudras*), nine regions (*khaṇḍas*), eight major mountains (*parvatas*), nine rivers (*nāḍīs*), twenty-seven constellations

¹⁹This specifically pertains to sections VI, VII, XIV, XVII, and XLI.

²⁰See p. 102.

(*nakṣatras*), and so on. Structurally, Rāmacandra simply names the macro-cosmic element and then locates it in the body. Finally, in sections LV–LVII, Rāmacandra lists the digits (*kalās*) of the moon (*candra*), sun (*sūrya*), and fire (*agni*). Another significant component of the *Tattvayogabindu* is a variant of a set of teachings that can be traced back to an ancient Śaiva paradigm.²¹ This set consists of teachings on *cakras*,²² *ādhāras*,²³ *lakṣyas*,²⁴ and *vyomas* or *ākāśas*.²⁵

Other topics include a description of the tamed Avadhūta,²⁶ and a description of the division of the heart lotus (*hṛdayakamala*), whose history of reception can be traced back to the teachings of the Śaiva exegetes of Kashmir.²⁷ Other sections discuss a pentadic cosmogony,²⁸ or the importance of the teacher (*guru*) for yoga practice.²⁹ The work concludes with a lengthy section titled the “esoteric yoga doctrine in all of the scriptures” (*yogaśāstrarahasyaṃ samagraśāstramādhye*), which primarily concerns the ultimate yoga teaching for those called *cakravartin*, namely Sahajayoga. This yoga enables the practitioner to enjoy all the benefits of yoga without the need to practice it. Table I provides an overview of all contents of the *Tattvayogabindu*, arranged by sections:

²¹*Tattvayogabindu* XXVIII.1: *navacakraṃ kalādhāraṃ trilakṣyaṃ vyomapaṃcakaṃ | svadehe yo na jānāti sa yogi nāmadhārakaḥ* || Variants of this verse are found in numerous yoga texts with a Śaiva orientation and older Śaiva Tantras. I discuss this paradigm on p. 386.

²²A total of nine *cakras*, along with meditation instructions on these, are described in detail in sections IV–XII. In section XXIX, nine *cakras* are listed again, but only with names and locations.

²³The sixteen containers (*ādhāras*) are described in section XXX. These include specific locations suitable for meditation, *mudrā* and *bandha* techniques.

²⁴The *Tattvayogabindu* includes five meditative foci (*lakṣyas*), which are collectively referred to as the Rājayoga method called Lakṣyayoga. The chapters of the sub-variants are found in sections XIII–XV and XXIII–XXIV.

²⁵These are five meditative spaces that the Yogi can traverse, described in section XXVIII.

²⁶The original archetype of the antinomian ascetic is tamed in XLIV.

²⁷See sections XLV–XLVII.

²⁸See sections XLVIII–LIV.

²⁹See sections XLIII and LVIII.

Table 1: Topics of the *Tattvayogabindu*

Section	Topic in Sanskrit	Translation
I	<i>rājayogaprakāraḥ</i>	Method of Rājayoga
II	<i>kriyāyogasya lakṣaṇam</i>	Characteristics of Kriyāyoga
III	<i>rājayogasya bhedāḥ</i>	Varieties of Rājayoga
IV	<i>mūlacakram</i>	Mūlacakra
V	<i>svādhiṣṭhānacakram</i>	Svādhiṣṭhānacakra
VI	<i>nābhīsthāne padmam</i>	Lotus within the place of the navel
VII	<i>hṛdayamadhye kamalam</i>	Lotus within the heart
VIII	<i>kaṇṭhaśthāne kamalam</i>	Lotus within the location of the throat
IX	<i>ājñācakram</i>	Ājñācakra
X	<i>cakraṃ tālūmadhye</i>	Cakra within the palate
XI	<i>aṣṭamacakraṃ brahmarandhra- sthāne</i>	Eighth cakra at the aperture of brahman
XII	<i>mahāśūnyacakram</i>	Cakra of the great void
XIII	<i>lakṣyayogaḥ</i>	Lakṣyayoga
XIV	<i>ūrdhvalakṣyam</i>	The upper focus
XV	<i>adholakṣyaḥ</i>	The lower focus
XVI	<i>rājayogayuktasya puruṣasya yac charīracihnam</i>	The physical sign of a person who is engaged in Rājayoga
XVII	<i>anyad rājayogasya cihnam</i>	Another sign of Rājayoga
XVIII	<i>caryāyogaḥ</i>	Caryāyoga
XIX	<i>haṭhayogaḥ</i>	Haṭhayoga
XX	<i>haṭhayogasya dvitīyo bhedaḥ</i>	Second type of Haṭhayoga
XXI	<i>jñānayogasya lakṣaṇam</i>	The characteristics of Jñānayoga
XXII	<i>svabhāvabhedaṃ</i>	Distinction of the nature
XXIII	<i>bāhyalakṣyam</i>	The outer focus
XXIV	<i>antaralakṣyam</i>	The inner focus
XXV	<i>nāḍīnām bhedāḥ</i>	Division of the channels
XXVI	<i>śarīramadhye vāyavaḥ</i>	The vital winds within the body

Table 1: Topics of the *Tattvayogabindu* (continued)

Sec- tion	Topic in Sanskrit	Translation
XXVII	<i>madhyalakṣyam</i>	Central focus
XXVIII	<i>ākāśabhedāḥ</i>	Divisions of space
XXIX	<i>cakrāṇām anukramah</i>	Sequence of <i>cakras</i>
XXX	<i>ādharacakrasya bhedaḥ</i>	Divisions of the wheels of support
XXXI	<i>aṣṭāṅgayogasya vicārah</i>	Reflection of Aṣṭāṅgayoga
XXXII	<i>piṇḍabrahmāṇḍayor aiikyam</i>	Identity of the universe and the body
XXXIII	<i>piṇḍamadhye lokatrayam</i>	Triad of worlds
XXXIV	<i>uparitanam lokacatuṣkam</i>	Upper tetrad of worlds
XXXV	<i>catvāro lokasvāmināḥ</i>	Lords of the world
XXXVI	<i>saptadvīpāni piṇḍamadhye</i>	Seven continents within the body
XXXVII	<i>piṇḍamadhye saptasamudrāḥ</i>	Seven oceans within the body
XXXVIII	<i>navadvāramadhye navakhaṇḍāni</i>	Nine regions within the nine doors
XXXIX	<i>piṇḍamadhye 'ṣṭakulaparvatāḥ</i>	Eight major mountains within the body
XL	<i>śarīre navanāḍyaḥ</i>	Nine rivers within the body
XLI	<i>saptaviṃśatinakṣatrāṇi ...</i>	Twenty-seven constellations ...
XLII	<i>rājayogāc charīre cihnāni</i>	Signs in the body as a result of Rā-jayoga
XLIII	<i>gurubhakteḥ phalam</i>	Result of devotion towards the teacher
XLIV	<i>avadhūtapuruṣasya lakṣaṇam</i>	Characteristics of an Avadhūta person
XLV	<i>kamalānāṃ saṃketam adbhutam</i>	The wonderful esoteric teaching of the lotus flowers
XLVI	<i>ādharakamalam</i>	Lotus of support
XLVII	<i>hṛdayakamalasya bhedaḥ</i>	Division of the heart Lotus
XLVIII	<i>yogasiddher anantaram jñānam</i>	Knowledge after the success in yoga
XLIX	<i>piṇḍotpattiḥ</i>	Origin of the body
L	<i>śarīramadhye pañca mahābhūtāni</i>	Five great elements within the body

Table 1: Topics of the *Tattvayogabindu* (continued)

Sec- tion	Topic in Sanskrit	Translation
LI	<i>pañcaprakārā antaḥkaraṇasya</i>	Five modes of the internal organ
LII	<i>kulapañcakasya bhedaḥ</i>	Divisions of the pentad of the <i>kula</i>
LIII	<i>ekaṃ jñānam</i>	Unique knowledge
LIV	<i>karma kāmāḥ candraḥ sūryaḥ ag- niḥ</i>	Action, desire, moon, sun and fire
LV	<i>candrasya ṣoḍaśakalāḥ</i>	Sixteen digits of the moon
LVI	<i>sūryasya dvādaśakalāḥ</i>	Twelve digits of the sun
LVII	<i>agnisaṃbandhinyo daśakalāḥ</i>	Ten digits related to fire
LVIII	<i>yogasya mātmyam</i>	Majesty of yoga
LIX	<i>yogaśāstrarahasyam</i>	Secret teaching of the scriptures of yoga

1.4 Rāmacandra and the audience of his text

THE article by Jason Birch titled **birch2014** (2014) re-evaluates the reception history of the term *rājayoga*, significantly enhancing our understanding, coloured by modern interpretations, with a far more nuanced perspective. As the title of Birch's article directly suggests, the term *Rājayoga* has been used by different traditions at various times, with their understanding and interpretation of this compound word being highly diverse. A significant insight for this study is that in the extant Sanskrit literature on Yoga, the interpretation of *Rājayoga* as “Yoga for kings” is comparatively rare. **birch2014** (2014: 412) notes:

In fact, my research has revealed only two texts which contain the gloss of *Rājayoga* as “the Yoga fit for kings”. Both are

eighteenth-century Vedāntic works, namely, the *Rājayogabhāṣya* and Divākara's commentary to the *Bodhasāra*.

Divākara's commentary is particularly interesting. Here, Rājayoga is described as the Yoga of kings—"rulers could accomplish it even when they remain in their position as kings."³⁰ The following pages demonstrate that Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* likely falls into this category. Textual evidence suggests that the *Tattvayogabindu* is one of the rare examples of a Rājayoga text composed for the warrior aristocracy, taught to members of a royal court, and perhaps even to the king himself. Rāmacandra begins his treatise on Rājayoga with the following definition. In *Tattvayogabindu* section I, ll. 1–2 he writes:

*atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate || rājayogasyedaṃ phalaṃ | yena rājayo-
genānekarājyabhogasamaya eva | anekapārthivavinodaprekṣaṇasamaya
eva | bahutarakālaṃ śarīrasthitir bhavati |*

Now, the method of Rājayoga is laid down. This is the fruit of Rājayoga: Through Rājayoga, the long-term durability of the body arises even when there are manifold royal pleasures [and] even when there is manifold royal entertainment and spectacle.

The core message is unequivocal. Rājayoga enables the practitioner to achieve lasting health and physical stability while leading a life filled with royal pleasures and entertainment. Consequently, the Rājayoga described in the text is not intended for ascetics who pursue soteriological goals with minimal material possessions but explicitly for individuals exposed to affluent life realities. In light of the initial definition presented in the text, the *Tattvayogabindu* is at least directed at affluent householders. However, the adjectives °*rājya*° and °*pārthiva*° used in the definition already suggest a more specific courtly context. The effect of *śarīrasthiti* promoted by Rājayoga can also be seen as an indicator of a courtly audience, as the qualities of

³⁰birch2014.

strength, discipline, and resilience were essential for fulfilling the primary duty of the *kṣatriya* caste, namely the protection and defence of the population. The motif of physical and mental strengthening through yoga in a courtly context is exemplified by the famous yoga tradition of the Mysore Palace. Tirumalai Krishnamacharya was employed as a yoga teacher by Maharaja Krishnaraja Wodiyar IV (1884–1940) within the court’s educational program at the Mysore Palace from the 1930s until the early 1950s, primarily to cultivate the physical robustness and mental agility of the royal family.³¹

In his book containing a new edition of the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* (2024: 21–22), **datta2024** argues convincingly that the state and name of Rājayoga in the early texts of Haṭhayoga reflect developments within the monastic traditions of the time. Mallinson dates the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* to 1200 CE, three centuries before the composition of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Many monastic institutions had gained significant power and autonomy, distancing themselves from royal patronage. The heads of these monasteries, known as *maṭhādhipatis*, began to function similarly to kings (*rājas*) and were sometimes even referred to by such titles. **datta2024** refers to Sanderson’s observation that Śaiva *maṭhādhipatis* from Bengal to Karnataka ruled like kings, engaging in activities such as founding monasteries, bestowing land-grants on brahmins, rewarding poets, founding temples and settlements, and providing means of irrigation. These *maṭhādhipatis* were often given royal or imperial titles. Furthermore, Mallinson demonstrates that the heads of monasteries where *haṭha* yoga texts were likely composed were also conceived of as kings. Could it be that the *Tattvayogabindu* is a text from one of the *maṭhas* described by Mallinson, even though the *Tattvayogabindu* was written approximately three centuries later? This can be ruled out for two reasons, even though powerful *maṭhas* existed in Rāmacandra’s time. Firstly, there are no indications of specific ascetic affiliations in the *Tattvayogabindu*; on the contrary, Rāmacandra strives to give this text a religiously neutral character and is careful to obscure the Śaiva roots of the source texts he uses. Secondly, the text explicitly speaks out against celibate ascetics, a stance that would hardly be expected from a text belonging to and intended for the audience of a *maṭha*.

³¹ See **singleton2010** and **sjoman1996**.

Rāmacandra writes in *Tattvayogabindu* LVIII.6:

aññānākulaśilānām yatinām brahmacāriṇām |
upadeśaṃ na grhṇīyād anyathā narakam dhruvam ||

One should not accept the teaching of celibate ascetics whose nature is confused by ignorance; otherwise, hell is inevitable.

Ascetics can thus be excluded as a potential audience at this point.³² Certainly, the development of the *maṭhas* described by **datta2024** (2024: 21–23), where *maṭhādhipatis* gained immense power and influence and promoted practices known as Rājayoga, did not go unnoticed by other rulers. It is possible that these circumstances inspired other rulers to include Rājayoga in their courtly training programs.

Beyond the introduction, further indications of the text's intended audience are scattered throughout the *Tattvayogabindu*. For instance, Rāmacandra points out that certain yogic practices can enhance one's attractiveness and cultivate popularity among young women,³³ or even subject women to one's will.³⁴ A result of meditation on the ninth *cakra* is that the practitioner, even while enjoying royal pleasures, amusing himself among women, and watching musical performances, finds that his vitality increases daily like the waxing moon.³⁵ As a result of practising *antaralakṣya*, a meditation on a red light between the eyebrows, he becomes beloved among all royal people.³⁶ Furthermore, one of the outcomes of Rājayoga is that every desire for worldly pleasures is fulfilled without attachment to those pleasures. As

³²There are literary accounts of kings renouncing their kingdom to become ascetic yogins, such as the *jogī khaṇḍa* of the *Padmāvat*. **mallinson2021** (2021: 75) cites the respective passage and provides a translation. In the *Tattvayogabindu*, Rājayoga is reinterpreted so that the king can remain in his position as the “enjoyer of the earth” while simultaneously achieving all soteriological goals without the inconveniences of an ascetic lifestyle.

³³*Tattvayogabindu* V ll. 6–7: *tanmadhye 'tiraktavarṇam tejo vartate | tasya dhyānakāraṇāt sādḥako 'tisundaro bhavati | yuvatinām ativallabho bhavati |*

³⁴*Tattvayogabindu* VII ll. 4–6: *asyā mūrter dhyānakāraṇāt svargapātālākāśamanuṣyagandharvakinnaraguhyakavidyādharaḥ lokasaṃbandhinyāḥ striyaḥ sādḥakasya puruṣasya vaśyā bhavanti |*

³⁵*Tattvayogabindu* XII ll. 1–3: *rājasukhabhogavṛtaḥ | strīmadhye vilāsavataḥ saṃgītavinodaprekṣyāvataḥ eva puruṣasya pratidinam śuklapakṣe candrakalāvat kalā vardhate |*

³⁶*Tattvayogabindu* XXIV ll. 2–3: *atha vā bhruvor madhye 'tiraktavarṇasyātisthūlasya tejaso dhyānakāraṇāt sakalānām pāṛthivapuruṣāṇām vallabho bhavati |*

an example, Rāmacandra mentions most excellent fruits and women.³⁷ Another result of Rājayoga, according to Rāmacandra, is that even if one were to obtain an entire kingdom, the feeling of having gained something does not arise.³⁸ Furthermore, the absence of non-violence (*ahiṃsā*) in the context of the presentation of Aṣṭāṅgayoga's *yamas* and *niyamas* points to a *kṣatriya* audience. The duties of a ruler sometimes involve "cruel" actions, such as enforcing laws, possibly through war. For this reason, a ruler cannot adhere to *ahiṃsā*.³⁹

An important example⁴⁰ that solidifies the above interpretation of a particular wealthy setting is the mention of the eight enjoyments (*aṣṭau bhogāḥ*). I was not able to locate the direct source of the *aṣṭau bhogāḥ* yet. However, in the *Mānasollāsa* of King Someśvara, one finds the mention of twenty royal *upabhogas*, which include all of the mentioned eight in much greater detail.⁴¹ The eight enjoyments seem to be a simplified form of the twenty royal enjoyments from King Someśvara's *Mānasollāsa*. Thus, the origin of this enumeration of pleasures likely stems from a courtly context. The eight enjoyments are introduced as the result of the innate nature of the self. Rāmacandra's depiction suggests that his audience is familiar with these enjoyments. In *Tattvayogabindu* XXII p. 168 ll. 1–4, Rāmacandra states:

paṭṭasūtramayāni vastrāṇi 1 || *pañca vā sapta vā śālikāyuktāni harṃyāṇi*
2 || *ativipulā mṛdūttarachadavatī śayyā* 3 || *padminī tārūṇyavatī*
manoharā guṇavatī tatropaviṣṭā kāntā 4 || *sādhvāsanam* 5 || *atimūlyo*
'śvaś ca 6 || *manoramam annam* 7 || *tathāvidham pānam* 8 || *ete 'ṣṭau*
bhogāḥ kathitāḥ | *ete duḥkham bhajante* | *bhikṣām yācante ca* |

³⁷Tattvayogabindu XVI ll. 6–7: *atha ca phalacandanakāminyāderyasya yasyeccha bhavati | tam tam bhogaṃ prāpnoti | atha vāsya mana eva sthāne 'nurāgaṃ na prāpnoti* ||

³⁸Tattvayogabindu XVII l. 1: *yasya rājyādhilābhe 'pi* ||

³⁹Cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XXXI.

⁴⁰This passage has no parallel to the *Yogasvarodaya*.

⁴¹*manasollāsa*.

1. Clothes made from silk thread;⁴²
2. Mansions endowed with five or seven rooms;⁴³
3. A very large bed with a soft and lovely blanket;⁴⁴
4. [on which] there is seated a sweetheart belonging to the Padminī-class of women—youthful, beautiful, and virtuous;⁴⁵
5. An excellent seat;⁴⁶
6. An exceptionally valuable horse;⁴⁷
7. Appetising food;⁴⁸
8. Similar drinks.⁴⁹

These are the eight enjoyments. They bring about suffering. And [they] require begging.

The final sentence of the passage, “And [they] require begging.” (*bhikṣām yācante ca* |), is initially puzzling, but the textual tradition is unequivocal. The preceding pronoun *ete* most naturally refers back to the *aṣṭau bhogāḥ*, and the translation deliberately preserves this awkwardness. Semantically, however, the statement clearly concerns the practitioner, since the act of begging can only be performed by an animate agent. The question is therefore who

⁴²In the twenty *upabhogas* of the *Mānasollāsa* we find the topic of *Vastropabhoga* or the “enjoyment of garments”. Particularly in summer, the king is asked to wear silk or cotton clothes, which are thin and charming. Cf. *manasollāsa*.

⁴³The first *adhyāya* of the third *viṃśati* of the *Mānasollāsa* discusses astrology for finding out auspicious moments while building new houses for princes. Here, houses with one to four *sālās* are described. Cf. *manasollāsa*.

⁴⁴This is found as *Śayyābhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this section, seven kinds of beds and eight kinds of bedsteads are described. Cf. *manasollāsa*.

⁴⁵This is resembled as *yoṣidupabhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this chapter, King Someśvara describes the qualifications of women whom a king should marry. The two most important qualities he gives are beauty and full youth. Out of the four kinds of women, a) Padminī, b) Citriṇī, c) Śaṅkhinī, and d) Hastinī, he suggests that the latter two kinds are not worth enjoying. Cf. *manasollāsa*.

⁴⁶The *āsanopabhoga* or “the enjoyment of seats” within the *Mānasollāsa* describes various kinds of royal seats. Cf. *manasollāsa*.

⁴⁷This is resembled as *yānopabhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this chapter, King Someśvara lists nine kinds of vehicles, including horses. Cf. *manasollāsa*.

⁴⁸This is resembled as *annabhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this section, King Someśvara describes the names of various kinds of great food and instructions for preparing various dishes. Cf. *manasollāsa*.

⁴⁹This is resembled as *pāṇiyabhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this chapter, everything related to drinking and drinks is described. Cf. *manasollāsa*.

could plausibly be envisaged as requesting the eight pleasures listed above. A travelling ascetic or mendicant might beg for food and drink, but hardly for silk garments, women, expensive horses, and similar luxuries. An ordinary householder might aspire to such possessions, yet the notion of begging for them still seems inappropriate. The passage therefore appears to presuppose a courtly milieu in which such costly goods could actually be requested and granted, most plausibly by wealthy patrons or members of a royal court.

In the last section of the *Tattvayogabindu* (LIX), Rāmacandra presents his *yogaśāstrarahasyasamagraśāstramadhya*, “esoteric yoga doctrine in all of the scriptures”. This chapter explicitly states that this esoteric yoga doctrine should be revealed before a king with certain qualities.

yasya rājño manomadhya kapaṭaṃ nāsti | yasmin dṛṣṭe deśakasya trāso na bhavati | tasya manaḥ śuddhaṃ bhavati | yasya pṛthivyāṃ kīrtir bhavati | yasya manomadhya satpuruṣavacanaviśvāso bhavati | yo rājā sadānanda-pūrṇo bhavati | yasya pārśve pratyakṣaṃ anekaṃ manohārivastūni bhavanti | etādṛśasya rājño 'gre yogarahasyaṃ kathañiyam |

The king in whose mind there is no deceit and, when he is seen [by his subjects] there is no fear of a ruler, [he is one who] has a purified mind. [The king] who has fame on earth; in whose mind there is trust in the speech of good people; who is a king always filled with bliss; at whose side there is an abundance of enchanting objects visible [to all], in the presence of such a king the secret of yoga shall be explained.

Next, Rāmacandra presents Sahajayoga as the ideal yoga for a *kṣatriya* or monarch:

vilāsinīnāṃ manohārigītaśravaṇāt || atisundarakāminīnāṃ rūpadarśanāt || kastūrikarpūragandhaya grahaṇāt || manaḥśītalakāryatikomalaparavastunaḥ sparśakāraṇāt || atimādhuryaṃ citte karoti | tādrśaḥ svādanāt || anekadeśānāṃ sādhasādhusthānadarśanāt || maitreṇa saha komalavacanāt || śatruṇā saha kāṭhinyavacanāt || yasya manasi harṣo vā dveṣo na bhavati | sa puruṣa īśvaropadeśako jñeyah ||

*svalīlayā vadati calati ca bhāvābhāvayoś cittam udāsīnaṃ bhavati ||
 kasyāṃcid vārttāyāṃ haṭhaṃ na karoti | yasya manaḥ sahaajānande
 magnaṃ bhavati || tena puruṣeṇa dṛṣṭiḥ sthīrā kartavyā | āsanaṃ
 dṛḍhaṃ kartavyaṃ | pavanaḥ sthīraḥ kartavyaḥ | etādṛśaḥ kaścin
 niyamaḥ siddhasya noktaḥ | manaḥpavanābhyāṃ yadā sahaajānandaḥ
 svasvarūpeṇa prakāśyate | sa sahajayogaḥ kathyate rājayogamadhye | iti
 cakravartināmakathanam |*

Because of listening to the lovely songs of charming women, looking at the beauty of very lovely women, smelling the fragrance of camphor and musk, touching objects that make the mind relax and that are extremely soft and superb, [because of all these things] he experiences exquisite beauty in the mind.

Despite enjoying such things, seeing good and bad places of many countries, speaking sweetly with friends, and speaking harshly to enemies, joyful excitement and hatred do not arise in his mind. This person is known as a teacher who conveys the instruction of the Lord (*īśvara*). For his own amusement, he speaks and moves. The mind is equanimous in both existence and non-existence. He, whose mind is immersed in inherent bliss, does not commit violence in any business.⁵⁰

By that person, the gaze shall be stabilised. The posture shall be stabilised. The breath shall be stabilised. No such discipline is prescribed for the accomplished [person]. When by means of mind and breath, the natural bliss appears through one's own true nature; it is called Sahajayoga ("natural yoga") [in this system] of Rajayoga. This is the explanation for those named *cakravartin* ("Universal Ruler").

⁵⁰The literal translation of *kasyāṃcid vārttāyāṃ haṭhaṃ na karoti* — "he does not commit violence in any business." — is both appealing and contextually plausible. At the same time, in view of the contrast with the forceful yogic practice prescribed for the non-*siddha* practitioner, which involves the stabilisation of posture, breath, and gaze, an allusion to *haṭhayoga* may also resonate here. On such a reading, *haṭha* would carry not only its ordinary sense of acting forcefully or harshly, but also evoke a deliberately forceful or effortful mode of yogic practice, in contrast to Sahajayoga, which arises naturally and without force.

A passage from the *Mokṣopāya* (2.11.3–18) sheds a brighter light on the religious aspirations of the warrior aristocracy. In a dialogue between Rāma and Vāsiṣṭha, a brief account of the “descent of knowledge” (*jñānāvatāra*) is given in order to explain to Rāma the reason why he, as a prince, is entitled to salvific knowledge. Jürgen Hanneder summarises and explains these passages as follows:

At the end of the *kṛtayuga*, when the system of ritual action (*kriyākrama*) was being lost, “protectors of the earth” (i.e. kings) were created for establishing and maintaining ritual and rules (2.11.10–11). Furthermore *smṛti*-works and ritual works were taught on earth for attaining success in the three aims of life *dharma*, *kāma* and *artha* (12). But with the passage of time the situation declined: when the people were only intent on their daily food, the kings quarrelled over lands, thus all beings became guilty and had to be punished (13–14). Then the kings could no longer protect the earth by peaceful means and became dejected together with their subjects. In order to remove their dejection, it is said, the doctrines of knowledge (*jñānadṛṣṭi*) were taught by the sages (16): First, the *adhyātmavidyā* was taught to the kings and later on spread to the people, wherefore it was called *rājavidyā* (17). Through this “secret of the kings” (*rājaguhyam*) the rulers attained a state free from suffering. There is at least one more occurrence of the term *rājavidyā* in the *Mokṣopāya*:

prabhutvaṃ samadrṣṭitvaṃ tac ca syād rājavidyayā |
tām eva yo na jānāti nāsau mantri na so 'dhipaḥ || (3.78.39)

Rulership and the condition of having equal vision—that occurs through *rājavidyā*.

Who does not know it is neither a minister nor a king.

The background of the issue of how *kṣatriyas* can obtain the salvific knowledge or become liberated is that their caste duties enjoin “cruel” actions, like law enforcement and the protection

of subjects, in the worst case, through war. Naturally, the accumulation of such bad *karmas* was seen as an impediment to the attainment of the religious aim, while their active life, and perhaps even the concept of the king as the “enjoyer of the earth” was difficult to align with the wide-spread notions of a religiously accomplished way of life that involved some kind of restraint.⁵¹

Although originating centuries before the composition of the *Tattvayogabindu*, these insights on the *kṣatradharma* have not lost their validity for *kṣatriyas* in Rāmacandra’s period. The depiction of the *yogaśāstrarahasya* presented in *Tattvayogabindu* LIX describes a lifestyle characterised by wealth and royal pleasures. Rāmacandra emphasises the dissolution of violence-induced bad *karma*. His Sahajayoga is characterised by the fact that it can be maintained without deprivations and continuous practice, making it the ideal yoga for a ruler. The king is explicitly addressed with the word *rājan* and finally with the word *cakravartin*. For this reason, the *Tattvayogabindu* is an important example of a Rājayoga text written for the warrior aristocracy and members of a royal court. The following scenario, therefore, seems most likely: Rāmacandra was a locally distinguished yogin hired by an unknown King in northern India⁵² in order to teach yoga to the members of the royal court and perhaps to the king himself.⁵³ These circumstances would also plausibly explain the relatively low register of Sanskrit. Yoga was trendy

⁵¹hanneder2006.

⁵²See n. 383 on p. 223 for a discussion of the place of the composition of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

⁵³The *Tattvayogabindu* XXVIII.1 presents a variant of a widely circulated verse, whose origins can be traced back to the *Netratantro* 7.1–2, composed between 700–850 CE, see sanderson2004. This verse presents a specific set of yogic teachings, an ancient Śaiva paradigm found in various texts. This consists of six to nine *cakras*, sixteen *ādhāras*, three to five *lakṣyas*, and five *vyomas*, *ākāśas*, or *khas*. For an overview, see p. 188. It is interesting to note that Rāmacandra gives these teachings such a central place in his *Tattvayogabindu*, as the *Netratantro*’s association with kingship has been illustrated by Alexis Sanderson, particularly its usage at the courts of Śaiva officiants in the capacity of royal priests or *rājapurohitas*. From the ninth to the eleventh century, it is well documented that Śaiva and Mahāyāna gurus conducted “apotropaic, restorative, and aggressive mantra rituals” to safeguard the king and the kingdom in the realms of South and Southeast Asia. The *Netratantro* is one such text employed by Śaiva gurus in the service of royalty. This same set of yogic teachings is also found in the *Śivayogapradīpikā*. Seth Powell (2024: 146) notes in his dissertation that the *Śivatattvaratnākara*, an extensive compendium attributed to a king named Keḷadi Basavabhūpāla (also known as Basavarāja, Basavappa Nāyaka I), who reigned from 1696–1714 in Ikkeri, Karnataka, quotes a

then and, therefore, could not be omitted from the educational program of a 16th-century Hindu royal court.⁵⁴ The *Tattvayogabindu* was commissioned by the king as a written legitimisation of the yoga teachings tailored to the royal court. Rāmacandra did not need to reinvent the wheel for this but instead used two texts that were likely important to his original religious group, the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, and rewrote them in a way that the teachings presented now directly addressed his courtly audience. This text could have served the courtiers for self-study, or perhaps Rāmacandra used it as a textual basis for his teaching at the royal court. His courtly audience likely included young courtiers such as the king's descendants. In section XXXI of the *Tattvayogabindu*, Rāmacandra explains the limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga. Here, he states explicitly that *sukumāras* ("young children" or "young princes") should not practice *prāṇāyāma*, and it is, therefore, only mentioned by name.⁵⁵ It is indeed very striking that Rāmacandra, although we know that the *Yogasvarodaya* taught many *kumbhakas* and *mudrās*, did not adopt these.⁵⁶

There is no doubt that yoga was practised at royal courts in northern India during early modern times. Jaqueline Hargreaves, in her 2020 article "Visual Evidence for Royal Yogins",⁵⁷ presents three paintings dating to the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries that depict royal yogins.

The first painting (Figure 3), created circa 1740–50 CE, depicts a prince in royal gear, such as a crown, silk scarf, and richly adorned with jewellery, his body containing depictions of Śiva at the forehead, Brahmā at the heart, and Viṣṇu at the navel. While sitting in a cross-legged yogic position, he is

large portion of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* in its seventh chapter, a section providing instructions on yoga for the king. Thus, this is yet another example of a text that provides an intriguing early modern example of the adaptation of yoga in a non-ascetic and courtly environment.

⁵⁴For a discussion of the increase in yoga's popularity at the time, see p. 474 et seqq.

⁵⁵*Tattvayogabindu* XXXI p. 206 ll. 1–2: *prāṇāyāmas tu sukumāreṇa sādhituṃ na śakyate | atas tasya nāmamātram kathyate* | I consider it very likely that Rāmacandra refrained from delivering a description of the eighth limb *samādhi* at this point. *Prāṇatoṣinī*, quoted with reference to *Yogasvarodaya* (Ed. p. 841), defines *samādhi* as: *samādhir niścālā buddhiḥ śvāsocchvāsādivarjitaḥ* | "Samādhi is the immovable intellect, devoid of inhalation, exhalation, and so forth." As a precaution, that is something that one would avoid teaching to very young yoga practitioners.

⁵⁶See p. 60, p. 61, p. 62, and p. 307.

⁵⁷[hargreaves2020](#).

performing breath control (*prāṇāyāma*). The painting is currently deposited in the Bhuri Singh Museum, Chamba in Himachal Pradesh.



Figure 3: A prince in royal gear performing breath-control (*prāṇāyāma*).

The second painting (Figure 4) from 1690–1700 C.E. depicts a crowned prince named Mandhāta seated in a yogic position and, as Hargreaves suggests, probably practising *prāṇāyāma*. This picture contains the same three deities, just in another order. Here, the lower two are reversed, with Viṣṇu at

the heart and Brahmā at the navel. The picture was obtained in India, Pahari, Nurpur and is currently in the Cleveland Museum of Art.



Figure 4: The crowned prince Mandhātā seated in a yogic position.

The third painting (Figure 5) is a miniature from circa the 19th century held in the Wellcome Collection. The painting illustrates a person called Appu Sahib Patumkar performing a yogic posture called *dhanurāsana* “bow-

posture” on an antelope’s skin. According to Hargreaves, the practitioner’s name suggests he is a person of a noble family.

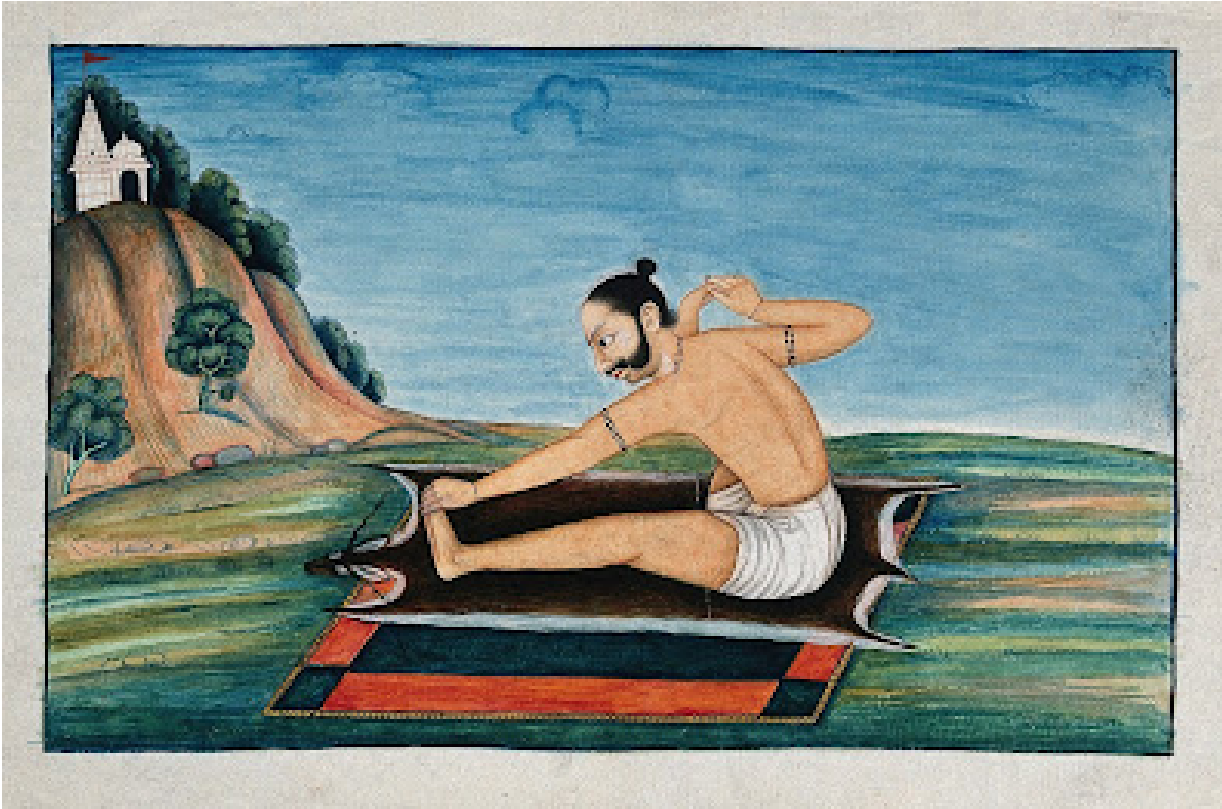


Figure 5: Appu Sahib Patumkar performing jogh [*āsana*].

In summary, the *Tattvayogabindu*, composed before 1591 CE, appears to be the earliest known work to address teachings on Rājayoga explicitly to monarchs, ranging from kings (*rājan*) to the idealised universal ruler (*cakravartin*). This strongly suggests that the term *rājayoga* is conceived here as a “yoga for kings.”

1.5 Editorial matters

THE section “Editorial Matters” covers essential text-critical formalities. Following a description of the consulted, and unconsulted witnesses, there is an initial discussion of the title. That is particularly relevant in the case of Rāmacandra’s text, where an unusual scenario arises: the text is known by at least eleven different titles according to the final rubrics of the colophons,⁵⁸ title pages, library cards, the printed edition, and citations. Thus, that phenomenon requires further discussion. Subsequently, the source texts, testimonies and parallels are briefly described and contextualised. Next, I will present a stemmatic analysis, a presentation of the text’s stylistic peculiarities, and an outline of the conventions used in the critical edition.

1.5.1 Description of the consulted witnesses

The official commencement of the funded period of the dissertation project from which this book emerged, on 15 March 2021, coincided with the extensive lockdowns and travel restrictions imposed in response to the COVID-19 pandemic. As a result, during the phase of the dissertation in which additional manuscripts might otherwise have been consulted, I was largely confined to desk-based work at home.

⁵⁸Once more I would like to stress that in order to avoid terminological confusion, I consistently follow Camillo Formigatti’s usage in distinguishing between the final rubric—the string of words marking the end of a textual unit, often including an assertion of authorship and title—and the colophon proper of a manuscript, that is, the statement providing information on the date, place, agency, or purpose of the manuscript’s production. See [colophon2022formigatti](#).

This is why, at the time of submitting this dissertation, I had been able to consult the following witnesses: B, D, E, L, N₁, N₂, P, U₁, and U₂. Approximately two weeks after successfully defending the dissertation, I took up a position on the ERC-funded “Saving the Kashmirian Sanskrit Heritage”-Project (Ka-Sa-Ha-Rakṣā) at the Philipps-Universität Marburg. For this project, I undertook a research trip through northern India in early 2025, during which I acquired not only a substantial number of digital scans and photographs of Kashmiri Śāradā manuscripts but also additional witnesses to the text edited in this dissertation. During this trip I was able to obtain eight further witnesses: C, J, K₁, K₂, K₃, P₂, S, and V. As the edition had already reached an advanced stage, I decided to collate only those new witnesses likely to be of real significance. I therefore transcribed each of them, applied various methods of computer-assisted stemmatics, integrated the witnesses into the stemma, and carefully re-examined crucial passages of the text where further manuscript evidence might prove helpful. In the end, only two manuscripts—J and K₁—provided material of genuine value: they confirmed readings previously attested only once and, in several places, rendered a number of earlier emendations unnecessary. The remaining witnesses were not worth the considerable effort of collation, as they supplied no useful variants and merely introduced additional scribal errors.

Siglum: B

Collection: Oxford Bodleian Library (OBL), Sanskrit Manuscripts of Candra Shum Shere (CSS), see **kaivalyadamanuscripts2005** of the Kaivalyadhama S.M.Y.M. Samiti (2005: 102–103).

Title: The title folio reads: *Tatvabimḍuyogaḥ*

Ms. No.: d. 458 (7)

Dimensions: 15 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Incomplete

Remarks: The first and last folio are missing. The textual evidence of B starts at section IX. The manuscript was donated to OBL by Shum Shere, Chandra Mahārāja Chandra Shamsher Jang Bahadur Rana in 1909.

Incipit: Unavailable

Final Rubric and Colophon: Unavailable

Siglum: C

Collection: Nagpur University Library (NUL), see [kaivalyadamanuscripts2005](#) (2005: 102).

Title: *Tattvabinduyoga*

Ms. No.: 5760

Dimensions: 28 cm x 16,5 cm x 12 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Incomplete (last folio is missing), otherwise very good

Remarks: The text of C is in a bad state with a high number of scribal errors such as forgotten *visargas* and *anusvaras*, lost punctuation, wrong case endings and conflation of long and short vowels. Moreover, the manuscript has many omissions of words and entire sentences as well

as conflation of separate sentences due to eyeskips, haplographies, dittographies and the rest. A detailed check of the witness could show that it contains no variants of value that would improve the established edition. In order to avoid inflating the apparatus without benefit, I refrained from collating this manuscript.

Incipit: *śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrī sarasvatyai namaḥ || śrī gurave namaḥ || atha tattv-abimḍuyogaprarambha ||*

Final Rubric and Colophon: Unavailable

Siglum: D

Collection: Saraswati Bhawan Library, Sampūrṇānanda Saṃskṛta Viśvavidyālaya, Varanasi. See **kaivalyadamanuscripts2005** of the Kaivalyadhama S.M.Y.M. Samiti (2005: 104–105).

Title: *Tattvayogabindu*

Ms. No.: 30019

Dimensions: 21 cm x 10,3 cm x 16 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1841 = 1784 CE

Condition: Incomplete

Remarks: Folios 15 & 16 are missing. The *lacuna* of D stretches from verse XLIV.9 up to section L. The scan indicates that folio 19 is missing, too. However, the text is complete on folio 18.

Incipit: *śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrī sarasvatyai namaḥ || śrī nirañjanāya namaḥ || atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate ||*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti paramahaṃsyāṃ śrīrāmacaṇḍraviracitāyāṃ
tatvayogabīṇḍu samāptaḥ || śubham astu | saṃvat 1841 || bhāḍau śudha 15 lī o
ve sarva śake rā rāma rāma cha*

Siglum: E

Title: *Binduyogaḥ with Bhāṣaṭīkā*

Collection: Kaivalyadhama Library, Lonavla

No.: 6387

Editors: Jvālāprasāda Miśra, son of the revered scholar Sukhānanda Miśra

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit and Hindi

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: 1905 CE

Condition: Contains several *lacunae*. A large section of the text is transposed.

Remarks: This is the only printed edition written in Mumbai together with Hindi Translation and *Bhāṣaṭīkā* commentary. The problematic passages of the unknown exemplar were emended or conjectured by the Pandit.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ | rājayogāntargataḥ || binduyogaḥ*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti rājayoge candraparamahaṃsaparipūrṇa-
pīṭhamāhātmyaprākāśakaḥ binduyogaḥ samāptaḥ || śubham astu || iti
śrīsarvagūṇasampannapaṇḍitasukhānandamiśrasūrisūnupaṇḍitajvālāprasā-
damiśrakṛtabhāṣaṭīkāśahito rājayoge binduyogaḥ samāptaḥ || śubham astu ||
śrīr astu ||*

Siglum: J

Collection: Jawaharlal Neru University Library, New Delhi

Title: *Tattvayogabinduḥ*

Ms. No.: 55769

Dimensions: 17 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1865, Śaka Saṃvat 1730 = 1808–1809 CE

Condition: Complete, good

Remarks: A very important manuscript which sometimes provides key readings. The manuscript is digitised and freely available online under:

<https://www.pandulipatala.nic.in/manus/search-view?id=MzAzMjg3OA%3D%3D>

Incipit: || śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrī gurubhyo namaḥ || oṃ namaḥ śrīvāsudevāya || oṃ niraṃjanāya ||

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīpāramahaṃsyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabinduḥ saṃpūrṇaṃ || || śubhaṃ bhavatu || saṃvat 1865 pramāthīnā-masaṃvatsare vai śākhavadya 10 sthiravārī narmadā tirīṭichamāṃḍe śvaṃ saṃnnidhā | nilikhiṭaṃ svarthaṃ paropakārārthaṃ ca hastākṣaraśi-varāmasaṃkarabaḍavopanaṃmakamāhadevakarena likhiṭaṃ śake 1730 caitravadyasaptamī 7 sthiravārīsaṃpūrṇaṃ || śrī kachārpaṇam astu || śrī || cha ||*

Siglum: K_I

Collection: Asiatic Society of Bengal, Kolkata

Title: *Tattvayogabindu*

Ms. No.: G 11019

Dimensions: 25,8 cm x 11,5 cm x 28 folios

Material: Handmade paper **Language:** Sanskrit **Script:** Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1818 = 1761 CE

Condition: Complete, brittle

Remarks: K₁ is one of the few complete witnesses of the stemmatically most important group of manuscripts.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrī sarasvatyai namaḥ || śrī niraṃjanāya namaḥ || atha rājayogaparakāro likhyate ||*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti paramahaṃsyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabimḍasamāptāḥ śubham astu || saṃvat 1818 samayavaisāṣavadi tṛtīyābudhavāsare || liṣitaṃ śrīdikṣitakalānāth tat putreṇa caṃdramani śubham bhūyāt || sthiti Jayatapuranagre liṣitaṃ śubham astu || śrī rādhe kṛṣṇa sahāi || śrī gaṃgāju sahāi || śrī rāmarāmarāma śrī bhavanyainamaḥ || śrī || rāmaśrīsarasvati namaḥ śrīrāmacaṃdrasahāi || śrī ||*

Siglum: K₂

Collection: Asiatic Society of Bengal, Kolkata

Title: *Tattvabinduyoga*

Ms. No.: IM 5441

Dimensions: 25,5 cm x 10,5 cm x 17 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1811 = 1754–1755 CE

Condition: Incomplete (first folio is missing), otherwise OK

Remarks: K₂ transmits the text with many scribal errors and does not contain any helpful variants that would improve the edition. Thus, I refrained from full collation.

Incipit: Unavailable

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīrāmacaṇḍraparamahaṃsavirācitas tatv-abinduযোগা সমাপ্তাহ || 1 || śubhaṃ || saṃvat || 1811 || ++ || cha |*

Siglum: K₃

Collection: Asiatic Society of Bengal, Kolkata

Title: *Tattvayogabindu*

Ms. No.: G 5538A

Dimensions: 25,1 cm x 15 cm x 25 folios

Material: Handmade paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Bengali

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Complete, very good

Remarks: I located manuscript K₃ during my research trip through northern India in the spring of 2025. Although I was able to ascertain that the manuscript belongs to the β -tradition (see the stemmatic analysis), I was unable to consult it in full for two reasons. First, the Asiatic Society of Bengal in Kolkata provides digital reproductions for only about thirty per cent of any given manuscript. Second, during my four-day stay in Kolkata I was able to transcribe only two of the three available

witnesses— K_1 and K_2 —in their entirety. Owing to time constraints, the prioritisation of other material, and my limited confidence in reading the Bengali script, I could not examine or transcribe K_3 with the same degree of precision. A member of staff kindly transcribed the first two folios for me, allowing me at least to form an initial impression of the manuscript's quality. Manuscript K_3 proved to be a typical β -witness, transmitting the characteristic β -readings and already exhibiting several of its typical errors. A complete consultation, inclusion in the stemmatic analysis, and, if appropriate, collation therefore remain desiderata.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ | śrīśarasvatāya namaḥ | śrīnirañjanāya namaḥ | atha rājayogaparakāra likhyate |*

Final Rubric and Colophon: Unavailable

Siglum: L

Collection: Lalchand Research Library Ancient Indian Manuscript Collection, Chandigarh; **srivastava2017lal** (2017: 251) = Hoshiarpur Vishveshvarananda Vedic Research Institute's (HVVRI) Ms. No. 5876 "*Tattvabindūyogaḥ* by Rāmacandra", see **kaivalyadamanuscripts2005** of the Kaivalyadhama S.M.Y.M. Samiti (2005: 102–103). All Manuscripts of HVVRI have been transferred to Chandigarh.

Title: *Tattvabinduyoga*

Ms. No.: 5876

Dimensions: 43 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Complete

Remarks: The manuscript is digitised and freely available online under:
<https://dav.splrarebooks.com/collection/view/tattvabinduyogah>

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ | atha tattvabimḍuyogaprārambhaḥ*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti rājamacaṁdraparahamaṁsaviracites tatvabimḍuyogasamāptaṁ || śrīkṛṣṇārpaṇam astu || cha ||*

Siglum: N_I

Collection: National Archives, Kathmandu; microfilmed by the Nepalese German Manuscript Preservation Project (NGMPP) and catalogued by the Nepalese German Manuscript Cataloguing Project (NGMCP).

Title: *Tattvayogabindu*

Ms. No.: B 38/31

Acc No.: NAK 5/2724

Dimensions: 26.5 cm x 8.5 cm x 13 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Pracalita (Nepālākṣara)

Date: Nepal Saṁvat 837 = 1716 CE

Condition: Incomplete (4 folios are missing)

Remarks: N_I is among the oldest dated extant textual witnesses of Rāmacandra's and often provides important readings. After section XXXIV, there is a *lacuna* until section XLVIII, approximately 23.50% of the entire text is missing. In light of the shared lacuna and its later date, N_I

must either depend directly on N₂ or descend from a common exemplar.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrīgurave namaḥ || atha rājayogaparakāro likhyate ||*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīparamarahasyāṃ śrīrāmacaṇḍraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabindu samāptaḥ || || śrīsvasti || || saṃvat 837 || vinā guru na siddhati ||*

[Second hand adds in a mix of Nepālī and Newārī:]

*eka vacana sosyā sālikaseṃ caudha bhuvana kā mola ||
kahane soka haḍiyā avakyā vajāye me ḍhola || 1 ||*

popoṣṭakamā 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 ja(m)mā 4 patra aghaḍiṣi ṭaṭāye ++ ho

Siglum: N₂

Collection: National Archives, Kathmandu; microfilmed by the Nepalese German Manuscript Preservation Project (NGMPP) and catalogued by the Nepalese German Manuscript Cataloguing Project (NGMCP).

Title: *Tattvayogavinda* (= *Tattvayogabindu*; the title folio reads: *srī rājayogabinduprārambhah*. The library card reads *Rājayogatattvabindu*.)

Ms. No.: B 38/35 = A 1327-14

Acc No.: NAK 3/750

Dimensions: 33 cm x 16 cm (B 38/35) and 32 cm x 16 cm (A 1327-14) x 11 folios

Material: Paper **Language:** Sanskrit **Script:** Devanāgarī

Date: Nepal Saṃvat 712 = 1591 or 1592 CE. Most likely, 21 June 1591.⁵⁹

⁵⁹I would like to express my sincere gratitude to Dr. Stanislav Jager, Prof. Dr. Dragomir Dimitrov, Dr. Martin Gansten, and, in particular, Anupam Suman for sharing their thoughts in decoding this intricate *bhūtasāmṅkhyā*-date. According to all the mentioned scholars (per-

Condition: Incomplete

sonal correspondence in person and via Email in December 2025), the colophon verse *sūrye turaṅge navacandraghasre jyeṣṭhākhyakṛṣṇe bhṛguvārayuktam* encodes a calendrical date in the Nepal Saṃvat era using the *bhūtasāṃkhyā* system along with standard lunar terminology. The *bhūta* numerals *sūrye* (=12, corresponding to the twelve Ādityas or solar months) and *turaṅge* (=7, corresponding to the seven horses of the solar chariot) together yield the year 712, which is to be read in reverse order according to established *bhūtasāṃkhyā* convention. The remainder of the verse specifies the lunar day and month (*navacandraghasre* = *amāvāsyā* or new-moon day; *jyeṣṭhākhyakṛṣṇe* = month of Jyeṣṭha, Kṛṣṇa pakṣa) and fixes the weekday (*bhṛguvārayuktam* = Friday).

A critical chronological question that Suman and Gansten pointed out to me is whether the year “712” should be interpreted as an elapsed (completed) year, as is often assumed in Indian chronological studies, or as the ongoing (running) year. Suman notes that the verse employs the locative case throughout (*sūrye turaṅge*...), situating the act of writing “in the year 712” without any explicit qualifiers such as *gate* (past), *atite* (gone), or *samāpte* (completed) that would unambiguously indicate a completed year. This usage aligns with other Nepal Saṃvat colophons in which the locative is used to specify the current year at the time of composition.

Astronomical testing confirms the necessity of reading NS 712 as a running year. If treated as elapsed (≈1592 CE), no occurrence of Jyeṣṭha Kṛṣṇa Amāvāsyā falling on a Friday can be established. Interpreted as a running year, however, the lunar and weekday data correspond precisely to 21 June 1591 CE, which is demonstrably Jyeṣṭha Kṛṣṇa Amāvāsyā and a Friday. This agreement is decisive, leaving little doubt that the author intended a running-year reckoning. Moreover, Suman emphasises that the date reflects the *amānta* lunar system (in which a month begins immediately after the new moon), as is standard in Nepal Saṃvat, rather than the *pūrṇimānta* system typical in North India.

Suman’s interpretation is further supported by parallels in other Nepalese manuscripts catalogued in the Nepal-German Manuscript Preservation Project (NGMPP), where locative constructions with full lunar details consistently yield coherent dates only when the year is understood as running. Historical precedent also supports this approach: **bendall1883** in the introduction and passim of his 19th-century Cambridge catalogue, stressed that Nepalese manuscript dates cannot be mechanically inferred from the year number alone, noting instances in which the *tithi* and weekday would be inconsistent with an elapsed-year reading. Similarly, **petech1984** in his chapters on chronology and dating practices has shown that Nepal Saṃvat dates in inscriptions and manuscripts must be tested both astronomically and historically, warning against assuming uniform elapsed-year reckoning and demonstrating that a current-year framework is sometimes required when detailed calendrical elements are supplied.

Taken together, locative grammar, manuscript parallels, and astronomical evidence establish the methodological principle that Nepal Saṃvat dates expressed in the locative must be interpreted in conjunction with internal calendrical details. Accordingly, the colophon year “712” must be understood as a running year. The corresponding historical date is therefore: Nepal Saṃvat 712 (running year), Jyeṣṭha Kṛṣṇa Amāvāsyā, Friday = 21 June 1591 CE. Suman also rules out the possibility of Śaka Saṃvat both philologically and astronomically. Furthermore, Suman argues, the precision of the date may reflect the author’s deliberate choice, as 21 June 1591 falls on a new-moon day governed by the *ārdra nakṣatra*, which is particularly auspicious for yogic and Śaiva matters.

Remarks: Manuscript N₂ has a *lacuna* after section XXXIV up until section XLVIII. Approximately 23,50% of the entire text is missing. The *lacuna* is indicated on f. 8 recto l. 1. It stops at the same place where manuscript N₁ has missing folios. Thus, we have to assume that manuscript N₁ is either a direct copy of manuscript N₂ or both stem from the same exemplar. The latter is more likely since N₂ sometimes includes several different and sometimes better readings.

For the critical reader, it should be noted that the palaeographical features of the manuscript—an almost modern-looking Devanāgarī hand on paper—leave open the question of whether the date recorded in N₂ refers to the manuscript itself or whether, as initially seemed quite possible, the scribe merely copied the colophon from the exemplar without indicating the precise date of the present copy. This possibility, however, can now be ruled out. As already observed by **bendall1883**, the dated Nepalese manuscripts of the sixteenth century available to him share several characteristic features: paper had by then become the dominant writing material; the horizontal headline is almost continuous, while the vertical strokes frequently project slightly above it; and the overall ductus appears regular, square, and distinctly Devanāgarī in character. All of the general features identified by Bendall are present in N₂, making it plausible that, in this case, the colophon genuinely belongs to the manuscript itself.

Furthermore, following a suggestion by Prof. Dr. Dragomir Dimitrov, I compared the orthographical features of the manuscript with scans of all dated Nepalese Nāgarī manuscripts from the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries that were available for purchase online at the time from the “Staatsbibliothek zu Berlin”. I examined the following manuscripts: *Kālītattva* (NGMPP Reel No. A 207-4), *Mādhavanidāna* (A 224-11), *Mṛtyuharalāṅgaśaḍakṣaramantravidhi* (A 246-19), *Skandapurāṇa* (A 259-5), *Skandapurāṇa* (A 292-9), *Skandapurāṇa* (A 300-2), *Vṛttaratnākara* (A 356-7), *Samjñānvivekavivṛti* (A 414-28(2)), *Ratnadīpa* (A 423-42), *Raudriyameghamālā* (A 424-16), *Siddhāntaśiromaṇi* (A 432-12), *Saṁjñātāntra* (A 433-9), *Apāmārjanastotra* (A 468-41), (*Śivaprokta*) *Īśvaraśa-*

hasranāmastotra (A 471-31), *Prāyaścittaprakaraṇa* (A 521-3), *Vaiyākaraṇabhūṣaṇa* (A 570-3), *Gotrapravarānirṇaya* (B 407-13), *Kātantravṛttipañjikā* (B 458-17), *Kakṣapuṭa* (C 25-5). The great majority of these manuscripts display palaeographical features highly similar to the almost modern-looking Devanāgarī hand of N₂, confirming with a high degree of certainty that N₂ is, in all likelihood, an original sixteenth-century manuscript rather than a more recent copy of an older exemplar.

NGMCP catalogues another scan of the same manuscript under NGMPP Reel No. A 1327-14. The dimensions differ in the catalogue, but this must be sloppy cataloguing, since it is definitely the same manuscript. However, the latter scan is poor.

Incipit: ⁶⁰*śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ || atha rājayogaparakāro likhyate ||*

Final Rubric and Colophon: ⁶¹*iti śrīparamarahasye śrīrāmacaṇḍraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogavinda samāptam ||*

|| śubham ||

*yad akṣarapadabhraṣṭaṃ mātrāhīnaṃ ca yad bhavet ||
tat sarvaṃ kṣamya tām eva prasīda parameśvara ||1||*

*sūrye turaṅge navacandraghasre
jyeṣṭhākhyakṛṣṇe bhṛguvārayuktam ||
tattvaprayogaḥ ṣaḍaḥarṣasamjñam
likhitam suhetoh bhavatiha dehi || bhūyāt ||⁶²*

⁶⁰ See p. iii for the facsimile of first folio of N₂.

⁶¹ See p. iv for the facsimile of final folio of N₂.

⁶² The final two *pādas* are grammatically highly problematic and contain a metrical error that clearly indicates textual corruption. Moreover, the terminology renders a convincing interpretation particularly difficult. Nevertheless, I would like to propose the following partial restoration of the final to *pādas* together with a tentative translation of the final verse of N₂:

Siglum: P

Collection: Bhandakar Oriental Research Institute (BORI), Pune; see **kaivalyadamanuscripts2005** of the Kaivalyadhama S.M.Y.M. Samiti (2005: 394–395), here catalogued under the title *Rājayoga*.

Title: *Tattvabinduyoga* (The library card reads *Rājayoga* (*Tattvabinduyoga*)).

tattvaprayogaṃ śaḍakṣarasamjñam
likhitam suhetoh bhavaniyam dehin || bhūyāt ||

On Friday, on the new-moon day of the dark fortnight of [the month called] Jyeṣṭhā, in the [Nepal Saṃvat] year 712 [understood as the current year; corresponding to 21 June 1591 CE], [this] application of [supreme] reality, bearing a six-syllabled designation (*Ta-ttva-yo-ga-bi-ndu*), was written for a good purpose. [It is] to be contemplated, O embodied one. May it endure!

The main problem of the verse lies in its transmitted reading *śaḍaharṣa*°, which is semantically unintelligible. The context suggests it as a possible alternative title for the work. However, judging the contents of the *Tattvayogabindu śaḍa-harṣa*° understood as “six non-joys” seems extremely unlikely. Not much better is to ignore the “a” or to explain it to be secondarily appended to *śaḍ*° in order to satisfy metrical constraints or to suspect influences of local linguistic usage in order to take it as “six joys,” perhaps referring to the six faculties (the five senses plus *manas*; cf. the *yamas* in *TYB XXXI*). Both interpretations are unable to convince. The word must therefore be regarded as corrupt.

Furthermore, the verse is grammatically incongruent: *likhitam* as well as *bhavati* are syntactically redundant, thereby producing a semantically unstable sequence. The word *dehi* is likewise problematic. It may be corrupt, and no fully satisfactory emendation readily suggests itself. Regarding the latter problem, two interpretations seem conceivable: either as a second-person singular imperative, which is contextually weak, or as a vocative singular in the non-standard form *dehi* (instead of the expected *dehin*), the omission of the final nasal being attributable to a minor scribal error.

Accordingly, I emend to *dehin*. Furthermore, I emend to °*prayogaṃ* in order to establish grammatical congruence and to imply an elided *idaṃ* as the nominative singular subject of the sentence. As discussed above, since *śaḍaharṣa* is not a plausible candidate for an alternative title of the work, whereas °*samjñam*, as the final member of a Bahuvrīhi compound, is congruent with °*prayogaṃ* and referring to the title that was written (*likhitam*), would be expected, the best conjecture I can propose is *śaḍakṣara*°, alluding to the six-syllabled title of the text given previously in the final rubric of the colophon. I have considered alternative conjectures at length; however, among other possibilities I explored—such as *śrīrahasya*°, *sapraharṣa*°, or *śaḍahani* in combination with *saṃsthām* in place of *samjñam*—*śaḍakṣara*° currently appears to me the most plausible solution. Additionally, I propose to emend the odd, redundant, and suspicious formulation *bhavatiha* in the light of *tattvaprayogaṃ* to the almost obvious gerundive form *bhavaniyam*.

Finally, a metrical irregularity remains, which I am presently unable to resolve. Ultimately, this reconstruction represents only my current best hunch and does not entirely resolve this perhaps irrecoverably corrupt verse.

Ms. No.: 644

Dimensions: 25 cm x 11,2 cm x 29 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1867 = 1810 CE

Condition: Complete

Incipit: *śrīṇe ya mah | atha rājayoga liṣyate*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīrāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas tattv-
abinduyogasamāptaḥ saṃvat 1867 pauṣakṛṣṇaḥ 12 ravau śubham bhuyāt || cha
||*

Siglum: P₂

Collection: Anandashrama Sanstha, Pune

Title: *Rājayogamāhātmya*

Ms. No.: 81/359

Dimensions: 22 folios

Material: Paper **Language:** Sanskrit **Script:** Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Incomplete, very good

Remarks: The cover folio reads: *rājayoga māhātmya*. The final folios are lost. The second last chapter on folio 22 is introduced with: *idānīm yogasya māhātmyaṃ kathyate*—hence the title on the cover folio. Since a colophon is missing but the manuscript belongs to the 7-group I expect *Tattvabinduyoga* to be the title of the manuscript. A thorough

check of the manuscript and its reading resulted in the decision to refrain from collation as there were no variants that would have improved the edition.

The manuscript is digitised and freely available online under:
<https://www.pandulipipatala.nic.in/manus/search-view?id=MzUwMjA5MA%3D%3D>

Incipit: || *śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ* || *gurubhyo namaḥ* || *kuladaivyai namaḥ* || *śrī ā+in-āthāya nam+*

Final Rubric and Colophon: Unavailable

Siglum: S

Collection: M. T. R. College Manuscript Library, Surat

Title: The library card reads *Rājayoga*. The original title is lost due to loss of final folio.

Ms. No.: 601

Dimensions: 33 cm x 16 cm x 11 folios

Material: Paper **Language:** Sanskrit **Script:** Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Incomplete, final folios missing, first folio broken in der upper right corner

Remarks: The library card suggests the text includes a commentary.⁶³ However, this is a misunderstanding of the catalogist. Most probably due to the fact that the manuscript begins with a couple of *śloka*s and then switches to prose. Furthermore, the manuscript completely dispenses punctuation. One looks in vain for a *daṇḍa* or the like. Specific variants indicate that this manuscript may be the direct model for the printed

⁶³The library card gives the title: “Rājayoga with commentary”.

edition, or that both this manuscript and the printed edition derive from the same exemplar. The textual witness is characterised above all by a lot of scribal errors, wrong case endings, and forgotten *anusvāras*. A detailed check of the witness could show that it contains no variants of value that would improve the established edition. In order to avoid inflating the apparatus without benefit, I refrained from collating this manuscript.

Incipit: || śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ || gurubhyo namaḥ || kuladaivyai namaḥ || śrī ā+in-āthāya nam+

Final Rubric and Colophon: Unavailable

Siglum: U_I

Collection: Scindia Oriental Research Institute (SORI) Vikram University (Ujjain), see **kaivalyadamanuscripts2005** of the Kaivalyadhama S.M.Y.M. Samiti (2005: 104–105, 246–247).

Title: *Tattvayogaviduḥ* (The title folio reads: *atha yogataprāraṃbhaḥ*.)

Ms. No.: 1574

Dimensions: 20 cm x 13 cm x 45 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Incomplete

Remarks: Manuscript U_I contains a *lacuna* within section LVII. This comparatively large and important section is almost entirely absent in this manuscript. Especially during the great *lacuna* in N₁ and N₂, the readings of this manuscript became important with regard to the constitution of the text.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ || atha rājayoga likhyate ||*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīpāramahaṃsyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ
tatvayogaviduḥ samāptāḥ śubhaṃ bhūyāt ||*

Siglum: U₂

Collection: Scindia Oriental Research Institute (SORI) Vikram University (Ujjain), see **kaivalyadamanuscripts2005** of the Kaivalyadhama S.M.Y.M. Samiti (2005: 394–395), here catalogued under the title *Rājayoga*.

Title: *Tattvabindu yoga*. (The title folio reads: *atha śrīrājayogaprārāmbhaḥ || śrīrāmavaracitena ||*)

Ms. No.: 6082

Dimensions: 21 cm x 11 cm x 37 folios

Material: Paper **Language:** Sanskrit **Script:** Devanāgarī

Scribe: Bābājī Rājadherakara

Date: Śaka 1805, Vikram Saṃvat 1940 = 1883 CE

Condition: Complete

Remarks: This manuscript contains lengthy additions on the ninefold *cakra* system in the sections IV–XII.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrīgurave namaḥ || atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate ||*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīrāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas tattvabindu-yogasamāptāḥ ||*

*śrīśubhaṃ bhavatu || śrīsītārāmārpaṇam astuḥ || idaṃ pustakaṃ || śake 1805 ||
vikramārka saṃmat || 1940 || jayanāmasaṃvatsare || udagayaṇe || grīṣmar̥tau
|| vaiśākhe māse || kṛṣṇapakṣe || tithau 23 || bhānuvāsare || prathamayāmye ||*

*śrīkṣetra avaṃtikāyām || śrīmahārudramahākālasaṃnidhānena saṃpūrṇam ||
lekhanam ānaṃt? suta? bābāji rājadherakareṇa likhyate ||*

*yādṛśam pustakam dṛṣtvā tādṛśam likhitam mayā ||
yadi śuddham aśuddho vā mama doṣo na dīyate ||1||*

śrīrāma || cha ||

Siglum: V

Collection: Baroda Oriental Institute, Central Library, Vadodara. See **baroda1950** (1950: 1238).

Title: *Tattvayogavicārah*

Ms. No.: 10558

Dimensions: 26 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1751 = 1694 CE

Condition: Complete, good

Remarks: Apart from the fact that V is the second oldest extant dated manuscript of the *Tattvayogabindu*, the manuscript displays numerous attempts at abbreviating the text (e.g., using *ādi* instead of complete enumerations, or omitting entire sentences deemed redundant or insignificant). At the same time, essential syntactic elements appear to have been inadvertently omitted, making deliberate and accidental abridgements difficult to distinguish. The redactor frequently replaces

the expected °*madhye* with a locative, and repeatedly attempts to optimise verbal constructions, often with questionable results. Aside from being an old dated witness and an interesting variant of the final colophon, the manuscript contains no important variants but an overwhelming number of minor ones. Furthermore, the manuscript also exhibits numerous omissions, duplications, and conflation of syntactically similar sentences, characteristic of this text's transmission. Including it in the collation would have caused the critical apparatus to become unmanageable. Therefore, I was forced to eliminate the witness. The only thing worth mentioning is an additional verse inserted between verses XLIV.1 and XLIV.2: *āvadhūta aiśvaryaś ca samagraś ca dharmaś ca yanāśaḥ śrīyaḥ jñānavairāgyasaṃyuktaḥ ṣaṇāṃ bhaga++tiraṇā* (V, fol. 27v, ll. 3-4).

Incipit: || *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ* || || *atha rājayogaprakārāḥ likhyamte* ||

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti paramahaṃsasamhitāyāṃ haṃsyāṃ srīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogavicārah* || || *saṃ 1751 mārگاśīrṣa śūdi pa somo likhitam* ||

1.5.2 Manuscripts not consulted

1.5.2.1 Important

- Kolkata (former Calcutta) Sanskrit Library. NCC: CS. III. 65. = *calcutta1900*. Title: *Tattvayogabinduḥ*. Author: Paramahaṃsa Rāmacandra. Material: Countrymade white paper. Dimensions 9x 3 inches x 22 folios. Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1847 (1790 CE). Condition: old, slightly worm-eaten, generally correct and complete. This manuscript is the most important among the unconsulted ones. The title indicates that it belongs to the β -group. During my research trip through India in early 2025, I visited the Kolkata Sanskrit Library. Unfortunately, a staff change happened to take place at that very time, so I was unable to order a digital copy of the manuscript. Since then, I have tried multiple times to place the order, but unfortunately without success so far.

- Sanskrit Vidyāpeetham near Yamuna Kinare, Etawah (U.P.). Title: *Tattvabindūyogaḥ*. Author: Rāmacandraḥ. Script: Devanāgarī. Condition: incomplete. Ms. No: ESV 7 (P20), see **kaivalyadamanuscripts2005** of the Kaivalyadhama S.M.Y.M. Samiti (2005: 102–103). The title of the manuscript indicates that it should belong to the γ -group.

1.5.2.2 Damaged

- Lucknow Sanskrit Parishad. **lucknow2021**. Title: *Rājayoga Prakāraḥ?*. Author: Rāmacandra. Serial No.: 74. Accession No.: 1266. Condition: Incomplete. Only two folios. Condition and Age: Recent.

1.5.2.3 Probably unobtainable

- NCC: Darbhanga Raj 2146 (inc.). Probably: Descriptive Catalogue of Raj Manuscripts Preserved in Kameshwar Singh Sanskrit University, Darbhanga. Title: *Rājayogaprakāra*. <https://lnmu.ac.in>. Unfortunately, I have no access to the catalogue.
- CPB. (Ms. No.: 4579–80. **nagpur1926**. Title “Rājayoga”. Author: Rāmacandra Paramahansa. Subject: Yoga. Owner. (4579) Nārāyaṇ Purāṇī of Hardā (Hoshangābād district). (4580) Viśvambharnāth of Ratanpur (Bilāspur district). Comment: According to what I heard from my colleagues, these manuscripts might be hard to track down. Possibly, it is manuscript C stored Nagpur University Library (NUL).

1.5.3 Discussion of the text’s original title

It is striking that there is disagreement among the witnesses of Rāmacandra’s text regarding the title. The variants are: *Tattvabinduyoga*, *Tattvayogabindu*, (*Tattvayogaviduḥ*), *Tattvayogavicāraḥ*, *Rājayogatattvabindu*, *Binduyoga*, *Rājayoga*, *Rājayogaprakāra*, *Rājayogavicāra*, *Rājayogamāhātmya* and *Tattvajñānapradīpikā*.

Five of the manuscripts of the γ -group⁶⁴ consulted for this critical edition—B, K₂, L, P and U₂, bear the title *Tattvabinduyoga* according to their final

⁶⁴See p.73 for the stemmatic analysis of the manuscripts.

rubrics. The printed edition E is titled *Binduyogaḥ*. From a stemmatological perspective, the printed edition E must descend from a γ -group manuscript.

It is challenging to derive a convincing meaning from the title *Tattvabinduyoga* and even *Binduyoga*, especially considering the actual content of the work. The term *bindu* does not appear even once in the entire text. Exploring various possible interpretations and translations of this compound, such as “Yoga of the points/essence of reality,” none seem satisfactory. If an interpretation of such a title were correct, one would expect an explanation of *bindu* in the text. Although various yoga practices involving concentration on specific bodily points are mentioned frequently, these are never referred to as *bindus*.

It is not apparent why Jvālāprasāda Mīśra, the editor of the 1905 printed edition, very likely made the editorial decision to discard the title of his exemplar⁶⁵ and rename the text to *Binduyoga* as it does not enhance the title’s relevance to the work. The term *binduyoga*, for example appearing in the *Amṛtasiddhi* (7.14), where *binduyoga* designates its core yoga practice⁶⁶ is not applicable here, as Rāmacandra neither teaches *mudrās* nor practices involving sexual fluids.⁶⁷ Nor does the term *bindu* in Rāmacandra’s text function as an ultimate *tattva* within a system of *tattvas*, as it does, for example, in *tattva* systems of Śaivism.⁶⁸ In fact, Rāmacandra’s text teaches a tenfold *tattva* system that does not require *bindu* as the ultimate *tattva*.⁶⁹ The only plausible, simple, and natural explanation is that Jvālāprasāda Mīśra must have understood *Binduyoga* as “Yoga of the points [for concentration],” given that larger chunks of the text teach *cakras*, *lakṣyas*, and *ādhāras* for meditation.

⁶⁵The exemplar of the printed edition is unknown. However, since it must be a manuscript of the γ -group, all of which refer to the text as *Tattvabinduyoga*, and the printed edition contains only two (*bindu* and *yoga*) of the three elements of the title-giving compound (with *tattva* missing), it is highly likely that an editorial decision was made to deviate from the original title in the final rubric of the exemplar.

⁶⁶*Amṛtasiddhi* 7.14: *binduyogaṃ parityajya yo mohād anyam icchatī | sa śākhōṭakavṛkṣeṣu mūḍho jāgṛti niṣphalam ||*

⁶⁷On the contrary, Rāmacandra discredits the practice of *mudrās* in section LVIII.

⁶⁸See *gengnagel1996* for the 36 *tattvas* of Śaivasiddhānta. Additionally, see *goodall2016tattvas* for a discussion on the genesis of the Śaiva *tattva* systems.

⁶⁹*Tattvayogabindu* XXII l. 4 mentions earth (*prthvī*), water (*āp*), fire (*tejas*), wind (*vāyu*), space (*ākāśa*), mind (*manas*), intellect (*buddhi*), illusion (*māyā*), transformations (*vikāra*), and form (*rūpa*).

For these reasons, and notably because the term *bindu* does not appear in the work, it is highly unlikely that Rāmacandra's text was originally titled *Tattvabinduyoga*.

Instead, the title of the γ -group manuscripts likely originated from the same archetype as the β -group manuscripts, specifically J, K₁, D, N₁, N₂, and U₁, all of which bear the title *Tattvayogabindu* in their final rubrics. Given that the β -group not only contains the oldest extant dated manuscripts of the text but also frequently offers superior readings, it can be asserted with high confidence that the γ -group title resulted from a metathesis of the two compound elements *bindu* and *yoga*.

Considering the aforementioned issues with the term *bindu*, which appears only in the title and not within the text, this title makes better sense. The term °*bindu* is a common suffix in titles of various Sanskrit texts.⁷⁰ The employment of the term “°*bindu*” in the titles of these texts emphasises the idea of expressing essential, seminal points in a condensed way to make complex topics more accessible and intelligible. As such, the term suggests that each work strives to distil the essence of its subject into basic doctrines or principles. In the case of Rāmacandra's text, °*bindu* makes perfect sense when understood in this way.

Based on the textual evidence of the manuscripts alone, it is highly probable that the final rubrics of the γ -group result from a metathesis of the final two elements of the title compound. The β -group, therefore, in all likelihood preserves a form of the title that is closer to the original than that transmitted by the remaining manuscripts. The only outlier is the second oldest extant dated manuscript, V, which is distinguished above all by its conspicuous editorial interventions and its frequently unsuccessful attempts to optimise or simplify the Sanskrit. These efforts often involve the omission of clauses or the peculiar conflation of two or more sentences. In its final rubric, this manuscript presents the title *Tattvayogavicārah*. I understand the

⁷⁰See, for example, stb1 NGMPP, Ms. No. MA 905-3 and NGMPP, Ms. No. E 1189-13 (“Drops of the [supreme] reality of Siddhānta”); *Nyāyabindu* (“Drops of reasoning”), NCC Vol 10. (2007: 252); *Nirṇayabindu* (“Drops of verdict”), NCC Vol 10. (2007: 146); *Bhaktibindu* (“Drops of devotion”), NCC Vol 15. (2007: 148); *Dharmabindu* (“Drops of law”), NCC Vol. 9 (2007: 257), etc.

final compound-member °*vicārah* as yet another editorial “improvement,” intended to convey the sense of ‘investigation’ or ‘reflection’. The sequence *Tattvayoga*° is thereby preserved, and it is reasonable to assume that, in cases of metathesis within longer compounds, it is generally the later elements rather than the initial member that are affected. Without exception, all manuscripts that preserve a final rubric read *Tattva*° as the first word of the title. The manuscript evidence thus speaks unequivocally: the most probable original title was *Tattvayogabindu*. How, then, did the other titles come into being? Sundaradeva’s *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*, which cites extensively from Rāmacandra’s text⁷¹ without attribution—an unusual omission, as he typically cites his other sources—suggests that he either did not accept the title as it appeared in his exemplar, or that it had simply been lost. Another testimony, titled *Yogasamgraha*, quotes approximately 20% of Rāmacandra’s entire text.⁷² In this case, the author, in the course of quotation, renames the work *Tattvajñānapradīpikā* for reasons unknown. Further titles also circulate, found both on manuscript cover pages and in catalogue entries. These titles—such as *Rājayoga*, *Rājayogaprakāra*, *Rājayogavicāra*, or *Rājayogamāhātmya*—are either the result of librarians working with exemplars that, owing to folio loss, lacked a final rubric and colophon, or they may have been adopted because the titles available in the final rubrics appeared misleading, given that all such variants occur in witnesses belonging in most instances to the γ-group of manuscripts.

Another title, however, attested only on the library card of N₂, is *Rājyogātattvabindu*. The final rubric of N₂, however, clearly reads *Tattvayogavinda* (obviously a corruption of *Tattvayogabindu*). At first sight, *Rājyogātattvabindu* or *Yogātattvabindu* appears to be a plausible and meaningful title for the work when understood as “Drops of the [supreme] reality of yoga.” This inevitably raises the question: Is it possible that even the title preserved in the β-group has succumbed to textual corruption? Could the title of the β-group itself be the result of metathesis, with the three components of the compound having been confused by scribes at an early stage of transmission? The following

⁷¹For references see p. 69.

⁷²For references see p. 68.

text-immanent observation could lend support to the possibility that no surviving manuscript preserves the title in its original form. In section LVIII, ll. 1–8, Rāmacandra's text reads:

*idānīm yogasya mähātmyam kathyate | guror anugrahāt | śāstrasya
paṭhanāt | ācāraḥkaraṇāt | vedāntarahasyaśravaṇāt | dhyānakaraṇāt |
layasādhanāt | upavāsakaraṇāt | caturaśītyāsanāsādhanāt | vairāgyasya-
otpatteḥ | vairāgyakaraṇāt | haṭhayogasya karaṇāt | idāpiṅgalayoḥ pa-
vanadhāraṇāt | mahāmudrādidaśamudrāsādhanāt | maunakaraṇāt |
vanavāsāt | bahutarakleśakaraṇāt | bahutarakālaṃ yantramāntrādi-
sādhanāt | tapaḥkaraṇāt | bahutarārthadānāt | tīrthasevākaraṇāt |
āśramācārapālanāt | samṇyāsagrahaṇāt | śaḍḍarśanagrahaṇāt | śīro-
muṇḍanāt | anyopāyakaraṇāt | **yogatattvaṃ** na prāpyate | sa tu yogo
gurusevayā prāpyate |*

Now, the majesty of yoga is taught.

As a result of the grace of the teacher, studying the teaching, execution of good conduct, hearing the secret of Vedānta, meditation, dissolution, fasting, practising 84 postures, generating indifference, cultivating indifference, doing Haṭhayoga, holding the breath of the Iḍā- and Piṅgalā-channels, practising the ten seals beginning with the great seal, observing silence, dwelling in the forest, causing excessive distress, practising Mantra and Yantra, etc. for a long time, doing austerities, giving many donations, frequenting places of pilgrimage, observing the conduct [proper] to the stages of life, adhering to renunciation, grasping the six philosophies, shaving the head, doing other methods, the **reality of yoga** is not attained. But this [reality of] yoga is truly attained by serving the teacher.

The negation of these practices, associated with yoga and even those previously taught by Rāmacandra himself, clearly indicates that this passage constitutes a central doctrinal statement of the entire work. The compound *tattvayoga* never occurs elsewhere in the text, whereas *yogatattva* appears

only at this single location. Given the centrality of this passage and the inconsistencies noted above in the titles transmitted by the β - and γ -groups, it appears conceivable that the original title of the work may have been *Yogatattvabindu*.

This hypothesis—while not entirely implausible and therefore not to be categorically dismissed—ultimately lacks persuasive force, since it is supported not by manuscript evidence, as argued above, but solely by the library card of N₂. It must nevertheless be noted that, in addition to the library card of manuscript N₂, which reads *Rājayogatattvabindu*, the first folio of manuscript U₁ introduces the text with *atha yogata[ttva?]prāraṃbhaḥ*. A plausible explanation for the appearance of the compound °*yogatattva*° on the library card may lie in the frequency of this word combination within the broader Yoga literature. A search through the commonly used e-text corpora circulated among scholars of Yoga and Tantra yielded the following results: the combination *tattvayoga* produced only 19 occurrences, whereas *yogatattva* appeared 109 times. The latter compound is also frequently attested in the titles of Yoga works.⁷³ Thus, this can be regarded as an understandable error on the part of a librarian when labelling a library card.

The existence of so many variants of the title in the final rubrics, manuscript cover pages, and catalogue entries can ultimately be attributed only to an early scribal error in the transmission of the text—a metathesis involving entire words, which at an early stage transformed the compound of the work's title from *tattvayogabindu* into *tattvabinduyoga*. Subsequent scribes or editors then either introduced further metatheses, attempted to correct what they perceived as an inappropriate title, replaced it altogether, or omitted it entirely.

Taking the text as a whole into account, the title *Tattvayogabindu* makes perfect sense when understood as a *tatpuruṣa* in combination with a simple *dvandva*: “The Essence of Yoga and [Supreme] Reality.” This is appropriate,

⁷³For example, *Yogatattva*, see NCC Vol. 22 (2007: 70); *Yogatattvasamāśasūtra*, see NCC Vol. 22 (2007: 70); *Yogatattvaupaniṣad*, see *yogatattvopanishad* (ed. pp. 363–388); *Yogatattvadīpikā*, see *kaivalyadamanuscripts2005* (2005: 232); *Yogatattvopaniṣaddīpikā*, see *kaivalyadamanuscripts2005* (2005: 232), etc. Moreover, the position of °*tattva*° is also supported by its occurrence in Sundaradeva's title *Haṭhatattvakaumudī*.

for the work's first half (I–XXXI) is concerned primarily with the individual practices of Rājayoga, while the second half, with a few exceptions, deals chiefly with cosmogony and the yogic body (XXXII–LVIII). The compound may also be understood more generally as a combination of two *tatpuruṣas*—a genitive *tatpuruṣa* and an instrumental *tatpuruṣa*—and rendered in English as “The Essence of Union with [Supreme] Reality.” *Tattvayogabindu* is thus the most plausible title for Rāmacandra's work.

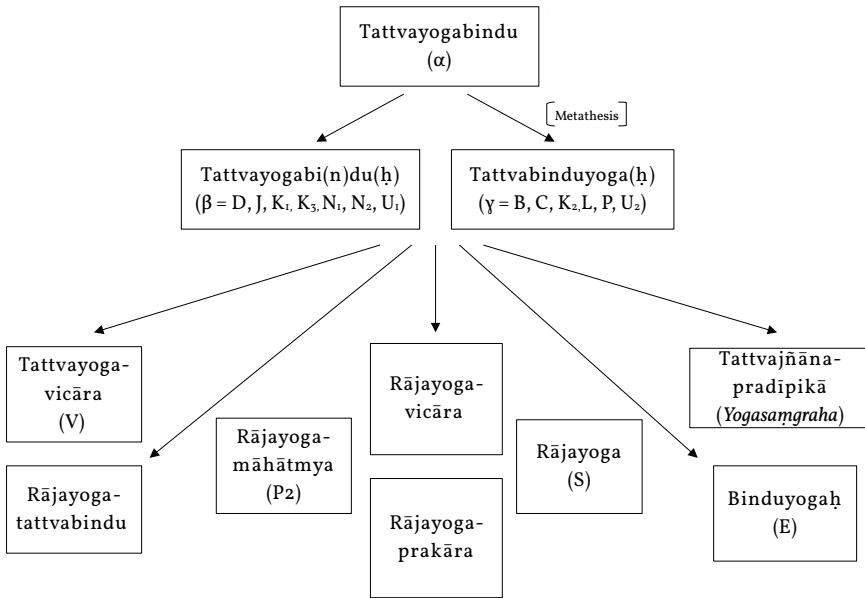


Figure 6: The hypothesis of transmission of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s title.

1.5.4 Reconstruction of the archetypal final rubric

The final rubric of the text in the manuscripts falls into two groups corresponding to the β - and γ -groups identified in the stemmatic analysis (p. 73). A close examination of the final rubrics reveals a gradual progression of corruptions in the transmission from β to γ . The figure 7 shows a synoptic representation of the final rubrics, which can optimally illustrate the split of the two groups.

beta-witnesses:

iti paramarahṁsyām	śrīrāmacāṁdrviracitāyām	tatvayogabiṁdu	samāptaḥ	\D
iti śrīpāramahṁsyām	śrīrāmacāṁdrviracitāyām	tatvayogabiṁduḥ	sampūrṇaṁ	\J
iti paramahṁsyām	śrīrāmacāṁdrviracitāyām	tatvayodabiṁda	samāptāḥ	\K1
iti śrīparamarahṁsyām	śrīrāmacāṁdrviracitāyām	tatvayogabiṁdu	samāptaḥ	\N1
iti śrīparamarahasye	śrīrāmacāṁdrviracitāyām	tatvayogabindu	samāptam	\N2
iti śrīparamahṁsyām	śrīrāmacāṁdrviracitāyām	tatvayogaviduḥ	samāptaḥ	\U1
iti paramahṁsasamhitāyām hṁsyām	śrīrāmacāṁdrviracitāyām	tattvayogavicāraḥ		\V

gamma-witnesses:

iti śrīrāmacāṁdraparamahṁsaviracitas	tatvabiṁduyogasamāptaḥ	\U2
iti śrīrāmacāṁdraparamahṁsaviracitas	tatvabinduyogasamāptaḥ	\P
iti rājamacāṁdraparamahṁsaviracites	tatvabiṁduyogasamāptam	\L
iti śrīrāmacāṁdraparamahṁsaviracitas	tatvabinduyogasamāptaḥ	\K2
iti śrīsārvaguṇasaṁpannapañḍitasukhānandamiśrasūrisūnupaṇḍitajvālāprasādamiśrakṛtabhāṣāṭīkāśahito rājayoge binduyogaḥ	samāptaḥ	\E

Figure 7: Synoptic transcription of the manuscripts' final rubrics.

At the same time, a widespread misconception comes to light: the spiritual title *paramahaṃsa* turns out to be only a later attribution to Rāmacandra resulting from a corruption in the final rubrics—an error which, to complicate matters, already appears in one of the oldest dated surviving manuscripts (V). Yet V is not a trustworthy witness: its readings diverge so markedly from the rest of the transmission, without contributing anything of value to the reconstruction of the text, that I was compelled to exclude it from the collation. The scribe introduced numerous redactional changes, consciously omitted sentences, and on almost every folio one encounters large numbers of (often unsuccessful) attempts to “improve” Rāmacandra’s admittedly less elegant Sanskrit. One such failed attempt is preserved in the final rubric of V, which reads: *iti paramahaṃsasamhitāyāṃ haṃsyāṃ śrīrāmacandraviracitāyāṃ tattvayogavicāraḥ* || The feminine endings in this final rubric create the impression that Rāmacandra’s text formed part of another, perhaps larger, work entitled *Paramahaṃsasamhitā*—a title that does exist, though it bears no relation to Rāmacandra’s text. The readings of the final rubrics in the other manuscripts of the β -group reveal that this final rubric is yet another failed attempt by the redactor to improve upon his exemplar. The other manuscripts of the β -group (for example, the third-oldest extant dated witness N₁, one of the best representative of the β -group) present the final rubric along the following lines: *iti śrīparamarahasyāṃ śrīrāmacandraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabindu samāptaḥ* || At first glance this final rubric appears contradictory. On the one hand, the title of the text is clearly given as *Tattvayogabindu*; on the other, the feminine endings evoke the constructions typical of final rubrics of chapters, which use the locative to indicate the overarching work and the final nominatives to provide the name of the concluding chapter. Taking the other witnesses of the β -group into account, it becomes evident that all members of the β -group continue to transmit the same grammatical irregularities and preserve the feminine endings. At a superficial level, the final rubrics of the γ -group do not appear to be of much help in resolving these issues. They all read approximately like U₂: *iti śrīrāmacandraparamahaṃsaviracitas tatvabinduযোগসমাপ্তাḥ* || One might therefore conclude that the manuscripts of the γ -group are preferable, since

their final rubrics are grammatically correct. However, as I demonstrated in the introduction (see p. 48), we may safely assume that the original title was *Tattvayogabindu* and not *Tattvabinduyoga*. Moreover, when reflecting on the discrepancies between the readings of the two manuscript groups and taking into account the stemmatic conclusions—particularly the fact that the β -group preserves a version that on average must be closer to the original text than that of the γ -group—it becomes apparent that the final rubrics of the β -group are likely the result of redactional intervention. They represent, in other words, an attempt to emend an already corrupt final rubric (presumably in a form similar to the final rubrics of the β -group).

This emerges, first, in the alteration of the title from the original *Tattvayogabindu* to *Tattvabinduyoga* in the γ -group; secondly, in the change from the β -reading *paramarahasya* to *paramahamṣa*; and thirdly, in what appears to be a concomitant disregard for the feminine endings of the hyparchetype of the β -group, on the basis of which the redactional changes in the β -transmission appear to have been undertaken.

Any remaining doubts the reader may entertain regarding the plausibility of these hypothetical reconstructions can be dispelled by an important observation. The final section of the *Tattvayogabindu*, namely LIX, which constitutes the undisputed culmination of the work, opens with the phrase *idaṃ yogaśāstrarahasyam samagraśāstramadhye*, after which the ideal form of yoga intended for Rāmacandra's audience is introduced. This makes it safe to assume that the occurrence of the forms of °*rahasya* in the final colophon ultimately originates here. I consider it probable that an originally section-concluding rubric once preceded the work-concluding final rubric. This provides the crucial clue to how the corrupt forms of the β - and γ -final rubrics arose:

The most likely archetypal final rubric, *iti śrīparamarahasyam | iti śrīrāmacandravirācito 'yaṃ tattvayogabinduḥ samāptah ||*, was corrupted through simple and typical scribal errors: the omission of *iti* and the introduction of a feminine locative ending through a minor inaccuracy (°*virācito 'yaṃ* → °*viracitāyām*), followed by what was likely an automatic adjustment of °*rahasyam* to °*rahasyām*. This produced the reading *iti śrīparamarahasyām śrīrāmacandraviracitāyām tat-*

vayogabim̐du samāptaḥ ||, from which the subsequent corruptions took their course. Later witnesses of the β -group, such as D and U₁, copied the final rubric from their exemplars, introducing further errors so that *śrīparamarahasyām* becomes *śrīpāramahaṃsyām*. Due to the loss of the feminine referent and the aforementioned copying error, scribes of the γ -group were led to a consequential emendation. From the intermediate stage *iti śrīpāramahaṃsyām śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyām*, a scribe apparently felt compelled to introduce a plausible correction and altered the reading of his exemplar to *iti śrīrāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas*. Thus, Rāmacandra was erroneously ascribed the spiritual title of a *paramahaṃsa* and consequently presumed to have undergone initiation into the Daśanāmī Saṃnyāsī order.^{74,75} Thus, even though looking at these somewhat confusing final rubric transmissions, one might expect one *iti* to mark the end of a chapter and the second to close the work as a whole. Yet one has to bear in mind that the text offers no clear system of chapters; instead, it is divided into numerous sections introduced by *idānīm* or, more rarely, *atha* and similar markers. These sections—aside from this single exception—never conclude with a chapter concluding rubric or chapter colophon. It is therefore unlikely that the *itis* before the final rubric should be interpreted as a chapter concluding rubric. Rather, I propose understanding it as an emphatic concluding formula that marks the climactic end of the text.

1.5.5 Description of the sources

In the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu*, the author's sources are indicated in the first register of the critical apparatus, corresponding to the respective passage. Overall, two texts form the basis of Rāmacandra's work: the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. However, Rāmacandra does not provide references for these sources in any instance. On the one hand, there are some direct quotations, often in the form of verses. On the other hand,

⁷⁴See [clark2006](#) for a discussion of the term *paramahaṃsa* in the Daśanāmī Saṃnyāsī order.

⁷⁵I wish to thank Dr. Jason Birch for sharing his thoughts regarding the reconstruction of the final rubric, which provided the decisive impetus for arriving at a satisfactory solution.

which constitutes the majority, Rāmacandra used his sources as a textual basis, either transforming them into prose, paraphrasing and editorially altering them, or blending the contents of both sources. Nevertheless, the passages can be identified, as the contents of these sources are highly similar. It is so similar that glancing at the source texts significantly helped make the correct editorial decisions and appropriately correct corrupt passages.

1.5.5.1 Yogasvarodaya

The *Yogasvarodaya* (YSv) is the main source text of Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. Rāmacandra derives most of his content from this text and even follows its structure to a great extent. The majority of sections in the *Tattvayogabindu* originate from Rāmacandra rewriting the *śloka*s of the *Yogasvarodaya* into prose, incorporating specific editorial changes to align with his agenda. Thus, this text is of utmost importance for the reconstruction of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s doubtful passages.⁷⁶ So far, the *Yogasvarodaya* is a text known only through quotations found in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* and *Yogakarnikā*, which will be described below. Manuscripts have yet to be found and remain a desideratum for the time being.⁷⁷

⁷⁶For a detailed description of the *Yogasvarodaya*, see p. 307.

⁷⁷One of the few glimmers of hope in the search for a manuscript of this text arose due to a hit in the current National Mission for Manuscripts search engine (<https://www.pan-dulipipatala.nic.in/>). This concerns a manuscript in the Dogra Art Museum in Jammu, with the Ms. No. 288. The manuscript titled *Yogasvarodaya*, which is classified as belonging to the Tantra genre according to the search engine, was therefore a promising candidate. During a visit to the museum in February 2025, after four days of negotiations, I was able to take a look at the manuscript. Unfortunately, it turned out to be a different text. The subject of the Jammu manuscript is *svarodaya* for yogis. The text includes a highly detailed account of the localisation and operation of the yogic channels (*nāḍi*s), the *ṣaṭkarmas*, the *haṃsamantra*, and the *aṣṭasiddhis*. Thematically, the manuscript is structured as follows:

1. *atha nāḍibhedah*; 2. *atha tattvanirśāyāḥ*, 3. *atha tattvadyhānaḥ*; 4. *atha yuddhajayaprakāraṇam*; 5. *atha svasvapraprakāraṇam*; 6. *atha garmaprakāraṇam*; 7. *atha samvatsanaprakāraṇam*, 8. *atha rogaprakāraṇam*; 9. *atha kālajñānam*. The final rubric reads: *iti śrīśivāśivasamvāde yogasvarodaye muktīprakāraṇam || sampūrṇam*.

1.5.5.2 Prāṇatoṣiṇī

The *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* (PT) by Rāmatoṣaṇa⁷⁸ is a Tantra compendium (*nibandha*) from the 19th century, compiled by the author in Bengal.⁷⁹ This extensive compendium addresses creation, the four *puruṣārthas*, and devotion. The *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* is divided into six major *kāṇḍas* (“sections”): 1. *sargakāṇḍa* (subject: cosmogony), 2. *dharmakhaṇḍa* (subject: rituals and Dharma of the twice-born), 3. *arthakāṇḍa* (subject: daily routine, deity worship, purification practices, rites, offerings, etc.), 4. *kāmyakāṇḍa* (subject: wish-fulfilment practices, protective mantras, etc.), 5. *bhaktikāṇḍa* (subject: performance of devotional deity worship), and 6. *jñānakāṇḍa* (subject: *mokṣa*, yoga, etc.). The author draws from a multitude of texts circulating in this region during the 19th century.

Additional topics of the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* range from *mantras*, *yantras*, and their meanings⁸⁰ to meditations, religious stories, legends, and deity worship,⁸¹ the six acts of magic, tantric rituals including sexual rites, and various areas of tantric philosophy.⁸²

The *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* incorporates a total of 304 verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* in its *jñānakāṇḍa*.⁸³ Therefore, it is currently the most extensive testimony of the *Yogasvarodaya*. All its verses are cited with the reference *yogasvarodaye*. These verses are quoted in a largely coherent sequence, giving the reader the impression of having the complete transmission of the text. However, this is not the case. Many additional verses of the *Yogasvarodaya* can be found in the *Yogakarnīkā* described below. There are numerous overlaps between the

⁷⁸ Although the printed editions identify Rāmatoṣaṇa as the author of this work, sometimes bearing the titles Vidyālaṃkāra or Bhaṭṭācārya, **shastrī**1905 (1905: 2) mentions another name: “Babu Prāṇakṛṣṇa Viśvās of Kharḥadaha, within ten miles of Calcutta, collected in the beginning of the nineteenth century a large number of Tantra, Purāṇa and Smṛti MSS., for the purpose of compiling Prāṇatoṣiṇī, Prāṇakṛṣṇa Kriyāmbudhi and other encyclopaedic works on Hindu ritual and worship.”

Since the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* is frequently cited in recent secondary literature on tantric studies but lacks detailed studies, critical editions, or complete translations into Western languages, this discrepancy remains unresolved.

⁷⁹ **ramatosana**.

⁸⁰ See **slouber**2010.

⁸¹ See **kinsley**1997.

⁸² See **urban**2010.

⁸³ **ramatosana**.

quotations. The main difference lies in the fact that, unlike the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, the *Yogakarnīkā* primarily includes practical instructions from the *Yogasvarodaya*, such as instructions for *prāṇāyāma*-, *kumbhaka*-, or *mudrā* techniques.

1.5.5.3 Yogakarnīkā

The *Yogakarnīkā* (YK) of Nāth Aghorānanda is another significant testimony of the *Yogasvarodaya*.⁸⁴ The *Yogakarnīkā* is an extensive anthology on yoga, comprising 1253 verses divided into 15 *pādas*. The text derives its verses from a wide array of sources, often, though not always, citing them with references. Besides various Purāṇas (*Mārkaṇḍeyapurāṇa*, *Narasimhapurāṇa*, etc.) and Tantras (*Kūbjikāmatatantra*, *Grahayāmala*, *Rudrayāmala*, etc.), Nāth Aghorānanda also cites texts from the Haṭha and Rājayoga genre (*Yogasvarodaya*, *Haṭhapradīpikā*, *Dattātreyayogaśāstra*, *Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā*, *Yogayājñavalkya*, various works attributed to Gorakṣa, etc.). Based on the established dating of the *Yogasvarodaya*, which must have been written before 1591 CE,⁸⁵ and Mallinson's dating of the *Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā* to circa 1700 CE,⁸⁶ we can confidently assume that the *Yogakarnīkā* was written no earlier than the 18th century. The fifteen *pādas* are thematically structured as follows:

1. *dinacaryā* ("daily routine"); 280 verses
2. *lakṣādiyoḡaḥ* ("Yoga of foci, etc."); 123 verses
3. *prāṇāyāmaḥ* ("Breath control"); 108 verses
4. *yogasāṅketāḥ* ("Preliminaries"); 80 verses
5. *sādhanaśāṅketāḥ* ("Consensus of methods"); 36 verses
6. *pratyāhāraḥ* ("withdrawal of the senses"); 34 verses
7. *kumbhakavidhiḥ* ("precepts for breath-retention"); 78 verses
8. *mudrāsādhanaṃ* ("discipline of [haṭhayogic] seals"; 214 verses
9. *dhāraṇā* ("concentration"); 31 verses

⁸⁴yogakarnika.

⁸⁵See p. 6.

⁸⁶MallinsonGheranda.

10. *dhyānam* (“meditation”); 50 verses
11. *samādhiḥ* (“meditative absorption”); 34 verses
12. *layayogaḥ* (“Yoga of absorption”); 26 verses
13. *āsanāni* (“postures”); 57 verses
14. *ghaṭaśodhanam* (“purification of the pot [the body]”); 56 verses
15. *tyāgyagrāhyavidhānam* (“injunctions and prohibitions”); 36 verses⁸⁷

The *Yogaṣaṇḍikā* cites a total of 134 verses with reference (*yogasvarodaye* or *svarodaye*) and at least four if not eight or more additional verses without reference.⁸⁸

- 1.210–213 [probably 1.209–216]: Kriyāyoga; 4–8 or more verses quoted without reference
- 1.244–280: main *nāḍis* and nine *cakras*; 36 ślokas quoted with reference
- 2.1–41: five *lakṣyas*, sixteen *ādhāras*, five *ākāśas*; 41 ślokas quoted with reference
- 4.40–49: *śaṭkarmas*; 9 verses quoted with reference
- 4.53–54: *trāṭaka*; 2 verses quoted with reference
- 4.67–80: various *kumbhakas* (*vyutkrama*, *bhāstrikā*, *bhrāmarī*, *kapālabhāti*, *antardhauṭi*, *vārisāra*, *nāḍikṣālanam*, *mūlaśodhanam*); 13 verses quoted with reference
- 5.29–33: Aṣṭāṅgayoga; 4 verses quoted with reference
- 6.23–34: *pratyāhāra*; 2 verses quoted with reference
- 7.2–10: various *kumbhakas* (*śītkāra*, *sūryabheda*, *ujjāyī*, *śītalī*, *bhāstrikā*, *bhrāmarī*, *mūrcchā*, *kevala*); 8 verses quoted with reference
- 7.23–28: *sūryabheda*; 6 verses quoted with reference
- 7.68–72: *śaṇmukhikaraṇa*, also called *dantodara*; 4 verses quoted with reference

⁸⁷There are two additional introductory verses and eight final verses that are not counted into the chapters.

⁸⁸See p. 307 n.492.

- 8.136–141: *khecarīmudrā*; 5 verses quoted with reference
- 12.2: a general statement to *laya*; 1 verse quoted with reference
- 12.23–25: Haṭhayoga practice about colour visualisation; 3 verses quoted with reference

It is noteworthy that all practical instructions on *ṣaṭkarmas*, *kumbhakas*, and *mudrās* from the *Yogasvarodaya* were not incorporated by Rāmacandra into his *Tattvayogabindu*.

A particularly distinctive feature of the *Yogakarnīkā* is its first chapter, which is also by far the most extensive.⁸⁹ No other Sanskrit yoga text known to me describes the daily routine of a yogin in such detail regarding ritual ablutions, mantra recitation, as well as other ritual acts such as dressing, applying sectarian markers (*tilaka*), including tying the hair into a knot, offerings, and the devotional performance of prostrations before one's own *iṣṭadevatā*, etc.⁹⁰

1.5.5.4 Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati

The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (SSP), one of the authoritative Sanskrit works of the modern Nātha Sampradāya and often attributed to Gorakṣanātha, appears to have served as another major source for the *Tattvayogabindu*.⁹¹ More broadly, the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* exhibit substantial similarities in both content and structure. These correspondences are sufficiently extensive to suggest a close textual relationship between the two works, whether through direct dependence or through shared textual materials.

In secondary literature, at least three attempts have been made to date the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. While white2003 (2003: 224) accepts the historical Gorakṣanātha as the author of the text, placing its origin in the 12th

⁸⁹It is also the only chapter in which almost no sources are given. Either all these verses are from Nāth Aghorānanda himself, or, and this is the more likely scenario, in my opinion, the sources are missing from the printed copy. I suspect further verses were taken from the *Yogasvarodaya*.

⁹⁰For further details on the first chapter of the *Yogakarnīkā*, see p. 345.

⁹¹All quotations from the SSP are from ssplonavla.

century, bouy1994 (1994: 19) dates the text much later, to the period between 1600–1650 CE. This period is based on Bouy’s dating of the *Goraṅśasiddhāntasamgraha* to the first half of the seventeenth century, and the fact that this text quotes the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. mallinsononline2013⁹² estimates the date of composition of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* to be around 1700 CE. His estimation is based on the period when the Nātha Sampradāya was institutionalised. Mallinson hypothesises that this text was composed to meet the need for a systematic religious scripture, which would serve as the authoritative textual foundation for the newly official institutionalised Nātha Sampradāya. Thanks to the present examination of the *Tattvayogabindu*, the time span of its composition can now be further narrowed down.

The research underlying the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu* establishes a *terminus ante quem* of 1591 CE for Rāmacandra’s text. If, as the textual evidence strongly suggests, Rāmacandra drew directly on the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* as one of the principal sources for compiling the *Tattvayogabindu*, then the same *terminus ante quem* would also apply to the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. On this basis, the latter was most likely composed in the second half of the sixteenth century or earlier. This timeframe may be further narrowed in light of its parallels with the *amaraughasasana*, whose oldest extant manuscript is dated to 1525 CE and which, according to mallinsonnath (2011: 16), may have served as a source for the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.⁹³ If the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* did indeed borrow this material from the *amaraughasasana*, 1525 CE may be taken as a possible *terminus a quo*. Taken together, these considerations suggest that the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* was most likely composed between 1525 and 1591 CE, assuming the proposed direction of textual dependence.

The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* is an exceptionally systematic exposition of the philosophical teachings associated with the Nātha Sampradāya. Simi-

⁹²See mallinsononline2013 2013.

⁹³I identified the following five parallels based on the printed edition of the *amaraughasasana*: 1. *amaraughasasana* 12 ≈ SSP 1.37; 2. *amaraughasasana* 13 ≈ SSP 1.38; 3. *amaraughasasana* 14 ≈ SSP 1.39; 4. *amaraughasasana* 15 ≈ SSP 1.40; and 5. *amaraughasasana* 16 ≈ SSP 1.41. It is likely that further parallels between the *amaraughasasana* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* will emerge upon a careful examination of the *amaraughasasana* manuscripts.

lar to the *Tattvayogabindu*, this text is a blend of prose and verse, presenting complex teachings in relatively simple Sanskrit, aside from some *termini technici*. The text comprises six *upadeśas*: 1. *piṇḍotpatti* (“genesis of the body”), 2. *piṇḍavicāra* (“investigation of the body”), 3. *piṇḍasaṃvitti* (“insight into the body”), 4. *piṇḍādhāraḥ* (“substratum of the body”), 5. *piṇḍapadayoḥ samarasakaraṇam* (“effecting a uniform taste of the [supreme] place and the body”), 6. *avadhūtayogilakṣaṇam* (“characteristics of an *avadhūtayogin*”).⁹⁴

Rāmacandra appears to have made extensive use of material also found in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. While the first half of the *Tattvayogabindu* (I–XXVIII) can be traced primarily to the *Yogasvarodaya*, with occasional formulations and concepts closely paralleling the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, correspondences with the latter become considerably more frequent from section XXIX onwards. These parallels consist less often of verbatim quotations than of distinctive formulations, concepts, rephrasings, and paraphrases, which Rāmacandra integrates, with varying degrees of success, into material otherwise closely related to the *Yogasvarodaya*.⁹⁵ Particularly significant are a number of unattributed verses in the *Tattvayogabindu* that correspond closely to verses of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. With one exception, Rāmacandra does not reproduce these verses verbatim but modifies them to varying degrees.⁹⁶ The direction of dependence is difficult to establish with absolute certainty, since Rāmacandra never identifies the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* as his source and the possibility of an otherwise unknown intermediary source cannot be excluded. Nevertheless, the cumulative evidence strongly suggests that Rāmacandra was drawing on the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, or on a source very closely related to it, rather than the reverse. This is indicated not only by the number and density of the correspondences, but also by

⁹⁴ A summary of the chapter contents can be found in *ssplonavlā*.

⁹⁵ Rāmacandra appears to have drawn on material corresponding to *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.4, 1.17–20, 1.22–26, 1.30–34, 1.37–67, 2.1–26, 2.28–34, 2.36, 2.38, 2.45, 3.1–14, 4.9, 5.55–60, 5.60, 5.79, 6.10–11, 6.32, 6.60, and 6.64–67.

⁹⁶ I have identified fifteen such verses: TYB 28.1 ≈ SSP 2.31; TYB 41.1 ≈ SSP 5.79; TYB 44.1 ≈ SSP 6.10; TYB 44.2 ≈ SSP 6.11; TYB 44.5 ≈ SSP 6.32; TYB 44.7 ≈ SSP 6.64; TYB 44.8 ≈ SSP 6.65; TYB 44.9 ≈ SSP 6.66; TYB 44.10 ≈ SSP 6.67; TYB 48.1 = SSP 1.4; TYB 58.1 ≈ SSP 5.60–61ab; TYB 58.2 ≈ SSP 5.61cd–62ab; TYB 58.3 ≈ SSP 5.64; TYB 58.4 ≈ SSP 5.64cd–5.65ab; and TYB 58.5 ≈ SSP 5.65cd–5.66cd.

their sequence and structural coherence, particularly in the cosmological sections, where passages of the *Tattvayogabindu* follow the order of material found in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. The comparatively uneven quality of Rāmacandra's adaptations likewise makes it unlikely that the corresponding verses originated with him. Since the *Tattvayogabindu* was certainly composed before 1591, these parallels may also provide evidence for dating the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, although they are not conclusive on their own.⁹⁷

1.5.5.5 Amanaska

The *Amanaska* is another source text for Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. According to Birch's (2013) research, the *Amanaska* is one of the most significant and influential texts on Rājayoga. It has profoundly impacted numerous subsequent yoga texts, including the *Haṭhapradīpikā*, *Amaraughaprabodha*, *Śivayogapradīpikā*, and *Yogatārāvalī*, as well as modern works like Yugaladāsa's *Yogamārgaparakāśikā* and Brahmānanda's *Jyotsnā*. Additionally, the *Amanaska* is frequently cited in compendiums such as *Yogacintāmaṇi*, *Haṭhatattvakau-mudī*, and *Gorakṣasiddhāntasaṅgraha*. It also influenced the twelfth chapter of Hemacandra's *Yogaśāstra* and was incorporated into two late Yoga Upaṇiṣads.⁹⁸ Birch dates the first chapter of the *Amanaska* to between the 15th and 16th centuries CE, while the second chapter is dated to the 11th or 12th centuries CE. This second chapter contains some of the earliest teachings on Rājayoga. The text is structured as a dialogue between the supreme god (*īśvara*) and the sage Vāmadeva. Vāmadeva initiates the discussion by asking how one attains liberation in life (*jīvanmukti*). *Īśvara*'s response is the practice of *amanaska* (the no-mind state), synonymous with *samādhi* and Rājayoga. In order to achieve the *amanaska* state, the dissolution of mind and breath is required, primarily through the practice of *śāmbhavīmudrā*. This yoga practice leads to the perception of the non-dual state (*advaitapada*), the highest reality (*paratattva*). According to Birch, the second chapter reveals Śaiva origins but

⁹⁷ For a discussion of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* in relation to the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, see powell2023.

⁹⁸ All information presented here is derived from Birch's dissertation, birch2013 (2013). This summary provides only a brief overview of the work. For a comprehensive introduction to the text, see Birch (2013: 1–16).

avoids specific tantric sect affiliations. *Amanaska* 2.3–4 describes Rājayoga as both the king (*rāja*) of all yogas and a means for the yogin to attain the supreme Self, who is the illustrious king.

A significant aspect of the *Amanaska* is its rejection of most Haṭhayoga techniques. Instead, it advocates an effortless path to liberation through the practice of *amanaska*. Birch notes that the text eschews complex metaphysics and philosophical elaborations.

The *Tattvayogabindu* shares two and a half verses with the *Amanaska* in *Tattvayogabindu* LIX: TYB LIX.2cd ≈ *Amanaska* 1.12ab, TYB LIX.6 ≈ *amanaskaed* 2.36, and TYB LIX.7 ≈ *amanaskaed* 2.37. Editorially modified versions of these verses also appear in the *Yogasvarodaya*. However, in certain hemistiches the readings of the verses in the *Tattvayogabindu* correspond more closely to those of the *Amanaska* than to the *Yogasvarodaya*. It remains uncertain whether Rāmacandra derived these verses via the *Yogasvarodaya* or directly from the *Amanaska*.

1.5.6 Description of the testimonia

To date, I have been able to identify two testimonies of the *Tattvayogabindu*, namely the *Yogasamgraha* and the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*. Both texts adopt conspicuously long passages from the source text. These sections serve as crucial additional evidence for reconstructing the *Tattvayogabindu*. They are included in the second register of the critical apparatus when available for the respective passage of the text.

1.5.6.1 Yogasamgraha

The *Yogasamgraha* is a compendium of excerpts from various Yoga texts, currently known from a single manuscript.⁹⁹ Although written in Devanāgarī script, the manuscript is exceedingly difficult to read. The scribe's handwriting is often imprecise and is not carefully executed. The manuscript consists of only eight folios in total. Folio 1 and folio 2 recto are missing. The text

⁹⁹tybd2; Ms. No.: 30020; Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA). The paper manuscript is incomplete and in very poor condition overall.

commences on folio 2 verso amidst the extensive testimonia of the *Tattvayogabindu*. It is precisely above the first line of folio 2 recto where a second hand inscribed the title *Yogasamgraha* over the first line of folio 2 verso.

The *Yogasamgraha* cites the *Tattvayogabindu*'s sections II–XII in sequence,¹⁰⁰ initially giving the impression that this manuscript is another, albeit incomplete, textual witness of the *Tattvayogabindu*. However, closer examination reveals various slight editorial alterations to the citations. The citation of the *Tattvayogabindu* in the *Yogasamgraha* concludes after section XII with “*cha | tad uktam tattvajñānapradīpikāyām ||*”. Beyond this point, there are no further citations of the *Tattvayogabindu* in the *Yogasamgraha*. Subsequently, the manuscript contains what appears to be an unsystematic collection of various yogic topics and practices. The manuscript lacks the final rubric and colophon. This absence and the nature of the handwriting likely explain the title assigned to this manuscript by the IGNCA. I propose that the *Yogasamgraha* represents a compilation made by a Yoga practitioner, likely a householder, who recorded personally relevant content.

Besides the *Tattvayogabindu*, I have so far only been able to identify the **uttaragita1926** as another source. Additional topics covered in this manuscript include the *nāḍīs*, *prāṇāyāma*, *kuṇḍalinī*, the *haṃsamantra*, and various descriptions of *mudrās*, such as *khecarīmudrā*, *haṃsamudrā*, *bhūcarīmudrā*, and, towards the end of the manuscript, *unmanīmudrā*.

1.5.6.2 Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā

The *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* is an unpublished Sanskrit yoga text from the 17th century,¹⁰¹ authored by Sundaradeva.

Sundaradeva, a Brahmin of the Kāśyapa Gotra, was the son of Govindadeva and the grandson of Viśvanāthadeva. He resided in Benares during the 17th century, where he was likely active not only as an author but also as a physician (*vaidya*). Sundaradeva did not originate from Benares but,

¹⁰⁰ *Yogasamgraha* IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. l. 1 to f. 4r. l. 4 ≈ *Tattvayogabindu* II–XII.

¹⁰¹ The dating of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* has recently been revised due to the discovery that some first-hand notes surrounding the main text of the Ujjain *Yogacintāmaṇi* were likely borrowed from Sundaradeva's *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*. See birch2024. birch2018proliferation (2018) dated the Ujjain *Yogacintāmaṇi* to 1659 CE.

like many scholars of his time, probably moved there from the southern regions of India, facilitated by the “Pax Mughalia”.¹⁰² Sundaradeva authored not only the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* but also another extensive yoga text, the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī*,¹⁰³ as well as various works on Ayurveda.¹⁰⁴

The *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* is an exceedingly comprehensive compendium¹⁰⁵ on yoga, written in a mixture of verse and prose. Its topics and sources are remarkably diverse and have yet to undergo a systematic academic examination. A critical edition of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* remains a desideratum. The text comprises a compilation of various teachings of Haṭha and Rājayoga,¹⁰⁶ which are interconnected with diverse teachings from the Upaniṣads, the epics, Pātañjalayoga, various Tantras, the *Yogavāsiṣṭha*, and various Purāṇas. Mallinson¹⁰⁷ also discovered fascinating parallels to the *Bahr al-Hayāt*, such as breathing techniques (*prāṇāyāmas*) in non-seated positions.¹⁰⁸ The eclectic mix and sheer number of yoga techniques taught in this text surpass those found in most other Sanskrit yoga texts.

Some of the descriptions of these techniques in the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* were taken without reference from the *Tattvayogabindu*.¹⁰⁹

¹⁰²The ancestry, location, and profession of Sundaradeva are derived from the colophon of the Jodhpur manuscript of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 145v). See [birch2018proliferation](#).

¹⁰³[birch2013](#) (2013: 162–165) discusses the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* in relation to the *Amanaska*. For an edition of the *hathatattvakaumudī* see: *Haṭhatattvakaumudī: A Treatise on Haṭhayoga* by Sundaradeva. Ed. by Gharote, M. L., P. Devnath, and V. J. Jha. Lonavla: The Lonavla Yoga Institute, 2007.

¹⁰⁴These include *Bhūpālavalabbha* (or *Bhūpacaryā*), the *Cikitsāsundara*, the *Lilāvati*, and the *Yogoktivyupadeśāmṛta*. For references and a discussion on the entanglement of yoga and Ayurveda in Sundaradeva’s works, see [birch2018ayur](#).

¹⁰⁵In terms of *śloka*, the text likely exceeds 3000 verses.

¹⁰⁶The text includes, for instance, an extended description of *āsanas*, some of which are not found in other yoga texts. See *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* MMPP 2244, f. 16r l. 4 to f. 22v l. 6.

¹⁰⁷See [birch2018proliferation](#).

¹⁰⁸See [ernst2013](#) (2013: 59–69) for a translation of the fourth chapter of the *Bahr al-Hayāt*. Additionally, see [ernst2003](#).

¹⁰⁹In an entry by Theodor Aufrecht in the *Catalogus Catalogorum* for the title *Tattvayogabindu*, currently listed in [newcataloguscatalogorum8](#) (Vol. 8), it states: “Q. by Sundaradeva in his C. *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*.” This not only attests to Theodor Aufrecht’s incredible erudition in Sanskrit literature but also indicates that he read the texts he catalogued with remarkable attention, as the *Tattvayogabindu* is cited without reference in approximately the second third of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*.

The passages quoted include the teachings on the sixteen *ādhāras*¹¹⁰ and the teachings on Lakṣyayoga and its subtypes.¹¹¹ These passages are predominantly adopted verbatim by Sundaradeva, though some may have undergone slight editorial changes. One passage, in particular, stands out. Within the descriptions of the *adholakṣya*, there is a passage teaching two additional techniques absent from the manuscript tradition of the *Tattvayogabindu*.¹¹² The first technique describes a specific form of gazing. After positioning the eyes in a particular manner and staring at a lamp for a set period, the yogin can subsequently see in the dark, perceive the luminous form of God, experience a sense of bliss, and lose bodily awareness. The second technique involves rubbing the eyes in specific spots to induce further light phenomena. The origin of these techniques is uncertain. Most likely, these additions originate from Sundaradeva himself. However, it is not entirely impossible that these techniques were originally from the *Tattvayogabindu*, with the manuscript tradition failing to preserve them. That is because the quotations from the *Tattvayogabindu* in the original *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* must be significantly older than any surviving manuscript or, perhaps because the manuscript tradition of the *Tattvayogabindu* is prone to haplographies and eye skips due to the frequent structural similarities and identical beginnings of certain sentences.¹¹³

1.5.7 Notes on the parallels

In the third register of the critical apparatus, I list relevant parallel passages from other texts that do not fall under the categories of source texts or testimonies but should still be included in the critical apparatus due to their significance for editorial decisions or their high informational value.

- The additional material found in manuscript U₂ in the context of the presentation of the nine *cakras* (IV–XII) turned out to correspond—often

¹¹⁰ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 95r l. 3 to f. 96r l. 4).

¹¹¹ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 124r l. 7 to f. 125r l. 3).

¹¹² *hathasamketacandrikachennai* I based on ORI B 220 (f. 239r l. 8 to f. 240r l. 13), GOML R 3239 (f. 258 l. 14 to f. 259 l. 10) and MMPP 2244 (f. 124r ll. 5–9 to f. 125r ll. 1–2).

¹¹³ I have edited the additional material on p. 392.

verbatim—to passages I later encountered, quite by chance, in several manuscripts or scrolls of a Kashmiri [art] tradition. These manuscripts bear the title *Nāḍīcakra*,¹¹⁴ are in most cases sumptuously illustrated, and depict the yogic cosmos in descending order. Following a brief cosmogony, they present a description of the nine *cakras*. Below this appears a representation of the yogic micro–macrocosm which, in large part, corresponds to the elements—especially the the yogic micro–macrocosm in the *Tattvayogabindu* (from XXXII onwards): the *saptadvīpas*, *pātālas*, *tattvas*, *tanmātras*, *mahābhūtas*, *vāyus*, *śaktis*, the *agni* groups, *līṅga* types, stages of *vāk*, *lokas*, and so forth. For the third register of the critical apparatus, I chose manuscript 1334, which not only contains the most beautiful illustrations but also seems most carefully written. I collected copies of all manuscripts; however, due to time constraints, I had to choose one without thoroughly reviewing them.

- In the context of the eight *cakras* of *Tattvayogabindu* XI, manuscript U₂ presents additional material. The text includes a widely known verse that describes the mechanism of the so-called *haṃsamantra*, also known as *ajapāgāyatrī*.¹¹⁵ The source text of the verse in U₂ is hard to pinpoint. In order to elucidate the possible sources, it was useful to display the texts that share the verse. These include: ≈*vivekamartandaolda* 29, ≈*yogabija* 106, ≈*Yogacintāmani* (PULL, f. 6r), ≈*hathatattvakaumudi* 22.27, and ≈*yogasikhopanisad* 1.130cd–131ab (Ed. p. 416).
- *Tattvayogabindu* XXVIII.1 presents a variant of a widely circulated verse, whose origins can be traced back to the *Netratantra*. Rāmacandra adopts this variant from the *Yogasvarodaya*. Further investigations into the variants of this verse revealed insights into an extensive and centuries-spanning intertextual network. This verse provides an intriguing starting point for further studies on the genesis of the Haṭha- and Rājayoga text

¹¹⁴Various manuscripts bearing the title *Nāḍīcakra* are catalogued at [srinagar2021](#). The manuscript numbers are: 722, 869, 890.3, 1334, 1388, 1490, 2150. Another manuscript of the same text lies in the Śāradā manuscripts of the Janert collection, housed at the Staatsbibliothek Berlin. The Ms. No. is Hs or 12446 SBB-PK, see [vohd218](#).

¹¹⁵*Tattvayogabindu* XI.1: *sakāreṇa bahir yāti hakāreṇa viśet punaḥ | haṃsaḥ so 'haṃ tato mantraṃ jīvo japeti sarvadā ||*

corpus from the 11th century CE, precisely at the intersection where ascetic and tantric traditions converge and produce new literature. This verse also appears later in the *Haṭhapradīpikā*, where it forms the first verse of a tetrad of verses, which, for reasons yet to be clarified, is called *saubhadra*.¹¹⁶ I have identified the following parallels to TYB XXVIII.1: $\approx$ netratantra 7.1cd–2, $\approx$ tantraloka 19.15, $\approx$ urmikaula 2.184, $\approx$ Vivekāmar-taṇḍa 6.3, $\approx$ yogatarangini quoted with reference *Nityanāthapaddhati* (Ed. p. 72), $\approx$ fausta1976 13, $\approx$ hathapradīpika2024 4.58, $\approx$ yogacudamani 3cd–4ab, $\approx$ mandalabrah 3.4.5, $\approx$ hathatattvakaumudī 24.1, $\approx$ Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati 2.31 (Ed. p. 43), $\approx$ Prāṇatoṣiṇī (Ed. p. 172).

- In *Tattvayogabindu* L, Rāmacandra presents the five great elements within the body (*śarīramadhye pañca mahābhūtāni*). Rāmacandra drew these descriptions from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* and the *Yogasvarodaya*. Notably, this description can be found in almost identical form in *Amarauḥsaśāsana* 11–16. I noticed the following parallels: TYB L l. 1–5 $\approx$ *Amarauḥsaśāsana* 11–16 $\approx$ SSP 1.37–41 $\approx$ YSv (PT, p. 846). Although this contributes little to the constitution of the edited text, this insight is nevertheless relevant from the perspective of yoga research, as the sources of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* have not yet been systematically explored. My observations suggest that both the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Amarauḥsaśāsana* are important candidates in this category.
- In *Tattvayogabindu* section XLI.1, the γ -group of witnesses quote a verse on the *navanidhis* which is a variant of *Amarakośa* 1.1.165 – 1.1.166.

1.6 Stemmatic analysis

THE stemmatic analysis of the *Tattvayogabindu* for the creation of a *stemma codicum* that represents the relationships between the collated textual witnesses is based on the classical Lachmannian method, supplemented by trees generated with contemporary phylogenetic software to support manual

¹¹⁶ Before *Haṭhapradīpikā* verse 4.58, it is stated: *tathā hi saubhadraṃ nāma ślokaḥ* |

philological methods empirically.¹¹⁷ The following pages of this section explain how the *stemma codicum* is constructed. The first subsection presents my philological observations concerning both the macro- and microstructure of the transmission of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Each observation is substantiated by concrete textual examples. The second subsection introduces a selection of computer-generated trees representing the manuscript transmission of the *Tattvayogabindu*, produced using different phylogenetic algorithms. These models are critically evaluated with regard to their respective advantages and limitations, assessed in detail against the background of the philological observations. In the final subsection, the convergence of both approaches results in the proposed *stemma codicum* of the *Yogatattvabindu*.

1.6.1 Philological observations

1.6.1.1 Macrostructural observations during collation

Before collating the manuscripts, I transcribed every single available witness of the *Tattvayogabindu* and arranged the transcriptions synoptically. This approach proved helpful for the critical editing of the *Tattvayogabindu*. The text comprises a mixture of prose and verse. Many prose passages are structurally very similar, with identical beginnings and sentence endings, resulting in virtually no manuscript that does not omit words, sentences, or entire sections due to eye skips caused by the text's arrangement. Additionally, there are frequent instances across the manuscripts in which words, phrases, or even entire passages are transposed. Several manuscripts have substantial *lacunae*. Creating a synoptic comparison of the transcriptions was crucial to maintaining an overview in these cases and reconstructing a

¹¹⁷Certainly, in the case of the *Tattvayogabindu*, reconstructing the *stemma codicum* would have been feasible even manually, given the relatively manageable textual tradition, without yielding fundamentally different results. However, precisely in light of the text's well-preserved and uncontaminated transmission — easily comprehensible to the human mind — the stemmatic analysis of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s textual witnesses conducted here can, in my view, serve as a valuable exemplar. It demonstrates both the utility and the limitations of computer-assisted stemmatics and provides data that can benefit future users of this technology.

text closest to the original. The synoptic comparison reveals the structural differences and provides a clear overview. See the following example:

puruṣo yad icchati	tad bhavati		\D
puruṣo yad icchati	tad bhavati//	cha //	\J
puruṣo yad icchati	tad bhavati//		\K1
puruṣo yad icchati	tad bhavati		\N1
puruṣo yad icchati	tad bhavati		\N2
puruṣo yad icchati	tad bhavati	vā	\U1
puruṣo yad icchati//			\U2
puruṣo yad icchati		cha	\P
puruṣo yad icchati/			\B
puruṣo yad icchati/			\L
puruṣo yad icchati/			\E

Figure 8: Example from section XII: Synoptic transcription of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s witnesses.

This is one among many examples (Figure 8) of sentences that illustrate the frequent structural differences among the witnesses, as these differences recur consistently. During the transcription of the textual witnesses, it became apparent that the transmission of the Urtext or archetype (α)—the hypothetically reconstructed state of the text, based on all extant witnesses, which approximates the original more closely than any surviving manuscript—divides into two main branches, each traceable to a hyparchetype.¹¹⁸ Both hyparchetypes not only differ structurally but also share most of their readings and key errors.

I refer to the first hyparchetype as β (D, J, K₁, K₃, N₁, N₂, U₁, and V) for two simple reasons: this group contains the two oldest extant dated witnesses and, in all likelihood, a structural arrangement that is closer to the original than the γ -group, which contains additional material in some places and often clearly comparatively degenerated variants. Although the β -group frequently contains errors, in many cases there is at least one manuscript whose reading is entirely convincing. The oldest extant dated manuscript N₂ is from 1591 CE. The second-oldest preserved dated witness is V and was written 1694 CE.

¹¹⁸ Paolo Trovato and others explain the very high rate of lost archetypes and two-branched stemmata by “the high (90%) rate of extinction of individual copies”. See [trovato2017](#).

	ūrdhvalakṣaṃ	āha	ākāṣe drṣṭiḥ	karttavā	\V
prathamam	urdhvalakṣaḥ	kathyate/	ākāśamadhye	drṣṭiḥ/	\D
prathamam	urdhvalakṣaḥ	kathyamte/ākāśamadhye	drṣṭiḥ//		\J
prathamam	urdhvalakṣaḥ	kathyate/	ākāśamadhye	drṣṭiḥ/	\K1
prathamam	urdhvalakṣaḥ	kathyate/	ākāśamadhye	drṣṭiḥ/	\N1
prathamam	urdhvalakṣaḥ	kathyate/	ākāśamadhye	drṣṭiḥ/	\N2
prathamam	urdhvalakṣya/	kathyate/	ākāśamadhye	drṣṭiḥ/	\U1
prathamam	urdhvalakṣam	kathyate/	ākāśamadhye	drṣṭiḥ	\U2
prathamam	ūrdhvalakṣyaḥ	kathyate/			\P
athama	urdhalakṣam		//ākāśamadhye	drṣṭi	\B
atha	ūrdhvalakṣam		//ākāśamadhye	drṣṭiḥ/	\L
prathamam	ūrdhvalakṣyam	kathyate/	ākāśamadhye	drṣṭiḥ/	\E
athavā//	mana	ūrdhvaṃ	kūryāt/		\V
athavā	mana	ūrdhaṃ	kṛtvā	sthāpyate	\D
athavā	mana	ūrdhvaṃ	kṛtvā	sthāpyate//	\J
athavā//	mana	ūrdhaṃ	kṛtvā//	sthāpyate	\K1
atha ca//	mana	urdhvaṃ	kṛtvā	sthāpyate/	\N1
atha ca	mana	ūrdhvaṃ	kṛtvā	sthāpyate/	\N2
atha ca	manerdhvaṃ		kṛtvā	sthāpyate	\U1
atha	mana	urdhvaṃ	kṛtvā	sthāpyate//	\U2
atha ca	mana	ūrdhvaṃ	kṛtvā	sthāpyate/	\P
athavā		ūrdhvamāna	kṛtvā	sthāpyate	\B
athavā		ūrdhvaṃ mana	kṛtvā	sthāpyate	\L
kadā ca	mana	ūrdhvaṃ	kṛtvā	sthāpyati/	\E

Figure 9: A typical example of sentences in section XIV that shows how the redactor of V tried to improve upon his exemplar.

I collated all manuscripts of the β -hyparchetype except for V and K₃. Already when transcribing V, it became clear that despite its age, it is full of errors, conflation of sentences, and a redactor who was messing around with what was in his exemplar. Crucial points of the edition were double checked but V did not provide readings that would improve upon the reconstructed text. A collation of manuscript V would have pushed the size of the critical apparatus to unbearable extremes and was thus eliminated.

K₃, a manuscript kept in Kolkata in the Asiatic Society, might have been interesting to collate, but I was only able to buy copies of the first 6 of 25 folios due to a restrictive policy. Those folios contained no useful and interesting new variants.

I refer to the second hyparchetype as γ (B, C, E, K₂, L, P, P₂, S and U₂). This hyparchetype is further apart from the archetype but significant, as its transmission contains almost the entire text with fewer *lacunae*. The manuscripts that go back to the γ -hyparchetype proved to be important for the reconstruc-

tion of the text, particularly in those instances in which all β -manuscripts are clearly corrupt.

tathā yasya manah	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavati/	sa eva	kriyāyogaḥ// \D
tathā yasya manah	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavati/	sa eva	kriyāyogaḥ// \J
tathā yasya manah //	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavati//	sa eva	trayāyogaḥ// \K1
tathā yamanah	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavati/	sa eva	kriyāyogaḥ// \N1
tathā pavana---	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavati/	sa eva	kriyāyogaḥ// \N2
tathā yasya manah	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavati	sa eva	kriyāyogaḥ \U1
tathā yasya manah	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavati//	sa eva	caryāyogaḥ// \U2
tathā yasya manah	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavati	sa eva	caryāyogaḥ \P
tathā yasya manah	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavatī	sa eva	caryāyogaḥ// \B
tathā yasya manah	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavati	sa eva	caryāyogaḥ// \L
tathā yasya manah	nirākāramadhye	līnaṃ bhavati/	sa eva	caryāyogaḥ// \E

Figure 10: The image shows the end of section XVIII on Caryāyoga. The β -transmission clearly contains an early binding error and reads *kriyāyogaḥ* or *trayāyogaḥ*. The γ -transmission provides the correct reading *caryāyogaḥ*.

I eliminated C, P₂, K₂, and S, which are manuscripts I found after the submission of the dissertation. After transcribing and thoroughly checking their variants, they provided no helpful new variants for reconstructing the archetype. Although these four manuscripts occasionally offered better readings than the rest of the γ -witnesses, in each of these rare cases their variants were already covered by readings found in the β -group. Furthermore, the critical apparatus would have grown even larger without any real benefit.

There is no detectable contamination between the β and γ -hyparchetypes, making editorial practice easier and using computerised stemmatics more reliable. Whenever there is additional material in γ it is never present in β .

Although both groups contain numerous errors and are equally indispensable for reconstructing of the archetype, the β -hyparchetype stands closer to the archetype than its γ -counterpart, even once γ -interpolations are excluded. In practice, while β -readings are more often favourable, readings of one group frequently illuminate and correct corruptions in the other, and meaningful emendation is often possible only by contrasting both hyparchetypes.

1.6.1.2 Microstructural observations during collation

Thus, the α -archetype splits into the β and γ -hyparchetypes. The following observations provide further details regarding the microstructure of the stemma.

β -hyparchetype: Witness N_2 is either the exemplar of N_1 or both manuscripts stem from the same exemplar because they share the same substantial *lacuna* of $\approx 23,5\%$ of the whole text. The latter scenario is more likely, as N_2 contains two sentences that are missing in N_1 . I decided to collate both manuscripts, as there are occasional minor discrepancies—some of which proved helpful. Although both manuscripts still contain numerous minor errors, the process of textual reconstruction made it clear that, at least in the $\approx 76,5\%$ of the text they preserve, they on average transmit the best readings; N_1 and N_2 therefore stand closest to the archetype (α) among all surviving witnesses.

\om				\D
yadyat prayatnanihpādya	tattat	svadharmakāraṇam/		\J
yadyat aprayatna nihpādyaṃ	tattat	sarvam akāraṇam//		\K1
yadyat prayatnaniṣpādyaṃ	tattat	sarvam akāraṇam/		\N1
yadyat prayatnaniṣpādyaṃ	tattat	sarvam na kāraṇam//7//		\N2
yadyat aprayatra niṣyayiṃ	tat	sarvam akāraṇam		\U1
yadyat prayatnanihpādyaṃ	tat	sarvaṃ kāraṇa//		\U2
yadyat prayatnanihpārdhaṃ	tattat	sarvam akāraṇam		\P
yadyat prayatnanihpādya	tat	sarvam akāraṇāt/		\B
yadyat prayatnanihpādya	tat	sarvem ikāraṇāt//2//		\L
yadyat prayatnanihpāyaṃ	tattat	sarvam akāraṇam//6//		\E

Figure 11: The image shows a synoptic transcription of verse LIX.9cd. One of several instances in which N_1 and N_2 provide the best variants. Additionally, the last part shows the nature of discrepancies between the two Nepalese witnesses.

There are only three β -witnesses that transmit the text in its entirety: K_1 , J , and U_1 . The latter two must form a separate branch, and one must assume that either both derive from the same exemplar or that U_1 directly descends from J , since they share their distinctive readings in the majority of cases, although U_1 introduces a greater number of minor scribal errors. Within this branch of the β -group, J should therefore be placed closer to the archetype than U_1 . Moreover, J ranks among the best witnesses available, together

with N_I , N_2 , and K_I . However, in terms of its evolutionary distance from the archetype, J stands somewhat behind these three witnesses, though still ahead of D and U_I .

asthimadhye śākadvipaḥ	śiromadhye śālmalidvipaḥ//	\D
asthimadhye śaktidvipaḥ//	śiromadhye śālmalidvipaḥ//	\J
asthimadhye śākadvipaḥ	śiromadhye śālmalidvipaḥ//	\K1
\om		\N1
\om		\N2
astimadhye śāktidvipaḥ	śiromadhye śālmalidvipaḥ	\U1
asthimadhye śākadvipaḥ	śirāmadhye śālmalidvipaḥ/	\E
asthimadhye śākadvipaḥ	śirāmadhye śālmalidvipaḥ	\P
astimadhye śākaladvipaḥ//	śirāmadhye śākaladvipaḥ//	\B
astimadhye śākaladvipaḥ	śarīramadhye śākadvipaḥ	\L
astimadhye śākadvipaḥ//	śiromadhye śālmalidvipaḥ//	\U2

Figure 12: The image shows a synoptic transcription of a sentence in section XXXVI. One can clearly see that J and U_I share the same variants, with U_I producing further corruptions.

Furthermore, there is a lot of evidence, that also D and K_I belong to a sub-branch of β . However, a direct copy-relation can be ruled out, as D contains several specific *lacunae* that are absent in K_I . Thus, one has to assume at least one exemplar from which both witnesses derive. Overall, the clear impression emerged that K_I is likely quite close to the archetype, as its readings are frequently among the intrinsically strongest variants.

śarīmadhye	karmasthāne	nenekatīrthavallī	vasaṃti//	\D
śarīramadhye	marmasthāne	naikatīrthavallī	vasaṃti//	\J
śarīmadhye	karmasthāne	nenekatīrthavallī	vasaṃti//	\K1
\om				\N1
\om				\N2
śarīramadhye	marmasthāne	naikatīrthavallī	vasaṃti	\U1
śarīramadhye		'nekatīrthāvalī	vasati//	\U2
madhye		nekatīrthāvalī	vasaṃti/	\P
śarīramadhye		anekatīrthāvalī	vasaṃti//	\B
śarīramadhye		anekatīrthāvalī	vasaṃti//	\L
śarīramadhye		anekatīrthāni	vasaṃti/	\E

Figure 13: The image shows a synoptic transcription of a sentence in section XLI. One can clearly see that D and K_I belong to the same branch.

γ -hyparchetype: Among the nine available textual witnesses of the γ -group is the printed edition E, based on a hitherto unknown manuscript.¹¹⁹ The Pandit editor attempted to correct poorly transmitted text passages by his *divinatio*. Unfortunately, apart from some grammatical emendations, he often failed in this endeavour.

U₂ contains a considerable amount of additional material on the nine *cakras*. Initially, I underestimated U₂ owing to its extensive additions in sections IV–XII. When these are excluded, U₂ stands remarkably close to the β -hyparchetype. On average, U₂ is the one representative of the γ -hyparchetype with readings corresponding more frequently with β -hyparchetype than the rest of the γ -transmission. The best representative of the γ -witnesses is P, whose readings closely resemble those of K₂. However, K₂ begins only at the end of Section II while P preserves the full text. Thus, it is unlikely that a direct genealogical relationship exists between the two manuscripts. Both can therefore be assigned to the same branch, but at least one intermediary exemplar must be assumed to lie between them.

sarvāsām \om			\D
sarvāsām nijavṛttinām	vismṛtiṃ	bhajate tu yaḥ//	\J
sarvāsām nijavṛttinām	vismṛtiṃ	bhajate tu yaḥ//	\K1
\om			\N1
\om			\N2
sarvāsām nijavṛttinām	vismṛtiṃ	bhajate tu yaḥ	\U1
sarvāsām nijavṛttinām	vismṛtiṃ	bhajate tu yaḥ//	\U2
sarvāsām nijavṛttinām	vismṛtī	bhajate tu yaḥ	\P
sarvāsām bījavṛttinām	vismṛtī	bhajate tu yaḥ	\B
sarvāsām bījavṛttinām	vismṛtiṃ	bhajate tu yaḥ//	\L
sarvāsām nijavṛttinām	vismṛtīr	bhajate ttu yaḥ/	\E

Figure 14: The image shows a synoptic transcription of verse XLIV.9ab. That is one among many instances in which U₂ is closer to the β -hyparchetype than any other witness among the γ -witnesses.

A further branching of manuscripts splits from the γ -group, comprising B and L. These contain the worst and most erroneous transmission of the text by far. Surprisingly, in some rare cases, they provided the decisive and

¹¹⁹After the submission of the dissertation, I got hold of S, which is either the exemplar E or both go back to the same exemplar.

only convincing reading, making their inclusion in the collation laborious but indispensable.

\om			\D
anekākārabhedotthaṃ	kaṃ	svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ//7//	\J
anekākārabhedochaṃ	kaṃ	svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ////	\K1
\om			\N1
\om			\N2
anekākārabhedotthaṃ	sva	svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ	\U1
anekākārabhedotthaṃ	kaḥ//	svarūpātmakaṃ paraṃ//	\U2
anekākārabhedocchaṃ	kaṃ	svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ 7	\P
anekākārabhedochaṃ	kiṃ	svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ//7//	\B
anekākārabhedātthaṃ	kiṃ	svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ//7//	\L
anekākārabhedotthaṃ	kaṃ	svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ/	\E

Figure 15: The image shows a synoptic transcription of verse XLV.1cd. That is one among rare instances in which B and L read better than the rest of the entire transmission.

Overall, the γ -group is noted for containing additional material in some passages, usually verse insertions that elaborate on a specific term. These were critically edited with the available witnesses and included in the grayscale as they provide important insights into the reception history of the text. On average, the impression arose that P, at minimal distance from U_2 (excluding the supplementary material), is the most reliable witness of the γ -group.

In light of the characteristics of both groups, and given the necessity of drawing on each of them for the reconstruction of the α -archetype, it is reasonable to assume that the root of the stemma is to be placed precisely between these two groups, although the exact position of the root must have lain somewhat closer to the β -hyparchetype. In order to verify my micro- and macrostructural philological observations and to obtain measurable, statistically robust results capable of depicting the precise distances between the individual manuscripts more accurately than the human mind, the trees generated with phylogenetic software—presented in the following section—were incorporated into the analysis.

1.6.2 Computer Stemmatology applied to the *Tattvayogabindu*

For the constitution of the *stemma codicum*, all transcriptions of the entire *Tattvayogabindu* were additionally analysed using common algorithms from phylogenetic software tools for stemmatic analysis. The dataset was stored in the Nexus format. The numerous gaps in the transmission were coded as non-significant sites in the data to prevent the results from being distorted by the large *lacunae* or the interpolations of the γ -group, particularly manuscript U₂. The results were compared with my philological observations, and the findings of both approaches were combined to achieve a final result. Here, I present the most useful phylogenetic trees which support and complement my philological considerations. Discrepancies between philological methods and computer-assisted stemmatology are examined and explained in detail.

This work may serve as an example of how such computer-assisted methods can be applied to stemmatic analysis in a less complex transmission like that of the *Tattvayogabindu*, to create a *stemma codicum* based on empirical data, harmonising the empiricism of phylogenetic analysis with the expertise of the philologist.^{120,121}

¹²⁰ See baptiste2020 (2020: 339–356) for an overview of the criticism digital methods have faced since their inception.

¹²¹ The main reason why the *Tattvayogabindu* constitutes a particularly suitable case for combining computer-assisted stemmatology with traditional methods of stemma construction is the absence of contamination between the β - and γ -groups. This significantly reduces the susceptibility of phylogenetic algorithms to methodological errors when applied to this tradition. As maas2009stemma (2009) has shown with regard to cladistic analysis using Maximum Parsimony, such errors typically arise from the strictly bifurcating structure of computer-generated trees. In these models, each extant textual witness is connected by exactly one branch to a single inferred ancestor, a structure that cannot adequately represent contamination within a textual tradition. Moreover, strict bifurcation fails to account for cases in which a manuscript was copied more than once and several of its descendants have survived. In cladistic trees, every extant manuscript is therefore modelled as a copy of an inferred witness, which is often inaccurate, since in most textual transmissions numerous manuscripts are in fact direct copies of other surviving manuscripts. See maas2009stemma. If the editor is aware of these structural limitations, has a thorough understanding of the transmission of the text, and is familiar with the assumptions and mechanics of the applied algorithms, falsely assumed bifurcations or contamination effects in computer-generated models can be identified. Under these conditions, phylogenetic analyses can meaningfully inform and refine the editor's philological judgement, supporting the manual construction of a plausible and empirically grounded *stemma codicum* that reflects the underlying trans-

1.6.2.1 Tree 1 and 2: Maximum Parsimony

The phylogenetic method based on the *Maximum Parsimony* algorithm is among the most widely used approaches for stemmatic analysis in philology.¹²²

The first resulting tree (Figure 16) has a very good CI (Consistency Index) of ≈ 0.79 . This indicates that the proposed tree structure accounts for roughly 79% of the trait changes represented in the phylogeny. My earlier observation that the manuscripts divide into two principal groups served as an explicit criterion for placing the root precisely between these two branches—a division also affirmed by the *Maximum Parsimony* algorithm.

The first tree (Figure 16), however, has three weaknesses.

First, even if N_1 were a direct copy of N_2 , it would never be able to detect that. This inability is due to the algorithm's strictly bifurcating assumptions, noted above.

The second weakness is indicated by the relatively low bootstrap value¹²³ of only 53 at the node where U_2 is positioned. In my view this arises because the character states resulting from the editorial interventions of the scribe who is also responsible for the additional material cannot be accommodated smoothly by the algorithm when viewed against the remaining γ -transmission. Consequently, the position of U_2 requires careful philological consideration.

mission of the text as accurately as possible. In the case of the *Yogatattvabindu*, however, the aforementioned problems—particularly those related to contamination—do not play a role.

¹²²*Maximum Parsimony* calculates all possible bifurcating trees and searches for the most parsimonious tree (the one requiring the fewest changes). It groups manuscripts according to their shared derived characters. Only parsimony-informative sites are considered: a site is informative if it contains more than one variant and at least two variants occur at least twice. All other sites are excluded; see *windram2008* (2008: 445–446).

¹²³Bootstrapping measures the statistical support for parts of a phylogenetic tree; see *felsenstein1985* (1985). The method assesses whether the entire dataset supports the reconstructed tree or whether the proposed tree is merely one among several nearly equivalent alternatives. This is achieved by repeatedly resampling the dataset, constructing trees from these random subsamples, and calculating how frequently the various clades reappear. Bootstrap support is assigned according to the frequency with which a given manuscript group is recovered. A clade appearing in every subsample receives 100% support; if it appears in half of them, support is 50%. Values of 70% or higher generally indicate reliable groupings; see *sandra2003* (2003: 250).

The third weakness of the tree—visible only when the display option “Branches proportional to length” is enabled—is the seemingly very short branch leading to V and U₂. This stands in striking contrast to the philological evidence. While it is indeed intriguing that the tree confirms the early divergence of both manuscripts’ branches, the evolutionary distance from the root must, in reality, be far greater. How is this to be explained?

It is crucial to understand that branch length here indicates only the number of character-state changes uniquely attributable to that node or taxon. It does *not* indicate, as an untrained eye might assume, how “close” a text stands to the archetype. Rather, it reflects the number of diagnostic (synapomorphic) changes assigned to that branch. If a manuscript such as V or U₂ exhibits many idiosyncratic, unshared variants—often editorial in nature—that are exclusive to itself, i.e. *autapomorphies*, then two consequences follow. First, the *Maximum Parsimony* algorithm ignores autapomorphies when constructing the topology; they play no role in determining the manuscript’s position within the tree. Parsimony evaluates only shared innovations. Thus, if V and U₂ represent early splits but shares almost no variants with any other witness, the algorithm places them close to the root. Second, branch lengths become shorter when most changes are autapomorphies. For example, the branch of V therefore appears short, even though the text is in fact heavily altered. For this reason, in such cases it is advisable to disable the option “Branches proportional to length” (Figure 17).

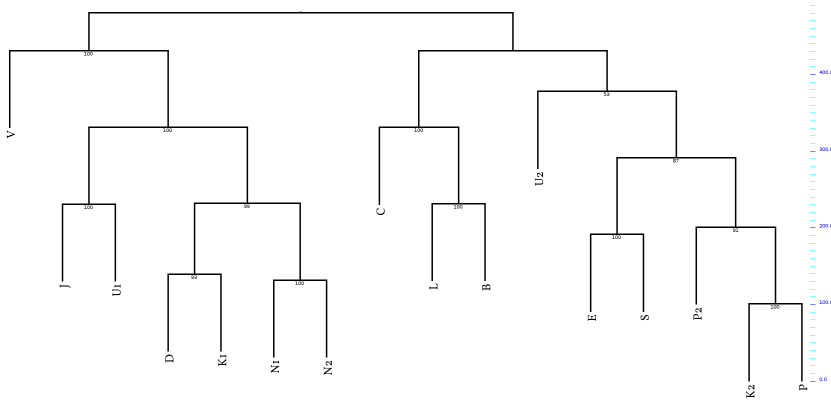


Figure 16: Generated with Mesquite Version 3.81 (build 955). **Algorithm:** *Parsimony Tree Analysis* with PAUP 4.a168. **Dataset:** Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

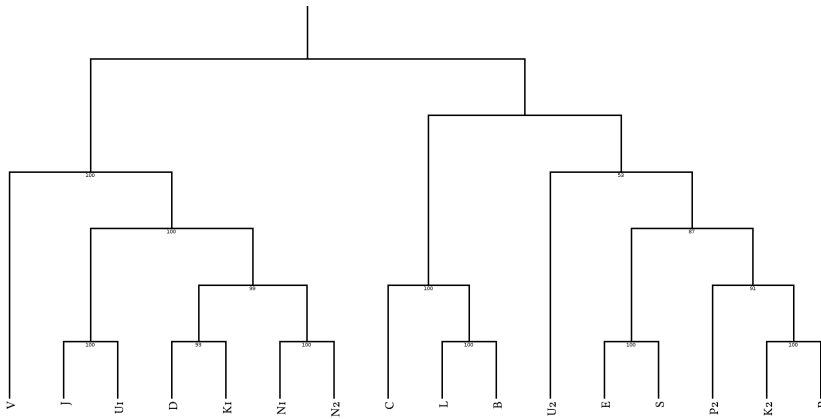


Figure 17: Generated with Mesquite Version 3.81 (build 955). **Algorithm:** *Parsimony Tree Analysis* with PAUP 4.a168. **Dataset:** Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

Apart from the weaknesses noted above, all further philological microstructural observations can be confirmed.

1.6.2.2 Tree 3, 4 and 5: Neighbour-joining

This section shows three *neighbor-joining* trees (Figure 18, 19 and 20).¹²⁴ The three trees are based on the same dataset. All spelling-variations were normalised to reduce *noise*. Any gaps in the transmission are encoded as non-significant. All three trees use the p-distance, a simple measure of sequence divergence.¹²⁵ The results differ only slightly, but in my assessment, all three trees correspond with key philological observations. The first tree (Figure 18) is unrooted. The second tree (Figure 19) is rooted by the calculated midpoint.¹²⁶ The three trees match the macro- and microstructural philological

¹²⁴*Neighbor-joining* is a particular approach to phylogenetic analysis that SplitsTree can execute. The primary mechanism behind this is a hierarchical clustering technique, see [neil1987](#). A concise explanation by the authors is as follows: “The principle of this method is to find pairs of operational taxonomic units (OTUs [= neighbours]) that minimise the total branch length at each level of clustering of OTUs starting from a star-shaped tree. The branch lengths and topology of a parsimonious tree can be quickly determined using this method.” In this case, it can be visualised as follows: The algorithm is fed with a diverse set of texts in the form of manuscript transcripts, which act as operational taxonomic units. *Neighbor-joining* divides them into smaller groups with shared features. First, the algorithm measures the distance of each possible pair of manuscripts. This distance indicates how different or similar they are regarding specific features. Then, the algorithm finds the two manuscripts with the smallest distance between them. These are the “closest neighbours” in terms of similarity. These two individual manuscripts are then joined together to form a node. This node represents an assumed common ancestor. The algorithm then recalculates the distances between this newly created node and all other manuscripts. These distances reflect each manuscript’s overall similarity or dissimilarity to the new node. The process repeats and identifies the next pair of nearest manuscripts or groups of manuscripts, creates the next node, and adjusts the distances. In this way, a phylogenetic tree is created. The function repeats these steps until all manuscripts and groups of manuscripts are connected in an undirected tree-like structure in which the length of the branches and the distance between the nodes represent the relationships of the manuscripts based on their similarities. Neighbour-joining assumes a constant rate of evolution across all lineages, and branch lengths correspond to evolutionary distances. The resulting trees can vary considerably depending on how the data are coded and how gaps are treated. The application of *neighbor-joining* to support philological work is discussed by [stemmamethods](#) (2020: 319).

¹²⁵The “Uncorrected P” or p-distance calculates the proportion of nucleotide or amino acid sites at which two sequences differ. The calculation of Uncorrected P is simple. The number of differing sites is divided by the total number of sites compared; see [hudson2022](#).

¹²⁶Midpoint rooting is a computational method used to assign a root to an unrooted phylogenetic tree or network by identifying the pair of taxa separated by the greatest patristic distance (i.e., the longest distance across the tree when branch lengths are considered). The algorithm then places the root at the midpoint of the longest path, effectively splitting it into two halves. This procedure does not rely on external outgroup information but instead assumes that evolutionary rates are approximately clock-like across the tree; under this as-

observations very well. In contrast to the *Maximum Parsimony* analysis (see above), the pronounced divergence of V within the β -group and of U₂ in the γ -group is clearly corroborated. While the unrooted tree leaves open whether the β or γ -hyparchetype lies closer to the root, i.e., the archetype, the rooted tree gives additional weight to my observation that the β -hyparchetype is overall closer to the archetype than γ . The first tree (Figure 18) additionally displays its bootstrap scores, which statistically underpins the validity of the depicted structure with extremely high values. The final tree (Figure 20) depicts the unrooted Neighbor-joining in a display mode which is closer to a traditional stemma codicum.

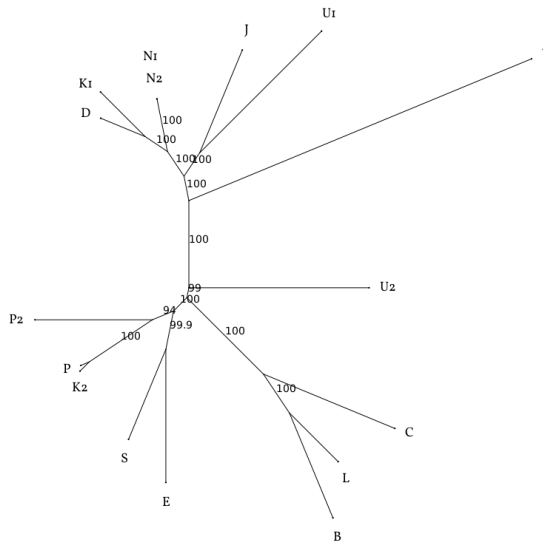


Figure 18: Generated with SplitsTree App version 6.3.12. **Algorithm:** *Neighbor-joining* (unrooted). **Distance:** Uncorrected P. **Dataset:** Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

sumption, the longest path is taken to represent the deepest divergence, and its midpoint provides a plausible estimate of the root. Splitstree implements this procedure by first computing all pairwise distances among taxa, locating the pair with the maximal separation, and then inserting the root at the exact point along their connecting path where the distances to each side are equal.

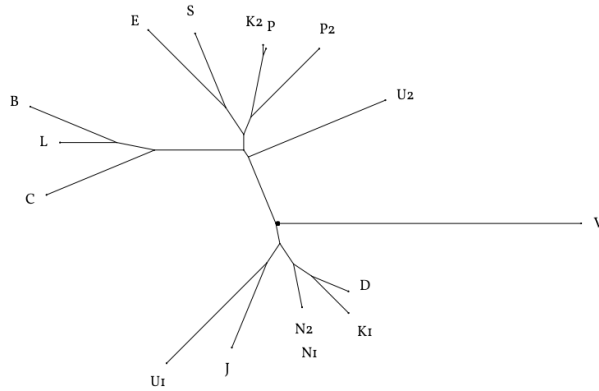


Figure 19: Generated with SplitsTree App version 6.3.12. **Algorithm:** *Neighbor-joining* (root by MidPoint, the little dot at the central line marks the root). **Distance:** Uncorrected P. **Dataset:** Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

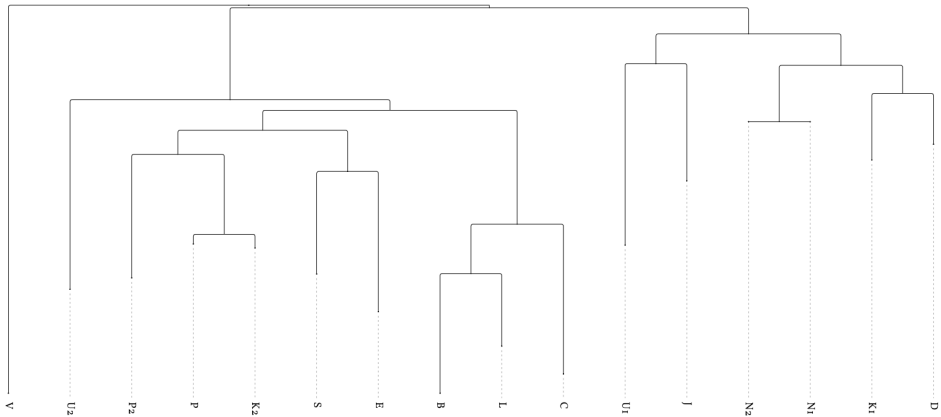


Figure 20: Generated with SplitsTree App version 6.3.12. **Algorithm:** *Neighbor-joining* (root by MidPoint, the little dot at the central line marks the root). **Distance:** Uncorrected P. **Dataset:** Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Bootstrapping with 1000 replicates.

1.6.2.3 Tree 3: Minimum Spanning Tree

Another vital aspect is illustrated by the *Minimum Spanning Tree* (Figure 21).¹²⁷ Interestingly, the *Minimum Spanning Tree* could be helpful to confirm important manuscripts due to its algorithmic properties. In our case, it highlights the central manuscripts of the two groups, namely N_2 for the β -group and P for the γ -group, which perfectly aligns with my philological observations. The *Minimum Spanning Tree* algorithm has only been used rarely in philology. Further experiments with different text traditions with known stemma would be necessary to determine whether these valid results occur repeatedly.

¹²⁷The algorithm underlying the *Minimum Spanning Tree* calculates an undirected and unrooted tree-shaped graph representing the simplest way to connect all the manuscripts by minimising the corresponding nodes based on their pairwise distances, see e.g. **stemmamethods** (2020: 317). Also see **cormen2009introduction** (2009). Furthermore, see **huson2022** (2022: 43). The goal of the *Minimum Spanning Tree* is to calculate the connections between the manuscripts so that the total length to connect all manuscripts settles on the minimum. The *Minimum Spanning Tree* thus, in our use case, represents the simplest and most efficient way to connect a set of manuscripts while minimising the total distance (based on their differences) of the connections. The resulting tree is far from a stemma and does not include hypothetical ancestral nodes at branching points; any shown branching point corresponds to a manuscript in every case.

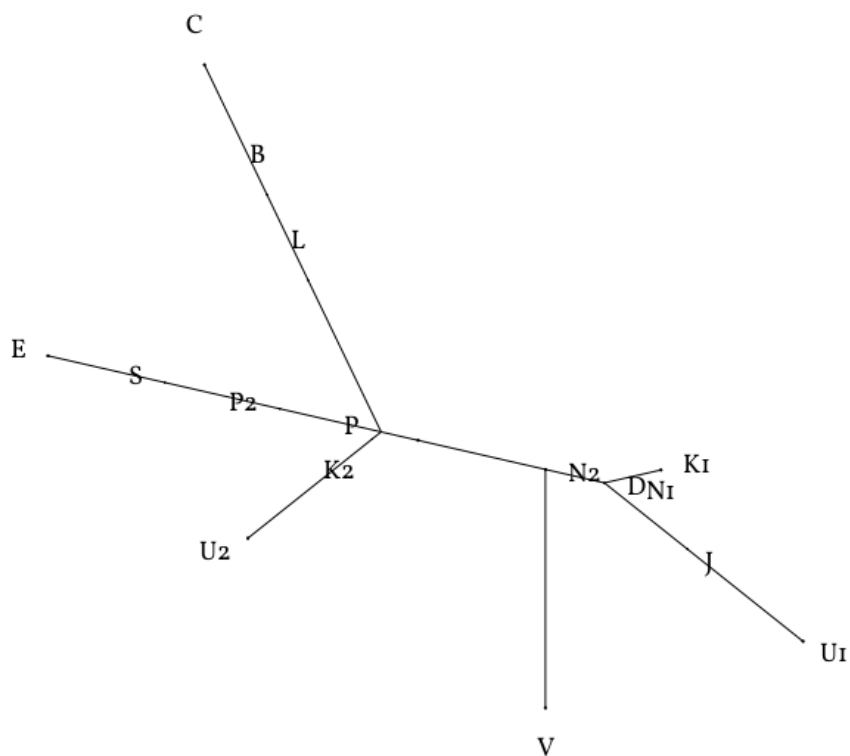
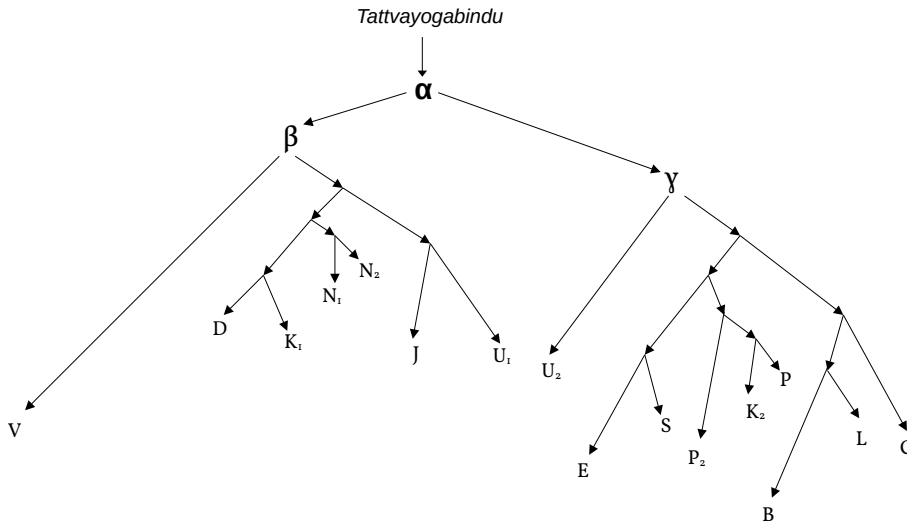


Figure 21: Generated with SplitsTree App 6.3.12. Algorithm: *Minimum Spanning Tree*. Distance: Uncorrected P. Dataset: Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

1.6.2.4 *Stemma codicum*Figure 22: Stemmatic hypothesis of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

The cumulative evidence from the phylogenetic algorithms, combined with the philological methods, leads to the following *stemma codicum* (Figure 22) of the *Tattvayogabindu*. This graph represents a plausible hypothesis of the relationships between the textual witnesses based on the current state of knowledge, forming the foundation upon which the critical edition presented in this study was prepared.

1.7 Conventions for the critical edition

To enhance reader convenience, the critical edition with its apparatus and the translation together with annotations are presented on facing pages. This arrangement eliminates the need for constant page-turning when the reader wishes to consult the edition, translation, and annotations. While this format offers a significant advantage, it also presents a challenge: the

length of the critical edition, including the multi-register critical apparatus on the verso page, does not always match the length of the translation and annotations on the recto page. Despite efforts to minimise this discrepancy, such as shortening annotations, printing empty spaces on one or both pages was often unavoidable.¹²⁸

The constituted text of the critical edition has been set in modern Devanāgarī, reflecting the vast majority of manuscripts and presumably the original text of the *Tattvayogabindu*. The editor introduced the headings and section numbering in large Roman numerals within square brackets to organise the text, make the beginning of new topics clear, and facilitate citation. These headings correspond to the sections introduced in the text by recognisable phrases such as *atha*, *idānīm*, and the like. Rāmacandra did not distinguish between chapters, subchapters, sections, and subsections but instead linked themes with these phrases. The headings in square brackets follow this convention. The verse numbering begins with the section numbering and subsequently counts the number of verses per section.

The verses have been organised and structured in accordance with the conventions of modern printed editions of metrical Sanskrit texts. Beyond the introduction of section headings, however, I have refrained from subdividing the prose passages into indented paragraphs, as such divisions would constitute an additional interpretative intervention not attested in the sources. This decision aims to preserve the original textual continuity and

¹²⁸This undertaking was laborious, and due to the complexity of the critical apparatus and the evolving technology used in this work, each page had to be manually typeset. This manual process did not achieve the precision that computer-generated typesetting would provide. I decided to typeset the critical edition with the Lua[®]TeX package “ekdosis,” see <https://ctan.org/pkg/ekdosis>. Ekdosis allows for creating multilingual critical editions with a multi-level critical apparatus and a printable PDF document. The primary reason for this choice is that the entire edition is also output as a TEI-compliant XML file. This file can then be converted into an HTML file, i.e., a digital edition (which I hope to publish soon for the *Tattvayogabindu*) with the press of a button using a script and an XSLT processor, facilitating computer-aided stemmatic analysis, data mining, and similar tasks. I want to thank Robert Alessi for his incredible support. I hope that ekdosis, which holds great potential for philologists seeking to leverage digital humanities, will continue to be developed and enable automatic page breaks of a complex multi-layered critical apparatus in an alignment environment of facing pages with translation and annotation. I hope some readers will appreciate the effort made to provide the convenience of not having to flip between the edition, translation, and annotations in my edition.

character of the work. Since the prose sections are often so brief that further paragraphisation would in any case not have required repeated editorial intervention.

Among the text's witnesses, there is a deviating and inconsistent application of *sandhi*. For the edited text, I have standardised *sandhi* and, when necessary, added *avagrahas* to provide a readable text adhering to contemporary conventions in Sanskrit. The variant readings concerning *sandhi* are consistently recorded in the apparatus criticus. That is due to various text-critical problems¹²⁹ arising from the inconsistent usage of punctuation, which results in the application or non-application of *sandhi* depending on whether the respective witness applied a *daṇḍa* or not. That is particularly the case within lists, which frequently occur in our compilation. Items were most likely originally separated by double *daṇḍas*.

These lists are a frequent feature in the *Tattvayogabindu*. The text opens with a list of 15 Yogas, and many more lists are utilised throughout its content. In order to produce a consistent and easily readable edition, lists have been normalised to the nominative singular or nominative plural form of the respective item, or, in the case of explanatory lists, to the ablative singular or plural. The items of the lists are always separated by a double *daṇḍa* (||).

The critical edition follows the standard conventions of punctuation. In verse poetry, a *daṇḍa* (|) marks the end of half a stanza or two quarters of the *śloka*, and a double *daṇḍa* (||) marks the end of a verse. In prose, a single *daṇḍa* indicates the end of a sentence, and a double *daṇḍa* marks the end of a section. In most cases, the *daṇḍa* in prose corresponds to a full stop.

The reader will observe that the critically established text employs *daṇḍas* with comparatively high frequency. Since, however, these punctuation marks are attested at a similarly high rate in virtually all manuscripts representing both hyparchetypes, their prevalence can hardly be regarded as

¹²⁹The inconsistent use of punctuation marks in the available witnesses necessitates standardisation. Upon close examination, it appears that punctuation has frequently been dropped or added during the transmission of the texts. The copyists' neglect or improper handling of punctuation has resulted in different versions of lists with and without punctuation. In many instances, missing punctuation has led to the change of case endings, alteration of the text, and the combination of list items into compound formations that were not present in the original text.

a secondary feature confined to a particular branch of the transmission. Rather, the agreement of the two branches strongly suggests that this usage is already to be assigned to the archetype reconstructed in the present edition. Accordingly, the *daṇḍas* have been retained in the constituted text, insofar as the aim of the edition is to reconstruct a textual form that stands closer to the lost original than any single surviving witness.

Furthermore, I have standardised gemination and degemination of consonants after semi-vowels. Due to the inconsistent use of class nasals among the witnesses, *anusvāras* have been substituted with the respective class nasals throughout the edition.

1.7.1 Grammatical particularities

Grammatical constructions in this text occasionally depart from the norms of Classical Sanskrit. In most cases, however, their frequency suggests that they should not be regarded as errors, but rather as features of contemporary or regional usage. In a number of passages, the genitive is employed in place of other cases.¹³⁰ Several relative constructions begin with *yasya*, which is to be understood as *yasmin*, since the corresponding correlative pronoun would otherwise appear to be lacking. In such relative constructions, a *daṇḍa* must also frequently be interpreted as functioning like a comma.

1.7.2 Guide to the apparatus

The critical apparatus consists of five registers, not all of which are filled on each page. These registers attest sources, testimonia, parallels, the critical apparatus with readings of the witnesses, and notes. To facilitate the differentiation of sources, testimonia, and parallels for the reader, these are marked as such on each page where they occur, aside from the critical apparatus. Sources, testimonia and parallel passages are consequently cited diplomatically. Orthographical, grammatical, and scribal irregularities have not been emended, as they may be relevant for assessing textual transmission and manuscript affiliation.

¹³⁰ whitney1879 1879: 87, 294.

The numbering of all registers of the apparatus and the lemmata follows the line numbering. This applies to both prose passages and verses. Every line is counted, and every fifth line of the text is numbered on the far left margin. The numbering is bold and blue to aid the reader's navigation in the apparatus. When present, the first register of the apparatus displays the source texts. It should be noted that Rāmacandra does not adopt the sources verbatim but often converts verses into prose and occasionally adds or omits information according to his agenda. When Rāmacandra incorporates verses, he usually makes editorial changes. According to the schema, variables in the source texts are indicated in round brackets following the affected word.

In the second register, if available, testimonia are recorded. In the third register, if available, parallel passages that are helpful or informative for the reconstruction of the text are noted. All texts used in these first three registers are consistently cited. If these texts are only available in manuscript form, the entry begins with the title, followed by an abbreviation for the location, the Ms. No., in round brackets (e.g., MMPP 2244, f. 99r l. 1–2). When the passage of the source, the testimonia or the parallel is identical, it is preceded by the equal sign (=). The approximate sign ($\approx$) is used instead when the passage is approximate to a certain degree.

The fourth register contains the critical apparatus. The critical apparatus is positive. Each lemma begins with the corresponding line number, followed by the selected reading. The selected reading is followed by one or more sigla that contain this reading. The closing square bracket separates this from the rejected variants. These are presented with the reading followed by the siglum. The selected reading is always highlighted in bold. The abbreviation “cett.” has been introduced to keep the critical apparatus concise. It stands for the Latin *ceteri*, meaning literally “the rest,” and refers to all other witnesses except those named for each lemma. This entry can appear only once per lemma. Here is an example:

indriyavikārah cett.] iṇdriyaṃ vīkārah P iti vikārah L

When the selected reading results from an emendation (em.) or a conjecture (conj.), the corresponding abbreviation appears instead of a witness, a

group of witnesses (β or γ), or the *ceteri* (cett.) abbreviation before the square bracket. If the emendation or conjecture is attributed to a colleague, the colleague's surname is printed before the abbreviation. If the reasoning behind the conjecture is not self-explanatory, it is explained in the annotations. The plus sign (+) represents illegible or missing letters due to manuscript damage. Given the manageable number of textual witnesses, I recorded all variants in the critical apparatus, except for those stemming purely from scribal conventions (e.g., substitution of class nasals with anusvāra, gemination/degemination of consonants). Thus, if one manuscript reads °tatva° and another °tattva°, only the latter (standard) spelling is reported for both, since this does not constitute a meaningful variant.

If words or sentences are omitted (om.), this is always noted in the corresponding entry before the respective siglum. However, in cases of larger *lacunae*, such as the *lacunae* in N_1 and N_2 , which encompass 23,50% of the total text, I have opted not to record each omission in the apparatus for the sake of a more concise critical apparatus. For these cases, I have documented this in the last register of the apparatus, which informs about the beginning and end of larger gaps in the respective witness, with a note that the large *lacunae* for this section are not included in the critical apparatus. In addition to comments regarding omissions, the final register also contains information about transpositions of passages and other such details. According to the conventions of recent publications of critical editions of Yoga texts¹³¹, the lemmata in the critical apparatus, as well as all sources, testimonia, and parallels, are set in Roman transliteration.

Variants are generally arranged in accordance with the stemma, proceeding from left to right from the reading judged preferable to that considered less preferable. Where several witnesses attest the same reading, their sigla are given in alphabetical order.

¹³¹See, for example, *Amṛtasiddhi* (2021), *Śivayogapradīpikā* (2023), or *Amarāgha* and *Amarāghaprabodha* of Gorakṣanātha (2024).

1.7.3 Guide to the translation and annotations

The translation is arranged parallel to the critical edition on the recto side of the book. In the translations, I have endeavoured to reflect the style of Sanskrit. Thus, I have sought to balance literal and idiomatic translation well. Verse insertions have been enumerated according to the numbering of the sections and clearly marked as such. When translations of certain words derive from a secondary or tertiary meaning, and the significance is not immediately apparent, the Sanskrit term is noted in round brackets. Technical terms from Sanskrit or proper names have not been translated into English. Technical terms with various possible translations, whose meaning can only be discerned in the context of the entire text, are printed in Sanskrit but accompanied by a translation in round brackets. English words that had to be added to facilitate the translation or provide contextual information that was not immediately evident are integrated into the translation in square brackets. The footnotes discuss textual issues, provide additional information, explain technical terms, or highlight important or interesting parallels to other texts.

In the translation I occasionally introduce paragraph breaks that are not marked as such in the Sanskrit text. This is intentional. Sanskrit manuscripts and traditional editions generally do not employ paragraphing in the same way as modern European texts. Introducing paragraphs in the translation serves to clarify the structure and argument for the reader and to make the text more accessible. Since the translation is an interpretative act, it may diverge in its layout from the edited Sanskrit text.

1.7.4 Abbreviations and signs

- + one illegible character; ++ indicates one illegible *akṣara*
- † marks the beginning and end of a corrupted and hitherto unreconstructable passage
- = passage or verse is identical
- ≈ passage or verse is similar

AS Asiatic Society Kolkata (former RASB = Royal Asiatic Society of Bengal)

BORI Bhandakar Oriental Research Institute (Pune)

conj. conjecture

CSS Sanskrit Manuscripts of Candra Shum Shere

Ed. Edition

em. emendation

et seqq. et sequentia ("and those following")

f. folio

ff. folios

GOML Government Oriental Manuscript Library (Chennai)

HVVRI Hoshiarpur Vishveshvarananda Vedic Research Institute

IFP French Institute of Pondicherry

IGNCA Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (Delhi)

illeg. illegible

JNUL Jawaharlal Nehru University Library

l. line

ll. lines

Ms. Manuscript

Mss. Manuscripts

Ms. No. Manuscript number

MMPP Maharaja Man Singh Pustak Prakash Research Centre

NCC New Catalogus Catalogorum

NGMCP Nepalese German Manuscript Cataloguing Project

NGMPP Nepalese German Manuscript Preservation Project

NWS Nachtragswörterbuch des Sanskrit

NUL Nagpur University Library

OBL Oxford Bodleian Library

OI MSU Oriental Institute, The Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda
(Vadodara)

ORI Oriental Research Institute (Mysore)

ORIS	Oriental Research Institute (Srinagar)
pc	post correctionem
PULL	Panjab University Library Lahore
r.	recto
ŚKD	<i>Śabdakalpadruma</i>
SSP	<i>Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati</i>
SORI	Scindia Oriental Research Institute Vikram University (Ujjain)
unm.	unmetrical
vol.	volume
vols.	volumes
v.	verso
YK	<i>Yogakarnīkā</i>
TYB	<i>Tattvayogabindu</i>
YSv	<i>Yogasvarodaya</i>

1.7.5 Sigla in the critical apparatus

- β : D, J, K_I, N_I, N₂, U_I
- γ : B, E, L, P, U₂
- B : Bodleian Oxford D 4587
- G : *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* GOML Ms. No. R 3239
- G_{pc} : *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* GOML Ms. No. R 3239
- cett.: ceteri (all manuscripts except the ones mentioned in the lemma)
- D_I: IGNCA 30019
- E : Printed Edition
- J : JNUL Ms. No. 55769
- Jo : *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* MMPP MS. No. 2244
- K_I: AS G 11019
- L : Lalchand Research Library LRL5876
- M : *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* ORIM Ms. No. B 220

- N₂: NGMPP B 38-35 / A 1327-14
- N₁: NGMPP B 38-31
- P : Pune BORI 664
- PT : *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*
- U₁: SORI 1574
- U₂: SORI 6082
- V : OI MSU 10558
- YK : *Yogakarnikā*
- YSv : *Yogasvarodaya*

Chapter 2

The *Tattvayogabindu* of

Rāmacandra

Critical Edition & Annotated

Translation

[I. rājayogaprakāra]

श्रीगणेशाय नमः ॥

अथ राजयोगप्रकारो लिख्यते ।

राजयोगस्येदं फलं येन राजयोगेनानेकराज्यभोगसमय एव । अनेकपार्थिवविनोद-
 5 प्रेक्षणसमय एव । बहुतरकालं शरीरस्थितिर्भवति । स एव राजयोगः ।
 तस्यैते भेदाः ।

क्रियायोगः १ ॥ ज्ञानयोगः २ ॥ चर्यायोगः ३ ॥ हठयोगः ४ ॥ कर्मयोगः ५ ॥ ल-
 ययोगः ६ ॥ ध्यानयोगः ७ ॥ मन्त्रयोगः ८ ॥ लक्ष्ययोगः ९ ॥ वासनायोगः १० ॥
 10 शिवयोगः ११ ॥ ब्रह्मयोगः १२ ॥ अद्वैतयोगः १३ ॥ सिद्धयोगः १४ ॥ राजयोगः
 १५ ॥ एते पञ्चदशयोगाः ॥

Sources: 2–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 831): atha rājayogaḥ || yogasvarodaye | iśvara uvāca | rājayogaḥ pravakṣyāmi śṛṇu sarvatra siddhidam | guhyād guhyataraṁ devi nānādharmam parāt param rājayogena deveśi nṛpapūjyo bhaven naraḥ | rājayogī cirāyus ca aṣṭaiśvaryaṁ bhavet || 8–11 cf. YSv (PT, p. 831): pañcadaśaprakāro 'yaṁ rājayogaḥ || kriyāyogo jñānayogaḥ karma-yogo haṭhas tathā | dhyānayogo mantrayoga urayogaś ca vāsanā | rājaty etad brahmavaśīva ebhiś ca pañcadaśadhā | idānīm lakṣaṇaṁ ca iṣāṁ kathayāmi śṛṇu priye |

Parallels: 8–11 cf. *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 2): nididhyāsanaṁ caikatānatādirūpo rājayogāparaparyāyaḥ samādhiḥ | tatsādhanam tu kriyāyogaḥ, caryāyogaḥ, karmayogo, haṭhayogo, mantrayogo, jñānayogaḥ, advaitayogo, lakṣyayogo, brahmayogaḥ, śivayogaḥ, siddhiyogo, vāsanāyogo, layayogo, dhyānayogaḥ, premabhaktiyogaś ca |

2 śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ cett.] śrīṇeyamaḥ P, śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrīgurave namaḥ || N₁, śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrīgurubhyo namaḥ || om namaḥ śrīvāsudevāya || om nīraṁjanāya || J, śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrīsarasvatyai namaḥ || śrīnīraṁjanāya namaḥ || DK₁, śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ || om śrīnīraṁjanāya || U₁ 3 atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate DJK₁N₁N₂] atha rājayogaprakāra likhyate U₁, rājayogāntargataḥ || binduyogaḥ E, atha tattvabimduyogaprārambhaḥ L, atha rājayoga liṣyate P, atha rājayoga likhyate U₂ 4 rājayogasyedaṁ phalaṁ PU₂] rājayogasya idaṁ phalaṁ DJK₁N₁N₂, om. EL °yogenāneka° PN₁] °yogena aneka° DJK₁N₂U₁U₂ 5 °prekṣaṇasamaya cett.] prekṣaṇasamaya U₂ eva cett.] evaṁ U₂ rājayogaḥ cett.] rājayogas U₂ 6 tasyaite PU₂] tasya ete cett. 8 caryāyogaḥ cett.] tvaryāyogaḥ U₁ 8–9 layayogaḥ cett.] nayayogaḥ U₂ 9 lakṣyayogaḥ cett.] lakṣayogaḥ JU₁ 10 siddhayogaḥ PU₂] rājayogaḥ β rājayogaḥ PU₂] siddhayogaḥ cett. 11 ete pañcadaśayogaḥ cett.] evaṁ pañcadaśayogā bhavaṁti U₂

[I. Method of Rājayoga]

Homage to the glorious Gaṇeśa.

Now, the method of Rājayoga is laid down.

This is the fruit of Rājayoga: Through Rājayoga, the long-term durability of the body arises even when there is the manifold enjoyment of political power [and] even when there is manifold royal entertainment and spectacle.¹³² That alone is Rājayoga.

These are the varieties [of Rājayoga]:

1. Kriyāyoga (“Yoga of [mental] action”); 2. Jñānayoga (“Yoga of gnosis”); 3. Caryāyoga (“Yoga of conduct”);¹³³ 4. Haṭhayoga (“Yoga of force”); 5. Karmayoga (“Yoga of deeds”); 6. Layayoga (“Yoga of absorption”); 7. Dhyānayoga (“Yoga of meditation”); 8. Mantrayoga (“Yoga of mantra”); 9. Lakṣyayoga (“Yoga of foci”); 10. Vāsanāyoga (“Yoga of mental residues”); 11. Śivayoga (“Yoga of Śiva”); 12. Brahmayoga (“Yoga of Brahman”); 13. Advaitayoga (“Yoga of non-duality”); 14. Siddhayoga (“Yoga of the Siddhas”); 15. Rājayoga (“Yoga for kings”).¹³⁴ These are the fifteen yogas.¹³⁵

¹³²This unique definition of Rājayoga hints at an exceptionally wealthy lifestyle of Rāmacandra’s audience.

¹³³The first three yogas invite comparison with the familiar Śaiva categories of *kriyā*, *caryā*, *jñāna*, and *yoga*; cf. *nishvasa*2015.

¹³⁴For Rājayoga with this meaning see *birch*2014.

¹³⁵The definitive source of the list of the fifteen yogas presented at the beginning of the text is uncertain. Rāmacandra’s text is largely based on the content and structure of the *Yogasvarodaya* (YSv) as quoted in *ramatosana* (Ed. pp. 831–858). In this text, however, the list is incomplete. YSv mentions the total amount of fifteen yogas but names only eight subcategories of Rājayoga. Because of that, Rāmacandra might have seen the necessity to complete it. The other source he used for compiling his text is *ssplonavla* (SSP), which does not present such a list. Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents an almost identical list in his *yogacandrika*. A comparable list of twelve yogas occurs in Sundardās’s *sarvangayoga*. A detailed investigation of the fifteen yogas is presented from p. 299 onwards.

[II. kriyāyogasya lakṣaṇam]

इदानीं क्रियायोगस्य लक्षणं कथ्यते ।

क्रियामुक्तिरयं योगः स्वपिण्डे सिद्धिदायकः ।

यं यं करोति कल्लोलं कार्यारंभे मनः सदा ।

5 तत्तदाकुञ्चनं कुर्वन्क्रियायोगस्ततो भवेत् ॥ II.1॥

क्षमाविवेकवैराग्यं शान्तिसन्तोषनिस्पृहाः ।

एतद्युक्तियुतो योऽसौ क्रियायोगी निगद्यते ॥ II.2॥

मात्सर्यं ममता माया हिंसाशा मदगर्वता ।

कामक्रोधौ भयं लज्जा लोभमोहौ तथाशुचिः ॥ II.3॥

10 रागद्वेषौ घृणालस्यं भ्रन्तिर्दम्भोऽक्षमा भ्रमः ।

यस्यैतानि न विद्यन्ते क्रियायोगी स उच्यते ॥ II.4॥

Sources: 3-4 ≈YSv(PT, p. 831): kriyāmuktimayo (*kriyāmuktir ayaṃ* YK 1.209) yogaḥ sapiṇḍisid-dhidāyakaḥ (*sapiṇḍe* YK 1.210) | yat kāromīti (*karomīti* YK 1.210) saṅkalpaṃ kāryārambhe manaḥ sadā || 5 ≈YSv(PT, p. 831): tatsāṅgācaraṇaṃ (°*saṅgā*° YK 1.210) kurvan kriyāyogarato bhavet | 6-7 = YSv(PT, p. 831): kṣamāvivekavairāgyasāntisaṅtoṣanīṣṛhāḥ | etan muktiyuto yo 'sau (*muktiyutaś cāsau* YK 1.211) kriyāyogo nigadyate | 8-9 = YSv(PT, p. 831): mātsaryaṃ mamatā māyā himsā ca madagarvitā | kāmāḥ krodho bhayaṃ lajjā lobho mohas tathā 'śuciḥ (°*śuciḥ* YK 1.212) || 10-11 = YSv(PT, p. 831): rāgadveṣau ghrṇālasyaśrāntidambhakṣamābhramāḥ (*ghṛṇālasyaṃ bhrāntir dambho 'kṣamā bhramāḥ* YK 1.213) | yasyai tāni na vidyante kriyāyogī sa ucyate ||

2 idānīm cett.] idānī N₂, atha U₂ kriyāyogasya cett.] kriyāyogas U₂ kathyate cett.] kathayate D, om. U₂ 3 kriyāmuktir cett.] kriyāmukti N₂, kriyāmuktiḥ || U₂ ayaṃ cett.] layaṃ N₂ siddhidāyakaḥ cett.] siddhidāyakaṃ U₂ 5 tat tad Mallinson em.] tattataḥ DK₁N₁N₂P, tatas tataḥ U₂, taṃ kṛtaṃ U₁, taṃ kataṃ J ākuñcanaṃ Mallinson em.] kuñcanaṃ DJK₁PN₁U₁U₂, kūrcaṇaṃ N₂ tato bhavet PU₂] ato bhava DJN₁N₂, ato ++va U₁ 6 °viveka° cett.] vivekaṃ EU₂ vairāgyaṃ cett.] vairāgya° JU₁ °niṣṛhāḥ PU₂] °niṣṛhāḥ D, °niṣṛhā EN₁N₂, °niḥṣṛhī J, °niṣṛhī U₁ 7 etad EJPU₁] etat DK₁N₁N₂U₂ yuktiyuto cett.] muktiyuto U₂ yo 'sau JK₁N₂U₁] yogi DEP₁U₂ 8 mātsaryaṃ EU₁U₂] mātsarya DJK₁N₁P himsāsā cett.] himsā ca E, himsāḥ || unm. N₁ 9 °krodhau U₁U₂] krodha° EN₁P, °krodho DJN₁N₂ śuciḥ EK₁N₂U₂] 'śuciḥ DJN₁PU₁ 10 rāgadveṣau cett.] rāgadoṣau U₁, atha dveṣo L ghrṇā° cett.] ghrṇā° N₂ bhrāṃtir dambho cett.] bhrāṃtir debho D, bhrāntitvaṃ E, bhrāṃti dambha° U₁, bhrāṃtir dabho K₁, bhrāṃtir dambhā J 'kṣamā bhramāḥ cett.] mokṣam ābhramāḥ E, kṣamā bhrasaḥ K₁, kṣami bhramāḥ JU₁ 11 yasyaitāni cett.] yathaitāni J na cett.] ca E

Notes: 6 kṣamā°: E begins here. rāga°: L starts here.

[II. Characteristics of Kriyāyoga]

Now, the characteristic of Kriyāyoga is described.^{136,137}

II.1 This yoga is liberation through [mental] action. It bestows success (*siddhi*) in one's own body. Whatever wave the mind creates at the commencement of an action, through constantly restraining that very [wave] Kriyāyoga arises.

II.2 Patience, discrimination, equanimity, peace, modesty, desirelessness: the one endowed with these means is said to be a Kriyāyogī.

II.3 Envy, selfishness, cheating, violence, expectation, intoxication and pride, lust, anger, fear, laziness, greed, error, and impurity, ...

II.4 ... attachment and aversion, disgust and laziness, error, deceit, envy and confusion: Whoever does not experience these is called a Kriyāyogī.

¹³⁶For a comparative analysis of all variations of Kriyāyoga within the texts containing complex yoga taxonomies, see p. 314 et seqq.

¹³⁷The most famous mention of the term *kriyāyoga* appears in *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* or *Yogasūtra* 2.1 where it is defined as: *tapaḥsvādhyāyeśvarapraṇidhānāni kriyāyogaḥ* || 2.1 || See **yogasutra**. According to the introduction of this *sūtra* in the *Vyāsaśāstra*, Kriyāyoga is presented as a means of how someone with a distracted mind can also attain yoga (*vyutthitacitto 'piyogayuktah*). Yoga, which for Patañjali is *samādhi*, shall be achieved by the three elements of Kriyāyoga, namely mental, moral, and physical austerity (*tapas*), repetition of *mantras* or study of sacred literature (*svādhyāya*) and surrender to god (*īśvarapraṇidhāna*). This trinity of means is supposed to destroy the impurities (*kleśas*) of *citta*. These are given in *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 2.3 as ignorance (*avidyā*), egoism (*asmitā*), attachment (*rāga*), aversion (*dveṣa*) and the urge to live (*abhiniveśa*), see **yogasutra**. The three major terms of Patañjali's Kriyāyoga are absent in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Nevertheless, the individual elements of the *kleśas*, along with the aim to reduce these in the yogi's mind, can also be found in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Nārāyaṇatīrtha in this commentary on the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* titled *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, who, like Rāmacandra uses a very similar list of fifteen yogas, presents Kriyāyoga as the first item of his list and explains its purpose as the generation of *samādhi* and the reduction of *kleśas*, cf. **yogacandrika**.

यस्यान्तःकरणे क्षमाविवेकवैराग्यशान्तिसंतोष इत्यादीनि निरंतरमुत्पाद्यन्ते स एव बहुक्रियायोगी कथ्यते। कापट्यं मायावित्वं हिंसा तृष्णा मात्सर्यं अहंकारः रोषो भयं लज्जा लोभो मोहा अशुचित्वं रागो द्वेष आलस्यं पाषण्डित्वं भ्रान्तिरिन्द्रिय-
विकारः कामः। एते यस्य मनसि प्रतिदिनं न्यूना भवन्ति स एव बहुक्रियायोगी
5 कथ्यते॥

[III. rājayogasya bhedaḥ]

इदानीं राजयोगस्य भेदाः कथ्यन्ते। के ते। एकः सिद्धकुण्डलिनीयोगः मन्त्रयोगः।

Sources: 7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 831): jñānayogaṃ pravakṣyāmi tajjñāni śivatām vrajet |

Testimonia: 3-5 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. ll. 1-2): lobhamohau aśucitvaṃ rāga-dveṣau ālasyaṃ pāṣaṇḍitvaṃ bhrāntiḥ indriyavikāraḥ kāmāḥ ete yasya pratidinam nyunā bhavanti | sa eva kriyāyogī kathyate | 7 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020 f. 2v. ll. 2-3): atha rājayogasya bhedaḥ kathyate || siddhakuṇḍaliyogaḥ mantrayogaś ceti |

1 yasyāntaḥkaraṇe cett.] va yasyāntaḥkaraṇe J kṣamā° cett.] kṣamāḥ N₁, kṣamā DN₂ vivekavairāgyaśānti cett.] 'vivekavairāgyaśānti° N₂, vivekavairāgya || śānti° DN₁K₁ °saṃ-toṣa ityādini niraṃtaram J] °santoṣa ity ādina niraṃtaram U₁, °santoṣa ity ādayo niraṃtaram U₂, °santoṣa ityādiny P, °saṃtoṣa ityādini DK₁N₁N₂, °santoṣādiny E, °santoṣa ity ādino° L utpādyante cett.] utpadyante E, °tpādyamte L, utyamte U₁ 2 bahukriyāyogī cett.] bahukriyāyogā D kathyate cett.] sa kathyate DJN₂, tkacyate U₂ kāpatyaṃ cett.] kāpayam L, yasyāntaḥkaraṇe kapatyaṃ N₁, kāpacham U₁ māyāvitvaṃ N₁N₂] māyāvitvaṃ DK₁, māyāvitam J, yāyavitvaṃ U₁, pāpātitaṃ U₂, vittam EP, vitam L mātṣaryaṃ cett.] mātṣaryam E, mātṣarya DK₁U₁, māścaryaṃ J roṣo BDK₁PLN₁] roṣaḥ EJU₁, eṣo N₂ 3 bhayaṃ cett.] kṣayaṃ E lajjā cett.] lajā U₁ lobho em.] lobhaḥ PL, lobha° cett., om. U₂ mohā cett.] mohaḥ P, moha LJN₂ aśucitvaṃ cett.] aśucitvaṃ N₂, asucitvaṃ K₁] rāgo em.] rāgaḥ P, rāga° βU₂, rāja° L, om. E dveṣa L] dveṣaḥ βPU₂, om. E ālasyaṃ cett.] om. E pāṣaṇḍitvaṃ DJK₁N₁] pākhaṃḍitvaṃ LU₁U₂, pākhaṃḍatvaṃ E, pārṣaḍitvaṃ N₂ bhrāntir em.] bhrāntiḥ cett. 3-4 indriyavikāraḥ cett.] indriyaṃ vikāraḥ P, iti vikāraḥ L 4 kāmāḥ cett.] kāma N₂, om. U₂ ete cett.] eta L, rāte U₁, etate U₂ nyūnā em.] nyunā cett., vyunā E bhavanti cett.] bhavīti N₁ 5 kathyate cett.] kathyate || cha || K₁, kathyamte U₁U₂ 7 idāniṃ rājayogasya cett.] om. U₁ bhedaḥ cett.] bheda N₂, om. U₁ kathyante cett.] kathyate N₂, om. LU₁ ke te DJK₁N₁U₁] te ke ELPU₂, kriyate N₂ siddhakuṇḍalini° EN₁] siddhakuṇḍalani° L, siddhakuṇḍani° J, siddhakuṇḍalani° DK₁N₂, siddhakuṇḍamliṃ P, siddhakuṇḍalini° U₁, siddhakuṇḍalini° U₂ °yogaḥ cett.] yogaḥ | EJ, yoga | LU₂ mantrayogaḥ cett.] om. L

Notes: 3 lobha°: IGNCA 30020 begins here.

In whose mind “patience, discrimination, equanimity, peace, contentment”, etc., are cultivated without interruption, he alone is called a Yogī of many actions (*bahukriyāyogī*).¹³⁸ Fraud, the state of being deceptive, violence, craving, envy, ego, anger, fear, shame, greed, delusion, impurity, attachment, aversion, laziness, heterodoxy, error, agitation of the senses, sexual desire: He in whose inner organ¹³⁹ these diminish from day to day, he alone is called a Yogī of many actions (*bahukriyāyogī*).

[III. Varieties of Rājayoga]

Now, varieties of Rājayoga are described. What are they? One is Siddhakuṇḍaliniyoga [and one is] Mantrayoga.¹⁴⁰

¹³⁸The term *bahukriyāyogī* (“yogī of many actions”) occurs solely in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Both the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Yogasamgraha* use only *kriyāyogī* in their discussions of Kriyāyoga. To my knowledge, *bahukriyāyogī* is otherwise unattested and thus likely a neologism coined by Rāmacandra to emphasise the multitude of negative mental fluctuations to be restrained and positive ones to be cultivated by the *kriyāyogī*.

¹³⁹In *Tattvayogabindu* LI (Ed. p. 264), Rāmacandra’s inner organ (*antahkaraṇa*) consists of mind (*manas*), intellect (*buddhi*), ego (*ahaṃkāra*), mental faculty (*citta*) and consciousness (*caitanya*).

¹⁴⁰The use of the term *siddhakuṇḍaliniyoga* instead of *siddhayoga* as listed initially is striking. Furthermore, this type of yoga, presented as the second-last item in the initial yoga taxonomy (TYB I, p. 102), is introduced as the second type right after Kriyāyoga, the first item in both the initial list and the subsequent text. That raises further questions as the term *kuṇḍalīnī* is not mentioned in the subsequent description. However, in choosing this formulation, Rāmacandra probably had in mind the ascent of the Kuṇḍalīnī through the nine *cakras* he presented (see p. 436, n. 877). The relation between Siddhakuṇḍaliniyoga and Mantrayoga appears mysterious since only witness U₂ describes a specific type of Mantrayoga. The additional passages of witness U₂, marked in greyscale, instruct the “recitation of the non-recitation” (*ajapājapa*) of the *haṃsamantra*, also called *ajapāgāyatrī*, during meditation for almost every (seven out of nine) *cakra*. All witnesses except L (L omits *mantrayoga*) preserve this reading, and the sentence following supports the reading of *mantrayoga* by dual forms. The *Tattvayogabindu* closely follows the structure of the *Yogasvarodaya*, as quoted in *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* and *Yogakarnīkā*. However, the yoga introduced there is *jñānayoga* and neither *siddhakuṇḍaliniyoga* nor *mantrayoga* are mentioned. The *saradaavalon* 25.37ab, however, provides a possible and plausible explanation: *bibharti kuṇḍalī śaktir ātmānaṃ haṃsaṃ āśritā* | “The *kuṇḍalī* Śakti abides in the *haṃsaḥ* [and] supports the [individual] Self.” See *saradatilakafull*.

अमू राजयोगौ कथ्येते । मूलमूलकन्दस्थान एका तेजोरूपा महानाडी वर्तते । इ-
यमेका नाड्य इडापिङ्गलासुषुम्णाः ॥ एतान् भेदान् प्राप्नोति । वामभागे चन्द्ररूपे-
डानाडी वर्तते । दक्षिणभागे सूर्यरूपा पिङ्गलानाडी वर्तते । मध्यमार्गेऽतिसूक्ष्मा प-
द्मिनीतन्तुसमाकारा कोटिविद्युत्समप्रभा भुक्तिमुक्तिदा शिवरूपिणी सुषुम्णा नाडी
5 प्रवर्तते । अस्या ज्ञानोत्पत्तौ सत्यां पुरुषः सर्वज्ञो भवति ॥

[IV. mūlacakram]

इदानीं सुषुम्णाया ज्ञानोत्पत्तावुपायाः कथ्यन्ते । आदौ चतुर्दलं मूलचक्रं वर्तते ।

Sources: 1-7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 831): *paṭhanāt smaraṇād vyānān maṇḍanāt brahmasādhakaḥ | tad bhedasyaikaśandhānam aṣṭaiśvāryamayo bhavet | tritirthaṃ yatra nāḍī ca tripuṇyaṃ paramaśvārī | ...eṣo 'sya viśvarūpasya rājayogo mato budhaiḥ | viśeṣaṃ kathayīṣyāmi śṛṇu caikamanāḥ sati | mūlakande sthale caikā nāḍī tejasvati parā (tejasvitāparā YK 1.246) | gudorddhe (gudordhve YK 1.247) sā tribhāgābhūd idā (tridhā bhūyād idā vāme YK 1.247) nāma śaśiprabhā | śaktirūpā mahānāḍī dhyānāt sarvārthadāyini | dakṣiṇe 'pi kulākhyeti (dakṣiṇe piṅgalākhyeti YK 1.248) puṃrūpā sūryavagrahā | madhyabhāge suṣumnākhyā brahmaviṣṇuśivātmikā | śud-dhacittena sā vijñā vidyutkoṭīsamaprabhā | bhuktimuktipradā dhyānād aṇimādiguṇapradā | suṣumnāntaḥ samāśritya navacakraṃ yathā śṛṇu | mūlādhāraṃ catuṣpatraṃ gudorddhe (gudordhve YK 1.250) varttate mahat 1-7 cf. SSP 2.26 (Ed. p. 38): *mūlakandād daṇḍalagnāṃ brahmanāḍīm śvetavarṇāṃ brahmarandhraparyantaṃ gatāṃ saṃsmaret | tanmadhye ka-malatantunibhāṃ vidyutkoṭīprabhāṃ ūrdhvagāminīm tāṃ mūrtim manasā lakṣayet | sar-vasiddhipradā bhavati | piṇḍe navacakraṇi | ādhāre brahmacakraṃ tridhāvartam bhaga-maṇḍalākāram | tatra mūlakandaḥ |**

Testimonia: 1-7 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. ll. 3-7): *mūlakandasthāne ekā tejo-mayā mahānāḍī vartate | iyaṃ idāpiṅgalasuṣumnā bhedā tridhā | vāmabhāge candrarūpā idā | dakṣiṇabhāge sūryarūpā piṅgalā | madhyamārge atisūksmā viśatāṃtusaṃmākārā koṭīvidyut-prabhā bhuktimuktipradā suṣumnā nāḍī vartate | yasyāḥ jñāne puruṣaḥ sarvajña bhavati | atas taj jñānotpattāu upāyā ucyante | gudamūlacakraṃ caturdalaṃ |*

1 amū cett.] astu E °yogau cett.] °yogaḥ E kathyete P] kathyate βEL, kathyante U₂ °kan-dasthāna em.] kandasthāne cett., °m kamdasthāne P ekā cett.] ekām J, eka N₁N₂ vartate cett.] pravartate U₂ 1-2 iyaṃ E] iyaṃ cett., trayam L 2 ekā cett.] eka | E, eka P, kā L nāḍy em.] nāḍī cett. °piṅgalā° cett.] °piṅgala° DJK₁ °suṣumṇān em.] suṣumṇān DK₁N₁N₂, °suṣumṇā EPU₂, °suṣumṇā JLU₁ etān JγU₁] ete DK₁N₁N₂ 2-3 °rūpeḍā° em.] °rupā idā° cett., °rupā U₂ 3 vartate cett.] pravarttate U₂ dakṣiṇa° cett.] dakṣiṇe JU₁ vartate cett.] pravart-tate U₂ °mārge cett.] °rge D °ti γ] ati° DK₁N₁N₂U₁, om. J 3-4 padmini cett.] padmanī LPN₁N₂, pa++nyanī K₁ 4 °kāra cett.] °kāra° P °prabhā cett.] °prabhaḥ U₁ °dā PU₂] °do° β, °pradā EL 4-5 śivarūpiṇī suṣumṇā nāḍī pravartate U₂] om. cett. 5 asyā PLU₂] °syā E, om. β jñānotpattau γ] °tpane β satyām PLU₂] satyaṃ E, sati β 7 suṣumṇāyā PU₂] suṣumṇāyāḥ DJK₁N₁N₂, suṣumṇāyām E, suṣumṇāyā° U₁, suṣumṇā° L °pattāu upāyāḥ E] °pattāu upāyāḥ DJK₁LPU₁, °pattāu upāyā U₂, °panno °pāyāḥ N₁, °panno upāyāḥ N₂ kathyante cett.] kathyate L caturdalaṃ mūla° DJK₁N₁U₂] caturdalaṃ mūlaṃ EPU₁, caturdalaṃ mūla° L, prathamacaturdalaṃ mūla N₂ vartate cett.] pravartate U₂

These two Rājayogas are described [in the following].¹⁴¹ In the location of the root-bulb¹⁴² exists one major channel in the form of light. This one channel splits up into Iḍā, Piṅgalā and Suṣumnā. On the left side is the lunar Iḍā-channel. On the right side exists the solar Piṅgalā-channel. Within the middle path, having the very subtle form equal to the fibre of a lotus stalk [and] shining like a thousand lightnings, bestowing enjoyment and liberation, [and] having the form of benevolence,¹⁴³ the central channel occurs.¹⁴⁴ When the knowledge of her has arisen, the person becomes omniscient.

[IV. Mūlacakra]

Now, the means for the genesis of gnosis Of the central channel are described. At the beginning [of the central channel] exists the four-petalled root-*cakra*.

¹⁴¹ See p. 430 et seqq. for Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and p. 378 et seqq. for Mantrayoga.

¹⁴² The *kanda* (“bulb”) in yogic literature is usually below the navel or near the perineum. Rāmacandra’s concept of the *kanda* is identical to the one found in *vivekamartanda* 16: *ūrdhvaṃ meḍhrād adho nābheḥ kandayoniḥ khagāṇḍavat | tatra nāḍyaḥ samutpannāḥ sahasrāṇi dvisaptatiḥ* || “Above the penis and below the navel is the home of the *kanda*, which is [formed] like the egg of a bird. There, the 72000 channels originate.”

¹⁴³ The expression *śivarūpiṇi suṣumṇānāḍī* derives from the source passage *suṣumnākhyā brahmaviṣṇuśivātmikā* in the *Yogasvarodaya*, where *suṣumṇā* is described as having “the nature of Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and Śiva”. Rāmacandra omits the first two and instead attributes to the *suṣumṇānāḍī* a specifically “Śiva-form”, associated with benevolence and auspiciousness, the precise meaning of which remains open to interpretation.

¹⁴⁴ The decision to adopt the reading *śivarūpiṇi suṣumṇānāḍī pravartate*, attested only in U₂, is not without problems, yet preferable for several reasons. Without it, the sentence remains syntactically incomplete and semantically opaque, and the referent of *asyā* in the following sentence is unclear — especially since *iḍā* and *piṅgalā* have already been introduced, so the omission of *suṣumṇā*, the most important of the three, would be unexpected. Although U₂ elsewhere contains additional material on the nine *cakras* — likely secondary — this case appears different, as it preserves a sentence seemingly lost very early in the rest of the tradition. This is supported by the *Yogasvarodaya* (*madhyabhāge suṣumnākhyā brahmaviṣṇuśivātmikā*) and the *Yogasamgraha* (*bhuktimuktīpradā suṣumṇā nāḍī vartate*). Stemmatic considerations likewise favour this choice, since the redactor or scribe of U₂ likely had access to an exemplar close to the γ-archetype.

प्रथममाधारचक्रम्। गुदा स्थानम्॥ रक्तवर्णम्॥ गणेशं दैवतम्॥ सिद्धिबुद्धिश-
क्तिम्॥ मुषको वाहनम्॥ कुर्मर्षिः॥ आकुञ्चनमुद्रा॥ अपानवायुः॥ ऊर्मि कला
॥ ओजस्विनी धारणा॥ चतुर्दलेषु रजःसत्त्वतमोमनांसि॥ वं शं षं सं॥ मध्यत्रि-
कोणे त्रिशिखा॥ तन्मध्ये त्रिकोणाकारं कामपीठं वर्तते। तत्पीठमध्येऽग्निशिखा-
कारैका मूर्तिर्वर्तते। तस्याः मूर्तेर्ध्यानकरणात् सकलशास्त्रकाव्यनाटकादिसकल-
वाङ्मयं विनाभ्यासेन पुरुषस्य मनोमध्ये स्फुरति। अस्य बहिरानन्दः॥ योगान-
न्दः॥ वीरानन्दः॥ उपरमानन्दः॥ अजपाजपशत्॥ ६००॥ घटि १ पलानि ४०॥

Sources: 4–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): tanmadhye svarṇapīṭhe tu trikoṇaṃ maṇḍalaṃ (*trikoṇa-maṇḍalaṃ* YK 1.251) param | tatra vahniśikhākārā mūrttiḥ sarvatra siddhidā | asyā dhyānaṃ manomadhye vinā pīṭhena (*pāṭhena* YK 1.252) vāṇmayam | sarvaśāstrāṇi saṅkarṣaṃ (*saṅkarṣa* YK 1.252) sadā sphurati yogavit | 4–6 cf. SSP 2.1 (Ed. p. 29): tatra śaktiṃ pāvākākārāṃ dhyāyet | tatraiva kāmārūpapīṭhaṃ sarvakāmaphalapradam bhavati |

Testimonia: 4–6 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. ll. 7–9): tanmadhye trikoṇākārāṃ kāmapiṭhaṃ | tatpīṭhamadhye agniśikhākārā gaṇeśamūrttir varttate | tasyā mūrter dhyā-nakaraṇāt sakalakāvyānāṭakādisakalavāṇmayam vinābhyāseṇa puruṣasya manomadhye sphurati |

Parallels: 1–7 ≈ *Nāḍicakra* (ORIS 1334 (S), ll. 180–188): om prathamam ādhārācakram guhyasthānam raktavarṇam gaṇeśadevatā siddhibuddhiśaktiḥ kūrmaṣiḥ muṣakavāhanam apānavāyu unmakala akocanamudrā mūlabandhaḥ caturdala 4 caturmātrā 4 vaṃ śaṃ śaṃ śaṃ antarmātrā 4 bahirmātrā 4 ānanda 1 yogānanda 2 virānanda 3 śrīparamānanda 4 ajapajapya ṣaṭṣatāni 600 palam 40 akṣara 40 pūjamānasikā soham bhāvena pūjayet atra gandhādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

1 prathamamādhārācakram em.] prathamamādhārācakram vartate E, prathamam ādhārācakram PLU₂, om. β gudā sthānam ELPU₂] om. β raktavarṇam ELPU₂] om. β gaṇeśam daivatam em.] gaṇeśadaivatam ELU₂, gaṇeśam daivatam P, om. β 1–2 °śaktim || muṣako vāhanam em.] °śaktimuṣakavāhanam E, °śaktir mukhako vāhanam P, °śaktimuṣako vāhanam L, °śaktiḥ muṣako vāhanam U₂, om. β 2 kurmaṣiḥ ELPU₂] om. β ākuñcana-mudrā LPU₂] ākuñcamudrā E, om. β apānavāyuh EL] apānavāyus P, apānavāyu U₂, om. β ūrmī em.] ūrmī U₂, om. β kalā ELPU₂] om. β 3 ojasvinī dhārāṇā ELPU₂] om. β caturdaleṣu rajaḥsattvatamomanāmsi ELPU₂] om. β vaṃ śaṃ śaṃ śaṃ ELPU₂] om. β 3–4 madhyatrikoṇe ELPU₂] om. β 4 triśikhā PL] triśikhā E, trirekhā U₂, om. β tanmadhye cett.] tanmadhya LN₁ °pīṭhaṃ γ] °pīṭhaṃ β 4–5 °gniśikhākārāikā E] agniśikhākārā ekā βU₂, agniśikhākārā ekā P, jñiśikhākārānakā L 5 vartate cett.] vartante K₁, asmi U₂ tasyāḥ DEK, N₁] tasyā LPN₂ U₂, tasyām J mūrter cett.] mūrtir EL, mūrtair U₁, om. U₂ °nāṭakādi° cett.] °nāṭakādi || L °sakala° cett.] om. L, °saka° N₂ 6 °vāṇmayam EPLU₂] °vāṇmayam DK, N₁ N₂ U₁, °vāmayam J sphurati cett.] sphuranti L bahirānandaḥ em.] bahir mānandā U₂ 6–7 yogānandaḥ em.] yogānandā U₂ 7 virānandaḥ em.] virānandā U₂ uparamānandaḥ em.] uparamānandā U₂

The first is the *ādhārācakra*.¹⁴⁵ The location is the anus. The color is red. The deity is Gaṇeśa. The power is success and intelligence. The mount is a rat. The Ṛṣi is Kūrma. The seal is contraction. The vital wind is Apāna. The digit is Ūrmi. The concentration is Ojasvinī. In the four petals [exist] *rajas*, *sattva*, *tamas* and the mind-faculties; [as well as] *vaṃ śaṃ ṣaṃ* and *saṃ*. A trident is [situated] in the internal triangle. In its middle is *kāmapīṭha*¹⁴⁶ in the shape of a triangle. In the middle of this seat (*pīṭha*) exists a single manifestation in the shape of a flame of fire. As a result of meditation on this manifestation, all literature, [such as] *śāstras*, poetry, drama, etc., appears in the person's mind without learning. From this [arises] external bliss, yogic bliss, heroic bliss [and] the bliss of coming to rest.¹⁴⁷ A hundredfold recitation of the non-recitation: 600. 1 *ghaṭi* [and] 40 *palas*.¹⁴⁸

¹⁴⁵This term already occurs in the tenfold *cakra*-system of the 13th c. *saṃgitaratna* 2.120ab.

¹⁴⁶This refers to one of the four *pīṭhas* of tantric Buddhism and the Kaula Yoginī-Tantra named Kāmarūpa, specifically the present-day Kāmākhyā Temple in Assam, which is identified with different parts of the yogic body in various traditions. For detailed discussions, see *liersch2026*, *rosati2020*, and *asiddhi*. The *Śārngadhara**paddhati*, *Śivayogapradīpikā*, and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (all teaching a ninefold *cakra*-system) place Kāmarūpa at the *brahmācakra*.

¹⁴⁷The 11th-century *Amanaska*, the earliest text on Rājayoga, already mentions various blisses such as *ānanda*, *paramānanda*, *sahajānanda*, and *cinmātrānanda* (*birch2013*). A similar group (*paramānanda*, *sahajānanda*, *virānanda*, *yogānanda*) is associated with the first *cakra* in the 13th-century *saṃgitaratna* (2.120cd–2.121ab). Earlier references to the “four blisses” appear in Vajrayāna sexual yoga (see *isaac2014*; *sferra2000*), and the *hevajra* (1.1.28 *et passim*) lists *ānanda*, *paramānanda*, *sahajānanda*, and *viramānanda*, the latter referring to male pleasure at ejaculation. These concepts were adopted in the *asiddhi*, which, however, contrasts sexual ritual with a celibate yoga. It states that semen (*bindu*) is the source of “the blisses whose last is Virama” (7.4) and that accomplished yogins experience three blisses without ejaculation (34.3), reflecting its ascetic orientation (*asiddhi*). Later texts, including the *Amaraughaprabodha*, which cite the *Amṛtasiddhi*, modified or removed such Buddhist sexual-yogic terminology (*birch2019*).

¹⁴⁸See p. 382 n. 721 for an explanation of the units of measurement.

[V. svādhiṣṭhānacakram]

इदानीं द्वितीयं स्वाधिष्ठानचक्रं षट्दलमुड्डीयाणपीठसंज्ञकं भवति । लिङ्गस्थानम् ॥
 पीतवर्णम् ॥ पीतप्रभा ॥ रजो गुणः ॥ ब्रह्मा देवता ॥ वैखरी वाचा ॥ सावित्री श-
 क्तिः ॥ हंसवाहनम् ॥ वरुण ऋषिः ॥ कामाग्निप्रभा ॥ स्थूलदेहः ॥ जाग्रदवस्था ॥
 5 ऋग्वेदः ॥ आचार्यलिङ्गम् ॥ ब्रह्मसलोकता मोक्षः ॥ शुद्धभूमिका तत्त्वम् ॥ गन्धो
 विषयः ॥ अपानवायुः ॥ अन्तर्मातृकाः ॥ वं भं मं यं रं लं ॥ बहिर्मातृकाः ॥ कामा ॥
 कामारव्या ॥ तेजस्विनी ॥ चेष्टिका ॥ अलसा ॥ मिथुना ॥ अजपाजपः सहस्रः ॥
 ६००० ॥ घ। १६ प। ४० ॥ तन्मध्येऽतिरक्तवर्णं तेजो वर्तते । तस्य ध्यानात्सा-
 धकोऽतिसुन्दरो भवति । युवतीनामतिवल्लभो भवति । प्रतिदिनमायुर्वर्धते ॥

Sources: 2–9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): līṅgamūle tu pīṭhābhaṃ (*raktābhaṃ* YK 1.253) svādhiṣṭhānan tu ṣaḍdalam | tanmadhye bālasūryābhaṃ mahajjyotiḥ susiddhidam | dhyānāc ca varddhate āyuh kandarapasamatām vrajet | 2–9 cf. SSP 2.2 (Ed. p. 28): dvitīyaṃ svādhiṣṭhānacakram | tanmadhye paścimābhimukhaṃ līṅgaṃ pravālāṅkurasadrśaṃ dhyāyet | tatraivodyānapīṭhaṃ jagadākaraṣaṇaṃ bhavati |

Testimonia: 2–9 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. ll. 9–11): liṅgo dvitīyaṃ ṣaḍdalam svādhiṣṭhānasamjñakam kamalam udyānapīṭhasamjñakam vartate | tatra atiraktaṃ yabhbha samjñakam tejaḥ | tasya nāt sādhaḥ atisumdarāṅgasan yuvatinām ativallabhaḥ san pratidinam āyusyābhivṛddhimān bhavati | cha |

Parallels: 2–8 ≈ *Nāḍicakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 164–179): om dvitīyaṃ svādhiṣṭhānacakram līṅgasthāne pitavarṇe rajoguṇa ākāśabrahmadevatā sāvitre śaktiḥ varuṇa ṛṣiḥ kāmāgniḥ ujāṇeyadhāraṇām sthūladeha jāgrātāvasthā vaikhari vācā rgveda ācāryaliṅga gatā bhūmikā sāyujyatā mokṣa hamsa vāhanaṣaṇmatrā 6 vaṃ bhaṃ maṃ yaṃ raṃ laṃ 6 antarmātrā 6 bahirmātrā 6 kāmā 1 kāmākṣa 2 tejasi 3 ullāsa 4 ceṣṭhitā 5 miṭhunadevatā 10 ajapājapya ṣaṣṣahasraṃ 60000 ghaṭikā 16 palam 30 akṣarā 40 pūjamānasikī proktā moham bhāvena pūjayet atra gandhādibhis samarpayet 4, 10, 4, 57, 0, 10, 11

2 idānīm cett.] idānī N₂ dvitīyaṃ cett.] dvitīye U₂ svādhiṣṭhānacakram K₁U₁] svādhiṣṭhānacakram γDJN₁, svādhinacakram N₂ ṣaḍdalam em.] ṣaḍdalam BDEK₁LPN₁JU₁U₂, ṣaḍdalam E, ṣaḍdalam N₂ udḍīyānapīṭha° U₂] upāyanapīṭha° E, udḍīyān pīṭhaṃ L, udyānapīṭha° N₁N₂, udyānapīṭha° DJK₁, udāganapīṭha° U₁ 3 guṇaḥ em.] guṇa U₂ 4 sthūladehaḥ em.] sthūladehā U₂ 5 rgvedaḥ em.] ṛg veda U₂ śuddhabhūmikā em.] śuddhabhūmikā U₂ 6 antarmātrkāḥ resp.=mallinsonem] antarmātrkā U₂ bahirmātrkāḥ Mallinson em.] bahirmātrā U₂ 7 tejasvinī em.] tejasi U₂ sahasraḥ em.] sahasra U₂ 8 'tiraktavarṇam PU₂] atiraktavarṇam βE, atiraktavarṇa° U₁N₂ tasya dhyānāt cett.] dhyānāt tasya dhyānāt J 8–9 sādhaḥ EPLU₂] sādhaḥ cett. 9 'ti° γ] ati° β yuvatinām ativallabho em.] yuvatinām ativallabho JK₁N₂, om. cett. bhavati JK₁N₂] om. cett. pratidinam γ] dinam dinam prati JN₁U₁, dinadinam prati K₁N₂, dinam prati D

[V. Svādhiṣṭhānacakra]

Now, the second is the six-petalled Svādhiṣṭhānacakra known as the seat of *Uḍḍiyāna*¹⁴⁹ The location is the penis. The colour is yellow. The shine is yellow. The quality is Rajas. The deity is Brahmā. The speech is Vaikharī. The power is Sāvitrī. The mount is the goose. The Ṛṣi is Varuṇa. The light is the fire of passion. The body is gross. The state is waking. The Veda is Ṛg. The object of veneration (*liṅga*) is the teacher. The liberation is Brahmasalokatā.¹⁵⁰ The principle is the pure state. The sense object is smell. The vital wind is Apāna. The internal syllables [are]:¹⁵¹ *vaṃ bhaṃ maṃ yaṃ raṃ laṃ*. The external mother goddesses [are]: Kāmā, Kāmākhyā, Tejasvinī, Ceṣṭikā, Alasā [and] Mithunā.¹⁵² A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 6000; 16 *ghaṭis* [and] 40 *palas*. In its middle exists an extremely red light. The adept becomes very handsome as a result of meditation on it. He becomes one whom young women desire. His lifespan increases every day.

¹⁴⁹The term *uḍḍiyāna* originally refers to one of the four *piṭhas* of tantric Buddhism and the Kaula Yoginī-Tantra, see **white1996**. According to **kowskir1988** (1988), **sandersonshaivaexe** (2007) and **urban2010** (2010), Uḍḍiyāna is probably situated in the Swat Valley in modern Pakistan. See **sandersonshaivaexe** for a detailed term discussion. Throughout the text corpus of Haṭhayoga, the *piṭhas* are repeatedly located differently in the yogic body.

¹⁵⁰The term *brahmasalokatā* might be translated as “residing in the world of Brahmā.”

¹⁵¹In all instances where U₂ provides the inner (*antar*°) syllables and outer (*bahir*°) mother goddesses, I have corrected and standardised all occurrences of °*mātrā* or °*mātrāḥ* to the appropriate word and form, which is °*mātrkāḥ*. Thanks to James Mallinson for this suggestion. The emended form, °*mātrkāḥ*, on the one hand, conveys a clearer meaning when applied to *syllables* placed on the *cakras*, while also signifying “mothers” or “mother goddesses,” precisely as presented in all cases where U₂ provides *bahirmātrkā*. In any case, U₂ yields a list of goddesses in the nominative singular feminine. Furthermore, this decision is reinforced by evidence from other texts. See for example Agastyamuni’s *rajayoga* (f. 8–9) which contains nearly identical syllable combinations that are placed on the petals of the *cakras* within its sixfold *cakra* system.

¹⁵²The worship of mothers is originally a central element of the Śākta tradition known as Kaula-Śaivism. It belongs to the Mantramārga and developed from the former Kāpālika cult. See **oberlies2012**.

[VI. nābhisthāne padmam]

तृतीयं नाभिस्थाने दशदलं पद्मं वर्तते। कपिलवर्णम्॥ विष्णुदेवता॥ लक्ष्मी श-
क्तिः॥ †आयु†ऋषिः॥ समानवायुः॥ गरुडवाहनम्॥ सूक्ष्मलिङ्गं देहः॥ स्वप्ना-
वस्था॥ मध्यमा वाक्॥ यजुर्वेदः॥ दक्षिणोऽग्निः॥ समीपता मोक्षः॥ गुरुलिङ्ग-
5 विष्णुः॥ आपस्तत्त्वम्॥ रसो विषयः॥ दशदलानि॥ दशमातृका अन्तर्मातृकाः-
॥ डं ढं णं तं थं दं धं नं पं फं॥ बहिर्मातृकाः॥ शान्तिः॥ क्षमा॥ मेधा॥ तनया॥
मेधाविनी॥ पुष्करा॥ हंसगमना॥ लक्ष्या॥ तन्मया॥ अमृता॥ अजपाजपः सह-
स्रः॥ ६०००॥ घ। १६ प। ४०॥ तन्मध्ये पञ्चकोणं चक्रं वर्तते। तन्मध्ये एका
मूर्तिर्वर्तते। तस्यास्तेजो जिह्वया कथयितुं न शक्यते।

Sources: 2-9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): *tr̥tīyaṃ nābhīdeśe tu digdalaṃ paramādbhutam | mahāmeghaprabhaṃ tat tu koṭividyutsamanvitam | kalpāntāgnisamaṃ (kalpānto 'gni° YK 1.255) jyotis tanmadhye saṃsthitam svayam |* 2-9 cf. SSP 2.3 (Ed. p. 30): *tr̥tīyaṃ nābhicakraṃ pañcāvartam sarpavat kuṇḍalākāram | tanmadhye kuṇḍalinīm śaktim bālārkaḥkoṭisannibhām dhyāyet | sā madhyā śaktiḥ sarvasiddhidā bhavati |*

Testimonia: 2-9 *Yogasamgraha* IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. ll. 11 to f. 3r. ll. 1-2: *nābhisthāne daśadalaṃ cakram | tanmadhye pañcakoṇaṃ piṭhe lakṣmī++parvatī saṃjñakaṃ guṇā sahita śiva saṃjñakā rāmaṇaṃ rūpā yasyās tejo jihvayā kathitum na śakyate*

Parallels: 2-8 ≈ *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 142-154): *om caturthaṃ maṇipūracakram nābhisthānaṃ nilavarṇaṃ ukāra sattvo guṇa viṣṇo devatāḥ lakṣmī śaktiḥ garuḍo vāhana vāyu ṛṣiḥ samānavāyuh liṅgadeha suṣuṃṇāvasthā madhyamā vācā caturveda dakṣiṇāgniḥ āgatābhūmikāḥ surūpatāmokṣa daśadala daśamātrā 10 ḍaṃ ḍhaṃ ṇaṃ taṃ thaṃ ḍaṃ dhaṃ ṇaṃ paṃ phaṃ antarmātrā 10 balirmātrā 10 kṣamā 1 medhā 2 trivratā 3 nāyā 4 medhā 5 yaścharā 6 haṃsagamanā 7 tanmayā 8 lakṣmī 9 devatā amṛtā 10 ajapājāpya śatsahasraṃ 6000 ghaṭikā 16 palaṃ 40 pūjamānasikaḥ sohaṃ bhāvena pūjayet atra gandhādī samarpayāmi namaḥ*

2 *tr̥tīyaṃ* cett.] *tr̥tīye* E, *atha tr̥tīyaṃ maṇipūracakram* U₂, *tr̥tīyacakram* N₂ *daśadalaṃ* cett.] *daśadala°* L, *daśadalakam* U₁, *om.* U₂ *padmam* E|PU₁] *°padme* L, *padma* DK₁N₁N₂, *om.* U₂ *vartate* cett.] *om.* U₂ 3 *āyu* em.] *vayu* U₂ *°liṅgaṃ dehaḥ* em.] *°liṅgadevatāha* U₂ 4 *dakṣiṇo°gniḥ* em.] *dakṣiṇāgniḥ* U₂ *saṃipatā* em.] *saṃipatā* U₂ 5 *raso* em.] *rajo* U₂ *daśamātrkā* em.] *daśamātrāḥ* U₂ *antarmātrkāḥ* em.] *antarmātrā* U₂ 6 *bahirmātrkāḥ* em.] *bahirmātrā* U₂ 7 *haṃsagamanā* em.] *ahaṃsagamanā* U₂ 7-8 *sahasraḥ* em.] *sahasra* U₂ 8 *tanmadhye pañca°* cett.] *om.* L *°koṇaṃ* cett.] *°koṇakam* J, *om.* L *vartate* cett.] *om.* L *tanmadhye* cett.] *om.* L *ekā* cett.] *om.* L 9 *mūrtir* cett.] *om.* L *vartate* cett.] *asmi* U₂ *tasyās* γ|U₁] *tasyā* DK₁N₁N₂ *kathayitum* cett.] *kathyitum* L, *kathatum* U₁, *vaktum* U₂

[VI. Lotus within the place of the navel]

The third lotus exists at the location of the navel¹⁵³ [and] has ten petals. The color is reddish. The deity is Viṣṇu. The power is Lakṣmī. The Ṛṣi is †Āyud†.¹⁵⁴ The vital wind is Samāna. The mount is Garuḍa. The body is the subtle body.¹⁵⁵ The state is sleep. The speech is Madhyamā. The Veda is Yajur[veda]. The fire is the southern [fire]. The liberation is Samīpatā. The *guruliṅga*¹⁵⁶ is Viṣṇu. The principle is water. The sense object is taste.¹⁵⁷ There are ten petals [and] ten *mātrkāḥ*. [The] internal syllables [are]: *ḍaṁ taṁ ṇaṁ taṁ thaṁ ḍaṁ dhaṁ ṇaṁ paṁ phaṁ*. The external mother goddesses [are]: Śānti, Kṣamā, Medhā, Tanayā, Medhāvinī, Puṣkarā, Haṁsagamanā, Lakṣyā, Tanmayā and Amṛtā.¹⁵⁸ A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 6000; 16 *ghaṭis* [and] 40 *palas*.¹⁵⁹¹⁶⁰ In its middle exists a *cakra* with five angles. In the middle of it is a single manifestation. It is not possible to describe the splendour of it with speech.

¹⁵³The important mention of *kuṇḍalinī* in SSP 2.3 (Ed. p. 30) and a parallel passage in *Nāḍīcakra* scroll (ORIS 1334, ll. 155–63) is discussed on p. 436.

¹⁵⁴The name *vayu* for a ṛṣi as attested in manuscript U₂ is probably a mistake. Since immediately afterwards, the associated *vāyu* is given, this should be an eyeskip. My best guess is *āyu*, the name of a sage mentioned in *ṛigveda* 2.14.7 and *geldner*1907.

¹⁵⁵I corrected *devatāha* to *dehaḥ* since a deity was mentioned before, *sūkṣmaliṅgaṁ* most likely refers to a *deha* and, as in the second *cakra* the *deha* is followed by an *avasthā*.

¹⁵⁶For the phallus of Śiva, considered as one's teacher or guide, cf. *shivapura* 1.18.31.

¹⁵⁷I emended *rajo* to *raso* since the association of water with taste is well known.

¹⁵⁸I was unable to locate parallel lists of *bahirmātrkāḥ* for the navel *cakra* in other sources, and a comprehensive search of my electronic text library yielded no occurrences. The association of deities with *cakra* petals or syllable series is, however, well attested — for instance in the *Rudrayāmala Uttaratantra* — with antecedents traceable to the *kubji*1988, albeit with differing enumerations. The pairing of *antarmātrkānyāsa* and *bahirmātrkānyāsa*, denoting the implantation of syllables within the *cakras* and their reinforcement on the outer body, is widespread and further elaborated in works such as the *Dīpikā* on the *Nityāṣoḍaśikāṇṇava* and the *Śāradātilaka*. I am grateful to Shaman Hatley for discussing this topic with me.

¹⁵⁹Thus, the prescribed duration for meditation on this *cakra* is six hours and forty minutes.

¹⁶⁰In comparison to the previous *svādhiṣṭhānacakraṁ* this *cakra* at the navel is not associated with a *guṇa*, a *dhāraṇā*, a *prabhā* and a *mudrā*.

तस्याः मूर्तेर्ध्यानकरणात्पुरुषस्य शरीरं स्थिरं भवति ॥

[VII. *hṛdayamadhye kamalam*]

चतुर्थं हृदयमध्ये द्वादशदलं कमलं वर्तते । अनाहतचक्रं हृदयस्थानम् ॥ श्वेतवर्ण-
 5 म् ॥ तमो गुणः ॥ रुद्रो देवता ॥ उमा शक्तिः ॥ हिरण्यगर्भ ऋषिः ॥ नन्दी वाहन-
 म् ॥ प्राणवायुः ॥ ज्योतिष्कलाकारणं देहम् ॥ सुषुप्तिरवस्था ॥ पश्यन्ती वाचा ॥
 सामवेदः ॥ गार्हपत्योऽग्निः ॥ शिवलिङ्गम् ॥ प्राप्तिभूमिका ॥ सरूपता मुक्तिः ॥
 द्वादशदलानि ॥ द्वादशमातृकाः ॥ कं खं गं घं ङं चं छं जं झं जं टं ठं ॥ बहि-
 र्मातृकाः ॥ रुद्राणी ॥ तेजसा ॥ तापिनी ॥ सुखदा ॥ चैतन्या ॥ शिवदा ॥ शान्तिः ॥
 उमा ॥ गौरी ॥ मातरा ॥ ज्वाला ॥ प्रज्वालिनी ॥ अजपाजपः सहस्रः ॥ ६००० ॥
 10 घ। १६ प। ४० ॥

Sources: 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): tasya (*asya* YK 1.256) dhyānāc cirāyuh syād arogo (*arogī* YK 1.256) jagatām varaḥ (*jagatāmvaraḥ* YK 1.256) | sarvapāpavinirmukto jagatkṣobhakaro (*jagan-mokṣakaro* YK 1.256) mahān | anāhatam aṣṭapīṭhaṁ (*mahāpīṭhaṁ* YK 1.257) caturthakamalam hṛdi | 1–3 cf. SSP 2.4 (Ed. p. 30): caturthaṁ hṛdayacakram aṣṭadalakamalam adhomukhaṁ tanmadhye karnikāyām liṅgākārām jyotirūpām dhyāyet | saiva haṁsakalā sarvendriyavaśyā bhavati |

Testimonia: 1–3 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. ll. 1–2): tasā dhyānakaraṇāt sād-hakasya śarīraṁ sthiraṁ bhavati | cha | hṛdayamadhye dvadaśadalaṁ ...

Parallels: 3–10 ≈ *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 97–113): om aṣṭamam anāhatacakram hṛdayasthā-
 nam śvetavarṇam tamoguṇa makāra gurudevataḥ umā śaktiḥ hiraṇyagarbha ṛṣiḥ nandī
 vāhana prāṇavāyu jyotikalākāraṇa deha suṣuptiḥ athavasthā paśyanti vācā sāmaveda gārha-
 patyāgni śivaliṅga prāpti bhūmikā sāyujyātā mokṣa dvādaśadala 12 dvādaśamātrā 12 kaṁ
 khaṁ gaṁ ghaṁ ṇaṁ caṁ chaṁ jaṁ jhaṁ ñaṁ ṭaṁ ṭhaṁ bahirmātrā 12 rudrāyaṇī 1 tejasā 2
 tāpini 3 sukhadā 4 caitanyā 5 śivā 6 śānti 7 umā 8 gauri 9 mātara 10 jvālā 11 prajvālinidevatāḥ
 12 ajapājapa ṣaḍśahasraṁ 6000 ghaṭikā 16 palaṁ 44 akṣara 40 pūjāmānasikā sohaṁ bhāvena
 pūjāyet atra gandhādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

1 tasyāḥ βEU₂] tasyā PL mūrter cett.] mūrtir L, om. U₂ puruṣasya cett.] om. P śarīraṁ
 cett.] om. P sthiraṁ cett.] om. P bhavati cett.] bhavati vā U₁, om. P 3 caturthaṁ cett.]
 caturthacakrakamalam N₂, caturthaṁ kamalam K₁ kamalam cett.] om. K₁N₂ vartate cett.]
 || vartate K₁, asti U₂, bhavati N₂ 4 nandi em.] nandi U₂ 5 jyotiṣkalākāraṇaṁ em.] jyotiḥ
 kalākāraṇaṁ U₂ deham em.] dehe U₂ paśyanti em.] paśyaṁti U₂ 6 gārhapatyogñiḥ
 em.] gārhasyatyo gñiḥ U₂ 7 dvādaśamātrkāḥ em.] dvādaśamātrā U₂ ñaṁ em.] yaṁ U₂
 7–8 bahirmātrkāḥ em.] bahir mātrā U₂ 8 śāntiḥ em.] śānti U₂ 9 mātara em.] mātara U₂
 ajapājapaḥ em.] ajapājapa° U₂ sahasraḥ em.] °sahasra U₂

As a result of meditation on this manifestation, the body of the person becomes durable.¹⁶¹

[VII. Lotus within the heart]

The fourth lotus is twelve-petalled [and] exists within the heart. The place of the Anāhatacakra¹⁶² is at the heart. The colour is white. The quality is Tamas. The deity is Rudra. The power is Umā. The Ṛṣi is Hiraṇyagarbha. The mount is Nandī. The vital wind is Prāṇa. The body is the instrument of the digit of light. The state is deep sleep. The speech is Paśyanti. The Veda is Samā[veda]. The fire is the fire of the householder. The *liṅga* is Śiva. The level is attaining.¹⁶³ The liberation is taking the same form [as the deity]. [There are] twelve petals. [The] twelve [internal] syllables [are]: *kaṃ khaṃ gaṃ ghaṃ ṇaṃ caṃ chaṃ jaṃ jhaṃ ṇaṃ ṭaṃ ṭhaṃ*. The external mother goddesses [are]: Rudrāṇī, Tejasā, Tāpinī, Sukhadā, Caitanyā, Śivadā, Śānti, Umā, Gaurī, Mātārā, Jvalā [and] Prajvālinī. A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 6000; 16 *ghaṭis* [and] 40 *palas*.

¹⁶¹The source text specifies this bodily durability as a long lifespan (*cirāyuh*) and freedom from diseases (*arogatā*).

¹⁶²The designation *aṣṭamam anāhatacakram* in the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, l. 97) for the *cakra* located in the heart — here referred to as *anāhatacakra* — is the result of a chain of scribal errors, confusions and conceptual extension. While the first two *cakras* in the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) largely correspond to witness U₂, the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) refers to the third *cakra* as *kuṇḍalinisthānam* without specifying its precise location, which is, however, indicated towards the end (l. 163) by the term *garbhapuṭam* which is the womb below the navel. The fourth *cakra* in the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) is the *Maṇipūracakra* at the navel (ll. 142–154), corresponding to the third *cakra* in U₂. The fifth *cakra* in the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) is the *Manacakra*, the description of which appears in U₂ within the account of the heart *cakra*. Subsequently, the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) identifies the heart *cakra* as the eighth (*aṣṭamam*), which, however, must be a scribal error for the original *ṣaṣṭham*, since the *Viśuddhicakra*, which follows (l. 79), is recorded as the seventh (*saptamam*), and yet another eighth *cakra* (ll. 68–69) is then listed at the site of the nose (*nāsikāsthānam*). Thereafter, three further *cakras* follow, which again correspond almost verbatim to the supplementary material preserved in U₂.

¹⁶³Cf. *yogasutra* 3.45: *prāptir āṅgulyagreṇāpi spr̥ṣati candramasam* | “Attaining is that by which one can touch the moon with the fingertips.”

अतितेजोमयत्वाद्दृष्टिगोचरं न भवति । तन्मध्येऽष्टदलमधोमुखं कमलं वर्तते । मन-
 श्चक्रे ॥ मनो देवता ॥ बहिःशक्तिः ॥ आत्मा ऋषिः ॥ हृदयमध्ये स्थितं पद्मं नालं
 तस्य दशाङ्गुलम् । कोमलं तस्य तन्नालम् । निर्मलं चाप्यधोमुखम् । कदलीपुष्पसं
 5 काशं तन्मध्ये च प्रतिष्ठितम् । मनउन्नतिः संकल्पं विकल्पात्मकमेव च । पूर्वदले
 श्वेतवर्णे यदा विश्रमते मनः धर्मकीर्तिविद्यादिसद्बुद्धिर्भवति । अग्निकोणे आरक्तवर्णे
 निद्रालस्यमायामन्दमतिर्भवति । दक्षिणे कृष्णवर्णति तदा क्रोधोत्पत्तिर्भवति । नै-
 र्ऋत्ये नीलवर्णे ममतामतिर्भवति । पश्चिमे कपिलवर्णे क्रीडाहासोत्सवोत्साहमति-
 र्भवति । वायव्ये श्यामवर्णे चिन्तोद्वेगमतिर्भवति । उत्तरे पीतवर्णे भोगश्चङ्गारमहो-
 10 दयमतिर्भवति । ज्ञानसंधानमतिर्भवति ।

Sources: 2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): sūryapatraṃ mahājyotir mahāsūkṣman tu cākṣuṣam | sūryap-
 atraṃ dvādaśadalam (sentence *om.* in YK) | tanmadhye 'ṣṭadalam padmam ūrdhvaktraṃ
 mahāprabham |

Testimonia: 2 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. ll. 2–3): ...tejomayatvāt | dṛṣṭigocaraṃ
 na bhavaty etādṛṣaṃ vartate | tanmadhye 'ṣṭadalam adhomukhaṃ kamalam ||

Parallels: 3–10 ≈ *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 114–141): om pañcamam manacakram man-
 adevatā buddhiśaktiḥ ātmārṣiḥ nābhimadhye sthitaṃ padmaṃ nālaṃ tasya daśāṅgulam
 komalaṃ tasya tat nālaṃ nirmalā cāpy adhomukhaṃ kadale puṣpaśāṅkhāṣaṃ tanmadhye
 ca pratiṣṭhataṃ pūrvadale śvetavarṇaṃ yadā maśrāmate manaḥ tadā dharmakīrtir matir
 bhavet 1 agnidale raktavarṇaṃ yadā maśramate manaḥ tadā krodhamātmanamatir bhavet
 2 dakṣiṇadale kṛṣṇavarṇaṃ yadā viśrāmate manaḥ yadā viśrāmate manaḥ tadakridham
 ātmanamatir bhavet 3 nainṛti dale nīlavarṇa yadā viśrāmate manaḥ tadā samatā matir
 bhavet 4 paścimadale kapilavarṇaṃ yadā viśrāmate manaḥ tadā ānandotmahamatir bhavet
 5 vāyavyadale śyāmavarṇaṃ yadā viśrāmate manāḥ tadā taś cātanamatir bhavet 6 uttaradale
 pītavarṇaṃ yadā viśrāmate manāḥ tadā kāmahāsyā matir bhavet 7 iśādale gauravarṇaṃ yadā
 viśrāmate manāḥ tadā kamākriyā++nabuddhi++sya ra bhavati ta sandhiḥ sandhiḥ tribdau
 bātapirtau dayaḥ atra gandhādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

2 °gocaraṃ cett.] gocaratām U₂ na cett.] *om.* J bhavati cett.] yāti U₂ 'ṣṭadalam EU₂] 'ṣṭadale P, ṣṭadalam L, aṣṭadalam β adhomukhaṃ kamalam cett.] adhomukhakamalam
 L, mukhaṃ kamalam P vartate cett.] asti U₂ 3 bahiśśaktiḥ conj.] bahiśaktiḥ U₂ ātmā
 em.] ātma° U₂ hṛdayamadhye conj.] nābhimadhye U₂ 4 daśāṅgulam em.] daśāgulaṃ
 U₂ 5 unnatiḥ em.] unnaty U₂ asaṃkalpaṃ em.] asaṃkalpa U₂ 6 °śveta em.] sveta° U₂
 viśramate em.] viśrāmate U₂ 7 nidrālasya em.] nidrā ālasya° U₂ 7–8 nairṛtye em.] nairṛtye
 U₂ 9 °śyāma em.] śāma U₂ 10 jñānasamdhāna° em.] jñānasamdhāna U₂

Because of being made of [such an] intense light, [the fourth lotus] is not in the range of sight. In its middle exists an eight-petalled lotus facing downwards.¹⁶⁴ The mind resides in the *cakra*. The deity is Manas. The power is Bahiś.¹⁶⁵ The Ṛṣi is the self. In the middle of the heart¹⁶⁶ is a lotus whose stalk is ten fingers long. Its stalk is soft. [The lotus] is pure [and] facing downwards. There is [something] resembling a banana flower established within it. The mind wants advancement, but its essence is indecision. While the mind rests on the eastern petal, which is white, a clear intellect endowed with the fame of *dharma*, knowledge, etc., arises. While in the southeast, which is reddish, a mind endowed with weakness, illusion, sleepiness, and laziness arises. While in the right south, being black, the production of anger arises. While in the southwest, which is blue, a mind of selfishness arises. While in the west, which is brown, a mind [focussed on] play, laughter, and excitement arise. While in the northwest, which is dark in colour, a mind endowed with worry and anxiety arises. While in the north, which is yellow, a mind occupied with enjoyment, sexual passion, and prosperity arises. While in the northeast, which is whitish, a mind united with gnosis arises.

¹⁶⁴For a discussion of the eight-petalled lotus within the twelve-petalled lotus in the heart, see p. 249.

¹⁶⁵*Bahiśśaktiḥ* is the external energy that permeates the external space. The conjecture is based on *kriyākrama* (Ed. p. 96) and *sakalagama* quoted with reference *siddhāntaśekhara* (Ed. p. 80): *caraṇāṅguṣṭhāyora yugmāt sañcintya suṣirāntanau | suṣirāntabahiśśaktim vyāpinim cintayet tataḥ ||* The reading attested in the parallel *Nāḍīcakra*, which developed within the same textual tradition, is *buddhiśakti*. While this cannot be entirely ruled out, given the poor quality of the transmission in the scroll, I strongly doubt that this reading is original.

¹⁶⁶I conjectured *nābhi*° to *hṛdaya*° since the context is an eight-petalled within the twelve-petalled lotus whose eight petals are discussed in U₂, cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XLVII.

तन्मध्ये प्राणवायोः स्थानमष्टदलकमलमध्ये लिङ्गाकारा कर्णिका कथ्यते । तस्याः कलिकेति संज्ञा । तत्कलिकामध्ये पद्मरागरत्नसमानवर्णाङ्गुष्ठप्रमाणैका पुत्तलिका वर्तते । तस्या जीवेति संज्ञा । तस्या बलं अथ च स्वरूपं कोटिजिह्वाभिर्वक्तुं न शक्यते । अस्या मूर्तेर्ध्यानकारणात्स्वर्गपातालाकाशमनुष्यगन्धर्वकिन्नरगुह्यकविद्या-
 5 धरलोकसंबन्धिन्याः स्त्रियः साधकस्य पुरुषस्य वश्या भवन्ति । इत्यत्र किं कथ्यते ॥

Sources: 1–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): prāṇavāyoḥ sthalaṅcāsyā liṅgākāraṇaṁ tu karṇikā | kālikākhyā karṇikeyaṁ asyā madhye tu kuṇḍali | padmavatyāḥ (*padmāvatyāḥ* YK 1.259) prabhāṅguṣṭhapramāṇā (*°prāmāṇa°* YK 1.259) ratnasannibhā | tasyā saṅgī (*tasya saṅgī* YK 1.260) jīva iti ananto balarūpataḥ | asya dhyānaṁ (*dhyānād* YK 1.260) jagadvaśyaṁ khecarīsarvago bhavet | bhavanti vaśyā devādyaś cintākarttur na (*citta°* YK 1.260) cānyathā | iṣṭāniṣṭo (*iṣṭāniṣṭa* YK 1.261) bhaved vaśyaḥ (*vaśyaṁ* YK 1.261) satyaṁ satyaṁ na saṁśayaḥ | iṣṭasiddhir bhavet tasya sarvajñādiguṇodayaḥ |

Testimonia: 1–6 = *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. ll. 3–7): ta ca prāṇavāyoḥ sthānam | aṣṭadalakamalamadhye liṅgākārā karṇikā kaliketi saṁjñikāsti tanmadhye padmarāgaratnasamānavarṇā aṅguṣṭhapramāṇā ekā puttalikā jiveti saṁjñikāsti | tasyāḥ balaṁ svarūpaṁ ca koṭijihvābhir vaktuṁ na śakyam || asyā mūrtter dhyānakaraṇāt sādhakasya svargapātāla ākāśagaṁdharvakimṇaraguhyakavidyādharastriyo vaśā bhavati | pṛthvi loke manuṣyādi striṇāṁ kākathā cha |

1 °vāyoḥ cett.] °vāyo U₁U₂ liṅgākārā cett.] om. J karṇikā cett.] karṇi D, om. J kathyate cett.] om. J tasyāḥ cett.] om. J 2 kaliketi cett.] kalikeli L, karṇiketi E, om. J saṁjñā cett.] om. L, om. J tatkalikāmadhye cett.] tataḥ kalikāmadhye N₂, madhye L, om. J °rāgaratnasamānavarṇāṅguṣṭhapramāṇaikā em.] °rāgasamānavarṇāṅguṣṭhapramāṇaikā E, °ratnasamānavarṇā aṅguṣṭhapramāṇā ekā L, °rāgaratnasamānavarṇāṁ || aṅguṣṭhapramāṇā || ekā PN₁, °rāgaratnasamānavarṇa aṅguṣṭhapramāṇā ekā N₂, °rāgaratnasamānavarṇā aṅguṣṭhapramāṇāt ekā DJU₁, °rāgaratnasamānavarṇā aṅguṣṭhapramāṇā ekā K₁ puttalikā cett.] putalim J 3 tasyā EP] tasyāḥ β, tasya LU₂ jiveti saṁjñā N₁] jiveti saṁjñāḥ N₂, jiveti saṁjñā DJK₁, jivasamjñā γ, om. L tasyā EN₂P] tasyāḥ DJK₁N₁U₁, tasya U₂ balaṁ atha ca svarūpaṁ cett.] balamadhyasvarūpaṁ E, bala sappa svarūpaṁ L, balaṁ atha svarūpaṁ P, balaṁ tasya atha svarūpaṁ U₂ koṭijihvābhir cett.] koṭijihvāyābhi LK₁ vaktuṁ cett.] ktuṁ K₁ na cett.] naiva EP 4 asyā cett.] asyāḥ DJK₁N₁U₁, tasyāḥ U₂ mūrter cett.] mūrtir LN₂ dhyānakaraṇāt cett.] dhyānaṁ karaṇāt || U₂, dhyānāt L °pātālākāśa° γ] °pātāla ākāśa° β 5 °saṁbandhinyāḥ em.] °saṁbandhinyāḥ ELPβ, saṁdadhinya U₂ striyaḥ sādhakasya puruṣasya β] striyo 'pi EPLU₂ vaśyā bhavanti cett.] vaśyo bhavati N₂, vaśyā bhavaṁti pṛthilokasambadhinyonipi striyaḥ vaśyā bhavaṁti J atra cett.] yaṁtra DK₁ kim β] om. γ 5–6 kathyate cett.] kathyate vā U₁, kathyate || cha || J

It is said that in its middle is the place of the *prāṇa*-vital wind [and] in the middle [of] the eight-petalled lotus is a central receptacle (*karnīkā*)¹⁶⁷ in the form of a *līṅga*. The technical designation of it is bud (*kalikā*).¹⁶⁸ In the middle of this bud exists a single thumb-sized [divine] figurine (*puttalikā*)¹⁶⁹ being similar to a ruby-gem in color. Her technical designation is *Jīva*.¹⁷⁰ Not even with ten million tongues is it possible to talk about her nature and her power. As a result of meditation on this form, the women of the inhabitants of the world [which are] Humans, Gandharvas, Kinnaras, Guhyakas, Vidyādhara, in the heavenly world, underworld, and open space become obedient to the will of the practising person. What [more] is here to say about this?

¹⁶⁷ Regarding the translation of *karnīkā* as “central receptacle” instead of the widespread translation “pericarp”, see reigle2012.

¹⁶⁸ A similar concept, including the usage of the term *kalikā*, is found in the chapter on creation (*sargakāṇḍa*) of the *ramatosana*. In a quotation attributed to a text called *Śāktānanda*, the *jīva* is described as having the shape of a bud of light (*pradīpakalikākāro jīvo*) and always resides in the heart: *ādau sañjāyate bijam brahmāṇḍam sahasāṅkuraḥ | tasya madhye sumeruś ca kaṅkāladaṇḍarūpadhṛk | carācarāṇām sarveṣām devādinām viśeṣataḥ | ālayaḥ savabhūtānām meror abhyantare 'pi ca | pradīpakalikākāro jīvo hṛdi sadā sthitaḥ |*

¹⁶⁹ The concept of a *puttalikā* in the heart can be traced back to the Kaula Tantras, e.g., the *śaradaavalon* 22.126–128: *puttalikāyā hṛdayaṃ sprśan prāṇā iha prāṇā jīva iha sthita iti indriyāṇi sprśan sarvendriyāṇi vānmanasacakṣuḥśrotraghṛṇeti sarvāṅgaṃ sprśan prāṇā ihāyāntu sukhaṃ ciraṃ tiṣṭhan tu iti śiraḥ sprśan svāheti japet | mantranyāsam iti |*

¹⁷⁰ The idea of the thumb-sized soul residing in the heart is already present in the oldest strata of yogic literature. See *kathaup* 6.17: *aṅguṣṭhamātraḥ puruṣo 'ntarātmā sadā janānām hṛdaye saṃniviṣṭaḥ | taṃ svāc charīrāt pravṛthen muñjād iveṣikāṃ dhairyeṇa | taṃ vidyāc chukram amṛtaṃ taṃ vidyāc chukram amṛtaṃ iti ||* Also cf. *Śvetāśvataropaniṣad* 3.13: *aṅguṣṭhamātraḥ puruṣo 'ntarātmā sadā janānām hṛdaye sanniviṣṭaḥ | hṛdā maṇiṣā manasābhikṣpto ya etad vidur amṛtās te bhavanti ||*

[VIII. *kaṇṭhasthāne kamalam*]

इदानीं पञ्चमं कमलं षोडशदलं कण्ठस्थाने वर्तते । धूम्रवर्णम् ॥ जीवो देवता ॥ अ-
विद्या शक्तिः ॥ विराट ऋषिः ॥ वायुर्वाहनम् ॥ उदानवायुः ॥ ज्वाला कला ॥ जा-
लन्धरो बन्धः ॥ महाकारणदेहः ॥ तूर्यावस्था ॥ परा वाचा ॥ अथर्वणवेदः ॥ जङ्ग-
मलिङ्गम् ॥ जीवप्राप्ता भूमिका ॥ सायुज्यता मोक्षः ॥ षोडशदलानि ॥ षोडशमा-
तृकाः अन्तर्मातृकाः ॥ अं आं इं ईं उं ऊं ऋं ॠं लृं लृं एं ऐं ॐ औं अं अं ॥
बहिर्मातृकाः ॥ विद्या ॥ अविद्या ॥ इच्छा ॥ शक्तिः ॥ ज्ञानशक्तिः ॥ शतला ॥ महावि-
द्या ॥ महामाया ॥ बुद्धिः ॥ तामसी ॥ मैत्रा ॥ कुमारी ॥ मैत्रायणी ॥ रुद्रा ॥ पुष्टा ॥
सिंहनी ॥ अजपाजपः सहस्रः ॥ १००० ॥ घ। २ प। ४६ अक्षर ४० ॥ तन्मध्ये को-
टिचन्द्रसमप्रभ एकः पुरुषो वर्तते । तस्य पुरुषस्य ध्यानकरणादसाध्यरोगा न-
श्यन्ति । एकसहस्रवर्षपर्यन्तं पुरुषो जीवति ॥

Sources: 3-12 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832) = YK: kalāpatraṃ pañcaman tu viśuddhaṃ kaṇṭhadeśataḥ | asya madhye pumān ekaḥ koṭīcandrasamaprabhaḥ | naśyanta sādhyarogā hi sahasrāyus ca cintanāt | 3-12 cf. SSP 2.5 (Ed. pp. 30-31): pañcamam kaṇṭhacakraṃ caturaṅgulam | tatra vāma idā candranāḍi | dakṣiṇe piṅgalā sūryanāḍi | tanmadhye suṣumnām dhyāyet | saiva anāhatakalā anāhataśiddhidā bhavati |

Testimonia: 3-12 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020 f. 3r. ll. 7-8): kaṇṭhasthāne pañcamam ṣoḍaśadalam viśuddhasamjñakam cakram varttate || tatra koṭīcamdraprabha ekaḥ puruṣo sti tasya puruṣasya dhyānakaraṇād asādhyarogā naśyamti || sahasravarṣam jīvati |

Parallels: 2-8 ≈ *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 79-96): om saptamam viśuddhicakraṃ kaṇṭhasthānam dhūmravarṇam jīvo devatā avidyā śaktiḥ virāṭ ṛṣi vāyu vāhana udāna vāyuh jvalā kalā jālāgni ++ vedā mahākāraṇadeha turyāvasthā parāvācā atharvanaveda jāṅgamalinga samatā bhūmikā salokatāmokṣa ṣoḍaśadala 16 ṣoḍaśamātrā am ām im im um um rm fm lm em aim om aum am aḥ antarāmātrā 16 bahirmātrā 16 vidyā 1 avidyā 2 icchā 3 kriyā 4 jñānaśaktiḥ 5 sitalā 6 mahāvidyā 7 mahāmāyā 8 buddhiḥ 9 tāmasa 10 maitra 11 maitrāyaṇī 12 kumārī 13 raudrā 14 pūrṇā 15 siṃhīni 16 ajāpājāpya sahasam 1000 ghaṭikā 2 palam 46 akṣarā 40 pūjāmānasikā soham bhāvena pūjayet atragandhyādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

3 idānim β] om. γ **kamalam** ṣoḍaśadalam kaṇṭhasthāne DJK₁N₁U₁] kamalaṣoḍaśadalam kaṇṭhasthāne N₂, kaṇṭhasthāne ṣoḍaśadalam kamalam EPL, viśuddhacakraṃ kaṇṭhasthāne U₂ °varṇam em.] °varṇe U₂ 5 °dehaḥ em.] °deha U₂ 6-7 °mātrkāḥ em.] °mātrāḥ U₂ 7 °mātrkāḥ em.] °mātrār carāḥ U₂ um em.] u U₂ 8 °mātrkāḥ em.] °mātrā U₂ śaktiḥ em.] śakti U₂ 9 tāmasi em.] tamasi U₂ puṣṭa em.] puṣṭa U₂ 10 °japaḥ sahasraḥ em.] japasahasra U₂ 11 °samaprabha em.] °samaprabhaḥ JK₁N₁N₂PU₁, °samaprabhaḥ || U₂, °samaprabhā DL, °sūryasamāna E ekaḥ puruṣo cett.] ekapuruṣo D, eka pumān U₂ puruṣasya cett.] pumṣaḥ U₂ °kāraṇād ELP] °karaṇāt cett. 12 °paryantam cett.] om. L puruṣo cett.] sa puruṣo EP jīvati cett.] jivatidānim E

[VIII. Lotus within the location of the throat]

Now, the fifth sixteen-petalled lotus exists at the location of the throat. The color is grey. The deity is Jīva. The power is ignorance. The Ṛṣi is Virāṭa. The mount is the vital wind. The vital wind is Udāna. The digit is the flame. The lock is Jālandhara. The body is the primordial cause (*mahākāraṇa*). The state is the fourth state (*tūrya*). The speech is Parā. The Veda is Atharvaṇa[veda]. The object of veneration is the movable. The level is Jīvaprāptā. The liberation is the union with the deity (*sāyujyatā*). [Associated with it are] sixteen petals [and] sixteen mother goddesses (*mātrīkas*). The internal syllables [are]: aṃ āṃ iṃ īṃ uṃ ūṃ ṛṃ ṝṃ ḷṃ ḹṃ eṃ aiṃ oṃ auṃ aṃ aṃḥ. The external mother goddesses [are]: Vidyā, Avidyā, Icchā, Śakti, Jñānaśakti, Śatalā, Mahāvidyā, Mahāmayā, Buddhi, Tāmasī, Maitrā, Kumārī, Maitrāyaṇī, Rudrā, Puṣṭā, Simhanī. A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 1000; 2 *ghaṭis*, 46 *palas*. 40 *aṅśaras*. In its middle exists the one consciousness¹⁷¹ shining like a thousand moons. As a result of meditation on this consciousness, incurable diseases vanish. The person lives up to 1001 years.

¹⁷¹The term *puruṣa* appears in the last three sentences of this section. Judging by the context, *puruṣa* in the first two sentences must be understood as “consciousness”, perhaps with the same connotations as in the Sāṃkhya-Yoga traditions. In contrast, the sentence concluding the section must refer to the person practising meditation.

[IX. ājñācakram]

इदानीं षष्ठचक्रं आज्ञानामकं वर्तते। अग्निर्देवता ॥ सुषुम्णा शक्तिः ॥ हंस ऋषिः ॥
 चैतन्यवाहनम् ॥ ज्ञानदेहः ॥ विज्ञानावस्था ॥ अनुपमवाचा ॥ सामवेदः ॥ प्रमा-
 दलिङ्गम् ॥ †अर्धमात्रा ॥ † आकाशतत्त्वम् ॥ जीवो हंसः ॥ चैतन्यलीला आरंभः
 5 ॥ द्वे मातृके ॥ हं क्षं ॥ अन्तर्मातृके ॥ बहिर्मातृके ॥ स्थितिः ॥ प्रभा ॥ अजपाज-
 पः सहस्रः ॥ १००० ॥ घ। २ प। ४६ अक्षर ४० ॥ तच्चक्रं भ्रुवोर्मध्ये द्विदलकं स्थि-
 तम्। तन्मध्येऽग्निज्वालाकारमकलं किञ्चिद्वस्तु वर्तते। न स्त्री न पुमान्। तस्य
 ध्यानकरणात्पुरुषस्य शरीरमजरामरं भवति ॥

Sources: 2–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): ājñākhyam ṣaṣṭhakam (ṣaṣṭham YK 1.264) cakram bhruvor madhye dvipatrakam | agnijvālānibham jyotiḥ puṃsaḥ strito (pūṃsastrito YK 1.264) vivarjitam | dhyānāc cāsyā sarvasiddhirajarāmaratām vrajet | 2–8 cf. SSP 2.7 (Ed. p. 31): saptamam bhrūcakram madhyamāṅguṣṭhamatram | tatra jñānanetraṃ dipāśikhākāram dhyāyet | tatra vāksiddhir bhavati |

Testimonia: 2–8 *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. ll. 8–10): bhrūvor madhye dvidalaṃ ājñācakram ṣaṣṭham | agnijvālākāram paramātmasamjñākam vastv āsti | tac ca na strīpumān | tasya dhyānakaraṇād ajarāmarah sādhamo bhavati | cha |

Parallels: 2–6 ≈ *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 58–67): om navamī ājñācakram bhrūvorsthānam pī-tavarṇam agni devatāḥ susumṇā śaktiḥ haṃsa ṛṣiḥ caitanyavāhana jñānadehī vijñānavasthā anupamā vācā suṣumṇā deva caitanyā śūnya nirārambha dvidala 2 antarmātrā haṃ caṃ bahirmātrā 2 sthiti 1 prabhāmi 2 ajapājapya ekasahasraṃ 1000 ghaṭi 9 palam 46 akāṣarā 40 pramādā liṃgam dve mātṛe ākāśatatva jīva haṃsa 4 pūjāmānasi kāmahaṃ bhāvena pūjāyet atra gandhādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

2 ṣaṣṭhacakraṃ β] ṣaṣṭham bhrūmadhye EP, ṣaṣṭhaḥ bhrūmadhye L, ṣaṣṭa bhrūmadhye U₂ ājñā cett.] ajñā DN₁N₂ nāmakaṃ DJK₁N₁U₁] nāmaka N₂, cakram EPL, cakram raktavarṇam U₂ vartate cett.] om. U₂ agniṣ em.] āgniṣ U₂ 3 jñānadehaḥ em.] jñānadehī U₂ 4 akāśa em.] ākāśa U₂ jīvo haṃsaḥ em.] jīvaḥ haṃsa U₂ °līlā ārambhaḥ em.] °līlārambhaḥ U₂ 5 mātṛke em.] mātṛa U₂ antarmātṛke em.] antar mātṛa U₂ bahirmātṛke em.] bahirmātṛa U₂ sthitiḥ em.] sthiti U₂ 5–6 ajapājapaḥ sahasraḥ em.] ajapājapasahasra U₂ 6–7 tac cakram bhruvor madhye dvidalakam sthitam β] dvidalam EPL, om. U₂ 7 °gnijvālā° E] agnijvālā° cett. karam akalam em.] °karam akalam DJK₁N₁N₂, °karakamalam γ, °karam akala U₁ kimcid vastu cett.] kimcit vastu U₁ na strī na pumān cett.] na strī pumān BEL 8 °karaṇāt cett.] °karaṇāt | U₂ śarīram ajarāmaram U₂] śarīram ajarāmaram Eβ, śarīram ajarāmaramo BLP bhavati cett.] bhavati vā U₂, bhavati ||cha|| J

Notes: 7 agnijvālākāra°: Witness B starts here.

[IX. Ājñācakra]

Now, a sixth¹⁷² *cakra* named Ājñā exists.¹⁷³ The deity is fire. The power is the central channel. The Ṛṣi is Haṃsa. The mount is consciousness. The body is knowledge. The state is insight. The speech is the incomparable. The Veda is Samā[veda]. The object of veneration is intoxication. †[It is consisting of] half a measure. †¹⁷⁴ The principle is space. The gander is the living soul. The origin is the activity of consciousness. There are two *mātrkas*. The inner syllables [are]: haṃ [and] kṣam. The external mother goddesses [are]: Sthiti [and] Prabhā. A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 1000; 2 *ghaṭis*, 46 *palas*, and 40 *akṣaras*. This two-petalled *cakra* is in the middle of the eyebrows. In its middle exists a certain object in the form of a blazing fire without parts. [It is] not female, [it is] not male. As a result of meditation on it, the body of the person becomes non-ageing and immortal.

¹⁷²Interestingly, the scroll entitled *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 68–77), which is situated in the same textual tradition as the supplementary material preserved in witness U₂, inserts — immediately prior to the *Ājñācakra* located between the eyebrows — an additional, eighth *cakra* positioned at the nose: *om aṣṭamaṃ balavāṇ cakraṃ nāsikāsthānaṃ omkāro devatā svaṣamṇā śaktiḥ virāṭ ṛṣiḥ trivarnata tridala 3 trimātrā 3 akāra ukāra makāra satvoguṇa rajoguṇa tamoguṇa brahmaviṣṇurudrah prthvī āpaḥ tejo vāyuh ākāśaḥ 5 prāṇa 'pāna vyāna dāna samāna 5 śabda sparśa rūpa rasa gandhaḥ 5 nāga kūrma kṛkala deva datta dhanañjaya 5 mano buddhi cittā antākaraṇa ahaṅkaraḥ 5 ida pingalā suṣuṃṇā.*

¹⁷³*Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.7 declares this *cakra* to be thumb-sized and calls it the eye of wisdom (*jñānanetram*) onto which the practitioner shall meditate as a flame of a lamp with the result of achieving the perfection of speech: *saptamaṃ bhrūcakraṃ madhyamāṅguṣṭhamātram | tatra jñānanetram dipaśikhākāraṃ dhyāyet | tatra vāksiddhir bhavati |*

¹⁷⁴It is hard to make sense of *ardhamātrā*. My best hunch is that an *ardha* divides something into two. It might be a synonym hinting at the two *mātrkas* that follow.

[X. cakram tālumadhye]

इदानीं सप्तमं चक्रं चतुःषष्टिदलं तालुमध्येऽमृतपूर्णं वर्तते । ललाटमण्डलम् ॥ च-
न्द्रो देवता ॥ अमृता शक्तिः ॥ परमात्मा ऋषिः ॥ अमृतवासिनीकला सप्तदशी ॥
अमृतकल्लोलनदी ॥ महाकाशा ॥ अंबिका ॥ लंबिका ॥ घण्टिका ॥ तालिका ॥ अ-
जपागायत्री देहस्वरूपम् ॥ काकमुखी ॥ नरनेत्रा ॥ गोशृङ्गा ललाटा ॥ ब्रह्मपठा ॥
हयग्रीवा ॥ मयूरमुखा ॥ हंसवदङ्गानि ॥ अजपागायत्रीस्वरूपम् ॥

Sources: 2 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 832–833): catuṣṣaṣṭhidalaṃ tālumadhye cakran tu madhyamam | cf. SSP 2.6 (Ed. p. 31): ṣaṣṭhaṃ tālucakram | tatrāmṛtadhārāpravāhaḥ |

Testimonia: 2 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. l. 10): tālumadhye catuṣṣaṣṭhidalaṃ amṛtapūrṇam

Parallels: 2–6 ≈ *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 49–52): om daśame pūrṇagiripīṭhe lalāṭamaṇḍale candro devatā amṛtā śaktiḥ paramātmā ṛṣiḥ dvāvīṃśaddalāni amṛtavāsinikalā 4 ambikā 1 lambikā 2 ghaṇṭikā 3 tālikā 4 dehasvarūpaṃ kākamukhaṃ 1 naranetraṃ 2 gośṛṅgaṃ 3 lalāṭabrahmapara 4 hayagrivā 5 mayūramuśchaṃ 6 haṃsacāritani 7 sthāna

2 saptamam cett.] saptama° J cakram catuṣṣaṣṭhidalaṃ tālumadhye β] tālumadhye catuṣṣaṣṭhidalaṃ EPU₂, tāludeśe madhye catuṣṣaṣṭhidala LB 'mṛtapūrṇam em.] amṛtapūrṇam cett., amṛtapūrṇa N₂ 4 mahākāśā em.] mahākāśa U₂ 5 lalāṭā em.] lalāṭa U₂ 6 svarūpam em.] svarūpam U₂

[X. Cakra within the palate]

Now, the seventh *cakra*, having sixty-four petals [and] being full of nectar, exists in the middle of the palate.¹⁷⁵ The Maṇḍala is the forehead.¹⁷⁶ The deity is the moon. The power is the nectar of immortality. The Ṛṣi is the supreme self. The seventeenth digit is the residence of the nectar of immortality. [It is] the river that has waves consisting of nectar of immortality. [It is] the great space. [It is] the “little mum”¹⁷⁷ [It is] the uvula. [It is] the Tālikā¹⁷⁸. [It is] the “little bell”. The unspeakable Gāyatrī is the own form of [its] body.¹⁷⁹ Crow-beaked, human-eyed¹⁸⁰, cow-horned forehead, reciting the Brahman,¹⁸¹ horse-necked, peacock-faced [and] swan-limbed is the own form of the unspeakable Gayatrī.¹⁸²

¹⁷⁵The *tālucaakra* follows the *ājñācakra* between the eyebrows, deviating from the usual ascending sequence. Rāmacandra adopts this order from the *Yogasvarodaya* (cf. table 19 in **powell2023**) but revises it in his second ninefold system in *Tattvayogabindu* XXIX (p. 190), following the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, which places the *tālucaakra* before the *ājñācakra*.

¹⁷⁶The scribe of U₂ likely altered the sentence to fit Rāmacandra's *cakra* system. The reading *lalāṭamaṇḍale* in the *Nāḍicakra* scroll (ORIS 1334) is preferable, as the *cakra* is located at the forehead rather than the palate. Rāmacandra's deviation from the expected ascending sequence may thus reflect a conflation of different interpretive traditions.

¹⁷⁷The terms *āmbikā*, *lāmbikā*, *ghaṇṭikā*, and *tālikā* may refer to the uvula. In the *jogpradīpyaka*, the haṭhayogic practice called *manthana* has two variations, see **mallinson2010**. The second type (vv. 643–653) instructs the yogin to use a metal peg (*kila dhātāmaya*) to churn, purify, and produce *amī* (= *amṛta*) at four locations: *āmbikā* (frenum), *lāmbikā* (tongue), *tālu* (palate), and *ghaṇṭikā* (uvula). These places correspond to the teats of Kāmadhenu, the “wish-fulfilling cow” (v. 651). The *Vairāṭapurāṇa* locates an *amṛtacakra* at the forehead emitting “nectar”. That is the dwelling place of the *gāyatrī*, known as Kāmadhenu, with four teats: *Ambikā*, *Lāmbikā*, *Ghaṇṭikā*, and *Tālikā*, see **kaviraj**.

¹⁷⁸The precise meaning of *tālikā* is unclear. In a private correspondence (November 2023), **mallinson2014b** suggested it might originate from *tālu*.

¹⁷⁹Tantric *mantras* are often associated with a deity and their bodies, see **haasgayatri**.

¹⁸⁰The concept of “human eyes” probably emphasises the contrast with the traditional notion of crows possessing only a single eye. Thanks to Dr. Dominic A. **haasgayatri** for this hint.

¹⁸¹Possibly the Veda or any sacred word, like i.e. the sacred syllable *om* or speculatively even the *ajapāgāyatrī* itself. However, whether the *haṃsa mantra* is considered a Vedic Brahman is unclear. I am grateful for Dr. Dominic A. **haasgayatri** suggestions regarding this passage.

¹⁸²The bird-like body of the *ajapāgāyatrī* refers to the body of a particular *haṃsa* (“swan”), ...

अधिकतरशोभायुक्तम्॥ अतिश्वेतम्॥ तन्मध्ये रक्तवर्णं घण्टिकासंज्ञा एका क-
 र्णिका वर्तते। तन्मध्ये भूमिः। तन्मध्येऽप्रकटचन्द्रकला अमृतधारास्रवन्ती वर्तते।
 तस्याः कलाया ध्यानकरणात् तस्य समीपे मरणं नायाति। निरन्तरध्यानकरणा-
 दमृतधारा स्रवति। तदा क्षयरोगपित्तज्वरहृदयदाहशिरोरोगजिह्वाजडभावा नश्य-
 5 न्ति। भक्षितं विषमपि न बाध्यते। यद्यत्र मनः स्थिरं भवति॥

Sources: 1-5 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 832-833): *piyūṣapūrṇam* (*piyūṣapūrṇa*° YK 1.266) *koṭīndusannibha-*
ham (°*sannibha*° YK 1.266) *cāmṛtasthalī* | *tanmadhye ghaṭikāsaṃjñā karṇikā raktasannibhā* |
saha cendukalā tatrāmṛtadhārām (*tāndrā*° YK 1.267) *sraṇaty asau* | *etad dhyātvāmṛtaiḥ snātvā*
sadā yogāt pramucyate | *unmādaḥ pittaḥ dāhāśūlādivedanāḥ* (°*śūnyā*° YK 1.268) | *naśyanti*
ca śīroduḥkham jādyaḥ bhāvo 'pi *naśyati* | *sadyodhyānādbhuktaviśvam jihvājādyāḥ* *ca naśyati*
 (last hemistich *om.* in YK) 1-5 cf. SSP 2.6 (Ed. p. 31): *ghaṇṭikāliṅgam mūlarandhram rājanan-*
taṃ śaṃkhiṇīvivaraṃ daśamadvāram | *tatra śūnyam dhyāyet* | *cittalayo bhavati* ||

Testimonia: 1-5 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. l. 11 to 3v. ll. 1-2): *adhikataśob-*
hayuktaṃ atīśvetam cakram | *tanmadhye raktavarṇaghaṇṭikāsaṃjñā varttate* | *tanmadhye*
prakaṭacandrakalā amṛtadhārāsraṇamti varttate | *tasyāḥ kalāyā niran-taraṃ dhyānakartum*
marāṇam kṣayarogaḥ pettajvarahṛdayadāhaśiro++++jihvājādyam *ca naśyati*

1 °*kataraśobhāyuktaṃ* K₁N₂] °*kaśobhāyuktaṃ* E, °*kataraśobhayuktaṃ* BDJLN₁PU₁, °*katara-*
prabhāmuktaṃ U₂ *atīśvetam* em.] *atīśvetam* cett. *raktavarṇam* cett.] *raktavarṇa*° K₁N₂
ghaṇṭikā° cett.] *ghaṇṭikā*° E, *ghaṭikā*° P, *ghaṇikā*° L *ekā* cett.] *ekā* *ekā* LB 2 *bhūmiḥ* cett.]
bhūmis° JU₁, *bhūmi* U₂ '°*prakaṭa*° cett.] *prakaṭa* U₁, °*mṛdrakaṭam* U₂ *amṛtadhārāsraṇamti*
 cett.] '°*mṛtadhārā* *sraṇamti* LB, '°*mṛtadhārā* *sraṇamti* PU₂, '°*mṛtadhārā* *bhavati* E *varttate* β] *om.*
 γ 3 *kalāyā* cett.] *kalāyāḥ* JK₁N₁N₂U₁, *karṇikāyā* LB *nāyati* cett.] *na yāti* LBU₂ *niran-*
tara° cett.] *niran-taraṃ* K₁ 3-4 °*dhyānakaraṇād* cett.] °*dhyānād* EP 4 *amṛtadhārā* cett.]
amṛtadhārāyāḥ *sajivo* E, *amṛtadhārā* *plāvanam* P, *amṛtadhārā* *plavanam* U₂ *sraṇamti* BLU₁] *sraṇamti*
 DK₁N₁N₂, *sraṇamti* *bhavati* J, *bhavati* EPU₂ *tadā* γ] *om.* β *kṣayarogapittaj-*
varahṛdayadāhaśīrorogajihvājādashāhā em.] *yakṣamarogapittajvarahṛdayadāhaśīroroga-*
jihvājādashāhā E, *kṣayarogapittajvarahṛdayadāhaśīrorogajihvājādashāhā* P, *kṣayarogapit-*
tajvarahṛdayadāharogajihvājādashāhā L, *kṣayarogapittajvarahṛdayadāharogajihvājā-*
dashāhā B, *kṣayarogam* *pittajvarahṛdayadāhaśīrorogajihvājādashāhā* N₁, *kṣayarogam* *pit-*
tajvarahṛdayadāhaśīrorogajihvājādashāhā N₂, *kṣayaṃ* *rogam* *pittajvarahṛdayadāhaśīro-*
rogajihvājādashāhā DK₁, *kṣayarogapittajvarahṛdayadāhaśīrorogajihvājādashāhā* JU₁,
kṣayarogoptatti || *jvara* *hṛdayadāha* || *śīroroga* || *jihvājādatā* || *dayo* U₂ 5 *bhākṣitam* N₂U₁] *bhākṣitam*
 N₁, *bhākṣitam* DJK₁, *bhākṣitam* *api* EPLU₂, *bhākṣitamār* *pi* B *viṣam* *api* β] *viṣam*
 BLU₂, *viṣan* E, *viṣa* P *bādhyate* cett.] *bādhyate* EPN₂ *yady atra* cett.] *yady atram* *api* BL,
yadyan *na* DJK₁N₂ *manah* *sthiram* EJP] *manasthiram* cett.

[It is] endowed with superabundant beauty. [It is] very bright. In its middle exists a unique central receptacle named “the little bell” (*ghaṇṭikā*)¹⁸³ being red in colour. In its centre is a site. In the middle of that exists the hidden digit of the moon, which is oozing a stream of nectar. As a result of meditation on this digit, death does not go near him. As a result of uninterrupted meditation, the stream of nectar flows. Then, the states of wasting[-disease] (*kṣayaroga*),¹⁸⁴ bilious fever (*pittajvara*),¹⁸⁵ burning sensation of the heart (*hṛdayadāha*),¹⁸⁶ head-disease (*śīrora*),¹⁸⁷ and tongue insensibility (*jihvājāḍya*)¹⁸⁸ vanish. Even ingested venom does not trouble if the mind is fixed on it.

since the *ajapāgayatrī* contains the unrecited [*a*] *ham sa* “I am that” expression. The *haṃsa* is a common metaphor for the soul wandering in the wheel of Brahman or Saṃsāra, cf. **hauschild1927** 1.6 and 3.18. The animal parts may symbolise the various physical embodiments which the *jīva* undergoes as it passes through the *brahmacakra*. The manuscript **nadicakra** (ORIS 1334) contains an illustration of the *dehasvarūpa* of *ajapāgayatrī*. The text surrounding the illustration is almost identical to the description of U₂ found here. See p. 483 for the facsimile with the illustration. Furthermore, **haasgayatri** notes that while the association between the Vedic Gāyatrī and birds was once prominent in Vedic literature, it seems to have diminished. Here, however, it has survived in the context of the *ajapāgayatrī*. Furthermore, in the *Nāḍicakra* scroll (ORIS 1334), between the description of the ninth *Ājñā-cakra* (ll. 58–67) and that of the subsequent tenth *cakra* (ll. 49–52), there appears an additional passage describing the *Suṣumṇā* (ll. 53–57): *om tejomayī nāḍī suṣumṇā madhyagāmṛtā yasyā mitaṃ idaṃ viśvaṃ proktaṃ ca putataṇḍavayogibhis tat praya 'nena jñeyā sā dehavarttinī tāṃ na jānanti ye mūḍhāḥ vṛthā te bhāravāhakāḥ tasyādidam cakraṃ dhyeyaṃ jñeyaṃ ca vijñātamaiḥ*.

¹⁸³The term *ghaṇṭikā*, meaning “little bell,” commonly denotes the uvula, see **mallinson2010** and **padoux1994**. Within the sixfold *cakra*-system of **kubji1988** 7.85, the uvula serves as a pathway for the ascent of breath, *mantra*, and self between the fifth and the sixth *cakra*: *lalanāghaṇṭike yojya pañcamam sthānam ākramet | ākramed guhyacakraṃ tu karaṇam cordhvamūlakam ||*

¹⁸⁴A fever which causes depletion in the body, cf. **ayurveda**, **ayurveda**.

¹⁸⁵A fever due to disordered bile, cf. **ibid.** **ayurveda**.

¹⁸⁶The burning sensation in the heart caused by heart disease resulting from disordered bile, cf. **ibid.** **ayurveda**.

¹⁸⁷The term refers to disorders of the head. When blood, fat, phlegm, or vata decreases, it causes severe pain, cf. **ibid.** **ayurveda**.

¹⁸⁸Stiffness or numbness of the tongue, cf. **ibid.** **ayurveda**.

[XI. aṣṭamacakram brahmarandhrasthāne]

- इदानीं अष्टमचक्रं ब्रह्मरन्ध्रस्थाने शतदलं वर्तते । गुरुदेवता ॥ चैतन्यशक्तिः ॥ वि-
राट ऋषिः ॥ सर्वोत्कृष्टसाक्षिः ॥ भूततुर्यातीतचैतन्यात्मकम् ॥ सर्ववर्णाः ॥ स-
र्वमात्राः ॥ सर्वदलानि ॥ विराट देहः ॥ स्थितावस्था ॥ प्रज्ञा वाचा ॥ सोहं वेदः ॥
5 अनुपमस्थानं ॥ अजपाजपः सहस्रः ॥ १००० घटि २ पला ४६ अक्षर ४० ॥ स-
र्वजपः संख्या ॥ २१६०० ॥ एकविंशतिसहस्राणि षड्गतानि ॥ तथैव च निशाहे व-
हते ॥ प्राणं यो जानाति स पण्डितः ॥

सकारेण बहिर्याति हकारेण विशेत् पुनः ।

हंसः सोऽहं ततो मन्त्रं जीवो जपति सर्वदा ॥ XI.1॥

Sources: 2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 833): brahmarandhre 'ṣṭamaṃ cakram śatapatraṃ mahāprabham | cf. SSP 2.8 (Ed. pp. 31–32): aṣṭamaṃ brahmarandhram nirvāṇacakraṃ sūcikāgrabhedyam |

Parallels: 2–9 ≈ *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 25–48): om ekādaśaṃ sahasradalacakraṃ mūrvnīsthānaṃ guru diptiḥ caitanyaśaktiḥ virāṭ ṛṣiḥ sarvotkr̥ṣṭasampattiḥ tayoḥ tita cai-
tanyātmakā sarvavarṇaṃ sarvamātrā sarvadā virāṭ daha sthitnyavasthā prajāvācā so haṃ
veda anupame sthāna ajapā ekasahasra 1000 ghaṭikāḥ 2 śaṃ 4 a 9, 40 so haṃsa saṃkhyā
21600 ekaviṃśati sahasraṇi śaṭśatāni tataiva ca śaśahe vahate prāṇa sa ca kalam vinaśyati
sakāreṇa bahir yāti hakāreṇa viśet punaḥ haṃ so haṃ so tato mantraṃ jīve japati sarvadā
8–9 ≈ *bäumer2013* 156: sakāreṇa bahir yāti hakāreṇa viśet punaḥ | haṃsa haṃsety amuṃ
mantraṃ jīvo japati nityaśaḥ || 8–9 ≈ *vivekamartandaold* 29: hakāreṇa bahir yāti sakāreṇa
viśaty adhaḥ | haṃsa haṃsety amuṃ mantraṃ jīvo japati sarvadā || 8–9 ≈ *yogabija* 106:
hakāreṇa bahir yāti sakāreṇa viśen marut | haṃsa haṃseti mantra 'yaṃ sarvajīva japanti
vai || 8–9 quoted with reference (*yogabije*) ≈ *yogacintamanilahore* (f. 6r): sakāreṇa bahir yāti
hakāreṇa viśen marut | haṃsa haṃseti amuṃ mantraṃ jīvo japanti sarvadā || 8–9 quoted with
reference (*yogabije*) ≈ *hathatattvakaumudi* 22.27: hakāreṇa bahir yāti sakāreṇa viśet punaḥ |
haṃsa haṃseti mantra 'yaṃ sarve jīva japanti vai || 8–9 ≈ *yogasikhopanisad* 1.130cd–131ab
(Ed. p. 416): hakāreṇa bahir yāti sakāreṇa viśet punaḥ | haṃsa haṃseti mantra 'yaṃ sarvair
jīvaiś ca japyate ||

2 aṣṭamacakraṃ brahmarandhrasthāne śatadalaṃ DJK₁N₁N₂] aṣṭamaṃ cakram brah-
maramdhrasthāne śatadalaṃ U₁, brahmarandhrasthāne 'ṣṭamaṃ śatadalaṃ cakram EPU₂,
brahmarandhrasthāne aṣṭamaṃ śatadalaṃ cakram BL 4 dehaḥ em.] deha U₂ vedaḥ em.]
veda U₂ 5 ajapājapaḥ sahasraḥ em.] ajapājapasahasra U₂ 5–6 sarvajapaḥ em.] sarvajapa°
U₂ 7 prāṇaṃ em.] prāṇaḥ U₂

[XI. Eighth cakra at the aperture of brahman]

Now, [there] exists the eighth *cakra* having one hundred petals at the location of the aperture of Brahman.¹⁸⁹ The deity is the teacher. The power is consciousness. The Ṛṣi is Virāṭa.¹⁹⁰ [It is] the witness above everything. The nature of consciousness is the state beyond the fourth state. [It has] all colours. [It has] all *mātrās*.¹⁹¹ [It has] all petals. The body is Virāṭa.¹⁹² The state is steady.¹⁹³ The speech is wisdom. The Veda is the “I am that”-[expression] (*so’ham*). The place is unsurpassed. A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 1000; 2 *ghaṭis*, 46 *palas*, 40 *akṣaras*. The count of all mutterings [per day] is 21600. In this way, it carries on day and night. He who knows the breath is a learned person.

XI.1 With the sound “sa”, he exhales. With the sound “ha”, he inhales again: “I am he, he is I”. Because of that, the embodied soul constantly utters the Mantra.^{194, 195}

¹⁸⁹The *brahmarandhra*, often termed the “aperture of Brahman,” is a tiny opening at the crown near the fontanelle. Its name originates from ancient Upaniṣadic beliefs, portraying it as a portal for the individual soul (*ātman*) to surpass bodily limitations and merge with the absolute (*brahman*).

¹⁹⁰The Ṛṣi Virāṭa was previously assigned to the fifth *cakra*.

¹⁹¹This could refer either to syllables, mother goddesses or both.

¹⁹²Due to the previously mentioned assignment of *virāṭa* to the Ṛṣi of the *cakra*, this could be an eyeskip, so that the originally intended assignment of the *deha* of the eighth *cakra* would be lost.

¹⁹³Possibly in the sense of cessation.

¹⁹⁴The exact source of this verse is unclear. Considering the possibilities presented in the parallels, it appears evident that this verse represents a mixed variant. It is likely that this verse was widespread in the yoga traditions of the time and was transmitted from text to text and orally from teacher to student, which may have led to the continual emergence of new variants.

¹⁹⁵The supplementary material in U₂ on this *cakra* terminates at this point, whereas the Nāḍīcakra scroll (ORIS 1334) transmits a slightly longer passage. Immediately following the verse, it reads (diplomatically transcribed): *ādhare liṅganabhau hr̥daya sarasi je tālamūle lalāṭe dvīpatre śoḍaśāre dvīdaśaśadale dvādaśāre catuṣkayāsānte bālamadhye ḍapha kaṭa sahite kaṇṭhadeśe svarāṇām haṃ kam tatvārthayuktaṃ sakaladalayutaṃ varṇarūpaṃ namāmi*. This passage ...

तस्य कमलस्य जालन्धरपीठ इति संज्ञा । सिद्धपुरुषस्य स्थानं । तन्मध्येऽग्निधूमा-
कारा रेखा यादृशी । तादृश्येका पुरुषस्य मूर्तिर्वर्तते । तस्या नादिर्नान्तोऽस्ति ।
तस्या मूर्तेर्ध्यानकरणात्प्रत्यक्षं निरन्तरं पुरुषस्याकाशे गमागमौ भवतः । पृथ्वी-
मध्ये स्थितस्यापि पृथ्वीबाधो न भवति । सकलं प्रत्यक्षं निरन्तरं पश्यति पृथग्भ-
वति । अतिशयेनायुर्वर्धते ॥

Sources: 1-5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 833): jālandharaṃ nāma pīṭhaṃ etat tu parikīrtitam | sid-
dhapuṃsaḥ (°puṃsa° YK 1.270) sthalaṃ jñātvā agnidhūmanibhā śikhā | ādimadhyāntahinā
stripuṃmūrtti (°mūrtir YK 1.270) varttate parā | antajñāni (antaryāmī YK 1.271) bhaved dhyānād
ākāśe 'pi samāgamaḥ | nirantaraṃ sarvavettā ity ūccāno mahān bhavet | jaganmadhye sthito
jantur jagadbādhāvivartitaḥ | 1-5 cf. SSP 2.8 (Ed. pp. 31-32): tatra dhūmaśikhākāraṃ dhyāyet
| tatra jālandharapīṭhaṃ mokṣapradam bhavati |

Testimonia: 1-5 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3v. ll. 2-5): brahmaraṃdhre śatadalaṃ
jālaṃdharapīṭhasaṃjñakaṃ siddhapuruṣasyānacakraṃ tanmadhye gñidhūmrāreṣākārā
ādimadhyāntarahitā puruṣasya mūrttir asti | tasyāḥ dhyānakartuḥ prthivyāṃ sthitāḥ api
prthvi kṛtabādhō na bhavati | trikālikajñānaṃ pratyakṣaṃ bhavati | āyurvṛddhiḥ liṃgaśarīreṇa
sarvatra pratyakṣaṃ gamāgamo bhavati |

1 kamalasya cett.] kamala° E jālandharapīṭha cett.] jālandharapīṭha° B, jātyadharapīṭha
E iti cett.] om. B saṃjñā cett.] °saṃjñā B °puruṣasya sthānam cett.] sthānam mūrti
vartate BL 1-2 'gnidhūmākārā rekhā BL] agnidhūmrākārā rekhā U₁, 'gnidhūmākārā reṣā
N₁, agnidhūmākārā reṣā DK₁, 'gnidhūmākārarekhā EP, agnidhūmrākārarekhā JN₂, 'gnid-
hūmrākārā rekhāyāḥ U₂ 2 yādṛśī cett.] yādṛśy° E, etādṛśī U₂ tādṛśy βBPL] ādṛśy E, om.
U₂ vartate cett.] vartamte K₁ tasyā γ] tasyāḥ β nādir nānto'sti cett.] nādinām 'to sti
P, nāsty aṃtaḥ ādir api nāsti DK₁N₁N₂U₁, aṃta ādir api nāsti J 3 tasyā BELP] tasyāḥ cett.
mūrter EPU₁U₂] mūrtir BDJLN₁N₂, mūrti° K₁ dhyānakaraṇāt pratyakṣaṃ nirantaraṃ
BE] dhyānakaraṇāt pratyakṣanirantaraṃ cett. puruṣasyākāśe cett.] puruṣasya ākāśe DJK₁,
puruṣasya ākāśi U₁, puruṣa ākāśe N₂, puruṣasyākāśa° U₂ °gamau cett.] °gamo JU₁, °game
K₁N₂ bhavataḥ cett.] bhavata U₂, bhavati J 3-4 prthvimadhye cett.] prthvimadhye BU₂
4 sthitasāpi γ] sthitāḥ api β prthvivādhō EL] prthvivādhō B, prthaka P, prthvivādhō ko U₂,
prthvikṣato bādhō β na bhavati cett.] bhavati P sakalaṃ pratyakṣaṃ nirantaraṃ em.]
sakalāpratyakṣaṃ nirantaraṃ β, sakalāḥ pratyakṣaṃ niraṃtara BL, sakalān pratyakṣaṃ
niraṃtaraṃ E, om. PU₂ paśyati cett.] paśyati LB, om. PU₂ 4-5 prthagbhavati E] ca
prthak bhavati BL, ca prthak ca bhavati JK₁N₁N₂U₁, ca prthak prthak bhavati D, om. PU₂
5 atīśayenāyur EP] atīśayanāyur BL, atīśayena āyur β, om. U₂ vārdhate cett.] vārdhayate
BL

“The seat of Jālandhara” is the name of its lotus.¹⁹⁶ [It is] the place of the accomplished person. In the middle of it, there is a streak that looks like the manifestation of smoke and fire, and in such a way, the unique manifestation of consciousness exists. It has no end nor a beginning. As a result of meditation on the manifestation, direct perception of both the coming and going of the soul in space arises. Affliction from the earth-element does not arise [anymore] even if one is within the earth.¹⁹⁷ One constantly sees everything directly [and] one becomes separate.¹⁹⁸ The span of life increases significantly.

constitutes a highly corrupt and partially difficult-to-reconstruct doxographical enumeration of localisations, presented in ascending order and occasionally accompanied by iconographic features such as the number of petals or phonetic elements.

¹⁹⁶For a similar concept of Jālandhara see the description of the eighth *cakra* in *saubhagya* and *ssplonavla* 2.8.

¹⁹⁷The meditation effect described here is probably an allusion to a yogic practice usually referred to in Hindi as *bhūmigaṭ samādhi*. Through a trance-like state of *samādhi*, certain yogis enable themselves to be buried underground for an extended period of time without suffering any lasting damage. See *mallinson2010* and *rootsofyoga2017* for more details on the practice and historical accounts. Biological studies have even been conducted to better understand the mechanisms of the human body that underlie this practice. See *hypo*.

¹⁹⁸Probably from the rest of matter in the sense of Sāṃkhya Yoga.

[XII. mahāśūnyacakram]

- इदानीं नवमचक्रस्य भेदाः कथ्यन्ते । तस्य महाशून्यचक्रमिति संज्ञा । तदुपर्यपरं किं मपि नास्ति । तदेव महासिद्धचक्रं कथ्यते । तस्य पूर्णगिरिपीठमिति एतादृशं नाम । तस्य महाशून्यचक्रस्य मध्ये ऊर्ध्वमुखमतिरक्तवर्णं सकलशोभास्पदं अने-
 5 ककल्याणपूर्णं सहस्रदलं एकं कमलं वर्तते यस्य परिमलो मनसो वचसो चागोचरः तस्य कमलस्य मध्ये त्रिकोणरूपैका कर्णिका वर्तते ।

Sources: 1-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 833): navaman tu mahāśūnyaṃ cakran tu tatparāt param | tad upari param kiñcin nāsti kiñcin mahāparam | mahācakram siddhacakraṃ pūrṇagaurādisaṃjñakam | tanmadhye varttate padmaṃ sahasradalam adbhutam | ūrdhvakakraṃ mahāvaktre (*mahāvakraṃ* YK 1.274) varṇasobhāpadaṃ mahat | sarvakalyāṇasampūrṇamasya tulyaṃ na vidyate | parimāṇaṃ vaktam (*vaktum* YK 1.275) asya manasā vacasā na hi | trikoṇakārṇikā tatra (*tantraṃ* YK 1.276) varttate jagad īśvari | 1-3 cf. SSP 2.9 (Ed. pp. 32): navamam ākāśacakram soḍaśadalakamalam ūrdhvamukham | tanmadhye kārṇikāyām trikūṭākārām tad ūrdhvaśaktim tām paramaśūnyāṃ dhyāyet | tatraiva pūrṇagiripīṭhaṃ sarveṣṭasiddhipradaṃ bhavati |

Testimonia: 1-3 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3v. ll. 6-9): brahmaramdhre eva śatadala-cakropari mahāśūnyacakram mahāsiddhacakraṃ pūrṇagiricakraṃ iti saṃjñakam sahasradalam cakram asti | tad upari kiñcin nāsti | tac cakram atiraktaṃ ūrdhvamukham sakalāśobhāspadam anekakalyāṇapūrṇam mano vācām agocara parimalo petaṃ | tat kamalamadhye trikoṇakārṇikā |

2° navama cett.] navamaṃ B, navamaś° U₁ bhedāḥ cett.] bheda N₂ kathyante cett.] kathyate BLN₂U₂ mahāśūnya° cett.] mahāśūnye BLN₁, om. U₂ °cakram iti BELL] cakreti β, om. U₂ samjñā cett.] om. U₂ tad upary BEP] tad upari βL, om. U₂ aparaṃ cett.] om. BLU₂ 2-3 kim api cett.] kim api β, om. U₂ 3 tasya cett.] tasya cakrasya β, madhye tasya U₂ pūrṇagiri cett.] pūrṇagire JU₁ °pīṭham BPLU₂] pīṭha E, om. cett. iti PU₂] iti samjñā BL, om. βE etādṛśaṃ cett.] etādṛśam E, ekādaśam U₂ nāma cett.] nāmaḥ U₁ 4° cakrasya madhye BELL] °cakramadhye β, °cakrasya U₂ ūrdhvamukham β] ūrdhmukham EPL, urdhvamukham U₂, ūrdhvamukhem B atiraktavarṇam β] iti raktavarṇam BEL, iti raktavarṇa° P, ativarṇam U₂ °śobhāspadam cett.] °śobhāspadam E, °śobhanāsyadam U₂ 5° pūrṇam cett.] °pūrṇa° BN₂ sahasradalam cett.] sahasradala K₁ ekaṃ cett.] eka° D, om. U₁ vartate cett.] vartato B yasya cett.] yasya kamalasya U₂ manaso vacaso E] manasā vacasā BDK₁LPN₁N₂, vacasā manasā JU₁, manasā vācā U₂ cāgocaraḥ conj.] na gocaraḥ BDJ] K₁EPN₁U₁, na gocara N₂U₂, gocaraḥ L 6° kamalasya cett.] kamala° P trikoṇārūpaikā E] trikoṇārūpā ekā cett., trikoṇārūpā eka N₁N₂

[XII. Cakra of the great void]

Now, the divisions of the ninth *cakra* are explained.^{199,200} The designation of it is “the *cakra* of the great void”. Above that, there is no other. Therefore, it is declared the “the great accomplished *cakra*”. [Another] such name is “[divine] seat of Pūrṇagiri”. In the middle of that *mahāśūnyacakra* exists a single upward-facing extremely red thousand-petalled lotus - an abode of absolute splendour full of countless blessings, whose fragrance is not in range of mind [and] speech, [and] in centre of this lotus exists one central receptacle in the shape of a triangle.

¹⁹⁹ Other texts incorporate a systems of nine places. For example **kumbhaka** 91–92, which presents a technique of *kumbhaka* for *pratyāhāra*: *navasthānāni vijñāya pratyāhāraḥ sa vedhasaḥ | pādatalaguhyānābhihṛdayoraḥkaṇṭhagaṇṭhikāḥ kramataḥ || 91 || bhrūmadhyam ca lalāṭam brahmas-thānam navaitāni | yogasiddhiḥ sarvaroganāśaḥ pratyāhṛtau bhavet || 92 ||* “Having realised the nine places, this [following description] is the withdrawal of the senses according to the creator. Holding [the breath] in the sequence of [the following places] brings about success in yoga and destruction of all diseases: soles of the feet, generative organ, navel, heart, throat, uvula, middle of the eyebrows, forehead and the crown of the head”. In the **goraksapaddhati** 2.75–76 one finds nine places as *dhyānasthānas*, “places for meditation”: *gudam meḍhram ca nābhiś ca hrtpadmaṁ ca tad ūrdhvataḥ | ghaṇṭikā lambikāsthāna bhrūmadhye ca nabhobilam || 75 || kathitāni navaitāni dhyānasthānāni yogibhiḥ | upādhitatvamuktāni kurvanty aṣṭaguṇodayam || 76 ||* “Anus and generative organ and navel, heart and [the place] above [the heart], uvula, tongue, middle of eyebrows and crown of the head. These are the nine places of meditation [taught] by the yogis, freeing one from the material world’s limitations and bestowing the eight supernatural powers.”

²⁰⁰ Similar ninefold *cakra* systems can be identified in the *Yogasvarodaya*, the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, and the *Yogakarnikā*. Yet another text that presents a similar system and most likely quoted the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* without reference but with several redactions is the *saubhagya*.

तत्कर्णिकामध्ये सप्तदशी एका निरञ्जनरूपा कला वर्तते। कोटिसूर्यसमप्रभं कला-
यास्तेजो वर्तते। परमुष्णभावो नास्ति। कोटिचन्द्रसमप्रभं शीतलं परं शीतभावो
नास्ति। अस्याः कलाया ध्यानकरणात्साधकस्य दुःखं मनसि न भवति। अत्र
स्थानेऽहं देवता ॥ सोऽहं शक्तिः ॥ आत्मा ऋषिः ॥ मोक्षमार्गः ॥ हं ब्रह्मोर्ध्वम् ॥
5 हं चक्र इति ॥ अग्निचक्रे सकारो भवति ॥ प्राणी रूढो भवेज्जीव आरोह्यवरोहति ॥
भवगुहा स्थानम् ॥ पीतवर्णम् ॥ कोटिसूर्यप्रतिकाशं तेजः ॥ सदोदितप्रभा ॥ शिवो
देवता ॥ मूलमाया शक्तिः ॥ हर आत्मालयावस्था ध्वनिस्थिरा नादात्मकोऽख-
ण्डध्वनिः ॥ अघोरा मुद्रा ॥ †मूलमाया ॥ † ॥ प्रकृतिदेहः ॥ वाङ्मनोऽगोचरः ॥
निःप्रपञ्चः ॥ निःसंशयः ॥ †निस्तरङ्गनिर्लेपलक्षं लयध्यानसमाधि ॥ †

Sources: 1-3 cf. YSv(PT, p. 833): nirañjanakalā sā tu koṭisūryasamaprabhā | koṭicandraprabhā
caiva śitoṣṇādivivarjitā | asya dhyānāt sādhakasya manoduḥkhaṃ bhaven na hi | asya dhyānāt
sādhakasya manoduḥkhaṃ bhaven na hi |

Testimonia: 1-3 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3v. ll. 10-11): tasyām karnikāyām sap-
tadaśī nirañjanarūpā koṭisūryaprabhā satī uṣṇabhava hīnā koṭicandrasamasītalakākalāstī
| tasyām ananta-paramānamtaparamānamdānam sthānam tasyāḥ kalāyā dhyānakaraṇāt
sādhako yadyādisati tatra bhavati |

Parallels: 3-9 ≈ *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 9-24): om namaḥ paramātmane pūrvapakṣam
idaṃ proktaṃ paramānandagiṇo kṛtaṃ anubhāvāt kathitaṃ śāstraṃ navacakraṃ prakirti-
taḥ om dvādaśāra brahmarandhrasthānam pītavarṇaṃ śīrasthānam sūryakoṭipratikāśam
tejasvinidīptaprabhā śivo devatā mūlamāyā śaktiḥ paramātmārṣiḥ layāvasthā dhunisthitiḥ
nādātmakaṃ śūnyamudrā mūlamāyā prakṛtiḥ deha vānmano 'gocaraḥ niṣprapañca nis-
saṃśaya nistaraṅga nirlepa 1 laya 2 lakṣa 3 samādhi 4 parambrahmasthānam mahāmantram
japet || brahmerandhe dehasuṣumṇāmārgasuṣumṇā avasthār ūrdhva prayogātma || om brah-
marandhradehasuṣumṇāmārga suṣumṇā avasthār ūrdhva prayogāt māhaṃ brahmarandheti
agnicakre sakāro bhavati ||

1 saptadaśī cett.] saptadaśireṇa LB ekā cett.] om. E °samaprabhaṃ cett.] samaprabhā
BLU₂, samaprabha P, sadṛṣaprabhaṃ U₁ 2 param EU₁U₂] paraṃ U₁, para N₂, parim cett.
uṣṇabhāvo cett.] uṣṇabhavo BLP, auṣṇabhāvo D, udbhavo E °samaprabhaṃ DN₁N₂] °
samaprabhā γ, °samam prabhaṃ U₁, om. L śītalam paraṃ BEPU₁U₂] śītalaparaṃ DN₁,
śītalapara N₂, om. L śītabhāvo BEP] bhāvo DN₁N₂U₁, śītalabhāvo U₂, om. L 3 asyāḥ cett.]
asyā N₂U₂ kalāyā N₂U₁] kalāyāḥ DN₁, kalāyā BEL, kalāyāḥ U₂, om. P °karaṇāt β] °yogāt γ
sādhakasya cett.] sādhaḥ N₂ na cett.] om. BL 4 sthāne em.] stāne U₂ brahmorvdam
em.] brahmordham U₂ 5 sakāro em.] sakaro U₂ bhavati em.] bhavati U₂ 6 śivo em.] śivo
U₂ 7-8 'khaṇḍadhvaniḥ em.] khaṇḍadhvani U₂

In the middle of that central receptacle exists the seventeenth digit in an untainted form. The splendour of the digit is shining like ten million suns, but there is no occurring of heat. Its coolness is that of ten million moons, and yet there is no occurring of coldness. As a result of meditation upon the digit, suffering does not arise in the practitioner's mind. Here, at this location the deity is "I" (*aham*). The power is the "he is I" (*so'ham*). The Ṛṣi is the self. The path is the liberation. Above Brahma[*randhra*?]²⁰¹ is *haṃ*.²⁰² *Haṃ* is in the *cakra*.²⁰³ In the *cakra* of fire²⁰⁴ is the letter "sa". The breathing becomes developed [and] the soul ascends and descends. The place is the hiding place of existence. The colour is yellow. The splendour is the shine of ten million suns. The shine always arises. The deity is Śiva. The power is primordial illusion. The state is the dissolution of the self into Hara²⁰⁵ which is the unbroken sound that is not subject to sonic change having the nature of subtle sonic matter.²⁰⁶ The seal is Aghorā. †Primordial illusion.†²⁰⁷ The body is original matter. [It is] not within the range of mind and speech. [It is] without manifestation. [It is] without doubt. †Absorption into meditation and dissolution is the goal without waves [and] without tarnish.†²⁰⁸

²⁰¹It is not clear if this *brahmordhvam* signifies Brahman, Brahmā or even the *brahmarandhra cakra*. Since the syllable "sa" is situated in the *agnicakra* this location here could point at the upper part of the body, the point up to which the *haṃ*-part of the breath ascends on inhalation.

²⁰²The syllable "*haṃ*" in this context refers to the first syllable of the word *haṃsa*.

²⁰³This particular *cakra* must refer to the current *cakra* which is described here, which appears to be the exact topmost point to which the breath ascends.

²⁰⁴Since the bodily fire in most texts of yoga is situated in the navel area, the *agnicakra* perhaps refers to the lowest point of the body the breath descends to.

²⁰⁵Epiphet of Śiva, cf. for example *hathatattvakaumudi* 25.6.

²⁰⁶The term *nāda* in Śaiva contexts can be taken as "subtle sonic matter", cf. *tantrika* 3.

²⁰⁷Possibly a dittography of the mention of *mūlamāyā* a few lines above. The point of mentioning it here is not clear to me.

²⁰⁸The meaning of the cruxed passage could not be reconstructed and translated with certainty. The translation is provisional. The compound *layadhyānasamādhi* seems to be a *dvandva*-compound of the collective unit of the three related terms. The compound could, however, also be dissolved as a *tatpuruṣa* and translated as "absorption into meditation and dissolution", which seems to provide a better sense.

तदुपरि अनन्तपरमानन्दस्य स्थानम् । तत्रोर्ध्वशक्तिः । एतादृशीसंज्ञा एका कला
वर्तते । अस्याः कलाया ध्यानकारणात् पुरुषो यदिच्छति तद्भवति । राज्यसुखभो-
गवतः स्त्रीमध्ये विलासवतः संगीतविनोदप्रेक्ष्यावतः एव पुरुषस्य प्रतिदिनं शुक्लपक्षे
चन्द्रकलावत् कला वर्धते । पुण्यपापेऽस्य शरीरस्य न स्पृशतः । निरन्तरध्यानक-
5 रणान्निजस्वरूपप्रकाशसामर्थ्यं भवति । दूरस्थमप्यर्थं समीप इव पश्यति ॥

Sources: 1-5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 833): anantaparamānandasthānam jñeyam tadūrdhvatāḥ
(*tadarddhataḥ* YK 1.278) | ūrdhvhagatakālā tatra tasya dhyānād bhaved iti | iti siddhirājaya-
gam strīnām bhogam mahāsukham | gītavādyavinodādi saśivam varddhate kṣitau | dhyā-
nam nirantarañ cāsyā puṇyapāpe sthīre (*sthīrau* YK 1.280) na hi | nijarūpasya dṛṣṭiḥ syād
dūrasvārthañ ca paśyati | 1-5 cf. SSP 2.9 (Ed p. 32): navamam ākāśacakram ṣoḍaśadalaka-
malam ūrdhvamukham | tanmadhye karṇikāyām trikūṭākārām tadūrdhvaśaktim tām para-
maśūnyām dhyāyet | tatraiva pūrṇagiripīṭham sarveṣṭasiddhipradam bhavati |

Testimonia: 2-5 ≈ *Yogasamgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 4r. ll. 1-4): rājasukhabhogavataḥ strī
vilāsavataḥ saṃgītavinodaprekṣāvato pi sādhakasya śuklapakṣasacandravat pratidinam tejaso
vapuṣaś ca vṛddiḥ puṇyapāpasya śārbhavaḥ nijasva rūpaprakāśasāmartham dūrasthapy
arthasya samīpastham iva darśanam ca bhavati | cha | tad uktaṃ tattvajñānapradipikāyām ||

Parallels: 1-5 cf. **saubhagya:** navamamākāśacakram | tatra ṣoḍaśadalapadmam ūrdhva-
mukham tanmadhyakarṇikātrikūṭākārām | tanmadhye ūrdhvaśaktiḥ | tām paśyan dhyāyet |
tatraiva pūrṇagiripīṭham sarveccḥāsiddhisādhanaṃ bhavati |

1 **ananta**° cett.] alakṣa° JU₁ **sthānam** cett.] stānam DU₂, sthānam vartate BL **tatordh-**
vaśaktiḥ EK₁N₁U₂] tatordhvaśaktiḥ P, urdhvaśaktir U₁, tatra ūrdhva śaktiḥ D, tata ūrdhva
śaktir J, tatra ūrdhva śakti N₂, rdhaśakti ardhhaśakti BL **etādṛśi** cett.] etādṛśā U₂, etādṛśa
J, etādṛśam D, ekādaśā BLP **saṃjñā** cett.] saṃjñakā JU₁ **2 asyāḥ** cett.] asyā U₁, tasyāḥ
K₁N₂ **kalāyā** cett.] kalāyāḥ K₁N₂U₂ **dhyānakāraṇāt** cett.] dhyānakāraṇā D **tad bhavati**
DK₁N₁N₂] tad bhavati ||cha|| J, tad bhavati vā U₁, om. γ **2-3 rājasukhabhogavataḥ** JN₁N₂U₁] **rājasukhabhogavataḥ** DK₁, tasya sukhahogavataḥ EPU₂, tasya kham bhogavataḥ B, ta-
sya sukham bhogavataḥ L **3 strīmadhye** cett.] śrī strīmadhye N₂ **vilāsavataḥ** cett.]
vilāsavata° U₂, vilāsavataḥ LB **°vinodaprekṣāvataḥ** DJK₁N₁U₁] °vinodaprekṣāvataḥ PN₂,
°vinodaprekṣāvata U₂, °m vinodavataḥ prekṣāvataḥ B, °vilāsavataḥ vinodaprekṣāvataḥ
E, °m prekṣāvataḥ L **eva** BP] evam cett., eka U₁ **4 °vat kalā** γ] vṛddhivato DJN₁, vṛddhi-
vata K₁, vṛddhi vanto N₂, vṛddhir U₁ **vardhate** DEPN₁U₁] vartate cett. **puṇyapāpe** cett.]
puṇyapāpau U₁, om. P °sya E] om. P, asya cett. **śarīrasya** BL] śarīrena β, śarīram EU₂,
om. P **na** BELU₂] om. βP °śataḥ cett.] sprṣāt U₁ **4-5 nirantaradhyānakāraṇān** em.]
nirantaradhyānakāraṇāt Eβ, nirantaram dhyānakāraṇāt BL, evam puruṣasya pratidinam
nirantaram dhyānakāraṇāt U₂, om. P **5 °prakāśa**° cett.] °m prakāśana° EU₂ **°stham apy**
artham DJK₁U₁] °stham api padārtham BP, °stham api parārtham L, °sthoپی ca dūrasthavastu
E, °stham api N₁N₂, °stham api bhavati || dūrastham api padārtham U₂ **samīpa** cett.] samī-
pam JN₁U₁, samīpam N₂ **iva** cett.] eva JU₁

Above that is the place of infinite supreme bliss. In that [place], there exists the upper power (*ūrdhvaśakti*)²⁰⁹ as a unique digit which has such a designation. As a result of meditation on this digit, whatever the person wants arises. Even though [one is] enjoying royal pleasures, amusing oneself amongst women and watching musical performances, the person's digit grows daily like the digit of the moon in the bright half of the month. His body is not affected by merit and sin. As a result of uninterrupted meditation [onto this digit], the ability to illuminate one's own nature arises. He sees even remote objects as if they were near.²¹⁰

²⁰⁹Examining the primary source for the composition of Rāmacandra's account of the ninth *cakra*, found in the *Yogasvarodaya* (cf. sources), one might infer that the term *ūrdhvaśakti* is a corruption of the term *tadūrdhvataḥ*. However, the term and concept are validated by its occurrence in *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.9 (cf. sources), which Rāmacandra must have consulted as well. The association of *ūrdhvaśakti* with a *kalā* is likely an innovation by Rāmacandra, as the *ūrdhvaśakti* of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* is not explicitly identified as a *kalā*. Moreover, the *kalā* mentioned in the YSv is not designated as a *śakti*. Rāmacandra, therefore, amalgamates assertions from both sources in his interpretation.

²¹⁰The final testimony from *Yogasamgraha* IGNC 30020 references its source as *Tattvajñānapradīpikā* (cf. testimonia). After that, the manuscript paraphrases and quotes other yoga texts such as the *Uttaragītā*.

[XIII. lakṣyayogaḥ]

इदानीं सुखसाध्यो लक्ष्ययोगः कथ्यते। अस्य लक्ष्ययोगस्य पञ्चभेदा भवन्ति। १
ऊर्ध्वलक्ष्यम्। २ अधोलक्ष्यम्। ३ बाह्यलक्ष्यम्। ४ मध्यलक्ष्यम्। ५ अन्तरलक्ष्य-
म्॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 833): sukhasādhyam lakṣayogam idānīm śṛṇu pārvati | pañ-
cadhā lakṣayogaś ca ūrddhalakṣādibhedataḥ (*ūrdhva* YK 2.1) || ūrddhalakṣam (*ūrdhva* YK 2.2)
adholakṣo (*lakṣam* YK 2.2) bāhyalakṣam (*vāhya*° YK 2.2) tathaiva ca | madhyalakṣas (*lakṣam*
YK 2.2) tathā jñeyam antarlakṣas (*lakṣam* YK 2.2) tathaiva ca |

Testimonia: 2–4 cf. hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244, f.124r ll. 7–9): atha rā-
jayogāṃgasukhasādhyo lakṣyayogaḥ kathyate || lakṣayogasya pañcabhedāḥ bhavati | parā
ūrdhvalakṣyāḥ bāhyalakṣyāḥ madhyalakṣyāḥ antarlakṣyāḥ ceti |

2 °sādhyo cett.] °sādhyā N₂, °sādho PB, °sādhe L, °sādhyopa° U₁ lakṣyayogaḥ cett.] lakṣayo-
gaḥ BL, °lakṣayogaḥ U₁, lakṣanayogaḥ N₂ asya γ] om. β lakṣya° cett.] lakṣa° BLU₂, alakṣa°
JU₁, lakṣana° N₂ pañcabhedā cett.] pañce bhedaḥ B, pañcabhedāḥ L bhavanti cett.]
bhavaṃti B, bhavati N₂U₁, bhaṃvaṃti K₁ 3 ūrdhvalakṣyam EP] ūrdhvalakṣam BLN₂, ūrd-
hvalakṣya DK₁JN₁, ūrdhvalakṣa N₂U₁ °lakṣyam EP] °lakṣam BLU₂, °lakṣya DJK₁N₁, °lakṣa N₂,
om. U₁ bāhyalakṣyam U₂] bāhyalakṣya DJK₁N₁, bāhyalakṣa N₂, bāhyalakṣya U₁, bāhyakṣam
B, lakṣyam E, madhyalakṣyam P, madhyalakṣam L madhyalakṣyam em.] madhyalakṣya
DJK₁N₁, madhyalakṣa N₂U₁, madhyalakṣam U₂, bāhyalakṣyam EP, bāhyakṣam L, om. B
3–4 antarlakṣyam EP] antarlakṣya DJK₁N₁U₁, aṃtaralakṣam BL, antarlakṣa N₂, sar-
valakṣyam U₂

[XIII. Lakṣyayoga]

Now, Lakṣyayoga (“Yoga of foci”),²¹¹ which is easily accomplished,²¹² is explained. There are five subdivisions of this Lakṣyayoga: 1. The upper focus (*ūrdhvalakṣya*), 2. The lower focus (*adholakṣya*), 3. The outer focus (*bāhyalakṣya*), 4. The middle focus (*madhyalakṣya*), 5. The inner focus (*antaralakṣya*).^{213, 214, 215}

²¹¹The original reading of the yoga is likely *lakṣyayoga* since it crosses the stemma of the β - and γ -group. This reading is supported by the usage in the *ssplonavla* 2.26–32 and *yogacandrika* (Ed. p. 2). However, *ramatosana* (Ed. pp. 833–834) and *yogakarnika* (Ed. pp. 23–24) as well as *sarvaṅgayoga* (Ed. pp. 104–105) use the term *lakṣayoga*, indicating that both designations were common. See p. 386 for a detailed discussion of Lakṣyayoga.

²¹²The emphasis on the easiness of Lakṣ(y)ayoga is not just shared with the *Yogasvarodaya* but also with Sundardās’s *sarvaṅgayoga* 3.25a: *lakṣayoga hai sugam upāi* |

²¹³In most other texts it is called *antarlakṣya*, but the *Tattvayogabindu* reads *antaralakṣya* throughout its manuscripts. This is confirmed by the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* (cf. sources).

²¹⁴The practices of Lakṣ(y)ayoga in Sundardās’s *sarvaṅgayoga* 3.35–36 (Ed. pp. 104–105) are basically identical except presented in a different order and subsumed under the category of Haṭhayoga. The *ssplonavla*, one of Rāmacandra’s central sources, particularly for the second half of his text, describes three almost identical *lakṣyas* in 2.26–31: *antarlakṣya*, *bahirlakṣya* and *madhyamaṃ lakṣyaṃ*.

²¹⁵Nārāyaṇatīrtha, in his *yogacandrika* does not mention any of the five categories within his descriptions of Lakṣyayoga. Here, Lakṣyayoga is connected to *Yogasūtra* 1.35. Lakṣyayoga directs the mind onto a specific focus, like the tip of the nose, etc., to stop the mind’s activity, cf. *yogacandrika*, Ed. p. 54.

[XIV. ūrdhvalakṣyam]

प्रथममूर्ध्वलक्ष्यं कथ्यते। आकाशमध्ये दृष्टिः। अथ च मन ऊर्ध्वं कृत्वा स्थाप्यते।
 एतस्य लक्ष्यस्य दृढीकरणात्परमेश्वरस्य तेजसा सह दृष्टैरेक्यं भवति। अथ चाका-
 शमध्ये यः कश्चिद्दृष्टः पदार्थो भवति। स साधकस्य दृष्टिगोचरे भवति। अयमेवो-
 5 र्ध्वलक्ष्यः ॥

Sources: 2-5 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 834): lakṣaṇaṁ śrṇu caiṣāṁ hi phalaṁ jñātvā maheśvari | ākāśe dr̥ṣṭim āsthāya mana ūrddhan tu kārayet | ūrdhalakṣaṁ (ūrdhva° YK 2.4) bhaved eṣā parameśasya caikatā |

Testimonia: 2-5 cf. *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f.124r l. 9 to f. 124v l. 2): tatra prathamam ūrdhvalakṣyaṁ nirūpyate ākāśamādhye dr̥ṣṭiḥ athavā mana ūrdhvaṁ kṛtvā sthāpyate tasya lakṣyadr̥ḍhikaraṇāt prathamam tamo jyotir nakṣatreṁdrādinām darśanaṁ tato 'bhyāsad ārdhye manasthairye krameṇa parameśvarasya tejasā sahadṛṣṭher aikyaṁ bhavati ākāśamādhye yaḥ kaścid dr̥ṣṭhaḥ padārtho bhavati sa sādhkasya dr̥ṣṭhigocaro bhavati || ayam ūrdhvalakṣyayogaparakārah

2 prathamam EP] prathamam βU₂, atha L, athama B ūrdhvalakṣyaṁ E] ūrdhvalakṣyaḥ P, urdhvalakṣya U₁, ūrdhvalakṣam L, urdhvalakṣam U₂, urdhvalakṣaḥ DJK₁N₁N₂, urdhalakṣam B kathyate cett.] om. BL ākāśamādhye cett.] om. P dr̥ṣṭiḥ cett.] dr̥ṣṭi B, om. P atha ca PN₁N₂U₁] atha vā BDJK₁L, atha U₂, kadā ca E mana ūrdhvaṁ EJP₁N₂] mana ūrdham DK₁, mana urdhvaṁ N₁U₂, manerddhvaṁ U₁, ūrdhvamāna B, ūrdhvaṁ mana L sthāpyate cett.] sthāpayati E 3 lakṣyasya EPN₁] lakṣasya cett., lakṣaṇasya N₂ dr̥ḍhikaraṇāt cett.] dr̥ḍhikaraṇāt EP, dr̥ḍhikṛtvā BL tejasā cett.] tenasā U₂, teja° BL dr̥ṣṭer aikyaṁ EPJU₁U₂] dr̥ṣṭeh aikyaṁ DK₁N₁, dr̥ṣṭeh ekam N₂, dr̥ṣṭair aikā BL atha cett.] atha B 3-4 cākāśa° EPBU₂] ca ākāśa° DJK₁N₁U₁, vākāśa° L, ākāśa° N₂ 4 kaścid adr̥ṣṭaḥ EPN₁U₁] kaścit adr̥ṣṭaḥ DK₁J, kaccit dr̥ṣṭaḥ B, kaccit dr̥ṣṭaḥ B, kaścita adr̥ṣṭaḥ N₂, kaścid dr̥ṣṭa° U₂ padārtho cett.] padārthe K₁N₁, padārtha N₂ sa cett.] om. BLN₂U₂ dr̥ṣṭigocare DK₁N₁U₂] dr̥ṣṭigocaro cett., dr̥ṣṭigocarā N₂ bhavati cett.] bhavati B ayam cett.] atham J 4-5 evordhvalakṣyaḥ DEPU₁] evordhvalakṣaḥ L, evordhalakṣaḥ B, evordhvalakṣya N₁U₂, eva vodhalakṣaṇam N₂

[XIV. The upper focus]

At first, the upper focus is explained. The gaze is on the centre of the sky.²¹⁶ And then, having directed the mind upwards, it is fixed [there]. As a result of stabilising this focus, unity of the gaze with the splendour of the highest lord arises. And then, some object that has not been seen before arises in the centre of the sky. That [object] arises in the range of sight of the practitioner. This alone is the upper focus.^{217,218}

²¹⁶ This could be the Zenith. See [petersburger3](#).

²¹⁷ Sundardās shares the concept of *ūrdhvalakṣ(y)a* as fixing the gaze in the sky in his *sarvangayoga* 3.27: *ūrdhva lakṣa karai ihim bhāmti | duṣṭyākāśa rahai dina rāti | bibidha prakāra hoi ujjyārā | gopi padāratha disahim sārā ||*

²¹⁸ A similar practice is presented in [bäumer2013](#) 84: *ākāśaṃ vimalam paśyan kṛtvā dṛṣṭim nirantarām | stabdhātmā tatkṣaṇād devi bhairavaṃ vapur āpnuyāt ||* Although the term *lakṣya* is not used, the central elements of the practice are found here: the gaze is constantly fixed on the sky, establishing a connection with the divine. See also [mallinson2007](#) 5.30–31.

[XV. adholakṣyaḥ]

- अथाधोलक्ष्यः । नासिकाया उपरि द्वादशाङ्गुलपर्यन्तं दृष्टिः स्थिरा कर्तव्या । अथवा नासिकाया अग्रे दृष्टिः स्थिरा कर्तव्या । लक्ष्यद्वयस्य दृढीकरणादृष्टिः स्थिरा भवति । पवनः स्थिरो भवति । आयुर्वर्धते ॥ एतद्वयमेव बाह्यलक्ष्यमपि कथ्यते । बाह्याभ्य-
 5 न्तरमाकाशवत् शून्यलक्ष्यः कर्तव्यः । जाग्रदशायां चलनदशायां भोजनदशायां स्थितिकाले सर्वस्थाने शून्यस्य ध्यानकारणात् मरणत्रासो न भवति ॥

Sources: 2–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 834): nāsikopari deveśi dvādaśāṅgulamānataḥ | dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā (dṛṣṭisthiran YK 2.5) tu karttavayā (karttavayam YK 2.5) adholakṣam idam bhaja (bhajet YK 2.5) | athavā (tathā ca YK 2.5) nāsikāgre tu sthirā dṛṣṭir iyaṁ bhavet (śrṇu YK 2.5) | sthirā dṛṣṭiś cirāyuh syāt tathāsau (yasya bhavet sthirā dṛṣṭiś cirāyuh YK 2.6) sthiraḍṛṣṭimān | : bāhyalakṣam svayam jñeyam yāti tattvanivāsinām (°nirāsinām YK 2.6) | kāminām tu bahir dṛṣṭiś cintādiṣu susiddhidā | etad bāhyamadhyalakṣam iṣṭacintā nirākulam (dṛṣṭicintānirākulaḥ YK 2.7) | antar-lakṣam śrṇu śukradigvidigādivarjitam (subhru° YK 2.8) | (bāhyabhyantara ākāśam vādhāmantram param matam YK 2.8cd) | calaj jāgratsusupteṣu bhojaneṣu ca sarvadā | sarvāvasthāsu deveśi cittam śūnye niyojayet | karttā kārayitā śūnyaḥ (śūnyam YK 2.10) mūrttimān śūnya īśvaraḥ | harṣaśokaghaṭastho 'yaṁ janmamṛtyū labhet svayam |

Testimonia: 2–6 ≈hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244, f. 124v ll. 2–4): atha adholakṣayogaḥ nāsikāyā upari dvādaśāṅgulaparyamta dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā kartavyā athavā nāsikāyā agre dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā kartavyā lakṣyadvayasya dṛḍhikaraṇād dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā bhavati pavano pi sthiro bhavati jito bhuvati pavanasthairya mano pi sthiram śāmtam bhavati lakṣadvayadṛḍhikaraṇād āyurvṛddhir bhavati | satyam ūrdhvalakṣyavad vāhyalakṣam api kathyate bāhyo abhyāmtare ākāśavat chonyalakṣaḥ kartavyaḥ jāgrad daśāyām calanadaśāyām ca bhojadaśāyām sthitikāle sarvasthāne śūnyadhyānakaraṇān maraṇā trāso na bhavati |

2 athādholakṣyaḥ em.] atha adholakṣyaḥ N₁, athādholakṣaḥ PL, athādholakṣa B, atha adholakṣanaḥ N₂, atha adholakṣaḥ DK₁, atha adholakṣa JU₁, om. EU₂ nāsikāyā cett.] nāsikāyāḥ EU₂ upari cett.] upariṣṭāt U₂ dvādaśāṅgula° cett.] dvādaśāṅgulamūla° E, daśāṅgula° U₂ dṛṣṭiḥ cett.] dṛṣṭi° JU₁ athavā cett.] om. LB 3 nāsikāyā cett.] nāsikāyāḥ JU₁, nāsika N₂ agre cett.] gre K₁, om. BL dṛṣṭiḥ cett.] dṛṣṭi° K₁N₂ sthirā cett.] om. BL karttavayā cett.] om. BL lakṣyadvayasya J] lakṣadvayasya cett., lakṣadvayasya E dṛḍhikaraṇād N₂] dṛḍhikaraṇāt DELN₁U₁U₂, dṛṣṭikaraṇāt P, dṛḍhikaraṇān B dṛṣṭiḥ cett.] dṛṣṭi° LN₂U₂ sthirā cett.] sthiro B, °sthiro L bhavati cett.] bhavati B 4 pavanaḥ DEK₁PN₁] pavana° JN₂U₁U₂, om. BL sthiro bhavati cett.] om. BL etad dvayam LJPN₂] etad dūyam E, etad dvayadvaya B, etad advayam DK₁N₂, etad dvayam U₁U₂ eva β] api γ °lakṣyam EPU₁U₂] °lakṣam cett. api β] eva γ kathyate β] bhavati γ, bhavati B 4–5 bāhyābhyantaram N₂] bāhyo bhyāmtaram DK₁N₁, bāhyābhyāmtare BJLP₁U₁U₂, bāhyāmtara E 5 ākāśavat β] ākāśavat B, ākāśa cen L, ākāśa cet PU₂, ākāśa E °lakṣyaḥ DJK₁N₁U₁] °lakṣyam EPU₂, °lakṣaḥ N₂, °m lakṣam BL karttavayaḥ cett.] karttavayā BL jāgraddaśāyām cett.] jāgraddaśāyām N₂, jāyadaśāyām N₂, jāgradādidaśāyām BL calana° cett.] cakaba° N₁ bhojanadaśāyām cett.] bhojanam daśāyām P, om. JU₁ 6 °sthāne cett.] °sthāneṣu BL °trāso DJK₁N₁] °trāso N₂, °sautrām U₁, om. γ na cett.] om. γ bhavati N₁N₂] bhavati || cha|| J, bhavati || śūnya D, bhavati vā U₁, om. γ

[XV. The lower focus]

Now, the lower focus. One should stabilize the gaze up to twelve finger breadths above of the nose. Alternatively, one should stabilize the gaze onto the tip of the nose. The gaze becomes still due to the stabilising of the two foci. The breath becomes stable. Lifespan increases.^{219,220} This pair is also taught as an external focus.²²¹ [Then] the focus of emptiness, which is like space, should be executed internally and externally.²²² The fear of death does not arise due to meditation on the void in all states—while eating, moving, waking [and] at the time of rest.^{223,224}

²¹⁹In Sundarās's *sarvangayoga* 2.26 (Ed. p. 104), one finds the following verse with a similar concept. He shares the technique of fixing the gaze onto the nose and the notion of the breath becoming stabilised: *prathamahiṃ adho lakṣa kauṃ jānaiṃ | nāśā agra drṣṭi sthira ānaiṃ | yātoṃ mana pavanā thira hoī | adho lakṣa jo sādhai koī ||*

²²⁰In his *hathasamketacandrikachennai*, Sundaradeva adds further techniques to the category of *adholakṣya* at this point of the text. For the reconstructed passage (based on ORI B220, GOML R3239, and MMPP 2244) and its translation, see p.392.

²²¹This statement associates the two practices of *adholakṣya* with *bāhyalakṣya*, which is described later on in the text. Indeed, these later descriptions instruct the practitioner to focus on one of the five elements at various distances in front of the nose or above the head (cf. p. 170).

²²²The description undoubtedly derives from the *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted in the *ramatosana* (Ed. p. 834), where it is declared a practice of *antaralakṣ(y)a*. Rāmacandra extracts this passage from his source text and locates this practice within the *adholakṣya* category.

²²³The translation of *sthitikāle* as “time of rest” is confirmed by the four states mentioned in the YSv (cf. sources). The formulation *sthitikāle* is Rāmacandra's rendering of *śuśupteṣu*.

²²⁴The concept of five *lakṣ(y)a*s appears only in the lost *Yogasvarodaya* and from there made its way into *ramatosana*, *yogakarnika* and *Tattvayogabindu*. The other texts including it are *sarvangayoga*, *hathasamketacandrikamysore* and *yogacandrika*. In those texts, this practice becomes a genuine yoga: *Lakṣ(y)yoga*. If one encounters the concept of three *lakṣ(y)a* as found in *netratantra* (cf. 7.1), *shivayogapradipika* (cf. 4.36–50), *mandalabrah* (cf. 2.6–2.14) or *advaya* (Ed. pp. 3–5) etc. it is never declared as an own type of yoga.

[XVI. rājayogayuktasya puruṣasya yac charīracihnam]

इदानीं राजयोगयुक्तस्य पुरुषस्य यच्छरीरचिह्नं तत् कथ्यते । सर्वत्र पूर्णो भवति । पृथिव्याः दूरे तिष्ठति । पृथ्वीं व्याप्य तिष्ठति । यस्य जन्ममरणे न स्तः । सुखं न भवति । दुःखं न भवति । कुलं न भवति । शीलं न भवति । स्थानं न भवति । अस्य सिद्धस्य मनोमध्ये ईश्वरसंबन्धी प्रकाशो निरन्तरं प्रत्यक्षो भवति । स च प्रकाशो न शीतो न चोष्णो न श्वेतो न पीतो भवति । तस्य न जातिर्न किञ्चिच्चिह्नम् । अयं च निष्कलो निरञ्जनः । अलक्ष्यश्च भवति । अथ च फलचन्दनकामिन्यादेर्यस्य यस्येच्छा भवति । तं तं भोगं प्राप्नोति । अथवास्य मन एव स्थानेऽनुरागं न प्राप्नोति ॥

Sources: 2–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 834): idāṇīm kathayisyāmi rājayogasya lakṣaṇam | rājayoge kṛte pumbhiḥ siddhicihnam bhaved iti | paripūrṇam bhaved cittaṁ jagatsthō 'pi jagadbahiḥ | na kṣobho janma mṛtyuś ca na duḥkham na sukham tathā | bhedābhedau manaḥsthai na jñānam śīlaṁ kulam tathā | prakāśakuśasambandhiprasaṅgo 'yaṁ niranteram | sarvaprakāśako 'sau tu naṣṭabhedādir eva ca | asya citte nānūrāgo virāgo na bhaved iti | asya jāter na cihnaḥ ca niṣkalo 'yaṁ nirañjanah | ananto 'yaṁ mahājyotir vāñchām bhogaṁ dadāti ca |

2 puruṣasya cett.] om. E yac charīracihnam DN₁P] yaccharīracihnam K₁, śarīre yac cihnam E, yac charīre cinham U₁, ya charīre cihnam J, yat śarīracinham U₂, yac charīracihūm N₂, cinham BL tat DE[K₁N₁N₂] tata U₁, om. BLPU₂ sarvatra° β] tatsarvatra° γ °pūrṇo cett.] pūrṇa PN₂ 3 prthivyāḥ cett.] prthivyā U₂, om. BL dūre DE[K₁N₁] ddūre U₁, dūra N₂, dūram U₂, om. BL tiṣṭhati cett.] om. BL prthviṁ DK₁N₂] prthvām N₁, prthivyām E, prthi° P, prthivyā U₂, om. BJLU₁ vyāpya DEK₁PN₁N₂] vyāti U₂, om. BJLU₁ tiṣṭhati cett.] om. BJLU₁ yasya janmamaraṇe na staḥ cett.] om. BJLU₁ 3–4 sukham na bhavati cett.] om. BJLU₁ 4 duḥkham na bhavati cett.] om. γJU₁ kulam BK₁U₂] kulam DPN₁N₂, kalam L, om. EJU₁ na bhavati cett.] om. EJU₁ śīlam cett.] śītalam P, om. BEL na bhavati cett.] om. BEL sthānam na bhavati cett.] om. BEL 5 siddhasya cett.] om. E, siddhasya prthivivyāpyam tiṣṭhati || yasya janmamaraṇe na staḥ sukham na bhavati || duḥkham na bhavati || kulam na bhavati || śīlam na bhavati || JU₁ manomadhye cett.] om. E īśvarasambandhi cett.] īśvaram sambandhi B, om. E prakāśo cett.] prakāśaḥ β, om. E niranteram cett.] nirattaram U₂, om. E pratyakṣo cett.] prakyaḥ N₁, om. E bhavati cett.] om. E 6 coṣṇo cett.] +++o U₁ śveto cett.] kheto N₂U₁ na pīto cett.] pīto na U₂ jātir cett.] jāti DK₁N₂, jānāti U₂ kiñcic cihnam cett.] kiñcic cihnam E, kiñcic cihūm DK₁N₁N₂, kiṁcit || cihūm J, kiṁcit khecha cihnam U₁, na kiṁcit cihnam U₂ ayaṁ cett.] ayaṁ J, vyayaṁ BL 7 niṣ° cett.] niṣ° BU₂, niḥ° JU₁ alakṣyaś cett.] alakṣyaḥ U₁U₂, alakṣaś BLN₁N₂ ca cett.] om. U₁U₂ phala° cett.] phalam BJN₂U₁ °candana° DJK₁PU₁U₂] °camdrana N₁, camdra N₂, °vaṁda L, jaṁda B, °dvande E āder cett.] āde DK₁, ādar B, ādir L 7–8 yasya yasyecchā em.] yasya yasyecchā DJK₁, yasyecchā E, yasyochā P, yasya yasyeccha N₁N₂, yasya yaṁ U₁, yasye chā U₂, yasya L, yasye B 8 bhavati cett.] bhavaṁti J, na bhavati BELP taṁ taṁ DJK₁N₁N₂] tataṁ U₁, om. γ bhogaṁ prāpnoti cett.] om. γ °vāsyā N₁N₂] °vā yasya DJK₁, °vāsvā U₁, om. γ mana β] om. γ eva DK₁N₁N₂] etat J, etata U₁, om. γ sthāne 'nurāgaṁ na prāpnoti β] om. γ

[XVI. The physical sign of a person who is engaged in Rājayoga]

Now, the physical sign of a person who is engaged in Rājayoga is taught.²²⁵ He is rich at all times.²²⁶ He exists detached from the world [yet] having permeated the world.²²⁷ For whom neither birth nor death exists; happiness does not exist; suffering does not exist;²²⁸ lineage does not exist; moral conduct does not exist;²²⁹ [and] abode does not exist in the mind of this accomplished [person], a light that is connected to God becomes perceptible. And, the light is not cold, not hot, neither white nor yellow.²³⁰ Neither does he have a caste, nor does he have any sign. Furthermore, he is without parts, immaculate and uncharacterised. And then, whatever wish for the most excellent fruit, affectionate woman, etc. arises,²³¹ he obtains that very enjoyment.²³² However, his very mind does not experience attachment in this situation.²³³

²²⁵The shift from Lakṣyayoga to the physical sign of Rājayoga seems abrupt, but Rāmacandra follows the *Yogasvarodaya*'s structure, treating the remaining Lakṣyayogas later.

²²⁶In light of Rāmacandra's understanding of Rājayoga as the "yoga for kings," this translation for *pūrṇa* is obvious.

²²⁷Cf. **sarvangayoga** 3.22: *icchā parai taham so jāi | tini loka mahim aṭaka na kāi | svarga jāi devani mahim baiṭhai | nāgaloka pātāla su paiṭhai || 22 ||*

²²⁸Equanimity towards opposites in the state of Rājayoga are common among texts that teach Rājayoga, cf. e.g. **amanaskaed** 1.26ab: *sukham duḥkham na jñāti śitoṣṇam ca na vindati ||*; **hp** 4.111 ≈ **nadabindu** 53ab–54cd: *na vijñāti śitoṣṇam na duḥkham na sukham tathā | na mānaṃ nopamānaṃ ca yogi yuktaḥ samādhinā ||*; also cf. **sarvangayoga** 3.18cd: *jākaṃ dukha aru sukha nahim hoī | harṣa śoka vyāpai nahim koī |*

²²⁹Cf. **datta2024** 186.

²³⁰Cf. **amanaskaed** 1.51: *vāsārādhāyēnāpi svātmajyotiḥ prakāśate | sūryo gobhir ivoddipto yogi viśvaṃ prakāśate ||*; also cf. **sarvangayoga** 3.13cd: *rājayoga saba ūpara chājai | jo sādhai so adhika birājai ||*; and 3.23cd: *hṛdai prakāśa rahai dina rāti | deśai jyoti tela bina vāti ||*

²³¹This statement is unusual as it contradicts standard renunciatory principles. For this reason, *bhavati* was changed to *na bhavati* in the transmission of the γ-group. The passage is supported by the *Yogasvarodaya*: *...mahājyotir vāñchāṃ bhogaṃ dadāti ca |* cf. sources.

²³²For similar constructions to "yasya yasyecchā ...taṃ taṃ bhogaṃ ..." cf. **anandakanda** 1.15.312 and **hathatattvakaumudi** 5.39.

²³³Nearly all manuscripts omit (some even repeat) sentences at this section, likely due to eye-skipping caused by structural similarity and brevity of the sentences.

[XVII. anyad rājayogasya cihnam]

अन्यद्राजयोगस्य चिह्नं कथ्यते। यस्य राज्यादिलाभेऽपि फललाभो न भवति।
 हानावपि मनोमध्ये दुःखं न भवति। अथ च तृष्णा न भवति। अथ च कस्मिन्नपि
 पदार्थे प्राप्ते कस्यापि पदार्थस्योपर्यनिच्छा न भवति। अस्मिन्नपि पदार्थे मनसोऽनु-
 5 रागोऽनो न भवति। अयमपि राजयोगः कथ्यते। अथ च यस्य मनः श्रुतिविद्वत् पु-
 रुषे मित्रे शत्रौ च समं भवति। दृष्टिश्च समा भवति। सकलपृथ्वीमध्ये गमनवतः
 सुखभोगवतः यस्य मनसि कर्तृत्वाभिमानो नास्ति। अनुचरलोकमध्ये कर्तृत्वं न
 ज्ञापयति। सोऽपि राजयोगः कथ्यते।

Sources: 2–8 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 834–835): rājye (em. *rājya* YSv) prāpte 'pi no harṣo hānau duḥkhaṃ bhaven na hi | kvacid vastuni deśasya niḥsvane keṣu kutracit | vidyāvidyāmitraśa-
 trau samā dṛṣṭiś ca sarvaśaḥ | bhogāsaktādikartṛtvena mano no bhavet khavat | lokamadye
 bhavet karttā manomadye 'pi niṣkriyaḥ | eṣo 'pi rājayogī sukhe duḥkhe samas tathā |

2 anyad EN₂] anyat β, anyate BL, om. P **rājayogasya** cett.] rājayoga° JU₁, om. P **cihnam**
 E]] cinham BLN₁U₂, cinhuṃ N₂, cinhuṃ DK₁, om. P **kathyate** cett.] om. P **yasya** cett.]
 om. P **rājyādi°** cett.] rājādi° BL, rājyāpi° J °lābhe DK₁EN₁] °lobhe N₂, °lābe U₁, °lābho U₂,
 lābhety BL, om. JP °pi DEK₁N₁] 'pi ca N₂U₁, ty BL, ca J, om. PU₂ **phala°** DEN₁N₂] aphala°
 BL, palā° J, pala° U₁, om. PU₂ **lābho** cett.] om. P **na bhavati** cett.] na bhavati BL, ba bha-
 vati N₁, om. P **3 hānāv** cett.] hānād U₂, hananād BL, om. P **api** cett.] pi BLN₂, om. P
manomadye duḥkhaṃ na cett.] om. P **bhavati** cett.] bhavati BL, om. P **atha ca tṛṣṇā**
na cett.] om. P **bhavati** cett.] bhavati B, om. P **atha ca** cett.] om. P **kasmin** cett.] om.
 P **api** DU₁] na BL, pi N₁N₂, adhi U₂, om. EP **4 padārthe** cett.] padārthau B, padārtho L,
 padārtha° U₂, om. EP **prāpte** cett.] prāpta N₁, om. EP **kasyāpi** cett.] kābhyādi U₂, om.
 EP **padārthasyopary** E] padārthasyopari BL, padārthopari U₂, padārthasya upari β, om.
 P **anicchā** E] ānicchā B, ānicchā L, anicchā DJK₁, anusthā N₁, anisthā N₂, aniṣṭā U₁, aniccha
 U₂, om. P **na** cett.] ni B, om. DK₁P **bhavati** cett.] bhavanti DJN₁, om. P **asminn** cett.]
 kasmin EU₂ **api** cett.] om. BEL **manaso** BELL] manasaḥ DK₁N₁N₂U₁, manasaś J, manasa
 U₁, om. U₂ **4–5 'nurāgo** BELL] cānurāgo J, anurāgo cett. **5 na bhavati** EK₁] na bhavati BL,
 na bhavati ayam api padārthe manasonurāgo na bhavati P, na bhavati || ayam api padārthe
 anurāgo na bhavati U₂, bhavati DJN₁N₂U₁ **ayam** cett.] atham P, atha L **api** cett.] sama L
rājayogaḥ cett.] rājayoga N₂U₂ ca cett.] caḥ E **yasya** cett.] ya D **śrutividvat** em.] muni-
 vidvat E, śunividvat P, bhunividvat L, śrunividvat BU₁, śrutividvat DK₁N₁N₂, śubhividvat J,
 śuciviśuddha° U₂ **5–6 puruṣe** cett.] puruṣeṣu E **6 mitre** cett.] maitre BELL] **śatrau** cett.]
 śatro B, om. E **dṛṣṭiś ca** cett.] om. BL **samā** cett.] namnā P, om. BL **bhavati** cett.] om. BL
sakalapṛthvīmadhye cett.] °pṛthvī° L **gamanavataḥ** E]N₁U₁] gamanaṃ vataḥ D, gamavataḥ
 U₁, gamanataḥ K₁, gamanāgamanavataḥ P, gamanāgamanavat U₂, gamanāgamanataḥ BL
7 sukhabhogavataḥ cett.] sukhabogho bhavataḥ BL, sukho bhogavataḥ U₁, sukhabhogavat U₂
yasya cett.] tasya K₁ **kartṛtvābhimāno** E]PU₁U₂] kartutvābhimano BL, kartṛtvādyabhimāno
 DK₁N₁N₂ **anucara°** BL] anuca° βPU₂, atha ca E °madhye cett.] °madhya BL **kartṛtvam**
 na cett.] kartṛtvābhimano BL, kartṛtvam N₁U₁ **8 jñāpayati** cett.] jñāta payati DJK₁U₁, nāsti
 BL **rājayogaḥ** EPN₁] rājayoga cett.

[XVII. Another sign of Rājayoga]

Another sign of Rājayoga is described. For whom,²³⁴ even if a kingdom has been attained, there is no gaining of a [karmic] result;²³⁵ [and] even in loss, suffering does not arise within the mind; and neither does desire arise. And then, if a certain object has been attained, no aversion²³⁶ arises towards [this] certain object, and also no affection of the mind arises towards this very object—this is said to be Rājayoga. Moreover, whose mind is equal towards a person who has expertise in sacred scriptures, a friend [or] an enemy; and [whose] view becomes indifferent; in whose mind prevails no sense of being the agent [while] moving in the whole world and enjoying pleasures; in whose mind the pride of the ability [to do these things] does not arise; [and] who does not show his being the agent among his attendants—this is also said to be Rājayoga.

²³⁴Grammatical constructions in this text may deviate from classical Sanskrit. In most cases, however, these should not be regarded as errors due to their frequency but as contemporary or regional language usage phenomena. Some constructions in this section and other passages of the text use the genitive as a substitute for other cases, such as the dative, instrumental or locative, see **whitney1879**. In particular, this can be observed in this and other places of the text in relative clause constructions beginning with *yasya*, which must, for example, be read as *yasmin*, as otherwise, the corresponding correlative pronoun seems to be missing. The genitive, for example, in connection with the following word *manasi* or *manah* (see edition text) would make the yogin the implicit subject of the sentence and the actual correlative pronoun of the construction referring to *yasya*, in this section *ayam* or *sah*, would appear incongruent. At the same time, the *daṇḍas* in these constructions should be understood as commas or semicolons.

²³⁵Mallinson suggested considering an emendation of *phalalābhaḥ* to *phalalobhaḥ*, which would indeed make good sense. However, in light of the unequivocal consistency of the manuscripts across the stemma, I have adhered to the transmitted reading.

²³⁶The most common meaning of the word *anicchā* is indifference. However, even with force, this meaning can not be the word's intended meaning in this context. Because of that, I propose the meaning of "aversion" as attested in **petersburger**. The meaning "aversion" can be easily derived by taking *an-icchā* as a *nañ-samāsa* compound that expresses the direct opposite of "desire". The mention of the word *trṣṇā* in the previous sentence supports this conclusion.

नवीनानि पट्टसूत्रमयानि धृतानि वस्त्राणि । अथवा जीर्णानि सच्छिद्राणि धृतानि क-
स्तुरिकाचन्दनलेपो वा कर्दमलेपो वा । यस्य मनसि हर्षशोकौ न स्थौ स एव राज-
योगः । नगरमध्येऽथच वनमध्ये उद्वसग्राममध्ये लोकपूर्णग्राममध्ये वा यस्य मन
ऊनं न पूर्णं वा न भवति । सोऽपि राजयोगः ॥

5

[XVIII. caryāyogaḥ]

इदानीं चर्यायोगः कथ्यते । निराकारो नित्योऽचलोऽभेद्यः स एतादृश आत्मा ।
एतादृशे आत्मनि मनो यस्य निश्चलं तिष्ठति तस्यात्मनः पुण्यपापस्पर्शो न भ-
वति । उदकमध्ये स्थितस्य पद्मिनीपत्रस्य यथोदकस्पर्शो न भवति तथैवात्मनि ।
यथाकाशमध्ये पवनः स्वेच्छया भ्रमति तथा यस्य मनः निराकारमध्ये लीनं भवति
स एव चर्यायोगः ॥

10

Sources: 1-10 Cf. YSv (PT, p. 835): harṣaśokau na jātv eṣāṃ nodvego lokasaṅgame | nityollāse
nirākāre nirāsane nirātmani | manasā nīścalo bhūtvā sadā tiṣṭhet samo 'pi ca | yathākāśe
bhraman vāyur ākāśaṃ vrajate svayam | tathākāśe mano linam rājayogakriyā matā | jagat-
saṃsarganirlepaṃ padmapatrajalaṃ yathā |

1 navīnāni cett.] navinīnir api B, navīnīnī pī L paṭṭa° BEL] paṭa° cett., pada° U₁ °mayāni
cett.] °maya E dhṛtāni cett.] tāni JU₁ vastrāni cett.] om. U₂ sacchidrāni cett.] sachidrāni
U₂, sachadrāni P, svachidrāni BL, chidrāni E dhṛtāni cett.] dhvātāni U₂, dhūtāni P 1-2 kas-
turikā β] kastūri BEPU₂, kasturi L 2 lepo cett.] lepair E vā cett.] cā L °lepo cett.] lepena
E vā cett.] om. E °śokau cett.] °śoko DJN₁U₂, °śo K₁, °śoka N₂ sthau em.] sthaḥ cett., sthā
N₂U₁, sta U₂, ko staḥ K₁ eva cett.] evātra E 2-3 rājayogaḥ cett.] rājayoga U₂, rājayogaḥ ||
idānīm || BL, rājayogaḥ || cha || J, tiṣṭhati | yasya janmamaraṇe na staḥ sukhaṃ na bhavati |
kulaṃ na bhavati śilaṃ na bhavati | sthānaṃ na bhavati | E 3 nagara° cett.] rājayogaḥ nagara°
E, ṣagara° D, vā nagara° U₁ 'tha PLBU₂] atha cett. udvasa° U₂] yuddhe saṃ° E, utasaṃ° P,
udvasta° BL, udvesū° DN₁N₂, udassaṃ° U₁, udvaṃsa J, udvaṃsū K₁ grāma° cett.] grāmaṃ B
loka° JK₁U₁] ++++° N₁, sveta° DN₂, om. γ mana PU₂] manaḥ cett. 4 ūnaṃ PJN₁N₂U₂] ūnan
DK₁N₂, unaṃ BLU₁, bhaya° E na DK₁N₁N₂] om. cett. vā cett.] vāṃ PU₂, om. U₁ 'pi em.] pi
cett. rājayogaḥ cett.] rājayogaḥ kathyate E 6 caryāyogaḥ cett.] tvaryāyogaḥ U₁, yogaḥ E
nirākāro cett.] nirākālo DJN₁N₂, nirvikāro U₂ nityo β] 'calo PU₂, calo BL, om. E 'calo β]
nityo γ 'bhedyah DEK₁N₁N₂] bhedhyaḥ BLP, abhedhyaḥ JU₁, 'bhedyha U₂ etādṛśa BJLP]
etādṛśaḥ DEK₁N₁N₂U₁, etādṛśa U₂ ātmā cett.] ātmani EU₂ 7 etādṛśe DJK₁N₁] sa etādṛśye
B, sa etādṛśe L, etādṛśa N₂, etādṛśo PU₁, om. EU₂ ātmani cett.] om. EU₂ mano EPU₁U₂] manaḥ
DJK₁N₁N₂, om. BL yasya cett.] om. BL nīścalaṃ cett.] nīścala PLN₂ tiṣṭhati
cett.] bhavati U₁ tasyātmānaḥ cett.] tasya ātmanaḥ JU₁U₂ °pāpasparśo cett.] °pāpaṃ
sparśo J, °pāsa sparśo U₁U₂ 8 padminīpatrasya cett.] padmanīpatrasya BLP, padmapatre E
yathodakasparśo U₂] yathā udakasparśo β, yathodakasya sparśo EPL, yathodakasya sparśa B
bhavati cett.] bhavati B 9 kāśa° EP] 'kāśa° U₂, ākāśa° cett. pavanaḥ sve° cett.] pavanaśva°
DJK₁N₁N₂ bhramati cett.] brahmayati JU₁ yasya manaḥ cett.] yamanaḥ D, pavana° N₂
bhavati cett.] bhavati B 10 caryā° γ] trayā° K₁, kriyā° β

Whether one is wearing new clothes made of silk, or old, worn [clothes] with holes, whether [one is] smeared with sandalwood and musk, or smeared with mud—when delight and grief do not reside within the mind, it is that which is Rājayoga. When the mind is neither bored nor overwhelmed situated in a city, a forest, an uninhabited village or a village full of people, also this is Rājayoga.

[XVIII. Caryāyoga]

Now, Caryāyoga is explained.²³⁷ Formless, permanent, immovable [and] unsplittable—such is the self. For whose mind remains steady in such a self, his self does not come into contact with sin and merit. Just as contact with water does not arise for the lotus leaf situated in water, likewise in the [case of the] self. When the mind is absorbed into the formless, in the same way as the wind wanders according to its own will in space, only that is Caryāyoga.²³⁸

²³⁷Caryāyoga is absent in the YSv (PT and YK). Rāmacandra uses a passage from the YSv's section on Rājayoga to construct this subtype of yoga (cf. PT, p. 835: *nityollāse ... samo 'pi ca* |). Its brevity suggests an attempt to match the initial list of yogas. The passage does not clarify why he employs the term *caryā*°. Its inclusion among the fifteen yogas reflects the four *pādas* of the Śaiva Āgamas (*kriyā*-, *jñāna*-, *caryā*-, and *yogapāda*). However, there is no connection to ritual conduct/discipline of Śaiva practices. Perhaps, in this context, the concept of *caryā*° = $\sqrt{car}$ + *kṛt*-suffix -*yā* f. might express the action, which refers to the meaning “wandering, roaming” of the verbal root $\sqrt{car}$, which Rāmacandra brings up in his description.

²³⁸Parallels to Rāmacandra's innovative Caryāyoga can be identified in the texts with similar taxonomies. In *yogacandrika* (Ed. pp. 2, 52–53, 100–101, 150) Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents Caryāyoga in the context of *Yogasūtra* 1.33. According to Nārāyaṇatīrtha's commentary, the practice of this involves the cultivation of specific mental attitudes, such as *maitrī* (“loving-kindness”), *karuṇā* (“compassion”), *muditā* (“compassionate joy”) and *upekṣā* (“equanimity”), towards circumstances characterised by happiness, suffering, virtue and vice. Sundardās, in his *sarvangayoga* (2.40–51, Ed. pp. 96–98), describes the similar sounding Cārcāyoga as a type of *bhaktiyoga* that is *bhakti* towards the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*) in rapturous devotion. According to Sundardās, the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*) is formless, eternal, etc. (40). However, in Sanskrit and *brājbhāṣā* the term means “discussion”. Thus Caryāyoga and Cārcāyoga are unrelated. An analysis of Caryāyoga can be examined on p. 344.

[XIX. haṭhayogaḥ]

इदानीं हठयोगः कथ्यते। रेचकपूरककुम्भक इत्यादिप्रकारेण पवनस्य साधनं कर्त-
व्यम्। अथ च धौत्यादिषट्कर्मकारणात् शरीरस्य शुद्धिर्भवति। सूर्यनाडीमध्ये पवनः
पूर्णो यदा तिष्ठति तदा मनो निश्चलं भवति। मनसो निश्चलत्वे आनन्दस्वरूपं प्रत्य-
5 क्षं भासते। हठयोगकरणात् मनः शून्यमध्ये लीनं भवति। कालः समीपे नागच्छ-
ति ॥

Sources: 2–6 cf. YSv(PT, p. 835): idānīm haṭhayogas tu kathyate haṭhasiddhidah | kṛtvāsanam pavanāśam śarīre rogaḥāarakam | pūrakam kumbhakañ caiva recakam vāyunā bhajet | it-
tham kramotkramam jñātvā pavanam sādhayet sadā | dhauty ādikarmaṣaṭkañ ca prakuryād
(*saṃskuryād* ŚKD p. 501) haṭhasādhakaḥ | etan nāḍyān tu deveśi vāyupūrnam pratiṣṭhitam
| tato mano niścalaṃ syāt tata ānand eva hi | haṭhayogān na kālaḥ syān manonāśo (*manaḥ
śūnye* ŚKD p. 501) bhaved yadi |

2 **haṭhayogaḥ** cett.] haṭayoga B, grahayogaḥ E, haṭhayoga U₂ ity ādi° cett.] ity ādhi° N₂
pavanasya sādhanam cett.] pavanasādhanaṃ EP 2–3 **kartavyam** BEL] kartavyam cett.
3 **ca** cett.] om. U₁ dhautyādi cett.] dhotyādi B, vidhotyādi U₁ sūryanāḍīmadye cett.]
sarvasūryanāḍīmadye B pavanaḥ cett.] pavana° BL 4 **pūrṇo** cett.] om. J yadā tiṣṭhati
cett.] yadāti BL mano γ] manaḥ β niścalaṃ cett.] niścalo BLP manaso γ] manasaḥ β
niścalatve cett.] niścalatvena E ānandasvarūpaṃ cett.] ānaṃdaṃ svarūpaṃ BL, ānandaṃ
svarūpa° P, ānandarūpaṃ E 5 **bhāṣate** cett.] bhāṣate N₂U₁ haṭha° cett.] haṭa° B yoga°
cett.] yogā° B karaṇāt cett.] karaṇāt BLP manaḥ cett.] mana N₂ līnam cett.] sthānam
U₂ kālaḥ cett.] kālām J, kālā° B, kāla° N₂U₁, kāsaḥ U₂ 5–6 **nāgacchati** cett.] nāma gacchati
B, nāgachamti D, pi nāgachati J, ti nāgachati U₁

[XIX. Haṭhayoga]

Now, Haṭhayoga is explained.^{239,240} Breath is to be controlled by means of practices such as exhalation, inhalation [and] retention, etc.²⁴¹ And then due to the six actions (*ṣaṭkarma*), like *dhauti* etc.,²⁴² the purification of the body arises. When the breath fills the inside of the sun channel,²⁴³ then the mind is unmovable. When the mind is motionless, then the nature of bliss manifests. As a result of Haṭhayoga, the mind becomes absorbed into emptiness. Time [as death] does not approach.

²³⁹See p. 351 for a detailed discussion of Haṭhayoga within the complex early modern yoga taxonomies.

²⁴⁰The *Yogasvarodaya*'s description of the two types of Haṭhayoga is quoted in *shabdakalpadrūma* (ŚKD), Ed. p. 501. I recorded the variants in the sources of the edition of this passage. I want to thank Franz Veit for the hint to this reference.

²⁴¹The *Yogasvarodaya* suggests that the term *ādi* should refer to the other common practices of Haṭhayoga such as, *āsana*, *mudrā*, and perhaps even *nāḍānusandhāna*, cf. *hathapradīpikā* 2024 I.56.

²⁴²See *hathapradīpikā* 2024 2.22–37.

²⁴³Usually the *sūryanāḍī* is the *piṅgalā*-channel, beginning at the right nostril, as previously declared in the *Tattvayogabindu* III l. 3. Here, it appears more likely that *sūryanāḍī* refers to the central channel, the *suṣūmnā*. However, the manuscript's transmission is clear. Nonetheless, the term might very well be corrupted. The context rather suggests a conjecture to *śūnyānāḍī*. In *Jyotsnā* 4.10, Brahmananda understands "the void" (*śūnya*) as the central channel. In *Hathapradīpikā* 3.4, *śūnyapadavi* is a synonym of *suṣūmnā*. Both words *sūrya*° and *śūnya*° begin with a sibilant, which is often confused, followed by a long *ū* in both manuscripts. Although both words end with one of the orthographically quite easily distinguished ligatures र्य (*rya*) or न्य (*nya*). An illegible manuscript at an early stage of transmission could easily have caused this error.

[XX. haṭhayogasya dvitīyo bhedaḥ]

इदानीं हठयोगस्य द्वितीयो भेदः कथ्यते । पादादारभ्य शिरःपर्यन्तं स्वशरीरे कोटि-
सूर्यतेजःसमानं श्वेतं पीतं नीलं रक्तं किञ्चिद्रूपं चिन्त्यते । तद्ध्यानकारणात् सकलाङ्गे
रोगज्वलनं भवति । आयुर्वृद्धिर्भवति ॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 835): idānīm haṭhayogasya dvitīyaṃ bhedam acchr̥ṇu (*bhedavat śr̥ṇu* ŚKD p. 501) | ākāśe nāsikāgre tu sūryakoṭisamam smaret | śvetam raktam tathā pītam kṛṣṇam ity ādirūpataḥ | evaṃ dhyātvā cirāyus syād aṅgājananavarjitam (°*varjitaḥ* YK 12.25) | śivatulyo mahātmāsau haṭhayogaprasādataḥ (°*prasaṅgataḥ* YK 12.25) | haṭhāj jyotir (*haṭha*° YK 12.26) mayo bhūtvā hy antareṇa śivo (*śiva* ŚKD p. 501) bhavet | ato 'yaṃ haṭhayogaḥ syāt siddhidaḥ siddhasevitaḥ |

Testimonia: 2–4 cf. ≈hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244 f. 125 ll. 4–5): pādād ārabhya śiraḥparyamṭasya śarīre koṭisūryatejaḥsadrśaṃś cetam pītam raktam vā kiṃcidrūpaṃ vicimṭya tasya dhyānakaraṇāt sarvāṃge rogajvalanaṃ bhavati ||

2 haṭhayogasya cett.] haṭayogasya BU₁, haṭhayoga° P dvitīyo cett.] dvitīya° DLP, dvitīyaṃ B bhedaḥ cett.] bhedaḥ BL kathyate cett.] kathyante BL pādād ārabhya cett.] pādādārabhyā DN₁ śiraḥ cett.] śira° BL, śiro U₂ paryantaṃ cett.] paryantaṃ N₁, pariyataṃ U₁ svaśarīre cett.] svaśariraṃ JU₁ 2–3 koṭisūryatejaḥ cett.] koṭisūrye tejaḥ U₂ 3 samānaṃ cett.] samāna° BL śvetam cett.] śveta° B pītam cett.] om. BL nīlam cett.] nīla° J raktam cett.] laktaṃ N₁ kiṃcidrūpaṃ DJK₁N₁U₂] kiṃdrupaṃ BP, tiṃdrupaṃ L, ciṃrūpaṃ U₁, kiṃcidvarṇaṃ E cintyate cett.] cityate P, ciṃtate BL tad ELPN₂] tat BU₂, ta DK₁U₁, na N₁, om. J dhyānakāraṇāt γ] dhyānakaraṇāt K₁, dhyānaṃ karaṇāt DN₁N₂U₁, dhyānakāraṇa J sakalāṅge βPU₂] sakalaṃge BL, sakalaṃ E 4 rogajvalanaṃ γD] roga N₁N₂, roga kṣataṃ U₁ bhavati EJU₂] na bhavati BDK₁LPU₁, na bhavati | jvalanaṃ na bhavati N₁, na bhavati | jvaranaṃ na bhavati N₂ āyur cett.] āyu° N₂, om. DK₁ vṛddhir cett.] om. DEK₁L bhavati cett.] bhavati B, vardhate EL, om. DK₁

[XX. Second type of Haṭhayoga]

Now, the second type²⁴⁴ of Haṭhayoga is explained.²⁴⁵ Some kind of form being white, yellow, blue [and] red, equal to the shine of ten million suns shall be contemplated in the own body from the feet to the top of the head. As a result of meditation on that, the burning of diseases in the entire body arises. The lifespan increases.²⁴⁶

²⁴⁴The division of Haṭhayoga into two subcategories is unique in yoga literature and originates from the *Yogasvarodaya*.

²⁴⁵At this point *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted with reference in *Yogakarṇikā* 12.23 adds a verse not found in the **ramatosana**: *susthāsanaṃ samāsino nīrajāyatalocanaḥ | cintayet paramātmānaṃ yo vadet sa bhaviṣyati |*

²⁴⁶Cf. *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 835) as presented in sources for XX. p. 152: “Now, listen to the second variation of Haṭhayoga. Contemplate the space at the tip of the nose as being equal to the radiance of ten million suns in colours such as white, red, yellow, black, and other colours of that nature. By meditating in this way, one can achieve a long life because one is freed from the process of ageing (*aṅgajaraṇavarjitaḥ* em.] *aṅgājananavarjitaṃ* PT). Through the devoted practice of Haṭhayoga, one whose self is great becomes like Śiva. Having become like the light, one truly becomes one with Śiva inside. Therefore, the path of Haṭhayoga will bring forth supernatural abilities and is followed by the Siddhas.” Rāmacandra’s transfer misses various details, but both descriptions remind of Bāhyalakṣya (see section XXIII on p. 170). Another light-based technique of Haṭhayoga, which is classified as a technique of *dhyāna* involves visualising equally intense light at the navel, heart and head and results in igniting this light in all six *cakras* and ultimately leading to liberation from the fetters of birth (*mucyante janma-bandhanāt*) can be found in **liersch2026** 33–50. Another similarity appears in **amanaskaed** 2.7–8: *cittaṃ buddhīr ahaṅkāra ṛtvijāḥ somapaṃ manaḥ | indriyāṇi daśa prāṇāṇ juhōti jyotimaṇḍale || 7 || āmulād bilaparyantaṃ vibhāti jyotimaṇḍalam | yogibhiḥ satataṃ dhyeyam aṇimādyasṭasiddhidam ||* These verses precede or introduce *sāmbhavi mudrā*. Here, thought, intellect and ego are taught to be the officiants, whereas the mind is the sacrificer who sacrifices the senses and the ten vital breaths into the orb of light (2.7). The orb of light (*jyotimaṇḍala*) shines from the root (one immediately thinks of the root of the body or spine, but **birch2013** suggests the palate) to the aperture at the top of the head. Yoga practitioners should constantly meditate on it to achieve *siddhis* (2.8).

[XXI. jñānayogasya lakṣaṇam]

इदानीं ज्ञानयोगस्य लक्षणं कथ्यते ।

एकमेव जगत्पश्येद्विश्वात्मासुविभास्वरम् ।
अविकल्पतया युक्त्या ज्ञानयोगं समाचरेत् ॥ XXI.1 ॥

5 यत्र तत्र स्थितो वापि सर्वज्ञानमयं जगत् ।
य एवं वेत्ति बोधेन सोऽपि ज्ञानाधिकारवान् ॥ XXI.2 ॥

प्राप्नोति शाम्भवीं सत्तां सदाद्वैतपरायणः ।
यथा न्यग्रोधबीजं हि क्षितावुप्तं द्रुमायते ॥ XXI.3 ॥

10 एकान्तं नैकधा स्वेन दृश्यते दशधा कृता ।
मूलाङ्कुरस्य चोदण्डाः शाखाकुसुमपल्लवाः ॥ XXI.4 ॥

Sources: 2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 835): idānīm jñānayogasya lakṣaṇam kathyate śive | yaj jñātvā jñānasampūrṇaḥ śivaḥ syān na punarbhavaḥ | 3-4 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 835): ekam eva jagat paśyed viśvātmā viśvabhāvanāḥ | iti kṛtvā tu vai yukto jñānayogaṁ samācaret | 5-6 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 835): yatra tatra sthito vāpi sarvajñānamayaṁ jagat | ya evam asti bodhena so'pi jñānādhikāravān | 7-8 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 835): prāpnoti śāmbhaviṁmantrān sadā nityaparāyaṇaḥ | yathā nyagrodhavi-jaṁ hi kṣitau vaptur drumāyate | 9-10 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 835): ādāv ekas tato 'nekaḥ svabhāvāc chādanādibhiḥ | varddhate 'harniśaṁ vṛkṣaḥ patrapallavavistṛtaḥ |

2 idānīm cett.] idānī U₁ kathyate EJK₁PN₂U₁U₂] om. BDLN₁ 3 eva cett.] evā BL jagat cett.] cayat P paśyed cett.] paśyad B viśvātmā° cett.] viśvāva° E 4 avikalpatayā cett.] āvikalpatayā U₁U₂ yuktyā cett.] yuktā BL 5 tatra BJ] yatra cett. vāpi cett.] himsa° U₂ 6 ya evam cett.] evam unm. JU₁U₂ veti cett.] vette na U₁, ve unm. B jñānādhikāravān cett.] jñānādhikāraṇāt E 7 prāpnoti cett.] om. E śāmbhaviṁ sattāṁ BP] śāmbhavisattāṁ DU₁U₂, śāmbhaviṁ sattān L, śāmbhaviṁ satta N₁, śāmbhavisattā JK₁N₂, om. E sadādvaita° cett.] sadādvaita° U₁, om. E 8 yathā cett.] om. E nyagrodhabijaṁ cett.] nyagrodhavijaṁ DN₁N₂, nyagrodhavija L, om. E hi cett.] om. E kṣitāv cett.] kṣiti B, kṣitvāṁ J, kṣitāptā unm. U₁, om. E uṣṭam drumāyate cett.] ukta drumāyate U₁, uṣṭam drumāyate likāṁ pa++vāḥ unm. P, utpadyate yathā L, utpadyate B, om. E 9 ekāntam cett.] ekānte BL, yekāntam U₁, om. P naikadhā cett.] naikadhā E, nekadhā BL, ++naikadhā unm. J, om. P svena cett.] śveta N₁, śvetana DJN₂, om. P dṛśyate cett.] dṛśyaṁte BL, dṛśyet N₂, om. P daśadhā E]N₁N₂] daśadhāt BL, śadhā unm. N₂U₁, om. P kṛtā β] kṛtaḥ EL, kṛ+tā B, kṛtiḥ U₂, om. P 10 mūlāṅkurasya E] mūlāṁkurutva cett., om. P coddāṇḍāḥ EN₁U₂] codarāṭaḥ DN₂, codarāḍa J, kudamjaḥ B, kudamḍa L, om. P śākhākusumapallavāḥ U₂] śākhākuṇḍalapallavāḥ E, śākhākilekālappallavā BL, śāvārakumbhalapallavāḥ N₁U₁, śākhāku++lapallavā J, śākhākumbhalapallavā N₂, śālāvākumapadṛtravā D, om. P

[XXI. The characteristics of Jñānayoga]

Now, the characteristic of Jñānayoga is explained.

XXI.1 He shall see the world as only one, illumined by the supreme self. By the method of non-dualistic thinking, he may accomplish Jñānayoga.

XXI.2 Alternatively, wherever one dwells, the world is made of all knowledge. He who knows thus by realisation is also qualified for gnosis.

XXI.3 The one who is devoted to non-duality always attains the reality of Śaṃbhu,²⁴⁷ just as the seed of the banyan tree scattered onto the ground [always] becomes a tree.²⁴⁸

XXI.4 By nature [the reality of Śaṃbhu] is not only seen as one [but] has been fabricated tenfold. [Just as] the branches, buds and twigs are [held] up by the stem of the roots and shoots. [...]

²⁴⁷Rāmacandra uses the term *śāmbhavīm sattām* as a designation of the ultimate state to be attained by practising Jñānayoga, which he presents as the realization of absolute unity. In medieval yoga texts, particular in the Rājayoga genre, the feminine noun *śāmbhavī* most often appears in the context of a non-physical *mudrā*, the so-called *śāmbhavī mudrā*. For a detailed discussion of *śāmbhavī mudrā*, its influence and all references, see [birch2013](#). The usage of the feminine noun *śāmbhavī* to qualify a state is less common. More frequently one finds the masculine adjective *śāmbhava* in order to qualify an exalted yogic state. See for example *Candrāvalokana* 2, *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.7, *Anubhavanivedana* 1, *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 49.27. The idea has its roots in tantric traditions of Śaivism and refers to an meditative state associated with Śiva.

²⁴⁸In rituals the banyan tree (*nyagrodha*) is associated with the *kṣatriya* class ([smith1998](#)).

स्नेहपुष्पफलं बीजे विस्तारोऽयं स्वभावतः ।
तथासौ निर्मलो नित्यो निर्विकारो निरञ्जनः ॥ XXI.5 ॥

एको ऽनेकः स्वयंभूश्च स्वधाम्ना बहुधा स्थितः ।
पञ्चतत्त्वमनोबुद्धिमायाहंकारविक्रियः ॥ XXI.6 ॥

5 एवं दशविधं विश्वं लोकालोकसुविस्तरम् ।
एक एव न चान्योऽस्ति यो जानाति स तत्त्ववित् ॥ XXI.7 ॥

Sources: 1-2 ≈YSv (PT, p. 836): snehapuṣṣaphalair vijair vistāro 'yaṃ svabhāvataḥ | tathāsau nirmalo nityo nirvikāro nirañjanaḥ | 3-4 ≈YSv (PT, p. 836): eko 'nekaḥ khayam bhūyān sādhanād bahudhā sthitaḥ | pañcatattvamayo buddhimāyāhaṅkāravikriyaḥ | 5-6 ≈YSv (PT, p. 836): evaṃ bahuvidham viśvaṃ lokālokasuvistaram | ekam eva na cānvo 'sti yo jānāti sa tattvavit |

1 snehapuṣṣaphalam DK₁N₁N₂PU₂] snehe puṣṣaphala° BL, snehapuṣṣam phala U₁, snehapuṣṣam phalam J, snehapuṣṣaphalam E bīje cett.] bija BL vistāro cett.] vistārā DN₁ 'yaṃ EPN₁N₂U₂] ya BL, yaḥ U₁, yasya D, yaḥ sya J svabhāvataḥ cett.] svabhāvataḥ BL, bhāvataḥ unṃ. DJ 2 tathāsau cett.] yathāsau B, tathāpasau unṃ. P nirmalo cett.] nirmalau P 3 eko cett.] yeko U₁ 'nekaḥ em.] nekaḥ cett., naika U₁, naiko U₂, neka BK₁N₂ svayambhūś ca cett.] svayambhūtyā U₁ svadhāmnā K₁PU₂] svadhāmnāva N₂, svayāmmnā N₁, svadhābhāva L, svabhāvā U₁, svabhāvād J, svadhā++sa D, dhāmnā ca E, dhāmnāya B sthitaḥ cett.] sthitaḥ DK₁LP 4 °buddhi° EPL] °buddhir cett. vikriyaḥ em.] vikriyāḥ EPU₁, vikriyā BDJK₁LN₁N₂U₂ 5 daśavidham viśvaṃ DJK₁EPN₁U₂] daśavidhā viśvaṃ BLN₂, daśavidhaviśvaṃ U₁ lokālokasuvistaram em.] lokālokasavistaram BDJELPN₂U₁, lokālokasavistarām K₁N₁, lokāloke savistarām U₂ 6 eka cett.] ekam U₂ eva cett.] yeva U₁

XXI.5 [...] The resin, flower [and] fruit are in the seed. This is the extent [of it] by nature. Thus, that [reality] is pure, eternal, unchanging, and immaculate.

XXI.6 [It] is one, [and] not one, self-existing and as a result of its own power it is many things, [as] a modification of five [gross] elements,²⁴⁹ thinking mind, intellect, illusion and individuation.²⁵⁰

XXI.7 Thus, everything is tenfold extending²⁵¹ as far as the Lokāloka[-mountain].²⁵² There is only one. There is nothing else. One who knows this is a knower of truth.

²⁴⁹The term *pañcatattva* refers to the five gross elements. The concept of five gross elements emerging from a supreme god is found in tantric works, cf. e.g. *śivasvarodaya* 6–8: *nirañjano nirākara eko devo maheśvaraḥ | tasmād ākāśam utpannam ākāśād vāyusambhavaḥ || 6 || vayos tejas tataś cāpas tataḥ pṛthvī samudbhavaḥ | etāni pañcatattvāni vistīrṇāni ca pañcadhā || 7 || tebhyo brahmāṇḍam utpannam tair eva parivartate | viliyate ca tatraiva tatraiva ramate punaḥ || 8 ||* “Faultless and without a body is the one god, the great supreme ruler. From him, the ether element (*ākāśa*) originated, and from the ether element, the air element came into existence (6). From the air element, the fire element and from the fire element, the water element and from the water element, the earth element. These five elements unfold in a fivefold manner (7). From these five elements, the universe has arisen, evolves and dissolves. [Then] right here, right there [it] enjoys again (8).”

²⁵⁰In the tantric traditions of Śaivism tenfold *tattva*-systems existed from an very early age, see *goodall2016*. Rāmacandra, as can be seen in the sources of the edition for this passage, is faithful to his source text. However, the exact origin of this specific arrangement of *tattvas* remains unknown. I discussed the system with Dominic Goodall, who has never encountered it. In Rāmacandra’s tenfold system, the one self-existing reality must be counted as the first *tattva*. The term *vikriya* functions as a placeholder for all further modifications of the one self-existing reality. Other *tattva*-systems provide similar concepts like *ahaṃkāravikriya* (“transformations of *ahaṃkāra*”) which refers to lesser *tattvas* like the *jñānendriyas*, *karmendriyas* and *tanmātras*.

²⁵¹The manuscripts read *savistara*, which is nonsensical in this context. Thus, I emended according to the source text’s reading.

²⁵²*birch2013* suggested to understand *lokāloka* as the mythical mountain that divides the visible world from the regions of darkness. See *apte1890practical* (1980: 933).

पृथ्वीवनस्पतिपर्वतेत्यादिस्थावररूपः संसारः । मनुष्यहस्त्यश्वपक्षीत्यादिको ज-
ङ्गमरूपः संसारः । अथ च यो दृष्टिविषयः स दृश्य उच्यते । यो दृष्ट्या न वीक्ष्यते स
अदृश्य इत्युच्यते । एवं संसारस्य स्वात्मनो भेदं दूरीकृत्य ऐक्येन दर्शनं स एव ज्ञा-
नयोगः । तस्य करणात्कालः शरीरनाशं न करोति ॥

Sources: 1–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 836): sthāvarāḥ parvatādyā hi jaṅgamāḥ khecarādayaḥ | jaṅga-
māsthāvarākāraḥ saṃsāraḥ syāt sa īśvaraḥ | svabhāvalilayā bhāti śūnye 'sau śūnyabuddhitaḥ
| yad dṛṣṭam viśayaṃ vastu tad dṛśyam iti kathyate | yo dṛṣṭātitaḥ so 'dṛśyas tadā dṛṣṭam hi
manyate | svatanūbhedaṃ evaṃ tu saṃsāraṃ duḥkhasaṅkulam | yatnād dūraṃ parityajya jñā-
nayogo bhavet sudhīḥ | jñānasamyoga ekas tu ekas tu jñānayogavān | ato hi jñānato 'bhinnam
jñeyam jñānāt prthak prthak | dūrikṛtyaiva mā prthvī bhedavākyaena darśanāt | jñānayogī
bhaved yena jñānayogas tu caikakaḥ | evaṃ jñānān maheśāni kālajit śivatām vrajet |

1 prthvī° cett.] prthivī° JU₁ °vanaspati° EJN₂U₂] vanaśpati P, vanaspati° BDK₁LN₁U₁ °par-
vatetyādīsthāvara° K₁N₁] °parvate 'thyādīsthāvara° N₂, °parvate iyādīsthāvara° U₁, °parvato
tyādīsthāvara° D, °parvato sādīsthāvararūpaḥ J, °parvatādīsthāvara° γ rūpaḥ cett.] rūpā
BL, rūpa N₂ saṃsāraḥ cett.] saṃsāra° EU₁ °hasty aśvapakṣīty ādiko E] °hasttyaś ca
pakṣīty ādiko U₂, °hasteśvapakṣīty ādiko BL, °hastī aśvapakṣīty ādiko DJK₁N₁, °hastipakṣīty
ādiko N₂, °hastī asvapakṣīty ādiko U₁ 1–2 jaṅgama° cett.] jaṅgamaḥ DK₁, jagad° U₁, jaga°
J 2 rūpaḥ cett.] rūpaḥ DK₁, rūpā L saṃsāraḥ cett.] saṃsāro U₁ ca cett.] vā DK₁ yo
cett.] yaḥ JU₁, ya DK₁N₁N₂ dṛṣṭī° cett.] dṛṣṭī° LN₁, daṣṭī° B, dārṣṭī° D dṛṣya cett.] dṛṣyā
J, dṛṣyad N₁, dṛṣy° U₁ dṛṣṭyā cett.] dyā N₂ 3 ity cett.] ty BL, śaty N₂ saṃsārasya cett.]
saṃsāra° PLU₂ svātmano BELP] svātmanaḥ β, svātmanoḥ U₂ bhedam cett.] bheda B,
bhedam DK₁N₁ °kṛtya cett.] °kṛtyam JU₂, °kṛty E aikyena P] aikam eva E, aikyona BLP,
ekona J, ekyena DK₁N₁, ekena N₂, ekānta U₁, ek++ U₂ sa eva E] om. cett. 3–4 jñānayogaḥ
cett.] jñānayoga U₂, jñānayogaḥ || cha || J 4 tasya cett.] gatasya U₁ karaṇāt cett.] karaṇāt EP,
dhyānakaraṇāt JU₁ kālaḥ cett.] kāla° U₁ na cett.] om. K₁N₂U₂

The stationary circuit of mundane existence consists of the earth, trees, mountains, etc. The moving circuit of mundane existence consists of humans, elephants, horses, birds, etc. Now, that which is the object of sight is called the visible. That which is not seen by sight is called the invisible. In this way, through the vision of unity, the distinction of one's self from the circuit of mundane existence is to be removed. Only this is Jñānayoga. From the execution of this, time [as death] does not bring about the destruction of the body.²⁵³

²⁵³Rāmacandra's prose following XXI.7 picks up the preceding verses' metaphysical non-dualism and elaborates supposedly his soteriological exposition of Jñānayoga. By distinguishing between the stationary and moving "circuits" of existence (earth, mountains, trees versus humans, animals, etc.) and between the visible and invisible domains, he delineates the full scope of *samsāra* as a unified field of experience. The yogin's task is to dissolve the imagined boundary between self and this totality—"through the vision of unity" (*ekadarśana*)—so that perceiver and perceived are no longer opposed. In this realization, all beings and visible and invisible phenomena are apprehended as expressions of one and the same reality, Śaṃbhu. Hence, Jñānayoga is not merely an intellectual affirmation of oneness but a contemplative practice of erasing dualistic perception. The final statement, that "time [as death] does not bring about the destruction of the body," implies liberation from temporal identification: once unity is realised, *kāla* loses its power to destroy, for the knower no longer identifies with the perishable body but with the timeless self.

[XXII. svabhāvabhedam]

इदानीं स्वभावभेदं कथ्यते। यथा वटबीजं वटरूपेण परिणमते स तद्वशाद्वा भेदं स्वभावत एव प्राप्नोति। मूलाङ्कुरत्वगुणदण्डशाखाकलिकापल्लवपुष्पफलस्नेहा इति द-
शभेदान् प्राप्नोति। तथा निर्मलो निर्विकारः निरञ्जन एक एतादृश आत्मस्वभावा-
देव पृथ्व्यापतेजोवाय्वाकाशमनोबुद्धिमायाविकाररूपभेदान् प्राप्नोति। ज्ञानयोग-
प्रभावादेक एव आत्मा इति निश्चयो भवति।

Sources: 2–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 836): svabhāvabhedam etat śṛṇu devi prayatnataḥ | yac chrutvā sarvabodhaḥ syāt muktidaḥ siddhivāñchitaḥ | ātmano vā pṛthivyādyāḥ svabhāvaḥ kiñcid ucyate |

2 *idānim* cett.] *idāni* B *svabhāva*° cett.] *svābhāva*° BL, *tasya* E °*bhedam* DJK₁N₁] °*bheda* N₂, °*bhedāḥ* U₁, *bhedāḥ* E, °*bhedāḥ* BLP_U₂ *vaṭa*° cett.] *vatha*° N₂ °*bijam* cett.] °*bijam* E, °*bija*° U₂, °*bijena* BL *vaṭarūpeṇa* cett.] *rūpeṇa* BL *pariṇamate* BLU₂] *pariṇāte* P, *pariṇatam* βE *sa tad* em.] *sa* tat JU₁, *sa* tu N₂, *sat* N₁, *sat* EP, *sa* ta K₁, *śata* BL, *sa* DU₂ *daśadhā* cett.] *dṛśadhā* P, *dasat* U₂ *bhedam* cett.] *om.* U₂ 3 *svabhāvata* cett.] *svabhāva* BL, *om.* U₂ *eva* cett.] *om.* U₂ *prāpnoti* cett.] *prāpnoti* BLU₁ *mūlāṅkura*° DEN₂] *mūla* *aṅkura*° JP, *mūlām* *aṅkura*° BL, *mūlām* *aṅkura*° N₁U₁, *mūla* *aṅkura*° K₁, *om.* U₂ °*tvag*° E] °*tvak*° cett., *om.* U₂ °*daṇḍa*° EN₁] °*daṇḍa*° cett. °*śākhā*° cett.] °*śākhām* DK₁N₁N₂ °*kalikā*° cett.] °*kilpikā*° P, °*kilakālā*° B, °*kilā*° L °*pallava*° cett.] °*pallavā* P, °*pallavā* || BL, *om.* U₂ °*puṣpaphalasnehā* cett.] °*puṣpaphalasneha* JK₁PN₁N₂U₁, *puṣpaphalasneham* D, *vistāro* *yam* *svābhāvataḥ* BL, *om.* U₂ *iti* cett.] *om.* U₂ 3–4 *daśabhedān* BLP] *bhedo* *daśadhā* β, *om.* U₂ 4 *prāpnoti* cett.] *prāpnotiti* P, *om.* U₂ *tathā* cett.] *yathā* EU₂ *nirmalo* BEL] *nirmalaḥ* βPU₂ *nirañjana* E] *nirañjanaḥ* cett. *eka* cett.] *ekah* JK₁N₁N₂U₁ *etādṛśa* E] *etādṛśaḥ* JK₁N₁N₂U₁ 4–5 *ātmasvabhāvād* cett.] *ātmā* *svabhāvād* E 5 *pṛthvy*° BLPN₁U₂] *pṛthivy*° E, *pṛthvi*° DN₂, *pṛth*° U₁ °*āpatejo*° BLN₁] °*apatejo*° K₁, °*aptejo*° EU₂, °*etetejo*° P, °*pate*° DN₂, °*akte*° U₁ °*vāyvakāśa*° E] °*vādvayakāśa*° BP, °*vāybākāśa*° LN₁, °*vāyyakāśa*° U₂, °*vākāśa*° K₁, °*jīvikāśa*° DN₂, °*jīvayuvakāśa*° U₁ °*manobuddhi*° γN₁] °*manobuddhir*° DK₁JN₂U₁ °*māyā*° cett.] °*māyāyā*° U₁ °*rūpabhedān* EJK₁N₁U₂] *rūpabhedāt* DN₂PU₁, *rūpabhedāna* BL 5–6 *jñānayogaprabhāvād* EU₂] *jñānayogabhavāt* β, *jñānayogaḥ* || *prabhāvād*° BL, *jñānayogaḥ* *prabhāvād* P 6 *eva* cett.] *eka* BLP, *yeva* U₁

[XXII. Distinction of the nature]

Now, the nature of the self and its distinction²⁵⁴ is described. Just as the seed of the banyan tree transforms into the shape of the banyan tree—[and] thus attains the tenfold distinction—‘root, shoot, bark, branch, twig, bud, the unfolding flower, flower, fruit and resin’—by virtue of its nature, in the same way, the pure, unchanging, immaculate one attains such [a distinction] precisely because of the nature of the self—[namely], the various forms and modifications of earth, water, fire, wind, space, mind, intellect, illusion, [and individuation.]²⁵⁵ As a result of the power of Jñānayoga, the conviction arises that ‘the self is only one’.

²⁵⁴The term *svabhāvabheda* appears in philosophical systems to signify the division or distinction of essential natures. For a Buddhist example, see balcerowicz2011dharmakīrti. In some Nyāya texts, the term is picked up to refer to different essential properties of the self, see ogawa2023perception. In the *Netratantantra*, the term *bhāvabheda* occurs frequently in a similar sense as in this passage of the *Tattvayogabindu*. For example cf. *Netratantantra* 16.20–21: *bhaviṣyanti mahādevi kaliḥ kaṣṭatara yataḥ | tadarthaṃ paramārtho 'yaṃ mayā te prakāṭikṛtaḥ | paramārthaḥ paratvena mṛtyujit sarvatomukhaḥ | bhāvabhedenā yaṣṭav yo mokṣasiddhim abhīpsatā* | Here, however, the context is unphilosophical and specifically intended to signify the phenomenological distinction of the self.

²⁵⁵Rāmacandra's tenfold taxonomy of *tattvas* may seem inconsistent at the first sight. It is probable, however, that *ahankāra* was lost in the course of the text's transmission given its inclusion in the list of the previous section. Perhaps the discovery of new textual witnesses of the text will solve this problem in the future. None of the tenfold *tattva*-systems known to me correspond exactly to Rāmacandra's system. Taxonomies of *tattvas* such as kaushik1993 7.4, in which Kṛṣṇa presents a list of eight divisions of *prakṛti*, are almost identical (*bhūmir āpo 'nalo vāyuḥ khaṃ mano buddhir eva cha | ahankāra itiyam me bhinnā prakṛtir aṣṭadhā* ||7.4||). “Earth, water, fire, air, space, mind, intellect and ego—these are the eight divisions of original nature.” In this list we find most of the elements of Rāmacandra's list, except for the term *māyā*. The description of *kuṇḍalini* in yajnavalkya 4.21 incorporates this system. Another system of ten *tattvas* appears in *Uttarasūtra* 1.9–1.13 of nishvasa2015 where the tenfold nature of Sadāśiva is homologised with the *mantra*. Here the following list is given: *prakṛti*, *puruṣa*, *niyati*, *kāla*, *māyātattva*, *vidyā*, *Īśvara*, *Sadāśiva*, *dehavyāpin* and *Śakti*, see goodall2016. There is no similarity between the two tenfold *tattva* systems. However, ...

यथैकैकः पृथ्वी क्वचित्कोमलरूपा ॥ क्वचित्मनोहररूपा ॥ क्वचित्परिमलरूपयुक्ता
 ॥ क्वचित्परिमलरहिता ॥ क्वचित्सुवर्णरूपा ॥ क्वचित्त्रूप्यरूपा ॥ क्वचिद्व्रतमयी ॥
 क्वचित्श्वेता ॥ क्वचित्कृष्णा ॥ क्वचिद्रक्ता ॥ क्वचित्पीता ॥ क्वचित्कर्बुरा ॥ क्वचि-
 ज्ञानाविधफलरूपा ॥ क्वचित्पुष्परूपा ॥ क्वचिदमृतमयी ॥ स्वभावत एव भवति ॥
 5 तथैवात्मा मनुष्यपक्षिहरिणहस्तीविद्याधरगन्धर्वकिन्नरमहापण्डितमहामूर्खरोग्य-
 रोगीक्रोधीशान्तरूपः स्वभावादेव भवति ॥ ज्ञानयोगाद्विकाररूपरहितो ज्ञायते ॥

Sources: 1-6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 836-837): ātmaiva pṛthivī dhātṛi komalā ca kvacid ṛḍḍhā | kvacin manoharā sā ca vimalā ca malāmālā | durgandhā ca sugandhā ca nirgandhā gandhamohinī | svarṇarūpā dhātūrūpā citrā ratnamayī parā | kvacit śvetā kvacid raktā kvacit pītā ca kṛṣṇalā | ūrvarā ūrvarā sā tu viśāṃṛtamayī sadā | tathā ca devagandharvakinnarādyāḥ khagādayaḥ | sukhāsampiṇḍito roḡi tathāiva krodhaśāntadhīḥ | aśeṣarūpabalito nānābuddhirataḥ svayam | devatattvaṃ bhūtaśaktyā jīvasaṃjñā bhramātmikā | jñānayogī nirvikāro nistāpa eka īśvaraḥ | ātmaikamūrttimān bhūtvā nirvikalpo nirañjanaḥ | sukhī duḥkhī mohayukto 'nantacetāḥ svabhāvataḥ |

1 yathaikaikaḥ em.] yathaikaiva E, yathā ekaika BLP_{U2}, yathā ekaiva DJK₁N₁, yathā ekaṃ ca N₂, yathā ekai ca U₁ pṛthvī γ] pṛthivī β kvacit komala cett.] om. J °rūpā γ] °rūpa DK₁N₁N₂U₁, om. J kvacit cett.] om. EJP_{U1} °hararūpā B] °hararūpāḥ L, °hararūpa U₂, °harā DK₁N₁N₂, om. EJP_{U1} kvacit cett.] om. EJP_{U1} °parimala cett.] om. EJP_{U1} °rūpayuktā BL] °rūpāyuktā DN₁, °rūpayuta K₁, °rūpāyuktaḥ N₂, om. EJP_{U1} 2 kvacit cett.] om. JPU₁ °parimāla cett.] °parimalarūpa° E, om. PJU₁ °rahitā ELN₁] °rohitā BK₁N₂U₂, om. DPU₁ kvacit cett.] om. JPU₁ suvarṇarūpā EK₁LN₂U₂] suvarṇarūpa BD, khavarṇakupa U₁, varṇa++pā J, om. P kvacit cett.] om. BLP rūpyarūpā JK₁N₁U₁] raupyarūpā E, rūpyarūpa DN₂, rajatarūpā U₂, om. BLP ratnamayī cett.] ratnamai BLP, raktamayim J 3 kvacit cett.] kvacit ca E, om. P śvetā DJEU₂] śveta K₁N₁N₂U₁, śvetarūpā L, śverūpā B, om. P °kṛṣṇā cett.] °kṛṣṇa N₁, °rakta K₁, om. EP kvacid raktā BELU₂] kvacid rakta DJK₁N₁N₂U₁, kvacitkṛṣṇa K₁, om. P kvacit pītā cett.] om. P kvacit karburā cett.] kvacit karpurā JU₁, om. P 3-4 kvacin cett.] kvacit JU₂, om. P 4 nānāvidhaphalarūpā cett.] nānāvidhophalarūpā U₁, nānāvidharūpā E, om. P kvacit BJL] kvacid DK₁N₁U₁, kvacir U₂, om. PN₂ puṣparūpā DN₁] viṣarūpā BEL, viṣarūpā U₂, viṣarūpa K₁, om. JU₁P kvacid cett.] kvacit U₂, om. JU₁ amṛtamayī cett.] amṛtarūpamayī E, amṛtamai BL, om. JU₁ svabhāvata cett.] om. JU₁ eva cett.] om. JU₁ bhavati cett.] bhavataḥ BL, om. JU₁ 5 tathaivātmā γ] tathātmā DK₁N₁N₂U₁, om. J manuṣya° cett.] om. JU₁ °pakṣi° cett.] pakṣi || K₁, om. JU₁ °hariṇa° cett.] °hariṇā° P, om. JU₁ °hasti° DK₁N₁] hasti cett., om. JU₁ °vidyādhara° cett.] °vidyādhara || K₁ °kinnara° cett.] kiṃnara || K₁ °paṇḍita° cett.] piṇḍata B, paṇḍita || J °mūrkha° cett.] °rmūkha° P, mūrkha || J, °mūrva° DN₁, °mūrṣa° K₁U₁ 5-6 rogyarogī em.] °rogyarogī E, °roḡi aroḡi DJN₁N₂U₁U₂, °roḡi || aroḡi || K₁, °roḡi BLP 6 °krodhi° cett.] °krodhi° EP, krodhi K₁, °krodha° BL °śānta° cett.] °dhiśānta° BL °rūpaḥ cett.] °rūpāḥ PL, °rūpa β svabhāvād eva cett.] evaṃ svabhāvaṃ U₁, evaṃ J bhavati cett.] bhavati BL, bhati N₁, dharati JU₁ °yogād vikāra JN₁U₁] °yogadhikāra cett. jñāyate cett.] jñāyate || cha || J, jāyate U₂

Just as the single soil at some places appears soft, at some places beautiful, at some places is endowed with fragrance, at some places without fragrance, at some places [the earth is] gold, at some places silver, at some places [it contains] gems,²⁵⁶ at some places, appears white, at some places black, at some places red, at some places yellow, at some places appears in variegated colour, at some places like various fruit, at some places like flowers, at some places like a liquid, [and that] only because of its nature.

In the same way, the self also takes the form of a human, a bird, a deer, an elephant, a Vidyādhara, a Gandharva, a centaur, a great scholar or a great fool, a sick or healthy person, an angry or peaceful person, by virtue of its inherent nature. Through Jñānayoga [the self] without the change of form is known.

since Rājayoga is rooted in ancient Śaivism (see [birch2019saiva](#)), and Rāmacandra usually tends to present simplified and transsectarian systems, the choice of a tenfold *tattva*-system could be considered as a remnant of these ancient systems.

²⁵⁶The description of the soil at this point is not clear. The coloured soil mentioned next suggests a soil in golden colour, silver colour and the colour of precious stones. However, the parallel formulations in the *Yogasvarodaya* (i.e. *svarṇarūpā dhātūrūpā citrā ratnamayī parā*) instead suggest soil containing the metals or precious stones in question.

यथा फलस्योत्पत्तिस्थानमेकमेव भवति । अथ च फलस्य गतिर्बहुधा दृश्यते । एकं फलं पृथ्वीमध्ये पतति । शुष्कं भवति । एकस्य फलस्य मकरन्दं भ्रमरः पिबति । एकस्य फलस्य मालां कामिनी तुङ्गकुचमण्डलोपरि दधाति । एकं फलं मृतमनुष्योपरि क्षिप्यते । अयं वस्तुनः स्वभावः । तथा एक एवात्मा स्वीयभावादेवाष्टौ भोगान्भुनक्ति । के तेऽष्टौ भोगाः ॥

सुवासश्च सुवस्त्रञ्च सुशय्या सुनितंबिनी ।
सुस्थाता चान्नपानान्यष्टौ भोगाः सुधिषणम् ॥ XXII.I ॥

Sources: 1–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 837): *striṣumpūrī mahān so hi parasparavimohitaḥ | amanaskaḥ svīyabhāvāt jñānayogī nirākulaḥ | sraccandanādivāmāsu svabhāvād bhogam icchukaḥ |*

1 *phalasyotpatti* cett.] *plakṣasyotpattiḥ* E, *phalasyautpatti* K₁ °*sthānam* cett.] *sthānam* E, °*sthāna* U₁ **ekam** cett.] *eka* K₁, *ekas* D, *eva* N₂, *om.* E *eva* cett.] *kam* *eva* N₂, *om.* K₁ **bhavati** cett.] *bhavati* B, *ti* U₁ **gatiḥ** cett.] *gati* K₁, *PN*₂ U₁ **ekam** cett.] *eka*° U₂, *eva* N₂ **2 phalam** cett.] *phala*° DK₁, *N*₁, *N*₂ **prṥthivī**° cett.] *prṥthivi*° U₁ **śuṣkaṁ** [K₁, *LU*₁, *U*₂] *śuklaṁ* cett. **bhavati** cett.] *bhavati* B, *bhavati* || *cha* || J **phalasya** cett.] *om.* PL **makarandaṁ** [ELPN₂, *U*₁, *U*₂] *makaraṁda*° K₁, *LN*₁, *makaraṁdaḥ* J, *karaṁdaṁ* B **bhramaraḥ** cett.] *bhramaraṁ* BL, *bhramara* N₂ **pibati** cett.] *pibaṁti* P, *pibati* B **3 phalasya** cett.] *phalasyaṁ* N₂ **mālāṁ** cett.] *mālā*° N₂ **kāminī** cett.] *kāminī* DJ **tuṅga**° cett.] *tuṅg*° U₁ **dadhāti** cett.] *dadhāṇi* N₁, *dadhovati* N₂ **ekam phalam** γ] *ekaphalaṁ* β **4 kṣīpyate** cett.] *kṣāpyate* B **eka** cett.] *ekam* U₂ **evātmā** cett.] *eva ātmā* U₂ **svīyabhāvād** cett.] *svīdhabhāvād* K₁, *svabhāvād* BL **evāṣṭau** cett.] *evāṣtau* N₂, *U*₁, *evāṣṭa* U₂ **4–5 bhogān** cett.] *bhogāt* N₂, *U*₁, *bhogāt* K₁ **5 bhunakti** cett.] *ābhunakti* N₁ **ke te** cett.] *om.* BL **’ṣṭau** cett.] *aṣṭau* BL, *ṣṭe* U₁ **bhogāḥ** cett.] *bhogauḥ* P, *bhogā* U₁, *U*₂ **6 suvāsaś ca** cett.] *suvāsaś ca* B **suvāstrañ ca** E] *suvāsaś ca* U₂, *om.* cett. **suśayyā** cett.] *suśayyā ca* U₁, *suśayyāḥ* BL, *suśayyā unm.* P **sunitāmbinī** cett.] *sunitāmbinīḥ* P, *su* || *nittāmbinī* J, *sunitavinita* U₁ **7 susthātā** em.] *susthātāś* DN₁, *U*₁, *susthānāś* PLN₂, *susthānaḥ* E, *sudehaṁ* U₂ **cānnapānāny** L] *vānnapānāny* B, *cānnapānāni* E, *cānpanānp*° P, *cāmapanasya*° N₁, *cānmanasya*° DK₁, *N*₂, *cānnapānaḥ* syād° U₁, *sukhasaṁtānaṁ* U₂ **aṣṭau bhogāḥ sudhiṣaṇam** em.] °*ṣṭau* *bhogāḥ* *sudhiṣaṇa*° D, °*ṣṭau* *bhogāḥ* || *sudhiṣaṇa* K₁, °*ṣṭau* *bhogāḥ* || *sudhiṣaṇāṁ* J, *aṣṭau* *bhogāḥ* *sudhiṣaṇāṁ* U₁, *aṣṭau* *bhogāś* *cā* *sudhimatām* BL, *ṣṭau* *bhogāḥ* *sudhipaṇa*° N₁, *aṣṭau* *bhogāś* *ca* *dhimatām* EP, *aṣṭau* *bhogāḥ* *sudhiyane* N₂, *abhayādicāṣṭakaṁ* U₂

Just as the place of origin of the fruit is only one, but the fruit's destiny is seen as manifold—one fruit falls to the ground and dries up; a bee drinks one fruit's juice; a woman places a garland made of one fruit over her voluptuous bosom; one fruit is placed upon a dead person — that is the own nature of the thing. In the same way, the one self enjoys eight enjoyments due to its own nature.²⁵⁷ What are the eight enjoyments?²⁵⁸

XXII.1 A good perfume, fine clothing, a good bed, a beautiful woman and a good charioteer,²⁵⁹ food, drink, [and a] good dwelling-place. Those are the eight enjoyments.

²⁵⁷Rāmacandra demonstrates that it is perfectly natural for an *ātman* to enjoy the eight pleasures. To illustrate this, he uses a random everyday object as an example. With this everyday object, the fruit, different experiences, and actions are naturally produced by different actors, although they all have a single origin—the fruit. In the same way, there is only one self, as Rāmacandra explained earlier, and it naturally manifests as different beings and experiences different things. The phenomenon Rāmacandra wants to address with this example is that it is natural for the one *ātman* to enjoy the eight enjoyments described in the following verse and the prose section on the next page.

²⁵⁸The origin of the *aṣṭau bhogaḥ* is uncertain. However, the term is mentioned as one of the results of Rājayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* in which Sundardās takes Rājayoga as that which is commonly known to be *vajrolīmudrā*. Cf. *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.16: *disai saṃga pūni muktā | aṣṭa prakāra bhoga kau bhuktā | pāpa puṇya kachu parasai nāṃhīm | jaisaiṃ kamala rahai jala māṃhīm* || 16 || In the *Mānasollāsa* of King Someśvara, one finds the mention of twenty royal *upabhogas*, which, however, include all of the eight pleasures in greater detail, cf. *manasollasa*. This alludes to the possibility of an exceptionally wealthy lifestyle for Rāmacandra's audience mentioned in section I.

²⁵⁹Several plausible readings exist for the fifth element among the eight pleasures. The reading *sudeham*, as an outsider, is probably a later correction. Moreover, although *susthānam* ("a good site") would be a simple and plausible solution, the stemma suggests the reading *susthātā* ("a good charioteer"). This word has only survived in an incorrect grammatical form and needs to be corrected. This choice is supported, among other things, by the fact that a total of eight pleasures must be mentioned in this verse, which is only possible if the last word of the fourth *pāda* is read as *sudhiṣaṇam* ("a good dwelling-place"), which makes the reading *susthānam* redundant. Additionally, Rāmacandra himself introduces a horse as one of the eight enjoyments in the following paragraph of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Thus, *susthātā* as an element related to vehicles is plausible.

पट्टसूत्रमयानि वस्त्राणि १ ॥ पञ्च वा सप्त वा शालिकायुक्तानि हर्म्याणि २ ॥ अति-
विपुला मृदूत्तरच्छदवती शय्या ३ ॥ पद्मिनी तारुण्यवती मनोहरा गुणवती तत्रोपवि-
ष्टा कान्ता ४ ॥ साध्वासनम् ५ ॥ अतिमूल्योऽश्वश्च ६ ॥ मनोरममन्त्रम् ७ ॥ तथाविधं
पानम् ८ ॥ एतेऽष्टौ भोगाः कथिताः । एते दुःखं भजन्ते । भिक्षां याचन्ते च ।

Sources: 1–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 837): ātmāvivekam āgamyā calac cittam mahākulam | viṣayānd-
hatamo dṛṣṭvā no vetti paramātmanah | amāyātmā tattvātītaḥ satsandhānavarjitaḥ |
sukhi duḥkhi janmamṛtyuṃ yāti satyaṃ punaḥ punaḥ | vairāgyādīdhanam tyaktvā viṣavad
duḥkhakṛddhiyah | koṭisūryasamātmēti jñānayogād vimucyate |

1 paṭṭa° DJK₁EN₁N₂] paṭa° BLU₂, pada° PU₁ °sūtra° cett.] °sūtrā° BL °mayāni cett.] °yāni
DN₁N₂ **vastrāṇi** EJK₁PL] vasrāṇi cett. **pañca vā sapta vā** β] pañcasaptā EP, pañcasatyā
BL **śālikā** em.] dṛālikā EN₁, dṛāmlikā D, dadhikā P, dātikā BL, dālikā JU₁, tālikā N₂, ṭṭā-
likā K₁ **yuktāni** cett.] saudhāni U₂ **harmyāṇi** β] harmyāṇi teṣu vāstu LB, harmyāṇi teṣu
vāsaḥ E, harmyāṇi teṣu cāsaḥ P, harmyāṇi vāsāya kecit U₂ **1–2 ativipulā°** cett.] ativapulā°
DJK₁N₁, ativipulām U₁, aṣṭau bhogān āha || U₂ **2 mṛdūttara°** em.] mṛdutarā° BELP, mṛdu |
uttara° β, sugrahaṃ || U₂ **°chadavati°** PJK₁] °chandavati° DN₁N₂, °chadavati° U₁, suvastraṃ ||
U₂ **°śayyā** cett.] suṣayā sūtri U₂ **padmini°** cett.] padmanī N₁, om. U₂ **tāruṇyavati°** em.]
tāruṇyavati BDEK₁LN₁N₂P, tāruṇvati J, tārūrāyavati N₂, om. U₂ **guṇavati°** cett.] guṇavati J
2–3 tatropaviṣṭā EJK₁] tatopaviṣṭā P, tatropavistā β, tatrāpavistā B, om. U₂ **3 kāntā** BELP]
om. cett. **sādhvāsanam** J] sādhu āsanam E, sādhu āsanam BLPU₂, sādhyāsanam DK₁N₁N₂U₁
atimūlyo 'śvaś ca em.] amūlyo svaś ca β, atimūlyāñ ca E, atimūlo 'śvaḥ P, atimūlyo asvaṃ
BL, suśvaḥ U₂ **manoramam** cett.] manoramyam B, manoramyam L, suṣṭu U₂ **3–4 vid-
ham pānam** cett.] vidhapānam BLN₂, vidhayānam U₂ **4 ete** cett.] rāte U₁ **'ṣṭau** γ] aṣṭau
β **bhogāḥ** cett.] bhogā N₁N₂, ghogā U₁ **kathitāḥ** EU₂] kathitā P, kathyante DJK₁, kathyate
N₁N₂U₁, om. BL **ete** DN₂U₁] eke EJK₁PN₁, eka BL, ekaṃ U₂ **duḥkham** cett.] duḥkha P,
duḥkhā BL, duḥkhataṃ N₂ **bhajante** cett.] bhajate N₂]U₁ **bhikṣām** E]PN₂U₁] bhikṣyām
DK₁N₁, bhikṣā BLU₂ **yācante** cett.] yāmcānte P, yāmcate BL, yācate N₂, pācate U₁ **ca** cett.]
kiñca E

²⁶⁰1. Clothes made from silk thread;²⁶¹ 2. Mansions endowed with five or seven rooms.²⁶² 3. A very large bed with a soft and lovely blanket;²⁶³ 4. [on which] there is seated a wife belonging to the Padmini-class²⁶⁴ of women—youthful, beautiful and virtuous;²⁶⁵ 5. An excellent seat;²⁶⁶ 6. An exceptionally valuable horse;²⁶⁷ 7. Appetising food;²⁶⁸ 8. Similarly [tasty] drinks.²⁶⁹ The eight enjoyments have been described. They impart suffering. And [they] require begging.²⁷⁰

²⁶⁰The comparison with the corresponding passage in the source text reveals once again Rāmacandra's positivist and anti-ascetic approach to wealth and sensual pleasures in his Rājayoga.

²⁶¹Within the twenty *upabhoga*s of the *Mānasollāsa* there is the topic of *Vastropabhoga* ("enjoyment of garments"). Particularly in summer, the king is asked to wear silk or cotton clothes which are thin and charming, cf. *manasollasa*.

²⁶²The first *adhyāya* of the third *viṃśati* of the *Mānasollāsa* discusses astrology for finding out auspicious moments while building new houses for princes. The section describes houses with one to four *śālās*, cf. *manasollasa*.

²⁶³This is found as *Śayyābhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. The section describes seven kinds of beds and eight kinds of bed-steads, cf. *manasollasa*.

²⁶⁴Cf. *ratirahasya*, Ed. p. 6.

²⁶⁵This is resembled as *yoṣidupabhoga* ("enjoyment of young women") within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this chapter, King Someśvara describes the qualifications of women a king should marry. The two most important qualities he gives are beauty and full youth. Out of the four kinds of women: (a) Padminī, (b) Citriṇī, (c) Śaṅkhinī, and (d) Hastinī, he suggests that the latter two kinds are not worth enjoying, cf. *manasollasa*.

²⁶⁶The *āsanopabhoga* ("the enjoyment of seats") within the *Mānasollāsa* describes various kinds of royal seats, cf. *manasollasa*.

²⁶⁷This is resembled as *yānopabhoga* ("enjoyment of vehicles") within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this section, King Someśvara lists nine kinds of vehicles, including horses, cf. *manasollasa*.

²⁶⁸This is resembled as *annabhoga* ("enjoyment of food") within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this section, King Someśvara describes the names of various kinds of delicious food and the directions as to the preparations of various dishes, cf. *manasollasa*.

²⁶⁹Drinks are the subject of the *pāṇīyabhoga* ("enjoyment of drinks") section within the *Mānasollāsa*. This section describes everything related to drinking and drinks, cf. *manasollasa*.

²⁷⁰To the genre connoisseur, the sentence "*bhikṣāṃ yācante ca* ["initially seems ...

यथा सूर्यस्य तेजः ॥ दुग्धस्य घृतम् ॥ अग्नेर्दाहः ॥ विषान्मूर्छा ॥ तिलात्तैलम् ॥
वृक्षाच्छाया ॥ फलात्परिमलः ॥ काष्ठादग्निः ॥ शार्करादिभ्यो मधुरो रसः ॥ हि-
मानीभ्यः शैत्यम् ॥ इत्यादिपदार्थस्वभाव एव ॥ तथा संसारोऽपि परमेश्वरस्वरू-
पमध्ये तिष्ठति । परमेश्वरोऽखण्डपरिपूर्णश्च ॥

5

[XXIII. *bāhyalakṣyam*]

इदानीं बाह्यलक्ष्यं कथ्यते । नासाग्रादारभ्याङ्गुलचतुष्टयप्रमाणं नीलाकारं तेजःपू-
र्णमाकाशलक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम् ।

Sources: 1-4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 837): ravi tejo ghr̥taṃ dugdhe tile tailaṃ svabhāvataḥ | śāsaṃ indau kule śākhaṃ kṣāre ca lavaṇaṃ yathā | tathā brahmaṇi saṃsāro hy akhaṇḍaparipūrvake | 6-7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 837): idāniṃ bāhyalakṣāṇi siddhidāni śṛṇu priye | dhāraṇākhyā tu caitāni jñātavyāni viśeṣataḥ | līlayā bhāvayel līnaṃ jyotiḥpūrṇaṃ mahāparam | 6-7 cf. SSP 2.28 (Ed. p. 39): atha bahirlakṣyaṃ kathyate | nāsāgrād bahiraṅgulacatuṣṭaye nilajyotiḥsaṃkāśaṃ lakṣayet |

1 *sūryasya* cett.] *sūryaś* ca U₁ *tejaḥ* cett.] *tejāḥ* BL *dugdhasya* cett.] *dugdha°* BL, *dusya* N₂, *dugdhasy* U₁ *ghr̥taṃ* cett.] *ghr̥taḥ* BLP *agner* E] *agne* cett. *dāhaḥ* em.] *dahaṃ* J, *dvāhaḥ* BLP, *dahiḥ* N₁K₁, *dadhi* N₂, *dadhiḥ* D, *dārhaṃ* U₁, *dāhiḥ* U₂, *jvalanaṃ* E *viśān* cett.] *viśāt* JU₁ *tilāt* cett.] *tilitāt* P, *tila* N₂, *tilā* U₁ 2 *vṛkṣāt* E]N₁] *vṛkṣāt* P, *vṛkṣā* BDK₁LN₂U₂, *vṛkṣā* U₁ *phalāt* cett.] *phalā* BL *parimalaḥ* cett.] *sarimalaḥ* BL, *palāt* *parimalaḥ* DK₁ *kāṣṭhād* cett.] *kāṣṭhād* PU₂, *kaṣṭhād* BL *agniḥ* γ] *āgniḥ* DK₁N₁N₂U₁ *śārkarādibhyo* em.] *śarkarādibhyo* DJK₁N₁N₂U₁U₂, *arkarādibhyo* E, *śarkvarādibhyo* P, *śarkadibhyo* BL *rasaḥ* cett.] *om.* BL 2-3 *himānibhyaḥ* cett.] *sahimānibhyaḥ* BL, *himānitpa* N₂ 3 *śaityaṃ* DJK₁U₁] *śaityāṃ* N₁, *śityaṃ* U₂, *śaityāś* N₂, *śitaṃ* EP, *śitaḥ* BL *ityādipadārthasvabhāva* DJK₁N₁P] *ityādipadārthā°* U₂, *ityādipadārthāsvabhāvataḥ* B, *atyādipadārtharthasvabhāva* N₂, *ityādisvabhāvaḥ* U₁, *ityādipadārthāḥ* *svabhāvataḥ* L, *ityādipadārthānām* *svabhāvaḥ* E *eva* cett.] *evā* N₁, *ravaḥ* U₁, *om.* E *tathā* cett.] *tathā* vā U₁ 3-4 *parameśvarasvarūpamadye* cett.] *paremesvara svarūpasya madhye* BL, *parameśvararūpamadye* U₁ 4 *tiṣṭhāti* cett.] *tiṣṭhāti* B, *tiṣṭhamti* U₂ *'khaṇḍa°* cett.] *'saṃḍa°* DK₁N₁, *yarānda°* N₂, *khaṇḍaḥ* JU₁ *'paripūrṇaś* ca cett.] *paripūrṇaḥ* E 6 *bāhyalakṣyaṃ* K₁P] *lakṣyaṃ* E, *bāhyalakṣa* BL, *bāhyalakṣaṃ* N₁, *bāhyalakṣaṇa* DN₂, *bāhyalakṣyaḥ* JU₁, *lakṣaṇaṃ* U₂ *catuṣṭaya°* cett.] *catuṣṭayaṃ* BL *nilākāraṃ* cett.] *nilākaraṃ* BLP, *nirākāraṃ* N₂ *tejaḥ°* cett.] *teja°* DK₁N₁N₂, *jaḥ°* B 6-7 *pūrṇaṃ* cett.] *pūrṇakāṃ* U₂ 7 *ākāśa°* cett.] *ākāśaṃ* E]PLU₁ *lakṣyaṃ* E]PU₁U₂] *lakṣaṃ* BDK₁LN₁, *lakṣaṇaṃ* N₂

Just like the rays of the sun, the ghee of milk, the burning of fire, the stupor from poison, the sesame oil from the sesame seed, the shade from the tree, the sweet odour from a fruit, the fire from a wood log, the sweet taste of sugary things, the cold from piles of snow, etc., is the nature of the thing. In the same way, the circuit of mundane existence is within the highest God's nature. Moreover, the highest God is indivisible and complete.

[XXIII. The outer focus]

Now, the outer focus is taught. Beginning at four finger breadths from the tip of the nose, the space element, appearing blue and being full of splendour, shall be made into the focus.

suspiciously strange and suggests a corruption of the text. However, the passage is well preserved in the β and γ -group. The subject of the sentence is undoubtedly the *aṣṭau bhogāḥ*. Nevertheless, this statement is aimed at the practitioner. If one takes the transmission of the manuscripts seriously, the question arises as to who would beg for the eight pleasures specified above. A travelling ascetic or mendicant would ask for food and drink, but certainly not for silk clothes, women, expensive horses, etc. The average householder may aspire to this, but the phrase *yācante* still seems inappropriate and overshoots the mark. Above all, there is no logical answer as to who exactly would be begged for such valuable objects and women. This statement can, therefore, only be aimed at members of the royal court. The only one able to grant such costly requests can be someone extremely rich or a king himself. This observation perfectly suits the initial definition of Rājayoga (cf. I. ll. 1–2, p. 102) in which it is defined as a practice that works even if the practitioner is leading an exuberant wealthy lifestyle.

अथवा नासाग्रादारभ्य षडङ्गुलप्रमाणं पवनतत्त्वं धूम्राकारं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। अथवा नासाग्रादारभ्याष्टाङ्गुलप्रमाणमतिरक्तं तेजोलक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। अथवा नासाग्रादारभ्य दशाङ्गुलप्रमाणं शुक्लं चञ्चलमुदकं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। अथवा नासाग्रादारभ्य द्वादशाङ्गुलप्रमाणं पीतवर्णं पृथ्वीतत्त्वं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। अथवा नासाग्रादारभ्य कोटिसूर्य-
 5 समप्रभं तेजःपूर्णमाकाशतत्त्वं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। आकाशमध्ये आकाशोपरि वा दृष्टिं कृत्वा ध्यानकारणात्सूर्यं विना सूर्यसंबन्धिनीं सहस्रकिरणावलीं पश्यति।

Sources: 1–6 cf. YSv (PT. p. 837): athavā tatra deveśi dhūmrākāraṃ ṣaḍaṅgulam | athavāṣṭāṅgulam raktaṃ nāsikopari lakṣayet | dvādaśāṅgulamānaṃ vā prthvitattvan tu pītabham | lakṣayed athavā tatra koṭisūryasamaprabham | tejaḥ puñjaṃ mahākāśaṃ tat-tad dhyānāc chivo bhavet | ākāśamādhye ākāśoparito dṛṣṭisusthiram | kṛtvā dhyānād vinā sūryaṃ caṇḍasūryaṃ tu paśyati | athavā lakṣaṃ etat tu karttur vahiḥ śivopari | 1–6 cf. SSP 2.28 (Ed. p. 39) athavā nāsāgrād ṣaḍaṅgulam adhovāyutattvaṃ dhūmravarṇaṃ lakṣayet | athavā aṣṭāṅgula āraktaṃ tejas tattvaṃ lakṣayet | athavā daśāṅgule kallolavad āpas tattvaṃ lakṣayet | athavā ākāśamukhaṃ dṛṣṭvā lakṣayat kiraṇākulitaṃ paśyati | evaṃ nirmalikaraṇaṃ | atha-vordhvadṛṣṭayāntarālaṃ lakṣayet | jyotir mukhāni paśyati | athavā yatra tatrākāśaṃ lakṣayet | ākāśasadrśaṃ cittaṃ muktupradaṃ bhavati |

Testimonia: 1–2 ≈hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244, f. 125r ll. 6–7): atha bāhyalakṣyaṃ nirūpyate nāsāgrādārabhyāṃgulacatuṣṭaya 4 pramāṇaṃ pavanatattvaṃ dhūmrākāraṃ lakṣyaṃ karttavyaṃ | athavā nāsāgrād ārabhyāṃguṣṭhāṃgulapramāṇaṃ atiraktaṃ tatvaṃ lakṣyaṃ kartavyaṃ |

1 nāsāgrādārabhya cett.] nāsāgrād ābhya DK₁N₁, nāsāgrādārabhya N₂, om. L ṣaḍaṅgula° cett.] ṣaḍaṃgulaṃ B, dvādaśaṃgula° U₂, om. L pavanatattvaṃ cett.] +++++ B, om. L dhūmrākāraṃ cett.] +++++ B lakṣyaṃ cett.] lakṣaṃ DK₁N₁U₂, lakṣaṇaṃ N₂, om. L kart-tavyaṃ cett.] om. L athavā cett.] atha U₁, om. BELP 2 ārabhyāṣṭāṅgula° U₁] ārabhya ṣṭāṃgula° J, ārabhyaṃ ṣṭāṃgula° N₂, ārabhyaṃ ṣṭāgula° U₂, ārabhya aṣṭāgula° K₁, ārabhya ṣaḍaṃgula° D, ārabhyā ṣaḍaṃgula° N₁, om. BELP atiraktaṃ JK₁N₁N₂] atirattaṃ D, itiriktaṃ U₁, matiraktaṃ U₂, om. BELP tejo cett.] teja° U₂, om. BELP lakṣyaṃ JU₁U₂] lakṣaṃ K₁N₁N₂, lakṣaṇaṃ N₂, om. BELP karttavyaṃ cett.] om. BELP 2–3 athavā nāsāgrād ārabhya daśāṅgulapramāṇaṃ śuklaṃ cett.] om. BELP 3 cañcalam cett.] caṇḍrākāraṃ U₁, om. BELP udakaṃ cett.] om. BELP lakṣyaṃ U₁] lakṣya DN₁, lakṣaṇaṃ N₂, lakṣaṃ U₂, om. BELP kartavyaṃ cett.] om. BELP 3–4 dvādaśāṅgulapramāṇaṃ cett.] tattvaṃ dvādaśāṃgu-lapramāṇaṃ E, dvādaśā aṃgulapramāṇaṃ U₁ 4 lakṣyaṃ EJP₁] lakṣaṇaṃ N₂, lakṣaṃ cett. 5 samaprabhaṃ cett.] °prabhāṃ L tejaḥpūrṇaṃ cett.] tejaḥ | pūrṇaṃ BE, pūrṇa N₂ ākāśa° cett.] akāśa° J lakṣyaṃ DEJK₁N₁PU₁] lakṣaṃ BLU₂, lakṣaṇaṃ N₂ ākāśamādhye cett.] om. BLP ākāśopari cett.] ākāśopari N₁ vā βU₂] om. BELP dṛṣṭim cett.] dṛṣṭi B, om. L 6 kṛtvā cett.] kṛtvā ākāśamādhye B, ākāśamādhye L sūryaṃ cett.] sūrya N₂U₂ sūryasambandhinim em.] sūryasambandhinim P, sūryasambandhinī J, sūryasambandhinī cett. sahasrakiraṇāvalim P] sahasrakiraṇāvalim U₂, sahasrakiraṇāvali BL, sahasrakiraṇa-paṅktiḥ E, sahasrāṇy api kiraṇāṇi JK₁N₁U₁, sahasrāṇyapi kiraṇāṇi DN₂ paśyati ELU₂] paśyati BDK₁N₁, paśyate N₂, pati P, paśyaṃti JU₁

Or, beginning at six finger breadths from the tip of the nose, the wind element, in the shape of smoke, shall be made into the focus.

Or, beginning at eight finger breadths from the tip of the nose, the very red fire element shall be made into the focus.

Or, beginning at ten finger breadths from the tip of the nose, the white fickle water element shall be made into the focus.

Or, beginning at twelve finger breadths from the tip of the nose, the yellow-coloured earth element shall be made into the focus.²⁷¹

Or, beginning at the tip of the nose, the space element full of fire shining like ten million suns shall be made the focus. After having fixed the gaze on the space-element or above the space-element, as a result of meditation, he sees the row of thousand rays connected to the sun without the sun.

²⁷¹The first five outer foci, associated with the five elements can also be identified in *sarvangayoga* 3.29–32: *bāhya lakṣa aura puni jāṃnahum | paṃca tatva kī lakṣa su ṭhānahum | agra nāsikā aṅgula cārī | nila varṇa nabha deṣi bicārī || 29 || nāsā agra aṅgula chaha deṣaiṃ | dhūmrahi varṇa vāyu tata peṣai | aṅgula aṣṭa nāsikā āgai | rakta varṇa su vahni tata jāgai || 30 || nāsā agra aṅgula daśa tāṃmī | śveta varṇa jala deṣi tahāṃmī | nāsā agra su aṅgula bārā | pīta varṇa bhū deṣi apārā || 31 || bāhya lakṣa aura bahuterī | so jānaiṃ jo pāvai serī | sataguru kṛpā karai jau kabahī | dei batāi chinaka maiṃ sabahī || 32 ||* “(29) Contemplate the external focus repeatedly, focusing on the five elements. Four fingers above the tip of the nose contemplate the blue-coloured space-element. (30) Six fingers from the tip of the nose one visualises the smoke-coloured air element. Eight fingers in front of the nose one visualises the red-coloured fire element. (31) Ten fingers from the tip of the nose one visualises the white-coloured water element. Twelve fingers in front of the nose one visualises the earth element with a yellow colour. (32) Many external foci exist, but only a few can attain the ultimate goal. If the true guru shows mercy, everything is revealed within an instant.”

- अथवा शिरोपर्यूर्ध्वं सप्तदशाङ्गुलप्रमाणं तेजःपुञ्जं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। अथवा दृष्टेरग्रे तप्तस्वर्णवर्णाकारं पृथ्वीतत्त्वं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। उक्तानां लक्ष्याणां मध्ये यस्य कस्याप्येकस्य लक्ष्यकरणाद्वलितपलितादि दूरे भवति। अङ्गरोगा विनौषधं दूरे भवन्ति। समग्राः शत्रवः स्वप्नेऽपि मित्रतामायान्ति। सहस्रवर्षपर्यन्तमायुर्वर्धते। अपठितं शास्त्रं जिह्वाग्रेणोच्चरति। एतादृशं बहुतरं फलं भवति ॥

Sources: 1–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 837): ūrddhvaṃ saptadaśāṅgulyaṃ pramāṇaṃ tejasā prabham | athavā prthivītattvaṃ taptakāñcanasannibham | dṛṣṭiragre tu karttavyaṃ lakṣaṃ etad yat ātmanāṃ | uktānāṃ yasya kasyaiva ekaśaḥ karaṇaṃ priye | valipalitahinaḥ syād auśadhena vinā tathā | sarvarogāṇi naśyanti mitravac ca vaśi ripuḥ | jīved varṣasahasraṇ tu sarvalokeṣu pūjitaḥ | jihvāgre prabhaved vidyā vinā sāstraṃvalokanāt | 1–2 cf. SSP 2.28 (Ed. p. 40): athavā dṛṣṭyā taptakāñcanasannibhāṃ bhūmiṃ lakṣayet | dṛṣṭiḥ sthīrā bhavati | ity anekavidhaṃ bahirlakṣyaṃ |

Testimonia: 2–4 ≈hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244, f. 125r ll. 7–8): uttānāṃ tatvānāṃ madhye yasya kasyāpy ekasya lakṣyasya karaṇād valipalitādīdūre bhavati | auśadhamṛtemgarogāṇā vilayo bhavati | āyur vardhate ca |

1 *athavā* cett.] *atha* kā N₁, *om.* P *śiropary* em.] *śiropari* cett., *śivopari* E, *śiroparir* B, *om.* P *ūrdhvaṃ* cett.] *ūrdhva*° L, *urdhvam* B, *ūrddham* U₁U₂, *vṛddham* E, *om.* P *saptadaśāṅgulapramāṇaṃ* cett.] *saptadaśāṅgulaṃ parāṇaṃ* N₂, *saptadaśāṅgulapramāṇa*° U₂, *om.* P *tejahpūñjaṃ lakṣyaṃ* U₂] *tejahpūñjaṃ lakṣaṇaṃ* P, *tejahpūñjaṃ lakṣaṃ* L, *tejahpūñjalakṣyaṃ* E, *tejā pūñjalakṣaṃ* N₁, *tejā pūñjalakṣyaṃ* DK₁, *tejahpūñjalakṣaṇaṃ* N₂, *tejahpūñjakṣaṃ* lakṣyaṃ JU₁ *agre* cett.] *agne* BLP, *ag++* N₁ 2 *taptasvarṇavarṇākāraṃ* U₂] *taptasvarṇavarṇākāraṃ* P, *tatparaṃ svarṇākāraṃ* E, *taptasvarṇavarṇa* BL, *taptavarṇākāraṃ* β *prthivītattvaṃ* βEP] *prthivitatvaṃ* B, *prthitatvaṃ* L, *prthviṃ tatvaṃ* U₂ *lakṣyaṃ* EPU₁] *lakṣaṃ* BDK₁LN₁U₂, *lakṣaṇaṃ* N₂ *kartavyaṃ* cett.] *om.* P *lakṣyānāṃ* E] *lakṣyaṇāṃ* U₁N₁, *lakṣyaṇaṃ* DJ, *lakṣyāṇaṃ* K₁, *lakṣaṇānāṃ* P, *lakṣaṇaṃ* BL, *lakṣāṇā*° N₂, *lakṣāṃ* U₂ 2–3 *kasyāpy* cett.] *kasyāpi* BJLU₁, *kasyāp*° D, *lasyāpy* N₂ 3 *ekasya* cett.] *kasya* BJLU₁, *elasya* N₂ *lakṣya*° cett.] *lakṣa*° BL, *lakṣasya* DJK₁N₁, *lakṣaṇasya* N₂, *lakṣyasya* U₁ *°karaṇād* em.] *°karaṇāt* cett., *karaṇā* JU₁ *°palitādi dūre* cett.] *°palitā dūre* E, *°m palitādi dūre* BL *bhavati* cett.] *bhavanti* EU₂, *bhavati* B *aṅgarogā* cett.] *aṅgarogāḥ* E, *aṅgirogādi* BL *dūre* cett.] *dūri* E, *dūro* BL 3–4 *bhavanti* DEN₁U₂] *bhavati* PLN₂U₁, *bhavati* B 4 *samagrāḥ* cett.] *samagrā* N₂, *samagra*° U₂ *śatravaḥ* cett.] *śatrave* B, *śatravo* L *svapne* cett.] *svapin* JK₁N₁N₂U₁, *svacan* D *°pi* U₂] *pya* BLP, *eva* DJK₁N₁U₁, *evan* N₂ *mitratām* BLP_U] *mitran* E, *mityaṃ* DK₁N₁, *nityaṃ* N₂, *mitevaṃ* U₁, *mityevaṃ* J *āyanti* U₂] *āyanti* PB, *ayāṃti* L, *nāyāṃti* E, *nāyāti* DJK₁N₁N₂, *naiyati* U₁ *°varṣaparyāntam* β] *°varṣam* γ *āyur* γ] *āyusaṃ* DK₁N₁N₂, *āyusaṃ* JU₁ 5 *apathitaṃ* cett.] *apathitaṃ* N₂U₁U₂ *°rati* BELU₂] *°rate* β, *°rati* B *etādṛśaṃ* cett.] *etādṛśyaṃ* U₁, *mitratām āyāṃti sahasravarṣam āyur varddhate* *apathitaṃ śāstraṃ jihvāgreṇoccarati etādṛśaṃ* P *bahutaraṃ phalaṃ* β] *phalaṃ* *bahutaraṃ* γ *bhavati* cett.] *bhavati* B, *bhavati* || *cha* || J, *bhavanti* L

Or, the mass of light situated seventeen-finger wide distance above the head shall be made the focus. Or, at the front of the gaze, the earth element appearing in the colour of molten gold shall be made the focus.^{272, 273, 274}

As a result of focusing on any one of the discussed foci, wrinkles, grey hair, etc., becomes remote. Diseases of the limbs become distant without medical herbs. All enemies become friends even while sleeping.²⁷⁵ The lifespan increases up to 1000 years. He recites unlearned scripture with the tip of the tongue. Such are the manifold results.

²⁷² A variant of the practice with little differences can also be found in *advaya* 6 (Ed. p. 4): *atha bahirlakṣyalakṣaṇam | nāsikāgre caturbhiḥ ṣaḍbhir aṣṭabhiḥ daśabhiḥ dvādaśabhiḥ kramāt aṅgulānte niladyutiśyāmatvasaḍrgraktabhaṅgiṣphuratpītavarnādvayopetaṁ vyoma yadi paśyati sa tu yogī bhavati | calaḍṛṣṭyā vyomabhāgavikṣituḥ puruṣasya ḍṛṣṭyagre jyotirmayūkhā vartante | taddarśanena yogī bhavati | taptakāñcanasaṁkāśajyotir mayūkhā apāṅgānte bhūmau vā paśyati taddṛṣṭiḥ sthīrā bhavati | śīrṣopari dvādaśaṅgulasamikṣituḥ amṛtatvaṁ bhavati | yatra kutra sthitasya śīrasi vyomajyotir dṛṣṭam cet sa tu yogī bhavati || 6 ||* “Now, the characteristics of the outer focus. If one sees a space endowed with two colours, a twinkling yellow breaking into a red which resembles the blackness of profound azure radiance, at [a distance of] four, six, eight, ten and twelve finger breadths, in that order, from the tip of a nose, he becomes a yogin. With the fluctuating gaze of one who looks at the portions of space, luminous rays manifest in front of the observer’s visions. By seeing that, one becomes a yogin. [Once] he sees luminous rays appearing like molten gold at the corner of his eye or on the ground, his gaze becomes stable. For one who sees [this phenomenon] twelve finger breadths above the head, the state of immortality ensues. If the light of space is seen in the head by one who is situated anywhere, he is a yogin.”

²⁷³ Cf. *shivayogapradipika* 4.41cd–47ab for another description of Bāhyalakṣya closely resembling the one in *advaya*.

²⁷⁴ The *hathasamketacandrikamysore* (manuscripts checked: ORI B220, GOML R3239, MMPP 2244) quotes the Bāhyalakṣya passage from the *Tattvayogabindu* without reference. Yet, it appears that Sundaradeva’s text is corrupted. Moreover, he selected only some of the techniques presented here; see sources on pp. 170–174.

²⁷⁵ It is not entirely clear how *svapne* ‘pi is meant here. Either it is supposed to emphasise the effortlessness of getting rid of all enemies, as this happens “overnight”. Alternatively, it could also be translated as “even in a dream”, in the sense that one has got rid of all enemies even in the rather uncontrollable state of dreaming.

[XXIV. antaralakṣyam]

इदानीमन्तरलक्ष्यं कथ्यते। मूलकन्दस्थाने ब्रह्मदण्डादुत्पन्ना श्वेतवर्णा ब्रह्मरन्ध्र-
पर्यन्तं एका ब्रह्मनाडी वर्तते। ब्रह्मनाडी मध्ये कमलतन्तुसमानाकारा कोटिसूर्य-
विद्युत्समप्रभा ऊर्ध्वं चलति। एतादृश्येका मूर्तिर्वर्तते। तस्या मूर्तेर्ध्यानकारणा-
5 दणिमाद्यष्टसिद्धिः पुरुषस्य समीपे आगत्य तिष्ठति।

Sources: 2-5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 838): mūlakandothhatalato brahmanāḍisamudbhavā | śvetavarṇā brahmarandhraparyantam eva tiṣṭhati | eṣā tu brahmarandhrākhyā tanmadhye varttate parā | padmatantusamākārā koṭisūryataḍitprabhā | calaty ūrdhvaṁ mahāmūrtir ityasya dhyānād bhavet chivaḥ | aṇimādy aṣṭasiddhis tu samagreṇa prasidati | 2-5 cf. SSP 2.26 (Ed. pp. 37-38): tatra tāvad antarakṣyam kathyate | mūlakandād daṇḍalagnāṁ brahmanāḍīm śve-tavarṇāṁ brahmarandhraparyantam gatāṁ saṁsmaret | tanmadhye kamalatantunibhāṁ vidyutkoṭiprabhāṁ ūrdhvaḡaminīm tām mūrtim manasā lakṣayet | sarvasiddhipradā bhavati |

Testimonia: 2-5 ≈hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244, f. 125r ll. 8-9 to f. 126v l. 1): athāmtarakṣyam nirūpyate | mūlakamdaṣṭhāne brahmadaṇḍād utpannāśve-tavarṇābrahmaramdhraparyamttam ekābrahmanāḍī vartate | brahmanāḍī madhye ka-malataṁtusamānākārakotīsūryavidyutprabhā tulyā ūrdhva calati | etādṛśī ekā mūrtir vartate | tasya mūrter dhyānakaraṇād aṇimādisiddhayaḥ samīpa upatiṣṭhamte |

2 idānīm EU₂] idānīm cett. antarakṣyam DK₁] anyataram lakṣyam E, amṭaram lakṣyam P, antarakṣam BL, antarakṣyakam N₁, antarakṣyaṇam N₂U₁, ataram lakṣyam U₂, an-taram] kathyate cett.] kartavyam BL, lakṣyate] mūlakandasthāne cett.] mūlakam sthāne P °daṇḍād utpannā cett.] brahmadaṇḍotpannā nāḍī E, brahmadaṇḍa ityannā N₁, brah-madaṇḍad utpannā N₂, daṇḍād utpannāḥ K₁, brahmadaṇḍ utpannaḥ U₁ °varṇā cett.] °varṇam U₁, °varṇam JK₁ 2-3 °randhraparyamttam cett.] °daṇḍaparyantam E 3 ekā brahmanāḍī cett.] ekā nāḍī B, ekanāḍī L brahmanāḍī madhye cett.] om. N₂ kamalata-n-tusamānākārā cett.] kamalataṁ samānākārā P, om. N₂ 4 °samaprabhā cett.] °sabhāprabhā BL, om. N₂ ūrdhvaṁ cett.] °rdhvaṁ U₁, urdhvaṁ U₂, om. N₂ calati cett.] om. N₂ etādṛśy ekā cett.] etādṛśī DJK₁N₁, om. U₁N₂ mūrtir cett.] om. U₁N₂ vartate cett.] om. U₁N₂ tasyā cett.] tasyāḥ N₁, tan E, om. U₁ mūrter cett.] mūrte B, om. U₁ dhyāna° cett.] om. U₁ 4-5 °karaṇād em.] °karaṇāt cett., °karaṇac° N₂, om. U₁ 5 aṇimādyasṭasiddhiḥ DJK₁U₁] aṇimādisiddhiḥ N₁, aṣṭamahāsiddhaya aṇimādyāḥ || U₂, aṣṭamahāsiddhaya °ṇimādayas tasya E, aṣṭamahāsiddhaya || aṇimādyāḥ || aṇimāmahimālaghimāgirimā dure vā yadi vā yadi vā dure śrutvā parakāyāpraveśitā || B, aṣṭamahāsiddhaya aṇimādyāḥ || aṇimāmahimālaghimā-garimā dure vā yadi vā ddure śrutvā parakāyāpraveśitā L, aṣṭamahāsiddhaya ṇimādyāḥ aṇimāmahimālaghimāgirimādure diya vā dure stutvā parakāyāpraveśitā P puruṣasya cett.] om. N₂ samīpe DJK₁N₁] samīpe U₁, samīpem B, samīpam ELU₂, samīm P, om. N₂ āgatya cett.] āgamyā U₂, om. N₂ tiṣṭhati cett.] tiṣṭhanti EPN₁, om. N₂

[XXIV. The inner focus]

Now, the inner focus is explained. At the location of the root-bulb (*mūlakanda*)²⁷⁶ originating from the staff of Brahman,²⁷⁷ being white, extending up to the aperture of Brahman exists the single Brahman-channel.²⁷⁸ The Brahman-channel, being within [the staff of Brahman],²⁷⁹ having the shape of a stalk of a lotus flower [and] shining like ten million suns goes upwards. One such manifestation exists. As a result of meditation on this manifestation²⁸⁰ the accomplishment of the eight supernatural powers beginning with ‘becoming as small as the smallest particle of matter’ etc.²⁸¹ exists in proximity of the person.²⁸²

²⁷⁶ Various concepts of the location of the *kanda* exist in yogic literature. In the *yajñavalkya* 4.16–27 one reads: *kandasthānām manuṣyānām dehamadhyān navāṅgūlam | caturaṅgūlam utsedham āyāmaś ca tathāvidhaḥ* || 16 || *aṇḍākrativad ākāraṃ bhūṣitaṃ tattvagādhībhiḥ | catuspadām tiraścām ca dvijānām tundamadhyame* || 17 || “The location of the bulb (*kanda*) of humans is nine finger widths from the waist. [It is] four finger widths in height and has the same [measure in] length. It appears like an egg, and [it is] ornamented with the five elements of creation and sustenance. In quadrupeds, birds and other beings, it is in the centre of the belly.” *hathapradīpikā* 2024 3.64cd (*gulphadeśasamīpe ca kandaṃ tatra prapīḍayet*) instructs the yogin to press the *kanda* with the feet in the context of *udḍīyāṇabandha*, which could imply that the *kanda* is in the genital region (unless one assumes the very complex and challenging posture termed *kandapīḍāsana*, cf. *encyclopediaasana*, pp. 143–144). Sundaradeva, in *yuktabhavadēva* 7.224 and Bhavadēvamiśra in *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 36r) argue that the *kanda* is near the navel. In *yogacudamani* 14cd the *kanda* is in between penis and navel (*ūrdhvaṃ meḍhrādadhō nābheḥ kande yoniḥ khagāṇḍavat*).

²⁷⁷ The term *brahmadaṇḍa* in this context refers to the spinal column, which is usually identified with Mt. Meru in tantric texts, cf. *stupa*.

²⁷⁸ The term *brahmanāḍī* is a synonym for the *suṣūmnā*, cf., e.g. *hathapradīpikā* 2024 2.67, *Gorakṣaśataka* 47, *yogakundalinīyopaniṣad* 37c–38b, *yogacintamani* (Ed. pp. 46, 112, 116, 140, 191), *hatharatnavali* 2.8, 2.25, 2.65, 2.69.

²⁷⁹ Naturally, one would read *brahmanāḍīmadhye* compounded, but this would leave the sentence lacking a subject. Therefore, the only option is to read *brahmanāḍī madhye* separately, referring to the inside of the previously mentioned *brahmadaṇḍa*. Assuming another channel within the *brahmanāḍī* like the *citrānāḍī* in *mallinson2007* 5.160 would be difficult to proof.

²⁸⁰ Cf. *bäumer2013* 35.

²⁸¹ For a detailed discussion of the yogic *siddhis*, see *yogapowers2017*.

²⁸² Three of five witnesses of the γ -group add an incomplete list of the eight *siddhis* ...

अथवा ललाटोपर्याकाशमध्ये शुक्लसदृशस्य तेजसो ध्यानकारणाच्छरीरसम्बन्धि-
नः कुष्ठादयो रोगा नश्यन्ति । आयुर्वृद्धिर्भवति । अथवा भ्रुवोर्मध्येऽतिरक्तवर्णस्या-
तिस्थूलस्य तेजसो ध्यानकरणात्सकलानां पार्थिवपुरुषाणां वल्लभो भवति । तं पुरुषं
दृष्ट्वा सर्वेषां दृष्टिः स्थिरा भवति ॥

Sources: 2-8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 838): lalāṭopari vā dhyātvā candram vā jyotir īśvaram | nāśayet kuṣṭharogādīn mahāyusmān śivaḥ paraḥ | bhruvor madhye 'thavā dhyātvā arkantu teja īśvaram | sthiradṛṣṭau rājapūjyo jīvanmuktaḥ śivo yathā | ātmānam ātmarūpaṁ hi dhyātvā yo nīśkriyo bhavet | nirāśīryatatattvo 'yaṁ itaro na nṛpasthitih | 2-8 cf. SSP 2.27 (Ed. p. 38): athavā lalāṭordhve gollāṭamaṇḍape sphurattārākāraṁ lakṣayet |

Testimonia: 2-8 ≈hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244, f. 125v ll. 1-3): athavā lalāṭopari ākāśamadye śukladṛśyasya tejaso dhyānakaraṇāc charirāḥ kuṣṭhādiroga naśyanti | athavā bhruvor madhye atiraktavarṇasyātisthūlasya tejaso dhyānakaraṇāt kalānām pārthivapuruṣāṇām vallabho bhavati | taṁ puruṣaṁ dṛṣṭvā sarveṣāṁ puruṣāṇām dṛṣṭih sthirā bhavati |

1 lalāṭopary E] lalāṭopari BDKJLN₁, lalāṭopari U₁U₂, om. N₂ ākāśamadye cett.] om. N₂ śuklasadrśasya cett.] om. N₂ tejaso cett.] om. N₂ dhyānakaraṇāc em.] dhyānakaraṇāt cett., om. N₂ śarīra° BL] śarīra° cett., om. N₂ 1-2 sambandhinaḥ γ] sambandhi DJK₁N₁U₁, °sambamdhī N₂ 2 kuṣṭhādayo cett.] kuṣṭhādayo DJK₁N₂ rogā cett.] rogāḥ DJK₁PN₁N₂ naśyanti cett.] naśyanti BP vṛddhir cett.] vṛddi N₂ bhavati cett.] bhavati || cha || J athavā cett.] om. E bhruvor cett.] bṛvor U₂ 'tirakta° cett.] atirakta° U₂, tirikta° E 2-3 varṇasyātisthūlasya cett.] varṇasyāti sthālasya U₁, 'tisthūlasyaḥ U₂ 3 dhyānakaraṇāt cett.] dhyānaṁ karaṇāt B, dhyānakaraṇād E sakalānām BLN₁PU₁U₂] sakālānām N₂, sakalānā DK₁, bahulānām E pārthivapuruṣāṇām cett.] parthivānām tatpuruṣāṇām ca E bhavati cett.] bhavati | jagad vallabho pi bhavati E taṁ cett.] asya E 3-4 puruṣaṁ dṛṣṭvā DJN₁U₁] puruṣaṁ dṛṣṭā N₂, puruṣaṁ BP, puruṣa° L, puruṣasyāvalokanena E 4 sarveṣāṁ βE] pratisarveṣāṁ cett. dṛṣṭih sthirā EJP] dṛṣṭisthirā cett. bhavati cett.] bhavati B, bhavati || cha || J

Or, as a result of meditation onto the bright light within the space above the forehead, diseases related to the body, skin disease[s], etc., vanish.^{283,284} The lifespan increases. Alternatively, as a result of meditation on the very subtle red light in the middle of the eyebrows, he becomes one who is beloved among all royal people.²⁸⁵ After having seen this person, everybody's gaze becomes fixed [onto him].²⁸⁶

(see apparatus). I did not include it in greyscale for two reasons. First, the passage is incomplete and in a very corrupt state. Second, since it is absent U₂ it probably does not belong to the γ -group archetype. The passage *dure vā yadi vādure śrutvā* seems to refer to the supernatural abilities *dūradarśana* and *dūraśravaṇa*. The list does not follow the standard list of eight supernatural powers. After the first four items that are usually considered as primary *siddhis*, the three manuscripts instead list three of the so-called secondary *siddhis*, cf. *bhagavata* 11.10 and 11.15.2–6. Because of that, it is impossible to determine the missing *siddhi* precisely. However, the passage allows to identify seven *siddhis*: *Aṇimā* (“the ability to reduce size to the size of the smallest particle”), *Mahimā* (“the ability to expand one's body to an infinitely large size”), *Laghimā* (“the ability to become weightless or lighter than air”), *Garimā* (“the ability to become heavy or dense”), *Dūraśravaṇa* (“hearing things far away”), *Dūradarśana* (“seeing things far away”) and *Parakāyapraveśitā* (“entering the bodies of others”).

²⁸³The *ssplonavla* 2.27 (Ed. p. 38) includes three techniques of *antarlakṣya* which are unparalleled in Rāmacandra's system: *athavā bhramaraguḥmādhaye āraktabhramarākāraṃ lakṣayet | athavā kaṇṇadvayaṃ tarjanībhyāṃ nirodhayet tataḥ śiromadhaye dhūṃdhūṃkāraṃ nādaṃ śṛṇoti | athavā cakṣurmadhaye nilajyotirūpaṃ putalākāraṃ lakṣayed* | “Or, one should focus the form of a very red bee within the *bhramaraguḥ*. Or, one should close both ears with the index fingers and listen to the *dhūṃ dhūṃ*-sound in the head. Or, one should focus on the form of a doll appearing in blue light within the eyes.”

²⁸⁴*shivayogapradipika* 4.32–41 describes the main practice of *antarlakṣya* in very similar ways along with two alternatives in 4.40–41 which resemble those in the *ssplonavla* 2.27: *athavā kaṇṇayor dvāre tarjanībhyāṃ nirodhayet | śrīhaṭṭamastake nādaṃ ghumghumkāraṃ śṛṇoti ca || 40 || cakṣurmadhaye 'thavā nilajyotirūpaṃ vilokayet | antarlakṣyam iti jñeyam bahirlakṣyam atha śṛṇu || 41 ||* “(40) Alternatively, one should block the opening of the ears with the index fingers. At the crown of the head, at the *śrīhaṭṭa*, one hears the sound which makes ‘*ghum ghum*’. (41) Likewise, one should visualize the form of blue light within the eyes. Thus, it is known as the internal focus. Now listen to the external fixation.”

²⁸⁵For the translation of *pārthivapuruṣāṇāṃ* cf. the usage of *pārthiva*° in section I, l. 5.

²⁸⁶The placement of the ten channels and vital winds after *antaralakṣya* rather than *madhyalakṣya* in both Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya* is puzzling.

[XXV. nāḍinām bhedāḥ]

इदानीं शरीरमध्ये नाडीनां भेदाः कथ्यन्ते । दश मुख्य नाड्यः तन्मध्ये नाडीद्वयमि-
 डापिंगलासंज्ञकं नासाद्वरे तिष्ठति । सुषुम्णा तु तालुमार्गेण ब्रह्मद्वारपर्यन्तं वहति ।
 सरस्वती मुखमध्ये वर्तते । गांधारी हस्तिजिह्वा कर्णयोर्मध्ये वहत्यौ तिष्ठतः । पूषा-
 5 लम्बुषा नेत्रयोर्मध्ये वहत्यौ तिष्ठतः । शङ्खिनी लिङ्गद्वारादारभ्येडामार्गेण ब्रह्मस्था-
 नपर्यन्तं तिष्ठति । कुहू मूलद्वारादरभ्य पिङ्गला मर्गेण ब्रह्मस्थानपर्यन्तं तिष्ठति । ए-
 तादृषा नाड्यो दशसु द्वारेषु तिष्ठन्ति । अन्या द्विसप्ततिसहस्रपरिमिता नाड्यो लोम्नां
 मूलेषु सूक्ष्मरूपेण तिष्ठन्ति ॥

Sources: 2-8 cf. SSP 1.66 (Ed. p. 29): atha nāḍinām daśa dvārāṇi | iḍā piṅgalā ca nāsādvārayor
 vahataḥ | gāndhārī hastijihvikā ca cakṣurdvārayor vahataḥ | pūṣā yaśasvinī ca karṇadvārayor
 vahataḥ | alambuṣā ānane vahati | kuhū gudadvāre vahati | śaṅkhinī liṅgadvāre vahati |
 suṣumṇā madhyadeśe vahati | sā daṇḍamārgaṇa brahmarandhraparyantaṁ vahati | evaṁ
 daśanāḍyo daśadvāreṣu vahanti | anyāḥ sarvanāḍyo romakūpeṣu vahanti | 2-8 cf. YSv (PT,
 p. 838): idānīm śṛṇu nāḍinām bhedam vakṣyāmi siddhidam | meruvāhye iḍānāmnī piṅ-
 galayā samanvitā | suṣumṇā bhānumārgaṇa brahmadvārāvadhī sthitā | sarasvatī sugandhā tu
 gāndhārī hastijihvakā | jñātavyā karṇayor madhye netrayoḥ ca tathāntimā | pūṣā cāambuṣā
 ceti mūlasthā kutracit tathā | liṅgadvārād iḍāmārge brahmasthānāvadhī priye | nāḍyantaṁ
 pratilomeṣu sahasrāṇām dvisaptatiḥ |

2 idānīm cett.] idānī BLN₂ nāḍinām cett.] nāḍī° BL, nāḍinām aparo β bhedāḥ cett.]
 bhedaḥ BDLN₁ kathyante EK₁PN₂U₁] kathyate || cha || J, kathyate cett. mukhya° cett.]
 mukhya° DJK₁PL, mukhye° B nāḍyaḥ cett.] nāḍhyas J, nāḍyas U₁, nāḍayas L, nāḍyā B nāḍī°
 cett.] om. E °dvayam cett.] dvayam BDLPU₁U₂ 2-3 iḍā° E] iḍā° cett., idānīm N₂, idām P
 3 °saṁjñakam cett.] °saṁjñākam U₁U₂, °saṁjñikāḥ BL nāsā° cett.] nāsānāsā° D suṣumṇā
 tu β] suṣumṇā γ °mārgaṇa DPN₁U₁U₂] °mārga BELN₂ °dvāra° cett.] °raṁdhra° BLP va-
 hati U₂] vahati tiṣṭhati cett. 4 sarasvatī cett.] tisaḥ sarasvatī U₂ vartate β] tiṣṭhati BELPU₂
 hastijihvākarṇayor E] hastinijihve DK₁PN₁N₂, hastijihve BJL, harratijihva U₁, hastinī || jihve
 || U₂ karṇayor cett.] karṇa° BL, °karṇayor U₁, netrayor U₂ madhye cett.] om. LB va-
 hatyau cett.] vahalyau E, vahatyō BL, vahamtyaḥ U₂, om. J tiṣṭhataḥ cett.] tiṣṭhati BL,
 om. U₂ pūṣā° cett.] pūṣo° BL, pūṣām DN₁N₂K₁ 5 °lambuṣā em.] °lambuse PU₁, alambuṣe
 DJK₁N₁N₂, °lambusemā E, °ḍalabuṣe B, °ya śaṅkhinī || U₂ netrayor cett.] netayor N₂U₁, netra°
 BL, karṇayor U₂ vahatyau cett.] rvahalyā E, vahatyō BLN₁N₂U₂ tiṣṭhataḥ cett.] tiṣṭataḥ P,
 tiṣṭhati B, tiṣṭhamti L, tiṣṭhata || alambuṣā || bh++madhye vamaḥatyō tiṣṭhati || U₂ śaṅkhinī
 cett.] śaṅkhani N₁, kuhū U₂ liṅgadvārād cett.] liṅgadvārā° U₁ ārabhye E] ārabhya cett.
 °ḍā° E] iḍā° cett., idānīm N₂ 6 tiṣṭhati cett.] tiṣṭhatī E kuhū conj.] śaṅkhinī U₂, om.
 cett. mūladvārād-arabhyā U₂] om. cett. piṅgalā° em.] piṅgala° U₂ mārgaṇa brah-
 masthānaparyantaṁ tiṣṭhati U₂] om. cett. 6-7 etādrṣā P] etādrṣyā BL, etā N₂, etādrṣā
 cett. 7 nāḍyo cett.] om. N₂ daśasu dvāreṣu cett.] daśa dvāreṣu L, daśasv adhāreṣu U₁
 tiṣṭhanti cett.] tiṣṭhati U₁ dvisaptatisahasraparimitā cett.] dvisaptatisahasraparimitā U₁,
 dvisaptatisahaparamitā J, hi daśonā dvisatyati sahasraḥ || 71110 || parimitā U₂ nāḍyo BLP]
 nāḍayo E, nāḍhyo U₂, °gryō U₁ 7-8 lomnām mūleṣu cett.] lomnā BJLPU₁

[XXV. Division of the channels]

Now, the divisions of channels within the body are explained. There are ten primary channels.²⁸⁷ Among them is a pair of channels. [Their] designation is *Iḍā* and *Piṅgalā* [and they] exist at the entrance of the nose. The *Suṣumṇā* flows by the path of the palate to the door of Brahman.^{288,289} The *Sarasvatī*[-channel] exists within the mouth. The two channels, *Gāndhārī* and *Hastijihvā*, exist within the two ears. The two channels, *Pūṣā* and *Ālaṃbuṣā*, are situated at the centre of the two eyes. *Śaṅkhinī* stretches from the beginning of the opening of the penis through the *Iḍā*-channel up to the place of Brahman.²⁹⁰ *Kuhū*²⁹¹ stretches from the entrance of the root²⁹² through the *Piṅgalā*-channel up to the place of Brahman. Such channels are situated at the ten openings. The other channels, quantified as 72000, are situated in very small form at the roots of the hairs.

²⁸⁷The notion of ten primary channels can already be found in early texts of Hāṭhayoga, cf. e.g., the *vivekamartanda* 17 (Central Library, Baroda Acc. No. 4110, 1534 Śaṃvat): *teṣu nāḍisahasreṣu dvisaptatir udāhṛtāḥ | pradhānāḥ prāṇavāhinyo bhūyas tatra daśa smṛtāḥ* || “Of those thousand channels, seventy-two have been spoken of, and among them, ten are considered most important. They are the main pathways of the vital breaths.” Also cf. *fausta* 1976 34. However, the enumeration of ten main channels in yogic literature also has predecessors, e.g., in Śaivasiddhānta, cf. *sardha* 10.4–5. Other systems, e.g., *yajñavalkya* IV.26 or *vasisthasaṃhita* 2.21, enumerate fourteen primary channels.

²⁸⁸According to *tantrika* 3 (p. 93), the palate is the Śaiva locus of the central *granthi* along the course of the breath through five *granthis* (heart, throat, palate, eyebrows, nose-tip), cf. *tantraloka* 5.III. YSv (PT) alternatively reads *bhānumargeṇa* “by the path of the sun.” In several yogic systems, the microcosmic sun is located at the base of the central channel (see *asiddhi* 4.1) and ascends upward (see *asiddhi* 4.11).

²⁸⁹The *brahmadvāra*, synonymous with *brahmarandhra* “aperture of Brahman,” denotes the fontanelle through which the yogi’s vital principle exits at death, see *rootsofyoga* 2017.

²⁹⁰The *brahmasthāna*, synonymous with *brahmarandhra*, is here identified with the *sahasrācakra*, cf. *dhyanabind* 65.

²⁹¹The list would be incomplete without *kuhū*, attested only in U₂, where it and *śaṅkhinī* are swapped. Neither occurs in YSv (PT), but both and their usual locations appear in SSP 1.66, hence my conjecture. I kept the sentence in greyscale as the omission may be authorial.

²⁹²The root entrance (*mūladvāra*) here denotes the anus, cf. *ssplonavla* 1.66: *kuhūr gudadvāre vahati*—“Kuhū conducts through the anus.”

[XXVI. śarīramadhye vāyavaḥ]

इदानीं शरीरमध्ये वायवो दश तिष्ठन्ति । तेषां कार्याणि कथ्यन्ते । प्राणवायुर्हृदय-
मध्ये श्वासोच्छ्वासं करोति । अशनपानेच्छा भवति । गुदमध्येऽपानवायुस्तिष्ठति ।
स आकुञ्चनं स्तम्भनं करोति । नाभिमध्ये समानो वर्तते । स समग्रा नाडीः शोषय-
5 ति । तथा नाडीः पोषयति । रुचिमुत्पादयति । अग्निं दीपयति । तालुमध्ये उदान-
वायुस्तिष्ठति । स वायुरन्नं गिलति । पानीयं पिबति । व्यानवायुः सकले शरीरे व-
र्तते । तस्माद्वायोः शरीरं चलति । शोकं आप्नोति विकृते । कूर्मवायुर्नेत्रमध्ये ति-
ष्ठति ।

Sources: 2–8 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 838–839): idānīm dehamadhyasthāḥ kathyante daśa vāyavaḥ | kāryakāraṇabhāvena kathyante tāni cihnataḥ | prāṇavāyur hṛdi sthitvā śvāsocchvāsam karoti saḥ | asikāntaṃ pitaṃ iśaṃ karoti yogasaṃjñakaḥ | apāno gudadeśasthāḥ karoty ākuñcanaṃ sa tu | stambhanaṃ ca tathāpānaḥ samāno nābhimaṇḍale | toṣakādiṣoṣakan tu nāḍināṃ rucidāyakaḥ | diptāgnimadhye 'pi tathā samānākhyā mahāparā | tālumadhye udānas tu aśnāti pibatiti ca | śarīraṃ sakalaṃ vyāpya vyānavāyuh pratiṣṭhitaḥ | śarīre cālanam teṣu karoti sthāpayaty api | netramadhye kūrmanāmā ... 2–8 cf. SSP 1.67 (Ed. pp. 23–24): atha daśavāyavaḥ | hṛdaye prāṇavāyur ucchvāsaniḥśvāsakārako hakārasakārātmakaś ca | gude tv apānavāyuh recakakumbhakapūrakaś ca | nābhau samānavāyuh dipakaḥ pācakaś ca | kaṇṭhe vyānavāyuh ṣoṣaṇāpy āyanakārakaś ca | tālau udānavāyuh grasanavamanajalpapakārakaś ca | nāgavāyuh sarvāṅgavyāpakaḥ mocakaś cālakaś ca | kūrmaṇvāyuh cakṣuṣor ...

2 vāyavo EPU₂] vāyavas β, om. BL daśa EPU₂] om. cett. tiṣṭhanti cett.] ṣṭaṃti U₂, om. BL teṣāṃ cett.] om. BL kāryāṇi cett.] nāmāni kāryāṇi E, nāmāni karmāṇi P, om. BL kathyante cett.] kathyate N₂U₁U₂, om. BL °vāyur EP] °vāyu° βU₂, om. BL 2–3 hṛdayamadhye cett.] om. BL 3 śvāsocchvāsam em.] śvāsośvaroti B, śvāsocchāsam E, śvāsośvareti L, śvāsochāsam P, svāsochvāsam U₂, utsvāsaprasvāsam DK₁, utsvāsaprasvāsasam N₁, ūrdhvaśvāsaprasvāsam N₂, ūdhvasaprasase U₁, utsvāsaprasvāse J karoti cett.] om. BL aśana° cett.] aśita° DN₁K₁, asita° N₂, aśite U₁ °pānecchā γ] pitechā U₁, °piteccha cett. °pāna° em.] om. E, apāna° cett. °vāyus cett.] °vāyo U₂L, °vāyu N₂U₁, °vāyor B, om. E tiṣṭhati cett.] om. E 4 sa cett.] om. EU₂ ākuñcanaṃ cett.] ākuñcana° N₂, āṃkucana° BLPU₂, om. E stambhanaṃ cett.] om. E karoti cett.] om. E °madhye cett.] °padmamadhye U₂, om. E samāno cett.] samāno vāyur E, smānā B sa cett.] sapta E samagrā γ] samāgram β nāḍiḥ EP] nāḍi BLU₂, nāḍim JU₁, nāḍhyam DK₁N₁N₂ 5 tathā cett.] om. U₂ nāḍiḥ P] nāḍi E, nāḍim β, om. BLU₂ poṣayati em.] poṣayati | tathā poṣayati B, poṣa iti U₁, ṣoṣayati U₂, °ṣoṣaṇāt E, poṣayati cett. rucim cett.] rucir B, śucim J, kvacit DK₁N₁N₂ agnim em.] agnim DJK₁N₁N₂, agnim U₁, vahnim EPU₂, vahnī BL udāna° cett.] udāno DJK₁EPU₂, udānāni N₂ 6 vāyur cett.] vāyuh E, vāyu P annam cett.] ratnam EPN₁ gilati cett.] lilati E, galayati B, galayati L, śilati N₁ vyānavāyuh em.] nāgavāyu° L, nānāgavāyuh D, nāgavāyuh cett. sakale cett.] sakala° BL, sarva° E 7 vāyoḥ cett.] vāyo P śarīram cett.] śarīre BL calati β] cālāti B, calayati PU₂U₂, cālayati EL śokaṃ γ] om. β āpnoti γ] om. β vikṛte em.] vikṛtaḥ U₂, vikṛtaḥ P, vikṛtaḥ U₂, vikutaḥ L, vivilaḥ E, vi+++++ B, om. β kūrmaṇvāyur cett.] kūrmaṇvāyoḥ BL, kūrmo vāyur J, kūrmo vāyu DK₁N₁N₂, om. U₁ netramadhye cett.] om. U₁ 7–8 tiṣṭhati cett.] om. BLPU₁U₂

[XXVI. The vital winds within the body]

Now, ten vital winds are situated within the body. Their functions are taught. The Prāṇa vital wind is located within the chest and performs inhalation and exhalation. It brings about the desire for food and drink. Within the anus, the Apāna vital wind is situated. It performs contraction [and] restraining. Within the navel, the Samāna vital wind exists. It induces the absorption of [substances from]²⁹³ all the channels. In this way, it causes the channels to be nourished, causes appetite to be generated, and causes the [digestive] fire to be kindled. Within the palate, the Udāna vital wind is situated. This wind swallows food, [and] it drinks liquid. The Vyāna vital wind exists in the entire body.²⁹⁴ Through that vital wind, the body is set in motion. When it is defective, it leads to pain. The Kūrma vital wind exists within the eyes.

²⁹³The verbal form *śoṣayati* (causative third person singular indicative present of *śuṣ*) means “causes to dry up” or “causes to disappear”. In this context, however, a better idiomatic translation would be “causes to absorb”, since the Samāna vital wind absorbs the eaten substances in the body and distributes it everywhere, cf. *yajñavalkya* 4.55–57 (Ed. p. 40) and 4.69ab (Ed. p. 42).

²⁹⁴I have conjectured *nāgavāyu* to *vyānavāyu* based on the description provided in YSv (PT), as the latter term generally corresponds to the provided function of this vital wind. From a text-critical perspective, however, this choice is difficult and not unambiguous, since according to SSP 1.67 (*nāgavāyuh sarvāṅgavyāpakah mocakaś cālakaś ca*), not just Vyāna (as in YSv) but also Nāga pervades the whole body, a concept also attested in *vasisthasamhita* 2.49cd and 2.52cd. YSv (PT, pp. 838–839) ascribes the function of belching (*udgāra*) to Nāga (*udgāre nāga ākhyātaḥ ūrdhvavāyuh pracālāne*) which speaks for my conjecture. However, Rāmacandra follows the SSP 1.67 (Ed. pp. 23–24) by ascribing the function of belching to Kṛkala, even though the Ysv ascribes sneezing (*kṣut*) to Kṛkala. This indicates that he mixed the descriptions of the YSv and SSP, which makes it possible that he followed the SSP in the case of Nāga, too. This leaves us with the other possibility that Vyāna and its description dropped out. However, in the YSv (PT, pp. 838–839), the order of the ten vital winds is as follows: Prāṇa, Apāna, Samāna, Udāna, Vyāna, Kūrma, Nāga, Kṛkara, Devadatta, Dhanañjaya. In the SSP 1.67 (Ed. pp. 23–24): Prāṇa, Apāna, Samāna, Vyāna, Udāna, Nāga, Kūrma, Kṛkara, Devadatta, Dhanañjaya. In both sources, the Vyāna vital wind appears to be within the group of the first five major vital winds. This group of five winds is undoubtedly common across yogic literature, see *rootsofyoga2017*. The emergence of Nāga instead of Vyāna in all the witnesses ...

निमेषोन्मेषं करोति । कृकलवायोरुद्गारो भवति । देवदत्तवायोरुद्गारो उत्पद्यते । ध-
नंजयवायोः शब्द उत्पद्यते ॥

[XXVII. madhyalakṣyam]

इदानीं मध्यलक्ष्यं कथ्यते । श्वेतवर्णं अथवा पीतवर्णं रक्तवर्णं वा धूम्रवर्णं वा नी-
लवर्णं वाऽग्निशिखासदृशं विद्युत्समानं सूर्यमण्डलसदृशं मर्धचन्द्रसदृशं ज्वल-
दाकाशसमाकारं स्वशरीरपरिमितं तेजो मनोमध्ये लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम् । एतस्मिंल्लक्ष्ये
कृते सति मनोमध्ये स्थितस्य मलस्य दाहो भवति । मनसः सत्त्वगुणः प्रकटो भ-
वति । पुरुष आनन्दमयो भूत्वा तिष्ठति ॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 839): ...nimeṣonmeṣakṛdayam | udgāre nāga ākhyātaḥ
ūrdhvavāyuh pracālāne | kṛkaraḥ kṣutkaro jñeyo devadatto vijṛmbhaṇe | dhanañjayah
saccidākāro mṛtadeham na muñcati | yady api sargakāṇḍe sarvam etad uktaṁ tathāpi
kāryakāraṇabhāvajñāpanāya punar nirdiṣṭam iti na punar uktaṁ | 1–2 cf. SSP 1.67 (Ed. pp.
23–24): ...unmeṣakārakaś ca | kṛkalaḥ udgārakaḥ kṣutkārakaś ca | devadatto mukhavijṛmb-
hakaḥ | dhanañjaya nādaghōṣakaḥ | iti daśavāyva avalokanena piṇḍotpattiḥ naranārīrūpaṁ
| 4–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): idāniṁ madhyalakṣaṇaṁ tu kathyate siddhikāraṁ | śvetaṁ rak-
taṁ tathā pītaṁ dhūmrākāraṁ tu nilabham | agnijvālāsamānābhā vidyutpuñjasamaprabhā |
ādityamaṇḍalākāraṁ athavā candramaṇḍalam | jvaladākāśatulyaṁvā bhāvayed rūpamāt-
manaḥ | etaj jyotirmayaṁ dehaṁ manomadhye tu lakṣayet | eteṣāṇ ca kṛte lakṣe nānā-
duḥkhaṁ prapāśyati | manas astu malo yāti mahānando bhavet tataḥ | 4–8 cf. SSP 2.29
(Ed. p. 41): śvetavarṇaṁ vā raktavarṇaṁ vā kṛṣṇavarṇaṁ vā agniśikhākāraṁ vā jyotirūpaṁ
vā vidyudākāraṁ sūryamaṇḍalākāraṁ vā arddhacandrākāraṁ vā yatheṣṭasvapīṇḍamātraṁ
sthānavarjitaṁ manasā lakṣayet ity anekavidham madhyamaṁ lakṣyaṁ |

1 nimeṣonmeṣaṁ cett.] unmeṣaṁ nimeṣaṁ N₁N₂, unmeṣaṁ nimeṣaṁ ca DJK₁, om. U₁
karoti cett.] om. U₁ kṛkalavāyor cett.] kṛkalavāyur BLP, kṛkalakartāvāyur E, puṣkaravāyur
U₂, om. U₁ udgāro em.] udgāraṁ EU₂, udhāraṁ BP, uhāraṁ L, ūdgāto D, om. U₁, ūdgāro
cett. bhavati β] karoti cett., om. U₁ °vāyor cett.] °vāyoḥ E, °vāyo N₂U₂ jṛmbha cett.]
jṛmbhaṇaṁ E, jumbhā BP, jṛmbhā L, jṛmbho° N₂, jāmbhā U₁ utpadyate β] bhavati ELPU₂,
bhavanti B 2 °vāyoḥ γ] °vāyo β śabda cett.] śabdāḥ P, śabdaḥ L, śabdo° N₂, sabta U₁
4 idāniṁ cett.] idāni P madhyalakṣyaṁ cett.] madhyalakṣaṇaṁ BN₂, madhyalakṣaṁ P,
madhye lakṣaṁ L, madhye lakṣyaṁ U₂ °śveta cett.] sveta° U₁, svata° U₂ °varṇaṁ cett.]
°varṇaṁ || D, °varaṁ P, °varṇāṁ K₁, °varṇā | N₁ athavā cett.] aṁtha ca E, om. BLP °varṇaṁ
cett.] °varṇa N₂ raktavarṇaṁ E] raktavarṇa N₂, om. B, raktaṁ cett. vā cett.] om. N₂
dhūmravarṇaṁ em.] dhūmakāro D, dhūmakāra K₁, dhūmāra N₁, dhūmravarṇa N₂, dhūm-
rākāra JU₁, dhūmrākāraṁ γ vā D] va K₁N₁, van JU₁, yan γ, om. N₂ 5 °gni° P] agni° cett.
°samānaṁ cett.] samāne L °maṇḍala° cett.] °maṇḍalaṁ DK₁N₁ sadṛśaṁ em.] sadṛśaṁ
cett. ardha° cett.] ūrdhva° BDJK₁N₁N₂, ārdha° U₁ 5–6 jvalad° cett.] jalad U₁ 6 °ākāśa°
cett.] °ā° JU₁, °ākāraṁ U₂ °samākāraṁ cett.] °samānakāraṁ β, samakāraṁ U₂, °samākāra L
°mitaṁ cett.] °manomittaṁ U₁ °mano° cett.] om. U₁ lakṣyaṁ cett.] tathyaṁ E, lakṣaṁ
BLU₂, lakṣaṇaṁ N₂ etasmil PLU₂] etasmin U₁, ekasmin cett. lakṣye cett.] lakṣe BLU₂, na
lakṣye U₁, lakṣaṇo N₂ 7 malasya cett.] om. P manasaḥ cett.] manaḥ saḥ D °guṇaḥ PL]
°guṇe N₁, °guṇa° EU₂, °guṇo cett. prakāto cett.] °prakāśo EU₂

It performs [the] opening and closing [of the eyes]. From the Kṛkala vital wind belching arises. From the Devadatta vital wind yawning arises. From the Dhanañjaya vital wind sound arises.

[XXVII. Central focus]

Now, the central focus is taught. Within the mind, the focus shall be directed onto the light which is white-coloured or yellow-coloured or red-coloured or grey-coloured or blue-coloured, like the flame of fire, equal to lightning, like the orb of the sun, like a half-moon, appearing like flaming space, [and] in the same size as one's own body.²⁹⁵ When the focus is performed, the burning of impurity within the mind manifests. The *sattva* quality²⁹⁶ of the mind becomes revealed.²⁹⁷ The person becomes blissful [and] remains like that.

indicates a corruption of the transmission or a mistake by Rāmacandra. The description of the function of the vital wind in this passage makes it slightly more likely that the term *vyāna* was dropped and replaced with *nāga*. In turn, the original descriptions of the functions of the vital winds were further confused in the course of transmission.

²⁹⁵Cf. **shivayogapradīpikā** 4.47cd–48: *śṛṇuṣva madhyalakṣyam ca kathitaṃ pūrvasūribhiḥ* || 4.47 *śvetādivarṇanavakhaṇḍacandrasaudāminivahnīśikhena bimbāt | jvalannabho vā sthalaḥinam ekaṃ vilakṣayet tat khalu madhyalakṣyam* 4.48 || “(47cd) Hear now the central fixation which the ancient sages have taught. (48) One should focus on one [object] devoid of location or the burning space [emerging] from a sphere with flames and lightning shining (*candra*) into [all] nine landmasses (of the continent Jambūdvīpa: Bhārata, Hari, Kimpuruṣa, Ramyaka, Ramaṇa, Kuru, Bhadrāśva, Ketumāla and Ilāvṛta) in the colours of white etc. Truly, this is the central fixation.” Despite all similarities, the differences of the techniques are: In the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, the practitioner should direct the mind towards the burning space or that which lacks locality. Conversely, Rāmacandra prescribes fixing one's mind onto the luminous mind, which is equated with the spatial extension of the human body.

²⁹⁶For a discussion of the *guṇas* in the context of Pātāñjalayoga, see **bryant2009**.

²⁹⁷The generation of the *sattvic* quality through the practice of *madhyalakṣ(y)a* also appears in **sarvangayoga** 3.28: *madhya lakṣa mana madhya bicārai | vapu pramāna koi rūpa niḥarai | yāte sātvik upajai āi | madhya lakṣa jo sādhai bhāi* || “The central focus directs the mind to reside at its centre, viewing the measure of the body according to its form. It produces the *sattvic* quality in those who practice it.”

[XXVIII. ākāśabhedāḥ]

इदानीमाकाशभेदाः कथ्यन्ते। तेषां लक्ष्यानि कथ्यन्ते। आकाशः ॥ पराकाशः ॥ महाकाशः ॥ तत्त्वाकाशः ॥ सूर्याकाशः ॥ बाह्याभ्यन्तरे निर्मलं निराकारमाकाशलक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। ततः परं बाह्याभ्यन्तरे घनान्धकारसदृशपराकाशस्य लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। ततः परं प्रलयकालीनज्वलद्वावानलपूर्णं बाह्याभ्यन्तरे महाकाशं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। ततः परं बाह्याभ्यन्तरे कोटिदीपानां प्रकाशप्राप्तौ यादृशं औज्ज्वल्यं भवति। तादृशं तत्त्वाकाशं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्।

Sources: 2–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): kathyate tu devy adhunākāśaṃ pañcabhir lakṣaṇaiḥ | ākāśan tu mahākāśaṃ parākāśaṃ parāt param | tattvākāśaṃ sūryākāśaṃ ākāśaṃ pañcalakṣaṇam | cf. YSv (PT, p. 839; YK 1.37): ākāśan tu mahākāśaṃ parākāśaṃ parāt param | tattvākāśaṃ sūryākāśaṃ ākāśaṃ pañcalakṣaṇam | sabāhyābhyantare nityaṃ nirākāśantu (*nirākāśas tu* YK 2.38) nirmalam | karttavyaṃ lakṣam ākāśaṃ sādhaḥet sādhanam vinā | ghanāntarālāsadrśaṃ parākāśaṃ tathaiva ca | koṭikoṭipradīpābhaṃ tattvākāśaṃ smaret tathā | kalpāntāgnisamaṃ (*kālāntāgnisamaṃ* YK 2.39cd) jyotir mahākāśaṃ smaret tathā | 2–7 cf. SSP 2.30 (Ed. p. 42): ākāśaṃ parākāśaṃ mahākāśaṃ tatvākāśaṃ sūryākāśaṃ iti vyomapañcakam | bāhyābhyantare 'tyantaṃ nirmalaṃ nirākāraṃ ākāśaṃ lakṣayet | athavā bāhyābhyantare 'tyantāndhakāranibhaṃ parākāśaṃ avalokayet | bāhyābhyantare kālānalasaṃkāśaṃ mahākāśaṃ avalokayet | bāhyābhyantare nijatatvakharūpaṃ tatvākāśaṃ avalokayet |

2 *idānīm* EPU₂] *idānīm* cett. *ākāśabhedāḥ* EN₂U₁U₂] *ākāśabhedāḥ* cett. *kathyante* cett.] *kathyate* LN₂U₂ *teṣāṃ* cett.] *te* E, *ṣaṃ* U₁, *om.* BL *lakṣyāni* cett.] *lakṣaṇāni* N₂, *om.* BL *kathyante* DU₁U₂] *ca* *kathyante* P, *kathyate* N₁N₂, *om.* BL *ākāśaḥ* BELP] *ākāśa°* β *parākāśaḥ* PU₂] *parākāśa* JN₁, *parākāśa°* DN₂U₁, *parā++++°* K₁, *paramākāśaḥ* BEL 3 *mahākāśaḥ* ELPU₂] *mahākāśa* BN₁, *mahākāśa°* DN₂U₁, *++hākāśa°* K₁ *tattvākāśaḥ* BELU₂] *tatvākāśa* JN₁, *tatvākāśa°* DK₁N₂U₁ *sūryākāśaḥ* BEL] *sūryākāśaḥ* N₂PU₂, *sūryākāśa* JN₁, *sūryākāśa°* DK₁U₁ 3–4 *nirākāraṃ ākāśa°* E] *nirākāraṃ ākāśa°* JDN₁N₂U₁, *nirākāraṃ ā++śaṃ* K₁, *nirākāraṃ ākāśaṃ* BLP, *nirākāraṃ mākāśaṃ* U₂ 4 *lakṣyaṃ* cett.] *lakṣaṃ* BL, *lakṣaṇaṃ* N₂ *kartavyam* E] *kartavyaṃ* cett. *paraṃ* cett.] *om.* U₂ *bāhyābhyantare* cett.] *bāhyābhyantarai* P *ghanāndha°* cett.] *ghanāṃgha°* B, *śvanandha°* E, *dha°* L *°kāra°* cett.] *°kāraṃ* P *°sadrśa°* cett.] *sadrśaṃ* EU₂, *sadrśaḥ* BL *parākāśasya* cett.] *parākāśaikyam* E, *parākāśa°* BL *lakṣyaṃ* cett.] *lakṣaṃ* BLU₂, *lakṣaṇaṃ* N₂ 5 *paraṃ* cett.] U₂ cett. *pralayakālina* cett.] *pralayakālinaḥ* BL *°jvalad°* cett.] *°jalad°* PB, *°jjala°* U₁ *°dāvā°* DE] *°dvārā vā* K₁, *dhaḍvā* J, *°vaḍa vā°* BLP, U₂, *°vṛddha°* N₁, *°vr°* N₂ *°nalapūrṇaṃ* cett.] *nalapūrṇa* N₁N₂U₂ *mahākāśaṃ* DJK₁PU₁] *mahākāśa°* BELN₁N₂, *ghanāṃ dhakārasadrśaṃ mahākāśasya* U₂ *°lakṣyaṃ* cett.] *°lakṣaṃ* BDK₁LN₂U₂ 6 *tataḥ paraṃ bāhyābhyantare koṭidīpānāṃ* cett.] *om.* E *prakāśaprāptau* cett.] *prakāśaprāpto* BL, *prakāśa++++°* K₁, *om.* E *yādṛśaṃ* cett.] *++drśaṃ* K₁, *om.* E *aujvalyaṃ* cett.] *ujvalaṃ* L, *om.* E 6–7 *bhavati* cett.] *bhavati* BL, *om.* E 7 *tādṛśaṃ* cett.] *om.* E *tattvākāśaṃ* cett.] *tattvāśa°* BL, *om.* E *lakṣyaṃ* P]N₁U₁] *lakṣaṃ* BDK₁LN₂U₂, *om.* E *kartavyaṃ* cett.] *om.* E

[XXVIII. Divisions of space]

Now, the divisions of space are taught.²⁹⁸ Their foci are taught: Space, beyond space, great space, reality-space, the sun-space. The focus on space shall be visualised as pure and formless internally and externally. After that, the focus onto beyond space shall be visualised as dense darkness²⁹⁹ internally and externally. Then, the focus on the great space shall be visualised as the plethora of the burning fire of the time of dissolution internally and externally. Afterwards, the focus on the reality-space should be visualised internally and externally as resembling the splendour upon being fixed onto the brightness of ten million lights.

²⁹⁸The **advaya** 7 (Ed. pp. 4–5) does not separate the practice of Madhyalakṣya from the five spaces. Here, both practices form a unified whole and follow a specific progression: *atha madhyalakṣyalakṣaṇaṃ | prātaḥ citrādivarṇākhaṇḍasūryacakravat vahniṇvālāvalīvat tadvināntarikṣavat paśyati | tadākārākāritayā avatiṣṭhati | tadbhūyodarśanena guṇarahitākāśaṃ bhavati | viṣphurattārakākāradīpyamānagāḍhatamopamaṃ paramākāśaṃ bhavati | kālānālasamadyotamānaṃ mahākāśaṃ bhavati | sarvotkṛṣṭaparamadyutipradyotamānaṃ tattvākāśaṃ bhavati | koṭisūryaprakāśavaibhavaśaṃ sūryākāśaṃ bhavati | evaṃ bāhyābhyantarasthavyomapañcakam tārakalakṣyam | taddarśi vimuktaphalas tādṛgyomasamāno bhavati | tasmāt tāraka eva lakṣyam amanaskaphalapradam bhavati || 7 ||* “Now, he sees the characteristics of the central fixation [which is], like the indivisible orb of the sun, [being] colourful like the variety [of colours of the sun] in the early morning etc., [then] like a row of flames of fire, [and finally] the atmosphere devoid of that. He dwells in a state [in which he is mentally] assuming the form of the apparition of that. By contemplating about that, the space (*ākāśa*) without qualities arises. [From that] supreme space (*parākāśa*) resembling absolute dense darkness shining in the form of a sparkling star arises. [From that] the great space (*mahākāśa*) whose shine equals the fire of time arises. [From that] the space of reality (*tattvākāśa*) arises, shining forth with supreme brilliance surpassing everything. [From that] the space of the sun (*sūryākāśa*) arises [which is endowed with] a brilliance as powerful as mighty as the brilliance of ten million suns. Thus, the fixations of Tāraka[yoga] consist of five spaces (*vyoma*) situated internally and externally. He who sees them becomes the same as such space [and] becomes one who is freed from the results [of his actions]. Because of that, only Tāraka[yoga] is the central fixation which bestows the fruits of the no-mind state (*amanaska*).”

²⁹⁹Instead of extreme brightness as in the **ssplonavlā** (Ed. p. 29) and **advaya** (Ed. p. 5), Rāmacandra has chosen to promote dense darkness in his *parākāśa*-visualization.

ततः पश्चाद्वाह्याभ्यन्तरे प्रकाशमानसूर्यबिम्बसहितं सूर्याकाशं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। एते
षां लक्ष्याणां कारणाच्छरीरे रोगसंसर्गो न भवति। तथा वलितं पलितं पुण्यं पापं
च न भवति।

नवचक्रं कलाधारं त्रिलक्ष्यं व्योमपञ्चकम्।

5

समक्रिया न जानाति स योगी नामधारकः ॥ XXVIII.1॥

Sources: 1-3 cf. SSP 2.30 (Ed. p. 42): athavā bāhyābhyantare sūryakoṭisadrśaṃ sūryākāśam avalokayet | 1-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): sūryākāśaṃ tathā koṭisūryavindusamaṃ (*°bimbasaṃ* YK 2.40d) smaret | sabāhyābhyantare caivam ākāśaṃ (*caiva sākāśaṃ* YK 2.41b) lakṣayet tu yaḥ | śivavad vihareḍ viśve pāpapuṇyavivarjitaḥ | eteṣāṃ caiva lakṣeṇa karmadvārā 'ghamāharet (*karmadvārā na pāharet* YK 2.41d) | 4-5 ≈ SSP 2.31 (Ed. p. 43): navacakraṃ kalādhāraṃ tri-lakṣyaṃ vyomapañcakam | samyag etan na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhāraḥ | 4-5 = YSv (PT, p. 832) = YK 2.14: navacakraṃ kalādhāraṃ trilakṣaṃ vyomapañcakam | svadehe yo na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhāraḥ | 4-5 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 839): navacakraṃ kalādhāraṃ dvilakṣaṃ vyomapañ-cakam | samagraṃ yo na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhāraḥ |

Parallels: 4-5 ≈ *netratantra* 7.1cd-2: ataḥ paraṃ pravakṣyāmi dhyānaṃ sūkṣmaṃ anutta-mam | ṛtucakraṃ svarādhāraṃ trilakṣyaṃ vyomapañcakam || granthidvādaśasaṃyuktaṃ śaktitrayasamanvitam | dhāmatrayapathākraṇtaṃ nāḍitrayasamanvitam || 4-5 ≈ *tantraloka* 19.15: ṣoḍaśādhāraṣaṭcakralakṣyatrayakhapañcakāt | kvacid anyataratrātha prāguktapaśukar-mavat | 4-5 ≈ *manthana* 25.2ab: ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ trilakṣyaṃ vyomapañcakam | 4-5 ≈ *urmikaula* 2.184: sarvaṃ samadhiyogena kulena hi tad ucyate | ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ trirlakṣaṃ vyomapañcakam || 4-5 ≈ *yogatarangini* quoted with reference *Nityanāthapaddhati* (Ed. p. 72) = *hathatattvakaumudi* 24.1: ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ dvilakṣyaṃ vyomapañ-cakam | svadehe ye na jānanti kathaṃ siddhyanti yoginaḥ | 4-5 ≈ PT (Ed. p. 172): ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ trilakṣaṃ vyomapañcakam | svadehe yo vijānāti sa guruḥ kathito budhaiḥ | 4-5 ≈ *fausta* 1976 13 = *Vivekāmartanda* 6.3: ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ trailokyaṃ vyomapañcakam | svadehe ye na jānanti kathaṃ sidhyanti yoginaḥ | 4-5 ≈ *mandalabrah* 3.4.5: navacakraṃ ṣaḍādhāraṃ trilakṣyaṃ vyomapañcakam | samyag etan na jānāti sa yogī nāmato bhavet | 4-5 ≈ *hathapradipika* 2024 4.61: ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ tridhā lakṣaṃ guṇatrayam | śeṣas tu granthavistāras trikūṭaṃ paramaṃ padam |

1 tataḥ cett.] om. BL paścād cett.] paścāt N₁N₂U₁, paccā BL, om. E bāhyābhyantare cett.] ābhyamtare N₂, bāhyā+++++ K₁ °māna° cett.] °māga° P, °mān BL °sūrya° cett.] °yarsu° E, °sūryam P °bimba° cett.] om. E °sahitaṃ cett.] °sahita° BL sūryākāśaṃ cett.] sūryakāśa° BLP lakṣyaṃ cett.] lakṣaṃ BJLN₂ kartavyam cett.] kartavyaṃ mataḥ BL 2 lakṣyāṇām cett.] lakṣāṇām JP, lakṣaṇām B, lakṣaṃ L, lakṣāṇā N₂ kāraṇāc N₂ kāraṇāt E, karanāt cett. charire N₂ śarira° DK₁N₁, śarire BJPLU₂, °śariraṃ E rogāsaṃsargo cett.] rogāsaṃsargi E, rohasaṃsargo D, rohasaṃsarge N₁, rogāsaṃsargo N₂U₁U₂ na cett.] om. E bhavati cett.] bhavati B valitaṃ palitaṃ cett.] vali° N₂, valita° BEP puṇyaṃ cett.] puṇyām BL 3 ca cett.] om. E bhavati cett.] bhavati BL, bhati U₁ 4 navacakraṃ cett.] śloka navacakraṃ BL, navacakra° DK₁N₁N₂ °lakṣyaṃ cett.] °lakṣaṃ BLN₂ 5 samakriyā β] svadehe yo γ

After that, the focus on sun-space (*sūryākāśa*) shall be visualized as being accompanied by the shining disc of the sun internally and externally. From executing these foci, contact with diseases does not arise within the body. And, wrinkles, grey hair, sin, and merit do not arise.

XXVIII. I One who does not understand the full procedure [consisting of] the nine *cakras*,³⁰⁰ sixteen supports,³⁰¹ the three foci,³⁰² and five spaces is merely a yogin by name.³⁰³

³⁰⁰Rāmacandra's ninefold *cakra* system is described in detail in IV–XII, pp. 108–134, and briefly repeated in XXX, p. 190, in a different order for no clear reason.

³⁰¹The sixteen supports of Rāmacandra are the big toe support (*pādāṅguṣṭhādhāra*), root support (*mūlādhāra*), anus support (*gudādhāra*), penis support (*liṅgādhāra*), Udyāna[-support] (*udyāna*), navel support (*nābhīyādhāra*), heart-form support (*hṛdayarūpādhāra*), throat support (*kaṇṭhādhāra*), uvula support (*ghaṇṭikādhāra*), palate support (*tālīyādhāra*), tongue support (*jihvādhāra*), teeth support (*dantādhāra*), nose support (*nāsikādhāra*), breath support at the root of the nose (*nāsāmūle vāyūyādhāra*), centre of the eyebrows support support (*bhrūvormaḍhyādhāra*) and the eye support (*netrādhāra*). Each one of them is associated with a particular yogic technique. The sixteen supports are presented in *Tattvayogabindu* XXXI.

³⁰²The three foci called *antar(a)lakṣya*, *bahirlakṣya* (often called *bāhyalakṣya* in the *pañcalakṣya* system of Rāmacandra and others) and *madhyalakṣya* are the predecessors of the five foci found in *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted in *ramatosana* and *yogakarnika* and *sarvangayoga*. The two additional foci are *ūrdhvalakṣya* and *adholakṣya*. A system of three foci is taught in *tantraloka*, *manthana*, *netrat Tantra*, *fausta*1976, *shivayogapradipika*, *ssplonavla*, *advaya*, *yogacudamani*, *mandalabrah*. Structurally, it is surprising that Rāmacandra mentions all five *lakṣyas* in section XIII, then teaches *ūrdhvalakṣya* in section XIV and *adholakṣya* in section XV, and just after the introduction of various other topics, he continues the subject of Lakṣya yoga by teaching *bāhyalakṣya* in section XXIII, *antar(a)lakṣya* in section XXIV and finally *madhyalakṣya* in section XXVIII.

³⁰³As shown by the sources and testimonia on the previous page, the reception of the variants of this verse and its practices is widespread—from Śaiva Tantras such as *tantraloka*, *manthana*, and *netrat Tantra*, through early and classical Haṭha- and Rājayoga works (e.g. *hathapradipika*2024), into the post-*Haṭhapradipikā* era and the late *yogaupanīṣaded*. Most technical terms appear already in earlier Śaiva Tantras, such as the *Mālinīvijayottaratantra*, which, however, presents a more elaborate but conceptually distinct system of six *lakṣyas* (cf. *vasudeva*2004).

[XXIX. cakrāṇām anukramah]

- इदानीं चक्राणामनुक्रमः कथ्यते। आधारे ब्रह्मचक्रम् १ ॥ आधारेपरि लिङ्गमूले
स्वाधिष्ठानचक्रम् २ ॥ नाभौ मणिपूरकचक्रम् ३ ॥ हृदयेऽनाहतचक्रम् ४ ॥ क-
ण्ठस्थाने विशुद्धिचक्रम् ५ ॥ षष्ठं तालुचक्रम् ६ ॥ भ्रुवोर्मध्ये आज्ञाचक्रम् ७ ॥
5 अब्रह्मन्त्रस्थाने कलाचक्रम् ८ ॥ नवममाकाशचक्रम् ९ ॥ तत्परमशून्यम् ॥

Sources: 2–5 cf. SSP 2.1–9 (Ed. p. 29–32): atha piṇḍavicāraḥ kathyate piṇḍe navacakraṇi | ādhāre brahmacakram tridhāvartam bhagamaṇḍalākāram | tatra mūlakandaḥ | tatra śaktiṃ pāvakākārām dhyāyet | tatraiva kāmārūpapiṭham sarvakāmaphalapradam bhavati | dvitīyaṃ svādhiṣṭhānacakram | tanmadhye paścimābhimukham liṅgaṃ pravālāṅkurasadrśam dhyāyet | tatraivodyānapīṭham jagadākarṣaṇam bhavati | tṛtīyaṃ nābhicakram pañcāvartam sarpavat kuṇḍalākāram | tanmadhye kuṇḍalinīm śaktiṃ bālārakatoṭisannibhām dhyāyet | sā madhyā śaktiḥ sarvasiddhidā bhavati | caturtham hṛdayacakram aṣṭadalakamalam adhomukham | tanmadhye karṇikāyām liṅgākārām jyotirūpām dhyāyet | saiva haṃsakalā sarvendriyavaśyā bhavati | pañcamam kaṇṭhacakram caturaṅgulam | tatra vāma idā candranāḍi | dakṣiṇe piṅgalā sūryanāḍi | tanmadhye suṣumnām dhyāyet | saiva anāhatakālā anāhataśiddhidā bhavati | ṣaṣṭham tālucakram | tatrāmṛtadhārāpravāhaḥ | ghaṇṭikālīṅgaṃ mūlarandhram rājadantaṃ śaṅkhinivivaraṃ daśamadvāram | tatra śūnyaṃ dhyāyet | cittalayo bhavati | sapṭamam bhrūcakram madhyamaṅguṣṭhamatram | tatra jñānanetraṃ dīpaśikhākāram dhyāyet | tatra vāksiddhir bhavati | aṣṭamam brahmarandhram nirvāṇacakram sūcikāgrabhedyam | tatra dhūmaśikhākāram dhyāyet | tatra jālandharapiṭham mokṣapradam bhavati | navamam ākāśacakram soḍaśadalakamalam ūrdhvamukham | tanmadhye karṇikāyām trikūṭākārām tadūrdhvaśaktiṃ tām paramaśūnyāṃ dhyāyet | tatraiva pūrṇagiripīṭham sarveṣṭasiddhipradam bhavati | iti navacakravācārah ||

2 anukramah cett.] anukrama N₁, anukramā DK₁N₂, anukramāḥ J kathyate cett.] kathyante DN₁N₂ ādhāre cett.] ādhāro BL brahmacakram BEL] brahmacakram cett. ādhāroperi γ] om. β liṅgamūle γ] liṅge β 3 svādhiṣṭhānacakram DJK₁EPN₁N₂] svādhiṣṭhānacakram cett. maṇipūrakacakram ELPN₁N₂] maṇipūrakacakram cett. 'nāhata° P] anāhata° BELU₂, viśuddha° cett. cakram BEL] cakram cett. 4 viśuddhicakram γ] anāhatacakram β ṣaṣṭham cett.] ṣaṣṭha° L tālucakram EN₁N₂] tālucakram DPU₁, tālucakre BL, tālucakra U₂ °ājñā cett.] agneya P, āgneya L, ājñāya B cakram cett.] cakram BD]K₁LP 5 °randhra° cett.] om. BJELP kalā° U₂] kalā° BDK₁ELPN₁N₂, brahma° U₁, om. J cakram E] cakram cett., om. J navamam cett.] navama N₂, navamam rattu U₁ °cakram cett.] ākāśacakram || cha || J, ākāśacakram BLP tat° cett.] etat E, tataḥ P, tata N₂ °parama° JK₁N₁] °param γD, para° N₂U₁ °śūnyam BEL] °śūnyam JK₁PN₁N₂U₁U₂, tatparamaśūnyam D

[XXIX. Sequence of cakras]

Now, the sequence of the *cakras* is taught.³⁰⁴ At the base,³⁰⁵ there is the Brahmacakra. Above the base at the root of the penis is the Svadiṣṭhānacakra. At the navel, there is the Maṇipūrakacakra. In the heart [there is] the Anāhatcakra. Situated within the throat is the Viśuddhicakra. The sixth is the Tālucakra. In the centre of the eyebrows is the Ājñācakra. At the aperture of Brahman³⁰⁶ is the Kalācakra.³⁰⁷ The ninth is the Ākāśacakra.³⁰⁸ It is supreme emptiness.

³⁰⁴Rāmacandra again describes the *cakras*, briefly naming them—partly with different terms and locations than before. A detailed ninefold system was already given in IV–XII; this repetition seems redundant. No parallel exists in the *Yogasvarodaya*, and in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* only the positions, not the terminology, mostly coincide. No other ninefold *cakra* system known to me matches this terminology fully. It may thus be Rāmacandra's own synthesis or based on an unknown source. For comparative overviews of nine-, eight-, and sixfold systems, see **powell2023**. For a tabular overview of the ninefold *cakra* systems and closely related systems with eight and six *cakras* see **powell2023**.

³⁰⁵In the previous section on *cakras* Rāmacandra situates the first *cakra*, which he there calls *mūlacakra*, at the beginning (*ādau*) [of supposedly the central channel], which should be at the anus if we assume an ascending order, cf. p. 108.

³⁰⁶The fontanelle, through which the vital principle of the yogi exists at death, cf. **rootsofyoga2017**.

³⁰⁷The term *kalācakra* (“*cakra* of the digit”) for the eighth *cakra* is unprecedented in other texts that teach *cakra* systems. A comparison of the term with the current standard collection of electronic texts in yogic and tantric studies, as well as with collections such as Muktabodha and GRETIL, yielded no hits. Thus, this appears to be an original and previously unknown term for a yogic *cakra*. All other texts that I am aware of designate the eighth *cakra* in a ninefold *cakra* system with different terms: **peterson1888** 4359/256.13, **shivayogapradipika** 3.15 and **ssplonavla** 2.8 call it *nirvāṇacakraṃ* (“*cakra* of absolute extinction”); *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted in **ramatosana** (Ed. p. 833) just calls it *aṣṭamaṃ cakram* (“the eighth *cakra*”) and *siddhapuṃsaḥ sthalaṃ* (“place of the accomplished human”); Rāmacandra himself in the previous chapter on *cakras* in section XI picks this up and calls it *aṣṭamacakraṃ* (“eighth *cakra*”) and *siddhapuruṣasya sthānaṃ* (“place of the accomplished person”); **saubhagya** also calls it *nirvāṇacakraṃ*, but provides us with yet another unique designation—*parabrahmacakraṃ* (“*cakra* of the supreme Brahman”).

³⁰⁸The term *ākāśacakra* for the ninth *cakra* in the known ninefold *cakra* systems occurs in **shivayogapradipika** 3.16 and **ssplonavla** 2.9 only.

[XXX. ādhārācakraśya bhedāḥ]

इदानीमाधारचक्रस्य भेदाः कथ्यन्ते । पादयोरङ्गुष्ठे तेजसो लक्ष्यकारणादृष्टिः स्थिरा भवति । द्वितीयो मूलाधारः । पादाङ्गुष्ठस्य मूलेऽपरपादस्य पार्श्विः स्थाप्यते । अग्निः प्रबलो भवति । एका पार्श्विमूलाधारेऽथ स्थाप्यते । तस्य पादस्याङ्गुष्ठमूलेऽपरस्य पादस्य पार्श्विः स्थाप्यते । अग्निर्प्रदीप्यते ।

Sources: 2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839) = YK 2.15: *ṣoḍaśādhārābhedan tu śrṇu devi viśeṣataḥ* | cf. SSP 2.10 (Ed. p. 32): *atha ṣoḍaśādhārāḥ kathyante* | 2-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): *aṅguṣṭhapādayas tejah salakṣasthiradrṣṭimān* | *pādāṅguṣṭhe ya ādhārah prathamō* (*prathamam* YK 2.16) *yogatattvataḥ* | 2-3 cf. SSP 2.10 (Ed. p. 32): *tatra prathamah pādāṅguṣṭhādhārāḥ* | *tatrāgratas tejomayaṁ dhyāyet* | *drṣṭiḥ sthirā bhavati* | 3-5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): *dvitīyaṁ pādāmūlan tu pādāmūlaparaṁ* (*pādāmūlaṁ paraṁ* YK 2.16) *sa vai* | *pādasya pārṣṇi* (*pārṣṇi* YK 2.17a) *saṁsthāpya balavān prabhaven munih* | *pādāmūle 'thavā pādāṅguṣṭhamūlaṁ* (*prṣṭhe pādāṅguṣṭhe* YK 2.17) *vidhārayet* || 3-5 cf. SSP 2.11 (Ed. p. 33): *dvitīyo mūlādhāras taṁ vāmapādapārṣṇinā niṣpīḍya sthātavyam* | *tatrāgnidīpanam bhavati* |

Testimonia: 2 cf. *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r ll. 3-4): *ity ādhārāḥ ṣoḍaśayaṁ athoktānāṁ ṣoḍaśādhārāṇāṁ kartavyatām āha* | 2-3 ≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r l. 4): *tatra mūlādhārāḥ 1 pādayor aṅguṣṭhe tejaso lakṣyakaraṇād drṣṭiḥ sthirā bhavati* 2 *ity ādhārācakraṁ* | 3-5 ≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r ll. 5-7): *atha dvitīyādhārāḥ* | *tatra tatra vāmapādāṅguṣṭasya mūlam aparapādasya pārṣṇis tasmin sthāpyate* | *tad āgneḥ pradīpanam bhavati* | *ekah pārṣṇi mūlādhāre dṛḍham sthāpyate* | *tasya pādasya mūla aṅguṣṭhamūlam aparasya pādasya pārṣṇinā saṁpīḍya ciraṁ sthiraṁ sthiyate tadāgnim agni dipyate* | *iti dvitīyadhārāḥ* |

2 *idānim* cett.] *idāni* N₂ *bhedāḥ* cett.] *bhedā* BL *kathyante* cett.] *kathyanta* E, *kathyate* DN₁ *aṅguṣṭhe* cett.] *aṅguṣṭhai* B *tejaso* cett.] *tejasam* BL *lakṣya*^o cett.] *lakṣa*^o N₂, *lakṣam* kartavyam BL **kāraṇād* cett.] **kāraṇāt* P *drṣṭiḥ* cett.] *drṣṭi*^o N₁N₂U₁U₂ 3 *bhavati* cett.] *bhavati* L *mūlādhārāḥ* cett.] *mūlādharaḥ* U₁, *mūlādhare* U₂ *'para*^o cett.] *apara*^o DK₁N₁N₂U₁, *aparasya* BL, *adhara*^o J *pādasya* cett.] *pāda*^o BL *pārṣṇiḥ* cett.] *pārṣṇi* K₁, *dhārāḥ pādāṅguṣṭhasya mūleḥ parapādasya pārṣṇiḥ* P *sthāpyate* cett.] *syāpyate* BL, *sthāpyamte* U₂ *agnih* N₁, *agnim* U₁, *agni*^o DJK₁, *tadāgnih* BELP, *om.* N₂U₂ 4 *prabalo* cett.] *om.* N₂U₂ *bhavati* cett.] *bhavati* BL, *om.* N₂U₂ *ekā* cett.] *ekah* E, *ekam* U₁, *om.* N₂U₂ *pārṣṇiḥ* U₁] *pārṣṇiḥ* DJK₁N₁, *pārṣṇir ādau* BELP, *om.* N₂U₂ *mūlādhāre* cett.] *mūlādhāra* BU₁, *mūlādhārā* L, *mūlādhārai* DK₁, *mūlādhāram* J, *om.* N₂U₂ *sthāpyate* cett.] *om.* N₂U₂ *tasya* cett.] *om.* U₂ *pādasyāṅguṣṭhamūle* cett.] *pādasya aṅguṣṭhamūlaṁ* N₁JU₁, *om.* U₂ *'parasya* EP] *aparasya* cett., *om.* U₂ 5 *pādasya* cett.] *om.* JU₁U₂ *pārṣṇiḥ* cett.] *pārṣṇi* J, *pārṇi* N₂, *pārṣṇo* U₁, *om.* U₂ *sthāpyate* cett.] *sthāpyam* DK₁N₁N₂, *om.* U₂ *agnir* DK₁N₁] *agni* N₂U₁, *tadāgnih* E, *tadāgnih* BPU₂, *tadāgnih* L, *om.* J *pradīpyate* E] *pradīpyate* BLPU₂, *dīpyate* DU₁, *dāpyate* N₁, *dīpate* N₂, *akṣīpyate* J

[XXX. Divisions of the wheels of support]

Now, the divisions of the group³⁰⁹ of supports³¹⁰ are taught.

As a result of focusing on a light at the big toes of both feet, the gaze becomes steady.³¹¹

The root support is the second [one]. The heel of the back-foot is caused to be placed at the base of the big toe of the foot.³¹² The fire is strengthened. [In other words,] one heel is placed at the root support. The heel of the other foot is placed at the base of the big toe of this foot. The fire is kindled.^{313, 314}

³⁰⁹I took *cakra* in the sense of “group, crowd, totality”, cf. **petersburger**.

³¹⁰The practice of sixteen *ādhāras* goes back to the yoga traditions of Śaivism and is mentioned in texts such as **tantraloka**, **manthana** and **netratantra**. The techniques were passed on, copied and recycled across the centuries among the yoga traditions of Haṭha- and Rājayoga. Besides Rāmacandra’s text, the other texts which present full lists of the sixteen *ādhāras* are *Netroddyota*-commentary of Kṣemarāja on *Netratantra* 7.5; **saradaavalon** 25.24–25; **shivayogapradipika** 3.17–33; **ssplonavla** 2.10–25; **yogatarangini** 1.13 (Ed. p. 72–73) quotation with reference “*nityanāthapaddhatau*” (maybe another recension of the **ssplonavla**, see **powell2023**); **hathatattvakaumudi** 24.10–23 and 40.19; and **jyotsna** on **hathapradipika** 2024, as well as **ramatosana** (Ed. p. 839–841) quotation with reference “*yogasvarodaye*” and **yogakarnika** quotation with reference “*yogasvarodaye*” 14–36. **Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā** (cf. GOML R3239, f. 201 l. 20 to f. 204 ll. 5–6) directly quotes the *Tattvayogabindu* without reference. Comparing the various lists of *ādhāras* reveals great variability. Rāmacandra’s system draws from the *Yogasvarodaya* and the **ssplonavla**. When there are differences in the descriptions of the respective *ādhāras* among the texts I note them in the annotations without providing a reference again; for the Sanskrit, see the above-provided references.

³¹¹In all previously mentioned systems, the big toe is the first *ādhāra*. In most texts, the practitioner is instructed to fixate the mind onto the big toe—either one shall visualize a light there (as in **shivayogapradipika**) or the light is already present. The **saradaavalon**, however, instructs to fix *prāṇa* in each *ādhāra* listed. Here, the practice of the *ādhāras* is subsumed under the *dhāraṇā*-limb of an eight-fold (*aṣṭāṅga*) yoga system.

³¹²The base of the big toe of the foot (*pādasyāṅguṣṭhamūla*) is probably the big toe joint of the foot or *articulatio metatarsophalangealis hallucis*.

³¹³Rāmacandra combines the techniques presented in YSv and SSP for this *ādhāra*, resulting in a *siddhāsana*-like bodily position.

³¹⁴*Netroddyota*, **saradaavalon** and **jyotsna** give the ankle (*gulpha*) as the second *ādhāra*.

तृतीयं गुदाधार स्थानम् स्थानं तन्मध्ये संकोचविकासाकुञ्चनकारणात्पवनः स्थिरो भवति । अनु च पुरुषस्य मरणं न भवति । चतुर्थं लिङ्गाधारम् । तन्मध्ये लिङ्गसंको-
चनाभ्यासात्पश्चिमदण्डमध्ये वज्रनाडी भवति । तन्मध्ये पुनरभ्यासकरणात्मनः-
पवनयोः संचारो भवति । तयोः संचारात्मध्ये ग्रन्थित्रयं त्रुट्यति । तत्त्रोटनात्पवनो
5 ब्रह्मकमलमध्ये पूर्णो भूत्वा तिष्ठति । ततो वीर्यस्तम्भो भवति । पुरुषः सदैव युवैव
भवति ।

Sources: 1-2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): *ṛṭṭiyan tu gudādhāro (gudādhāre YK 2.18) gudasaṅkocanakriyā | vikāśakuñcanaṃ (em. vikāśa° PT) tasya sthīravāyau ca mṛtyujit | 1-0.0 cf. SSP 2.12 (Ed. p. 33): ṛṭṭiyo gudādhāra taṃ vikāśasaṅkocanena nirākuñcayet | apānavāyuh sthīro bhavati | 2-6 cf. Ysv (PT, pp. 839-840): liṅgādhāraṃ caturthan tu liṅgasaṅkocanan tu ca | liṅgasaṅkocanābhyāsāt paścimādaṇḍamadyagaḥ | vajranāḍīti (vajrānāḍī tu YK 2.20) tanmadhye punar abhyasyaṃs (abhyasanan YK 2.20) tathā | saṅcāro vāyumanasor atisaṅcāra iti (ratim saṅcarati YK 2.20) tridhā | granthitrayavibhedas (°bhedan YK 2.21) tu tadbhedo brahmamārgataḥ | brahma- padmo (°padme YK 2.21) vāyupūrṇo (°pūrṇe YK 2.21) bhūtvā tiṣṭhati yogirāt | vīryastambho bhavet tena sādhyet tu sadā yuvā | mūlādhāre brahmapadme śaṭpadme ca tathā tathā | 2-6 cf. SSP 2.13 (Ed. pp. 33-34): caturtho meḍhrādhāraḥ | liṅgasaṅkocanena brahmagranthitrayaṃ bhitvā bhramaraguḥyāyāṃ viśramya tata ūrdhvamukhe bindustambhaṇaṃ bhavati | eṣa va- jrolī prasiddhā*

Testimonia: 1-2 ≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r ll. 7-9): *atha ṛṭṭiyādhāraḥ ṛṭṭiyaṃ gudādhārasthānaṃ tanmadhye dṛḍhaṃ muhuś ciraṃ saṅko- canavikāsanarūpākumcanakaraṇād pānavāyuh dvā vāmapādād pārṣṇimūlena gudāśya nipiḍanād apānavāyuh sthīro bhavati | cāmaraṃ karoti sādhaḥ | iti ṛṭṭiyādhāraḥ | 2-6 ≈ hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r l. 9 to f. 95v l. 3): *atha caturthaṃ liṅgādhāraḥ | tanmadhye liṅgasaṅkocanābhyāsāt mūlabamdhena gudāyā muhuś saṅko- cane kṛte liṅgasaṅkocanaṃ svayame liṅgasaṅkocanābhyāsāt mūlabamdhena gudāyā muhuś saṅkocane kṛte liṅgasaṅkocanaṃ svayaṃ eva bhavati | paścimādaṇḍamadye vajranāḍī bhavati tanmadhye punarabhyāsakaraṇān manāḥpavanayoḥ saṃcāro bhavati | tayoḥ saṃcārān madhye gramthitrayaṃ trudyati | tat troṭanāt pavano brahmakamalamadhye pūrṇo bhūtvā tiṣṭhati | tadā vīryastambho bhavati | puruṣa sadaiva yuvā tiṣṭhati | iti caturthādhāraḥ 4*

1 *ṛṭṭiyaṃ* cett.] *ṛṭṭiya* U₂ °sthānam em.] °sthāne B, °sthānam cett. °sthānam cett.] °sthāne B °vikāśa° E] °vikāśa° BDPN₁N₂, °vikāśa L, °vikāśa U₁ °kuñcana cett.] ākumcana L, akum- cana U₁, kuṃcanaṃ DK₁N₂ pavanaḥ cett.] pavana° DJK₁U₁U₂N₂ 2 *anu* ca cett.] anyac ca E, anūca N₁N₂, anucara° B, anucakra° L na cett.] om. BPL caturthaṃ cett.] caturtha° BDJK₁L 2-3 *saṅkocanā*° cett.] sakoṇā° N₂ 3 *paścima*° cett.] paścima° BP, paścama° L *vajra*° cett.] vajrā° DJK₁, vajñā° BPL, prajñā° E °karaṇān EPU₂] karaṇāt cett. manāḥ° cett.] punaḥ° BL 4 *pavanayoḥ* cett.] pavanayo BL saṃcāro cett.] saṃcoro DK₁ tayoḥ cett.] tayo B saṃcārān cett.] saṃcārāt DJK₁U₁ trutyati cett.] trutyati B, trūṭayati L, trudyati U₁, ti N₂ °tattroṭanāt K₁N₁U₂] tatroṭanāt BEJLU₁, tata troṭanāt DN₂ pavano BEL] pavanaḥ cett. 5 °kamala° cett.] °ka° BL pūrṇo cett.] pūrṇā BL puruṣaḥ cett.] puruṣa N₂ sadaiva cett.] saṃdaivam P yuvaiva DJK₁L] yuvā E, yuve P, yuvai B, yuve va N₁, yurvaiva N₂, yuvaivam U₁, vai bhavo U₂ 6 *bhavati* cett.] prabhavati P

The third is the place of the anus support.³¹⁵ As a result of expansion, contraction and compression, the vital wind becomes stable [on it]. And then, the person does not die.

The fourth is the penis support. As a result of the practice of contracting the penis in the middle of the [support], the adamantine channel (i.e., central channel)³¹⁶ arises in the posterior staff (i.e., spine).³¹⁷ From the repeated practice, both breath and mind move into that. Caused by the transition of both [breath and mind] the trinity of knots³¹⁸ within [the central channel] are pierced. Because of the piercing of those [knots], the breath becomes full in Brahmā's lotus and remains there.³¹⁹ As a result of that, the stopping of semen arises.³²⁰ The person becomes youthful forever.³²¹

³¹⁵ *Netroddyota*, *saradaavalon* and *vyotsna* provide the knee (*jānu*) as the third *ādhāra*.

³¹⁶ The adamantine channel (*vajranāḍī*) is another synonym for the central channel. Rāmacandra adapted the term from the *Yogasvarodaya*. *yogatarangini* in the commentary on 1.13 uses the term *vajragarbha* ("adamantine womb").

³¹⁷ The posterior staff (*paścimadaṇḍa*) is the spine. Cf. *petersoni1888* 4365.

³¹⁸ The trinity of knots are: 1. the knot of Brahmā (*brahmagranthi*) is situated in the lower regions of the body (cf. *liersch2026* 23–24); 2. the knot of Viṣṇu (*viṣṇugranthi*) at the level of the heart (cf. *liersch2026* 25 and *gsatacod* 80); and 3. the knot of Rudra (*rudragranthi*) at the level of the head or between the eyebrows (cf. *liersch2026* 25 and *gsatacod* 81). Depending on text and tradition, it is either the breath (cf. *asiddhi* 13.9–11) or the *kuṇḍalinī* (cf. *yogabija* 96–97 and *gsatacod* 74–86) that enters the central channel and pierces the knots. *gsatacod* 48 states that the entrance to the central channel is blocked by phlegm and that the three knots have arisen from the three *guṇas*. They obstruct the central passage.

³¹⁹ Brahma's lotus refers to the eighth *cakra* in Rāmacandra's system, cf. chapter VIII, p. 130. The same location is expressed in the *ssplonavla* 2.13 and *yogatarangini* commentary on 1.13 with the term *brahmaraguhā* ("buzzing hive") situated on top of the head (*jogpradīpyaka* 932; also cf. *petersoni1888* 4366 and *gorakbhani* 28.2 and 30.4).

³²⁰ Breath, mind and semen are interconnected. If one of them stops its movement, all stop their movement, cf. *asiddhi* 7.19–20 and 23.

³²¹ Most of the consulted texts situate the fourth *ādhāra* at the penis (*meḍhra*). *saradaavalon* and *vyotsna* place the fourth support at the thighs (*ūru*). *shivayogapradīpika* 3.20 and *ssplonavla* 2.13 additionally associate the practice with the arrest of semen (*bindustambha*). However, *ssplonavla* calls this *vajrolī*.

पञ्चमं उड्डीयाणं स्वाधिष्ठानम् । तत्र बन्धनान्मलमूत्रयोर्नाशो भवति । षष्ठो नाभ्या-
 धारः । तत्र प्रणवाभ्यासादनाहतो नादः स्वयमुत्पद्यते । सप्तमो हृदयरूपाधारः ।
 तस्मिन्स्थाने प्राणवायोर्निरोधात्षडपि कमलान्यूर्ध्वमुखानि विकसन्ति । अष्टमः
 कण्ठाधारः । तत्र जालन्धरो बन्धो दीयते । तस्मिन्सतीडायां पिङ्गलायां पवनः
 5 स्थिरो भवति ।

Sources: 1 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): pañcamam jaṭharādhāraṃ tadā bandhayati kramāt | mṛtyunā bhaṅgasiddho 'yaṃ (mṛtyunā māṅga° YK 2.23) mṛtyor (mṛtyur YK 2.23) eva kṣayaṅkaraḥ | anena paścimād ūrddhaṃ (ūrdhvaṃ YK 2.24) vāyuh kuryād viśāladhiḥ | bandho 'yaṃ buddhimana-soḥ pañcamādhārakārajit | cf. SSP 2.14 (Ed. p. 34): pañcame oḍiyāṇādhārayor bandhanān malamūtrasaṃkocanaṃ bhavati | *uḍyānā° etc. in various mss. 1-2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): nābhyādhāro bhavet śaṣṭhas (śaṣṭhaṃ YK 2.25) tatra prāṇaṃ samabhyaset | svayam utpadyate nādo nādato muktidantataḥ (muktidaṇḍataḥ YK 1.25) | 1-2 cf. SSP 2.15 (Ed. p. 34): śaṣṭhe nābhyādhāra omkāraṃ ekacittenoccārayet | nādalayo bhavati | 2-3 cf. SSP 2.16 (Ed. p. 34): saptame hṛdayādhāre prāṇaṃ nirodhayet | kamalavikāso bhavati | 2-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): saptamo hṛdayādhāras tasmin vāyunibandhanāt | ūrddhaktrāṇi (ūrdhvaktrāṇi YK 2.26) pad-māni vikasanti mahān bhavet | 3-5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840) = YK 2.27: kaṇṭhādhāro 'ṣṭamas tatra kaṇṭhasaṅkocalakṣaṇaḥ | jālandharākhyo bandhaḥ syāt tasmin sati marud dṛḍhaḥ | 3-5 cf. SSP 2.17 (Ed. p. 34): aṣṭame kaṇṭhādhāre kaṇṭhamūlaṃ cibukena nirodhayet | iḍāpiṅgalayor vāyuh sthīro bhavati |

Testimonia: 1 ≈hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244, f. 98v ll. 3-4: athāmamu-drāṇām | tatra baṃdhanān malamūtranāso bhavati | 1-2 ≈hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244 f. 98v ll. 4-5): atha śaṣṭhonābhyādhāraḥ 6 tatra prāṇavābhyāse harau samāhitamanah puruṣasya anāhatanādo manah | sthairyam svayam utpadyate | 2-3 ≈hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244 f. 98v ll. 5-6): atha saptamam hṛdayarūpa ādhāraḥ 7 tasmin yāṇavāyor nirodhā chaṭakamalāni svayam ūrdhamukhaṃ vikasanti | 3-5 ≈hathasamketacandrikajodhpur (MMPP 2244, f. 203 ll. 5-6): athaṣṭamakamṭhādhāraḥ 8 tatra jālaṃdharabaṃdho dīyate tasmin satīḍāpiṅgalāyām pavanaḥ sthīro bhavati |

1 pañcamam cett.] paṃcama B, paṃcam N₂ uḍḍiyāṇam svādhīṣṭhānam PU₂] uḍḍiyāṇam svādhīṣṭhānam BL, uḍḍiyāṇam svādhīṣṭhānam P, udgīryāṇam svādhīṣṭhānam E, udyānam DK₁N₁, udyāṇam J, odyānam N₂, uddyānam U₁ bandhanā E] badhadānān U₂, baṃdhanāt K₁N₁N₂, vaṃdhanāt D, baṃdhadānāt JU₁, baṃdhadānān P, baṃdha dīyate BL malamū-trayor cett.] mūlamūcayor L bhavati cett.] bhavati B 1-2 nābhyādhāraḥ cett.] nābhyādhāras JU₁, nābhyādhāre U₂ 2 tatra cett.] om. E prāṇavābhyāsād Jγ] prāṇavābhyāsāt DK₁N₁N₂, prāṇavābhyāmsad U₁ anāhato cett.] anohato U₂, om. E nādaḥ cett.] nāraḥ P, om. E svaya cett.] svayam N₂, om. E utpadyate cett.] ūtpadyate N₁, om. E saptamo cett.] om. BE hṛdaya° cett.] hṛdayā° U₂, om. BE °rūpādhāraḥ JN₂U₁] °rūpādhāraḥ L, rūpa ādhāraḥ DK₁N₁, °dhāraḥ U₂, om. BE 3 prāṇavāyor cett.] prāṇavāyo B nirodhāt γ] nirudhanāt JK₁, nirūmḍhanāt DN₁N₂U₁ ṣaḍ api BE] ṣaḍam pi J, ṣadapi cett. ūrdhvamukhāni cett.] ūrdhvamukhaṃ DN₁N₂, puttaṣasyordhvamukhaṃ J, ūrusyordha mukhaṃ bhavati U₁ aṣṭamaḥ cett.] aṣṭamaṃ E, aṣṭame BL, aṣṭama° N₂ 4 tatra cett.] tatraḥ DJ jālandharo cett.] jālaṃdharā° N₂, jālaṃ BL dīyate cett.] dīpyate U₁ satīḍāyām EP] satīyām BL, satīśadāyām N₂, sati iḍāyām cett. pavanaḥ cett.] pavana° DJK₁ 5 bhavati cett.] bhavati BL

The fifth is Uḍḍiyāṇa,³²² that is, Svādhiṣṭhāna. As a result of performing a lock at that place, faeces and urine disappear.³²³

The sixth is the support of the navel. There, from the repeated practice of *praṇava*,³²⁴ the unstruck sound³²⁵ arises by itself.³²⁶

The seventh is the support in the form of the heart. The six lotuses [become] upward facing [and] open up from the restraint of the breath in this location.³²⁷

The eighth is the throat support. There, the Jālandhara lock³²⁸ is performed. When [the lock] is engaged, the breath in the Iḍā [and] Piṅgalā channels becomes firm.³²⁹

³²²For a discussion of the term *uḍḍiyāṇa*, see p. 112 n. 149.

³²³*shivayogapradipika*, *ssplonavla* and *yogatarangini* share the concept of binding at Uḍḍiyāṇa. *hathatattvakaumudi* instructs to do a pressing (*moṭana*) at the waist (*kaṭau*). *Netroddyota*, along with *saradaavalon* and *jyotsna* situate the fifth *ādhāra* at the anus (*pāyu* or *sivani*). The *Yogasvarodaya* situates the fifth *ādhāra* at the belly (*jaṭharādhāra*).

³²⁴The syllable *om*. See *bryant2009* 2009, pp. 105–109 and *harimoto2014* 2014, pp. 151–163 for a more detailed discussion of the term *praṇava* in the context of the *Pātāñjalayogaśāstra*.

³²⁵Cf. *hathapradipika* 2024 4.17 et seqq.

³²⁶*ssplonavla* prescribes reciting *om* at the navel; *yogatarangini* adds meditation on the form of consciousness (*cidrūpa*); and *hathatattvakaumudi* instructs retaining the breath at the navel, causing the sound of *om* to rise into emptiness. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, breath retention at the navel likewise produces spontaneous *nāda*, while the *shivayogapradipika* directs contemplation of Kuṇḍalinī there. The *Netroddyota* identifies the *kanda* as the sixth support.

³²⁷Rāmacandra's mention of *ṣaḍ api kamalāny* ("six lotuses") seems inconsistent, as he previously (section XXIX) taught a ninefold *cakra* system. In the *ssplonavla*, *Yogasvarodaya*, and *yogatarangini*, practice at the seventh *ādhāra* culminates in the blossoming of the heart lotus alone; in the *hathatattvakaumudi*, it is consciousness that blossoms in the heart. The *shivayogapradipika* describes the heart centre as a downward-facing eight-petaled lotus bestowing desires, where one should place the mind in the pericarp (*karṇikā*) as a *liṅga* of light. *Netroddyota* identifies the seventh *ādhāra* as the *nāḍi*, the middle path between navel and heart (*nābhīḥṇmadhyamārge tu sarvakāmābhidho mataḥ* |), while *saradaavalon* and *jyotsna* list the navel as the seventh.

³²⁸This passage shows how Rāmacandra shifts between his two sources. In chapter XI, he places Jālandhara at the *brahmarandhra*; see p. 131 for a discussion.

³²⁹The *Netroddyota* locates the support in the belly (*jaṭhara*), while the *saradaavalon* and *jyotsna* place the eighth support in the heart. The remaining texts agree in this regard.

नवमो घण्टिकाधारः तत्र जिह्वाग्रं लग्नं भवति । ततोऽमृतकलाया अमृतं स्रव-
ति । तदमृतपानाच्छरीरमध्ये रोगसंचारो न भवति । दशमस्ताल्वाधारः । तन्मध्ये
चालनं दोहनं च कृत्वा लम्बिकाप्रवेशे सति तालुनि मग्ना जिह्वा तिष्ठति । एकादशो
जिह्वातले जिह्वाधारः । तस्मिन् जिह्वाग्रेणमन्थनं क्रियते । तस्मिन्कृतेऽतिमधुरं पा-
नीयं स्रवति । तथा च कवित्वगीतछन्दोनाटकादिविषयञ्ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते ।

Sources: 1-2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): navamo ghaṇṭikādhāras tatra jihvāgram agrataḥ (*jihvāgrataḥ* kṛte YK 2.28) | sampivaty amṛtaṁ tasmād yogajinmṛtyujitparaḥ | 1-2 cf. SSP 2.18 (Ed. p. 35): navame ghaṇṭikādhāre jihvāgram dhārayet | amṛtakalā sravati | 2-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): daśamas tālukādhāras tatra jihvāgrataḥ kṛte (hemistich omitted in YK) | calane dohane caiva jihvā jaḍati lambitā (*jāyeta lambitam* YK 2.28cd) | nāsikāprāptajihveyaṁ tālulagnā bhavet tataḥ | 2-3 cf. SSP 2.19 (Ed. p. 35): daśame tālvādhāre tālvantar garbhe lambikāṁ cālanadohanābhyāṁ dirghikṛtvā viparītena praveśayet | kāṣṭhibhavati | 3-5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): ekādaśī (*ekādaśo* YK 2.29) bhavet jihvā talajādhāra īśvari | jihvāgramathane tasmīn pāniyaṁ madhuraṁ bhavet | tatpīteṣu kavir gītiyotiś (*gītir* YK 2.29) chandovidāṁ (*chandovidur* YK 2.30) varaḥ | 3-5 cf. SSP 2.20 (Ed. p. 35): ekādaśe atha jihvādhāre tatra jihvāgram dhārayet | sarvaroganāśo bhavati |

Testimonia: 1-2 ≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 98v ll. 6-8): atha nava-
maṁ ghaṇṭikādhāraḥ 9 tatra jihvāyā agraṁ dataṁ cet tata uparitaḥ amṛtaṁ yat sravati | taj
jihvāgreṇa yogī pibati | tadāmṛtapānāc charīramadhye rogāṇāṁ saṁcāro na bhavati | 2-3
≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 98v l. 8): atha daśamaṁ (*daśamaṁ* GOML
R3239) *damam* MMPP 2244) tālvādhāraḥ 10 spaṣṭam | 3-5 ≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur*
(MMPP 2244, f. 98 ll. 8-9): ekādaśo jihvātale jihvādhāraḥ 11 tasmin jihvāgreṇa mathanaṁ
kriyate | tasmin kṛte atimadhuraṁ pāniyaṁ sudhāvat sravati | kavitvagītaḥ cāṁdanāṭakādi-
jñānaṁ svayaṁ utpadyate |

1 navamo cett.] navo B ghaṇṭikā° cett.] ghaṇṭikā° P, ghaṇṭā° L °dhāraḥ cett.] dhāras U₁
jihvāgram cett.] jihvāyāgram D, juhvāyām U₁ bhavati cett.] bhavati B, bhavati vā U₁, bha-
vati || cha || J tato cett.] tataḥ DJK₁N₁U₁ °mṛtakalāyā cett.] mṛtakalāyām L, amṛtakalāyāḥ
DJK₁U₁ amṛtaṁ cett.] amṛta P, om. L 1-2 sravati cett.] om. L 2 tadāmṛtapānāc DJK₁P]
tadamṛtapānāt EN₁N₂U₁, tadamṛtakalāyām amṛtapāni° B, amṛtapānā L, tadamṛtapānā U₂
charira° cett.] śarira° EN₁N₂ na cett.] om. BL bhavati cett.] bhavati B daśamas cett.]
daśamaṁs B, daśamaṁ E, daśama N₁N₂ tanmadhye cett.] stamnamadhye U₁ 3 cālanam
cett.] cālanam D, vānam E dohanam cett.] dollahanam E, dohanam chedanam U₂ kṛtvā
cett.] kratvā BL, sva kṛtvā U₁ lambikā° cett.] cālambikā° J, cālam vika° U₁ sati cett.] śe sati P,
grati DK₁N₁N₂ tāluni magnā cett.] tālūni lagnā N₂, tāluni lagnā JU₁, tālumagnā BPL jihvā
cett.] om. N₂ tiṣṭhati cett.] om. N₂ ekādaśo cett.] ekādaśa J, om. N₂ 4 jihvātale cett.]
om. EN₁N₂ jihvādhāraḥ cett.] om. N₂ tasmin cett.] tasmin na U₁, om. N₂ manthanam
cett.] mathanam DJK₁LP kriyate cett.] kṛtvā BL °ti° cett.] ati° N₁N₂, sati° BDJL 5 sravati
cett.] sravati B tathā cett.] tadā E, kamin nāsikā phatkāravat || tathā N₂ ca cett.] om. BL
kavitva° cett.] kvacitva° BL, kvacitta° D, kavitvam U₂ °gita° N₁N₂U₁] om. cett. °chando° γ]
°cāmdavacchamda° U₁, °cāmda° cett. °nāṭakādi° cett.] nāṭikādi J, °nāḍi° U₁ °viṣaya° γD]
°viṣaye K₁N₁N₂, viṣayam JU₁ jñānam cett.] jñānam U₁ utpadyate cett.] utpadyamte B

The ninth is the support of the uvula. The tip of the tongue becomes attached to it. As a result of that, the nectar of immortality flows from the immortality digit. From drinking the nectar of immortality, diseases do not spread in the body.³³⁰

The tenth is the support of the palate. After the moving and milking have been done, [and] after abiding at the entrance with the tongue in the middle of it, the tongue resides inserted within the [cavity above the] palate.³³¹

The eleventh is the tongue support at the surface of the tongue. In the middle of that [support], the tip of the tongue is churned.³³² When that has been done, a very sweet liquid oozes out. Moreover, after that, the knowledge of areas like poetry, singing, metrics and dance is generated.³³³

³³⁰ Most texts with the sixteen *ādhāra* system share this concept. Only *saradaavalon* and *jyotsna* situate the ninth support at the neck (*grīva*), and *Netroddyota* at the heart.

³³¹ The ninth, tenth, eleventh and twelfth supports are all associated with the tongue-related hathayogic *khecarīmudrā* and its forerunners. For a detailed account of this *khecarīmudrā*, see *mallinson2010*. *Netroddyota* places the tenth support at the tortoise channel (*kūrmanāḍī*), whereas *saradaavalon* and *jyotsna* situate it at the throat (*kaṇṭha*).

³³² For a discussion of the term *manthana* in the context of *khecarīmudrā*, see *mallinson2010*.

³³³ Almost all texts teaching the sixteen *ādhāras* share the concept of the churning of the tongue with just minor differences: *ssplonavlā* teaches the destruction of all diseases (*sarvarogānāśa*) as the result of this practice, *yogatarangini* calls the practice *jihvādhobhāgādhāra*. The *Netroddyota* alone teaches the throat (*kaṇṭha*) as the eleventh *ādhāra*. Here, it states: *lambhikasya sthitaś cordhve sudhādhāraḥ sudhātmakah ||* "Above the place of the uvula is a stream of nectar resembling nectar itself."

तदुपरि द्वादशो दन्तयोर् मध्ये दन्ताधारः । तस्मिन्स्थाने जिह्वाया अग्रं घटीमात्र-
मर्धगटीमात्रं वा बलात्कारेण स्थाप्यते । तस्मिन्सति साधकस्य समग्रा रोगा न-
श्यन्ति । त्रयोदशो नासिकाधारः । तस्मिन्लक्ष्ये कृते सति मनः स्थिरं भवति ।
चतुर्दशो नासामूले वाय्वाधारः तस्मिन्दृष्टेः स्थैर्यकारणात्षष्ठे मासे स्वीयं तेजः प्र-
त्यक्षं भवति । तेजसः प्रत्यक्षत्वे पार्थिवं बन्धनं नृत्त्यति ।

Sources: 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): dantādhāro (*dvandvādhāro* YK 2.31a) dvādaśeti sarvaro-
gakṣayaṅkaraḥ (*sarvarogaḥ* YK 2.31b) | dhārayed dantayor madhye jihvāgraṇ ca balād api |
dhṛtvārdhaghāṭikāmātram sarvarogan (*sarvarogāms* YK 2.32b) tu nāśayet | 1–3 cf. SSP 2.21
(Ed. p. 36): dvādaśe bhrūmadhyādhāre tatra candramaṇḍalaṃ dhyāyet śītalatām yāti | 3 cf.
YSv (PT, p. 832): nāsādhāras tato (*tataḥ* YK 2.32b) jñeyo nāsākṣas trayodaśaḥ (*trayodaśa* YK
2.32d) | manaḥsthirakaro yas tu (*sthiram karoty eva* YK 2.33a) vāyusthirakaro (*vāyuh* YK 2.32b)
mahān | cf. SSP 2.22 (Ed. p. 36): trayodaśe nāsādhāre tasyāgram lakṣayet manaḥ sthiram
bhavati | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839) = YK 2.33ab–34cd): nāsāpuṭe sthirā dṛṣṭir ādhāro 'yaṃ
caturdaśaḥ | kṛte 'smin svīyatejaḥ syāt pratyakṣaṃ śaṭtrimāsataḥ | pāṛthivaṃ trūṭati kṣipram
pratyakṣaṃ svīyatejaśā | 4–5 cf. SSP 2.23 (Ed. p. 36): caturdaśe nāsāmūle kapāṭādhāre dṛṣṭim
dhārayet | śaṇmāsāj jyotiḥpuṇjaṃ paśyati |

Testimonia: 1–3 ≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r l. 9 to 99v l. 1):
atha tadupari dvādaśo dāntayor madhye dāntādhāraḥ 12 tasmin sthāne jihvāyā agraṃ
ghaṭimātram ardhaghāṭimātram balāt sthāpyate | tasmin sati samagraroganāśo bhavati |
≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 99r l. 1–2): atha trayodaśo nāsikādhāraḥ
13 tasmin lakṣye kṛte sati manaḥ sthiram bhavati | 4–5 ≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur*
(MMPP 2244, f. 99r ll. 2–3): atha caturdaśo nāsāmūle lālāte 'py ādhāraḥ 14 tasmin
dṛṣṭeḥ sthairyakaraṇāt ṣaṣṭhe māsi svīyaṃ tejaḥ pratyakṣaṃ bhavati | tejaśaḥ prasakṣatve
pāṛthivasamkalam baṃdhanam trudyati |

1 dvādaśo dantayor BK₁LPU₁] dvādaśadantayo madhye E, dvādaśor dāntayo madhye U₂, dvā-
daśayor madhye DN₁N₂, dvādaśavaṃ tayor madhye J dantādhāraḥ cett.] dantādhāras J ji-
hvāyā cett.] jihvāyām U₁ agraṃ cett.] agnaṃ BL, graṃ N₂ 1–2 ghaṭimātram cett.] ghaṭimā-
tram DN₁N₂ 2 ardhaghāṭimātram em.] arddhaghāṭimātram DJK₁N₁N₂, ārdhaghāṭikāmā-
tram U₁, ārgghaghāṭimātram PU₂, ārgghaghāṭimātram B, ārdhaghāṭimātram L, om. E vā em.]
va K₁, om. cett. balātkāreṇa cett.] balātkāreṇa PU₁U₂, balātkāreṇa BL tasmin cett.] tasmim
BL sati cett.] om. BL 2–3 naśyanti cett.] naśyaṃti B 3 nāsikādhāraḥ cett.] nāsikā-
grādhāraḥ EP tasmil lakṣye em.] tasmil lakṣe U₂, tasmim lakṣye EPU₁, tasmin lakṣye J,
tasmin lakṣe DK₁N₁N₂, tasmin dṛaṣṭe BL kṛte sati cett.] sati kṛte J, om. BL manaḥ sthiram
EJP] minasthira B, manaḥ sthiro L, manasthiram cett. 4 nāsāmūle vāyvādhāraḥ DN₁N₂] nāsāmūle vāyādhāraḥ K₁, nāsāmūle vā adhāraḥ J, nāsāmūle vādhāraḥ U₁, nāsāmūlādhāro P,
nāso mūlādhāraḥ BL, nāsāmūlādhāraḥ EU₂ tasmin cett.] tasmim na cett. dṛṣṭeḥ cett.]
llakṣe krute sati B, lakṣe kṛte sati L, na dṛṣṭeḥ U₁, laṣṭhe U₂ māse BLU₁] māsaḥ J, māsi cett.
svīyaṃ cett.] svayaṃ BLN₂U₂ 5 pāṛthivaṃ cett.] pāṛthiva N₂ trūṭyati PU₂U₁] tuṭyati E,
truṭyati BL, trudyati DJK₁N₁N₂

Above that is the twelfth, the tooth support within the two [top front] teeth.³³⁴ At this place, the tip of the tongue is to be positioned with force for the duration of one or half a *ghaṭi*³³⁵. Abiding therein, the diseases of the practitioner will entirely disappear.³³⁶

The thirteenth is the support of the nose. When that is set as the focus, the mind becomes stable.³³⁷

The fourteenth is the support of the vital wind at the bridge of the nose. As a result of stabilising the gaze therein, one's own brilliance becomes apparent within six months. When the brilliance has manifested the mundane bond breaks.³³⁸

³³⁴ SSP 2.21 (Ed. p. 36) teaches the brows as the twelfth *ādhāra*. Rāmacandra decided to stick to the YSv. Given the other descriptions, it is apparent that Rāmacandra switched between both sources when compiling the section on the sixteen *ādhāras*.

³³⁵ One *ghaṭi* equals 1/60 of a day (see *sircar1966*), which is 24 minutes. Half a *ghaṭi* would thus equal 12 minutes

³³⁶ Most of the texts teach a practice that involves contact between the tongue and the teeth. Rāmacandra and *Yogasvarodaya* teach to push the tongue forcefully against the [upper] teeth. *shivayogapradipika* instructs to rub the tip of the tongue at the upper teeth for half a year, which would cause the practitioner to see an inner light. *hathatattvakaumudi* mixes the two previous ideas. The name of the twelfth *ādhāra* here is *dvijādhāra*, and Sundaradeva also calls it *rājadanta*. The yogin presses the tip of the tongue against this point, and hence, he perceives an inner light within six months. *yogatarangini* surprisingly teaches the same technique as Rāmacandra and not the *bhrūmadhyādhāra* of *ssplonavla*. *Netroddyota* names the palate as the twelfth support and lets us know that at the root of it is that which is blissful, which is enveloped by the *somakalā*. *saradaavalon* and *jyotsna* list the nose as the twelfth support.

³³⁷ The majority of texts teach either the nose, the base of the nose as in *shivayogapradipika* (*ghrāṇamūla*) and *hathatattvakaumudi* (*ghrāṇapada*), or the tip of the nose (*nāsāgra*) as the *ssplonavla* and *yogatarangini*. Whereas *Netroddyota*, *saradaavalon* and *jyotsna* teach the place in between the brows as the thirteenth *ādhāra*.

³³⁸ *Yogasvarodaya* and *ssplonavla* provide the term *kapāṭādhāra*. *yogatarangini* teaches the base of the nose as the fourteenth *ādhāra*. All other texts teach fixing the mind and the breath at the forehead. *Netroddyota* calls this place at the forehead “a wish-fulfilling jewel with its abode at the crossroads of the four channels” (*cintāmanyabhidhānākhyas catuṣpathanivāsi yat*).

पञ्चदशो भ्रुवोर्मध्याधारः। तस्मिन्दृष्टेः स्थिरीकरणात्कोटिकिरणानि स्फुरन्ति।
षोडशो नेत्राधारः। अयमङ्गुल्यग्रेण चाल्यते। तदभ्यासात्पृथ्वीमध्ये यत्किञ्चित्तेजो
वर्तते। तत्सर्वतेजो दृष्टिविषयं भवति। तद्दर्शनात्पुरुषः सर्वज्ञो भवति॥

Sources: 1 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): pañcadaśo bhruvormadhye sthira (*sthira* YK 2.35) dr̥ṣṭis tathā dhruvam | asmin dr̥ṣṭiḥ sthirā koṭiḥ (*koṭi*° YK 2.35) kiraṇāni sphuranti hi | cf. SSP 2.24 (Ed. pp. 36–37): pañcadaśe lalāṭādhāre tatra jyotiḥpuñjaṃ lakṣayet | tejasvi bhavati | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 840–41): netrādhāraḥ ṣoḍaśo 'yam (*aṅgulyagre na* YK 2.36) aṅgulyagreṇa cālayet | pr̥thvimadhye tu yat kiñcid varttate (*sarvajñāḥ prabhavas tena varddhate* YK 2.36) jaṭharāṇalah | pratyakṣaṃ tad bhavet sarvaṃ tad ābhyāsān na saṃśayaḥ | 2–3 cf. SSP 2.25 (Ed. p. 37): avaśiṣṭe ṣoḍaśe brahmarandhram ākāśacakraṃ | tatra śrīgurucaraṇāmbujayugmaṃ sadāval-okayet | ākāśavat pūrṇo bhavati |

Testimonia: 1 ≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 99r l. 3–4): atha pañcadaśo bhrūmadhye ajñādhāraḥ 15 asmiṃ dr̥ṣṭeḥ sthīrikaraṇāt koṭikiraṇāḥ puraḥ sphuraṃti | 2–3 ≈ *hathasamketacandrikajodhpur* (MMPP 2244, f. 99r l. 4): atha ṣoḍaśo netrādhāraḥ 16 ayaṃ aṅgulyagreṇa cālyate tadābhyāsāt pr̥thvimadhye yat kiñcit tejo varttate | tat sarvaṃ tejo dr̥ṣṭiṣayaṃ bhavati | taddarśanāt puruṣaḥ sarvajñaḥ bhavati | iti pūrvoktaṣoḍaśādhārāṇaṃ spaṣṭo 'rthaḥ |

1 *bhruvor madhyādhāraḥ* P] *bhruvor madhyādhāras* E, *bhruvor madhye dhāraḥ* BL, *bhruvor madhye ajñādhāraḥ* D, *bhruvor madhye ādhāraḥ* JK₁N₁N₂, *bhruvor madhye ādhāra* U₁, *bhruvor madhyādhāra* U₂ *tasmin* cett.] *asmin* N₁, *smin* D, *asin* U₁ *dr̥ṣṭeḥ* cett.] *dr̥ṣṭe* L, *na dr̥ṣṭeḥ* U₁, *dr̥ṣṭi*° U₂ *kiraṇāni* β] *koṭikiraṇāḥ* EP, *koṭikiraṇaḥ* U₂, *koṭikiraṇā* BL 2 *ṣoḍaśo* cett.] *ṣoḍaśaḥ* DK₁N₁N₂ *netrādhāraḥ* cett.] *ne ādhāraḥ* J, *netrā* BL *ayaṃ* γ] *ayaṃ* β *aṅgulyagreṇa* cett.] *agulyagreṇa* DJN₁, *aṅgugreṇa* N₂ *pr̥thvi*° cett.] *pr̥thivi*° LBU₂ *tejo* cett.] *tejaḥ* DN₁N₂, *om.* JU₁ 3 *varttate* cett.] *vatate* U₁ *tatsarvatejo* DN₁N₂] *tatsarvaṃ tejo* cett. *bhavati* cett.] *bhavati* B *taddarśanāt* cett.] *tadarśanāt* P, *tatdarśaḥ* JU₁ *bhavati* cett.] *bhavati* B

The fifteenth support is situated in the middle of the eyebrows. As a result of stabilising the gaze therein, ten million rays of light sparkle.³³⁹

The sixteenth is the eye support. It is caused to be rubbed with the fingertips. As a result of that practice, some light arises from the earth[-element].³⁴⁰ That entire light becomes the object of vision. As a result of seeing that, the person becomes omniscient.³⁴¹

³³⁹**shivayogapradipika** teaches gazing above the brows, which quickly brings about the appearance of light. **ssplonavla** calls it the “support of the forehead” (*lalāṭādhāra*), in which the practitioner shall visualize a cluster of light. **yogatarangini** teaches the centre of the brows. By concentrating on this point, a direct vision of many-rayed light occurs, and one’s mind will merge into the sun-sky (*etasya dṛḍhābhyāse sūryākāśo liyate* ||). **hathatattvakaumudi** calls it the “support of ether” (*vyomādhāra*) and explains that by gazing at it, everything is perceived as light. However, *Netratāntra* teaches the *brahmarandhra* as the fifteenth support. *Netroddyota* declares it as the “support of the fourth state” (*turyādhāra*). **saradaavalon** and **jjyotsna** also teach the top of the head (*mūrdhan*) as the fifteenth.

³⁴⁰Perhaps, *tejas* arises from *pṛthvī*, because its origin is unknown and in Śaiva Tantras the earth as the bottom *tattva* contains the entire *brahmāṇḍa*, cf. **tantrika3**.

³⁴¹Rāmacandra’s description of *netrādhāra* is very similar to **yogatarangini**, which also instructs the yogin to rub the eyes with the fingers in order to generate the perception of a light. Other texts have some noteworthy differences: **shivayogapradipika** teaches to fix [the gaze] above the eyes. Due to that, the yogin sees a mass of light in the corner of his eyes. **hathatattvakaumudi** teaches to meditate upon the eyes. By seeing a mass of light in the corner of the eyes, one soon becomes like Śiva. **ssplonavla** teaches to visualize the pair of the lotus feet of the revered teacher (*śrīgurucaraṇāmbujayugmaṃ*) at the *brahmarandhra* in which the *ākāśacakra* is situated. The **jjyotsna**, too, lists the *brahmarandhra*. **saradaavalon** and *Netratāntra* teach the *dvādaśānta* as the sixteenth support. **tantrika3**, p. 210. *Netroddyota* explains: *nāḍyādhāraḥ paraḥ sūksmo ghanavyāptiprabodhakaḥ* || “The support of the [central?] channel is the highest subtle one which awakens complete pervasion.”

[XXXI. aṣṭāṅgayogasya vicāraḥ]

इदानीमष्टाङ्गयोगस्य विचारः कथ्यते। यमनियमासन प्राणायामप्रत्याहारध्यान-
धारणासमाधिरिति एतेषां लक्षणानि कथ्यन्ते। शान्तिः ॥ षण्णामिन्द्रियाणां जयः ॥
आहारः स्वल्पः ॥ निद्राजयः ॥ शैत्यजयः ॥ उष्णजयः ॥ एते यमाः ॥ नियमाः
5 खलु मनः चापलभवावन्निवार्य स्थैर्यं स्थाप्यते ॥ एकान्ते सेवनम् ॥ प्राणिमात्रे समा-
बुद्धिः ॥ औदासीन्यं ॥ कस्यापि वस्तुन इच्छा न कर्तव्या ॥ यथालाभसंतोषः ॥ पर-
मेश्वरनाम न विस्मरणीयम् ॥ मनोमध्ये दैन्यं न कर्तव्यम् ॥ इति नियमाः ॥

Sources: 2-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841): idāniṃ yogam aṣṭāṅgaṃ śṛṇu lakṣaṇasamyutam | 2-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841) = YK 5.29-30ab: yamaś ca niyamaś caiva cāsanam prāṇasamyamaḥ | pratyāhāro dhāraṇā ca samādhiś ca viśeṣataḥ | aṣṭāṅgayoga ebhis tu caiteṣāṃ lakṣaṇam śṛṇu | 2-3 cf. SSP 2.32 (Ed. pp. 43-44): yamaniyamāsanaprāṇāyāmapratyāhāradhāraṇādhyānasamād-
hayaḥ 'ṣṭāṅgāni | 3-4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): śāntiḥ santoṣa āhāro nidrālpā (nidrālpam YK 5.30) manaso damaḥ | śūnyāntaḥkaraṇaṇ ceti ('karaṇaś ceti YK 5.31) yamā iti prakirttitāḥ | 3-4 cf. SSP 2.32 (Ed. p. 44): tatra yama iti upaśamaḥ sarvendriyajayaḥ āhāranidrāśītavātātapajayaś caivam śanaiḥ śanaiḥ sādhayet | 4-7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841): cāpalyan tu dūre tyaktvā manaḥ sthairyam vidhāya ca | ekatra melanam nityam prāṇamātre na sā matiḥ (sāmaḥbhī YK 5.32c) | sadodāsinabhāvas tu sarvatrecchāvivaraṇam ('vivarjitāḥ YK 5.32d) | yathālābhena santuṣṭaḥ parameśvaramānaśaḥ | mānadānaparityāga ete tu niyamā iti | 4-7 cf. SSP 2.33 (PT, p. 44): niyama iti manovṛttinām niyamanam | iti ekāntavāso niḥsaṅgatā audāsinyam yathāprāpti-
samtuṣṭiḥ vairāgyam gurucaraṇāvarūḍhatvam iti niyamalakṣaṇam |

2 idāniṃ cett.] idāniṃ N₂U₁U₂ °yogasya cett.] °yoga° E vicāraḥ cett.] vicāra U₂ kathy-
ate cett.] kathyate || cha || J yamaniyamāsana° cett.] yama || niyama || āsana || J, yama
nimāsana° K₁ prāṇāyāmapratyāhāra° cett.] prāṇāyāma || pratyāhāra || J 2-3 °dhyānad-
hāraṇāsamādhir iti EPU₂] dhāraṇādhyānasamādhir iti BL, dhyānadhāraṇāsamādhīyaḥ
N₁N₂, dhyānadhāraṇāsamādhī DK₁U₁, dhyāna || dhāraṇā || samādhi || J 3 kathyante cett.]
kathyate U₁ śāntiḥ 7] śānti° DK₁N₁N₂U₁ śaṇṇām E]K₁U₁] śaṇṇām DLN₁N₂, śaṇṇām BP, śaṇa
U₂ indriyāṇām cett.] indriyāṇām B 4 āhāraḥ svalpaḥ U₂] svalpāhāraḥ E, āhāraḥ svalpaḥ
BP, āhāraḥ || svalpaḥ || L, svalpāḥ N₁, āhāraḥ svalpāḥ N₂, āhāraḥ svalpāḥ D, āhāraḥ sajayaḥ
JU₁ nidrājayaḥ cett.] nidrāyā jayaḥ BJ, nidrāyāḥ jayaḥ LU₂ śāityajayaḥ cett.] śītyajayaḥ
N₁, śītoṣṇajayaḥ E uṣṇajayaḥ cett.] uṣṇājayaḥ BU₂, auṣṇājayaḥ U₁, om. E ete cett.] ya
te BL yamāḥ cett.] yamāniyamāḥ P, yamaḥ BL niyamāḥ EK₁] niyamaḥ βU₂, om. BPL
5 khalu cett.] khalu N₁N₂U₂ manaḥ DJK₁N₂U₁] om. cett. cāpala° BEL] cāpalā° PU₂, capala°
β nivārya cett.] nivārye DK₁, nirvārya BLP, nivārya U₁ sthairyē cett.] om. BK₁LDU₂
ekānte sevanaḥ EN₁] ekāmtasevānaḥ PDJK₁N₂U₁U₂, ekāmtasevānām BL 5-6 samā bud-
dhiḥ cett.] samā buddhi U₁U₂ 6 audāsinyam E] udāsinyam BLPN₂, udāsinyām U₁, udāsinya
DK₁N₁N₂ vastuna EPU₂] vastunaḥ βBL kartavyā cett.] karttavyam U₁U₂ 6-7 parameś-
varanāma cett.] parameśvaraḥ nāma U₁U₂ 7 na cett.] om. DJK₁N₁N₂ vismaraṇīyam EN₁] vismaraṇīyam BDLPU₁, vismanīyam N₂, vismaraṇam U₂ manomadhye cett.] yaṃ mano
madhye U₂, mano na J, mano U₁ na βU₂] om. BELP iti niyamāḥ EP] iti niyamaḥ BLU₂, om.

[XXXI. Reflection of Aṣṭāṅgayoga]

Now, the reflection of Aṣṭāṅgayoga³⁴² is explained: observances, restrictions, posture, breath control, withdrawal of the senses, meditation, concentration³⁴³ and absorption. Their characteristics are taught.

Peace, mastery of the six senses,³⁴⁴ little food, the conquest of sleep, the conquest of cold, [and] conquest of heat.³⁴⁵ These are the observances.

Now, the restrictions: the mind is to be restrained from the unsteady state [and] caused to be grounded in tranquillity, dwelling in a lonely place, maintaining equanimity towards all kinds of living beings, indifference, one shall not desire any object, contentment with whatever is obtained, never forgetting the name of the highest lord, [and] one shall not indulge in self-pity. These are the restrictions.

³⁴²Given the extensive list of fifteen yogas presented at the beginning of this text does not contain *aṣṭāṅgayoga*, one wonders why this type of yoga suddenly appears and why it was not included within the list methods of Rājayoga. Suffice it to say that he followed the structure of his main source text. A comparative analysis of the integration of Aṣṭāṅgayoga into the early modern complex yoga taxonomies can be found on p. 461.

³⁴³The reversed order of the sixth (*dhāraṇā*) and seventh (*dhyāna*) limb of the “classical” Pātañjalayoga model is striking (cf. *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 2.29). Rāmacandra’s main source text, the *Yogasvarodaya*, names *aṣṭāṅgayoga* but does not list *dhyāna* in the respective verse (cf. sources). The critical edition of the Lonavla Yoga Institute of **ssplonavla** mentions two manuscripts (J₁ and J₂) with Rāmacandra’s order. According to **vasudeva2004**, this reversed order frequently appears in yoga texts structured in *ṣaḍāṅga* or even *pañcāṅga* systems. It is found in *Jayākhyasamhitā* and *Maitrāyaṇīyopaniṣad*. Furthermore, it is present in the Śaiva *Rauravatantra*, *Kiraṇatantra*, *Mataṅatantra*, as well as in Buddhist Tantras like the *Guhyasamājatantra* and *Kālacakrat Tantra*. *Vāyupurāṇa* teaches this “reversed” order in its *pañcāṅga* schema. **powell2023** mentions that he has not found an Aṣṭāṅgayoga system with *dhyāna* and *dhāraṇā* reversed outside of the **shivayogapradipika** 2.1–9. Some witnesses of **ssplonavla**, *Tattvayogabindu* and implicitly the *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted in **ramatosana** and **yogakarnika** can be added to this group. It appears that the source for this concept goes back to the Vīraśaiva milieu of the fifteenth century. For a useful table of the texts, including the reversed order, see **powell2023**.

³⁴⁴The sixth sense is the mental faculty (*manas* or *citta*), cf. **white2021**.

³⁴⁵Rāmacandra presents a unique mix of his two primary sources: *Yogasvarodaya* lists peace (*śānti*), contentment (*santoṣa*), little sleep (*nidrālpā*), taming of the mind (*manaso dama*) and ...

आसनस्य लक्षणं बहुग्रन्थेषु निरूपितमस्ति। तेनात्र न निरूप्यते। प्राणायामस्तु सुकुमारेण साधितुं न शक्यते। अतस्तस्य नाममात्रं कथ्यते। प्रत्याहारः कथ्यते। मनः संसारान्निवृत्त्यात्मनि स्थाप्यते। मनोमध्ये ये विकारा उत्पद्यन्ते। तेऽपि निवारणीयाः। अनेकचमत्कारिणी बुद्धिरुत्पद्यते। सा गोप्या। ध्यानं च बहुतरं प्रागुक्तं तेनात्र नोच्यते॥

Sources: 1 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841): āsanāni ca tāvanti yāvanto jīvajantavaḥ | SSP 2.34 (Ed. p. 44): āsanam iti svasvarūpe samāsannatā | svastikāsanam padmāsanam siddhāsanam eteṣāṃ madhye yatheṣṭam ekaṃ vidhāya sāvadhānena sthātavyam ity āsanalakṣaṇam | 1-2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841): prāṇāyāmas tridhā ceti bahudhā prathamam śrṇu | āsane prāṇasamyāme na śaktāḥ sukumārakāḥ | mahāpuṇyaprabhāveṇa śakyate tu mahātmanā | 1-2 cf. SSP 2.45 (Ed. p. 45): prāṇāyāma iti prāṇasya sthiratā | recakapūrakakumbhakasaṅghaṭṭakaraṇāni catvāri prāṇāyāmalakṣaṇāni | 2-4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841) = YK 7.6-7: kṛtvā kalevaram śuddham kuryād yatnair mahātmanā | mano nivārya saṃsāre viṣayeṣu tathaiva ca | manovikārān sarvāś ca tyaktvā śūnyamayo bhavet | pratyāhāro bhavaty eṣu sarvanindācamatkrtaḥ | 2-4 cf. SSP 2.36 (Ed. p. 45): pratyāhāra iti caitanyaturāṅgānām pratyāharaṇam vikāragrasanam utpannavikārasyāpi nirvṛttr nirbhātiti pratyāhāralakṣaṇam | 4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841) = YK 7.8: dhyānan tu dvidham proktaṃ sthūlasūkṣmavibhedataḥ | sthūlam mantramayaṃ vidhī sūkṣman tu mantravarjjitam | 4-5 cf. SSP 2.38 (Ed. p. 46): atha dhyānam | asti kaścana paramādvaitasya bhāvaḥ | sa evātmēti yathā yad yat sphurati tattatsvarūpam eveti bhāvayet | sarvabhūteṣu samadṛṣṭiś ca | iti dhyānalakṣaṇam |

1 āsanasya lakṣaṇam β] āsanalakṣaṇam EPL, āsanalakṣaṇam tu U₂, āsanam lakṣaṇam B bahugrantheṣu U₂] bahugrantheṣu BL, bahuṣu graṃtheṣu EP, bahūgramthe β nirūpitam EPU₂] nirūpitam | DJK₁N₁N₂, nirūpyam BL, nirūpitam tan U₁ asti γ] om. K₁, atah cett. tenātra γ] atrāyaṃ K₁N₁N₂, atratyaṃ D, atra JU₁ na EPU₁] om. cett. 2 sukumāreṇa EP] kumāreṇa BLU₂, kumāreṇa puruṣeṇa β atas tasya EPU₁] atah tasya DJK₁N₁, ata tasya N₂, atā tasya U₂, atah BL nāmamātram EPN₁U₂] nāmamātre DJK₁N₂U₁, nāma BL kathyate γ] kathitam β kathyate cett.] pratyato E 3 nirvṛtyātmani em.] nirvṛtyātmani BLPU₁U₂, nivartyātmani E, nirvṛtya ātmani DJK₁N₁N₂ sthāpyate cett.] om. N₂ vikārā cett.] vikārah P, vikārāḥ DK₁, om. N₂ utpadyante cett.] om. N₂ te'pi cett.] om. N₂ 3-4 nivāraṇīyāḥ cett.] nivāraṇīyā BL, vāraṇīyāḥ N₂, nivāraṇīyāḥ U₁U₂ 4 anekacamatkārīṇi cett.] anekacamatkārakarakāraṇi N₁N₂, anekacamatkārakāraṇi DJK₁ buddhir cett.] buddhi DN₁N₂ utpadyate cett.] utpadyate BDEU₂, utpadyataram P sā gopyā BLU₂] sā gopyāḥ N₂, sām-gopyāḥ DJK₁N₁, sā gaupyā U₁, sām-gopāṅgaṃ E, om. P dhyānam cett.] om. P ca cett.] om. PJU₁U₂ bahutaram cett.] om. P prāḡ γ] om. β uktam DJK₁U₁U₂] uktam | E, uktam cett. 5 tenātra cett.] tena atra DJK₁N₁U₁ nocyate cett.] na ucyate U₁

The characteristic of posture has been discussed in many works. For that reason, it is not discussed here.

Young persons can not practise breath control. That is why it is just mentioned by name.³⁴⁶

Withdrawal of the senses is taught. The mind is supposed to be turned away from the cyclic existence and caused to abide in the self. The changes that arise within the mind should also be restrained. An intellect that is capable of creating many wonders arises. This is to be kept secret.

Meditation has been taught many times earlier [in this text]. Because of that, it is not discussed here.³⁴⁷

emptiness of the inner organ (*śūnyāntaḥkaraṇa*). **ssplonavl** lists: tranquillity (*upaśama*), mastery of all senses (*sarvendriyajaya*), and conquest of food, sleep, cold, wind, heat (*ahāranidrāśī-tavātātāpajaya*).

³⁴⁶It is crucial to note here that *Yogasvarodaya* states that young persons are not qualified to practice posture and breath control, but that, by the power of great merit a great soul becomes capable, cf. **yogakarnika** quoted with reference *yogasvarodaye* 7.2 (*āsane prāṇasaṃyāme na śaktāḥ sukumārakāḥ | mahāpuṇyaprabhāveṇa śakyate tu mahātmanā* |). Right after that statement, the text continues to present detailed instructions for eight *kumbhakas*, cf. **yogakarnika** quoted with reference *yogasvarodaye* 7.3–10, 7.23–24 and 7.68–72. The whole extent of *Yogasvarodaya*'s teaching on *prāṇāyāma* can not be determined since it is absent in the quotes of **ramatosana** and is just partially quoted in **yogakarnika**. It seems that Rāmacandra, who previously strictly followed the structure of the *Yogasvarodaya*, consciously decided to exclude these teachings due to the reason he presents here. Therefore, he probably directly hints at a part of his audience: *sukumāras*, young persons, or, considering all previous allusions to a wealthy and royal lifestyle, young courtiers and princes.

³⁴⁷Rāmacandra perhaps refers to the teaching of the nine *cakras* and other sections of the text in which meditation is mentioned. The same schema is already found in the *dhyāna* descriptions of *Śivayogapradīpika* 3.4–33, cf. **powell2023**. He might also hint at the various methods he subsumes under Lakṣayoga. Most likely, Rāmacandra consciously decided to skip a description of *samādhi*, since **ramatosana** quoted with reference *Yogasvarodaye* (Ed. p. 841) defines *samādhi* as follows: *samādhir nīscalā buddhiḥ śvāsocchvāsādivarjitāḥ* | “Samādhi is the immovable intellect devoid of inhalation, exhalation, etc.”. If, indeed, one purpose of Rāmacandra's text was to teach Rājayoga to young courtiers or princes, surely children will not be taught that the highest level of yoga is accomplished by stopping breathing altogether.

[XXXII. piṇḍabrahmāṇḍayor aikyam]

इदानीं पिण्डब्रह्माण्डयोरैक्यमस्ति । तस्मात्ब्रह्माण्डमध्ये ये पदार्थास्तेऽपि पिण्ड-
मध्ये सन्ति । ते कथ्यन्ते । पादयोरङ्गुष्ठतले तलं वर्तते । तदुपरि तलातलं वर्तते ।
गुल्फयोर्महातलं वर्तते । जङ्घामध्ये सुतलं वर्तते । जान्वोर्मध्ये वितलं वर्तते । ऊ-
5 र्वोर्मध्येऽतलं वर्तते ॥

Sources: 2-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841): piṇḍabrahmāṇḍayor aikyam śrṇv idānīm prayatnataḥ | brahmāṇḍe santi ye cāṇḍāḥ piṇḍamadhye 'pi te sthitāḥ | 2-3 cf. SSP 3.1 (Ed. p. 28): piṇḍa-
madhye carācaram yo jānāti sa yogi piṇḍasaṃvittir bhavati | 3-5 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 841-842):
talaṃ pādāṅguṣṭhatale tasyopari talātalam | mahātalam gulphayor madhye gulphopari rasā-
talam | sutalam jaṅghayor madhye vitalam jānumadhyakam | ūrvor madhye 'talam proktaṃ
saptapātālam iritam | talaṃ talātalaṇ ceti mahātalarasātalam | saptapātālam etat tu sutalam
vitalātalam | 3-5 cf. SSP 3.1-2 (Ed. pp. 48-49): kūrmaṇ pādātale vasati | pātalam pādāṅguṣṭhe
| talātalam aṅguṣṭhāgre | mahātalam pādaprṣṭhe | rasātalam gulphe | sutalam jaṅghāyām |
vitalam jānvoḥ | atalam ūrvoḥ |

2 piṇḍa° cett.] piḍa° DK₁N₁ brahmāṇḍayor BEJLP] °brahmāḍayoḥ βU₂ aikyam cett.]
ekyam B, ekam N₂ m-a-sti cett.] asti || cha || J tasmāt cett.] tasmā B, tasmānte N₂
padārthās cett.] padārthāḥ DK₁N₁, padārthā N₂U₁ te 'pi cett.] te BLP, sarve pi U₁, tan-
madhye U₂ 3 santi cett.] santiti E, sati BU₂, saṃ° L te DK₁N₁N₂] om. cett. kathyante cett.]
kathyate BPU₁ pādayor cett.] padas E, pādayos PL, pādayas B, pādayo° U₂ aṅguṣṭatale
em.] aṅguṣṭatale U₁, aṅguṣṭale DJK₁N₁N₂, °ṃguṣṭatale U₂, tālas BL, tele P, tale E talaṃ
cett.] talaṃ ca U₁, mūlaṃ rasātālāt U₂ tadupari J] tadupari U₁, tādupari DK₁N₁N₂, pādopari
γ vartate cett.] vartate | pādopari talaṃ vartate P 4 gulphayor γ] gulpho β mahātalam
γ] parimahātalam β jaṅghā° cett.] jaghā° U₂, om. P sutalam cett.] stutalam B, om. P
vartate BELU₂] om. cett. jānvormadhye DJK₁U₁] jānvomadhye N₁N₂, jānumadhye EPU₂,
jānubhyām BL vartate EBL] om. cett. 5 'talam E] atalam cett. vartate ELB] om. cett.

[XXXII. Identity of the universe and the body]

Now, there is the identity of the universe and the body.³⁴⁸ Because of that, the objects which exist in the universe are also in the body. They are taught. Tala exists at the base of the big toe[s] of the feet. On top of the feet exists Talātala. Mahātala exists at the two ankles.³⁴⁹ Sutala exists within the lower leg. Vitala exists within the knees. Atala exists within the two thighs.³⁵⁰

³⁴⁸The concept of the body as a microcosmic manifestation of a macrocosmic universe is a common feature in yogic literature, see [rootsofgyoga2017](#).

³⁴⁹A description of *rasātala* is missing in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Either this item of the enumeration was lost in transmission or we must assume an authorial mistake. A phrase like “*gulphopari rasātalaṃ vartate* |” would be expected at this point of the text. Both source texts Rāmacandra used describe *rasātala* right after the description of *mahātala*.

³⁵⁰Hindu cosmography, according to various *Purāṇas*, the *Atharvaveda*, etc. assume fourteen worlds (*lokas*), seven higher ones (*vyāhṛtis*) and seven lower ones (*pātālas*). The higher *lokas* (1–7) are described as the heavens, populated by mortals, celestial or divine beings, gods and higher gods, and full of truth. The lower *lokas* (8–14), which are here mapped onto the human body, constitute the different “hells” and are the abode of the *nāgas* or serpents and demons, cf. [haag2012](#). According to *yogasūtra* in his *bhāṣya* on *Yogasūtra* 3.26, the beings residing in their respective *lokas* experience the fruit of their *karma*. Residence in those abodes, however, is never eternal but lasts until the particular individual’s *karma* has been accounted for and borne their due fruits ([bryant2009](#)). A well-known depiction that shows the mapping of the *lokas* onto the body is Viṣṇu Viśvarūpa, India, Rajasthan, Jaipur, ca. 1800–1820 in the Victoria and Albert Museum, see p. 484. Directly related to the *Tattvayogabindu* is the depiction of a Siddha’s body that shows the equivalence of the self and the universe in the manuscript of *ssplonavlā* located in Mehragarh Museum Jodhpur, see p. 485.

[XXXIII. *piṇḍamadhye lokatrayam*]

इदानीं पिण्डमध्ये लोकत्रयं कथ्यते । मूलाधारे भूर्लोकः । लिङ्गाग्रे भुवर्लोकः । लिङ्गमूले स्वर्लोकः ॥

[XXXIV. *uparitanam lokacatuṣkam*]

- 5 इदानीमुपरितनं लोकचतुष्कं कथ्यते । पृष्ठदण्डाङ्कुरे महर्लोकः । दण्डछिद्रमध्ये जनलोकः । तद्दण्डनालीमध्ये तपोलोकः । दण्डकमलमध्ये सत्यलोकः ॥

Sources: 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): *idānīm piṇḍamadhye tu saptalokaṃ śṛṇu priye | mūlādhāre tu bhūrloko liṅgāgre tu bhuvas tataḥ | svarloko liṅgamūle tu merumūle mahas tathā* | 2–3 cf. SSP 3.3 (Ed. p. 49): *bhūrloko guhyasthāne bhuvarloko liṅgasthāne svarlokaṃ nābhīsthāne evaṃ lokatraye indro devatā piṇḍamadhye sarvendriyaṇīyāmakaḥ sa evendraḥ* | 5–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): *merucchidre janaloko merunāḍyāṃ tapas tathā | kamale marttyalokas tu iti lokaḥ pṛthak pṛthak | bhūrbhuvahsvarmahaś ceti janaś caiva tapas tathā | saptamaḥ satyalokas tu saptaloka iti smṛtaḥ | saptalokais tu pātālair bhuvanāni caturdaśa* | 5–6 cf. SSP 3.4 (Ed. p. 49): *daṇḍāṅkure maharlokaḥ daṇḍakuhare janolokaḥ | daṇḍanāle tapolokaḥ | mūlakamale satyalokaḥ* |

2 *idānīm* cett.] *idānīm upati tataṃ lokaṃ U₁* *piṇḍamadhye* cett.] *piṇḍopari L, piḍopiri B, śarīramadhye E* *liṅgāgre* cett.] *liṅgamūle N₁N₂* *bhuvarlokaḥ* DEPU₁U₂] *bhuvarloka° BL, om. N₁N₂* 2–3 *liṅgamūle* PU₁U₂] *liṅgamadhye* BDJK₁L, *om. N₁N₂* 3 *svarlokaḥ* cett.] *svargalokaḥ N₂, svaravarlokaḥ U₁* 5 *idānīm* BELP] *idānīm βU₂* *uparitanam* cett.] *uparitana° LU₂, uparijanam N₁N₂, uparitanu° PB* *lokacatuṣkam* cett.] *lokacatuṣka E, lokaḥ catuṣṭayam BL, lokaṃ catuṣkam U₁* *prṣṭhadanḍāṅkure* cett.] *prṣṭhadanḍākūle N₂, prṣṭhadanḍākūre P, daṇḍaṣṭaṭhemskure B, daṇḍaṣṭaṭhemkure L* *maharlokaḥ* cett.] *maharloka B* *daṇḍachidra°* cett.] *daṇḍaschidra° P, daṇḍasthita° U₁, uchidra° U₂* 5–6 *janalokaḥ* cett.] *janaloka BL* 6 *taddanḍa°* cett.] *daṇḍa° U₂* *°nālīmadhye em.] °nāḍīmadhye EU₁, °nālīmadhye PK₁U₂, °nālīkāmādhya B, °tālīkāmādhya L, °nālamādhya BJ, °nālī N₁N₂* *tapolokaḥ* cett.] *polokaḥ B* *daṇḍakamalamadhye* cett.] *daṇḍamalamadhye EU₁*

Notes: 2 *taddanḍanāḍīmadhye ...*: After section XXXIV up until section XLVIII, approximately 25% of the entire text disappears in two important witnesses of the *β*-group. The two Nepalese manuscripts *N₁* and *N₂* exhibit a substantial lacuna, which suggests their close affiliation. They must both be derived from the same exemplar or from each other. The omissions of the text of *N₁* and *N₂* will not be documented in the apparatus until after their respective *lacunae* to prevent an unnecessarily inflated critical apparatus with entries for every omitted word. The reader will be informed in this register of the apparatus once their evidence resumes.

[XXXIII. Triad of worlds]

Now, the threefold world within the body is taught.³⁵¹ The earth realm (*bhūr-loka*) is situated at the root support (*mūlādhāra*). The atmosphere (*bhuvarloka*) is at the tip of the penis. Heaven (*svarloka*) is at the base of the penis.

[XXXIV. Upper tetrad of worlds]

Now, the upper tetrad of worlds is taught. The world of greatness (*maharloka*) is at the sprout of the staff of the back. The world of men (*janaloka*) is within the opening of the spine.³⁵² In the centre of the tube of that spine is the world of ascetic heat (*tapoloka*). Within the lotus of the spine is the world of truth (*satyaloka*).³⁵³

³⁵¹The earliest conception of the equation of the cosmos with the body is found in *rigveda* 10,90. This concept becomes linked with yogic practice in subsequent Hindu traditions. According to the *Bhagavadgītā* and the *Kūrma Purāṇa*, the deities Viṣṇu and Śiva are described as engaging in the practice of yoga. During this practice, they assimilate all external aspects by either encompassing the entire universe within their cosmic bodies or by engulfing everything, see *white2011*. For a detailed exposition of the Purāṇic concept of the universe in Patañjali's yoga, see the commentaries on *yogasutra* 3.25, e.g., *yogasutra* or *bryant2009*. The idea of situating the universe into the yogic body is carried on into the traditions of Haṭha- and Rājayoga and becomes a substantial constituent of their worldview, cf. *asiddhi* 15–19. For a collection of references to the yogic body, see *rootsofyoga2017* 2017: 171–227.

³⁵²The localisation of the upper tetrad of worlds occurs along the spine, which is imagined as a lotus. While the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* locate *maharloka* at the sprout (°*āṅkūre*) of the spine, in the *Yogasvarodaya* we read about the root (°*mūle*) of the spine. The next world *janaloka* is at the opening (°*chidra*) of the spine. In the context of the simile of the spine with the lotus, this must be the rhizome of the lotus because the tube of the stem grows from it. I want to thank *mallinson2007* for this hint. This rhizome is likely the root-bulb mentioned in *Tattvayogabindu* III, from which the central channel emerges. The *satyaloka* within the lotus of the spine may be the lotus of the eighth or ninth *cakra* (section XI–XII).

³⁵³For extensive accounts of Hindu cosmography and the inhabitants of the various spheres of the cosmos, see *bhagavata* 5.16–26, *kirfel1954*'s study of Purāṇic cosmography, and, more generally, *kirfel1927*'s *kirfel1927*.

[XXXV. catvāro lokasvāminah]

अथ ब्रह्माण्डमध्ये चत्वारो लोकस्वामिनः । तेऽपि पिण्डमध्ये वर्तन्ते । शरीरमध्ये
 द्वे कुक्षौ ॥ द्वे शक्तिन्योः ॥ वक्षःस्थले ॥ कण्ठमूले ॥ कण्ठमध्ये ॥ लंबिकाया मूले ॥
 तालुद्वारे ॥ तालुमध्ये ॥ ललाटे ॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): atha brahmāṇḍamadyasthās catvāro lokapālākāḥ | piṇḍa-
 madhye tu tān jñātvā sarvasiddhiśvaro bhavet | indro brahmā viṣṇur īśaś catvāraś cātma-
 vatāḥ | mūlād dhāre catuspatre gajārūḍho mahān iti | sṛṣṭikarttā ca tatraiva svādhiṣṭhāne
 mahān hariḥ | maṇipūre śūlapāṇir aṣṭasiddhiśvaro mahān | tāludvāre tālumadhye lalāṭe
 vakṣakaṇṭhake | 2–4 cf. SSP 3.4–5 (Ed. pp. 50–52): evaṃ lokacatuṣṭāye brahmā devatā |
 piṇḍamadye anekamānābhīmānasvarūpi tiṣṭhati | viṣṇulokaḥ kuṁṣau tiṣṭhati | tatra viṣṇur
 devatā | piṇḍamadye 'nekavyāpārakārako bhavati | hṛdaye rudralokaḥ | tatra rudro devatā |
 piṇḍamadya ugrasvarūpi tiṣṭhati | vakṣaḥsthala īśvaralokaḥ tatreśvaro devatā | piṇḍam-
 adhye tṛptisvarūpi tiṣṭhati | kaṇṭhamūle sadāśivalokaḥ tatra sadāśivo devatā | piṇḍamadye
 saumyavarūpi tiṣṭhati | kaṇṭhamadye nilakaṇṭhalokaḥ tatra nilakaṇṭho devatā | piṇḍamadye
 'bhayasvarūpi tiṣṭhati | tāludvāre śivalokaḥ | tatra śivo devatā | piṇḍamadye 'nupamasvarūpi
 tiṣṭhati | lambikāmūle bhairavalokaḥ | tatra bhairavo devatā | piṇḍamadye sarvottamas-
 varūpi tiṣṭhati | tatrābhyantare mahāsiddhalokaḥ | tatra mahāsiddhadevatā | piṇḍamadye
 prabodhasvarūpi tiṣṭhati | lalāṭamadye 'nādilokaḥ | lalāṭamadye 'nādilokaḥ | tatrānādir
 devatā | piṇḍamadya ānandaparāhantāsvarūpi tiṣṭhati |

2 catvāro DJK₁U₁] caturdaśa° cett. lokasvāminah DJK₁] lokāḥ svāminah U₁, °lokāsthānāni
 BLP, °lokāḥ stānāni U₂, °lokāni sthānāni E te 'pi DJK₁U₁] tānyapi cett. piṇḍamadye
 DJK₁U₁] piṇḍe BELU₂, piṇḍe P vartante E] vartate cett. 3 dve kuṁṣau em.] dvau kuṁṣau
 BL, dvau kuṁṣi EPU₂, dvau kuṁṣinau DJK₁, dvau kuṁṣinau U₁ dve śaktinyoḥ Sellmer conj.]
 dve sakthini ELU₂, dve sakthini PB, vartate DJK₁U₁ vakṣaḥsthale em.] vakṣasthale DJK₁U₁,
 vakṣaḥ sthalaṃ EB, vakṣaḥschalaṃ P, vakṣassthalaṃ U₂ kaṇṭhamūle LU₂] kaṇṭhamūlaṃ
 EPB, kaṇṭhasya mūle DJK₁U₁ kaṇṭhamadye DJK₁U₁] kamardhye B, kaṇṭhamadhyam EL,
 kaṇṭhamadhyah PU₂ lambikāyā mūle DJK₁U₁] lambikāmūlaṃ γ 4 tāludvāre DJK₁U₁] tāludvāraṃ γ
 tālumadhye DJK₁U₁] tālumadhyam γ lalāṭe DJK₁U₁] lalāṭamadye E, lalāṭa-
 madhyam BLP U₂

[XXXV. Lords of the world]

Now, there are four lords (1–4) of the world in the universe.³⁵⁴ They also exist in the body. [Other deities and worlds exist within the body]³⁵⁵ two in the belly (5–6), two in the thighs (7–8), at the location of the chest (9), at the pit of the throat (10), in the centre of the throat (11), at the root of the uvula (12), at the entrance of the palate (13), at the forehead (14),...³⁵⁶

³⁵⁴Only the reading of D, J, K₁ and U₁ (β -group) is plausible and *lectio difficilior*. The source text confirms this; the *Yogasvarodaya* introduces the *lokapālakāḥ*, which Rāmacandra renders as *lokasvāmināḥ*. In the γ -group, the subject was not understood and rewritten in an attempt to fix the passage.

³⁵⁵I decided to add the words in the square brackets to derive the most probable sense of the list of locations based on the source texts.

³⁵⁶Rāmacandra greatly simplifies his source texts at this point. The parallel passages in the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *ssplonavla* provide much more detail. The background of what Rāmacandra wants to express lies somewhere between the two sources available to him (see sources in the first layer of the *apparatus criticus*). I translate the respective passage in the *ramatosana* quoted with reference *Yogasvarodaye* (Ed. p. 842) as follows: “There are now four world keepers amid the external universe. Having recognised these within the body, the supreme ruler (of the body?) may be fully successful. Indra, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and Īśa are the deities of the body (*ātman*). (1) In the four-petalled Mūlādhāra-[cakra] is the great one who is seated on an elephant (Indra). (2) There at Svādiṣṭhāna is the Creator, the great Hari (Viṣṇu). (3) In the Maṇipūra is the one with the trident in hand, the great lord of the eight supernatural powers (Śiva). (4) at the gate of the palate, (5) amid the palate, (6) on the forehead, (7) in the chest and (8) throat, (9) at the junction in the skull, and at (10) the uvula, (11) as well as at the opening of Brahman and (20) at the nine *cakras*, upper *cakra* and (21) at the triple peak. They are in the 21 worlds and must be realised in detail.” The passage of *ssplonavla* 3.4–5 reveals further details of the physical locations listed by Rāmacandra: “Thus, Brahmā is the deity within the fourfold world. He resides in the body in various forms of self-esteem and pride. The world of Viṣṇu is situated in the belly (*kukṣau*). Viṣṇu is the deity there. In the body, he manifests as the performer of various forms of activity. In the heart is the world of Rudra. Rudra is the deity there. Within the body, he resides in the form of strength. In the location of the chest (*vakṣaḥsthale*) is the world of Īśvara. Īśvara is the deity there. Within the body, he exists in the form of contentment. At the root of the throat (*kaṇṭhamūle*) is the world of Sadāśiva. Sadāśiva is the deity there. Within the body, he exists in the form of being...

शृङ्गाटिकायाम् ॥ कपालमध्ये ॥ कमलिनीमध्ये ॥ ब्रह्मरन्ध्रे ॥ ऊर्ध्वकमलिन्यां त्रि-
कूटस्थाने ॥ एवमेकविंशस्थानेष्वेकविंशतिब्रह्माण्डानि वसन्ति ॥

[XXXVI. saptadvīpāni piṇḍamadhye]

इदानीं सप्तद्वीपानि पिण्डमध्ये कथ्यन्ते । मज्जामध्ये जम्बुद्वीपः ॥ अस्थिमध्ये शा-
5 कद्वीपः ॥ शिरोमध्ये शाल्मलिद्वीपः ॥ मांसमध्ये कुशद्वीपः ॥ त्वचामध्ये क्रौञ्च-
द्वीपः ॥ शरीरस्य लोममध्ये गोमयद्वीपः ॥ नखमध्ये श्वेतद्वीपः ॥ एतानि द्वीपानि
गुप्तानि देहमध्ये तिष्ठन्ति ॥

Sources: 1-2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): śṛṅgāṭikā kapāle ca lambikā brahmarandhrake | navacakram
ūrdhvacakraṇ ca trikūṭety ekaviṃśatiḥ | brahmāṇḍāni vasantīti jñātavyāni prayatnataḥ
| 1-2 cf. SSP 3.4-5 (Ed. pp. 52-53): śṛṅgāṭe kulalokaḥ | tatra kuleśvaro devatā | piṇḍamad-
hya ānandasvarūpi tiṣṭhati | śaṅkhamadhya nalinisthāne 'kuleśalokaḥ | tatra akuleśvaro
devatā | piṇḍamadhya nirabhimānāvasthā tiṣṭhati | brahmarandhre parabrahmalokaḥ | tatra
parabrahma devatā | piṇḍamadhya paripūrṇadaśa tiṣṭhati | ūrdhvakamale parāparalokaḥ |
tatra paramesvaro devatā | piṇḍamadhya parāparabhāvas tiṣṭhati | trikūṭasthāne śaktilokaḥ |
tatra parāśaktir devatā | piṇḍamadhya 'sti vāvasthā sarvāsām sarvakartṛtvāvasthā tiṣṭhati |
evaṃ piṇḍamadhya saptapātālasahitaikaviṃśatibrahmāṇḍasthānavicārah | 4-7 cf. YSv (PT, p.
842): sapta dvīpāni kathyante 'dhunā tāni śṛṇu priye | jambūdvīpas tu majjāyāṃ śākadvīpas
tu madhyamaḥ | śālmadvīpaḥ śiromadhya māṃsamadhya kuśas tathā | tvaci krauñco loma-
madhya gomayadvīpa iritaḥ | nakhamadhya tathā śvetaḥ saptadvīpā vasundharā | jambūḥ
śākas tathā śālmāḥ kuśaḥ krauñcaś ca gomayaḥ | śvetaḥ sapteti khaṇḍāni saptakhaṇḍair
vasundharā | guptāny etāni rūpāni dehamadhya sthirāṇi ca | 4-7 cf. SSP 3.7 (Ed. p. 54): ma-
jjāyāṃ jambūdvīpaḥ | asthiṣu śākadvīpaḥ | śirāsu sūkṣmadvīpaḥ | tvakṣu krauñcadvīpaḥ |
romasu gomayadvīpaḥ | nakheṣu śvetadvīpaḥ | māṃse plakṣadvīpaḥ | evaṃ saptadvīpāḥ |

1 śṛṅgāṭikāyām DK₁U₁] śṛgāṭikāyām J, śṛṃgāṭikā γ kapālamadhya em.] karālamad-
hya L, kapolamadhya cett. kamalinimadhya BL brah-
marandhre DJK₁U₁] brahmaramdhra° E, brahmaramdhram BLP_U₂ 1-2 ūrdhvakama-
linyām trikūṭasthāne Birch em.] urdhvakamalinyās trikūṭasthānam U₂, urdhvakama-
linyaḥ trikūṭasthāne U₁, ūrdhvakamalinyāḥ || trikūṭasthāne | saptapātāle K₁, ūrdhva-
kamalinyāḥ || trikūṭasthāne || saptapātāle DJ, ūrdhvaṃ kamalinyā trikūṭasthānam LP, ka-
malinyām trikūṭasthānam B, kamalinyas trikūṭasthānam E 2 evaṃ cett.] evaṃ D ekav-
iṃśasthāneśv P] viṃśasthānek° B, ekaṃ viṃśasthāneśv L, ekaviṃśatisthāne DEJ_K₁, ekav-
iṃśasthān U₂ ekaviṃśatibrahmāṇḍāni DEK₁U₁] ekaviṃśatibrahmāṇḍāni J, ekaviṃśabrah-
māni BLP_U₂ vasanti cett.] vasaṃti BL 4 kathyante cett.] kathyate BL jambu cett.] jambū
P asthi° DEJ_K₁] asthi° P, asti° BLU₁U₂ 4-5 śākadvīpaḥ cett.] śākaladvīpaḥ BL, śāktid-
vīpaḥ JU₁ 5 śiromadhya cett.] śirāmadhya BEP, śarīramadhya L śālmalidvīpaḥ cett.]
śālmalidvīpaḥ U₂, śākaladvīpaḥ B, śākadvīpaḥ L 6 lomamadhya cett.] lomadhya U₁U₂ go-
mayadvīpaḥ DJK₁U₁] gomedadvīpaḥ cett. nakha° cett.] naṣa° K₁, tarava° LU₁ śvetadvīpaḥ
DJK₁U₁] puṣkaradvīpaḥ cett. dvīpāni cett.] rūpaṇi DJK₁U₁ 7 guptāni BLP_U₂] gupta° DJK₁U₁,
om. E dehamadhya Birch conj.] °madhya cett.

at the junction (15), in the middle of the skull (16), at the centre of the lotus pond (17), at the aperture of Brahman (18), and at the place of the three peaks above the lotus (19–21). Thus, the 21 worlds reside in 21 locations.

[XXXVI. Seven continents within the body]

Now, the seven continents within the body³⁵⁷ are taught.³⁵⁸

(1) Within the marrow is the continent [called] Jambu. (2) Within the bones is the continent [called] Śāka. (3) In the head is the continent [called] Śālmali. (4) In the flesh is the continent [called] Kuśa. Within the skin is the continent [called] Krauñca. (6) Within the body hair is the continent [called] Gomaya. (7) In the nails is the continent [called] Śveta. These hidden continents are situated within the body.³⁵⁹

beneficial. In the centre of the throat (*kaṇṭhamadhye*) is the world of Nilakaṇṭha. Nilakaṇṭha is the deity there. In the body, he exists in the form of fearlessness. At the entrance of the uvula (*tāludvāre*) is the world of Śiva. There, Śiva is the deity. Within the body, he exists in his matchless form. At the root of the uvula (*lambikāmūle*) is the world of Bhairava. There, Bhairava is the deity. In the body, he exists in the most excellent form. Therein is the world of Mahāsiddha. Mahāsiddha is the deity there. In the body, he exists in the form of awakening. Within the forehead (*lalāṭamadhye*) is the world of Anādi. Anādi is the deity there. Within the body, he is situated in the form of the blissful supreme destroyer. At the crossroads of the three paths (*śrīṅgāṭe*) is the world of the Kula. There, the Kuleśvara is the deity. Within the body, he resides in the form of bliss. Within the temple (*śaṅkhamadhye*) at the location of Nalinī is the World of Akuleśa. There, Akuleśvara is the deity. Within the body, he resides in the state of being free from pride, at the aperture of Brahman (*brahmarandhre*), the world of Parabrahman. There, Parabrahman is the deity. Within the body, he resides in a state of completeness. At the upper lotus (*ūrdhvakamale*) is the world of Parāpara. There, Parameśvara is the deity. Within the body, he exists as the state of Parāpara. At the place of the three peaks (*trikūṭasthāne*) is the world of Śakti. There, Parāśakti is the deity. Within the body, she exists in the existential state for all and the all-creative state. Thus, that is the examination of the locations of the external universe consisting of 21 worlds and seven hells within the body.” It is fascinating that he refrains from mentioning the various deities, which once again underlines Rāmacandra’s profanist and simplifying agenda he follows in his text.

³⁵⁷ **hatharatnaṇḍī** 4.39 identifies the seven continents with the seven *dhātus*.

³⁵⁸ The world of earth (*bhurloka*) consists of seven continents and seven oceans.

³⁵⁹ The diagnostic conjecture “*dehamadhye*” is based on the reading of *Yogasvarodaya*.

[XXXVII. piṇḍamadhye saptasamudrāḥ]

इदानीं पिण्डमध्ये सप्तसमुद्राः कथ्यन्ते। प्रस्वेदमध्ये क्षारसमुद्रः ॥ ललाटमध्ये
क्षीरसमुद्रः ॥ वसामध्ये मधुसमुद्रः ॥ कफमध्ये दधिसमुद्रः ॥ मेदोमध्ये घृतसमु-
द्रः ॥ रक्तमध्ये इक्षुसमुद्रः ॥ वीर्यमध्येऽमृतसमुद्रः ॥ पादमध्ये कूर्मस्थानम् ॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 842–843): samudrāḥ sapta kathyante piṇḍamadhye vyavasthitāḥ | lavaṇekṣusurāsarpiṛdadhidugdhajalāntakāḥ | lavaṇaṃ svedamadhye tu ikṣūraḥ kṣārasamudraḥ | sarpiṛ medo vasāmadhye dadhi kṣīraṃ lalāṭake | vīryamadhye 'mṛto jñeyāḥ pāde kūrmaḥ sthito mahān | 2–4 cf. SSP 3.8 (Ed. p. 29): mūrte kṣārasamudraḥ | śukre 'mṛtasamudraḥ | lālāyāṃ kṣīrasamudraḥ | kaphe dadhisamudraḥ | medasi ghṛtasamudraḥ | vasāyāṃ madhusamudraḥ | rakte ikṣusamudraḥ | evaṃ saptasamudrāḥ ||

2 saptasamudrāḥ cett.] samudrāḥ BL kathyante cett.] kathyate B, kathyete D prasvedamadhye cett.] svedamadhye U₁ kṣārasamudraḥ cett.] sārāsasamudraḥ L, kṣārasasamudraḥ U₁, kṣārasasamudra K₁, kṣārasāgaraḥ U₂ lalāṭamadhye cett.] lālāmadhye P 3 kṣīrasamudraḥ cett.] kṣīraḥ samudraḥ E vasāmadhye cett.] vānmadhye E, vīrya- madhye svāduḥ samudraḥ || majjāmadhye U₂ madhusamudraḥ EP] madasamudraḥ B, madyasamudraḥ L, madhusamūdraḥ U₂, om. DJK₁U₁ kaphamadhye cett.] om. DJK₁U₁ medo° BEP] meda° cett. 4 raktamadhye PU₁U₂] vasāmadhye madhusamudraḥ || raktamad- hye DU₁, npāmadhye madhusamudraḥ || raktamadhye J, rasamadhye E ikṣusamudraḥ cett.] ikṣurasamudraḥ U₁U₂, ikṣurasasamudraḥ EP 'mṛtasamudraḥ JU₁] amṛtasamudraḥ DK₁, svādusamudraḥ E, svādukasamudraḥ BL, svādudakasamudraḥ P pādāmadhye cett.] kar- masthāna pādāsamadhye B, karmasthāna pādāmadhye L, pādā tale DK₁ kūrmassthānam cett.] kūrmassthānam DJK₁U₁, om. BL

[XXXVII. Seven oceans within the body]

Now, the seven oceans within the body are taught.³⁶⁰ (1) Within the sweat is the salt ocean. (2) Within the forehead is the milk ocean. (3) Within the marrow is the honey ocean. (4) In the phlegm is the sour milk ocean. (5) In the fat is the ghee ocean. (6) Within the blood is the sugarcane ocean. (7) Within the semen is the ocean of the nectar of immortality. Situated at the feet is the place of the turtle.³⁶¹

³⁶⁰Rāmacandra, who bases his descriptions of the seven oceans on the YSv(PT, pp. 842–843) (cf. sources on the previous page) changed the order of oceans slightly. The respective passage can be translated as follows: “The seven oceans are taught to be situated within the body, [one of each] containing salt (*lavaṇa*), sugar (*ikṣu*), wine (*surā*), butter (*sarpir*), sour milk (*dadhi*), milk (*dugdha*) and water (*jala*). (1) Salt is within the sweat, (2) sugar in the blood, (3) wine in the skin, (4) ghee in the fat, (5-6) sour milk and milk in the forehead. (7) The nectar of immortality is known to be situated within the semen. A big turtle* (*the earth imagined as a tortoise floating on water) is situated at their feet.”

³⁶¹The earth consisting of seven islands with Mount Meru in its centre represented as a tortoise floating on waters of the seven oceans, cf. **markandeya** 58, **bhagavata** 5.16–26 and **bryant2009**.

[XXXVIII. navadvāramadhye navakhaṇḍāni]

इदानीं नवद्वारमध्ये नवखण्डानि कथ्यन्ते । भरतखण्डः ॥ काश्मीरखण्डः ॥ स्त्री-
मण्डलखण्डः ॥ द्विजखण्डः ॥ एकपादखण्डः ॥ राक्षसखण्डः ॥ गान्धारखण्डः ॥
कैवर्त्तखण्डः ॥ गर्भखण्डः ॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): idānīn tu navadvāre navakhaṇḍāni saṁśr̥ṇu | pāyvdau bhāratam khaṇḍam kāśmīram trikamaṇḍalam | dvijakhaṇḍam ekapādam khaṇḍam vakṣye samaṇḍalam | kaivarttam garttagāndhāram navakhaṇḍam iti sthitam | 2–4 cf. SSP 3.9 (Ed. p. 55): navakhaṇḍāḥ nava dvāreṣu vasanti | bhāratakhaṇḍaḥ kāśmīrakhaṇḍaḥ karparakhaṇḍaḥ śrīkhaṇḍaḥ śaṅkhakhaṇḍaḥ ekapādakhaṇḍaḥ gāndhārakhaṇḍaḥ kaivartakhaṇḍaḥ mahāmerukhaṇḍaḥ evaṁ navakhaṇḍāḥ |

2 navadvāramadhye DEJK₁U₁] navadvāreṣu EPU₂, *om.* BL navakhaṇḍāni BPLU₂] navakhaṇḍāḥ DJK₁U₁, *om.* E kathyante cett.] kathyate U₁ bharatakhaṇḍaḥ DJK₁U₁] mukhe bharatakhaṇḍaḥ BPL, pādamadhye kūrmaśthānam || mukham bhāratākhaṇḍam U₂, *om.* E kāśmīrakhaṇḍaḥ DJK₁U₁] nāsikayoh kinnarakhaṇḍanaraharikhaṇḍauḥ E, nāsikayoh kinnarakhaṇḍe 3 P, nāsikayor madhye kināraharikhaṇḍā B, nāsikayor madhye kinārasimhakhaṇḍā L, nāsikayoh || kinnara || harikhaṇḍa U₂ 2–3 strimaṇḍalakhaṇḍaḥ DJK₁U₁] *om.* cett. 3 dvijakhaṇḍaḥ DJK₁U₁] netrayoh ketumāla bhadraśvau E, netrayoh ketumāla bhadraśve 4 P, netrayo ketumāla bhadraśve BL, netrayoh || ketumāla || bhadraśve U₂ ekapādakhaṇḍaḥ DJK₁] yekapādakhaṇḍaḥ U₁, *om.* cett. rākṣasakhaṇḍaḥ DJK₁U₁] karṇayoh hiraṇmayakhaṇḍa ramyakakhaṇḍau E, karṇayor hiraṇmayaramyakakhaṇḍaḥ 5 P, karṇayor hiraṇmayaramyakakhaṇḍaḥ BL, karṇayoh || hiraṇmaya || ramyakakhaṇḍe U₂ gāndhārakhaṇḍaḥ DJK₁] gaṇdhārakhaṇḍaḥ U₁, gude kurukhaṇḍaḥ E, gude kurukhaṇḍaḥ 6 P, gude kurukhaṇḍāḥ BL, gudekurukhaṇḍam U₂ 4 kaivarttakhaṇḍaḥ DJK₁U₁] liṁge ilāvṛtakhaṇḍaḥ E, liṁge ilāvṛtaḥ 7 P, ilāvṛtam BL, liṁge ulāvṛtam U₂ garbhakhaṇḍaḥ DK₁U₁] garbhakhaṇḍaḥ || cha || J, evaṁ navakhaṇḍāḥ U₂, *om.* cett.

[XXXVIII. Nine regions within the nine doors]

Now, the nine continents³⁶² within the nine doors³⁶³ are taught: Bharata (1), Kāśmīra (2), Strīmaṇḍala (3), Dvija (4), Ekapāda (5), Rākṣasa (6), Gāndhāra (7), Kaivartta (8)[and] Garbha (9).³⁶⁴

³⁶²The island of Jambudvīpa consists of nine continents.

³⁶³The nine doors (*navadvāra*) refer to the nine orifices of the body: mouth, nostrils, eyes, ears, anus and gender.

³⁶⁴There is a clear divergence between the two main groups of manuscripts. I have edited according to the β -group, as its readings of the *khaṇḍas* are much closer to the source texts. The names of the doors are absent in the β -group and were likely also absent in Rāmacandra's original—perhaps because they were incomplete in the *Yogasvarodaya* or, more plausibly, because they were considered common knowledge. A diligent scribe of the γ -group, however, must have been dissatisfied with the original nomenclature and with the apparent omission of the names of the nine doors in his exemplar, and therefore felt compelled to rewrite the passage. Consequently, the γ -group transmits this section with an alternative nomenclature for the nine regions and includes the full set of names of the nine doors. The names of the nine doors are partially preserved in the *ramatosana* and entirely absent from the *ssplonavla*. The γ -group locates (1) the Bharatakhaṇḍa within the mouth, (2–3) the Kinnara- and Harikhaṇḍa in the two nostrils, (4–5) the Ketumāla- and Bhadrāśva[-khaṇḍa] in the eyes, (6–7) the Hiranyamaya- and Ramyaka[-khaṇḍa] in the ears, (8) the Kurukhaṇḍa at the anus, and (9) the Ilāvṛta[-khaṇḍa] at the genitals. This system, together with a detailed and elaborate description, is presented in *parakhya* 5.61–93.

[XXXIX. piṇḍamadhye 'ṣṭakulaparvatāḥ]

इदानीं पिण्डमध्येऽष्टकुलपर्वताः कथ्यन्ते। मेरुदंडमध्ये मेरुपर्वतः ॥ ब्रह्मकपाट-
मध्ये कैलासपर्वतः ॥ पृष्ठमध्ये हिमाचलः ॥ वामस्कन्धे मलयाचलः ॥ दक्षिण-
स्कन्धे मन्दराचलः ॥ दक्षिणकर्णे विन्ध्याचलः ॥ वामकर्णे मैनाकः ॥ ललाटमध्ये
5 श्रीशैलः। अपरे पर्वता हस्तयोः पादयोरङ्गुलीनां मध्ये वर्तन्ते ॥

Sources: 2-5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): idānīm parvatāś cāṣṭau kathyante śrṇu yatnataḥ | meru-
daṇḍe sumerus tu pīṭhamadhye himālayaḥ | vāmaskandhe tathā dakṣe malayo mandarācalaḥ
| vindhyas tu dakṣiṇe karṇe vāme maināka īśvari | lalāṭe madhyadeśe tu śrīśailaḥ paramēśvari
| tathā brahmakapāṭasthaḥ kailāsaḥ parvato mahān | sumerur himavān vindhyo malayo
mandaras tathā | śrīśailo mainākaś ceti kailāso 'ṣṭau ca parvatāḥ | apare parvatāḥ sarve
aṅgulimadhyavāsinaḥ | 2-5 cf. SSP 3.10 (Ed. p. 56): meruparvato merudaṇḍe vasati | kailāso
brahmakapāṭe vasati | himālayaḥ pṛṣṭhe | malayo vāmakandhare | mandaro dakṣiṇakandhare
| vindhyo dakṣiṇakarṇe | maināko vāmakarṇe | śrīparvato lalāṭe | evaṃ aṣṭa kulaparvatāḥ |
anye upaparvatāḥ sarvāṅguliṣu vasanti |

2 idānīm DJK₁U₁] idānīm cett. piṇḍamadhye DJK₁U₁] om. cett. 'ṣṭakulaparvatāḥ em.]
aṣṭakulaparvatāḥ PDJK₁U₁, aṣṭakulaparvatā U₂, aṣṭamakulaparvatāḥ BEL meruparvatāḥ
em.] merumparvatāḥ DJK₁U₁, merumaṇḍaraḥ cett. 3 kailāsaparvatāḥ DJK₁U₁] kailāsaḥ
cett. pṛṣṭhamadhye EU₂] pṛṣṭhaṃ madhye P, pṛthvīamadhye BL, paiṭimadhye D, paiṭhi-
madhye J, paiṭhamadhye K₁U₁ himācalaḥ cett.] himācalaḥ || parvatāḥ D, himācalaparvatāḥ
JU₁ vāmaskandhe cett.] vāmaskandhye K₁ 3-4 dakṣiṇaskandhe cett.] dakṣaṇaskandhe
DK₁U₁ 4 mandarācalaḥ cett.] maṇḍirācalaḥ K₁ dakṣiṇakarṇe cett.] dakṣaṇakarṇe
DU₁ 5 śrīśailaḥ cett.] śrīśailāsaḥ B parvatā em.] parvatāḥ DJK₁U₁, śailāḥ EU₂, śailā BPL
aṅgulīnām DJK₁EP] aṅgulibhyāṃ U₁, aṅgulī° BL madhye DJK₁U₁] mūleṣu cett. vartante
cett.] vartaṃte || cha || J, vartate BL, parvate U₁

[XXXIX. Eight major mountains within the body]

Now, the eight major mountains³⁶⁵ within the body are taught.³⁶⁶ (1) Within the spine is Mount Meru.³⁶⁷ (2) Within the door of Bahman is Mount Kailāsa.³⁶⁸ (3) Within the back is the Himālaya.³⁶⁹ (4) Within the left shoulder the mountains of Malaya.³⁷⁰ (5) Within the right shoulder Mount Mandara.³⁷¹ (6) In the right ear, the Vindhya mountain.³⁷² (7) the Maināka[mountain]³⁷³ is in the left ear. (8) Within the forehead Śrīśaila.³⁷⁴ Other mountains exist within the fingers of the hands[and] toes of the feet.

³⁶⁵The eight major mountains of Jambudvīpa.

³⁶⁶**hatharatnavali** 4.38ab situates all major mountains within the bones of the spine: *viṇā-daṇḍamayo merur asthīni kulaparvatāḥ* | “The bones of Mount Meru resembling the neck of a *viṇā* are the major mountains.” A related idea is expressed within **yogavasishta** 73.59cd: *jambūdvīpe mahāmeruṃ kulaparvatasamkūlam* || 59 ||. “In the continent of Jambudvīpa, there is the great Mount Meru, filled with the major mountains.”

³⁶⁷Mount Meru is considered to be situated at the universe’s centre. According to **asiddhi** 2.1, the central channel (*suṣūmṇā*, *madhyamā*, etc.) is situated within Mount Meru.

³⁶⁸Cf. **hathatattvakaumudī** 31.1–7. Here, Sundaradeva situates Mount Kailāsa at the center of the thousand-petalled lotus. Furthermore, he associates Mount Kailāsa as the abode of Śiva, having the nature of the form of *bindu*, etc.

³⁶⁹In the **hathasamketacandrikamysore** (ORI B 220, f. 10r) the Himālaya is supposed to be visualised in the context of *cikitsā* for *doṣas* arising for the yogin who does not heed the rules of proper time and place in yoga practice. If the practitioner is shaking, he shall visualize the Himālaya (*nāgendra*) in his heart.

³⁷⁰The term *malayācala* usually refers to the mountain range on the west of Malabar (see **petersburger5**).

³⁷¹In the *samudramanthana* episode of the **vishnupurana** (Ed. p. 75) Mount Mandara was used as a churning rod to churn the ocean of milk.

³⁷²In **bodhasara** 12.1.6 the immobility of the mind through the practice of yoga is compared to the great mount Vindhya (*niścalatvaṃ prajāyeta vindhyasyeva mahāgireḥ* ||6||).

³⁷³See **puranicencyclopedia**, p. 468 for references.

³⁷⁴The mountain has been associated with yoga practice, cf. **yogataravali** 28.

[XL. *śarīre navanāḍyaḥ*]

इदानीं शरीरे नवनाड्य स्तिष्ठन्ति । तन्मध्ये नवानां नदीनां स्थानानि वर्तन्ते । ग-
ङ्गा यमुना वितस्ता चंद्रभागा सरस्वती विपाशा शतरुद्रा इरावती नर्मदा । अपरा
नद्योपनदिनिर्झराः स्रोतांसि तटाकानि वापीकूपा द्विसप्ततिसहस्रनाडीनां मध्ये ति-
ष्ठन्ति ॥

Sources: 2–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): *śarīre navanāḍisthā narmadā ca maheśvari | iḍāyāṃ yamunā devī piṅgalāyāṃ sarasvatī | suṣumnāyāṃ vahed gaṅgā cānyonyāsu ca nāḍiṣu | gaṅgā sarasvatī godā narmadā yamunā tathā | kāveri candrabhāgā ca vitastā ca iḍāvati | dvisaptatisahasreṣu nadīnadaparīsravaḥ* | 2–5 cf. SSP 3.II–12 (Ed. p. 57): *pīnasā yamunā gaṅgā candrabhāgā sarasvatī | vipāsā śatarudrā ca śrīrātrīś caiva narmadā | evaṃ navanadyo navanāḍiṣu vasanti | anyā upanadyaḥ kulyopakulyā dvisaptatisahasranāḍiṣu vasanti* |

2 *śarīre* cett.] *śarīramadhye* EU₂ **navanāḍyas** EU₂] *navanāḍyas* BLP, *ṇavānāḍyas* DJK₁, *ṇavānāḍyaḥ* U₁ **tiṣṭhanti** cett.] *tiṣṭhati* DJK₁U₂ **navānām nadinām** cett.] *navanadinām* E **vantante** cett.] *vantante* || cha || J, *nivartante* U₂, *vantate* B 3 **yamunā** cett.] *jamunā* J **sarasvatī** cett.] *sarasvatī* L **vipāsā** cett.] *vaipaśā* DJK₁U₁ **śatarudrā** J] *śatarūdṛā* K₁, *śā-taḥṛdā* DPU₁, *śatahradā* E, *śāśataḥṛdā* B, *śātadrumā* U₂ **irāvati** DK₁E] *irāvati* BLPU₁, *airāvati* J, *om.* U₂ **narmadā** cett.] *narmadā* gaṇḍakī U₁, *narmadā* || gallakī || J **aparā** cett.] *om.* J 4 **nadyopanadinirjharāḥ srotāṃsi** em.] *nadyopanadinair bhurasrota°* D, *nadyūpanadinair bhurasrota°* U₁, *nadyo nadānirjārā srotāṃsi* P, *nadyopanadī* || *nair jarasrota* K₁, *nadyopanadinair jñanasrota* J, *nadyo nadānirjārāsty etāṃsi* BL, *nadyo nadānirjārāsrotāsi* U₂, *nadyo nadāni srotāṃsi* E **taṭākāni** E] *taṭāka* DJK₁, *taṭāni* BLP, *taḍaga* U₁, *taṭhāni* U₂ **vāpikūpā** cett.] *vāpikupāḥ* DJK₁ **dvisaptati°** cett.] *dvisaptati°* BP, *disaptati* E **sahasranāḍinām** cett.] *sahasranāḍinā* B, *sahasranāḍi°* J, *sahastranāḍi* EU₁ 4–5 **tiṣṭhanti** cett.] *tiṣṭhamṭi* U₁, *tiṣṭhati* JK₁

[XL. Nine rivers within the body]

Now, within the body, nine rivers³⁷⁵ are situated. Within it, the courses of the nine rivers exist. Gaṅgā, Yamunā, Vitastā,³⁷⁶ Candrabhāgā,³⁷⁷ Sarasvatī,³⁷⁸ Vipāśā,³⁷⁹ Śatarudrā,³⁸⁰ Irāvati³⁸¹ and Narmadā.³⁸² Other rivers and waterfalls near the rivers, streams, lakes, ponds and wells are within the 72000 channels.³⁸³

³⁷⁵The main microcosmic rivers of the yogic body are frequently associated with the main channels, c.f., for example, *hathapradipika*2024 3.108.

³⁷⁶The Jhelum river that originates in Kashmir and flows through present-day Pakistan, cf. *slaje*2014 and *geldner*1907.

³⁷⁷This is the Cenab River, cf. *nandikesvara*1917 2017. The river begins at the confluence of the Candrā and Bhāgā rivers near Tandi in the upper Himalayas in the Lahaul and Spiti districts of Himachal Pradesh. The river flows through the Jammu region in the south of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir and the plains of Punjab, where the Jhelum and the Rāvi flow into it.

³⁷⁸Name of an important river in Vedic times, cf. *wilke*2011.

³⁷⁹The present-day river Beas in the Punjab, cf. *geldner*1907.

³⁸⁰The Sutlej River, the longest of the rivers that flows through the Punjab.

³⁸¹The Rāvi river of the Punjab, cf. *mwi*899.

³⁸²The Narmada River flows from east to west in India, rises in the Amarkantak hills in the state of Madhya Pradesh, crosses the central highlands, flows through the states of Maharashtra and Gujarat and finally flows into the Gulf of Khambhat in the Arabian Sea.

³⁸³The comparison of the river lists in *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* suggests conclusions about their regions of composition due to notable differences. I thank *mallinson*2014b for this impulse. The three lists follow the order given in the texts:

Tattvayogabindu: Gaṅgā, Yamunā, Vitastā (mod. Jhelum), Candrabhāgā (mod. Cenab), Sarasvatī, Vipāśā (mod. Beas), Śatarudrā (mod. Sutlej), Irāvati (mod. Rāvi), Narmadā.

Yogasvarodaya: Yamunā, Sarasvatī, Gaṅgā, Godā, Narmadā, Kāverī, Candrabhāgā, Vitastā, Iḍāvati.

Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati: Pināsā, Yamunā, Gaṅgā, Candrabhāgā, Sarasvatī, Vipāsā, Śatarudrā, Śrīrātrī, Narmadā.

While the *Tattvayogabindu* lists only North Indian rivers (esp. Kashmir and Punjab), the *Yogasvarodaya* also includes Godā (Godāvarī) and Kāverī from the South, suggesting a South Indian provenance, supported by its closeness to the *Śivayogapradīpikā*. The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* replaces Vitastā with Pināsā and Irāvati with Śrīrātrī, possibly corruptions, as the Lonavla Edition offers no better variants.

[XLI. saptaviṃśatinakṣatrāṇi ...]

सप्तविंशतिनक्षत्राणि द्विसप्ततिकोष्ठकान्त्राभ्यन्तरे वसन्ति । द्वादश राशयः ॥ मेषः ॥
 वृषः ॥ मिथुनः ॥ कर्कः ॥ सिंहः ॥ कन्या ॥ तुला ॥ वृश्चिकः ॥ धनुः ॥ मकरः ॥
 कुम्भः ॥ मीनः ॥ नवग्रहाः ॥ आदित्या ॥ सोमः ॥ मङ्गलः ॥ बुधः ॥ बृहस्पतिः ॥
 5 शुक्रः ॥ शनिः ॥ राहुः ॥ केतुः ॥ पञ्चदश तिथयोऽत्र मध्ये वसन्ति ।

Sources: 2–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): itas tato dehamadhye ṛkṣas ca saptaviṃśatiḥ | yogās ca rāśayaś caiva grahās ca tithayas tathā | 2–5 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 57): saptaviṃśatir nakṣatrāṇi | dvādaśa rāśayaḥ | navagrahāḥ | nava lakṣa tārāḥ | pañcadaśa tithayaḥ | ete 'ntarvalaye dvisap-tatisahasrakoṣṭheṣu vasanti |

2 dvisaptatikoṣṭhakāntrābhyāntare P] dvisaptatikoṣṭhākāntrābhyāntare B, dvisap-tatikoṣṭhākāntrābhyāntare L, dvisaptatikoṣṭhakābhyantare E, dvisaptatikoṣṭhakāntrābhyāntare U₂, dvisaptatikoṣṭhakās cāmtrābhyantare DK₁, dvisaptatikoṣṭhākās cāmtrābhyāntar U₁, dvisaptatikoṣṭhakās cāmtrābhyāntare J **vasanti** cett.] vasati J **rāśayaḥ** cett.] rāśayaḥ B, meṣādy dvādaśarāśayaḥ || J **meṣaḥ** E] meṣa || K₁U₂, meṣa° cett., om. J **3 vṛṣaḥ** E] vṛṣabha || U₂, °vṛṣa° cett., vṛṣi° K₁, om. J **mithunaḥ** E] mithuna || U₂, °mithuna || K₁, °mithūnaḥ P, °mithūna° B, °mithuna° cett., om. J **karkaḥ** cett.] karka° P, karka || U₂, °karka || K₁, °karka° cett., om. J **siṃhaḥ** E] siṃha || U₂, °siṃha || K₁, °siṃha° cett., om. J **kanyā** cett.] kanyā || K₁U₂, °kanyā° cett., om. J **tulā** E] tula || K₁U₂, °tūla° cett., om. J **vṛścikaḥ** em.] vṛściko E, vṛścika || K₁U₂, °vṛścika° cett., om. J **dhanuḥ** em.] dhanur E, dhana || K₁U₂, °dhana° cett., om. J **makaraḥ** em.] makara || K₁U₂, °makara° cett., om. J **4 kumbhaḥ** em.] kumbha || K₁U₂, °kumbha° cett., om. J **mīnaḥ** em.] °mīnaḥ BL **navagrahāḥ** cett.], navagrahā K₁, navagrahaḥ P, ādityādinavagrahāḥ J **ādityā** em.], āditya° cett., ravi || U₂, om. J **somaḥ** em.], °soma° cett., °soma | DK₁, caṃdra || U₂, om. J **maṅgalaḥ** em.], maṅgala | DK₁U₂, om. J, °maṅgala° cett. **budhaḥ** em.], budha || K₁U₂, budha | D, °budha° cett., om. J **br̥haspatiḥ** em.], °br̥haspatiḥ P, br̥haspati | DK₁, vṛhasyati || U₂, °br̥haspati° cett., om. J **5 śukraḥ** em.], śukra || K₁U₂, śukra° D, °śukra° cett., om. J **5 śaniḥ** em.], °śaniḥ P, śani || U₂, śani || K₁, °śani° cett., om. J **rāhuḥ** P], rāhu || K₁U₂, °rāhu° cett., om. J **ketuḥ** PU₁U₂], ketavaḥ E, ketu K₁, °ketu° cett., om. J **pañcadaśa tithayo** cett.] pañcadaśa tithayaḥ || L, pañcadaśa tithiḥ || B, padaśa tithayo U₂ 'tra DK₁EPU₂] atra BJL, ātra U₁ **vasanti** cett.] tiṣṭhaṃti U₂

[XLI. Twenty-seven constellations ...]

Twenty-seven constellations³⁸⁴ are located inside the intestines in the seventy-two vessels.³⁸⁵

The twelve zodiacal signs (*rāśi*): Aries, Taurus, Gemini, Cancer, Leo, Virgo, Libra, Scorpio, Sagittarius, Capricorn, Aquarius, and Pisces.³⁸⁶

Nine Planets: Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn, Rāhu and Ketu.³⁸⁷

The fifteen lunar days reside here inside [the body].

³⁸⁴In *hathatattvakaumudī* 45.34–35, one of the results of yoga is the perception of heavenly gardens, the stars, the moon, etc.: *mano layaṃ yadā yāti bhrūmadhye yogato nṛṇām | jīhvāmūle 'mṛtasrāvo bhrūmadhye cātma darśanam || 34 || kampaṇaṃ tathā mūrdhni manasaivātma darśanam | devodyānāni ramyāṇi nakṣatrāṇi ca candramāḥ || ṛṣayaḥ siddhagandharvāḥ prakāśaṃ yānti yoginām ||*

³⁸⁵The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* reads *dvisaptatisahasra koṣṭheṣu*, which denotes 72,000, as opposed to Rāmacandra's 72. However, none of the witnesses of the *Tattvayogabindu* preserves this reading. The number 72,000 appears more convincing since *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 16 states that the *kanda*, located between the navel and the penis, is the origin of the 72,000 channels. This number cannot be coincidental, suggesting that this passage might be corrupted.

³⁸⁶Twelve zodiac signs are mentioned in the *vasisthasaṃhita* in 5.30–31. They appear in a larger discussion of the nature of the self, the relation of the self with time and the cycles of breath in the body (5.4–29). From 5.32–33, the text discusses the twelve zodiac signs and their influence on various aspects of human life.

³⁸⁷A detailed analysis of the *navagrahas* can be found in *kropf2005*. For an explanation of the concept of Rāhu and Ketu, see *kropf2005* 2005: 142.

यथा समुद्रमध्ये लहरी वर्तते। तथा शरीरमध्ये ऊर्मिनाम लहरी भवति॥ तथा ऊर्मेश्चलनाच्छरीरे चलनं भवति। धावनं भवति। तन्मध्ये समग्रं तारामण्डलं वर्तते। त्रयस्त्रिंशत्कोटयो देवता बाहुरोममध्ये वसन्ति। पृष्ठिरोममध्ये षडशीतिसहस्रदिव्यतपस्विनः। पीठोपपीठानि ऊर्ध्वपृष्ठोपरि यानि रोमाणि तन्मध्ये वसन्ति।

Sources: 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): lahariṣu minamanī cāvāhanam sthāpanam tathā | sarvāṅgeṣu ca deveśi samagraṃ ṛkṣamaṇḍalam | trayastriṃśatkoṭay astu nivasanti ca devatāḥ | sarvāṅgeṣu ca deveśi samagraṃ ṛkṣamaṇḍalam | 1–3 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. pp. 57–58): anekatārāmaṇḍalam ūrmipuñje vasati | trayastriṃśatkoṭidevatā bāhuromakūpeṣu vasanti | 3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): trayastriṃśatkoṭay astu nivasanti ca devatāḥ | cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 58): trayastriṃśatkoṭidevatā bāhuromakūpeṣu vasanti | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): tathā pīṭhāni sarvāṇi dehamadhye sthitāni ca | 3–4 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 58): anekapīṭhopapīṭhakā romakūpeṣu vasanti |

1 yathā cett.] pīṭhasya romamadhye yathā U₁ samudramadhye cett.] om. P lahari cett.] laharā B, om. P tathā cett.] om. P °madhya em.] madhye cett. ūrmi° K₁ ūrmi° DJ, urmmi° BLPU₂, urmi° U₁, kūrmmi° E bhavati cett.] bhavanti U₂ 1–2 tathā urmeś em.] tathā urmeś U₁, tasyāḥ urmyaḥ D, tasyāḥ || urmyaḥ K₁, tasyā ūrmyaś], ūrmyaś calās E, ūrmyaś calās P, ūrmmiś calās B, ūrmyaś calāḥ || U₂, om. L 2 calanāc charire em.] calanāśarire U₁, calācharire DJK₁, cataḥ || śarire B, cataḥ śarire P, tataḥ śarira° U₂, tataḥ E, om. L dhavanam bhavati DJK₁U₁] dhāvanam ca cett., om. E samagraṃ cett.] samagrām B, samagra° U₁U₂ 3 trayastriṃśatkoṭayo BL] trayastriṃśatkoṭyo PJK₁, trayāḥ triṃśatkoṭyo U₂, trayāḥ striśatkoṭi U₁, trayastriśatkoṭyo D, trayastriṃśatkoṭi° E devatā DJK₁U₁] devatāḥ | cett. vasanti cett.] vasaṃti DJU₁ prṣṭhiromamadhye em.] prṣṭhiromamadhye BLU₁, prṣṭaromamadhye PU₂, pīṭhasya romamadhye DJK₁, om. E ṣaḍaśīti° DJK₁U₁U₂] ṣaḍaśati° BL, ṣaḍaśi° P, om. E 3–4 °sahasra° cett.] om. E 4 divya cett.] om. E °tapasvināḥ BLPU₂] °tapasvino DJK₁U₁, om. E pīṭhopapīṭhāni conj.] pīṭhopapīṭhe LP, miṣṭhopapīṭher B, pīṭhopapīṭho° U₂, pīṭhamahāpīṭhau DJK₁U₁, om. E ūrdhvapṛṣṭhopari em.] urdhvapṛṣṭhopari U₁, ūrdhvatvaṣṭhopari DJK₁, °rdhvapari U₂, dvavaṣṭhopari P, dvaiṣṭhopari B, dvaiṣṭhipari L, om. E yāni BDJPU₁U₂] yoni J, yā L, om. E romāni BDLPU₂] romāni U₁, om. E tanmadhye cett.] om. E vasanti cett.] santi JU₁, om. E

Just as the wave resides in the ocean, so does the wave called Ūrmi³⁸⁸ exists in the body. Thus, from the fluctuation of Ūrmi, movement arises in the body, [and] flowing arises. Within her, the totality of stars exists.

Thirty-three crores of divinities reside within the hairs of the arms.

Within the hairs of the back, there are 86,000 (*ṣaḍaśītisahasra*) heavenly ascetics. Seats [of power] and secondary seats [of power]³⁸⁹ reside within the hairs³⁹⁰ which are on the upper part of the back.

³⁸⁸ Rāmacandra's concept of *ūrmi* is remarkable. The term *ūrmi* is present in one of his source texts. The SSP 3.13 reads: *anekatārāmaṇḍalaṃ ūrmipuñje vasati* | "The totality of stars resides in the mass of the wave(s)." It appears that both mentions of *ūrmi* could derive from historically much earlier statements of the Kashmiri Śaiva exegetes in which *ūrmi* is a synonym for *spandaśakti*. In his commentary to *spandakarika* 1.1 Kṣemarāja writes: *sā caiṣā spandaśaktir garbhikṛtānantasargasaṃhāraikaghanāhantācamatkārānandarūpā niḥśeṣaśuddhāsud-dharūpāmātṛmeyasaṃkocavikāsābhāsanatattvā sarvopaniṣadupāsyā yugapad evonmeṣanimeṣamayī* || *tathā hi śivādeḥ kṣityantasyāśeṣasya tattvagrāmasya prākṣrṣṭasya saṃhartrūpā yā nimeṣabhūr asāv evodbhaviṣyaddaśāpekṣayā sraṣṭurūponmeṣabhūmis tathā viśvanimeṣabhūś cidghanatonmeṣasārā cidghanatānimajjanabhūmir api viśvonmeṣarūpā* || *yad āgamaḥ | lelihanā sadā devī sadā pūrṇā ca bhāsate* || *ūrmir eṣā vibodhābdheḥ śaktir icchātmikā prabhoḥ* || *iti* ||. For Kṣemarāja *ūrmi* is the *spandaśakti*, the goddess (*devī*) and thus the *icchāśakti* of lord Śiva. *Ūrmi* is the force that sets in motion the creation and dissolution of the universe.

³⁸⁹ The emendation to *piṭhopapiṭhāni* is based on the reading of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, which reads *anekapiṭhopapiṭhakā* (cf. sources). The manuscripts of the *Tattvayogabindu* offer two main readings. The β -group preserves the reading *piṭhamahāpiṭhau*, whose dual form does not align with the final verb *vasanti* preserved in all manuscripts. The γ -group retains variants of *piṭhopapiṭha* with inconsistent case endings. Given that this is the reading of the source text, I preferred the γ -variant over the β -variant. Consequently, I corrected the case ending to the grammatically appropriate nominative plural.

³⁹⁰ In the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, the macrocosmic elements are in the pores of the skin (*romakūpa*). However, Rāmacandra seems to take a different view by consistently locating the macrocosmic elements within the body hair (*roma*).

हृदयरोममध्ये तक्षकमहानागः ॥ कर्कोटकः ॥ शङ्खः ॥ पुलकः ॥ वासुकिः ॥ अन-
न्तः ॥ शेषः ॥ एते नागा वसन्ति । उदररोममध्येऽपरे नागा वसन्ति ।
गणगन्धर्वकिन्नरकिंपुरुषाप्सरोविद्याधरगुह्यकाः । शरीरमध्ये मर्मस्थानेऽनेकती-
र्थावली वसन्ति । अश्रुपातमध्ये मेघमण्डलं वसति । अनन्ताः सिद्धयो बुद्ध्याः
5 प्रकाशमध्ये वर्तन्ते । चन्द्रसूर्यौ द्वयोर्नेत्रयोर्मध्ये वर्तते । अनेकवनस्पतिगुल्मल-
तातृणानि जङ्घारोममध्ये वसन्ति ।

Sources: 1-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): hṛdaye vyomamadhye tu anantādyās tu vāsukih | udare vyomamadhye tu pare nāgā vasanti hi | 1-3 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 58): kulanāgā vakṣasi vasanti | 3-5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): udare vyomamadhye tu 'pare nāgā vasanti hi | gandharvakinnarāḥ śūrā vidyādharaṁpsarādayaḥ | anekatīrthavarṇāś ca guhyakāś ca vasanti hi | 3-5 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 58): gandharvakinnarakimpuruṣā apsarasāṁ gaṇā udare vasanti | 3-5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): anantasiddhaya buddhyā prakāśo varttate hṛdi | meghasya maṇḍalaṁ jñeyam aśrūpāte tathaiva ca | 3-5 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 59, in mss. B₁, W, P₁, P₃): anekatīrthāni marmasthāne vasanti | anantasiddhā matiprakāśe vasanti | 5-6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): candrārkaḥ netrayormadhye jaṅghā lomasu sāksīṇaḥ | tṛṇagulmādikañcāpi viśvarūpaṁ smaret tataḥ | 5-6 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 59): candrasūryau netradvaye vasataḥ | anekavṛkṣalaṭāgulmatṛṇāni jaṅghāromakasthāne vasanti |

1 hṛdayaromamadhye cett.] om. BL takṣakamahānāgaḥ DJK₁] takṣakaḥ mahānāgaḥ EU₂, takṣakamahānāga P, takṣamā nāgaḥ U₁, om. BL karkoṭakaḥ DK₁PU₂] karkoṭaḥ JU₁, om. BEL śaṅkhaḥ cett.] śaṅkha K₁, om. BL pulakaḥ P] pulikaḥ JU₁, pulika DK₁, kulakaḥ U₂, takṣakaḥ E, om. BL vāsukih EPU₂] vāsuki DJK₁U₁, om. BL 1-2 anantaḥ P] ananta° E, ananta J, ānanta° U₁, ānanta DK₁U₂, om. BL 2 śeṣaḥ JU₂] °śeṣaḥ E, śoṣa P, °śoṣa U₁, śeṣā DK₁, om. BL ete cett.] om. BL nāgā cett.] nāga E, om. BL vasanti cett.] vasaṁti || cha || J, om. BL °madhye cett.] °madhye | D 'pare JU₁] apare cett. 3 gaṇa° DJK₁U₁] guṇa° BELP, gaṁdha° U₂ °kinnarakimpuruṣāpsaro° J] °kiṁnarakimpuruṣa || apsaro D, °kiṁnarakimpuruṣa || apsaro || K₁, °kinnarapuruṣāpsaro° U₁, °kinnarāpsaro° EU₂, °kinnarābhara° BL, °kinarā P °vidyādhara° cett.] °vidyādhara | D, vidyādhara | K₁, om. P °guhyakāḥ BEL] °guhyakaḥ U₂, °guhyaka JU₁, guhyaka DK₁, om. P śarīramadhye cett.] śarīmadhye D, madhye P marmasthāne U₁] karmasthāne DK₁, om. cett. 3-4 'nekatīrthāvali PU₂] anekatīrthāvali BL, naikatīrthavallī JU₁, nenekatīrthavallī DK₁, anekatīrthāni E 4 meghamaṇḍalaṁ cett.] meghamaṇḍala B vasati EPU₂] vasati L, vasaṁti DJK₁U₁, vasaṁti B anantāḥ DEJK₁P] anantā BLU₁U₂ buddhayaḥ em.] buddhayaś ca cett., buddhayaś ca B 5 vartante EJK₁PU₂] vartate BDLU₁ °sūryau cett.] °sūryo BDL dvayor DEP] dvayā° B, dvayo LU₂, dvayaur K₁, om. JU₁ netrayor DK₁E] netreyor P, netrayo B, netrayoḥ U₂, netradvaya° JU₁ madhye cett.] °madhye || J, om. U₁ vartate cett.] pravartate U₂, vasaṁti U₁, vasaṁti || cha || J 5-6 anekavanaspatigulmalatātṛṇāni BELP] anekavanaspatigulmatṛṇāni D, anekavanaspatigulmalatāni U₁, anekavanaspatigulmatṛṇāni JK₁, anekavana | spatigulmalatātṛṇāni U₂ 6 roma° cett.] °rora° BL °madhye cett.] °sthāne DJK₁ vasanti cett.] vasati JU₂, varttaṁte DK₁

Within the hairs of the chest: the great Nāga Takṣaka, Karkoṭaka, Śaṃkha, Pulaka, Vāsuki, Ānanta and Śeṣa. These Nāgas reside [there].³⁹¹

Within the abdominal hair reside other snakes, [as well as] Gaṇas, Gandharvas, Centaurs, Dwarves, Apsaras, Vidyādhara, and Guhyakas.

Many series of pilgrimage sites are located at vulnerable places within the body. Within the falling tears resides the totality of clouds. Infinite supernatural powers exist within the light of the intellect (*buddhi*).³⁹²

The sun and the moon exist within the two eyes.

Many trees, bushes, creepers and grasses live within the hairs of the legs.³⁹³

³⁹¹ Notably, none of the known sources contains the names of the snake demons.

³⁹² The original reading suggested by the manuscript transmission is: *anantāḥ siddhāyo buddhayaś ca prakāśamādhye vartante* | “Infinite supernatural powers and *buddhis* exist within the light.” While a plural of *buddhi* appears in other Sanskrit texts, its meaning in this context is rather ambiguous. Furthermore, the source text suggests a more coherent reading. Emending *buddhi* to the genitive singular form *buddhayāḥ*, supported by the formulation *matiprakāśe* in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (cf. sources), resolves nearly all issues within the sentence. Without this emendation, the reference to light in the *Tattvayogabindu* would remain undefined and, therefore, nonsensical in this context, as there is no unspecified *prakāśa* within the body. Additionally, this adjustment avoids the problematic plural form of *buddhi*. The only remaining issue is the *ca*, which likely entered the text during an early stage of transmission once *buddhayāḥ* became *buddhayaḥ*.

³⁹³ Rāmacandra does not explain why he teaches the microcosmic equivalents of the macrocosmic world within the yogic body. Other texts state possible reasons. For example, immediately after the verses on the various contents of the yogic body **mallinson2007** 2.5 states: *jānāti yaḥ sarvaṃ idaṃ sa yogī nātra saṃśayaḥ* | “One who knows all this is a yogi, in this, there is no doubt.” SSP 3.1 explains: *piṇḍamādhye carācaram yo jānāti sa yogī piṇḍasaṃvittir bhavati* || 1 || “He who knows the movable and immovable within the body is a yogi who has the realization of the body.”

पुरुषस्य नृत्यदर्शनात्। गीतश्रवणात्। वल्लभवस्तुनो दर्शनात्। य आनन्द उत्पद्यते सः स्वर्गलोकः कथ्यते। रोगपीडादुर्जनेभ्यः पुरुषस्य यदुःखमुत्पद्यते। तद्वहुतरं नरकं कथ्यते। अथ च यत्कर्मकरणात्सर्वेषां लोकानां स्वमनसि च शुभं न। भ्रते। तत्कर्म बन्धनमित्युच्यते। अथ च यत्कर्मकरणान्मनोमध्ये शङ्का न भवति
 5 तत्कर्म मुक्तिकारणम्॥

Sources: 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 843–844): samagradarśanān muktaḥ svargabhogaṇ ca mat-sukham | tad etac cintayā yāti rogaśokavivarjitaḥ | 1–3 cf. SSP 3.14 (Ed. pp. 59–60): yat sukham tat svargaḥ | yad duḥkham tan narakāḥ | yat karma tad bandhanam | yo nirvikalpaḥ sā muk-tiḥ | svasvarūpajñānadaśāyām nidrādau svātma-jāgaraḥ śāntir bhavati | evaṁ sarvadeheṣu viśvarūpaḥ parameśvaraḥ paramātmā 'khaṇḍasvabhāvena ghaṭe ghaṭe cit svarūpi tiṣṭhati | 3–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): yat karmā karmaṇā śāṅkā manomadhye bhaved vahiḥ | tatkar-makaraṇam muktir ity āha bhagavān śivaḥ |

1 puruṣasya cett.] puruṣasya vādyā J, puruṣasyāvādyā U₁ nṛtyadarśanāt DEP] nityadarśanād BDK₁L, darśanāt || U₂, nṛtyod° U₁, nṛtyot° J gītaśravaṇāt cett.] gītaśravaṇād U₁ darśanāt cett.] darśanād U₁ ya P] | yā U₁, yaḥ BDK₁EL, om. U₂ 2 saḥ E] sa DJK₁U₁U₂, om. BLP svargalokaḥ BELP] svargaloka U₂, bahurānamdaḥ svarga+++laḥ D, bahurānamdaḥ svargaphalaḥ K₁U₁, sa bahurānamdaḥ || cha || svargaphalaḥ J °piḍā° DJK₁] °piḍa° U₁, °piḍito E, °piḍato BP, °piḍāto U₂, °piḍano L durjanebhyāḥ cett.] durjanebhyā BLP yad duḥkham em.] yat duḥkham E, yad duḥkham L, ya duḥkham P, yat duḥkha B, duḥkham DK₁, duḥkham JU₁, duḥkha U₂ 2–3 tad bahutaram cett.] tat bahutaram DK₁, bahutaram JU₁ 3 narakam cett.] nakam U₁ atha ca yat karmakaraṇāt sarveṣāṁ lokānām svamanasi ca śubham na JU₁] om. cett. 4 bharate U₁] bhāsate J, om. cett. tat karma bandhanam ity ucyate JU₁] om. cett. yatkarmakaraṇān PU₂] yatkarmakaraṇāt cett. manomadhye cett.] manobudhye BL śāṅkā cett.] śākā U₂ bhavati cett.] bhaviti K₁, bhavanti U₂ 5 muktikāraṇam cett.] muktikāraṇam || cha || J, kamuktikāraṇam BL

The person's bliss that is generated as a result of seeing dance, listening to songs, [and] viewing beloved objects, that [bliss] is called heaven. The person's suffering that arises as a result of the pain caused by disease and wicked people, that great [suffering] is called hell. Moreover, an action that does not bring goodness to all people and one's mind, that action is said to be bondage.³⁹⁴ And furthermore, the action that, when performed, does not cause doubt in the mind, that action is the cause of liberation.³⁹⁵

³⁹⁴This sentence is only preserved in J and U₁. The manuscripts N₁ and N₂ have a *lacunae* here and manuscripts D and K₁ of the β -group omit the sentence. The sentence significantly improves the meaning of the entire paragraph. Therefore, it is likely that the sentence belongs to the original text. This error in the other witnesses can easily be explained here as a haplography of the following sentence, as they begin similarly. A similar statement is found in Rāmacandra's source text, the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (cf. sources).

³⁹⁵Structurally, lacking any introductory statement, these sentences at first sight do not convincingly align with the context of the yogic body's contents. However, the structure is consistently preserved across all witnesses. Furthermore, this sequence corresponds to the presentation of contents in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, as well as the *Yogasvarodaya* (cf. sources). Both source texts conclude the chapter with information about the contents of the yogic body. Rāmacandra's formulations are a synthesis of the two source texts. *ssplonavlā* (Ed. p. 60, cf. sources) note the following regarding the corresponding passage in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*: "Thus, the Supreme Lord of universal nature exists in every manifestation in the form of *cit*. Heaven and hell are not two worlds which the souls visit after leaving the body, but only mental states of happiness or sorrow."

[XLII. rājayogāc charīre cihnāni]

- इदानीं राजयोगाच्छरीरे एतादृशानि चिह्नानि भवन्ति । तानि कथ्यन्ते । सकलरो-
 गनाशः । सकलपृथ्वीं पश्यति । तदनन्तरं तत्त्वविषयं ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते । समग्रां भा-
 षां जानाति । ततः पुरुषस्य देहो वज्रमयो भवति । सर्पदंशे सति मरणं न भवति ।
 5 ततः पुरुषस्य बुभुक्षापिपासानिद्रोष्णताशीतबाधां न कुर्वन्ति । वाक्सिद्धिर्भवति ।
 विद्युत्पाते शरीरे काचिद्धानिर्न भवति । तदनन्तरं पवनयोगी पुरुषो भवति । समग्रां
 पृथ्वीं दृष्ट्वा पश्यति । अणिमाद्यष्टसिद्धिर्भवति ।

Sources: 3–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): *yasya darśanamātreṇa rogaśokavivarjitah | paramānan-
 dacittaḥ syāt tapasvī caiva kirttitah | saptadvīpā bhaved dr̥ṣṭā tattvajñānam tato bhavet |
 sarvabhāvaṃ vijānīyād vajradeho bhavet tathā | sarpadaṣṭe viṣaṃ na syāt kṣudhā nidrā tṛṣṇā
 tathā* | 5–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): *uṣṇatā śītatā ceti vāksiddhiḥ syān na saṃśayaḥ | vidyutpāte
 'pi dehasya kvacid hānir na jāyate* | 6–7 cf. YS (PT, p. 844): *tato 'sau vāyuyogī syād dr̥ṣṭvā
 pṛthvikulānvitah | aṇimādyasṭasiddhiḥ syān ...*

2 *idānīm* cett.] *idāni* BPU₂ *rājayogāc charīre* DJEL] *rājayogā* || *charīre* K₁, *rājayogāc charīre*
 || B, *rājayogācharīre* U₁, *rājayogāśarīre* U₂, *rogayogācharīre* P *etādr̥śāni* cett.] *yādr̥śāni* E
 2–3 *sakalaroganāśaḥ* cett.] *sakalarogaḥ nāśaḥ* U₁, *sakalarogaḥ* || J 3 *sakalapṛthvīm* cett.]
sakalām pṛthvīm P *paśyati* cett.] *paśyati* BDK₁L *tad anantaram* cett.] *tad aṃtaram* P,
tad anam̐tara° U₂ *tattvaviṣayaṃ* DJK₁U₁] *om.* cett. 3–4 *samagrām bhāṣām* cett.] *sama-
 grā bhāṣā* EU₂, *samagrā bhāṣa* B, *samagra bhāṣā* L 4 *dam̐śe* cett.] *dam̐śo* P, *dam̐śena* E,
°dam̐śema B *sati* [K₁] *sati* DU₁, *om.* cett. *na* cett.] *om.* L *bhavati* cett.] *bhavati* B, *vati* U₂
 5 *tataḥ* cett.] *tat*° BL, *om.* JU₁ *puruṣasya* cett.] *om.* JU₁ *bubhukṣā* DEK₁U₂] *bunnuṣā* P,
babhukṣā BL, *om.* JU₁ *pipāsānidroṣṇatā*° L] *pipāsānidroṣṇatā*° U₂, *pipāsānidrā* | *uṣṇatā* ||
 DK₁, *pipāsānidrollatā* EB, *pipāsānidrolmatā* P, *om.* JU₁ *°śīta*° cett.] *śītatā* P, *śītoṣṇatā* E, *śīta*
nā DK₁, *om.* JU₁ *kurvanti* cett.] *karoti* K₁, *kuroti* D, *om.* JU₁ *vāksiddhir* cett.] *vāk* || *siddhir*
 K₁, *om.* J *bhavati* cett.] *bhavati* B, *om.* J 6 *śarīre* DJK₁U₁] *om.* cett. *kācid hānir na* U₂] *kācid glānir na* BL,
na kiṃcid glānir D, *na kiṃcid vānir K₁*, *kvacid dhvanir J*, *kvācid glānir na* U₁, *kācid bādhāpi* E *°yogī* K₁U₁] *°rūpi* PU₂, *°rūpi* BL, *°yopi* DJ, *°rūṣi* E *puruṣo* cett.] *puruṣi* E
 7 *pṛthvīm* cett.] *pṛthvi* B *dr̥ṣṭyā* DEK₁P] *dr̥ṣṭā* BL, *dr̥ṣṭvā* JU₁U₂ *aṇimādyasṭasiddhir* cett.] *aṇimāmahimāgarimāladhimā* tathā U₂ *bhavati* cett.] *prātikāmyamiśatvaṃ* || *viśitvaṃ* || *ity*
āṣṭasiddhayaḥ || U₂

[XLII. Signs in the body as a result of Rājayoga]

Now, signs like this manifest in the body as a result of Rājayoga.³⁹⁶ They are described. The eradication of all diseases occurs. He sees the entire world. Subsequently, knowledge whose range is the principles arises. He understands all languages. Then, the person's body becomes as hard as a diamond. After a snake bite has taken place, death does not occur. Then, the troubles of hunger, thirst, sleep, heat and cold do not oppress for the person. Perfection of speech arises. When struck by lightning, there is no damage whatsoever to the body. Subsequently, the person becomes a yogin of the wind.³⁹⁷ He sees the entire earth with [his] gaze. The eight supernatural powers beginning with "becoming infinitely small" etc. (*aṇimādi*) arise.

³⁹⁶The repeated mention of the effects of Rājayoga seems redundant since the topic has been covered extensively already in section XVI–XVII. Nevertheless, these specific results have not been mentioned so far. In the descriptions of previous chapters, the unhinderedness, equanimity and bliss resulting from Rājayoga were emphasised. Here, the focus shifts to physical results such as health, strength, supernatural abilities or resilience.

³⁹⁷Rāmacandra employs *pavanayogī* as a synonym for *vāyuyogī* of his source text *Yogasvarodaya*. The following sentences suggest that the *pavanayogī* is so-called because the yogin can move freely through space, like the wind. That reminds us of *Amanaska* 1.65: *dvādaśāhalayenāpi bhūcaratvaṃ hi sīdhyati | nīmiśārdhapramāṇena paryaṭaty eva bhūtaḥ* || 65 || Birch (213: 243) translates: "By means of absorption for a period of twelve days, the state of moving across the earth is achieved. Within half the time [it takes to] blink an eyelid, [the yogin can] travel [anywhere] around the world." An e-text search for *pavanayogī* yielded no hits, in contrast to *vāyuyogī*. However, the term seems to be mostly associated with *prāṇāyāma* in other texts, as in the case of *Rudrayāmala* 61.177: *pavaneśaś cāṇilasthā paramātmā nirantaraḥ* (em.) *nināntarā*) *vāyupūrakakārī ca vāyukumbhakavadhinī* || 175 || *vāyucchidrakaro vātā vāyunirgamamudrikā | kumbhakastho recakasthā pūrakasthātīpūriṇī* || 176 || *vāyvakāśādhārārūpī vāyusañcārakārīṇī | vāyusiddhikaro dātrī vāyuyogī ca vāyugā* || 177 || "(175) The lord of the breath, residing in breath is the supreme self, not interrupted anywhere. She is one who performs the inhalation of the breath and the one who executes the retention of the breath. (176) He is one who pierces with the breath, he is the blower; she is the one who seals the outflow of the breath. He abides in retention, she abides in exhalation, in inhalation, and in intensified inhalation. (177) She is the one who has the form of a support of space and breath, the one who sets the breath in motion. He is the one who accomplishes the breath, the giver and the yogin of the wind; and she the one who moves the wind."

श्रीपद्मश्च महापद्मः शङ्खो मकरकच्छपौ ।
मुकुन्दकुन्दनीलाश्च खर्वश्च निधयो नव ॥ XLII.1॥

- 5 महापद्माद्या नव निधयः समीप आगच्छन्ति । आकाशमध्ये दशसु दिक्षु गमना-
गमनबलं भवति । यत्र लोके गमनेच्छा भवति । तत्र लोके गच्छति । आज्ञा सर्वत्र
स्फुरति । परमेश्वरं समीपे पश्यति । करणे हरणे सामर्थ्यं भवति ॥

Sources: 5–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): ...mahāpadmodayas tathā | āgacchanti samīpe ca nidhaya
nātra saṁśayaḥ | yatrecchā gamanaṁ tatra svarge marttye rasātale | sphuraty ājñākhyāḥ
sarvatra samīpe paramēśvaraḥ | kāraṇe hāraṇe śakto rakṣaṇe 'pi ca pārvati | ātmamadhye
mano nityaṁ nirjane nivaset sudhīḥ | kṛtvātmamanasor aikyaṁ prāpnoti paramaṁ padam |

Parallels: 2–3 ≈ amaraed I.I.165–I.I.166: mahāpadmaś ca padmaś ca śaṅkho makarakaccha-
pau | mukundakundanilāś ca kharvaś ca nidhaya nava ||

2 śrīpadmaś ca mahāpadmaḥ E] śrīpadmaś ca mahāpadmaṁ PB, padmaś ca mahāpadmaś ca
U₂, om. DELU₁ śaṅkho BLU₂] saṅkho P, om. DU₁ makarakacchapau em.] makarakacha-
paḥ BLU₂, makarakachapa° P, om. DU₁ 3 mukundakundanilāś ca em.] mukunḍo kuṇḍaś
ca nīlāś ca unṁ. U₂, kuṇḍonukuṇḍanilāś ca P, kuṇḍonukuṇḍoś ca nīlāś ca BL, om. DU₁
kharvaś ca nidhaya nava em.] vijñeyā nidhaya nava P, vajrayoni cidātmakā BL, vajrayo
navanidhi U₂, om. DU₁ 5 mahāpadmādyā DEJK₁U₁] mahāpadmājñā BL, mamahāpadmā P
nava nidhayaḥ em.] nava nidhyayaḥ EJ, nava nidhayaya K₁, nava nidhapa U₁, nidhyayaḥ D,
nanidhyayaḥ || L, navinidhyayaḥ || B, dhānavanidhaya P samīpa E] samīpe cett. āgaccha-
nti cett.] āgacchati U₂, āgacchati || nava nidhayaḥ samīpa āgacchanti || B ākāśamadhye cett.]
ākāśa° JU₁ daśasu cett.] °daśa U₂ dikṣu cett.] dikṣumadhye DJK₁U₁ 5–6 gamanāgamana-
balaṁ cett.] gamanāgamanaavallabhaṁ BL, gamanāgamane bhavataḥ balaṁ E 6 bhavati
cett.] bhavati B yatra cett.] om. E loke cett.] om. E gamanechā cett.] om. E bhavati
cett.] bhavati U₁, om. E tatra cett.] yatra BPU₁, om. E loke cett.] om. E gacchati cett.]
om. E ājñā cett.] ajñā BLP sarvatra cett.] om. E 7 sphurati cett.] om. E paśyati cett.]
paśyanti BU₂ karaṇe cett.] karaṇa° K₁, karaṇaṁ D haraṇe cett.] taraṇe U₂ sāmartyaṁ
cett.] ca sāmartyaṁ JU₁, ++++marthyam D

XLII.1 1. Śrīpadma (“glorious lotus”), and 2. Mahāpadma (“great lotus”), 3. Śaṃkha (“conch”), 4. Makara (“crocodile”), and 5. Kacchapa (“turtle”), 6. Mukunda (“gem”), 7. Kunda (“jasmine”), and 8. Nīla (“sapphire”), as well as 9. Kharva (“[another type of] gem”) are the nine treasures.³⁹⁸

The nine treasures, beginning with the Mahāpadma, are near at hand. The power of coming and going within the ten cardinal points in space arises. Wherever one desires to go in the world, one goes there. Unlimited force manifests everywhere. One sees the Supreme Lord nearby. The capability to create and destroy arises.

³⁹⁸The verse is absent in the β -group and therefore greyscaled. A scribe must have added this verse. The verse might stem from the *Amarakośa*. The nine treasures traditionally belong to the god Kubera, the lord of the riches, the wealthiest god. I emended the edition according to the traditional list. The nine treasures that a virtuous emperor possesses are also mentioned in **sarvangayoga** 3.21: *jākaiṃ saba baiṭhe hī sūjñai | asa sabahiṃna kī bhāṣā būjñai | sakala siddhi ājñā mahiṃ jākai | navanidhi sadā rahaiṃ ḍhiṃga tākai ||* 21 || Here, the *navanidhis* are one of the results of Rājayoga (Rājayoga in the **sarvangayoga** is *vajrolīmudrā*). Furthermore, they are mentioned in **jogpradīpyaka** 601 (*nāṭika chaṃda saha jahī pāvai aṣṭasidha navanidha cali āvai | prāṇyāma ādi vasi hoī dasavai dvāra pahautai soi ||* 601 ||) in the context of the *mahābandhamudrā*. On top of that, the *navanidhis* occur in the *vajrolī*-section of the *Jog Manjari*: *jākauṃ saba dehī ko sūjhai aura sakala jīva kī bhāṣā būjhai | sarva siddhi āgyā maiṃ jākai navanidhi rahai sadā ḍhiṃga tākai |*

[XLIII. gurubhakteḥ phalam]

इदं गुरुभक्तेः फलम्। आत्ममध्ये मनसो विश्रामकरणमिच्छता पुरुषेण सद्गुरोः
सेवां कृत्वा सावधानं मनः करणीयम्। अभ्यासबलात्परमप्राप्तिः। तेन स्वस्य म-
नसः समरसं कर्तव्यम्। चन्द्रसूर्यौ यावत्पिण्डो निश्चलो भवति। श्लोकः ॥

- 5 सम्यक्स्वभावकिरणोदयचिद्विलासे।
व्यक्ते स्वशान्तिमहतां स्वयमेव याति।
ग्रस्ते स्ववेगनिचये पदपिण्डमैक्यम्।
सत्यं भवेत्समरसं गुरुवत्सलानाम्॥ XLIV.1॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): candraḥ sūryaḥ sthīro yāvat tāvad dehasthitis tathā | tāvad ekaṁ samābhāṣya prāpnoti ca sadāgatiḥ | sa bhavet kavitaḥ dhīrā nīścalā śāntir eva ca | gurupādaprasādena tad aikyaṁ yāti siddhibhāk | 4–8 ≈ SSP 5.79 (Ed. p. 105): samvitkriyā vikaraṇodayacidvilāsa viśrāntim eva bhajatām svayam eva bhāti | graste svaveganicaye padapiṇḍam aikyaṁ satyaṁ bhavet samarasam guruvatsalānām |

2 gurubhakteḥ cett.] gurubhaktaiḥ P phalam cett.] phalam bhavati U₂ viśrāmakaraṇam cett.] viśrāmaṁ karaṇam B, viśrāmaṁ karaṇam L icchatā cett.] icchatam BL, icchati J sadguroḥ cett.] sadguruḥ DU₁ 3 kṛtvā cett.] kṛ++ D, kṛtvā || U₂ sāvadhānam cett.] māvadhānam U₂ karaṇīyam cett.] kṛtvā karaṇīyam L, kṛtvā karaṇīyam B abhyāsabalāt cett.] abhyāsabalāt || L paramaprāptiḥ cett.] paramapadaprāptiḥ U₂ tena cett.] tena saha DJK₁U₁ 3–4 svasya manasaḥ BLP_{U₂}] svasya manaḥ DK₁, svascha manaḥ U₁, svasiṣya-manasaḥ E, svasya J 4 samarasam L] samarasyam DK₁PU₂, samasyam J, svāsthyam E, om. BU₁ kartavyam cett.] om. B candrasūryau yāvat EK₁PU₁] caṁdrasūryau yāvit D, caṁdrasūryo yāvat J, caṁdrasūryayāt L, caṁdrasūryavat U₂, om. B piṇḍo PLU₂] piṇḍe DE, piṇḍau U₁, om. B nīścalo PJJLU₁U₂] nīścalau DE, om. B bhavati cett.] bhavataḥ E, bhavatiḥ D, om. B ślokaḥ DK₁U₂] śloka JLU₁, om. BEP 5 samyak° cett.] samyagaḥ unnm. U₁, om. B svabhāvakiraṇodaya° cett.] karaṇotdṛḍi U₂, om. B cidvilāse em.] cidvilāsam DJK₁U₁, cidvilāsa ELP_{U₂}, cidvilāsam U₁, samarad vilāsa || unnm. B 6 vyakte Hanneder conj.] °grastam BDJK₁ELP_{U₂}, grastasamagraṁ unnm. U₁ svaśānti° cett.] saśānti U₁ mahatām U₁] manasā BLP, bhavatām U₂, avatām DJK₁, samatām E svayam cett.] svam B yāti cett.] yāmi P, śānti BL 7 graste cett.] grāme U₂ svaveganicaye cett.] svavegaṁ nicaye DK₁, svavegaṁ nīścayed J, svaveganīścaye U₁, sveramganicaye U₂ padapiṇḍam aikyaṁ cett.] padapiṇḍam aikyaṁ D, yada piṇḍam aikyaṁ U₂ 8 satyam cett.] satam B, satām L guruvatsalānām em.] guruvatsalānām DJK₁PU₂, guruvatsalābham BL, guruvatsalām ca E, guruvatchalānām U₁

[XLIII. Result of devotion towards the teacher]

This is the reward for devotion to the teacher. An attentive mind should be cultivated by the person desiring to bring about peace of mind within the self after having frequented the teacher. As a result of the power of practice, one attains the supreme [state]. By that, he shall cultivate the uniform taste of one's own mind.³⁹⁹ The body becomes unchangeable for as long as the moon and sun exist. [There is a] verse:

XLIII. 1 ⁴⁰⁰When the play of consciousness,⁴⁰¹ the manifestation of the rays of one's intrinsic nature, becomes clear, one arrives at the vastness of peace of the self. When all one's agitations are devoured, the body and [supreme] place⁴⁰² truly become one uniform taste for those who are affectionate to the teacher.

³⁹⁹In the *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.70 (= *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 163; ≈ *Yuktabhavadēva* 11.30; ≈ *Haṭhasaṅketa-candrikā* f. 117v), the word *samarasatvam* is used to gloss the state called *samādhi*: *yadā saṃkṣīyate prāṇo mānaśaṃ ca vilīyate | tadā samarasatvaṃ yat samādhiḥ so' bhidhīyate ||* When the breath is destroyed and the mind dissolves, all experience is the same (*samarasatva*). That is called *samādhi*." In this context, *samarasa*, which literally means "same taste," indicates equanimity and mental silence.

⁴⁰⁰The metre is Vasantatilaka.

⁴⁰¹The manuscript's accusatives in *pāda* ab are perplexing. Ideally, one would anticipate a locative absolute construction as observed in *pāda* c, i.e., ^o*cidvilāse* | *graste*. The conversion of accusatives into locatives is a satisfactory solution. Hanneder contends that it is highly implausible for *cidvilāsa* to be an entity that can be devoured. The agitation *nicaya* is antithetical to *cidvilāsa*. The repetition of variants of *grasta* is suspect, as it does not harmonise with *pāda* b. Therefore, *grastaṃ* is probably a dittograph of *graste*. Hence, I adapted the conjecture "vyakte", proposed by Hanneder in *pāda* c to yield a coherent verse.

⁴⁰²Within the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, *piṇḍa* and *pada* refer to the body and the [supreme] place. The *piṇḍa* is discussed in SSP's chapters two and three. This conclusion is drawn from the fact that throughout these chapters, various elements are located within the body (*piṇḍa*), such as the nine *cakras* and sixteen *ādhāras* or the fourteen worlds. The term *pada* is a shorthand for *paramapada*, the supreme place, as shown in *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 5.1: *atha piṇḍapadayoḥ samarasakaraṇaṃ kathyate | mahāsiddhayogī pūrvoktakrameṇa parapiṇḍādisvapiṇḍāntaṃ jñātvā paramapade samarasaṃ kuryāt ||1||* "Now, the process of achieving the uniform taste of the body and the [supreme] place is taught. As it was taught gradually before, after ...

[XLIV. avadhūtapuruṣasya lakṣaṇam]

इदानीमवधूतपुरुषस्य लक्षणं कथ्यते ।

यस्य हस्ते धैर्यदण्डः खर्परं शून्यमानसम् ।

योगैश्वर्येण संपन्नः सोऽवधूत उदाहृतः ॥ XLIV.1 ॥

5

भेदाभेदौ यस्य भीक्षाभरणं जागरं तथा ।

एतादृशोऽपि पुरुषः सोऽवधूत उदाहृतः ॥ XLIV.2 ॥

आत्मा ह्यकारो विज्ञेयो वकारो भववासना ।

धूतस्तत्कम्पनं प्रोक्तं सोऽवधूतो निगद्यते ॥ XLIV.3 ॥

Sources: 3-4 ≈ SSP 6.10 (Ed. p. 111): yasya dhairyamayo daṇḍaḥ parākāśaṁ ca kharparaṁ | yogapaṭṭaṁ nijāsaktiḥ so 'vadhūto 'bhidhiyate | 5-6 ≈ SSP 6.11 (Ed. p. 111): bhedābhedau svayaṁ bhikṣāṁ kṛtvā sāsavadane rataḥ | jaraṇaṁ tanmayibhāvaḥ so 'vadhūto 'bhidhiyate |

2 lakṣaṇam cett.] lakṣaṇam BDJK₁LU₁ **kathyate** cett.] āha BL **3 haste** cett.] hastai U₂ **kharparaṁ** cett.] kharaparaṁ DU₁, kharpara° J **śūnyamānasam** D] śūnyam āsanam EPU₂, śubhāsanam L, śunyaḥśāsanam B, śūnyanāmakam JU₁, śūnyamāna K₁ **4 yogaiśvaryeṇa** cett.] yogaiśvaryai *unm.* B, yogaiśvarye *unm.* L **sampannaḥ** cett.] sampanna P, sapannaḥ U₂ **so 'vadhūta** cett.] so vadhūtam BL **udāhṛtaḥ** cett.] udāhṛtaṁ BL **5 bhedābhedau** cett.] bhedābhedo U₂ **bhikṣābharaṇam** cett.] bhikṣābhakṣaṇam DU₁ **jāgaram** P] jaraṇam BDEJK₁LU₁, jiraṇam U₂ **6 etādṛśo 'pi** cett.] tādrśopi *unm.* BL **so 'vadhūta** cett.] so vadhūtam BL **7 ātmā** DEJK₁P] ātmāt B, ātmār L, ātmai U₁, ā+++ U₂ **hy akāro** cett.] dyukāro BL **vijñeṇo** cett.] vijñeyau B **vakāro** cett.] vikāro BL **8 dhūtas** cett.] dhūtaṁ E, dhūtaṣa *unm.* D **tatkampanam** cett.] samtāpanam E **so 'vadhūto** cett.] so vadhūta BLP **nigadyate** cett.] nirucyate JU₁

[XLIV. Characteristics of an Avadhūta person]

Now, the characteristics of an Avadhūta-person are taught.⁴⁰³

XLIV. 1 He, who has the staff of courage⁴⁰⁴ in [his] hand, whose begging bowl is mind of emptiness, he who is endowed with the power of yoga is called an Avadhūta.

XLIV. 2 He, whose alms are “difference and non-difference,”⁴⁰⁵ whose ornament is vigilance,⁴⁰⁶ only such a person is called an Avadhūta.

XLIV.3 The letter *a* is, in fact, to be known as the self and the letter *va* as mental residues of [mundane] existence; *dhūta* is said to be the shaking off of those [mental residues]; he is called an Avadhūta.⁴⁰⁷

...having realised the beginning with the universal body and ending with the own body, the great Siddhayogin should merge into the supreme place.” According to *Tattvayogabindu* XLIX, the *paramaṃ padaṃ* is a synonym for *param tattvam*, the “supreme reality”. Thus, here, the phrase *padapiṇḍam aikyam* must be considered to refer to the goal of yogic endeavour, which is the state of Rājayoga. The concept perhaps derives from **kubjī**1988 11.48.

⁴⁰³According to **pudi**2023 (2023), the spectrum of meaning of the term *avadhūta* has shifted considerably from the original concept of the antinomian ascetic across texts over the centuries. The Avadhūta was integrated into the Brahmanical *āśrama* system, its unconventional traits and unorthodox practice were tamed, and the Avadhūta was thereby elevated to a legitimate and finally even to the highest class of *saṃnyāsa āśrama*. In **pudi**2023’s words, the Avadhūta became a sanitised *saṃnyāsin*, see **pudi**2023.

⁴⁰⁴The term *dhairya* can have royal connotations (see **petersburger**3) and could be translated as “courage of a prince”.

⁴⁰⁵The *bhedābheda*-Vedānta schools hold the belief that the individual self is both distinct and inseparable from the ultimate reality, Brahman, bridging the gap between Advaita’s monistic view of complete identity and Dvaita’s dualistic perspective of absolute distinction. See **bhedābheda** for a discussion of the concept of *bhedābheda*.

⁴⁰⁶Only manuscript P preserves the reading *jāgaram*, which is the word of the source text and according to **brunner**1963 (1963: 134) means vigilance in Śaiva traditions. Here, the word is attested in neuter form. The other manuscripts present the following variants: *jāraṇaṃ*, and *jīraṇaṃ*. These options make less good sense. Another possibility would be to understand *jāgaram* = *jaḡaram* (n.) as “armour”.

⁴⁰⁷The origin of this verse, the next verse, and the subsequent prose passage remains uncertain.

अकारार्थो जीवभूतो वकारार्थोऽथ वासना ।

एतद्वयं यो जानति सोऽवधूत उदाहृतः ॥ XLIV.4 ॥

- यः पुरुषो द्वितीयं न पश्यति केवलं स्वस्वरूपं पश्यति सोऽवधूतः । अथवा यस्य मनश्चञ्चलभावं न दधाति सोऽवधूतः कथ्यते । यन्न दृश्यते तदव्यक्तमित्युच्यते ।
 5 तदव्यक्तं प्रत्यक्षेण पश्यति । यत्किञ्चित्पश्यति तत्सर्वं ग्रसति । मुक्तमिति ज्ञायते । सोऽवधूतः कथ्यते ।

अवधूततनुः सोमो निराकारपदे स्थितः ।

सर्वेषां दर्शनानां च स्वस्वरूपं प्रकाशते ॥ XLIV.5 ॥

Sources: 7–8 ≈ SSP 6.32 (Ed. p. 118): avadhūtatanur yogī nirākārapade sthitaḥ | sarveṣāṃ darśanānāṃ ca svasvarūpaṃ prakāśate |

1 vakārārtho cett.] vikārādirsthor *unm.* BL 'tha cett.] ya BU₁U₂ 2 etad dvayaṃ P] etad dūyaṃ E, etad vayaṃ cett. yo jānati em.] yaḥ jānati BL, yaṃ jayati yaḥ P, jayati yaḥ U₂, jīyate yaḥ DJK₁, jīryate yaḥ U₁, japaṃ kuryāt E udāhṛtaḥ cett.] udādhṛtā B, udādhṛtaḥ L, udārataḥ U₁ 3 dvitiyaṃ EU₂] dvitiya P, dvitiyaṃ BLDU₁ paśyati cett.] paśyati || U₂, paśyaṃti B svasvarūpaṃ cett.] svasvarūpa J paśyati cett.] tiṣṭhati DU₁ °vā cett.] °vo E, °cā DJK₁U₁ 4 manaś cett.] manaḥ DJK₁U₁ cañcala° cett.] caṃcalaṃ BL, caṃcali U₂, cacala° J bhāvaṃ cett.] bhāva B, bhāve U₁ dadhāti cett.] dhadhāti | BD so 'vadhūtaḥ cett.] so vadhūtaḥ | BL kathyate cett.] *om.* BL yan na EPU₁] yanma DK₁, athavā kasyase panna BL, yatra J, *om.* U₂ dṛśyate cett.] iśyate B, *om.* U₂ tad cett.] °d BL 5 tad avyaktaṃ cett.] tad avyakta° DJU₁ paśyati cett.] yasyati BL, paśyati U₁ yatkiṃcit cett.] yatkiṃcid BELP paśyati cett.] dṛśyate PLU₂, ṛśyate BE tatsarvaṃ cett.] tatatsarvaṃ P, tatsarva L grasati JP] grasati DK₁U₁, grasaṃti U₂, grastāti E, gasati BL muktam cett.] muktim U₂ jñāyate cett.] jñāyate || U₂, jñānaṃ paśyati | E 6 so 'vadhūtaḥ cett.] sāvadhūtaḥ P, 'sauvadhūtaḥ K₁ kathyate cett.] kathyamte U₂, kathyataḥ K₁ 7 avadhūta° cett.] āvadhūta U₁ °tanuḥ BEJU₁] tanu DK₁LP, +++ U₂ somo cett.] somā L, samo J sthitaḥ cett.] sthita U₁ 8 darśanānāṃ cett.] darpaṇānāṃ U₂ prakāśate BLP] prakāśyate cett.

XLIV. 4 The meaning of the letter *a* is the embodied soul, the meaning of the letter *va* then mental residues. He who knows this couple is declared to be an Avadhūta.

The person who does not see a second [person]⁴⁰⁸ but only sees [other people as] his own essential nature alone is an Avadhūta. Or, he whose mind does not cause the unsteady state is said to be an Avadhūta. What is not seen, it is said, is the unmanifest. He sees the unmanifest by means of direct perception. Whatever he sees, all of that he devours.⁴⁰⁹ He is known to be liberated. He is said to be an Avadhūta.

XLIV.5 The body of the Avadhūta is Soma,⁴¹⁰ existing in a formless state. It shines forth as the essence of all philosophical views.

⁴⁰⁸For *dvitīyaṃ* in the sense of “second person” or “another person”, see *kashikhandā*1998 4.41.7 and *astavakragita*1997 18.16.

⁴⁰⁹The verb *grasati* conveys that all experiences are assimilated into the Avadhūta’s *svavarūpa*.

⁴¹⁰Rāmacandra has substituted the word *yogin* of his source text with *soma*. *Soma* can have various meanings, with a common translation being the “moon”. The moon’s radiance is often associated with the juice of the Soma plant, interpreted as *amṛta*, the “nectar of immortality”, or sometimes as *kṣīra*, “milk”, akin to the Ambrosia of Greek mythology (see *soma*1960). In several yoga texts, the body becomes filled with nectar and subsequently perfected through yoga practice, as seen in *Goraṣayogaśāstra* 28ab: *tataḥ kṣīramayo dehaḥ piṇḍasiddho bhaved dhruvaṃ*. Chapter three of the *maitreyopanishat* describes Maitreya’s personal mystical experience in the supreme yogic state. In 3.3ab, he experiences himself as *soma*: *vijñāno ’smi viśeṣo ’smi somo ’smi sakalo ’smy aham* | The *Vivekamārtāṇḍa* (6 chapters) 2.58–73 explains that *soma*, the moon is considered the king of the Brahmins because, even after waning, it begins to wax again, thus embodying its immortal nature: *dhiro vidvān ko na nīcatvam uccair āpatkālaṃ prāpya yāti prayogāt* | *kṣīno dhatte vastrānanto ’pekṣāṃ somo ’smākaṃ brāhmaṇānāṃ tu rājā* || 55 || *dehasthairyaṃ bheṣajaiḥ samprayuktaṃ prāyaḥ pumsāṃ yad bhavet sādurāsā* | *kṣīṇāṅgaḥ syād oṣadhīso ’pi yasmāt* | *somo ’smākaṃ brāhmaṇānāṃ tu rājā* || 73 ||. In his *jyotsna* 3.126, Brahmānanda compares the significance of Rājayoga as the king of Yogas for all other yoga practices with the moon as the king of the Brahmins: *pakṣāntare rājño nṛpasya yogo rājayogo rājasambandhas taṃ vinā pṛthvi bhūmir na rājate* | *śāstāraṃ vinā bhūmau nānopadravasambhavāt* | *rājā candraḥ* | *somo ’smākaṃ brāhmaṇānāṃ rājā iti śruteḥ* | *tasya yogaṃ sambandhaṃ vinā niśā rātrir na ...*

सत्यमेकमजं नित्यमनन्तमक्षयं ध्रुवम्।
ज्ञात्वा यस्तं वदेद्धीमान् सत्यवादी स कथ्यते ॥ XLIV.6॥

यत्किञ्चिदैक्येन पश्यति स एकः। †तस्य मनो जानाति नाशो न तादृशां पदार्थं
ज्ञात्वा काले चेष्टा भवति†स सत्यवादी कथ्यते।

5

प्रसरं भासते शक्तिः संकोचं भासतेऽपि च।
तयोः संयोगकर्ता यः स भवेत् सत्ययोगभाक् ॥ XLIV.7॥
विश्वातीतात्तया विश्वमेकमेव विराजते।
संयोगेन सदा यस्य सिद्धयोगी स गद्यते ॥ XLIV.8॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. SSP 6.60 (Ed. p. 128): *satyam ekam ajam nityam anantaṃ cākṣayaṃ dhruvam* | *jñātvā yas tu vaded dhīraḥ satyavādī sa kathyate* | 5–6 ≈ SSP 6.64 (Ed. p. 129): *prasaraṃ bhāsate śaktiḥ saṃkocaṃ bhāsate śivaḥ* | *tayor yogasya kartā yaḥ sa bhavet siddhayogirataḥ* | 7–8 ≈ SSP 6.65 (Ed. p. 130): *viśvātitaṃ yathā viśvam ekam eva virājate* | *saṃyogena sadā yas tu siddhayogī bhavet tu saḥ* ||

1 *ekam* cett.] *ekām* DJK₁U₁ *ajam* cett.] *ja unṃ*. D *nityam* BELL] *nityam* cett. *anantaṃ* BEK₁LP] *manam tam* DU₁U₂, *manam hy* J 2 *jñātvā* cett.] *jñātvāt* LD *yas tam* em.] *hy astam* U₁, *hy asta* J, *hy evam* γ, *hy sva* K₁, *hy ++++* D *vaded* cett.] *vadet* U₂ *satyavādī* cett.] *om.* L *sa* cett.] *om.* U₂ 3 *yatkimcid* cett.] *yatkimcin* E, *yatkim* BL, *om.* U₂ *aikyena* DJK₁] *aikena* U₁, *kena* BL, *yena* P, *na* E, *om.* U₂ *paśyati* cett.] *paśyati* U₁, *paśyanti* BL, *om.* U₂ *sa* cett.] *sa* D, *om.* U₂ *ekaḥ* cett.] *eko* E, *om.* U₂ *tasya* cett.] *hy evam* E, *om.* U₂ *mano* cett.] *manaso* BELL, *om.* U₂ *jānāti* JL] *vijānāti* E, *na jānāti* P, *jānātir* B, *jātita* D, *jātinā* K₁, *jñānamti* U₁, *om.* U₂ *nāśo na* DK₁] *na nāśo na* BLP, *nāśa na* E, *tādṛśo* J, *tādṛśot* U₁, *om.* U₂ *tādṛśam* cett.] *om.* U₂ *padārtham* cett.] *padārtha* P, *om.* U₂ 4 *jñātvā* cett.] *jñā* BL, *om.* U₂ *kāle* cett.] *kāla°* DU₁, *om.* U₂ *ceṣṭā* cett.] *om.* U₂ *bhavati* cett.] *om.* U₂ *sa satyavādī kathyate* cett.] *om.* U₂ 5 *prasaraṃ* conj.] *vāsare* PLU₂, *vāsvare* E, *vāsvre* B, *vasare* DJK₁U₁ *bhāsate* conj.] *bhāsvare* BDEPU₂, *bhāskare* JK₁LU₁ *śaktiḥ* cett.] *śaktiḥ* DU₂, *om.* BL *saṃkocaṃ* conj.] *saṃkoco* DEK₁PU₁U₂, *saṃkoce* J, *om.* BL *bhāsate* conj.] *bhāsvare* cett., *bhāskare* U₁, *om.* BL 6 *tayoḥ* cett.] *om.* BLU₁ *saṃyogakartā yaḥ* cett.] *sayogaḥ kartavyaḥ* B, *saṃyogaḥ karttā yaḥ* L *sa bhavet* cett.] *bhavat* B, *saṃvit svabhāvāt* U₁ 7 *viśvātītāt tayā* em.] *viśvātītātayā* BL, *viśvātītātayā* DK₁U₂, *viśvānitātayā* EP, *viśvāso viśvātītātayā* *unṃ*. U₁, *viśvāvāso viśvātītātayā* *unṃ*. J *virājate* cett.] *evādhirājate* J 8 *saṃyogena* DK₁] *saṃyogo na* cett. *gadyate* cett.] *kathyate* PJU₁

XLIV.6 Having known the one truth which is unborn, eternal, infinite, imperishable [and] changeless, the wise man who proclaims it is said to be a speaker of truth.

Whatever he sees united, he is one [with it]. †...†,⁴¹¹ he is called a speaker of truth.

XLIV.7 Śakti shines forth as expansion and as contraction.⁴¹² He who unites those two, he experiences true yoga.⁴¹³

XLIV.8 Through that the universe shines forth as only one, as a result of being beyond the universe. One who is always united with it is said to be a perfected yogin.

rājate | rājayogaṃ vinā nṛpasambandhaṃ vinā mudrā rājabhiḥ patreṣu kriyamāṇaś cihnaviśeṣaḥ | vicitrāpi | prthvipakṣe ratnādījanakatvena vilakṣaṇāpi niśāpakṣe grahanakṣatrādibhir vicitrāpi mudrāpakṣe rekhābhir vicitrāpi na rājate |

⁴¹¹Rāmacandra appears to elucidate the preceding verse or add relevant information in his prose interjections. As the transmission lacks convincing meaning, I have marked the passage with cruxes.

⁴¹²Rāmacandra has borrowed the verse from the **ssplonavla** and redacted it. The transmission of the manuscripts introduces *bhāskara* ("sun") instead of the source text's *bhāsate*, and *vāsara* ("day") instead of *prasara*. As this makes little sense even with much imagination, I emend the text according to the source. However, the editorial change from *śivaḥ* to *'pi ca* should be retained as this aligns with Rāmacandra's previous redactions of his source texts, where he strives not to mention specific deities by name. In this passage, he also seems to consider SSP 4.19: *sarvaśaktiprasarasaṅkocābhyāṃ jagatsṛṣṭiḥ saṃhṛtiś ca bhavaty eva na sandehaḥ* | "There is no doubt that the creation and destruction of the world result from the expansion and contraction of Sarvaśakti." This teaching appears to be associated with **kubji** 988

II.40–43.

⁴¹³Satyayoga is discussed on p. 471 and Siddhayoga on p. 430.

सर्वासां निजवृत्तीनां विस्मृतिं भजते तु यः ।
 स भवेत्सिद्धसिद्धान्ते सिद्धयोगी स गद्यते ॥ XLIV.9॥
 उदासीनः सदा शान्तो महानन्दमयोऽपि च ।
 यो भवेत् सिद्धयोगेन सिद्धयोगी स कथ्यते ॥ XLIV.10॥

5

[XLV. *kamalānām saṃketam adbhutam*]

अधुना कमलानां तु शृणु संकेतमद्भुतम् ।
 अनेकाकारभेदोत्थं किं स्वरूपं तु निर्मलम् ।
 कमलं तेन विख्यातं त्रिविधं तत्त्वदेहकम् ॥ XLV.1॥

Sources: 1-2 ≈ SSP 6.66 (Ed. p. 130): sarvāsām nijavṛttinām prasṛtir bhajate layam | sa bhavet siddhasiddhānte siddhayogī mahābalaḥ | 3-4 ≈ SSP 6.67 (Ed. p. 130): udāsinaḥ sadā śāntaḥ svastho 'ntarnijabhāsakaḥ | mahānandamayo dhīraḥ sa bhavet siddhayogirāt | 6-8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): adhunā kamalānān tu śṛṇu saṃketam adbhutam | anekākārabhedotthaṃ kaṃ svarūpan tu nirmalam | kamalaṃ tena vikhyātaṃ trividhaṃ tattvadehakam |

1 nijavṛttinām cett.] bijavṛtinām BL vismṛtiṃ JK₁U₁U₂] vismṛtiṃ L, vismṛti BP, vismṛtīr E 2 siddhānte cett.] siddhasiddhānto E 3 udāsinaḥ cett.] udāsina K₁U₁, om. L sadā śānto cett.] om. L mahānandamayo BJK₁U₁] mahānaṃdamayā U₂, brahmānandamayo EP, om. L 'pi ca cett.] om. L 4 yo bhavet siddhayogena siddhayogī sa kathyate cett.] om. L 6 śṛṇu cett.] nuṣṛe P 7 anekākārabhedotthaṃ U₂] anekākārabhedotthaṃ EJU₁, anekākārabhedocchaṃ BK₁P, anekākārabhedātthaṃ L kiṃ BL] kaṃ EJK₁P, sva° U₂, om. U₁ svarūpaṃ tu nirmalam conj.] svarūpātmakaṃ malam BELP, svasvarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ JK₁U₁, svarūpātmakaṃ paraṃ U₂ 8 trividhaṃ cett.] vividhaṃ P tattvadehakam em.] tatra dehaṃ BELU₂, tena dehaṃ JK₁U₁

Notes: 1 sarvāsām From the first word of verse XLIV.9 up to the middle of section L a larger lacunae starts in D. The omissions will not be recorded to avoid the inflation of the critical apparatus. The reader will be notified once the evidence from D resumes.

XLIV.9 He who forgets all inherent fluctuations [of the mind],⁴¹⁴ he is called a perfected yogin according to the doctrine of the Siddhas.

XLIV.10 One who is always indifferent, peaceful and immersed in great bliss by means of Siddhayoga is said to be a perfected yogin.

[XLV. The wonderful esoteric teaching of the lotus flowers]

XLV.1 Now, listen to the wonderful esoteric teaching of the lotus flowers. What [is it that] arises as manifold differentiations of form, but [its] own true form is pure?⁴¹⁵ [It is] the lotus, for it is known as the threefold body of [supreme] reality.⁴¹⁶

⁴¹⁴*Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (cf. sources) glosses the description with *laya* instead of *vismṛti* in order to simplify the terminology: “[When] the flow of all one’s fluctuations [of the mind] assumes [the state of] absorption, one is called a mighty Siddhayogin according to the doctrine of the Siddhas.” In **hathapradīpikā** 2024 4.25*25 (4.34 in the Vulgate of the *Haṭhapradīpikā*) *laya* is defined as *viśayavismṛti*: *apunarvāsanotthānāl layo viśayavismṛtiḥ* |

⁴¹⁵I decided to emend according to the source text and read *svarūpaṃ tu nirmalam*, since the readings *svarūpātmakaṃ malam* or *svasvarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ* would render the true form and the lotus as impure, which would be nonsensical—as the true form in the preceding sections is always presented as intrinsically pure, and the lotus is a symbol of purity. The scribe of U₂ attempted to preserve the reading and emended *malam* to *param*. Considering the source text’s reading *svarūpaṃ tu nirmalam*, we can see that *malam* resulted from *nirmalam*. This reading provides a much better sense. In the case of the last *pāda*, the manuscript’s reading of *tattra dehagam* or *tena dehagam* is a corruption of the source text’s reading *tattvadehakam*.

⁴¹⁶This verse introduces the following sections which present three lotuses in the body. The first one is the four-petalled lotus of the *mūlādhāra*. The second one is the twelve-petalled lotus of the heart. The third lotus has eight petals and is situated within the twelve-petalled lotus of the heart.

[XLVI. ādhāarakamalam]

अथाधःकमलं कथ्यते। आधारकमलमस्य कमलमिति संज्ञा कस्मात्। एकमात्मा
स्वरूपं स आत्मनमनेकरूपं पश्यति। तद्दर्शनं कमलमिति कथ्यते। तस्मात्क-
मलमिति संज्ञा। अस्याधारः कमलस्य दलचतुष्टयं भवति। प्रथमदलं
5 सत्त्वगुणस्य। द्वितीयं राजोगुणस्य। तृतीयं तमोगुणस्य। चतुर्थे दले मनस्तिष्ठति।
एतद्दलचतुष्टयसंगादात्मा साध्वसाधु करोति। तस्मिन्कमले निश्चलीकृते सति
पुरुषस्य समीपे मरणं न गच्छति ॥

Sources: 2–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): tatrādhāraś catuṣpatre sattvarajastamodayaḥ | etad bhā-
vasthitaś cātmā sādhasādhuḥkaro bhavet | asmin sati sthira citte yamo vandiva gacchati |

2 athādhaḥ cett.] athādha° BL, *om.* E kamalam cett.] kamakalamam K₁, *om.* E kathyate
cett.] *om.* E ādhāarakamalam cett.] adhāarakamalam E, ārakamalam B samjñā cett.] kaṁ
E kasmāt cett.] kasmāt || EK₁U₂ ekam U₂] kaḥ J_U₁, ka K₁, kam EP, kām L, *om.* B 2–3 ātmā
svārūpaṁ JK₁LPU₂] ātmā EU₁, svarūpaṁ B 3 sa ātmanam em.] sa ātmanam cett., tasmāt
kamalam E anekarūpaṁ JK₁PU₂] anekarūpaṁ svarūpaṁ U₁, anarūpaṁ BL, *om.* E paśyati
cett.] paśyate U₁, *om.* E tad darśanam U₂] tadṛśanam JK₁PU₁, tadṛśa BL, *om.* E kamalam
em.] kamala JK₁U₁, malam U₂, mala P, na BL, *om.* E iti kathyate JK₁U₁] ity ucyate BLPU₂,
om. E tasmāt cett.] *om.* E 3–4 kamalam cett.] kamala JK₁U₁, *om.* E 4 iti BLPU₁U₂] *om.*
E samjñā cett.] samjñāṁ L, *om.* E asyādhāraḥ BELP] asyādhāra° K₁U₁U₂, asyādhārasya J
kamalasya cett.] kamala° JE dalacatuṣṭayaṁ JK₁U₁U₂] dalam catuṣṭayaṁ BL, catuṣṭayaṁ E,
om. P bhavati cett.] bhavati BL, *om.* P prathamadalam JK₁U₁] prathamam BELU₂, *om.*
P 5 sattvagūṇasya cett.] satyagūṇasya L rājogūṇasya JU₂] rājayogasya P, rājayogaya E,
rājogūṇaḥ B, rajogūṇa K₁U₁ tṛtiyaṁ cett.] tṛtiye K₁ tamogūṇasya K₁PU₁U₂] tamogūṇaḥ
EL, tamogūṇam J, tamogūṇ B caturthe cett.] caturtho E, caturtham J, *om.* B dale mana
EK₁LU₂] dalam enas P, dalam manaḥ U₁, dalam manas J, *om.* B tiṣṭhati cett.] tiṣṭhati U₁, *om.*
B 6 etad cett.] etac U₁, *om.* B dala cett.] *om.* BJK₁U₁ catuṣṭaya° PJK₁U₁U₂] catuṣṭayaṁ EL,
om. B samgād JK₁PU₁] ca samgād E, samjñāgid L, samyogād U₂, *om.* B ātmā cett.] ātma
U₁, *om.* B sādhasādhu JK₁U₂] sādhasādhu U₁, sāvadhvasādhu P, sādhu EL, *om.* B karoti
cett.] *om.* B tasmin cett.] *om.* U₁ kamale cett.] *om.* U₁ niścali EK₁PU₂] niccali BL, *om.*
U₁ kṛte cett.] *om.* U₁ sati cett.] *om.* U₁ 7 puruṣasya cett.] *om.* U₁ samīpe cett.] *om.* U₁
maraṇam cett.] *om.* U₁ na gacchati cett.] nāgacchati U₂, nāgacchati || cha || J, *om.* U₁

[XLVI. Lotus of support]

Now, the lower lotus is explained. Why is the technical designation of this lotus the “support lotus”? The self, a single essential form, perceives itself in many forms. This perception is referred to as the lotus. Therefore, it is given the technical designation of “lotus.” Its “support” is the tetrad of the petals of the lotus. The first petal consists of the *sattva*-quality. The second consists of the *rajas*-quality. The third consists of *tamas*-quality. In the fourth petal is the mind.⁴¹⁷ As a result of the connection of the four petals, the self acts [in a] good and bad [way]. When the lotus is made motionless, death does not come near the person.⁴¹⁸

⁴¹⁷The image that the author presumably wants to convey here is the following: The lotus plant grows from a single root base and develops many lotus flowers in different colours and sizes with harmoniously arranged petals. The lotus thus stands for diversity that emerges from a common source, or for the diversity of the manifest that is based on unity. At the same time, the lotus grows out of the mud but remains untouched by it. It is a symbol of the purity and immaculateness of the one Self amidst the multiplicity of the world. In addition, the lotus has a clear geometry — the leaves are arranged symmetrically around the centre. Each lotus flower is connected to the one Self, and the petals represent the individualised Self’s view of the multiplicity of the world, which consists of the three *guṇas* and is perceived via *manas* through the senses (contained in the petals of the upper two lotuses which are presented in the following section).

⁴¹⁸In *Tattvayogabindu* IV (p. 108) the *mūlādhāra* is associated with the same four petals. Thus, we must assume that the lower lotus is situated at the beginning of the central channel. Or, as manuscript U₂ declares in its additional material that the *ādhārācakra* is at the anus. The main difference, however, is that this time, the location is described as a *kamala* and not as a *cakra*. Interestingly, the passage implies an unspecified yogic practice. In order to delay death, the unspecified practice instructs to cause stillness within the *kamala*. Is this the same as the meditation technique in the context of the first *cakra*? Probably, since the source text for this passage reads: *asmin sati sthira citte yamo vandīva gacchati* | “When the mind is in this [the lotus], death itself [respectfully] withdraws – like a court herald [who bows and leaves the king’s presence.]”

[XLVII. *hṛdayakamalasya bhedāḥ*]

इदानीं हृदयकमलस्य भेदः कथ्यते। द्वादशदलानि सिद्धपुरुषाः कथयन्ति। तथा द्विषणां दलानामष्टदलं मध्ये एकं कठिनं भवति। तदष्टदलं कमलं हृदये तिष्ठति। ते उभे हृदये तिष्ठतः। प्रथमे दले शब्दस्तिष्ठति। द्वितीये दले स्पर्शस्तिष्ठति। तृतीये दले रूपं तिष्ठति। चतुर्थे दले रसस्तिष्ठति। पञ्चमे दले गन्धस्तिष्ठति। षष्ठे दले चित्तं तिष्ठति। सप्तमे दले बुद्धिस्तिष्ठति। अष्टमे दलेऽहंकारस्तिष्ठति। एतदष्टदलमध्ये समग्रपृथिव्याकारो वर्तते।

Sources: 2–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): anāhato dvitiyaṃ yatkaṭhyate śṛṇu śraddhayā | anāhate mahāpīṭhe caturasrasamanvitam | varttate 'ṣṭadalaṃ padmam adhovaktran tu satpuram | sparśaśabdārūparasagandhā buddhir manas tathā | ahaṅkāraḥ kramād ete tatrāṣṭadalasaṃsthitāḥ |

2 hṛdayakamalasya bhedāḥ BLP] hṛdayakamalasya dvitiyo bhedāḥ K₁U₁, hṛdayakamalasya dvitiyo bhedāḥ J, hṛdayakamalasya bhedāḥ U₂, hṛyakamalabhedāḥ E **kathyate** cett.] kathyante E] **siddhapuruṣāḥ** cett.] siddhāḥ puruṣāḥ U₂ **kathayanti** EP] kathyante BK₁LU₁, kathayamti JU₂ **tathā** BLP_U] tathāpi JK₁U₁, om. E **3 dviṣaṇṇām** Sellmer em.] dviṣaṇṇām PU₂, dviṣaṇā BL, varṇam JK₁, varṇa° U₁, anuparṇa° E **dalānām** EK₁PU₁U₂] dalanā BL, ++nām J **aṣṭadalaṃ** conj.] aṣṭadalānām EPU₂, maṣṭadalānām J, aṣṭadalām || K₁, aṣṭadalā U₁ **madhye** PU₂] madhya BEL, om. JK₁U₁ **ekaṃ** cett.] eva U₁ **kaṭhinaṃ** EK₁] kaṭhinaṃ BJLP_U, kaṭitaṃ U₁ **tadaṣṭadalaṃ** cett.] tataḥ aṣṭadalaṃ JK₁, tata aṣṭadalaṃ U₁ **3–4 te ubhe** PJK₁LU₁] te ubha BU₂, te ubhaye E **4 hṛdaye** cett.] pi K₁U₁, api J **tiṣṭhataḥ** cett.] kathyate U₁ **prathame dale** EU₁] prathamadale BK₁LP, prathamadala° U₂ **śabdāḥ** cett.] śabdaḥ U₁ **tiṣṭhati** cett.] tiṣṭhati U₁, tiṣṭhanti E **dvitiye dale** PK₁U₁] dvitiye dala° J, dvitiyadale cett. **sparśas** cett.] sparśaḥ EK₁U₁, sparśa B **tiṣṭhati** cett.] om. E **4–5 tritiye dale** EK₁] tritiyadale BL, tritiye dala° J, tritiyadale PU₁U₂ **5 rūpaṃ** cett.] rūpas J, rūpaḥ U₁ **caturthe dale** EP] caturthadale BJK₁LU₁, caturthadala° U₂ **rasas** cett.] rasaḥ U₁ **pañcame dale** EJK₁U₁U₂] pañcamadale cett. **gandhas** cett.] gamdha BP, gamdhaḥ U₁ **tiṣṭhati** cett.] tiṣṭhati U₁ **ṣaṣṭhe dale** em.] ṣaṣṭhe dale U₁U₂, ṣaṣṭhadale BPL, ṣaṣṭhe dale U₁U₂, paṣṭhadale E **5–6 cittaṃ** EPU₂] citta J, citta B, citta L, cittaḥ U₁ **6 tiṣṭhati** cett.] tiṣṭhati U₁ **saptame dale** EJK₁U₁U₂] saptamadale cett. **buddhis** cett.] budhiḥ U₁ **aṣṭame dale** EJK₁PU₁U₂] aṣṭamadale BL **'haṃkāras** EJK₁P] ahaṃkāras BL, ahaṃkāraḥ U₁U₂ **etad aṣṭadalamadhye** cett.] etad aṣṭadale madhye P, etat tādalamadhye U₁, eta dalamadhye K₁ **7 samagrapṛthivyākāro** BPLU₂] samagryā pṛthivyākāro J, samagryā pṛthvākāro K₁U₁, pṛthivyākāro E

Notes: 1–5 **tathā dviṣaṇṇām ...kaṭhinaṃ bhavati:** The next twenty-one sentences of XLVII are transposed in E. In order to preserve important readings, I collated the evidence of E according to the structure of all other witnesses.

[XLVII. Division of the heart lotus]

Now, the division of the heart lotus is taught. The accomplished persons teach twelve petals [of it]. So, too, in the middle of the twelve petals, there is one solid eight-petalled [lotus].⁴¹⁹ This eight-leaved lotus is situated in the heart. They are both situated in the heart.⁴²⁰

Sound resides in the first petal. Touch resides in the second petal. Form resides in the third petal. Taste resides in the fourth petal. Smell resides in the fifth petal. The mental faculty (*citta*) is situated in the sixth petal. The intellect resides in the seventh petal. The principle of individuation resides in the eighth petal. The form of the entire earth exists within the eight petals.⁴²¹

⁴¹⁹Rāmacandra introduces the concept of an eight-petalled lotus within the twelve-petalled lotus in the heart as early as section VII on p. 116. The phrase *ekaṃ kaṭhinam bhavati* is peculiar. However, since this second lotus within the lotus faces downwards initially and is turned upwards to bloom through meditation, it seems logical that the author wants the reader to understand that before the lotus flower blooms, its petals are closed, forming a firm or hard unit. Therefore, it seems plausible to interpret *ekaṃ* as one single eight-petalled lotus bud and *kaṭhinam* literally as hard, describing the property of hardness of a closed lotus bud.

⁴²⁰The concept of a distinguished space within the lotus of the heart (*hṛdayākāśa*), where the self (*ātman*) resides, traces back to early Upanishadic literature, particularly in *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* 8.1.1–5. The specific notion of a twelve-petalled lotus within an eight-petalled lotus is further developed by non-Saiddhāntika Śaiva exegetes of Kashmir, especially within the Trika tradition, a subdivision of the Śāktitantra division of the Vidyāpīṭha. For a concise discussion on the meditation method focusing on the two heart lotuses, see [bäumer2013](#). Furthermore, this dual lotus concept appears in the *Siddhayogeśvarimata* chapters 17 and 20. Here, amidst intricate descriptions of possession, rites, and deity worship, an elaborate *maṇḍala* is depicted, featuring a twelve-spoked *cakra* embedded with an eight-petalled lotus. For a visual representation of the *maṇḍala* in *Siddhayogeśvarimata* 20, see [törzsök2022](#).

⁴²¹For the Śaiva exegetes of Kashmir, the heart is the binding force of all conscious experiences. The individual person is a *kula* composed of eight elements: five senses, the ego, the mental faculty and the intellect. These eight are a unified, interrelated *kaula* based on consciousness as their common substratum, see [pandey1963](#) and [triadicheart](#).

अथ च तत्कमलमधोमुखं तिष्ठति । अस्य कमलस्य ध्यानादात्मप्रकाशो भवति । प्रकाशादनन्तरं कमलमूर्ध्वमुखं भवति भवति । तथा सूर्यप्रकाशादनन्तरं तदा कमलमध्ये कमलं विकसति । तथेदमप्यात्मप्रकाशानन्तरमूर्ध्वमुखं विकसति । तन्मध्ये परमानन्दरूपा भूमिर्भवति । तस्याहं सो ऽहं स इति संज्ञा । तस्य मध्ये स्वात्मनो
5 ध्यानादिने दिने आयूर्वर्धयति । रोगा दूरे भवन्ति ।

शक्तिस्त्रिशाल्येककृता सम्यक्मुद्रा च खेचरी ।

चिदानन्दोदयश्चन्द्रश्चेतना चन्द्रिकान्विता ॥ XLVII.1 ॥

Sources: 1–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844–845): saparyā prthag ākārā varttate tatra niścitam | dhyānād ātmaprakāśo 'sya prakāśam kamalam tataḥ | yathā sūryaprakāśena ūrdhvavaktram prakāśitam | ātmadhyānāt sadā tatra āyur vṛddhir dine dine | 7–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): śaktiprasannatā syāc ca rogaśokavivarjitāḥ | yasya mudrābhyāśāli samyak siddhā ca khecarī | cidānandamayam cittam cetanā candrikānvitā |

1 **tatkamalam** em.] **tatkamalam** JK₁U₁, **tatkamalamadhye** cett. **adhomukham** JK₁U₁] **mukham** cett. **dhyānād ātmaprakāśo** JK₁U₁] **dhyānākāśo** BPL, **dhyānād ātprakāśo** U₂, **nādāt prakāśo** E 2 **prakāśād** cett.] **prakāśāvan** L, **prakāśā**° E **anantaram** cett.] **anaṃtara** | B, **aṃtaram** L, °**naṃtaram** E **kamalam** cett.] **kamalam** B **ūrdhvamukham** cett.] **mūrdhvaṃ mukham** B, **ūdhvamukham** K₁ **bhavati** cett.] **vikasanti** | **tathā** cett.] **yathā** U₁, *om.* | **sūryaprakāśād anantaram** U₂] **sūryo prakāśānaṃtaram** | B, **sūryaprakāśānaṃtaram** EK₁LPU₁, *om.* | 2–3 **tadā kamalamadhye** BLP] **tadā malamadhye** U₂, **tadā saromadhye** E, **tadā** K₁U₁, *om.* | 3 **kamalam** cett.] **kamalamadhye** K₁, *om.* | **vikasati** cett.] **visati** P, *om.* | **tatheda** EPU₂] **tathā idam** K₁U₁, **tam** BL, *om.* | **apy** EU₁] **api** cett., *om.* | **ātmaprakāśānaṃtaram** K₁PU₂] **ātmaprakāśānataram** U₁, **ātmāprakāśānantaram** E, *om.* | **ūrdhvamukham** EK₁LU₁U₂] **ūrdhvaṃ mukham** P, **mūrdhvaṃ mukham** B, *om.* | **vikasati** cett.] *om.* | 3–4 **tanmadhye** cett.] **tanamadhye** U₂ 4 **°rūpā bhūmir** cett.] **°rūpo bhūmir** L, **°rūpā dhūmir** K₁ **bhavati** cett.] **bhavati** U₁ **'ham sa** cett.] **ham** E, °**daram** J, °**dara** K₁ **tasya** BL] **tasyā** cett. **svātmano** cett.] **svātmanaḥ** JK₁U₁ 5 **dhyānād** cett.] **dhyād** BU₂ **āyūr** cett.] **hy āyur** E **vardhayati** BL] **varddhati** JU₁U₂, **varddhate** EK₁P **rogā** cett.] **rogo** E **dūre** cett.] **dūro** P, **dūrā** L **bhavanti** cett.] **bhavati** BE 7 **śaktis** cett.] **śaktiḥ** K₁, **tathā dviśaśaktis** E **triśālyekakṛtā** conj.] **trīvali kṛtaṃ unṃ.** U₁, **trīpalāṃ kṛtaṃ unṃ.** K₁, **trīpalāṃkatam unṃ.** J, **trītayalokāntaḥ** U₂, **trītayalokānta**° P, **trītiyalokāntaḥ** E, **trītayo lokānta**° BL **mudrā** cett.] **samudrā** E **ca khecarī** JK₁PLU₂] **bhavati khecarī unṃ.** U₁, **ca khecarī** B, **khecarī unṃ.** E 8 **cidānandodayaś** JK₁] **cidānaṃdodayaś** U₁, **cidānaṃdādayoś** BL, **cidānandādvaya** E, **cidānandādayaś** P, **cidānaṃdādayaḥ** U₂ **candraś** JK₁] **candra**° E, **caḍriś** P, **caṃdraḥś** U₁, **caṃdrāś** U₂, *om.* BL **cetanā** em.] **cetanāś** U₁, **cetanāṃ** K₁, **cetanāś** J, **caṃdrikā** E, **cadrikā** P, **caḍrikā** B, **caṃḍrikā** L, **cadrikā** U₂ **candrikānvitā** em.] **caṃdrakānvitā** U₁, **caṃdrikānvitāḥ** K₁, **caṃdrakānvitāḥ** J, **veti nāmānvitāḥ** E, **cetanānvitāḥ** P, **cetanānvitāḥ** U₂, **cetanvitāḥ** BL

Notes: 5 **rogā dūre** Evidence of E resumes at this point and resynchronises with the structure of the other witnesses.

Moreover, this lotus is downward facing. As a result of the meditation on that lotus, the light of the self arises. Upon that illumination, the lotus faces upwards without delay. Therefore, immediately after the illumination, which is like [the light of] the sun, the lotus within the lotus blooms. Accordingly, only after the illumination of the self, the upward-facing [lotus] blooms. Within it, the stage of the supreme bliss arises. The technical designation of it is “I am he, he is I”. Because of the meditation on one’s own the self in the middle of it, the lifespan increases day by day. Diseases are remote.

XLVII.1 The Śakti, furnished with the three [moon, sun and fire], that has been completely made into one, is the seal that is Khecari.⁴²² The moon has the arising of the bliss of consciousness. Consciousness is endowed with the light of the moon.⁴²³

⁴²²In the Haṭha- and Rājayogacorpus *Khecarīmudrā* usually refers either to a physical practice in which the yogin inserts his tongue into the nasopharyngeal cavity, (cf. [mallinson2010](#)) or to *śāmbhavīmudrā*, like in *Śivayogapradīpikā* 5.3, *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.5–7 or *Candrāvalokana* 2, which equate *khecari* and *śāmbhavi*. Judging by the passage’s context, however, neither seems to be the case. Rather, this passage seems to draw on the concept of *khecarīmudrā* of the Kashmiri Śaiva exegetes of the Trika division. Cf. [singh2005paratrisika](#) verse 1 with Abhinavagupta’s commentary. Here, Abhinavagupta equates Khecari with Śakti as Rāmacandra does in our verse, cf. [singh2005paratrisika](#). [triadicheart](#) (1989: 142–146) explains in this regard, that *khecarīmudrā* is “the ability of consciousness to freely move (*carati*) about in the space (*kha*) of the heart”.

⁴²³The problem with this verse lies in *pāda* a. The best representative of the β -group available for this passage, manuscript *U*₁, reads *śaktis trīvali kṛtaṃ*, and is much closer to the reading of the source text than all other readings of the γ -group manuscripts. The source text reads *yasya mudrābhyāśālī*. However, the reading of *U*₁ is unmetrical. It seems that “*vali*” in manuscript *U*₁ is a corruption of “*śālī*” from the source text. Therefore, an important intermediate step here would be to first reconstruct *śaktis trīśālī kṛtaṃ*, which is still unmetrical. The missing syllable can be derived as follows. The Śakti mentioned in our half-verse, according to the previously reconstructed intermediate step, is equipped with three. According to the following verses XLVII.2–4, the only mentioned triad is the triad consisting of moon, sun, and fire. It is therefore plausible that the adjective *trīśālī* assumes the gender of Śakti and is understood as “equipped with [the] three”, and that these three are the triad mentioned in ...

परमात्मा महासूर्यरश्मिपुञ्जः प्रकाशकः ।
प्रकाशानन्दयोरैक्यं प्रकर्तव्यं निरन्तरम् ॥ XLVII.2 ॥

स्वयमग्निर्महाज्योतिराभाति परमं पदम् ।
सदोदितमनश्चन्द्रः सूर्योदयमिवेक्षते ॥ XLVII.3 ॥

5

तेन ग्रस्तो मनश्चन्द्रः सोऽपि लीनः स्वयंपदे ।
पदमेव महानग्निर्येन ग्रस्तं कलामयम् ।
एवं चन्द्रार्कवह्नीनां सङ्केतः परमार्थतः ॥ XLVII.4 ॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): paramātmā mahāsūryaḥ sūrya ekaḥ prakāśakaḥ | prakāśānandayor aikyaṃ karttavyaṇ ca niranṭaram | dīptas tathā mahājyotir avirbhāti param padam | sadoditam manasḥsūryaṃ candrajyotir ivekṣate | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): paramātmā mahāsūryaḥ sūrya ekaḥ prakāśakaḥ | prakāśānandayor aikyaṃ karttavyaṇ ca niranṭaram | dīptas tathā mahājyotir avirbhāti param padam | sadoditam manasḥsūryaṃ candrajyotir ivekṣate |

1 paramātmā mahāsūryaraśmipūñjaḥ JK₁U₁] paramātmā mahāsūryaraśmipūñja° BLP_U₂, paramātmanā saharaśmipūñja° E prakāśakaḥ cett.] prakāśaḥ E 3 agnir cett.] agni° J, manasi E mahājyotir cett.] mahājyotiś U₁ ābhāti cett.] abhāti U₁ paramam padam cett.] paramapadam B, parammapadam U₂ 4 sadoditamanaś BEK₁L] sadoditamanaś U₁, sadoditamanaś PJU₂ candraḥ cett.] candram JK₁, cadraḥ B sūryodayam E] sūryodaya BPLU₂, sūryodaye JK₁U₁ ivekṣate cett.] avekṣate E, ca lakṣyate JK₁U₁ 5 grasto cett.] graste JK₁U₁U₂ manaś cett.] manah | B candraḥ cett.] ścamdraḥ B linaḥ P] linaḥ JK₁, lina B, linam LU₁, lipyaḥ EU₂ 6 padam cett.] m P mahānagnir cett.] mahānagni K₁, mahānagnih L yena cett.] yame E, sūrya° BL kalāmayam cett.] kalāmayah JU₁ 7 candrārka-vahninām cett.] camdrārka-vahninām L, camdrārka-vahninām B, camdrārksavahninām K₁, camdrārka-vatām U₁ saṅketaḥ cett.] samketanam BL paramārthataḥ cett.] paramārthataḥ vā U₁

XLVII.2 The supreme self is a mass of rays like a great sun, [and] it is an illuminator. The bliss and the light should be united constantly.

XLVII.3 One's own fire, the great light illumines the supreme place. The moon, being the mind that constantly arises, perceives as though it were the rising of the sun.

XLVII.4 ⁴²⁴Because of that, the moon, which is the mind, is devoured. Moreover, he dissolves into its own place. That very place is the great fire, by which [the moon] consisting of its digits is devoured. Thus, the esoteric teaching of the moon, sun and fire according to its highest meaning.⁴²⁵

the subsequent verses. The only verb of the half-verse, the past passive participle *kṛtam*, which stands in the masculine or neuter, has no referent in this half-verse but is surrounded by feminine nouns, suggesting an emendation to the feminine gender. This leads us to the next step of reconstruction, namely to *śaktis triśāli kṛtā*. In the following verses, *paramātman* stands as *cetanā* for the sun, *svayam agniḥ* for the own fire which could be interpreted as the individual self, and the moon is equated with the *manas*. By uniting the *prakāśa* of the fire with the *ānanda* of the *manas*, i.e., the moon, the moon is ultimately consumed by the fire. The sun and the fire are intrinsically connected. Thus, the three become one. It seems to me that Rāmacandra wants to express in *pāda* a that Śakti, which is furnished with three, should be made into one. A distant variant of this half-verse from the source text is found in a quotation by Jayaratha *ad Tantrāloka* 32.63, introduced with *yad āgamaḥ: ekaṃ sṛṣṭimayaṃ bijam ekā mudrā ca khecarī* | “There is one seed [syllable], which contains creation, one *mudrā*, *khecarī*”. Based on the context of the passage and the formulation from *Tantrāloka* 32.63, I propose as the final step of the verse reconstruction the now metrical conjecture (*bha-vipulā*) to *śaktis triśālyekakṛtā*. This could explain the readings of the γ-group, which are based on similar orthography: शक्तिस्त्रिशाल्येककृता looks very similar to शक्तिस्तृतीयलोकान्तः .

⁴²⁴The source text of verse XLVII.4 has not yet been identified.

⁴²⁵These verses seem to explain the preceding meditation on the lotus of the heart in an esoteric way. Abhinavagupta describes a largely similar practice in his *Tantrāloka* 5.19b–25a: *tatra dhyānamayaṃ tāvad anuttaram ihocyate* | *yaḥ prakāśaḥ svatanthro 'yaṃ citsvabhāvo hṛdi sthitaḥ* | *sarvatattvamayaḥ proktam etac ca triśiromate* | *kadamḥliṣaṃputākāraṃ saṃbāhyābhyantarāntaram iḥṣate hṛdayāntaḥstaṃ tatpuṣpam iva tattvavit somasūryāgnisaṃghaṭṭaṃ tatra dhyāyed ananyadhīḥ taddhyānāraṇisaṃkṣobhān mahābhairavahavyabhuk hṛdayākhye mahākūṇḍe jāvalan sphittāṃ vrajet* | *tasya śaktimataḥ sphitaśakter bhairavatejasāḥ mātṛmānaprameyākhyāṃ dhāmabhedena bhāvayet* | *vahnnyarkasomaśaktināṃ tad eva tritayaṃ bhavet* | *parā parāparā ceyam aparā ca sadoditā* | ...

[XLVIII. *yogasiddher anantaram jñānam*]

इदानीं योगसिद्धेरनन्तरमेतादृशं ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते ।

यदा नास्ति स्वयं कर्त्ता कारणं न कुलाकुलम् ।

अव्यक्तं च परं तत्त्वमनामा विद्यते तदा ॥ XLVIII.1॥

- 5 अनामैकः कश्चित्पुरुषो वर्तते । अनामश्च परावरः । परावरा त्परं पदम् । परम-
पदात्परमं शून्यम् । शून्यान्निरञ्जनम् । अनामः पञ्चगुणाः । अनुत्पन्नत्वम् ॥ अख-
ण्डत्वम् ॥ अचलत्वं ॥ अनुपमत्वम् ॥ अनन्यत्वम् चेति । परावरस्य पञ्चगुणाः ।
निश्चलत्वम् ॥ निर्मलत्वम् ॥ परिपूर्णत्वम् ॥ व्यापकत्वं ॥ अकलत्वम् चेति ।

Sources: 3-4 = SSP 1.4 (Ed. p. 2): yadā nāsti svayaṃ kartā kāraṇaṃ na kulākulam | avyaktaṃ
ca paraṃ brahma anāmā vidyate tadā || 3-4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): tanmadhye nābhikarteti
karaṇaṃ nā kulākulam | avyaktan tu paraṃ tattvaṃ anityaṃ varttate sadā || 5-6 cf. YSv (PT,
p. 845): eko nāma pumān asti tasmāt tasmāt paraṃ padam | tasmāt tu paramaṃ śūnyaṃ
tasmāt syāt tu nirañjanam || 6-7 cf. SSP 4.9 (Ed. p. 65): ananyatvād akhaṇḍatvād advayatvād
anāśrayāt | nirdhāmatvād anāmatvād akulaṃ syān niruttaram ||

2 *yogasiddher* cett.] *yogasiddhe* P, *yogasiddhar* LU₁, *yo yogasiddhar* B *anantaram* em.]
anantaram EJK₁LU₁U₂, *anaṃtaram* | B, *naranam̐taram* P *etādṛśaṃ* cett.] *etādṛśa* U₁ *jñā-*
nam cett.] *jñānaṃ* L 3 *yadā* cett.] *padā* K₁U₁ *kāraṇaṃ* cett.] *kāraṇaṃ* || U₂ 4 *ca* em.] *na*
cett. *paraṃ* cett.] *para°* BL *tattvaṃ* EJK₁PU₂] *tatva°* P, *om.* BL *anāma* γ] *manāmā* U₁K₁
5 *anāmaikaḥ* em.] *anāmā* ekaḥ EPU₂, *anāma* eka BL], *anāmay* eka U₁K₁ *kaścitpuruṣo* cett.]
puruṣo BL *anāmnaś* *ca* cett.] *anāmnaḥ* K₁P, *anāthaḥ* JU₁ *parāvaraḥ* EPU₂] *parāvaraś* *ca*
JK₁U₁, *parāvara°* BL *parāvarāt* cett.] *parāt* *paraḥ* E *paraṃ padam* ELK₁U₁U₂] *paraṃ* *pada*
B, *paramaṃ* *padam* J, *paramapadam* P 6 *paramaṃ śūnyaṃ* U₁U₂] *paramaśūnyaṃ* BJK₁P,
paramaśūnya L *śūnyān nirañjanam* EJU₂] *śūnyā* *niraṃjanaṃ* BL, *śūnyā* *niraṃjanaḥ* JPU₁
anāmnaḥ cett.] *amnaḥ* B *pañcaguṇāḥ* cett.] *pañcaguṇās* E *anutpannatvam* cett.] *teṣv*
anutattvam E 6-7 *akhaṇḍatvama* cett.] *aṣam̐tatvam* J 7 *acalatvam* JK₁] *ācalatvam* U₁,
om. cett. *anupamatvam* cett.] *avayavatvam* E, *om.* B *ananyatvam* EJK₁P] *ananyatvam*
nirmalatvam U₂, *ananyastvam* U₁, *anatvam* BL *ceti* cett.] *cetiḥ* B *parāvarasya* cett.] *om.*
P *pañcaguṇāḥ* cett.] *pañcaguṇā* U₂, *om.* P 8 *niścalatvam* cett.] *om.* P *nirmalatvam*
cett.] *niṣkarmatvam* E, *om.* U₂ *paripūrṇatvam* cett.] *paripūṇatvam* P *akalatvam* cett.]
akalam̐tvam B, *prakāśatvam* U₁, *akalatvam* || *nirvikāratvam* U₂ *ceti* cett.] *om.* U₁

Notes: 7 *anupamatvam*: After the word *anuparatvam*, E's (printed Edition) previously omitted passage reappears. As all manuscripts share the same order, the editor likely exchanged the folios of E's exemplar. Five later sentences common to all manuscripts are likewise displaced in E, suggesting another folio transposition. Thus, E contains two *lacunae* that reappear later. The reader will be informed once all witnesses resynchronize. All readings of E are recorded in the critical apparatus according to order of all other manuscripts.

[XLVIII. After the success in yoga, such knowledge arises]

Now, immediately after the success in yoga, knowledge like this arises:

XLVIII.1 When neither the creator itself, nor the cause, the “Kula and Akula”,⁴²⁶ existed, then the unmanifest,⁴²⁷ the supreme reality, the nameless one, existed.⁴²⁸

The nameless [one] exists alone as an unspecified soul. From the nameless [one], totality arises. From totality, the supreme place arises. From the supreme place, the supreme emptiness arises. From supreme emptiness, the the supreme being arises.

The five qualities of the nameless are: Unbornness, indivisibility, immobility, incomparability, [and] no-other-ness.

The five qualities of the totality⁴²⁹ are immobility, purity, completeness, pervasiveness, [and] partlessness.

triadicheart (1989: 157) translates: “Now as for the Supreme, as it is called here, there is meditation on it. The light, the freedom whose essential nature is consciousness, contains principles, realities, and things within it. This light abides in the Heart. It has been described in this way in the *Triśiro-mata*: The knower of truth sees that reality within the Heart like a flower within which are all external and internal things, a flower shaped like a plantain bloom. He should meditate with undistracted mind on the union there in the Heart of the sun, moon, and fire. From this meditation, as from the agitation of two firesticks, one comes to experience the oblation fire of the great Bhairava, which expands and flames violently in the great firepit known as the Heart. Having arrived at the effulgence of Bhairava, which is the possessor of the powers and full of the powers, one should contemplate its identity with the abode of the knowing subject, the means of knowledge, and the known object. That triad is the very same triad as the triad of powers of fire, sun, and moon, as well as that of the always arising powers of Parā, Parāparā and Aparā.”

⁴²⁶In this context, the term *kulākula* is a determinative compound, in the sense of “the unevolved cosmic totality”, cf. **tantrika**3. Also cf. **goraksasiddhantasamgraha**1973 16.39: *sṛṣṭimārgakramāyātaṃ śivaśaktikulākulam | saṃhārakramaṣaṭkaṃ tu kulaśaktyāś ca dakṣiṇam ||*

⁴²⁷See **peterson**1888 4271.

⁴²⁸As in *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* this verse marks the beginning of a longer description of cosmography. Rāmacandra follows the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* but reduces, reorganises, simplifies and modifies the contents.

⁴²⁹The five qualities of *parāvara* do not occur in the sources and seem to be authorial.

परमपदस्य पञ्चगुणाः । नित्यम् ॥ निजम् ॥ निरन्तरम् ॥ निराकारम् ॥ निर्निकेत-
नम् चेति । शून्यस्य पञ्चगुणाः । लीनता ॥ पूर्णता ॥ मूर्छा ॥ उन्मनीभावः ॥ अल-
सत्त्वम् चेति । निरञ्जनस्य पञ्चगुणाः । सत्यः ॥ सहजः ॥ स्वभावः ॥ सत्ता ॥ स्वरू-
पता चेति ॥

5

[XLIX. piṇḍotpattiḥ]

इदानीं पिण्डोत्पत्तिः कथ्यते । अनादितः परमात्मा । परमात्मनः परमानन्दः । प-
रमानन्दात्प्रबोधः । प्रबोधाच्चिदुदयः । चिदुदयात्प्रकाशः ।

Sources: 1-2 cf. SSP I.17 (Ed. p. 7): niṣkalatvam aṇutaratvam acalatvam asaṃkhyatvam anādhāratvam iti pañcaguṇaṃ paramapadam | 1-2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): nirākāratvanityat-
vanijatvañ ca nirañjanam | nirṇīketanatā ceti tatpadasyeti tadguṇāḥ | 2-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845):
līnatā śīrṇatā mūrccātoyamaṇḍalatā iti | guṇāḥ pañca samākhyātāḥ śūnyasya paramasya
vai | 2-3 cf. SSP I.18 (Ed. pp. 7-8): līnatā pūrṇatā unmañi lolatā mūrccatā iti pañcaguṇaṃ
śūnyam | 3-4 cf. SSP I.19 (Ed. p. 8): satyatvaṃ sahaajatvaṃ samarasatvaṃ sāvadhānatvaṃ sar-
vagatvaṃ iti pañcaguṇaṃ nirañjanam | 3-4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): svabhāvaṃ sahaajaṃ satyaṃ
śāntiḥ śāntiṣvarūpataḥ | iti | nirañjanaguṇāḥ pañca etaj jñāni maheśvaraḥ | 6-7 cf. YSv (PT,
p. 845): vidyotpattis tadānin tu kathyate śṛṇu yatnataḥ | ānandaparamātmēti paramānanda
ekataḥ | prabodhaparamānandacittotpattiḥ prabodhavān | cidudayāt prakāśaś ca eṣāṃ pañca
tathaiva ca | avināśyo 'kṣayo 'bhedo 'dāhyo hyakhādyā eva ca | ete pañca guṇāḥ proktā anādo
nādavairiṇā | 6-7 cf. SSP I.22 (Ed. p. 9): anādyāt paramānandaḥ | paramānandāt prabodhaḥ |
prabodhāc cidudayaḥ | cidudayāt prakāśaḥ | prakāśāt so'hambhāvaḥ |

1 nityam EPU₂] nitya° JL, nityā° K₁U₁, niś++ B nijam em.] °nija° K₁U₁, om. cett. nirantaram
EP] nirantarā U₂, niraṃtara JK₁, °niraṃtara° U₁, °niraṃstaga° L, °++++raṃga° B nirākāram
BEL] nirākāra JK₁U₁, nirākārā U₂ 1-2 nirṇīketanam BPU₂] nimilaketanā U₁, nirṇīketanam
niścalatvam E, nirṇitanāś K₁, nimittaketanā J 2 ceti cett.] om. JU₁ śūnyasya BELU₂] śun-
yasya P, śūnyaḥsya K₁U₁, ti anyasya N₁, ti anyasya N₂ pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] pañcaguṇā JU₁
līnatā cett.] līnatāḥ BL pūrṇatā cett.] ++rṇatā K₁, ghūrṇatā EU₂ mūrccā cett.] mūrccā
BLP unmanibhāvaḥ EPLU₂] unmanibhāva JK₁N₁N₂U₁, unmabhāvaḥ B 2-3 alāsattvam
cett.] ālasatvaṃ BL 3 ceti cett.] om. JU₁ pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] pañcaguṇāḥ U₂ satyaḥ BLP]
satya βU₂, satyā E sahaajaḥ em.] sahaaja β, sahaḥ P, saha° E, saha BLU₂ svabhāvaḥ BLP]
svabhāva° βU₂, bhāva E sattā cett.] satta° P, sata° BL 3-4 svarūpatā cett.] svarūpatāḥ P,
svarūpatā samatā E 4 ceti EU₂] || cha J, om. cett. 6 piṇḍotpattiḥ cett.] piṇḍotpatti JN₂U₁,
piṇḍotpattiḥ BL paramātmā cett.] paramātmānaḥ K₁ 6-7 paramānandāt cett.] om.
J 7 prabodhāc cett.] prabodhā U₂, om. U₁ cidudayaḥ EJPu₂] cidudaya° BL, cittayaḥ U₁,
ciddayaḥ N₁N₂, om. K₁ cidudayāt EJK₁LU₂] vidudayāt P, viduyāt B, ciddayacidudayāt N₁,
cidudayacidudayāt N₂, citta° U₁

Notes: 2 śūnyasya pañcaguṇāḥ: The previously mentioned substantial *lacunae* in N₁ and N₂
(cf. start of the *lacunae* in section XXXV. on p. 210) ends here and evidence resumes.

The five qualities of the supreme place are permanence, immanence, constancy, formlessness, [and] placelessness.

The five qualities of emptiness are dissolution, completeness, swooning, the state without mind, [and] inactivity.

The five qualities of the supreme being are truth, innateness, self-existence, beingness, [and] the state of one's own form.⁴³⁰

[XLIX. Origin of the body]

Now, the origin of the body⁴³¹ is taught. From beginninglessness,⁴³² the supreme self arises. From the supreme self, supreme bliss arises. From supreme bliss, awakening arises. From awakening, the manifestation of consciousness arises. From the manifestation of spirit, light arises.

⁴³⁰In the doctrine of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* the *param tattvaṃ* has a will, a force which is called *nijā śakti* (SSP 1.5). Here, from *nijā śakti*'s proximity *parāśakti* arises, from her vibration *aparāśakti* arises (SSP 1.6). From *aparāśakti*'s sense of I-ness (*ahaṃtārtha*) the *sukṣmāśakti* arises. From her nature of sensitivity (*vedanaśīla*) *kuṇḍaliniśakti* arises (SSP 1.7). From those five *śaktis*, the *piṇḍaḥ paraḥ śivaḥ* arises (SSP 1.14). The *piṇḍaḥ paraḥ śivaḥ* has five forms, which, according to SSP 1.15, are *aparam param*, *paramapada*, *śūnya*, *nirañjana*, and *paramātman*. The pentad makes up the *anādyapiṇḍa* (SSP 1.21). Rāmacandra entirely skips the part with the five *śaktis* of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*'s doctrine and instead provides the reader with something close to the five forms of *piṇḍaḥ paraḥ śivaḥ*: *anāman*, *parāvara*, *paramapada*, *śūnya* and *nirañjana* respectively. The five qualities Rāmacandra assigns to each item of his pentad are, to the greatest extent, inspired by mixing the individual qualities of the five *śaktis* and the five forms of *piṇḍaḥ paraḥ śivaḥ*, combined with a strong influence of the *Yogasvarodaya*.

⁴³¹Here, *piṇḍa* refers to both a cosmic and individual body.

⁴³²The generation of the cosmic body starts with the primordial generation of the supreme self (*paramātman*), which arises from *anādi* ("that which is without beginning"). This *anādi* is used as a synonym for *param tattvaṃ* ("the supreme reality").

तत्र परमात्मनः पञ्चगुणाः । अक्षयः ॥ अभेद्यः ॥ अच्छेद्यः ॥ अदाह्यः ॥ अवि-
नाशी ॥ परमानन्दस्य पञ्चगुणाः । स्फुरणः ॥ किरणः ॥ विस्फुरणः ॥ अहंता ॥ ह-
र्षवत्त्वम् ॥ प्रबोधस्य पञ्चगुणाः । लयः ॥ उल्लासः ॥ विभासः ॥ विचारः ॥ प्रभा ॥
चिदुदयस्य पञ्चगुणाः । कर्तृत्वम् ॥ ज्ञातृत्वम् ॥ अभ्यासत्वम् ॥ कलनत्वम् ॥ सर्व-
ज्ञत्वम् ॥ प्रकाशस्य पञ्चगुणाः । सकलः ॥ निष्कलः ॥ संबोधनम् ॥ समता ॥ वि-
श्रान्तिः ॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): kiraṇasphūrttivisphūrttihaṣavat paramātmanā | te tu pañca prakāreṇa guṇāḥ pañca prakīrtitāḥ | 1–2 cf. SSP 1.20 (Ed. p. 8): akṣayyatvam abhedyatvam achedyatvam adāhyatvam avināśitvam iti pañcaguṇaḥ paramātmā | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): kiraṇasphūrttivisphūrttihaṣavat paramātmanā | tetu pañca prakāreṇa guṇāḥ pañca prakīrtitāḥ | 2–3 cf. SSP 1.23 (Ed. p. 9): spando haṣa utsāho nispano nityasukhatvam iti pañcaguṇaḥ paramānandaḥ | 3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): vicāśa ca prabhollāsā vibhāśa ca layas tathā | prabodhasya guṇāḥ pañca kīrttyante tena hetunā | cf. SSP 1.24 (Ed. p. 9): udayaḥ ullāso 'vabhāso vikāśaḥ prabhā iti pañcaguṇaḥ prabodhaḥ | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): abhyāsakarṭka-manāḥ sarvatattvaprabhā tathā | cidudayasya pañceti guṇā jñeyā viśeṣataḥ | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.25 (Ed. p. 10): sadbhāvo vicāraḥ karṭṛtvam jñāṭṛtvam svatantratvam iti pañcaguṇaś cidudayaḥ | 5–6 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 845–846): bodhanam samayatvañ ca viśmṛtiḥ sakalaprabhā | prakāśasya guṇāḥ pañcacaite jñānakarāḥ śubhāḥ | 5–6 cf. SSP 1.26 (Ed. p. 10): nirvikāratvam niṣkalaṅkatvam nirvikalpatvam samatā vibhrāntir iti pañcaguṇaḥ prakāśaḥ |

1 akṣayaḥ cett.] akṣayya J, akṣayyaḥ avadyha U₁ acchedyaḥ cett.] avināśi BL, om. PU₁ adāhyaḥ cett.] adahyaḥ J, aṣṭadyaḥ P, āḍṣya U₁ 1–2 avināśi cett.] avināśi U₁, avināśaḥ U₂, om. BL 2 pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] paṃcaguṇā P sphuraṇaḥ EJP] sphurana cett. kiraṇaḥ EJP] kiraṇa cett. visphuraṇaḥ EJP] visphuraḥ U₁, visphuriṇa BN₁, visphura K₁LN₂U₁ 2–3 haṣavattvam cett.] haṣavatvam || cha || J, haṣavārttvam U₂, hairyatva U₁ 3 prabodhasya cett.] bodhasya U₁ layaḥ EPU₂] laya JK₁LN₁N₂, layā B, om. U₁ ullāsaḥ EU₂] ullāsā cett. vibhāsaḥ EU₂] vibhāsā cett. vicāraḥ cett.] vicāra JK₁LN₂U₁ prabhā cett.] abhā B, samādhi U₁, om. N₁N₂ 4 cidudayasya cett.] udadayasya U₁, cidudadayasya JL, cidudapasya K₁, vihrdayasya B pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] paṃcaguṇā PU₂ karṭṛtvam cett.] karṭṛtve P, katutvam B, akartutvam L, katṛtvam U₁ jñāṭṛtva cett.] jñātvam N₂, jñānatvam JU₁ abhyāsātvaṃ cett.] ātmāsātvaṃ K₁, +++++satvaṃ N₂ kalanatvaṃ BLU₂] kalatvaṃ E, kalanamtvaṃ PN₁, kalanātvaṃ K₁N₂, kalyana° U₁ 4–5 sarvajñatvaṃ cett.] saṃvajñatvaṃ BL, sarvaśātvaṃ U₁ 5 pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] guṇāḥ E sakalaḥ E] sakalā JK₁U₁U₂, sakala cett. niṣkalaḥ E] niṣkala J, nikaṃla K₁, niṣkvalā P, niṣkvala BL, nikala N₂, tidvasā U₂, om. U₁ saṃbodhanam U₂] saṃbodhanā P, sarvaiḥ saha E, saṃbodhana cett. samatā cett.] samamtā N₂ 5–6 viśrāntiḥ EPU₂] viśrānti || cha || J, viśrānti cett.

Notes: 4 cidudayasya ...: Here, a major *lacuna* begins in E. Readings reappear later owing to conflation and are recorded according to the structure of the *ceteri* manuscripts.

In this case, the supreme self has five qualities: imperishable, indivisible, uncuttable, unburnable, [and] indestructible.

The five qualities of the supreme bliss are vibration, beam of light, quivering, I-ness, [and] joyful excitement.

The five qualities of awakening are absorption, joy, light, reflection, [and] radiance.

The five qualities of manifestation of spirit are agency, knowership, the state of practising, causality, [and] omniscience.

The five qualities of light consist of parts, not consisting of parts, recognition, uniformity, [and] cessation.⁴³³

⁴³³In *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.22–28 the author's pentad consists of *paramānanda*, *prabodha*, *cīdudaya*, *prakāśa* and so 'haṁbhāva'. They cause the creation of the *ādyapiṇḍa*. The *ādyapiṇḍa*, in turn, is the cause for the great elements to emerge.

तत एतादृशं ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते । आद्यः । आद्यादात्मा । आत्मन आकाशः । आकाशा-
 त्ववनः । पवनात्तेजः । तेजसो जलम् । जलात्पृथ्वी । तत्रात्मनः पञ्चगुणाः । अ-
 ग्राह्यः ॥ अनन्तः ॥ अवाच्यः ॥ अगोचरः ॥ अप्रमेयश्च ॥ आकाशस्य पञ्चगुणाः ।
 प्रवेशः ॥ निष्क्रमणम् ॥ छिद्रम् ॥ शब्दाधारः ॥ भ्रान्तिनिलयत्वम् ॥ महावायोः प-
 5 ञ्चगुणाः । चलनम् ॥ शोषः ॥ संचारः ॥ स्पर्शः ॥ धूम्रवर्णता ॥ तेजसः पञ्चगुणाः ।
 दहनम् ॥ ज्वालारूपम् ॥ उष्णता ॥ रक्तवर्णः ॥ प्रकाशः ॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 845–846): etaj jñāne tataś caiśāṃ jñānam utpadyate mahat | ākāśāt pavano vāyos tejas tejasa eva ca | jalam jalāt tathā pṛthvī eṣāṃ pañcaguṇās tathā | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): agocarād vayānantagrāhyam eṣāṃ tathātmanah | 3–4 cf. SSP 1.30 (Ed. p. 12): avakāśaḥ acchidratvam asprśatvaṃ nilavarṇatvaṃ śabdatvaṃ iti pañcaguṇo mahākāśaḥ | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): sañcāraś cālanam śeṣe pañcadhūmrābhamambare | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.31 (Ed. p. 12): sañcāraḥ sañcālanam sparśanam śoṣaṇam dhūmaravarṇatvaṃ iti pañcaguṇo mahāvāyuh | 5–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): uṣṇaprakāśaraktābhajvālādāhas tu tejasā | 5–6 cf. SSP 1.32 (Ed. p. 12): dāhakatvaṃ pācakatvaṃ uṣṇatvaṃ prakāśatvaṃ raktavarṇatvaṃ iti pañcaguṇam mahātejah |

1 tata EK₁N₁N₂] tat BLP, tataḥ JU₁U₂ etādṛśam cett.] etādṛśam BL, etādṛśyam U₂ jñānam cett.] om. E ādyaḥ cett.] adya N₂, om. U₁ ādyād JK₁] ādhyād BLPN₁N₂, ādhyā U₂, om. EU₁ ātmā cett.] dātmā U₂, om. BLU₁ ātmana EPN₂] ātmanah JK₁N₁U₁U₂, manah L, manam B ākāśaḥ cett.] ākāśa N₂ 1–2 ākāśāt JK₁N₁N₂U₁] ākāśād PU₂, om. BEL 2 pavanaḥ JK₁N₁U₁] pa+++ N₂, vāyuh E, vāyuh LPU₂, vāyoh B pavanāt JK₁N₁N₂U₁] vāyos γ tejaso cett.] tejaso U₂, tejah sa U₁, tejas J, tejah K₁ jalam γ] udakam JU₁, otadakā K₁, om. N₁N₂ jalāt γ] udakāt JK₁U₁N₂, °dakāt N₁ pṛthvī cett.] pṛthivī P tatrātmanah N₂] tatra ātmanah JK₁N₁U₁, atrātmanah E, ātrātmanah P, ādyātmanah BL, ātmanah U₂ pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] pañcaguṇah U₂ 2–3 agrāhyaḥ cett.] agrāhya LN₂, om. B 3 avācyaḥ cett.] avācya N₂, avācyā U₂, om. B agocaraḥ cett.] om. B aprameyaś ca cett.] om. B ākāśasya cett.] ākāśa° L, om. B pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] om. B 4 praveśaḥ cett.] praveśa° U₂ niṣkramaṇam E] niṣkraṇam U₂, niṣkrumāṇam BPN₁N₂, nikrumāṇah U₁, nikrumāṇam J, nikrumāṇam K₁ śabdādhāraḥ EU₂] śabdadhāraḥ PN₁N₂, śabdādhāraṃ J, śabdadhāraṃ BLU₁, śabdadhāra K₁ bhrāntinilayatvaṃ cett.] bhrāti nilayatvaṃ K₁, bhrāmth || nilayatvaṃ J, bhrāmte nijatvaṃ U₁ mahāvāyoh cett.] mahāvāyo K₁, mahāvāyor JU₁ 4–5 pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] guṇāḥ JU₁ 5 calanam cett.] pracālanā U₁, om. B śoṣaḥ cett.] śeṣa° E, śoṣaṇam U₂, om. B sañcāraḥ cett.] om. BU₁ sparśaḥ cett.] sparśa L, om. BU₁ dhūmravarṇatā cett.] nirodhanam || prasaraṇam || cha || J, nirodhanam prasaraṇam vah U₁, om. B tejasah cett.] om. BU₁ pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] pañcaguṇah U₂, guṇāḥ J, om. BU₁ 6 dahanam cett.] pravāha K₁, om. U₁ jvālārūpam cett.] jvālā || rūpam U₂, śithilatā K₁, om. U₁ uṣṇatā cett.] uṣṇatā U₂, drava K₁, om. U₁ raktavarṇah LN₂] raktavarṇah U₂, rakto varṇah E, rakto varṇah B, rakto varṇah P, rakto | varṇah N₁, madhurarasaṭā K₁, om. U₁ prakāśaḥ conj.] śvetavarṇatā K₁, om. cett.

From that⁴³⁴ knowledge like this is generated.

There is a beginning. From the beginning⁴³⁵ self arises. From self, space arises. From space, wind arises. From wind, fire arises. From fire, water arises. From water, earth arises.

In this regard, the self⁴³⁶ has five qualities: untouchable, infinite, inexpressible, unattainable, [and] immeasurable.

The five qualities of space are penetrating, disappearing, containing holes, medium of sound, [and] container of movement.

The five qualities of the great wind are moving, drying, passing, tangible, [and] smoky.

The five qualities of fire are burning, flamelike, heating, red-coloured [and] bright.⁴³⁷

⁴³⁴*tatas* seems to refer to the relationships and dependencies of the cosmography described above.

⁴³⁵Rāmacandra previously described the qualities and interrelationships of the beginninglessness (*anāditāḥ*) which brings forth the supreme self (*paramātmān*). His realm of beginninglessness signifies a realm before any physical existence. Here, he turns to the beginning (*ādhyāḥ*). The beginning brings forth the [individual] self and marks the moment of the generation of physical existence itself. Interestingly, the way he presents it implies that physical existence (the elements and so forth) is a result of the self (*ātman*).

⁴³⁶The concept of the merging of the self with the five great elements as seen in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* and adopted by Rāmacandra is paralleled as early as the **peterson1888** 4278: *tena sṛṣṭaṃ svaśaktyedaṃ trailokyam sacarācaram | pañcabhiḥ saha saṃbhūya pañcabhūtamayātmakaiḥ* || “Created by his own power, the three worlds with all living and non-living beings, along with the five elements, merged with the Self consisting of the five elements.”

⁴³⁷Since all witnesses preserve only four qualities of light but five are required, I conjectured the fifth, namely *prakāśa* following the *Yogasvarodaya*.

आपसः पञ्चगुणाः । प्रवाहः ॥ शिथिलता ॥ द्रवः ॥ मधुररसता ॥ श्वेतवर्णः ॥ पृथि-
व्याः पञ्चगुणाः । स्थूलता ॥ साकारता ॥ कठिनता ॥ गन्धवत्ता ॥ पीतवर्णता ॥

[L. *śarīramadhye pañca mahābhūtāni*]

इदानीं शरीरमध्ये पञ्च महाभूतानि कथ्यन्ते । तेषां गुणाः कथ्यन्ते । तत्र पृथिव्याः
5 पञ्चगुणाः । अस्थि ॥ मांसम् ॥ नाडी ॥ लोमानि ॥ त्वक् ॥

Sources: 1 cf. SSP 1.33 (Ed. p. 12): pravāhaḥ āpyāyanam dravo rasah śvetavarṇatvam iti pañcaguṇam mahāsalilam | cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): prakāśād eva śaithilyam adhutā śvetataj jale | 2 cf. SSP 1.34 (Ed. p. 13): sthūlatā nānakāratā kāthinyam gandhaḥ pītavarṇatvam iti pañcaguṇā mahāpṛthvī | cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): sthūlasākārakāthinyagandham pātamarṇadau tathā | cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): mahābhūtāni pañceti dehamadhye 'dhunā śṛṇu | mahābhūtāni pañceti pṛthvī tejo marut khakam | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): eteṣān ca tathā pañcaguṇasthānam śṛṇu priye | asthi māmsam loma nāḍi tvak ceti pṛthviguṇāḥ | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.37 (Ed. p. 14): asthimāmsatvañnāḍiromāṇīti pañcaguṇā bhūmiḥ |

Parallels: 4 cf. amaraughasasana 11: ayam prakṛtibhedaḥ pṛthvī āpaḥ tejaḥ vāyuḥ ākāśaś ca iti śarīre pañcaguṇāḥ mahābhūtāni bhavanti tatraiva tāni pañcavidhāni bhavanti 4–5 cf. amaraughasasana 12: asthi māmsam tvak nāḍi romāṇi iti pañcaguṇā pṛthivī ||

1 āpasah em.] apām EPU₂, apa° LB, āpo JN₁N₂, om. K₁U₁ pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] om. K₁U₁ pravāhaḥ cett.] pravāha° P, pravāha N₁N₂, om. K₁U₁ śīthilatā cett.] śīthata B, om. K₁U₁ dravaḥ cett.] drava JN₁N₂, om. K₁U₁ madhurarasaṭā JN₁]°madhura | rasaṭā N₂, madhurasatā LP, madhuradatā B, madhuratā EU₂, om. K₁U₁ śvetavarṇāḥ EU₂] śvetavarṇāḥ BPL, śvetavarṇatā JN₁N₂, om. K₁U₁ 1–2 pṛthivyāḥ EU₂] pṛthivyā JK₁N₁N₂U₁, om. BLP 2 pañcaguṇāḥ EU₂] guṇāpaṃca K₁N₁N₂, guṇāḥ JU₁, om. BLP sthūlatā EJK₁U₂] sthulatā N₁, syūlatā N₂, sthalatā U₁, om. BLP sākāratā cett.] om. BLPU₂ kāthinatā EK₁] kathinatā JN₁N₂, kāthinatā U₁U₂, om. BLP gandhavattā EK₁U₁] gamdhavatta N₁, gamdhavettā JU₁, om. BLPN₂ pītavarṇatā EU₂] pītavarṇāḥ K₁N₁N₂, pītavarṇā JU₁, om. BLP 4 idānīm cett.] atha U₂, om. BDLP śarīramadhye EK₁N₁N₂] śrīramadhye JU₁, śarīrasya madhye U₂, om. BDLP pañcamahābhūtāni cett.] paṃca paṃcamahābhūtāni J, pañca āpaguṇāḥ mahāsveravarṇa U₁, om. BDLP kathyate K₁N₁N₂] kathyamte J, om. cett. teṣāṃ cett.] teṣā N₂, tāvāt U₁, om. BDLP guṇāḥ cett.] om. BDLPU₁ kathyante EJU₂] kathyate K₁N₁N₂, om. BDLPU₁ tatra EJK₁N₁N₂] om. cett. pṛthivyāḥ P] pṛthivyā EN₁N₂, pṛthivyā J, pṛthvyā U₂, pṛthvyā BL, om. U₁ 5 pañcaguṇāḥ em.] pañcaguṇāḥ kathyamte LP, pañcaguṇāḥ | athyate | B, guṇāḥ EJK₁N₁N₂U₂, om. U₁ asthi cett.] asti U₂, om. U₁ māmsam P] māmsā K₁, māmsa cett., om. U₁ lomāni cett.] lomani K₁, tvak BL, om. U₁ tvak JN₁N₂] tvākā K₁, tvakḥ U₂, vāk E, vākṛt P, lomāni BL, om. U₁

Notes: 4 śarīramadhye: At this point of the text E resynchronises with the textual structure of all other witnesses.

The five qualities of water⁴³⁸ are flowing, looseness, fluidness, pleasant taste, [and] transparent colour.

The five qualities of earth are grossness, form, hardness, smelliness [and] yellowness.⁴³⁹

[L. Five great elements within the body]

Now, the five great elements situated within the body are taught. Their qualities are taught.⁴⁴⁰

Among them, the five qualities of the earth-element are bone, flesh, channels, hair, [and] skin.

⁴³⁸I emended to the required genitive singular.

⁴³⁹The five great cosmic elements have five qualities each. The following section describes how they manifest within the body.

⁴⁴⁰Following his exposition of the macrocosmic properties of the five great elements, Rāmacandra proceeds to delineate their microcosmic counterparts, each defined by its own pentadic set of qualities.

तत्रोदकगुणाः । लाला ॥ मूत्रम् ॥ शुक्रम् ॥ रक्तम् ॥ प्रस्वेदः ॥ तेजसो गुणाः ।
क्षुधा ॥ तृषा ॥ निद्रा ॥ ग्लानिः ॥ आलस्यम् ॥ वायोर्गुणाः । धावनम् ॥ मज्जनम् ॥
निरोधनम् ॥ प्रसारणम् ॥ आकुञ्चनं चेति ॥ आकाशस्य गुणाः । रागः ॥ द्वेषः ॥ भ
यम् ॥ लज्जा ॥ मोहः ॥

5

[LI. pañcaprakārā antaḥkaraṇasya]

तदनन्तरमेतादृश्येका बुद्धिरुत्पद्यते । मनो बुद्धिरहंकारश्चित्तं चैतन्यं चेति । एते प
ञ्चप्रकारा अन्तःकरणस्य ।

Sources: 1 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): kṣudhā tṛṣṇāśasya nidrā glāniś ca pañca vāriṇaḥ | cf. SSP 1.38 (Ed. p. 14): lālā mūtram śukram śoṇitam sveda iti pañcaguṇā āpaḥ | 1-2 cf. SSP 1.39 (Ed. p. 14): kṣudhā tṛṣṇā nidrā kāntir ālasyam iti pañcaguṇam tejah | 1-2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): kṣudhā tṛṣṇāśasya nidrā glāniś ca pañca vāriṇaḥ | 2-3 cf. SSP 1.40 (Ed. p. 14): dhāvanam plavanam prasāraṇam ākuñcanam nirodhanam iti pañcaguṇo vayuh | 2-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): rogo lajjā bhayodvegau dhāraṇa ca marudguṇāḥ | 3-4 cf. SSP 1.41 (Ed. pp. 14-15): rāgo dveṣo bhayam lajjā moha iti pañcaguṇa ākaśaḥ | 6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): etaj jñānenaiva teṣāṃ buddhir utpadyate śubhā | yadyapi sargakāṇḍe pṛthvyāder guṇā uktās tathāpy etaj jñānenety anena kāryakāraṇabhāvadārśanāya punar ucyante | 6-7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): mano buddhir ahaṅkāraś cittam caitanyam eva ca | ete pañcaprakārāś ca antaḥkaraṇasambhavāḥ | 6-7 cf. SSP 1.42 (Ed. p. 15): mano buddhir ahaṅkāraś cittam caitanyam ity antaḥkaraṇapañcakam |

Parallels: 1 cf. amaraughasasana 13: lālāmūtrāsrūniḥsvedaprasvedāḥ iti pañcaguṇā āpaḥ || 1-2 cf. amaraughasasana 14: kṣudhā tṛṣṇā nidrā ālasyam kāntiś ca iti pañcaguṇam tejah || 2-3 cf. amaraughasasana 15: dhāvanam valganam ākuñcanam prasāraṇam nirodhaś ceti pañcaguṇo vāyuh || 3-4 cf. amaraughasasana 16: rāgo dveṣo lajjā bhayam mohaś ceti pañcaguṇa ākaśaḥ iti pañcaguṇālaṅkṛtāni pañcatattvāni ||

1 **tatrodakaguṇāḥ** cett.] netrodake guṇāḥ N₁, netrodakaguṇāḥ N₂, *om.* U₁ lālā cett.] lālā° BL **mūtram** EN₂U₂] mutram N₁U₁, °mutra° BL, mutra J, °muvam P **śukram** cett.] śuklam E **raktam** cett.] vaktram K₁, *om.* N₂ **prasvedah** cett.] svedaḥ U₁ **guṇāḥ** cett.] guṇaḥ U₂ 2 **kṣudhā** cett.] kṣudhām B **glāniḥ** EP] glāni cett. **ālasyam** cett.] ālasya K₁U₁ **vāyor** cett.] vāyo BN₂U₂, vāyu U₁ **guṇāḥ** cett.] guṇā U₁ **majjanam** cett.] majana N₂, mano° U₁ 3 **nirodhanam** cett.] rodhanam JU₁, virodhana N₂ **ākuñcanam** cett.] ākūrcana N₂ **ceti** cett.] *om.* U₂ **guṇāḥ** cett.] guṇaḥ K₁U₁ **rāgaḥ** U₂] rāga° cett. **dveṣaḥ** PU₂] °dveṣo N₁, °dveṣau EJK₁U₁, dveṣ° BL 4 **mohaḥ** EPN₁U₂] moha BLN₂, mohā U₁ 6 **etādrśy** U₂P] etādrśī N₂, etādrśā N₁, etādaśī JK₁LU₁, ekādaśī E, metādaśī B **ekā** cett.] kā E, *om.* BL **buddhir** cett.] buddher P **buddhir** cett.] buddhy E **ahaṁkāraś** cett.] ahaṁkāraś E, ahaṁkāraḥ || U₂, ahaṁkāra |ś B, ahaṁkāra N₁N₂ **caitanyam** γ] *om.* β 6-7 **pañcaprakārā** E] paṁcāprakārā N₂, paṁcaprakārāḥ U₂, paṁcāpiprakārā PJK₁N₁U₁, paṁcāpiprakārā | B, paṁcāpiprakārāḥ L 7 **antaḥkaraṇasya** cett.] aṁtaḥkaraṇasya || cha || cett., aṁtakaraṇasya N₂, aṁtaḥkarṇasya K₁, aṁtaḥkarṇasya BL, aṁtaḥkarṇva U₁

In this case, the five qualities of the water element are saliva, urine, semen, blood, [and] sweat.

The qualities of the fire-element are hunger, thirst, sleep, exhaustion, [and] sloth.

The qualities of the wind-element are abrasion, immersion, cessation, expansion, [and] contraction.

The qualities of the space-element are ⁴⁴¹ passion, aversion, fear, shame and confusion.⁴⁴²

[LI. Five modes of the internal organ]

Then, immediately following that, such unique insight⁴⁴³ arises: the mind, the intellect, the ego, the mental faculty, and consciousness.⁴⁴⁴ These are the five modes of the internal organ.

⁴⁴¹The *Yogasvarodaya* (PT) does not include the five qualities of *ākāśa*.

⁴⁴²The earliest formulation of these specific pentads that explain the manifestation of the five elements in the human body can be at least traced back to the beginning of the sixteenth century, more precisely the *amaraughasasana*, whose oldest extant manuscript is dated to 1525 CE and according to *mallinsonnath* (2011: 16) is perhaps the oldest Nath work on Haṭhayoga.

⁴⁴³In this case I translated *buddhi* as insight, since *buddhi* as a *tattva* would unlikely arise from the previously mentioned five great elements. In addition, it is dealt with immediately afterwards in the context of the internal organ. Henceforth, it seems probable that it must refer to the specific knowledge that arises from the accomplishment of yoga, as mentioned in section XLVIII.

⁴⁴⁴Apart from the *Tattvayogabindu*, this particular pentad appears only in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* and the *Yogasvarodaya*. I have not been able to trace it further back in the textual record. Since both sources are associated with the Nāth milieu, it is conceivable that this pentadic scheme formed part of the process of consolidating a distinct sectarian identity for the Nāth Sampradāya. Notably, *citta*—which in several earlier, related traditions subsumes *buddhi*, *ahaṁkāra*, and *manas* (cf. *peterson*1888: 4275), and is regarded as being opposed or perceived by consciousness (*caitanya*)—here becomes a constituent element of the internal organ (*antaḥkaraṇa*) itself.

मनसः पञ्चगुणाः । संकल्पः ॥ विकल्पः ॥ मूर्खत्वम् ॥ जडता ॥ मननं चेति ॥ बुद्धेः
 पञ्चगुणाः । विवेकः ॥ वैराग्यम् ॥ शान्तिः ॥ सन्तोषः ॥ क्षमा चेति ॥ अहंकारस्य
 पञ्चगुणाः । अहम् ॥ मम ॥ एतस्य दुःखम् ॥ एतस्य सुखम् ॥ स्वतन्त्रता ॥ चित्तस्य
 पञ्चगुणाः । वृत्तिः ॥ धृतिः ॥ स्मृतिः ॥ त्यागः ॥ मतिः ॥ चैतन्यस्य पञ्चगुणाः ।
 5 हर्षः ॥ विमर्शः ॥ धैर्यम् ॥ चिन्तनम् ॥ निस्पृहत्वम् ॥

Sources: 1 cf. SSP 1.43 (Ed. p. 15): saṃkalpo vikalpo mūrccā jaḍatā mananam iti pañcaguṇaṃ manah | 1–2 cf. SSP 1.44 (Ed. p. 15): viveko vairāgyaṃ śāntiḥ santoṣaḥ kṣameti pañcaguṇā buddhiḥ | 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): mananāmananam jñeyam buddhy ādipaṇca pañca tu | vivekaśāntisantoṣakṣamāvairāgyateti ca | ete pañcaguṇā buddher ahaṅkāraguṇān śṛṇu | 3 cf. SSP 1.45 (Ed. pp. 15–16): abhimānaṃ madiyaṃ mama sukhaṃ mama duḥkhaṃ mamedam iti pañcaguṇo 'haṅkāraḥ | cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): ahambhāvamahaṅcādiyugāntaṃ hiṃsanaṃ tathā | 3–4 cf. SSP 1.46 (Ed. p. 16): matir dhṛtiḥ smṛtiḥ tyāgaḥ svikāra iti pañcaguṇaṃ cittam | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): vṛttiḥ smṛtir matis tyājyaṃ nirāśaṃ caitikā guṇāḥ | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.47 (Ed. p. 16): vimarśaḥ śīlanaṃ dhairyaṃ cintanaṃ nispṛhatvam iti pañcaguṇaṃ caitanyam | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): niḥspṛhatā dveṣatā dhairyaṃ vimarśacintanaṃ tathā |

1 pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] ye ca guṇāḥ E saṃkalpaḥ K₁N₂] sakalpa L, saṃkalpa cett. vikalpaḥ JN₁] vikalpa cett. mūrkhavatvaṃ JN₂] mūrṣatvaṃ K₁N₁U₁, mūrkhavā E, mūrkhavā cett. jaḍatā cett.] lasatā E ceti cett.] ceti vā U₁, ceti ete pañcāpiprakārā aṃtaḥkaraṇasya ma N₁ buddheḥ EJK₁LPN₁] buddhe B, om. cett. 2 pañcaguṇāḥ BEJK₁LPN₁] om. cett. vivekaḥ PK₁N₁N₂] viveko EU₂, viveka BJLU₁ vairāgyaṃ EJU₂] vairāgya cett. santoṣaḥ cett.] santoṣa N₂, santoṣāḥ U₂ ceti cett.] vā U₁ 3 pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] pañcaguṇaḥ U₂ aham cett.] om. BLP_U mama cett.] mamā K₁, samā U₁, om. BLP etasya cett.] om. BLP duḥkham cett.] om. BLP_U etasya sukham conj.] om. cett. svatantratā cett.] svasvatamtratā U₁, svatantratāḥ DU₂, om. BLP cittasya cett.] om. BLP 4 pañcaguṇāḥ cett.] naḥ U₁, om. BLP vṛttiḥ J] om. cett. dhṛtiḥ cett.] dhṛti° BL, vṛddhiḥ U₁ smṛtiḥ cett.] °smṛti° BL, om. U₁ tyāgaḥ JN₁N₂U₁] tyāgaṃ DK₁, rāgadveṣau E, rāgadveṣa° P, rāgadveṣam B, °rāgadveṣa° L, rāgaḥ || dveṣaḥ U₂ matiḥ cett.] mati D, iti B, bhiti L pañcaguṇāḥ EU₂] guṇāḥ pañca N₁N₂, guṇāḥ cett. 5 harṣaḥ cett.] harṣa° BLN₂, ārṣaṃ E vimarśaḥ cett.] °vimarśa° BLN₂, vimar++ P dhairyaṃ cett.] dhairya J cintanaṃ cett.] citanaṃ K₁, cetanā U₁, cetanaṃ U₂ nispṛhatvam cett.] om. J

Notes: 2 santoṣāḥ || kṣamā ceti: The *lacuna* in D ends here, and collation resumes.

The five qualities of the mind are intentional thought, discursive thought, foolishness, dullness, and reflection.

The five qualities of the intellect are differentiation, equanimity, peace, contentment, and patience.

The five qualities of the ego are⁴⁴⁵ [the sense of] I, [the sense of] mine, its suffering, its happiness, [and] self-determination.⁴⁴⁶

The five qualities of the mental faculty are fluctuation, will, memory, renunciation, [and] understanding.⁴⁴⁷

The five qualities of consciousness are excitement, reflection, understanding, thinking, [and] desirelessness.

⁴⁴⁵ All five qualities of *ahaṃkāra* are omitted in B, L and P. All three manuscripts list the qualities of *citta* instead.

⁴⁴⁶ Rāmacandra follows neither exactly the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* nor exactly the *Yogasvarodaya* in this pentad. Based on the two source texts, the following missing qualities come into question: *abhimānaṃ* ("pride"), *hiṃsanaṃ* ("violence"), or *mama sukhaṃ* ("my happiness"). I decided to conjecture the missing fifth quality to *sukhaṃ etasya* to contrast *duḥkhaṃ etasya* based on the reading of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.

⁴⁴⁷ Given the β -group's close correspondence with the source text *Yogasvarodaya*, the *rāgaḍ-veṣau* reading of the γ -group appears to be a scribal correction intended to restore the set of five qualities of *citta* lost in an intermittent exemplar. Only J within the β -group preserves the complete and presumably original list.

[LII. kulapañcakasya bhedaḥ]

तदनन्तरं कुलपञ्चकस्य भेदाः कथ्यन्ते ॥ सत्त्वम् ॥ रजः ॥ तमः ॥ कालः ॥ जीव-
नम् ॥ तत्र सत्त्वस्य गुणाः । दया ॥ धर्मः ॥ कृपा ॥ भक्तिः ॥ श्रद्धा चेति ॥ रजसो
गुणाः । त्यागः ॥ भोगः ॥ शृण्गारः ॥ स्वार्थः ॥ वस्तुसंग्रहः ॥ तमसो गुणाः । वि-
5 वादः ॥ कलहः ॥ शोकः ॥ बन्धः ॥ वञ्चनम् ॥ तदनन्तरं कालस्य गुणाः । कलना ॥
कल्पना ॥ भ्रान्तिः ॥ प्रमादः ॥ उन्मादः ॥ जीवस्य गुणाः । जाग्रदवस्था ॥ स्वप्ना-
वस्था ॥ सुषुप्तावस्था ॥ तुरीयावस्था ॥ तुरीयातीतावस्था ॥

Sources: 2–3 cf. SSP 1.48 (Ed. p. 16): sattvaṃ rajas tamaḥ kālo jīva iti kulapañcakam | 3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): citter guṇās trayo jīvaguṇān śṛṇu maheśvari | āsthā śraddhā krpā bhaktiḥ satyaṃ sattvaguṇā iti | cf. SSP 1.49 (Ed. p. 16): dayā dharmāḥ kriyā bhaktiḥ śraddheti pañcaguṇaṃ sattvam | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): tyāgo bhogaś ca śraddhā ca sārthavastusprhā tathā | raso pañcaguṇāḥ caite tāmasasya guṇān śṛṇu | 3–4 cf. SSP 1.50 (Ed. p. 17): dānaṃ bhogaḥ śṛṅgāro vastugrahaṇaṃ svārthasaṃgrahaṇaṃ iti pañcaguṇaṃ rajaḥ | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.51 (Ed. p. 17): vivādaḥ kalahaḥ śoko baṃdho vañcanam iti pañcaguṇaṃ tamaḥ | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): pramodaḥ svādakalahau vivādo bhrāntivarddhanam | vañcanaṇ ca tathā śokaś tāmasasya guṇā ime | 5–6 cf. SSP 1.52: kalanā kalpanā bhrāntiḥ pramādo 'nartha iti pañcaguṇāḥ kālaḥ | 6–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): svapnajāgratsusuptāni caitanyaṃ jīvakaḥ guṇāḥ | etādṛśi sati tattvaṃ caitanyāt tad bhaved iti | 6–7 SSP 1.53 (Ed. p. 18): jāgrat svapnaḥ susuptis turyaṃ tūryātitaṃ iti pañcāvasthāguṇo jīvaḥ |

2 tad anantaram βU₂] ataḥ paraṃ cett. bhedaḥ cett.] bheda BU₂ kathyante cett.] kathyate N₂ sattvam cett.] satva JK₁N₁N₂U₁ rajaḥ cett.] rajas BL, raja JN₁N₂U₁ tamaḥ cett.] tama JN₂U₁ kālaḥ cett.] kāla JLN₂U₁, kā B 2–3 jivanam EP] jivanam || cha || J, jivana cett. 3 tatra cett.] tatrasya B sattvasya cett.] sattva BEL guṇāḥ cett.] guṇāḥ kathyamte J dayā cett.] dayāḥ BL dharmāḥ EPU₂] dharma cett. bhaktiḥ cett.] bhakti BLN₂ ceti cett.] || cha J, om. U₁ rajaso cett.] rajo U₂ 4 tyāgaḥ cett.] tyāga N₂ bhogaḥ cett.] bhoga N₂, bheda P, om. JU₁ svārthaḥ cett.] svārtha BLN₂U₁ vastusaṃgrahaḥ cett.] vastunāṃ saṃgrahaḥ L, vastunā saṃgrahaḥ B, vastusaṃgrahaś ceti E tamaso cett.] tamo LN₂U₂ guṇāḥ cett.] guṇāḥ U₂ 4–5 vivādaḥ cett.] vivāda N₂ 5 kalahaḥ EPU₂] kalahaṃ DK₁N₁N₂, kalaha BJLU₁ śokaḥ cett.] śoka BJN₂U₁, śokaiḥ L bandhaḥ cett.] baṃdha BJLU₁, vidha vā N₂ vañcanam cett.] vañcanam smṛtaṃ N₂, vañcanā JU₁, caṃcalaṃ ceti U₂ tad anantaram β] om. γ kālasya cett.] kāla° U₁, kāraṇasya DK₁ kalanā cett.] om. N₂ 6 kalpanā cett.] kalpaḥ P, kalma° E, om. N₂ bhrāntiḥ cett.] bhrānti° BU₁, śaṃbhrāntiḥ E, om. N₂ pramādaḥ cett.] prasādaḥ EP, om. N₂ unmādaḥ cett.] unmādaś ceti U₂, om. N₂ jīvasya cett.] om. N₂ guṇāḥ cett.] guṇā D, guṇāḥ U₂, om. N₂ jāgradavasthā cett.] jāgravadasthāḥ B, jāgravadasthā N₁, jāgradavadasthā N₂, jāgrdavasthā U₁ 7 susuptāvasthā cett.] susupta° B, susupti° L tūriyāvasthā cett.] tūriyāvasthā || cha || J, tūriyāvayāvasthā D, turyāvasthā BLU₁ tūriyātītavasthā cett.] tūriyā | titāvasthā B, tūriyātītavasthā || kaivalyā U₁, om. J

[LII. Divisions of the pentad of the *kula*]

Immediately afterwards, the divisions of the pentad of the *kula*^{448,449} are taught: *sattva*, *rajas*, *tamas*, time and the embodied soul.

In the case of *sattva*, the qualities are compassion, religious duty, pity, devotion and confidence.

The qualities of *rajas* are renunciation, enjoyment, sexuality, self-interest, [and] accumulation of possessions.

The qualities of *tamas* are conflict, struggle, grief, bondage, [and] cheating.

Furthermore, the qualities of time are effecting, arranging, moving around, negligence [and] mental disorder.

The qualities of the embodied soul are the state of waking, the state of sleep, the state of deep sleep, the state of liberation [and the] state beyond liberation.⁴⁵⁰

⁴⁴⁸ According to **pandey1963** (1963: 594–597), the term *kula* has about twenty-two different meanings in various texts. **triadicheart** explains that the basic meaning of the term from which all other meanings derive is “group”. The core concept is that when the absolute reality of Śiva becomes manifest, the various manifestations of reality come together as a unified whole because of the inherent presence of Śiva’s underlying unity. The manifest reality is called *kula* whereas Śiva is called *akula*. In this regard, **triadicheart** (1989: 59) writes: “Similarly, each smaller unit of manifest reality—a universe, a world, a family, an individual person (a body)—can be termed a *kula* because it is a conglomeration of disparate objects, beings, and organs held together by an overarching unity.” In the present case, the term *kula* probably refers to an individual person (a body) since the living soul, including its five states, is listed.

⁴⁴⁹ The term *kulapañcaka* can be traced back to the **urmikaula** 2.227 and **sarvadurga**, Ed. p. 224.

⁴⁵⁰ See **peterson1888** 449I–4504.

[LIII. *ekaṃ jñānam*]

तदनन्तरमेतादृशमेकं ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते। इच्छा ॥ क्रिया ॥ माया ॥ प्रकृतिः ॥ वाचा ॥
 इच्छयाः पञ्चगुणाः। उन्मादः ॥ वासना ॥ वाञ्छा ॥ चैतन्यम् ॥ चेष्टा ॥ क्रियायाः
 पञ्चगुणाः। स्मरणम् ॥ उद्यमः ॥ उद्वेगः ॥ कार्यनिश्चयः ॥ सत्कुलाचारत्वम् ॥ मा-
 5 यायाः पञ्चगुणाः। मदः ॥ मात्सर्यः ॥ दम्भः ॥ कीर्तिः ॥ असत्यभावः ॥ प्रकृतेः प-
 ञ्चगुणाः। आशा ॥ तृष्णा ॥ स्पृहा ॥ कांक्षा ॥ मिथ्यात्वं ॥ वाचायाः पञ्चगुणाः।
 परा ॥ पश्यन्ती ॥ मध्यमा ॥ वैखरी ॥ मातृका ॥

Sources: 2 cf. SSP 1.54 (Ed. p. 18): *icchā kriyā māyā prakṛtir vāg iti vyaktaśaktipañcakaṃ* | cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): *prakṛticchā kriyā māyā vacaḥ pañca guṇā iti* | 3 cf. SSP 1.55 (Ed. p. 18): *unmādo vāsanā vāñchā cintā ceṣṭeti pañcaguṇecchā* | cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): *āśātṛṣṇāsprhākāñkṣāmithyāntaṃ prakṛter iti* | *unmādo vāsanā vāñchā cekṣitā ca guṇāḥ priye* | 3-4 cf. SSP 1.56 (Ed. p. 18): *smaraṇam udyogaḥ kāryaṃ niścayaḥ svakulācāra iti pañcaguṇā kriyā* | 3-4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): *śaraṇaṃ satkulācāraḥ kāryaniścaya ucyaṭe* | 5 cf. SSP 1.57 (Ed. p. 18): *mado mātsaryaṃ dambhaḥ kṛtrimatvam asatyam iti pañcaguṇā māyā* | 5-6 cf. SSP 1.58 (Ed. p. 19): *āśā tṛṣṇā sprhā kāñkṣā mithyeti pañcaguṇā prakṛtiḥ* | 6-7 cf. SSP 1.59 (Ed. p. 19): *parā paśyanti madhyamā vaikharī mātṛketi pañcaguṇā vāk* | *iti vyaktiśaktipañcaviṃśatiguṇāḥ* |

2 *etādṛśam* cett.] *etādṛśom* U₂ *ekaṃ* cett.] *eka* EPN₂ *icchā* cett.] *icchāyāḥ* N₁, *om.* E *kriyā* cett.] *kriyāḥ* K₁, *om.* EN₁ *māyā* cett.] *om.* E *prakṛtiḥ* cett.] *prakṛti* P, *prakṛti°* U₁, *om.* E *vācā* [K₁] *vāca* β, *vācāḥ* PB, *vācyāḥ* L, *bhāvaḥ* U₂, *om.* E 3 *icchayāḥ* cett.] *ichāyā* BLP, *icchayā* N₂ *unmādaḥ* conj.] *unmany* βEL, *unmaya* P, *unmayā* B, *unmanya* JK₁, *unmanyam* U₂ *vāsanā* cett.] *avāsanā* L, *vāsanāḥ* U₂, *avasthā* E, *icchā kriyā māyā prakṛti vāca ichāyāḥ pañcaguṇāḥ* *unmany* U₁ *vāñchā* cett.] *vāñcha* BLP, *om.* U₁ *caittam* [N₁N₂] *caitaṃ* K₁, *caita* D, *cittaṃ* EL, *krittaṃ* B, *vittaṃ* P, *om.* U₁ *ceṣṭā* cett.] *ceṣṭa* PL, *ceṣṭāḥ* U₂, *ccoṣṭhā* B, *veṣṭanam* *vibhramaḥ* E, *om.* U₁ *kriyāyāḥ* cett.] *kriyā* J, *kriyāyā* BLN₂, *om.* U₁ 4 *pañcaguṇāḥ* cett.] *guṇāḥ* J, *om.* U₁ *smaraṇam* cett.] *om.* U₁ *udyama* cett.] *udyama* N₂, *om.* U₁ *udvegaḥ* cett.] *udvega* BLPN₂, *om.* U₁ *kāryaniścayaḥ* cett.] *kārya* | *niścayaḥ* N₁, *om.* U₁ *satkulācāratvam* cett.] *sakulācāratvam* || *cha* || J, *om.* U₁ 4-5 *māyāyāḥ* BEU₂] *māyāyāḥ* P, *māyāyā* DJLN₁N₂, *māyā°* K₁, *om.* U₁ 5 *pañcaguṇāḥ* BEL] *guṇāḥ* cett., *guṇā* D, *om.* U₁ *madaḥ* cett.] *mada* EJN₂, *om.* U₁ *mātsaryaḥ* DN₁] *matsaryaḥ* K₁, *mātsaryaṃ* PU₂, *mātsarya* BLN₂, *mātsaryādayaḥ* E, *māścaryaḥ* J, *om.* U₁ *dambhaḥ* cett.] *rañbhaḥ* BL, *dambha* JN₂, *om.* U₁ *kīrtiḥ* cett.] *kīrtiś* ca DJK₁N₁N₂, *om.* U₁ *asatyabhāvaḥ* cett.] *asatyabhāvaḥ* E, *om.* U₁ *prakṛteḥ* E] *prakṛter* PJK₁U₂, *prakṛte* cett., *om.* U₁ 5-6 *pañcaguṇāḥ* E] *guṇāḥ* cett., *om.* U₁ 6 *āśā* cett.] *om.* U₁ *tṛṣṇā* cett.] *om.* U₁ *spṛhā* cett.] *om.* U₁ *kāñkṣā* cett.] *kāñkṣā* D, *bhikṣā* P, *om.* U₁ *mithyātvam* cett.] *om.* U₁ *vācāyā* cett.] *vācā* D, *vācaḥ* U₂, *om.* U₁ *pañcaguṇāḥ* BEL] *pañcaguṇāḥ* U₂, *guṇāḥ* DJK₁PN₁N₂, *om.* U₁ 7 *parā* cett.] *om.* U₁ *paśyanti* cett.] *paśyanti* BLN₁N₂U₂ *madhyamā* cett.] *om.* U₁ *vaikhari* cett.] *vaiṣarī* K₁, *om.* U₁ *mātṛkā* cett.] *mātṛkāḥ* U₂, *om.* U₁

[LIII. Unique knowledge]

Immediately after that, unique knowledge like this is generated: will, action, illusion, nature, [and] speech.⁴⁵¹

The five qualities of will are intense passion, mental residue, wish, mental state, [and] acting.

The five qualities of activity are memory, effort, agitation, determination of action, [and] adherence to the conduct of the noble lineage.

The qualities of illusion are intoxication, envy, fraud, fame, [and] the state of untruth.

The five qualities of nature are hope, thirst, desire, striving [and] infatuation.

The five qualities of speech are Parā, Paśyantī, Madhyamā, Vaikhari⁴⁵² [and] Mātrkā.⁴⁵³

⁴⁵¹The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.54 associates the five concluding qualities on this page with the higher category of *vyaktaśakti*, each comprising five sub-qualities, amounting to twenty-five in total. Rāmacandra, however, does not employ the term *vyaktaśakti*, nor is it attested in any of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s witnesses examined thus far. It appears that, in this instance, Rāmacandra followed the *Yogasvarodaya* as his model, a text which likewise neither refers to *vyaktaśakti* nor explicitly identifies the referent of these five qualities. Given that Rāmacandra drew upon both works, his omission of a reference element remains a point of interpretive interest.

⁴⁵²Parā, Paśyantī, Madhyamā, Vaikhari are the well-known successive phases of sound transformation in Sanskrit. These phases represent the progression of sound from its eternal source to audible speech. Parā is the highest eternal sound or word in which all concepts and words potentially rest. In the additional material of U₂, Parā is associated with the fifth *cakra* at the throat (see p. 122.). Next, Paśyantī is the phase of speech reaching the heart associated with the fourth *cakra* in the heart (see p. 116). Then, Madhyamā is the intermediate stage of speech, characterised by thought or contemplation residing in the mind and intellect. In U₂, it is linked to the *cakra* at the navel (see p. 114). Finally, Vaikhari is the daily spoken language characterised by comprehensible speech. Unlike the first three stages, Vaikhari is audible to others and represents the full transformation of sound from subtle to gross form. U₂ associates Vaikhari with the *svādhiṣṭhānacakra* at the gender (see p. 112).

⁴⁵³The fifty or fifty-one letters including vowels as well as consonants of the Devanāgarī alphabet associated with the power of the Divine Mother herself, cf. *aryan*.

[LIV. karma kāmāḥ candraḥ sūryaḥ agniḥ]

तदनन्तरमेतादृशं ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते । कर्म ॥ कामः ॥ चन्द्रः ॥ सूर्यः ॥ अग्निः ॥ एत-
त्पञ्चकं प्रत्यक्षं कर्तव्यम् । तत्र कर्मणः पञ्चगुणाः । शुभम् ॥ अशुभम् ॥ यशः ॥ अ-
पकीर्तिः ॥ इष्टफलसाधानम् ॥ कामस्य गुणाः । रतिः ॥ प्रीतिः ॥ क्रीडा ॥ कामना ॥
5 अनुरता ॥

[LV. candrasya ṣoḍaśakalāḥ]

इदानीं चन्द्रस्य षोडशकलाः कथ्यन्ते । उल्लोला ॥ कल्लोलिनी ॥ उच्चलन्ती ॥ उ-
न्मादिनी ॥ तरङ्गिणी ॥ पोषयन्ती ॥ लंपटा ॥ लहरी ॥ लोला ॥ लेलिहाना ॥ प्रस-
रन्ती ॥ प्रवृत्तिः ॥ स्रवन्ती ॥ प्रवाहा ॥ सौम्या ॥ प्रसन्ना ॥ चन्द्रस्य सप्तदशी कला
10 वर्तते । तस्या नाम निवृत्तिः साऽमृतकला कथ्यते ॥

Sources: 2-3 cf. SSP 1.60 (Ed. p. 19): karmaḥ kāmāś candraḥ sūryo 'gnir iti pratyakṣakaraṇa-
pañcakam 3-4 cf. SSP 1.61 (Ed. p. 19): śubham aśubham yaśo 'pakīrtir adṛṣṭaphalasādh-
hanam iti pañcaguṇaṃ karma | 4-5 cf. SSP 1.62 (Ed. p. 20): ratiḥ prītiḥ kṛīḍā kāmānā
'turateti pañcaguṇaḥ kāmāḥ | 7-10 cf. SSP 1.63 (Ed. p. 20): ullolā kallolinī uccalanti unmādinī
taraṃgiṇī śoṣiṇī alampaṭā pravṛttiḥ laharī lolā lelihānā prasāranti pravāhā saumyā prasannā
plavanti | evaṃ candrasya ṣoḍaśa kalāḥ | saptadaśī kalā nivṛttiḥ | sā 'mṛtakalā |

2 utpadyate cett.] utpādyate DJN₁N₂ karma cett.] karmaḥ U₂ kāmāḥ cett.] kāma
BJK₁LPN₂U₁ candraḥ EK₁N₁U₂] candra cett. sūryaḥ cett.] sūrya JN₂U₁ agniḥ EJK₁U₂] agni N₂, agni U₁, āgniḥ cett. 3 kartavyam cett.] kartavyaṃ K₁ karmaṇaḥ cett.] kar-
maṇā BP, karmaṇa° N₂, karmaṇāṃ L, karmaṇaḥ K₁ pañcaguṇaḥ cett.] om. K₁ śubham
cett.] śubha DU₁, om. E aśubham cett.] aśubha° U₁, om. EP yaśaḥ cett.] yasa N₂, om.
E 3-4 apakīrtiḥ cett.] apakīrtti N₂, āvakīrtiḥ U₁, om. E 4 iṣṭaphalasādhānam cett.] om.
E kāmasya cett.] kāmasya U₂ ratiḥ cett.] rati° JN₂U₁ prītiḥ cett.] prīti β kāmānā
cett.] kāmānā K₁, kāmānāḥ P, kāmīnā B, kāmīnī L 5 anurata DJN₁] anurata K₁U₁, anurajā N₂,
anuraktatā L, anurattutā P, anustutā BE 7 ṣoḍaśakalāḥ cett.] ṣoḍaśakalāḥ J, ṣoḍaśa L, sap-
tadaśakalā U₂ kathyante cett.] kathyate BL, vartamte || tasyānāmāni || ṣoḍaśakalā kathyamte
|| U₂ ullolā em.] hallolā DJK₁PN₁N₂U₁, hallolāḥ U₂, hullātva L, dullālā B, dallolā E kallolinī
cett.] kallolinī K₁U₁, kallolī N₂ uccalanti em.] udyalinī J, uścalinī EP, ucamlinī B, ucamlinī
L, uchalani U₁, ucchrīlinī U₂, om. cett. 7-8 unmādinī cett.] unmādani U₁ 8 poṣayanti EP]
poṣayanti DJK₁N₁N₂, poṣāyanti BL, poṣayani U₁, poṣayati U₂ lampaṭā EJK₁PU₁U₂] lapamṭāḥ
B, lapaṭāḥ L, lapaḍā DN₁N₂ lolā cett.] lolāḥ U₂ lelihānā cett.] lelihanā K₁, lelihānāḥ U₂,
lelihā BL 8-9 prasāranti cett.] prasaramti JU₁U₂ 9 pravṛttiḥ cett.] pravṛtti B, prakṛti L
sṛavanti cett.] sṛavati K₁, plavanti E pravāhā cett.] pravahāḥ U₂, mavahā BL, pravamti
śvāḥ U₁ saumyā cett.] saumyāḥ U₂, saumya U₁, somyā BL prasannā cett.] prasannāḥ U₂
saptadaśī cett.] saptadāśī U₂, saptadaśami BE kalā cett.] kalā K₁, kā U₁ 10 tasyā cett.] tasya
P, tasyāḥ U₂, om. J nāma cett.] nāmāni || U₂, om. J nivṛttiḥ U₁] nivṛtti BELP, naivṛttiḥ N₁N₂,
naivṛttaiḥ DK₁, vṛttiḥ U₂, om. J sā 'mṛtakalā DK₁N₁N₂] sā mṛta U₁, sametaḥ || kalāḥ || U₂,
sametakalā BELP, om. J kathyate cett.] kathyante U₂, om. J

[LIV. Action, desire, moon, sun and fire]

Immediately after that, knowledge like this is generated: action, desire, moon, sun, and fire. The direct perception of this pentad shall be done.⁴⁵⁴ Among those, the five qualities of action are auspicious, inauspicious, honour, dishonour [and] bringing about the desired result.

The qualities of desire are lust, satisfaction, play, sexual desire, [and] falling in love.

[LV. Sixteen digits of the moon]

Now, the sixteen digits⁴⁵⁵ of the moon are taught. 1. Ullolā, 2. Kallolinī, 3. Uccalantī, 4. Unmādinī, 5. Taraṅginī, 6. Poṣayantī, 7. Lamṭā, 8. Laharī, 9. Lolā, 10. Lelihānā, 11. Prasaraṇtī, 12. Pravṛtṭiḥ, 13. Sravantī, 14. Pravāhā, 15. Saumyā, 16. Prasannā. A seventeenth digit of the moon exists. Her name is Nivṛtti (“inactivity”), [and] she is taught to be the Amṛtakalā (“digit of the nectar of immortality”).

⁴⁵⁴In contrast to the initial statements introducing the sections dealing with metaphysics and the yogic body (XLVIII–LV) in which the topics are presented as a mere result of the accomplishment of yoga, here, the reader is suddenly instructed to perceive the pentad directly. That raises the question of whether the purpose of the whole metaphysics and yogic body sections is always taught merely informative or if, indeed, all pentads are supposed to be perceived or visualised. The latter option is advocated by *ssplonavla* 1.65, which concludes the section of the *kalās* of sun, moon and fire in a similar way: *iti pratyakṣakaraṇaguṇakalāsamūhaḥ* || “This is the group of qualities and *kalās* of direct perception.” As mentioned, various teachings of the *Tattvayogabindu* and its two source texts have various parallels with the *netratantra*. In the *netratantra* 7.4–5, all contents of the yogic body are the objects of meditation. The meditation bestows knowledge of the body, a requirement through which the yogin nourishes or enlivens his own body and that of others (*nāḍivṛṇḍaiḥ samākrāntaṁ malinaṁ vyādhibhir vṛtaṁ | sūkṣmadhyānāmṛtenaiva pareṇaivoditena tu* ||4|| *āpyāyaṁ kurute yogi ātmano vā parasya ca | divyadehaḥ sa bhavati sarvavyādhivivarjitaḥ* ||5||). That is the condition for attaining or becoming a divine body. Furthermore, cf. *bāumernetra*.

⁴⁵⁵The term *kalā* carries the primary meaning of “digit,” specifically indicating “a sixteenth digit of the moon”. This concept is found in various texts (cf., e.g. *brhadaranyaka* 1.5.14 or *asiddhi* 3.1–4), and it is associated with the moon’s waxing and waning, where each day it gains or loses one *kalā*. Some tantric texts (cf. *tantraloka* 3.137), add a seventeenth ...

[LVI. sūryasya dvādaśakalāḥ]

इदानीं सूर्यस्य द्वादशकलाः कथ्यन्ते। तापिनी ॥ ग्रासिका ॥ उग्रा ॥ आकुञ्चिनी ॥
शोषिणी ॥ प्रबोधिनी ॥ घस्मरा ॥ आकर्षयन्ती ॥ तुष्टिवर्धिनी ॥ ऊर्मिरेखा ॥ किर-
णवती ॥ प्रभूतवती ॥ सूर्यस्य त्रयोदशी कला विद्यते। तस्याः संज्ञा निजकला स्व-
5 प्रकाशा च ॥

[LVII. agnisambandhinyo daśakalāḥ]

इदानीमग्निसंबन्धिन्यो दशकलाः कथ्यन्ते। दीपिका ॥ राजिका ॥ ज्वलनी ॥ वि-
स्फुलिङ्गिनी ॥ प्रचण्डा ॥ पाचिका ॥ रौद्री ॥ दाहिका ॥ रावणी ॥ शिखावती ॥ अ-
ग्नेरेकादशी निजकला ज्योतिः संज्ञा वर्तते ॥

Sources: 2–5 cf. SSP I.64 (Ed. p. 20): tāpinī grāsikā ugrā ākuñcinī śoṣiṇī prabodhinī smarā ākarṣiṇī tuṣṭivardhinī urmirekhā kiraṇavati prabhāvatitī dvādaśa kalāḥ sūryasya | trayodaśī svaprakāśatā nijakalā | 7–9 cf. SSP I.65 (Ed. p. 21): dipikā rājikā jvalanī visphuliṅginī pra-
caṇḍā pācikā raudrī dāhikā rāgiṇī śikhavati ity agner daśa kalāḥ | ekādaśī kalā jyotiḥ |

2 dvādaśakalāḥ JPU₂] dvādaśakalā DK₁N₁N₂U₁BL, kalāḥ E kathyante cett.] kathyate BK₁LN₂ tāpinī em.] tāpanī P, tāpani BL, tapani DEJK₁N₁N₂U₂, tapani U₁ grāsikā em.] grāsakā cett., grāsaka BLP ākuñcinī em.] ākuṃcanī β, ākocanī BLP, akocanī U₂ 3 śoṣiṇī P] śoṣaṇī cett. ākarṣayanti cett.] ākarṣayati U₂, ākarṣayanti U₁, ākarṣiṇī E tuṣṭivardhinī EP] tuṣṭivard-
hanī BL, tuṣṭivarddhanī β, tuṣṭiḥ varddhanī U₂ urmirekhā cett.] urmireṣā K₁, kūrmiṣā E, kurmmirekhā P, ūrmī || rekhā U₂ 3–4 kiraṇavati EU₂] kiraṇāvati DJK₁PN₁N₂, kīrṇāvati BL, kīrṇavati U₁ 4 prabhūtavati PU₂] prabhutavati DJK₁N₁N₂U₁, prabhutavati L, prabha-
vati BE tasyāḥ DJK₁U₁] tasyā U₂, tasya cett. samjñā β] nāma ELP, namaḥ B, nāmāni U₂ nijakalā cett.] nijakalāṃ DK₁N₁N₂ 7 idānim cett.] idāniṃ U₂ agnisambandhinyo EP] agnisambandhini cett., agnisambandhiniṃ U₁ daśakalāḥ cett.] daśakalā BLN₂, dvā-
daśakalāḥ J, dvādaśakalā U₁ dipikā cett.] dipikar U₁ rājikā em.] jārakā DJK₁N₁N₂, jakā U₁, om. cett. jvalanī em.] jvālaviḥ U₁, jvālā cett. 8 pācikā E] pācakā DJK₁N₁N₂, pāvakā cett. dāhikā E] dāhakā DJK₁PN₁N₂U₂, dāhaka BLU₁ rāvaṇī BEK₁LPU₂] rāvaṇī DJN₁N₂U₁ 8–9 ag-
ner cett.] agne BLU₁, ajñer K₁ 9 ekādaśī DEPU₂] ekādaśī cett. samjñā cett.] samjñakā DN₁N₂, °samjñakā || cha || J vartate cett.] om. DJN₁N₂

[LVI. Twelve digits of the sun]

Now, the twelve digits of the sun are taught. 1. Tāpinī, 2. Grāsikā, 3. Ugrā, 4. Ākuñcinī, 5. Śoṣiṇī, 6. Prabodhinī, 7. Ghasmarā, 8. Ākarṣayanti, 9. Tuṣṭi-vardhinī, 10. Ūrmirekhā, 11. Kiraṇavatī, 12. Prabhūtavatī.⁴⁵⁶ The thirteenth digit of the sun is to be known. Her technical designation is Nijakalā (“the inherent digit”) and Svaprakāśā (“self-luminous”).

[LVII. Ten digits related to fire]

Now, the ten digits, which are related to the fire, are taught. 1. Dīpikā, 2. Rājikā, 3. Jvalanī, 4. Visphuliṅginī, 5. Pracaṇḍā, 6. Pācikā, 7. Raudrī, 8. Dāhikā, 9. Rāvaṇī,⁴⁵⁷ 10. Śikhāvatī. Jyotis (“light”) is the technical designation for the eleventh inherent digit of fire.

kalā, often called *amṛtakalā* or *amākalā* (cf. *tantraloka* 3.141 [Jayaratha ad 5.63–64]; *paratrishi* 35; *kissmatsya* 25.57 (e-text provided by Csaba Kiss [08.02.2007]); *satcakranirū* 47) which exists eternally, even during the moon’s darkest phase. The early association of the moon with *soma* and *amṛta* in Indian traditions (see *gonda* 1965 particularly chapters II. “Soma, Amṛta and the Moon” [1965: 38–70] and IV. “The number sixteen” [1965: 115–130]) resulted in the idea that all of the moon’s *kalās* contain *amṛta*, cf. particularly chapter II. of the *mallinson* 2010 2010. Those ideas were carried into Rājayoga literature like in *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.63 and the *Tattvayogabindu*. Moreover, the term *kalā* is used to describe the divisions of the sun and fire, cf. e.g. *kularnavatāntra* 6.37–40; *asiddhi* 4.1–12 and 5.1–4; *ssplonavla* 1.64–65; *Goraṅgyogaśāstra* 9; *gorakbhani* 89. In the *Tattvayogabindu*, the twelve *kalās* of the sun represent the various qualities and aspects of the sun’s influence. Perhaps the number twelve additionally reflects the twelve signs of the zodiac or the twelve months in a year. The ten *kalās* of the fire in the *Tattvayogabindu* represent the various qualities and aspects of the fire’s influence.

⁴⁵⁶The best manuscripts of both main branches of the stemma clearly support the variants of *ākarṣayanti* and *prabhūtavatī* for the eighth and twelfth *kalās* of *sūrya*. For this reason, I was compelled to discard the readings of the source text, which also occurs in our transmission, but was, given the specific manuscripts that transmit it, in all likelihood introduced at a later stage.

⁴⁵⁷Here, too, the stemmatic evidence clearly supports the reading *rāvaṇī* which is distinct from that of the source text (*rāgiṇī*).

[LVIII. *yogasya mähātmyam*]

इदानीं योगस्य माहात्म्यं कथ्यते। गुरोरनुग्रहात्॥ शास्त्रस्य पठनात्॥ आचार-
 करणात्॥ वेदान्तरहस्यश्रवणात्॥ ध्यानकरणात्॥ लयसाधनात्॥ उपवासक-
 रणात्॥ चतुरशीत्यासनसाधनात्॥ वैराग्यस्योत्पत्तेः॥ वैराग्यकरणात्॥ हठयो-
 5 गस्य करणात्॥ इडापिङ्गलयोः पवनधारणात्॥ महामुद्रादिदशमुद्रासाधनात्॥
 मौनकरणात्॥ वनवासात्॥ बहुतरक्लेशकरणात्॥ बहुतरकालं यन्त्रमन्त्रादिसाध-
 नात्॥ तपःकरणात्॥ बहुतरार्थादानात्॥ तीर्थसेवाकरणात्॥ आश्रमाचारपाल-
 नात्॥ संन्यासग्रहणात्॥ षड्दर्शनग्रहणात्॥ शिरोमुण्डनात्॥ अन्योपायकरणात्
 ॥ योगतत्त्वं न प्राप्यते। स तु योगो गुरुसेवया प्राप्यते।

Sources: 2-9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847-848): idāniṃ yogamāhātmyaṃ kathyate yad bhavet tataḥ | guror anugrahāc chāstrapāṭhād ācāratas tathā | vedāntārtharahasyārthasarva-
 jñānādūpāsanaṭ | āsanaṭ dhāraṇād dhyānāl layaṣaṭkarmasāadhanāt | āsanaṭ caturaśītvairā-
 gyaṭyāgasambhavāt | haṭhayogād varauśadhyāt mudrāsāadhanamānataḥ | vanavāsād bahuk-
 leśāt tathā mantrādisāadhanāt | bahudānatapastirthasevanād dānaśikṣaṇāt | sandhyātrayagra-
 heṇātha ṣaḍdarśagrahaṇāt tathā | śiromuṇḍagato nyāsād yogatattvaṇ ca vidyate | 2-9 cf. SSP
 5.55-58 (Ed. pp. 97-98): samyaksvabhāvaviññānāt kramābhyāsān na cāsanāt | na vairāgyān na
 nairāśyān nāhārat prāṇadhāraṇāt ||55|| na mudrādhāraṇād yogān na mānakarmasamāśrayāt |
 na virakṣyaṇ vṛthāyāsān na kāyakleśadhāraṇāt ||56|| na jāpān na tapodhyānān na yajñāt tirtha-
 sevanāt | na devārcaṇāśrayād bhaktyā nāśramāṇān ca pālanāt ||57|| na ṣaḍdarśanaśeṣād-
 dhāraṇān na ca muṇḍanāt | nānantopāyayatnebhyaḥ prāpyate paramaṃ padam||58||

2 idāniṃ cett.] idāni B *yogasya* cett.] *yasya* U₁ *māhātmyam* cett.] *māhātmaṃ* BL, *māhāt-
 mya* N₂ *kathyate* cett.] *kathyamte* U₂ *guror* cett.] *guru* BL *anugrahāt* cett.] *agrahāt*
 L *śāstrasya paṭhanāt* cett.] *śāstrapāṭhanāt* J 2-3 *ācārakaraṇāt* cett.] *ācārakathanāt* U₂
 3 *dhyānakaraṇāt* cett.] *om.* P *layasāadhanāt* β] *om.* γ 3-4 *upavāsakaraṇāt* cett.] *om.*
 P 4 *caturaśītyāsana*° BLP_U₂] *caturaśītyāsane* E, *caturaśīti āsana*° β *vairāgyasyotpatteḥ*
 ELN₂U₂] *vairāgyasyotpatte* B, *vairāgyasyotpattaḥ* P, *vairāgyotpatteḥ* N₁D, *vairāgyotpatte*
 U₁, *vairāgyotpattair* J *vairāgya*° cett.] *nairāśya* PL, *nairāśa*° B, *nairāśye* E *haṭha*° cett.]
 haṭa° BLU₁ 4-5 *yogasya* cett.] *yoga*° DJK₁N₁N₂ 5 *piṅgalayoḥ* cett.] *°piṅgalayāḥ* JK₁N₂U₁
pavanadhāraṇāt EPU₁] *pāvanādhāraṇāt* DN₁, *pavanādhāraṇāt* N₂, *pavanādhānākaraṇāt*
 U₂, *pāvanāpāvadhyānakaraṇāt* L, *pāvansāadhanāt* J, *om.* B *mahāmudrādidaśamudrāsā-
 dhanāt* cett.] *mahāmudrāsāadhanāt* U₁, *mahāmudrādidaśamudrādi daśamūdrasāadhanāt* D
 6 *maunakaraṇāt* cett.] *maunakaraṇād* N₂ *vanavāsāt* cett.] *vane vāsāt* DJK₁N₁U₁, *vane*
vāsata° N₂ *bahutarakālām* cett.] *bahutarakāla*° LU₁U₂, *bahukāla*° BE *yantramantrādi*°
 cett.] *mantrayamtrādi*° LU₁, *mantrādi*° K₁ 7 *tapāḥ* EPU₂] *tapa*° cett. *bahutarārthadhānāt*
 cett.] *bahutarārpaṇādānāt* E, *bahutarakleśakaraṇāt* *bahutarakaraṇāt* *bahutatārthadhānāt* P
tirthasevākaraṇāt DJK₁N₂] *tirthasevokaraṇāt* N₁, *tītham sevākaraṇāt* K₁, *niyamakaraṇāt*
 U₁, *om.* cett. *āśramācāra*° cett.] *āśramācyāra*° U₁, *āśramāra*° K₁ 8 *ṣaḍdarśana*° BELU₁] *ṣaḍdarśana*° cett. *śiromuṇḍanāt* cett.] *siromamḍanāt* JN₂, *om.* P *anyopāyakaraṇāt* cett.]
om. P 9 *prāpyate* cett.] *prāpyate śrī* N₁, *prāpyate* || cha || J, *om.* P

[LVIII. Majesty of yoga]

Now, the majesty of yoga is taught. As a result of the grace of the teacher, studying the teaching, execution of good conduct, hearing the secret of Vedānta, meditation, dissolution, fasting, practising 84 postures, generating indifference, cultivating indifference, doing Haṭhayoga, holding the breath of the Iḍā- and Piṅgalā-channels, practising the ten seals [like] the great-seal etc., observing silence, dwelling in the forest, causing excessive distress, practising Mantra and Yantra, etc. for a long time, doing austerities, giving many donations, frequenting places of pilgrimage, observing the conduct [proper] to the stages of life, adhering to renunciation, grasping the six philosophies, shaving the head, doing other methods, the reality of yoga⁴⁵⁸ is not attained. But this [reality of] yoga is truly attained by serving the teacher.⁴⁵⁹

⁴⁵⁸This is the only mention of the compound *yogatattva* in the entire text. The formulation makes the prominent position of *gurusevā* in Rāmacandra's doctrinal system unmistakably clear. According to Rāmacandra, the techniques and metaphysical views presented earlier in the text and all other yoga practices are incapable of bringing about the reality (*tattva*) of yoga. In Rāmacandra's opinion, *gurusevā* is the means *par excellence* to achieve the goals of yoga.

⁴⁵⁹This specific type of presentation under the keyword *yogamāhātmyam* or *yogasya mātmyam* is found not only in the *Tattvayogabindu* and its source texts, but also in several other Rājayoga texts. That is not entirely surprising, as the sublimity, superiority or majesty of Rājayoga, which is always suggested, is fundamentally contained in the association with this term. Comparable formulations can already be found in *amanaskaed* 2.5: *rājayogasya mātmyam ko vā jānāti tattvataḥ | jñānāt siddhir muktir iti guror jñānam ca labhyate* || **birch2013** translates: "Who, indeed, truly knows the majesty of Rājayoga? Since [both] power and liberation arise from knowledge, knowledge [should be] obtained from the guru." The proximity becomes even more apparent in *amanaskaed* 1.3–5. Here, **birch2013** translates: "In the Cakras, such as Mūlādhāra, in the pathways [of vitality], such as Suṣumnā, and in the vital airs, such as Prāṇa, the highest reality is not located. Some are devoted to Mantra Yoga, some are confused by meditation, and some are tormented by forceful [practices]. They do not know what causes one to cross over [to liberation]. Not by studying the doctrines of scriptural exegesis, logic, planets and mathematics, nor by the Vedas, Upaniṣads, Dharmaśāstras [and the like]; not even by lexicons nor metre, grammar, poetry, nor rhetoric; the sage's attainment of the highest reality is gained only from the oral teachings of his own guru." (*ādhārādiṣu cakreṣu suṣumnādiṣu nādiṣu | prāṇādiṣu samīreṣu paraṁ tattvaṁ na tiṣṭhati* || 3 || *mantrayogaratāḥ ke cit ke cid dhyānavimohitāḥ | haṭhena ke cit kliṣyanti naiva jānanti tāraṁ* || 4 || *na mīmāṃsātarkagrahaṇītasiddhāntapaṭhanair ...*

गुरुदृक्पातपात्राणां दृढानां सत्यवादिनाम् ।
कथनादृष्टिपाताद्वा सांनिध्यादवलोकनात् ॥ LVIII.1॥

प्रसादात्सद्गुरोः सम्यक्प्राप्यते परमं पदम् ।
अत एव वचः प्रोक्तं न गुरोरधिकं परं ॥ LVIII.2॥

5

वाङ्मात्राद्वाथ दृक्पाताद्यः करोति शमं क्षणात् ।
प्रस्फुटभ्रान्तिहृत्तोषं स्वच्छं वन्दे गुरुं परम् ॥ LVIII.3॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 848): gurupādodakam śiṣṭasevinā satyavādinā | kanyāstrā-didṛṣṭipātaharṣagativivarttanāt | 1–2 ≈ SSP 5.60–61ab (Ed. pp. 98–99): gurudṛkṣpātanāt prāyo dṛḍhānām satyavādinām sā sthitir jāyate | kathanāc chaktipātād vā yad vā pādāvalokanāt | 3–4 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 848): prasādāt sadguroḥ samyak prāpnoti paramaṃ padam | na guror adhikaṃ tattvaṃ yat tasmāt paramaṃ padam | 3–4 ≈ SSP 5.61cd–62ab (Ed. p. 99): prasādāt svaguroḥ samyak prāpyate paramaṃ padam ||61|| ata eva śivenoktam na guror adhikaṃ na guror adhikaṃ na guror adhikaṃ | 5–6 ≈ SSP 5.64 (Ed. p. 100): vānāmātrād vātha dṛkṣpātāt yaḥ karoti ca tatkaṣṇāt | prasphuṭaṃ sāmabhavaṃ vedhaṃ svasaṃvedyaṃ paraṃ padam |

1 gurudṛkṣpātapātrāṇām P]N₁N₂U₂] gurudṛkṣpāt patrāṇām L, gurudṛk | pāt | patrāṇām B, gurudṛkṣpātrāṇām K₁, gurudakṣpātrāṇām U₁, gurudṛkṣpātapātrāṇo D, gurudṛkṣpātāḥ patrāṇām E dṛḍhānām cett.] dṛḍhānām K₁, om. L satyavādinām cett.] satyavāridinām unṃ. U₁ **2** kathanād cett.] kathanā K₁, upayā° U₁ dṛṣṭipātād cett.] viṣapātād B, viṣapānād L sām-nidhyād PEU₂] sānnidhyād J, sānidhyāt B, sānnitdhy L, sānidhyād DN₁N₂, sānidhyāty K₁U₁ avalokanāt E]K₁LPU₁] dyavatrokanāt B, dhyavalokanāt N₁N₂, dhyāvalokanāt U₂, dyavalokanāt D **3** prasādātsadguroḥ cett.] sadguruprasādāt E, prasādāsya guroḥ P, prasāt sadguroḥ B prāpyate paramaṃ padam cett.] paramaṃ padam pāpyate E **4** ata eva cett.] ata evaṃ E param cett.] param E **5** vātha cett.] bodha E dṛkṣpātād cett.] dṛkṣpātād B sāmam cett.] sasam JU₁ **6** prasphuṭa° em.] prasphaṭa° N₂, prasphaṭad BL, prasphaṭat N₁, prasphuṭad EPU₂, prasphuṭat DJK₁ °bhrānti° cett.] °bhāti° BL hr̥ttoṣam EK₁P] hatoṣam BL, hatddoṣam N₁, haddoṣam N₂, hr̥ddoṣam DJ, ++++ṣam U₂ svaccham cett.] tvaccham N₂ vande γ] vade N₁, veda° DJK₁N₂ gurum γ] karaṃ N₁, °karaṃ K₁N₂, °kakaraṃ unṃ. DJ param cett.] parām N₁

Notes: **1** gurudṛkṣpātapātrāṇām: This point marks the beginning of a larger *lacuna* U₁. Omissions will not be recorded. The reader will be informed once the evidence of U₁ resumes.

LVIII.1 Those worthy ones upon whom the teacher's gaze falls, who are firm and truthful, because of either the [teachers'] stories, the falling of the teachers gaze, or his proximity, or because of viewing [the teacher], ...

LVIII.2 By the grace of the true teacher, they completely attain the supreme state. Therefore, it is said that nothing is greater than the teacher's words.

LVIII.3 I venerate the supreme, pure teacher, whose contentment removes my obvious errors, and who instantly brings [me] equanimity by his mere words and the fall of his gaze [on me].

na vedair vedāntaiḥ smṛtibhir abhidhānair api na ca | na cāpi cchandovyākaraṇakavitālaṅkṛtimayair munes tattvāvāptir nijagurumukhād eva vihitā || 5 ||). Sundaradeva's **hathatattvakaumudī** 2.1–12 also teaches a *yogamāhātmyam*. In comparison, however, with an interesting twist. While in Rāmacandra's formulations, all the techniques mentioned for achieving *yogatattva* except *gurusevā* are eclipsed, Sundaradeva raises various techniques in his explanations that can only be learnt by a competent *guru*, such as *mudrās*, *āsanas*, *kumbhakas* etc. as a basic prerequisite for achieving the state of yoga, see, e.g. **hathatattvakaumudī** 2.1: *atha yogamāhātmyam | yāvan mudrābhyasanamamalaṁ sampradāyānna yātaṁ yāvat pīṭhān yatha gadaharāṇyuccakairno jitāni || yāvat kumbho nijagurumukhān nopalabdho na dīrghas tāvad yogo na bhavati kalau lolacittasya sūraiḥ || 1 ||* For Sundaradeva, the main focus is on mastering the breath. In a very similar way, the breath is also emphasised within the *yogamāhātmya* section of the first verses of the **hathasamketacandrikajodhpur** (Ms. No. 2244 f. 2r–2v). In addition, the necessity of detaching the mind from attachment to sense objects and continuous yoga practice, etc., is highlighted here. The term is also mentioned in Agastya's **rajayoga** (f. 1r) but without the reference to *gurusevā* or the negation of other practices. Thus, in Rājayoga texts, the term *yogamāhātmya* is used either to explain the superiority of the respective core practices of Rājayoga with or without a comparison of inferior or ineffective means.

सम्यगानन्दजननः सद्गुरुः सोऽभिधीयते ।
 निमेषार्द्धं च पादं वा यद्वाक्यादवलोकनात् ॥ ।
 स्वात्मा स्थिरत्वम् आयाति तस्मै श्रीगुरवे नमः ॥ LVIII.4 ॥

नानाविकल्पविश्रान्तिं कथनात्कुरुते तु यः ।
 सद्गुरुः स तु विज्ञेयो न तु विप्रियजल्पकः ॥ LVIII.5 ॥

5

अत एव परमपदप्राप्त्यर्थं सद्गुरुः सर्वदा वन्द्यः । यः पुरुषः सत्यवादी भवति । निर-
 न्तरं गुरुसेवारतो भवति । यस्य मनसि पापं न भवति । स्वाचाररतो स्नानादिशीलो
 भवति । कापट्यं न भवति यस्य वंशपरंपरा ज्ञायते । एतादृशस्य सद्गुरोः संगतिः
 10 कर्तव्या तेन । पुरुषस्य मनः शान्तिं प्राप्नोति ।

Sources: 1-3 ≈ SSP 5.64cd-5.65 (Ed. p. 100-101): samyag ānandajanakaḥ sadguruḥ so 'bhidhiyate | nimeṣārdhārdhapātād vā yad vā pādāvalokanāt | svātmānam sthiram ādhatte tasmai śrīgurave namaḥ | 1-3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 848): nimeṣārdhdhena tasyaiva ājñāpālanato bhavet | mahānandaśataprāptis tasmai śrīgurave namaḥ | 4-6 ≈ SSP 5.66cd (Ed. pp. 101): nānāvikalpaviśrāntiṃ kathayā kurute tu yaḥ | sadguruḥ sa tu vijñeyo na tu mithyāviḍam-bakaḥ | 4-6 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 848): nānāvikalpavibhrāntināśaṇ ca kurute tu yaḥ | sadguruḥ sa tu vijñeyo na tu vairaprakalpakaḥ | 7-8 cf. SSP 5.67 (Ed. p. 101): ata eva paramapadaprāpty arthaṃ sa sadguruḥ sadā vandaniyaḥ | 7-8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 848): ata eva mahesāni sadguruḥ śiva āditaḥ | satyavādī ca sacchilo gurubhakto dṛḍhavrataḥ | 8-9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 848): svalpācāraratātmā yo dānādiśīlasaṃyutaḥ | kāpaṭyalobhavinyāsau mahāvamśasamudbhavaḥ | 9-10 cf. YSv (PT, p. 848): idrśaḥ sadgurus tasya saṅgatau yatnavān bhavet | tad eva manasaḥ śāntiṃ prāpnoti paramaṃ padam |

1 °jananaḥ γ] jananaṃ DJK₁N₁N₂ 2 nimeṣārdhdham cett.] nimeṣārdhdham PN₂, nimeṣārdh-
 dhā BL ca cett.] vā cett. pādām vā cett.] tatpādām EPU₂, tatpāda BL 3 āyāti cett.]
 yāyāti J śrīgurave cett.] śrīgurubho L, śrīguru namo unṃ. U₂ 4 nānāvikalpaviśrān-
 tiṃ N₁U₂] nānāvikalpam viśrāntiṃ D, nānāviplavaviśrāntiḥ E, nānāvikalpaḥ viśrāntiḥ P,
 nānāvikalpaviśrānti BK₁LN₂, nānāvaikalpaviśrānti J kathanāt cett.] kathanāt | B tu
 yaḥ BLP_U] tataḥ E, tu saḥ cett. 5 vijñeyo cett.] vijñō unṃ. BL na tu cett.] nnu BL
 vipriyajalpakaḥ cett.] viprāyajalākaḥ BL, vai priyajalpakaḥ E, me priyajalpaka J 7 parama-
 padaprāpty cett.] paramapadasya prāpty EP sarvadā vandyāḥ cett.] sevyāḥ sarvadā EPU₂,
 sevyasarvadā BL 7-8 niranṭaram cett.] niraṃtara° P 8 gurusevā cett.] gusevā° U₂ rato
 cett.] taro B, tatparo E bhavati cett.] bhava D pāpam cett.] pāpa B svācāra° γ] svasyācāra°
 cett. °rato cett.] rataḥ EPU₂, ratāḥ BL, °taḥ || U₂ 9 na bhavati EPLU₂] bhavati B, nāsti DN₁N₂
 vamśaparamparā cett.] parāparam parā DK₁ sadguroḥ cett.] guroḥ U₂ saṃgatiḥ cett.]
 saṃgati PN₂, saṃgati BL 10 karttavyā γ] karttavyāḥ JK₁N₂, kattavyāḥ DN₁ tena E] om.
 cett. manaḥ cett.] mano U₂ śāntiṃ cett.] śānti BL

LVIII.4 The true teacher is said to be the one who generates complete bliss. Homage to the glorious teacher, because of whose words, a slight glance of [whose] feet and from seeing [whom], my self becomes steady.

LVIII.5 One who brings about the end of [my] various discursive thoughts through his teachings should be known as the true teacher and not an unpleasant blowhard.

Hence, the true teacher is always to be praised in order to attain the supreme place. The person who is a speaker of truth is constantly engaged in serving the teacher. In whose mind there is no evil, he is devoted to good customs, [and] practices [such as] ceremonial bathing, etc. He who knows his noble lineage, he is not deceitful.⁴⁶⁰ He shall associate with a true teacher of such a kind. The mind of the person attains peace.

⁴⁶⁰In the light of my hypothesis of Rāmacandra addressing an audience of *kṣatriyas* I translate *vaṃśa* here as “noble lineage”.

अथ च यस्य मनोमध्ये स्थिर आनन्द उत्पद्यते। सोऽपि सद्गुरुः कथ्यते। अथ च घटिकामात्रं घटिकार्धं घटिकाचतुर्थांशो वा यस्य पार्श्वमुपविष्टे सत्यतादृशो भावो मनोमध्ये उत्पद्यते। गत्वा वनमध्ये स्थीयते गृहं त्यज्यते सोऽपि सद्गुरुः कथ्यते। कस्यापि दुःखं न दीयते। प्राणिमात्रेण सह मैत्री क्रीयते कस्यापि दोषं न प्रकाशयते
5 सोऽपि सद्गुरुः कथ्यते।

अज्ञानाकुलशीलानां यतीनां ब्रह्मचारिणाम्।

उपदेशं न गृहीयादन्यथा नरकं ध्रुवम् ॥ LVIII.6॥

यस्य वचसि मनसि धृते सति स्वात्मनः परमेश्वरस्यैक्यं भवति। एतादृशो मनो-
10 मध्ये निश्चयो भवति। तं सद्गुरुं जानीयात्। विकल्प एतादृशो यथा समुद्रमध्ये महत्तर कल्लोलाडम्बरः प्रपञ्चवासना एतादृशी यथोदकमध्ये महत्तरङ्गाः। तादृ-
शात्संसारार्णवाद्यो नावा परं पारं प्रापयति। स सद्गुरुः कथ्यते।

1 yasya cett.] om. U₂ sthira cett.] sirah BL, sira P, sthirā° N₂ ca cett.] om. EU₂ 2 ghaṭikāmā-
traṃ em.] ghaṭimātraṃ J, ghaṭimātra° N₂, ghaṭim mātraṃ D, ghaṭi++++mo N₁, ghaṭi K₁, om. γ
ghaṭikārdhaṃ cett.] °ghaṃṭikārdhaṃ N₂, ghaṭikā U₂, om. E ghaṭikā° LN₂U₂] ghaṭikāyāḥ
DK₁N₁, ghaṭikāyāḥ J, ghaṃṭikā° BP caturthāṃśo B] PLU₂] caturtho ḍaṃśo K₁N₁, caturtho
ḍaṃśo N₂, caturtho aṃśo D, om. E vā yasya pārśvam upaviṣṭe cett.] om. E satyatādr̥ṣo
cett.] satyetādr̥ṣo DJK₁LN₁, om. E bhāvo cett.] bhavo K₁, +++ N₂, om. E 3 manomadhya
BLP] manomadhye cett., om. E utpadyate cett.] upapadyate BL, om. E gatvā vanamadhye
sthiyate gr̥haṃ tyajyate cett.] om. E so 'pi sadguruḥ kathyate cett.] om. DEJK₁N₁N₂
4 prāṇimātrena cett.] prāṇimātre U₂ kriyate cett.] yate N₂ doṣaṃ EN₂] doṣo DPJK₁LN₁U₂,
doṣau B prakāśyate PN₂] prakāśyate DJK₁N₁, prakāśate BL, kathyati E 5 so γ] yena so
cett. 6 ajñānā° em.] ajñānā° BDLN₁U₂, ajñāta° EJK₁PN₂ 7 upadeśaṃ cett.] upadeśo PU₂
gr̥ṇhīyād EPL] gr̥ṇhīyāsthā | B, gr̥ṇhīyāt cett. anyathā cett.] yadānyathā unm. B narakam
cett.] narake J, na narakam unm. B 9 vacasi cett.] cavi U₂ manasi cett.] om. U₂ sati cett.]
sati | DN₁N₂ parameśvarasyaikyaṃ cett.] parameśvarasyaikam N₂, parameśvarasyakyaṃ
BL 10 jāniyāt cett.] vijāniyāt E vikalpa cett.] om. J etādr̥ṣo cett.] etādr̥ṣaṃ N₂ 11 ma-
hattara° cett.] mihattara D, mahattaraṃ E, om. J °ḍambaraḥ cett.] °ḍambara° BL, °ḍam-
baraṃ EPU₂ prapañca° cett.] prapaca U₂ etādr̥ṣi cett.] tādr̥ṣi E mahattaraṅgaḥ E]
mahattari U₂, mahattarati cett. 11-12 tādr̥ṣāt cett.] tādr̥ṣasya E 12 saṃsārārṇavād PLU₂] saṃsārārṇavād B, saṃsārāt arṇavād DK₁N₁N₂, saṃsārārṇavād J yo cett.] yau BL, yaḥ E
nāvā BLPDU₂] nāvaram N₁N₂, svavākyanāvā E param param E] param param U₂, param
BDK₁LP, om. N₁N₂ sa cett.] om. DJK₁

Furthermore, he, in whose mind steady bliss arises, only he is called a true teacher. Thus, a state characterised by seeing the truth arises in the mind of whom is seated at the side [of a true teacher] for merely a *ghaṭikā*⁴⁶¹, half a *ghaṭikā*⁴⁶², or a quarter [of a *ghaṭikā*]. Having gone forth, he who dwells in the forest [and] abandons his home is called the true teacher. He is called a true teacher who does not induce suffering to others, [who] bestows friendliness towards living beings, [who] will not expose anyone's badness.

LVIII.6 One should not accept the teaching of celibate ascetics, whose nature is confused by ignorance; otherwise, hell is inevitable.⁴⁶³

For one who is steadfast in mind and speech, unity arises between the supreme lord and the own self. Conviction of such a kind arises within the mind. One should know a true teacher. Such discursive thinking is like the roar of mighty waves within the ocean [and] such manifold mental residues are like great waves within the water, one who causes [the disciple] to reach the farther shore of such an ocean of Saṃsāra with a boat is called the true teacher.

⁴⁶¹One *ghaṭikā* equals 1/60 of a day (cf. **sircar1966**). A day has 1440 minutes (24 hours x 60 minutes), so 1/60 of a day corresponds to 24 minutes.

⁴⁶²12 minutes.

⁴⁶³I could not locate a source for this verse. The verse is possibly authorial.

यस्य पुरुषस्य मनोऽखण्डे परमपदे लीनं भवति । यः पुरुषः स्वीयं कूलं त्रिविधा-
त्तापान्निवर्त्य परममुक्तिपदे रक्षति । एतादृशं पुरुषं श्रवणादर्शनात्समग्रविघ्ना नश्य-
न्ति । दिने दिने कल्याणं भवति । निष्कलङ्का बुद्धिरुत्पद्यते ॥

[LIX. *yogaśāstrarahasyam*]

- 5 इदं योगशास्त्ररहस्यं समग्रशास्त्रमध्ये । यस्य मनो यथान्वकारस्य मध्ये दीपस्य
तेजः प्रविशति । तथा शास्त्रमध्ये तस्य मनः प्रविशति । यस्य राज्ञो मनोमध्ये कपटं
नास्ति । यस्मिन्दृष्टे देशकस्य त्रासो न भवति । तस्य मनः शुद्धं भवति ।

Sources: 5–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): *idaṃ yogarahasyaṃ ca na vācyaṃ mūrkhāsannidhau || yogadeśas tu tatraiva || utpātarahite deśe kaṇṭakādivivarjite | abhyasyate sadā yogaḥ samah syāt sukhaduḥkhaḥ | surājāni samāśritya karttavayo nirupadrave | deśe tu sarvaśasyāḍhye lobhamohavivarjite |*

1 *mano* cett.] *manaḥ* BL 'khaṇḍe cett.] *akhaṇḍe* BL *paramapade* E] *parapada*° DK₁N₁, *paramada*° N₂, *parapade* JU₂ *linam* cett.] °*lina* N₁, °*lita* N₂ *bhavati* cett.] *bhavati* B *pu-ruṣaḥ* cett.] *puruṣa* N₂U₂ *svīyaṃ kūlaṃ* cett.] *svikulaṃ* B, *svakulaṃ* E **1–2** *trividhāt* cett.] *trividha*° LU₂, *trividham* | B **2** *tāpān* cett.] *tapān* P *nivṛtya* cett.] *nivṛtya* J *parama-muktipade* PDJK₁N₁] *parame muktipade* E, *paramamamuktipade* N₂, *paramuktipade* BL, *paramamuktipakṣe* U₂ *etādṛśam* cett.] *etādṛśa* DU₂, *etādṛśa* | N₁, *etādṛśā* BLP, *etādṛśasya* E *puruṣam* β] *puruṣasya* γ *śravaṇād* cett.] *śravaṇāt* BJL, *śravaṇāt* || U₂, *śravaṇā* P *darśanāt* cett.] *darśanāt* | B °*vighnā* cett.] °*vighnām* J, °*viśvaś* ca *vaśām* U₁ **2–3** *naśyanti* cett.] *na naśyaṃti* L, *na naśyaṃti* B, *bhavati* U₁ **3** *dine dine* cett.] *dine* U₁ *kalyāṇam* cett.] *ka-lyāṇām* U₁ *bhavati* cett.] *bhavatir* U₁ *niṣkalaṅkā* cett.] *niṣkalaṃ* N₁N₂, *niṣkalaṃko* U₂ **5** *yogaśāstrarahasyam* BJLN₁U₂] *yogaśāstrarahasya* DN₂, *yogaśāstreṣu rahasyam* K₁U₁, *yogaśāstrasya rahasyam* EP *yasya* cett.] *om.* U₂ *mano* em.] *manaḥ* EJPU₁U₂, *mana* cett., *om.* N₂ *yathāṇḍhakārasya* cett.] *yathāṇḍhakāras* N₁, *yathāṇḍhakāra*° D, *om.* N₂ *madhye* cett.] *om.* N₂ *dīpasya* cett.] *dīpa*° E, *om.* N₂ **6** *tejaḥ* cett.] *om.* N₂ *praviśati* DEJK₁N₁P] *praviśyati* BLU₁, *vipraśati* U₂, *om.* N₂ *tathā* cett.] *yathā* U₂, *om.* N₂ *śāstramadhye* cett.] *om.* BLN₂U₁ *tasya manaḥ* DK₁N₁N₂] *manaḥ* JP, *mano* EU₂, *om.* BLU₁ *praviśati* cett.] *om.* BLU₁ *yasya* cett.] *om.* U₁ *manomadhye* cett.] *madhye manasi* BL, *madhye* E *kapaṭam* cett.] *kalaho* E **7** *deśakasya* cett.] *daśakasya* J, *darśakasya* U₁, *deśika*° E *tasya* cett.] *yasya* JU₁

Notes: **2** *etādṛśam*: Textual evidence of U₁ resumes from this word onwards.

That person's mind that has dissolved into the undivided supreme state and who has turned his lineage away from the threefold miseries⁴⁶⁴ and protects [them] in the state of supreme liberation, all obstacles disappear because of listening to and seeing that person. Day by day, prosperity arises. A flawless intellect arises.

[LIX. Esoteric yoga doctrine in all of the scriptures]

This is the esoteric yoga doctrine in all of the scriptures. [The king] whose mind enters into the teaching just as the light of a lamp enters into the midst of darkness; the king in whose mind there is no deceit and, when he is seen [by his subjects] there is no fear of a ruler, [he is one who] has a purified mind.

⁴⁶⁴The threefold misery consists of: 1. *adhyātmika* ("internal"), which refers to any physical and mental misery caused by diseases; 2. *adhibhautika* ("external"), which refers to any misery caused by external living beings or objects; and 3. *adhidaivika*, which refers to any misery caused by the gods or comes from heaven, such as cold, heat, storm, drought, etc. For a more detailed account, see **mainkar2004** (2004), especially the respective explanations provided in the *bhāṣya* of Gaudapāda for the first *kārikā*.

यस्य पृथिव्यां कीर्तिर्भवति। यस्य मनोमध्ये सत्पुरुषवचनविश्वासो भवति। यो राजा सदानन्दपूर्णो भवति। यस्य पार्श्वे प्रत्यक्षमनेकं मनोहारिवस्तूनि भवन्ति। एतादृशस्य राज्ञोऽग्रे योगरहस्यं कथनीयम्।

न स्नेहान् न भयाल्लोभान् न मोहान् न धनाद्वलात्।

5

न मैत्रीभावान् न दानान् न सौन्दर्यान् न सेवनात् ॥ LIX.I ॥

सामान्यादग्रे योगो न कथनीयः। यः परनिन्दारतो भवति। दुराचारो भवति। भ्रातुर्मित्रस्य च योग्यं वस्तु न ददाति। योऽसत्यं वदति। यो योगिनां मनोमध्ये निन्दां करोति। यस्य मनोमध्ये दया न भवति। यः कलहप्रियो भवति।

Sources: 8–9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): stutir nindā na karttavayā sādhanāsatyavādinā || yogānad-hikāriṇaṃ āha tatraiva || manomadhye dayā nāsti sadā yaḥ kalahapriyaḥ |

1 yasya cett.] om. U₁ prthivyām PL] prthvyām BEU₂, prthivī DN₁N₂, prthvī J, prthivī K₁U₁ kīrtir cett.] vītir E, kīrti K₁U₁, kītir U₂ satpuruṣavacanaviśvāso cett.] satpuruṣavacanah viśvāso N₂, satpuruṣasya vacanaviśvāso J, satpuruṣasya vaco viśvāso E, vacanaviśvabhyāso U₁ 2 sadānandapūrṇo cett.] sadānamdarūpo E, sānamdarpūrṇo L anekam cett.] aneka° BLE, anokaṃ K₁ manohārivastūni E] manohārivastu cett. bhavanti em.] tiṣṭhaṃti E, bhavati cett. 3 rājño cett.] rājña E 'gre β] ye BPU₂, yad L, idaṃ E yogarahasyam cett.] thogarahasyam B kathanīyam EP] kathyaniyam BL, kartavyam JK₁N₁N₂U₁, kartavya D, kathyate U₂ 4 na cett.] ni BL snehān EPU₂] śnehān cett. na EJK₁PU₂] nā° BL, a° DN₁N₂ bhayāl cett.] bhayān EU₁ lobhān cett.] ++bhān N₁N₂, +++++ P, lo++ unm. U₂ na cett.] om. P mohān cett.] om. P dhanād cett.] na dhanād L, om. P balāt cett.] balāta B, om. P 5 na cett.] na maitrī na unm. J, om. P maitribhāvān cett.] maitribhāva N₂, maitrī++++ D, +++++bhāvān P na JK₁N₁U₁] no BLPU₂, nau E, nā N₂, om. D dānān N₂PU₂] dāsān JN₁U₁, dāryān E, dānāt BK₁L, om. D na cett.] om. D saundaryān cett.] saudaryān PN₂, saumdayan L, om. D na cett.] ni L, om. D sevānāt cett.] sevātā U₁ 7 sāmānyād agre cett.] sāmānyāgre BELU₁ kathanīyaḥ cett.] kathanīyam B, kathanīyam L, kaniyaḥ N₂ yaḥ cett.] om. U₁ paranindā cett.] paranimdām BLU₁, parato J rato cett.] om. BJL bhavati cett.] karoti BL durācāro bhavati EP] durācāro bhavati JK₁N₁N₂U₁U₂, om. BL 8 bhrātūr K₁PU₂] bhrātu° JN₁N₂, bhrātūr U₁, dur° BE, om. L mitrasya cett.] mitram U₁, maitryānyasya BE, om. L ca योग्याṃ JN₂U₁] ca योग्याṃ ca N₁, योग्याṃ PU₂, ca योग्या K₁, om. BLE vastu na dadāti cett.] om. L yo PU₂] so JK₁N₁N₂U₁, ya E, om. BL 'satyam cett.] asatyam E, samtyam K₁, om. BL vadati cett.] om. BL yo EP] om. cett. yoginām cett.] yoginā K₁N₁N₂, yoga° E, om. BL manomadhye cett.] om. BEL 9 nindām cett.] nimdā J, ni° U₁, om. BL karoti cett.] om. BL yaḥ cett.] yaṃ J, yasya BLPU₂, om. DN₂ kalahapriyo cett.] kalaham priyo BL, kalahah priyo U₂, om. DN₂ bhavati cett.] na bhavati BL, om. DN₂

Notes: 5 maitrī: A lacuna in D starts here. The omissions are not recorded. The reader will be informed when D resumes.

[The king] who has fame on earth; in whose mind there is trust in the speech of good people; who is a king always filled with bliss; at whose side there is an abundance of enchanting objects visible [to all], in the presence of such a king the secret of yoga shall be explained.⁴⁶⁵

LIX.I Not because of affection, fear, greed, delusion, wealth, strength, friendship, donations, beauty, not because of service [shall the secret of yoga be explained.]⁴⁶⁶

Yoga shall not be taught in the presence of common [people]. He, who is devoted to criticising others, who is misbehaving, who does not give a useful thing, which benefits friend and brother, who speaks falsely, who blames yogis in his mind, in whose mind compassion does not arise, who delights in quarrel, ...

⁴⁶⁵The decision for the γ -group reading *kathanīyam*, and against the reading of the β -group, which reads *kartavyam*, is based on the following observations: Rāmacandra aims to emphasize the contrast between a suitable and an unsuitable king for his *yogaśāstrarahasya*. In the sentence following verse LIX.I, Rāmacandra states: *sāmānyād agre yogo na kathanīyaḥ* | Here, not only the γ -group but also the β -group of manuscripts read the gerundive of $\sqrt{kath}$. The core of Rāmacandra's explanation in this section of the *yogaśāstrarahasya* is the ideal practice for the monarch. The Sahajayoga Rāmacandra teaches in this chapter enables the king, despite being an "enjoyer of the earth," to achieve soteriological completion without the deprivations typical for ascetics. The king can fulfil his duties without even needing practice. Thus, the concluding statement in the last sentence is: *iti cakravartināmakathanam* | "This is the explanation for those named *cakravartin*." In all manuscripts, we again find a word formed from $\sqrt{kath}$. Although the reading of the β -group works, the reading of the γ -group appears to be the original, especially since *kartavyam* could be a scribal error that crept into the transmission early on. This is because *kartavyam* is a word Rāmacandra uses very frequently, and like *kathanīyam*, it begins with *ka* and ends with *yam*. Thus, a scribe who is tired or whose concentration has waned towards the end of copying the text could easily make this mistake.

⁴⁶⁶So far, I have not been able to identify the source of this verse. Perhaps this verse stems from Rāmacandra's own hand.

स्वकार्यकरणेऽसावधानो भवति । गुरोः कार्यकरण आदरो न भवति । एतादृशस्या-
ग्रे न योगः क्रियते न पठ्यते ।

5

शृण्वन् गीतादिकान् शब्दान् पश्यन् रूपं मनोहरम् ।
जिघ्रन् गन्धांश्च सुरभीन् स्पृशन् स्पर्शं मृदुप्रियम् ।
स्वादान् मनोरमान् खादन् भ्राम्यन् देशान् मनोरमान् ॥ LIX.2 ॥

भाषमाणः सुमधुरं रममाणः स्वलीलया ।
भावाभावविनिर्मुक्तः सर्वग्राहविवर्जितः ॥ LIX.3 ॥

सदानन्दमयो योगी सदाभ्यासी सदा भवेत् ।
विरुद्धे दुःखदेशे च विरूपेऽतिभयानके ॥ LIX.4 ॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): svakāryalobhane śīlo gurukāryaparāṇmukhaḥ | etasmai ca na dātavyaṃ vaktavyaṃ tasya sannidhau | 6–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): nañ ubhayatra sambadhyate na vaktavyaṃ ity arthaḥ | yogādhikāriṇo 'pi tatraiva || bhāvābhāvavinirmuktaḥ sarvagrahavivarjitaḥ | 7 ≈ *Amanaska* 1.12ab: bhāvābhāvavinirmuktaṃ vināśotpattivarjitam | 8–9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): sadānandamayo yogī sadābhyāsī sadā bhavet | viruddhe duḥkhadeśe ca virūpe 'tibhayānake |

1 svakāryakaraṇe EPU₁U₂] svakāryakaraṇe LN₁, svakāryakaraṇem B, svakāryākaraṇā N₂ guroḥ cett.] guro BN₂U₂ kāryakaraṇa em.] kāryakaraṇe cett., kārye karaṇe B ādaro na [K₁N₁N₂U₁] nādrto PU₂, anādarano B, anādare no L, na dattacitto E 1–2 etādrśasyāgre cett.] etādrśasya agre U₁ 2 yogaḥ cett.] om. N₁N₂U₁ paṭhyate cett.] padyamte N₁N₂, paṭhayate BL 3 śṛṇvan cett.] śuśvana unṃ. N₂ gītādikān cett.] prītādikān E śabdān cett.] śab-dāt | N₂ paśyan cett.] paśyat U₁ 4 jighran cett.] jāgrat E, jighraṃ U₁ gandhāms ca P] nāmdhaś ca U₁, gaṃdhām śu K₁, gandhān unṃ. N₁N₂, agachan unṃ. BP, sprśan gaṃdhan unṃ. U₂, om. E surabhīn [K₁U₁U₂] sphuran E, surabhīn PL, sphurabhi B, śusurabhīn N₁N₂ sprśan γ] sprśyan N₁N₂K₁, sprśyān J, om. U₁ sparsaṃ P[K₁U₁U₂] sparsa° E, asyaṃ N₂, asya N₁, om. cett. mṛdupriyam cett.] mṛdupriyāṃ || K₁, śarmṛdupriyāṃ N₂, mṛdu || priyam U₂ 5 manoramān cett.] manorathān BL, manomān N₁N₂, manoman K₁ khādan P] khādavan BL, khādaṃta° U₁, svādan [K₁N₁, om. EN₂U₂ bhrāmyan cett.] bhrāman BL, bhrāmyena N₁, bhrāmya na N₂ deśān cett.] veśān J, tveśāṃ U₁ 6 bhāsamāṇaḥ EPU₂] bhāsamāṇasya K₁N₁N₂U₁, bhāsamāṇa J, bhakṣamāṇaḥ L, bhakṣamāṇa B sumadhuraṃ PU₂] samadhuraṃ J, samaghura° B, samadhura° L, madhuraṃ K₁N₁N₂U₁, om. E ramamāṇaḥ cett.] rasamāṇaḥ N₁N₂, °ramamāṇaṃ L, °ramāṇa unṃ. B 7 bhāvābhāvavinirmuktaḥ cett.] bhāvābhāvavinirmukto E, bhāvāvinir muktaḥ BL 8 sadānandamayo cett.] sadāmaya unṃ. BL, om. U₂ yogī cett.] yo yogī unṃ. L, om. U₂ sadābhyāsī cett.] sadābhyāso K₁U₁, om. U₂ sadā bhavet cett.] om. U₂ 9 viruddhe cett.] viruddha° EP, om. U₂ duḥkhadeśe ca em.] duḥkhade deśe E[K₁PN₁N₂U₁, duḥkhe deśe B, duḥkhadeśe L, om. U₂ virūpe EK₁PN₂] śovirūpe B[LN₁, vivarūpe U₁, om. U₂ 'tibhayānake EK₁PN₁N₂] te bhayānake J, bhayānake BLU₁, om. U₂

...who is inattentive towards his own obligations, [and] who has no regard for fulfilling his obligations to his teacher. In the presence of someone like this, yoga is neither done nor taught.⁴⁶⁷

LIX.2 While hearing the sounds of music, and the like, while seeing [things with] charming forms, while smelling pleasant scents, while touching [things with a] soft and pleasant touch, while eating [dishes with] delicious tastes, while roaming around beautiful places, ...

LIX.3 ...while speaking very gently and delighting in his own play,⁴⁶⁸ he is free from existence and non-existence and clinging to the world.

LIX.4 He is always a yogin, always engaged in practice, and full of permanent bliss, even in a land of suffering, unpleasant, odious and extremely terrible.

⁴⁶⁷Rāmacandra contrasts a good king with a bad king. In both formulations, the usage of *agre* suggests that this yoga was meant to be disseminated in a king's court.

⁴⁶⁸I was unable to identify any known source for verse LIX.2 and the first half of LIX.3; these may therefore be original compositions by the author. The stylistic features of the verses lend some support to this assumption.

इष्टाद्यनिष्टं संस्पर्शे रसे च लवणादिके ।
पूत्यादावपि गन्धे च कण्टकोष्मादिवर्जिते ॥ LIX.5॥

सर्वदैव सदाभ्यासः समः स्यात्सुखदुःखयोः ।
एवंभूतस्य कर्माणि संकल्परहितानि च ॥ LIX.6॥

5

गच्छन्नृणां च संस्पर्शात्पापं कुर्वन्न लिप्यते ।
उत्पन्नतत्त्वबोधस्य ह्युदासीनस्य सर्वदा ॥ LIX.7॥

Sources: 1-4 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 847): etad anīṣṭasaṃsparśe nyūnādhike balādhike | evaṃbhūtasya karmāṇi saṅkalparahitāni ca | 1-4 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 847): utpātarahite deśe kaṇṭakādivivarjite | abhyasyate sadā yogaḥ samaḥ syāt sukhaduḥkhaḥ | 5-6 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 847): evaṃ gacchan svapan paśyan pāpapunyair na lipyate | utpannatattvabodhaḥ syāt sadā śīlasya sarvadā | 5-6 ≈ amanaskaed 2.36: utpannatattvabodhasya hy udāsīnasya sarvadā | sadābhyāsaratasaitan naikatrāpy upayujyate ||

1 iṣṭādy anīṣṭaṃ saṃsparśe N₂] iṣṭādhanīṣṭaṃ saṃsparśe P, iṣṭādyaniṣṭasaṃsparśe cett., om. U₂ rase cett.] rasaṃ N₂, om. U₂ lavaṇādike cett.] lavaṇādiko N₂, om. U₂ 2 pūtyādāv api JLN₁N₂] pratyādāv api BEP, pūjādāv api K₁U₁, om. U₂ gandhe cett.] gamdhaṃ N₂ ca cett.] om. U₂ kaṇṭakoṣmādivarjite JK₁N₁] kaṇṭakoṣmādivarjite N₂, kaṇṭakoṣnādivivarjayet E, kaṇṭakoṣyādivivarjite P, kaṇṭakoṣmādivarji B, kaṇṭakoṣmādivarji L, kuṇṭakoṣmādivarjite U₁ 3 sarvadaiva cett.] sarvadeva BLN₁U₁, sarvadaivaṃ U₂ sadābhyāsaḥ EK₁PU₂] sadābhyāsaḥ BLN₁N₂U₁, sadābhyā J samaḥ cett.] sama JK₁N₁U₁, mana N₂ syāt cett.] sya | t L, syā U₁ 4 bhūtasya JK₁N₂] bhūta° U₁, yogasya cett. 5 gacchan cett.] gacha U₁ saṃsparśāt cett.] saṃsparśot BN₁ pāpaṃ cett.] pāpaḥ P, tapaḥ E 6 utpannatattvabodhasya cett.] utpannatattvabodhasyād U₁K₁, utpannatattvabodhaḥ syād J hy udāsīnasya E] udāsīnasya cett.

LIX.5 [As for example] in relation to contact with unfavourable [things] such as [something] desired and so forth, [or] in relation to taste, such as salt and so forth, [or] in relation to odour, such as that of rot and so forth, and [in relation to a place] without thorns, heat and so forth,⁴⁶⁹ ...

LIX.6 ...the[yogin] practises yoga frequently and is equanimous to pleasure and pain. In this way, the actions of one who is thus are free of volition.

LIX.7 [Although] walking among men, and as a result of mutual contact [naturally] committing sin, [the yogin] is untainted.⁴⁷⁰ [When the yogin's] awakening has taken place [and when he has become one] who is always indifferent, ...

⁴⁶⁹ An examination of the source text used by Rāmacandra for these verses reveals particular difficulties with verse LIX.5. Here the author seems to have confused two distinct sections of his source, the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, by merging descriptions of the *yogadeśa* with those of the *yogādhikārin*. Given the negative aspects presented by Rāmacandra earlier (in LIX.4cd), verse LIX.5d, with its formulation *kaṇṭakoṣmādivarjite* ("a place free from thorns, heat, etc."), seems entirely out of place—but only at first glance. The textual transmission, however, is unambiguous. Furthermore, Rāmacandra states in the following verse (LIX.6) that the yogin is indifferent to pleasure and pain, which makes it conceivable that the preceding verse presents both positive and negative examples of the conditions that affect the yogin. Although Rāmacandra mentions the negative circumstance of foul odours etc. in LIX.5c, he refers shortly before to the taste of salt and the like, which is more likely to be regarded as positive. While salt water might be a possible negative interpretation here, the fact that even fruit juices in India are salted to enhance flavour suggests that the mention of salt in the context of taste should be read more positively. Consequently, LIX.5d should ultimately be accepted as a legitimate reading.

⁴⁷⁰ The *kṣatradharma* requires the warrior and ruling caste to perform actions that could be categorised as sinful. For example, killing in a war or the use of force may be necessary to maintain order. If the *kṣatriya* has attained liberation through Rājayoga, he is immune to the karmic consequences.

तदा दृष्टिविशेषः स्याद्विविधान्यासनानि च ।
 अन्तःकरणजा भवा योगिनो नोपयोगिनः ॥ LIX.8॥
 सर्वदा सहजस्थस्य निष्कलाध्यात्मवेदिनः ।
 यत्प्रयत्ननिष्पाद्यं तत्तत्सर्वम् न कारणं ॥ LIX.9॥

5

विलासिनीनां मनोहारिगीतश्रवणात् ॥ अतिसुन्दरकामिनीनां रूपदर्शनात् ॥ क-
 स्तूरीकर्पूरगन्धग्रहणात् ॥ मनःशीतलकार्यतिकोमलपरवस्तुनः स्पर्शकारणात् ॥
 अतिमाधुर्यं चित्ते करोति ।

Sources: 1-2 ≈YSv (PT, p. 847): pare dṛṣṭivilaṃ na syād vividhāni mṛtāni ca | antaḥkaraṇam etasya yogino niṣkriyaṃ [niṣkalā?] tu sa | 1-2 ≈amanaskaed 2.37: tadā dṛṣṭiviśeṣāś ca vividhāny āsanāni ca | antaḥkaraṇabhāvāś ca yogino nopayoginaḥ || 3-4 ≈YSv (PT, p. 847): sarvadā sahajas tasya niṣkalādhyātmavādinah | yadā prayatnaniṣpādyam grāhyam sarvam akāraṇam |

1 dṛṣṭiviśeṣaḥ cett.] dṛṣṭiviśeṣa BLP, dṛṣṭir viśeṣa U₁ vividhāny EK₁N₂U₂] vidhāny unṃ. cett.
 2 antaḥkaraṇajā cett.] antaḥkaraṇayā J, antaḥkaraṇayo U₁, antaḥkaraṇajo K₁ nopayogi-
 naḥ cett.] nopi yoginaḥ LU₂ 3 sarvadā cett.] sarvadya BL, sarva° E saḥajasthasya cett.]
 saḥajasya B, mahajarasya U₁, rājapadasthasya E vedinaḥ EJP₂]°vedinā BLU₁,°vedina N₁N₂,
 °cedina K₁ 4 prayatnaniṣpādyam N₁N₂U₂] aprayatna niḥpādyam K₁, aprayatna niṣyayim
 U₁, prayatnaniḥpādy B JL, prayatnaniḥpārdham P, prayatnaniḥpāyam E tat tat sarvam
 EK₁PN₁N₂] tat sarvam BU₁U₂, tat sarvem L, tattaḥ svadharma° J na kāraṇam N₂] akāraṇam
 EPN₁, akāraṇam U₁, akāraṇāt B, ikāraṇāt L,°kāraṇam J, kāraṇa unṃ. U₂ 6 vilāsininām cett.]
 vilāsa || ninām K₁ manohārigītaśravaṇāt K₁N₁N₂U₁] manoharijītaśravaṇāt J, manohārigā-
 naśravaṇāt γ atisundarakāmininām cett.] atisaumḍaryakāmininām E, atisaumḍaram
 kāminām P, atisaumḍarakāmininām B, atisaumḍarakāmininām L rūpadarśanāt cett.] rū-
 paṃ darśanāt J 6-7 kastūri° cett.] kastūri° U₁ 7 karpūragandha° N₂] karpuro gaṃdha° U₁,
 karpūrayo gaṃdha° U₂, karpūragandhayor L, karpūrayor gaṃdha° BEJP, karpūragandhayār
 gaṃdha° N₁, karpūra gaṃdhayārgadhya° K₁ śītalakāry em.] śītalakārī N₁N₂, śīlakārī JU₁,
 śaityakārī cett. atikomalaparavastunaḥ JK₁N₁N₂U₁] komalavastunaḥ γ sparśakāraṇāt
 cett.] saṃsparśakam B, saṃsparśakam L 8 citte cett.] cittaṃ N₂, cikri U₂

LIX.8 then the specific gazing point, the various postures⁴⁷¹ and the states produced from the internal organ⁴⁷² are useless to the yogin.

LIX.9 For the knower of the undivided supreme self, who is always in the natural state, whatever is brought about with effort, all of that is entirely groundless.

Because of listening to the lovely songs of charming women, looking at the beauty of very lovely women, smelling the fragrance of camphor and musk, touching objects that make the mind relax and that are extremely soft and superb, [because of all these things] he experiences exquisite beauty in the mind.

⁴⁷¹ Postures (*āsanas*) are not discussed in Rāmacandra's text. Together with this passage, however, they are mentioned thrice (cf. p. 204 l. 6 and p. 276 l. 2) and given these three statements, one might assume that the audience of this text practised them, but other works were consulted.

⁴⁷² **birch2013** (2013: 368, n. 52) wrote a long endnote on the compound *antaḥkaraṇabhāvā* that occurs in **amanaskaed** 2.37c which is a possible source of this verse in Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. I briefly summarize the endnote and complement my findings: Even though the Nepalese commentator of the **amanaskaed** interprets it as the "intention of the heart" (*antaḥkaraṇakā manasuvā paṇi*) **birch2013**, who has not found the compound in other texts back in 2013 proposes the more plausible explanation that *antaḥkaraṇabhāva* refers to the eight mental states characterizing the higher faculty of discernment (*buddhibhāva*). These eight states, as outlined in **mainkar2004** 23, include religious merit (*dharma*), gnosis (*jñāna*), dispassion (*virāga*), and power (*aiśvarya*) as positive aspects, while their opposites (*adharma*, *ajñāna*, *avirāga*, and *anaiśvarya*) form the negative states (*adhyavasāyo buddhir dharmo jñānaṃ virāga aiśvaryaṃ | sāttvikam etad rūpaṃ tāmasam asmād viparyastam*). According to **birch2013**'s research, this division of *buddhi* is adopted by Śaiva traditions, such as **malinivijay** 1.30cd. The eightfold *buddhi* in the *Mālinivijayottaratantra* has been noted in **vasudeva2004**. The concept of the *buddhibhāvas* is also present in other contexts, like the hierarchical system of religions in the **svacchandatantra** (II.179–182). In this scheme, deluded individuals are influenced by dark *buddhibhāvas*. The specific formulation of Rāmacandra with the phrase *antaḥkaraṇajā bhāvā* however, I was able to locate within **bodhasara** 17.5: *mano buddhir ahankāraś cittam ceti catuṣṭayam | antaḥkaraṇajā bhāvā ātmā śuddho nirañjanaḥ* || 17.15 || "The quadruplet — mind, intellect, ego, and consciousness — are states produced by the inner organ. The self, however, is pure and untainted." This fourfold scheme is very close to the fivefold version taught by Rāmacandra ...

तादृशः स्वादनात् ॥ अनेकदेशानां साध्वसाधुस्थानदर्शनात् ॥ मैत्रेण सह कोमल-
 वचनात् ॥ शत्रुणा सह काठिन्यवचनात् ॥ यस्य मनसि हर्षो वा द्वेषो न भवति । स
 पुरुष ईश्वरोपदेशको ज्ञेयः । स्वलीलया वदति चलति च । भावाभावयोश्चित्तमुदा-
 सीनं भवति । कस्यांचिद्वार्त्तायां हठं न करोति । यस्य मनः सहजानन्दे मग्नं भवति ।
 5 तेन पुरुषेण दृष्टिः स्थिरा कर्त्तव्या । आसनं दृढं कर्त्तव्यम् । पवनः स्थिरः कर्त्तव्यः ।
 एतादृशः कश्चिन्नियमः सिद्धस्य नोक्तः । मनःपवनाभ्यां यदा सहजानन्दः स्वस्व-
 रूपेण प्रकाशयते । स सहजयोगः कथ्यते अराजयोगमध्ये ।
 इति चक्रवर्तिनामकथनम् ॥
 इति श्रीपरमरहस्यम् ।

10

1 *tādṛśaḥ* BELP] *tādrśa* cett. *sādhvasādhusthānadarśanāt* cett.] *sādhusthānadarśanāt* N₁ *maitreṇa* cett.] *mitreṇa* E *komala*° cett.] *kommala* J 2° *vacanāt* cett.] *vacat* K₁ *śa-
 trunā* cett.] *śatruṇām* K₁N₁N₂U₂ *kāṭhinya*° LJK₁U₁U₂] *kāṭhina*° E, *kaṁvinya*° P, *kāṭhinya*° B,
kavinya° N₂ *vacanāt* cett.] *vacanān* N₁, *vacanād* N₂ *manasi* cett.] *manasi* K₁U₁U₂, *mana*
 L *na* cett.] *vā na* JK₁U₁, *om.* L 2-3 *sa puruṣa* cett.] *puruṣo* U₂ 3° *īśvaropadeśako* cett.]
īśvaropade ko L *svalilayā* cett.] *svaliyayā* N₁N₂ *ca* cett.] *va* P, *om.* E 4 *haṭhaṁ* cett.]
haṭaṁ LU₁, *harṣaviṣādaṁ* E *manaḥ* cett.] *mana*° N₂ *sahajānande* cett.] *sahajānaṁdam* L,
sahajānaṁda° U₁, *sahajānaṁ damde* U₂ *magnaṁ* cett.] *añjaṁ* L, *saṁjñāṁ* JU₁ 5 *puruṣeṇa*
 cett.] *bhya* *puruṣeṇa* P, *svapuruṣeṇa* D *drṣṭiḥ* cett.] *drṣṭi*° U₁ *karttavyā* cett.] *karttavyaṁ*
 DK₁N₁N₂ *āsanam* cett.] *āsana*° U₁ *pavanaḥ sthiraḥ* cett.] *pavanasthiraḥ* K₁, *om.* L *kart-
 tavyaḥ* cett.] *karttavyaṁ* N₂, *om.* L 6 *kaścin niyamaḥ* cett.] *kaści niyamaḥ* K₁U₁, *kaścin*
niyamaḥ U₂, *kaści niyamaḥ* J *manaḥpavanābhyāṁ* cett.] *manapavanābhyāṁ* L *saha-
 jānandaḥ* cett.] *sahajānaṁda*° EL 6-7 *svasvarūpeṇa* cett.] *svarūpeṇa* J 7 *prakāśyate*
 cett.] *prakāśate* U₁ *sahajayogaḥ* cett.] *sahajayoga* DN₁, *sahajo yoga* JK₁, *sahajo yogya* N₂,
sahayogaḥ U₁ *rājayogamadhya* cett.] *rājayogasya madhya* U₂, *te madhya* EP 8 *cakravartī*°
 EPLN₁U₂] *cakravartī* DJK₁N₂, *cakravaktya* U₁ *°nāma*° β] *om.* γ *°kathanam* cett.] *kathanam*
 || *cha* || J, *kathyate* LU₂, *°madhya iti cakravartye nāma madhya kathanam* U₁ 9 *śrī*° cett.]
om. DLK₁U₁V *°paramarahasyam* em.] *°paramarahasyāṁ* DJK₁N₁U₁, *°paramarahasye* N₂,
°paramahamṣasamhitāyāṁ haṁsyāṁ V

Notes: 2 *vacanāt*: The evidence of manuscript B stops here. The last folio of the manuscript is missing. *dveṣo na bhavati*: Here the *lacuna* in witness D concludes, and the transmission of its text continues.

Despite enjoying such things, seeing good and bad places of many countries, speaking sweetly with friends, and speaking harshly to enemies, joyful excitement and hatred do not arise in his mind. This person is known as a teacher who conveys the instruction of the Lord (*īśvara*). For his own amusement, he speaks and moves. The mind is equanimous in both existence and non-existence. He, whose mind is immersed in inherent bliss, does not commit violence in any business.

By that person, the gaze shall be stabilised; the posture shall be stabilised; [and] the breath shall be stabilised. No such discipline is prescribed for the accomplished [person].⁴⁷³ When by means of mind and breath, the natural bliss appears through its own true nature, it is called Sahajayoga (“natural yoga”) in [this system of] Rajayoga.

This is the explanation for those named *cakravartin* (“Universal Ruler”).

This is the venerable supreme secret.⁴⁷⁴

in his metaphysics section on p. 264 in which *consciousness* (*caitanya*) is added as a fifth item. The verses of chapter 17 provide information about further resulting states and their differentiations. The states born of the inner organ originally derive from the qualities (*guṇas*) of original matter (*prakṛti*) (17.4). The four states of the inner organs produce more differentiated states (*bhāvāḥ*)—*manas*, viz., “will and indecision” (*saṃkalpa* and *vikalpa*) (17.6); *buddhi*, viz., “ascertainment” (*nīścaya*) (17.7); *ahaṃkāra*, viz., “knowing, doing, experiencing, the sense of agency, and the concepts of being the doer or the enjoyer, as well as notions of injury and harm” (*jñātvakartṛtvabhokṛtvavadhyaghātakatādayaḥ*) (17.8) of the *citta*, viz., “memory of past experiences and recognition” (*smṛtiḥ pūrvānubhūtasya pratyabhijñā*) (17.9). For the whole account of further divisions of the *bhāvas* see **bodhasara** 17.1–51.

⁴⁷³With this statement, Rāmacandra repeats the message of verse LIX.7. Once the highest state of yoga is reached, yoga practice becomes unnecessary.

⁴⁷⁴Rāmacandra’s treatise concludes with these emphatic statement, clearly asserting that *sahayoga* is a form of yoga intended for kings or aspiring monarchs. For a king who rules and enjoys the amenities of his position, Sahajayoga is the appropriate yoga practice. As a *kṣatriya*, he can maintain the soteriological state of salvation through Sahajayoga while continuing to fulfill his caste duties without continuous practice. Beyond this passage, the term *cakravartin* is absent in the Haṭha- and Rājayoga literature known to me. However, there are notable occurrences of the term in yogic literature, such as Hemacandra’s **hemacandras** 4.19–21: *dhanahinaḥ śatam ekaṃ sahasraṃ śatavān api | sahasrādhipatir lakṣaṃ koṭiṃ ...*

इति श्रीरामचन्द्रविरचितोऽयं तत्त्वयोगबिन्दुः समाप्तः ॥

I iti śrīrāmacandraviracito 'yaṃ Birch em.] śrīrāmacandraviracitāyāṃ β, rāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas PU₂, rājamacaṃdraparahāṃsaviracites L, śrīsarvagūṇasampannapaṃḍitasukhānandamiśrasūrisūnupaṇḍitajvālāprasādamiśrakṛtabhāṣāṭīkāśahito E **tattvayogabinduḥ**] tatvayogabindu DN₁N₂, tatvayogaviduḥ U₁, tatvayodabimda K₁, tattvayogavicāraḥ V, tatvabimduyoga PLU₂, rājayoge binduyogaḥ E **samāptaḥ** cett.] samāptam LN₂, saṃpūrṇaṃ K₁, vicāraḥ V

Notes: I iti śrīparamarahasyam | śrīrāmacandraviracito 'yaṃ tattvayogabinduḥ samāptaḥ: For the final rubrics and colophons of all consulted manuscripts, see p.27.

Thus, the *Tattvayogabindu* (“The Essence of Yoga and Reality”)⁴⁷⁵ composed by Śrī Rāmacandra, is concluded.

lakṣeśvaro 'pi ca ||4.19|| *koṭīśvaro narendratvaṃ narendraś cakravartitām | cakravarti ca devatvaṃ devo 'pīndratvaṃ icchati* ||4.20|| *indratve 'pi hi saṃprāpte yadīcchā na nivartate | mūle laghīyāṃs tallobhaḥ śārāva iva vardhate* ||4.21|| **hemacandras** (Ed. p. 80) translates “One who is poor [desires] a hundred [rupees]; one who has a hundred [desires] a thousand; one who has a thousand [desires] one hundred thousand, and one who has one hundred thousand [desires] ten million [rupees]. One who rules ten million [people] wishes to be a king of men, a king of men [desires to be a] world-emperor, a world-emperor a god, [and] a god wishes even to be a king of gods. [But] even when one has become the king of gods, [one's] desire does not end [there]. Initially, such greed is rather small, [but over time], it increases [and increases] like a [begging-]bowl, [which at the root is shallow, but which expands more and more from the centre to the edge].” A *cakravartin* is, therefore, a ruler who reigns over the kings of the earth. The nexthigher rank would be that of a god. Thus, the *cakravartin* represents the highest possible secular status that a human being can achieve in terms of power and prosperity. The text further suggests that a king aspires to rise to the rank of a *cakravartin*. Rāmacandra deliberately employs this term to address his target audience. An extensive discussion of Sahajayoga can be found at the end of the comparative analysis of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies on p. 472.

⁴⁷⁵For a discussion of the title, see p. 48. For the reconstruction of the archetypal final rubric, see p. 55.

Chapter 3

Comparative Analysis of the Complex Early Modern Yoga Taxonomies

THE similarities between the yoga taxonomies of Rāmacandra's *Tattvayoga-bindu*, his source text, the *Yogasvarodaya* as well as the taxonomies laid out by Nārāyaṇatīrtha in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* and Sundardās' *Sarvāṅgayogadīpikā* which all emerged between the 16th and 17th centuries have been initially observed and discussed briefly by birch2014 (2014).⁴⁷⁶ I would like to call this specific literary phenomenon the “complex early modern yoga taxonomies of the medieval yogas” or simply “complex yoga taxonomies”. Table 2 provides an overview of the four known complex yoga taxonomies.

No.	<i>Tattvayoga-bindu</i>	<i>Yogasvarodaya</i>	<i>Yogasiddhāntacandrikā</i>	<i>Sarvāṅgayoga-pradīpikā</i>
1.	<i>kriyāyoga</i>	<i>kriyāyoga</i>	<i>kriyāyoga</i>	<i>bhaktiyoga</i>
2.	<i>jñānayoga</i>	<i>jñānayoga</i>	<i>caryāyoga</i>	<i>mantrayoga</i>
3.	<i>caryāyoga</i>	<i>karmayoga</i>	<i>karmayoga</i>	<i>layayoga</i>
4.	<i>haṭhayoga</i>	<i>haṭhayoga</i>	<i>haṭhayoga</i>	<i>carcāyoga</i>
5.	<i>karmayoga</i>	<i>dhyānayoga</i>	<i>mantrayoga</i>	<i>haṭhayoga</i>
6.	<i>layayoga</i>	<i>mantrayoga</i>	<i>jñānayoga</i>	<i>rājayoga</i>
7.	<i>dhyānayoga</i>	<i>urayoga</i>	<i>advaitayoga</i>	<i>lakṣayoga</i>
8.	<i>mantrayoga</i>	<i>vāsanāyoga</i>	<i>lakṣyayoga</i>	<i>aṣṭāṅgayoga</i>
9.	<i>lakṣyayoga</i>	-	<i>brahmayoga</i>	<i>sāṃkhyayoga</i>
10.	<i>vāsanāyoga</i>	-	<i>śivayoga</i>	<i>jñānayoga</i>
11.	<i>śivayoga</i>	-	<i>siddhiyoga</i>	<i>brahmayoga</i>
12.	<i>brahmayoga</i>	-	<i>vāsanāyoga</i>	<i>advaitayoga</i>
13.	<i>advaitayoga</i>	-	<i>layayoga</i>	-
14.	<i>siddhayoga</i>	-	<i>dhyānayoga</i>	-
15.	<i>rājayoga</i>	- [rājayoga]	<i>premabhaktiyoga</i>	-
16.	-	-	[rājayoga]	-

Table 2: The four complex yoga taxonomies

The phenomenon of complex yoga taxonomies raises various questions.

- I. How are the individual yoga categories used and classified in the four texts?

⁴⁷⁶ See birch2014.

2. Do the four texts use and understand the single yogas in the same way, or are there differences?
3. Furthermore, what conclusions can be drawn from answering the previous question in terms of the individual yoga category and in the context of each text?
4. Is there a direct historical connection between all the texts with complex yoga taxonomies, or did they all arise independently?
5. How can the phenomenon of “complex early modern yoga taxonomies of the medieval yogas” be situated within the broader context of the history of yoga?
6. Is it possible to explain why they did emerge?

To answer or at least approach these questions, the complex yoga taxonomies and their single categories of yoga are examined within a comparative analysis. The results will be linked with the recent findings of yoga research.

This chapter will conduct an empirical comparative analysis grounded in the hermeneutics of difference.⁴⁷⁷ It first historicises the objects of comparison—the early modern yoga texts *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*—by placing them in their specific historical and religious contexts. It then instrumentalises the empirically derived concept of “complex early modern yoga taxonomies of the medieval

⁴⁷⁷The term “hermeneutics of difference” should be understood in the context of the German concept “Differenzhermeneutik” as employed by the cultural studies-oriented Heidelberg School of Religious Studies. Here, Differenzhermeneutik refers to an interpretative method, particularly in the comparative study of religions, that seeks to understand and analyze the diversity and distinctiveness of religious expressions. This approach emphasises the context, cultural background, and the differences that shape a religious phenomenon. Instead of searching for universal principles, the focus is on the differences between various religious traditions and practices. Religious phenomena are examined within their specific cultural, historical, and social contexts, thus revealing the particular conditions and circumstances, as well as the internal logic and significance in their emic context, as viewed from an etic perspective. This etic perspective is critically reflected upon, so that the biases and assumptions of the researcher are taken into account. Researchers are encouraged to become aware of their own cultural and religious perspectives and to reflect on their impact on the understanding process.

yogas"⁴⁷⁸ for the intended comparison. This aims to capture the structural and functional similarities and differences between the complex yoga taxonomies and the individual yoga taxa, considering the specific signatures of the texts. The results derived from this will be applied to the questions mentioned above.

The comparison will broaden and clarify our understanding of the respective spectrum of meanings of the individual yoga categories in the discursive field of the authors of the texts containing the taxonomies. Furthermore, the comparison results in the documentation of the discursive web⁴⁷⁹ of word usage of various yoga categories in the 16th and 17th centuries. Additionally, contrasting the single yoga categories used across traditions will sharpen our understanding of the categories themselves, as multiperspectivity will naturally reveal new aspects previously hidden to the eye. Individual yoga categories that do not appear in the list of the *Tattvayogabindu* but are listed in the other texts with complex taxonomies will also be covered and outlined. In addition, yoga categories that do not appear in any of the analysed lists but are nevertheless mentioned in the texts will also be covered. Thus, this comparative study will display the overall picture of all yoga categories used during the period under consideration in an encyclopedic fashion and will serve scholars as a comprehensive reference. However, it is essential to emphasise that the comparison of yoga categories is limited to those texts that contain the complex yoga taxonomies. Although the analysis and comparison of the yoga categories can be extended to other yoga texts, locations, and periods if necessary or valuable, for example, to provide the required context, the restriction on the complex yoga taxonomies is generally maintained to prevent this complex endeavour from going *ad absurdum*.⁴⁸⁰ Ultimately, the

⁴⁷⁸The metalinguistic capturing of this phenomenon, which appears in the mentioned texts, serves to delineate a specific religious-historical phenomenon observed in the 16th and 17th centuries on the Indian subcontinent in certain yoga texts written in Sanskrit and Brajbhāṣā from different traditions. In this comparative study, it serves as the *tertium comparationis*. "Complex" refers to a double-digit number of different yoga categories in an early modern yoga text, compared to the more widespread, less complex medieval yoga taxonomies that describe a single-digit number of yogas.

⁴⁷⁹Spoiler alert: There are astonishing differences!

⁴⁸⁰The historical tracing and analysis of developments in the reception history of the yoga categories presented in the complex taxonomies can be used to generate valuable insights,

comparative analysis of the texts, their authors, and their multiple yoga categories will help to formulate a new, concise hypothesis as to why and under what circumstances the complex yoga taxonomies emerged across traditions, and whether or not they emerged independently of each other.

In striving to avoid the issues highlighted by Jonathan Z. **smith**¹⁹⁸² in his revolutionary essay for the theoretical development of comparative religious studies titled *In Comparison a Magic Dwells* (1982),⁴⁸¹ this work fundamentally follows the approach and methodology of Barbara A. **holdrege**¹⁹⁹⁴. Her comparative model, presented in her essay *Comparative Religion with a Difference* (1994), effectively addresses all the problems of comparative work criticised by Smith.⁴⁸² This work adheres to her method, undergoing modifications tailored to this study in its three phases of analysis.⁴⁸³ These phases are:

1. The historical-religious⁴⁸⁴ contextualisation and content characterisation. Holdrege's first step, the "Historical Interpretation," is adjusted to suit the present topic. In this first step, the comparative objects, i.e., the individual texts, are embedded in their historical and religious contexts, providing an overview of the significant contents. The primary focus is on the individual taxa of the yoga taxonomies in the four texts. The necessary concepts and complexes of ideas for an adequate

as I have demonstrated by the example of the development of the early modern forms of Kriyāyoga into the modern forms of Kriyāyoga, beginning with the lineage of the world-famous Paramahansa Yogānanda; see p. 322 et seqq. Unfortunately, this example made me realise that it is beyond this work's scope to extend this analysis to the history of the reception of each yoga category and term throughout the entire history of yoga, particularly the transition from the early modern to the modern period. Fortunately, other scholars have already done great work in the last decade. A groundbreaking example of the history of Rājayoga is **birch**²⁰¹⁴ (2014), **birch**²⁰¹⁴. Even single yogic techniques can be extremely complex. For an outstanding article on the history of the hathayogic *vajrolīmudrā* see for example **mallinson**^{2018vajrolimudra} (2018), **mallinson**^{2018vajrolimudra}.

⁴⁸¹**smith**¹⁹⁸².

⁴⁸²**holdrege**¹⁹⁹⁴.

⁴⁸³See *ibid.* 1994: 806–812.

⁴⁸⁴The originally termed historical-cultural contextualisation and content characterisation is adapted to the needs of this comparison's specific setting, as this study deals with texts from the same culture but belonging to different religious streams within that culture. The specific tradition from which each text emerges is highly relevant to providing the necessary context of each complex yoga taxonomy.

description and an immanent understanding of the yoga category in each text are considered here. That will be achieved by analysing each individual yoga of each individual text separately.

2. The comparative analysis. Here, the differences and similarities of the “complex early modern yoga taxonomies of the medieval yogas” for each taxon will be highlighted. Within this framework, the constitutive concepts of each text and their tradition, which form the basis for each complex yoga taxonomy, are contrasted.
3. The interpretation of the results. In this final step, the results are applied to the questions posed in the introduction. The significance of the differences and similarities is examined and reflected upon in the context of the introductory questions. That is initially done at the level of individual yogas and finally at the overarching level, considering the results of the comparative analysis phase of all individual yogas.

In summary, this means the following: After describing and contextualising the four texts, the three analysis phases will be conducted for each yoga category mentioned in these texts. The comparative analysis will follow the structure of the individual yogas (the taxa) outlined in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Each yoga will initially be analysed in its context. The order is based on the order of the list in the *Tattvayogabindu*. That is phase one. The results of the descriptions of each yoga will be compared with each other. Some yogas only appear in the taxonomies of *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* but are not explicitly dealt with in the text. At these points, reference is made to this fact, and the analysis is continued based on the explanations of the other taxonomies that describe these yogas. Some yogas only occur in one⁴⁸⁵ or two texts. They will be described, too, and compared if more than one text contains them. The third analysis phase is conducted for each yoga category, which has more than one occurrence in the four texts. This part of the comparison will allow us to answer the questions 1–3 mentioned above. In a concluding step, an overarching third phase of analysis (the conclusion),

⁴⁸⁵In this case, a comparison is impossible. However, they are nonetheless described for an encyclopedic overview.

the overall results of the analysis of the individual yoga categories are summarised, interpreted, and applied to this comparative study's remaining significant questions (4–6 mentioned above).

3.1 Contextualising the four texts with complex yoga taxonomies

THIS section describes the four texts that contain the four known complex yoga taxonomies. The focus will be on characterising the historical and religious background of the texts and their authors. Additionally, an overview of the contents will be presented, along with other relevant facts for this comparison. Finally, the role of the complex yoga taxonomies within each respective text will be highlighted. The analysis of the individual yogas in each text, which follows this section, is always conducted within the specific religious, historical, and social context of the respective text.

3.1.1 *Tattvayogabindu*

The *Tattvayogabindu* has already been extensively contextualised in the introduction of the present work. In the previous chapter it was critically edited for the first time.⁴⁸⁶ It has been established that the *Tattvayogabindu* was composed before 1591 CE⁴⁸⁷ and that it was most likely written somewhere in northern India. Much about the author remains unknown. Rāmacandra's composition reflects the Śaiva orientation of his source texts, but also the religious universalism of Advaita Vedānta. As outlined in the chapter *Rāmacandra's audience*,⁴⁸⁸ the *Tattvayogabindu* was certainly aimed at householders of the affluent segments of the population. Due to numerous text-immanent statements, it is plausible that Rāmacandra's *yogaśāstra* was composed at an unknown royal court to educate aristocrats. If this is true, we must assume that Rāmacandra was employed as a yoga teacher at the royal court. At the very beginning of the text, a complete list of fifteen yogas, presented as meth-

⁴⁸⁶ For a more detailed discussion of the *Tattvayogabindu*, see p. 3.

⁴⁸⁷ The dating of the *Tattvayogabindu* is discussed on p. 6.

⁴⁸⁸ See p. 12 et seqq.

ods of Rājayoga, is provided.⁴⁸⁹ Rāmacandra places Rājayoga at the top of the taxonomy to highlight its overarching position, presenting Rājayoga as a universal category encompassing all other yoga methods. Rāmacandra presents the following taxonomy: 1. Kriyāyoga, 2. Jñānayoga, 3. Caryāyoga, 4. Haṭhayoga, 5. Karmayoga, 6. Layayoga, 7. Dhyānayoga, 8. Mantrayoga, 9. Lakṣyayoga, 10. Vāsanāyoga, 11. Śivayoga, 12. Brahmayoga, 13. Advaitayoga, 14. Siddhayoga, and 15. Rājayoga itself.

3.1.2 *Yogasvarodaya*

The *Yogasvarodaya* is a Sanskrit yoga text of the Rājayoga genre with a distinct Śaiva orientation, which was possibly written in central or south India.⁴⁹⁰ As the *Yogasvarodaya* was the primary source for the compilation of Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*, the *terminus ante quem* for this work can also be set at 1591 CE. Manuscripts of this text have yet to be discovered. We know of its existence only from quotations in other texts. These include primarily the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, which cites 304 verses and a half verse from the *Yogasvarodaya* with reference (*yogasvarodaye*).⁴⁹¹ The *Yogakārnīkā* cites a total of 134 verses with reference (*yogasvarodaye*) and at least four additional verses without reference.⁴⁹² The *shabdakalpadruma* (Ed. p. 501) quotes seven verses of the *Yogasvarodaya* with reference (*iti yogasvarodayaḥ*), which form its entry for the term *haṭhayoga*. There are numerous correspondences between the verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* quoted in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* and the *Yogakārnīkā*. It is, however, very noticeable that many verses attributed to the *Yogasvarodaya* in the *Yogakārnīkā* containing practical instructions for *kumbhakas* or purification techniques (*karmas*) are not found in the quotations of the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*.

⁴⁸⁹See p. 102 and especially table 2 on p. 301 for an overview.

⁴⁹⁰The *Yogasvarodaya* mentions the rivers Godāvarī and Kāverī. I discuss the role of the rivers of the *Yogasvarodaya*, *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* and *Yogasvarodaya* on p. 223, n. 383.

⁴⁹¹Cf. *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, Ed. pp. 831–848.

⁴⁹²The four verses without reference are found in *Yogakārnīkā* 1.210–213 (these overlap with the quotations of the *Yogasvarodaya* in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*). However, it appears to me that at least 1.209–216 must belong to the *Yogasvarodaya*. In this chapter, many verses are not attributed to any text. That is noteworthy since the author Nath Aghorānanda consistently attributes his chosen verses in all other chapters. Additional verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* might precede 1.209.

These same verses are also absent in the *Tattvayogabindu*.⁴⁹³ The texts that quote the *Yogasvarodaya* are good indicators that the *Yogasvarodaya* circulated in India's north-east.⁴⁹⁴

The *Yogasvarodaya* was probably addressing non-celibate householders.⁴⁹⁵ However, some quotations of the *Yogasvarodaya*, particularly one in the *Yogakarnikā*, suggests that the *Yogasvarodaya* might have had enthusiastic ascetics among its readers.⁴⁹⁶

Large parts of the content and the content's structure are similar to those of the *Tattvayogabindu*, except for the few passages where Rāmacandra exclusively relies on the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.⁴⁹⁷ Furthermore, only the quo-

⁴⁹³This suggests the existence of different recensions of the *Yogasvarodaya*—one shorter version without practical instructions for physical techniques and another including them. If this is the case, Rāmacandra used the former as the template for the *Tattvayogabindu*.

⁴⁹⁴The *Prāṇatoṣinī* was written near Calcutta, see *shastrī*1905 (1905). The origin of the *Yogakarnikā* is unknown. The only available printed edition of the *Yogakarnikā* by *yogakarnika* (2004) is based on a manuscript presumably from Benares, see *yogakarnika* 2004: vi. Radhakanta Deva (1784–1867) compiled the *shabdakalpadrūma* in Calcutta. Thus, northeastern India was a significant area for the circulation of the *Yogasvarodaya*.

⁴⁹⁵Cf. *mallinson*2018*vajrolimudra*.

⁴⁹⁶Based on an understanding of *śaktināḍī* as a “powerful channel” or “mighty intestine”, the inclusion of the practice described here may have been way too extreme for householders and could only be aimed at an enthusiastic ascetic audience. That technique is called *nāḍikṣālanam* and described in the *Yogakarnikā* with reference to *yogasvarodaya*. *Yogakarnikā* 4.73–77 (Ed. pp. 58–59; ≈*MallinsonGheranda* 1.21–24; ≈*hathayogasamhitā*1921 2.11–15) reads: *nāḍikṣālanam | kākīmudrāṃ sādhyaitvā pūrayed udaram marut (marutodaram hathayogasamhitā*1921 2.11) | *dhārayed ardham yāmāntam cālayed ardhavartmanā* || 73 || *nābhilagnajale sthitvā śaktināḍīm visarjayet | karābhyām kṣālayen nāḍīm yāvan malavisarjanam* || 74 || *tāvat prakṣālyā nāḍīm ca udare veśayet punaḥ* || 75 || *idaṃ prakṣālanam gopyam devānām api durlabham* || 76 || *kevalam dhautimātreṇa devadeho bhaved dhruvam | yāmārdham dhāraṇāśaktim yāvan no dhārayen naraḥ | bahiṣkṛtam mahādhautam tāvan naiva ca kārayet* || 77 || “(73) Having cultivated the crow-seal, fill the stomach with air, hold it for an hour and a half, then move by the midway [path]. (74) Standing in water up to the navel, draw out the mighty intestine *śaktināḍī*. Wash out the intestine with both hands until all dirt is gone. (75) Having thoroughly washed the intestine, return it to the stomach. (76) This cleansing is so secret that even gods find it difficult to obtain. (77) By this cleansing alone, one certainly achieves the divine body. As long as a man is not able to hold the breath for an hour and a half, he should not perform the externalised great wash (*mahādhautā*).” Further research revealed that this interpretation of *śaktināḍī* is common among Indian scholars, as it is also found in *pureyoga* (1992: 46–47) and additionally in *sahai*1972 (1972: 123). This is reinforced by a reading in *hathayogasamhitā*1921 2.11, which reads *gudavartmanā* instead of *ardhavartmanā* in the context of the preliminary practice called *Kākīmudrā*.

⁴⁹⁷In particular, this concerns *Tattvayogabindu* XLIII on the topic of *avadhūtapuruṣa*, as well as individual passages of cosmogony, such as sections XLVIII, LIII, LIV, LV, LVI, and LVII.

tations in the *Yogakarnīkā* attest that the *Yogasvarodaya* also taught various physical practices not present in the quotations of the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*: detailed description of the *ṣaṭkarmas* (4.40–49, 4.67–80), *kevalakumbhaka* and *pratyāhāra* (6.23–34), instructions for *kumbhaka* (7.1–10, 7.23–28, 7.67–72), and instruction on *khecarimudrā* (8.136–141). Thus, we can assume that these descriptions were much more numerous in the original *Yogasvarodaya*.

The *Yogasvarodaya* presents the fifteen yogas immediately at the beginning of its text. The fifteen yogas are understood, just like in the *Tattvayogabindu*, as equivalent methods of Rājayoga. Of the total fifteen announced yogas, only eight methods of Rājayoga are named in this introduction according to the quotation from the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*. *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* (Ed. p. 831) reads:

atha rājayogaḥ || yogasvarodaye |
īśvara uvāca |
rājayogaṃ pravakṣyāmi śṛṇu sarvatra siddhidam |
guhyād guhyataraṃ devi nānādharmāṃ parāt param ||
rājayogena deveśi nṛpapūjyo bhaven naraḥ |
rājayogī cirāyus ca aṣṭāisvāryamayo bhavet ||
pañcadaśaprakāro'yaṃ rājayogaḥ ||
kriyāyogo jñānayogaḥ karmayogo haṭhas tathā |
dhyānayogo mantrayoga urayogaś ca vāsanā |
rājaty etad brahmavaśīva ebhiś ca pañcadaśadhā |

Now Rājayoga; [as described] in the *Yogasvarodaya*. God said: “I will teach Rājayoga, listen! In every case, it bestows completion. [It is] more secret than secret, oh Goddess, [its] nature is manifold, [and it is] higher than the highest. By means of Rājayoga, oh Goddess, the person is to be praised like a king. The Rājayogin may have a long life, and he may be equipped with the eight [supernatural] powers. This Rājayoga has fifteen varieties: Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Karmayoga, Haṭha[yoga], Dhyānayoga, Mantrayoga, Urayoga⁴⁹⁸ and Vāsanā[yoga]. By [means of] these fifteen [yogas], this [person] who is resting in Brahman shines [like a king].”

⁴⁹⁸The term is discussed on p. 444, n. 906.

Not all of the eight yogas mentioned in the introduction are explained in the course of the text. The yogas treated in the text are: Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Lakṣyayoga, which was not mentioned in the introductory verses, Rājayoga, Haṭhayoga, another form of Jñānayoga, and Aṣṭāṅgayoga, which was also not mentioned in the introduction. Since there is still no complete transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya*, it remains uncertain whether the text ever contained a more comprehensive description of these yogas.

3.1.3 *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

The *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* is an important commentary on Patañjali's *Yogasūtra*. Nārāyaṇatīrtha was a Telugu Brahmin who was born in Kaza in the Guntur district,⁴⁹⁹ a devotee of Kṛṣṇa, a *saṃnyāsin*, a renowned intellectual⁵⁰⁰ and a prolific author.⁵⁰¹ Ko suggested that Nārāyaṇatīrtha flourished between 1600 and 1699.⁵⁰² Birch was able to further narrow down this period to 1659–1690.⁵⁰³ Nārāyaṇatīrtha spent a considerable amount of time in Benares, though the exact period of his stay is currently unclear.⁵⁰⁴

As birch2014 (2014: 414) noted, in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Nārāyaṇatīrtha is likely the first author to integrate the teachings of Haṭhayoga with Pātañjalayoga.⁵⁰⁵ At the beginning of his commentary (1.1), he enumerates fifteen different yogas, which he locates throughout his commentary, particularly in the first two chapters of the *Yogasūtra*.

⁴⁹⁹endo1993.

⁵⁰⁰Later authors like Brahmānanda considered Nārāyaṇatīrtha an authority in the field of yoga, as evidenced by his citation in the *jyotsna* (Ed. p. 6).

⁵⁰¹Nārāyaṇatīrtha composed several commentaries on the *Yogasūtra* and other works in different literary genres. See penn2004.

⁵⁰²endo1993.

⁵⁰³birch2024.

⁵⁰⁴See especially penn2004. A comprehensive study on the life and works of Nārāyaṇatīrtha can be found in Endo endo1993's endo1993 (1993). All excerpts of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* used in this study are based on the following edition: *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (of Nārāyaṇatīrtha). Ed. by Vimalā, Karnāṭak. Chowkhambā Sanskrit Series, No 108. Varanasi: Chowkhambā Sanskrit Series Office, 2000.

⁵⁰⁵The *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* is also the first text in the commentary tradition of Pātañjalayoga to document a proliferation of *āsanas*. In his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 2.46, Nārāyaṇatīrtha lists and describes a total of 38 *āsanas*. A detailed discussion of Haṭhayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* can be found on p. 353 et seqq.

These yogas are as follows: Kriyāyoga, Caryāyoga, Karmayoga, Haṭhayoga, Mantrayoga, Jñānayoga, Advaitayoga, Lakṣyayoga, Brahmayoga, Śivayoga, Siddhiyoga, Vāsanāyoga, Layayoga, Dhyānayoga, and Premabhaktiyoga. Nārāyaṇatīrtha conceptualises all fifteen yogas as valid methods for achieving the overarching goal of Pātañjalayoga, namely *asamprajñātasamādhi*, which he equates with Rājayoga in his commentary on 1.20.⁵⁰⁶

3.1.4 *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Sant Sundardās (1596–1689) was a prominent 17th-century poet and scholar who, as a follower of the Dādūpanth, a religious group named after its founder Dādū, was deeply rooted in the Vaiṣṇava bhakti tradition.⁵⁰⁷ Born in the Būsar line of the Khandelval merchant caste (*Vaiśya*), Sundardās met Dādū at a young age, probably shortly before 1600, and became his disciple.⁵⁰⁸

Together with other Dādūpanthīs, he studied from the age of eleven in Benares under the initial guidance of Jagjivandās, a Brahmin disciple of Dādū, who maintained an ashram near Sundardās's birthplace in Dausa. During this period, he mastered Sanskrit, poetry (*kāvya*), and the prevailing knowledge systems of his time. Sundardās is recognised as the best educated Dādūpanthī of his era.

After completing his education, Sundardās moved to Fatehpur in Rajasthan. He was known as a Sant poet and wrote numerous works,⁵⁰⁹ and his scholarly activities extended to various disciplines.

Sundardās left us with most of his works and transcribed them into a single manuscript in 1685 A.D., just a few years before he died in 1689. This manuscript, known as the *Granthāvalī*, comprises three volumes, with the

⁵⁰⁶ See p. 446 for the passages and a detailed discussion of Rājayoga in the *Yogasiddhānta-candrīkā*.

⁵⁰⁷ For a comprehensive account of Dādū and the Dādūpanth (1544–1603), see horstmann2023shrine.

⁵⁰⁸ horstmann2023shrine.

⁵⁰⁹ A selection of Sundardās' works has been translated by horstmann2023shrine in the book horstmann2023shrine.

Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā in the second volume. This collection contains 38 texts of varying lengths dealing with topics such as *jñāna*, yoga, and the Guru.⁵¹⁰

The *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, written in *Brajbhāṣā*, is a seminal historical document that systematically categorises twelve different yogas. Sundardās's text aims to present yoga as a cohesive, progressive system and reflects his comprehensive understanding of the discipline, which has undoubtedly influenced many contemporary Sants.

The yoga system in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* is divided into three main categories comprising twelve different yogas. Each tetrad consists of four yogas, including the main category which Sundardās presents as an individual yoga itself. The first main category is Bhaktiyoga (2.1–51), including Bhaktiyoga (2.1–15), Mantrayoga (2.16–27), Layayoga (2.28–39), and Carcāyoga (2.40–51). The second category is Haṭhayoga (3.1–52), consisting of Haṭhayoga (3.1–12), Rājayoga (3.13–24), Lakṣayoga (3.25–36), and Aṣṭāṅgayoga (3.37–52). The last category is Sāṃkhyayoga (4.1–50), which includes Sāṃkhyayoga (4.1–12), Jñānayoga (4.13–24), Brahmayoga (4.25–30) and Advaitayoga (4.31–50). Each yoga is assigned approximately the same number of verses, with each main category receiving about fifty stanzas.

Sundardās' system emphasises the interconnectedness and complementarity of these yogas, which all converge towards his ultimate goal of Advaitayoga, his system's final limb (*aṅga*).

Sundardās also describes practices that he rejects (1.12–49). He emphasises his disdain for the six philosophical schools (1.11). In other verses, he shows a strong anti-ritualistic attitude and mocks ritual practices, ascetic performances, Jain rites and quacks. He criticises groups such as the *kāpālikas*, *pāsupatas* and other ascetics and denounces their extreme behaviour.⁵¹¹

⁵¹⁰ burger2014sarvangayogapradipika.

⁵¹¹ For example, Sundardās writes in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 1.34: *kecit kaṇḍa mūla khani khāhīm, ekāeka rahaiṃ bana māhīm kecit kāsāyadika pahiraiṃ, japahīm jāpa paiṭhahīm jala gaharaiṃ* || "Some dig up roots and bulbs and eat them, and live alone in the forest. Others wear saffron robes, recite mantras and sit in deep water." Similarly, in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 1.40, he remarks: *kecit meghāḍambara baiṭhahīm, śīta kāla jalasāi paiṭhahīm | kecit dhūma pāna kari bhūlaiṃ, aumḍhe hoi bṛccha sauṃ jhūlaiṃ* || "Some are staying outside all the time, in the cold season they lie in the water. Some breath smoke [and] digress, [some are] swinging upside down from trees."

He never explains the practices of the latter groups as yogas but as doctrines (*matas*).

Sundardās recognises and distances himself from what he considers heretical and glorifies the teachings of his master, Dādū. His adoration for the Guru is evident in his writings, which are imbued with personal devotion.

3.2 Comparison of the individual yoga categories

WE have observed that although the complex yoga taxonomies are situated in very different texts and religious contexts, they show remarkable similarities. A striking number of the yoga categories covered in these texts overlap. Furthermore, it became clear that all the texts containing the complex yoga taxonomies date from the 16th to 17th centuries CE. As previously announced, the individual yoga categories of the four yoga taxonomies will be compared in the following sections. This comparison will elucidate the spectrum of meanings of the individual yoga categories, expanding our understanding of the discursive web of negotiations across the traditions that propagated and practised these yogas from the 16th to 17th centuries. Contrasting the individual yoga categories across traditions will sharpen our understanding of the categories themselves.

3.3 Kriyāyoga

KRIYĀYOGA, “the yoga of action”, is the first method of Rājayoga within the list of fifteen yogas presented by Rāmacandra and his source text *Yogasvarodaya*. Remarkably, Nārāyaṇatīrtha also positions Kriyāyoga at the first position within the list of fifteen yogas in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. Sundardās, on the other hand, omits Kriyāyoga altogether.

3.3.1 Kriyāyoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*

Since Rāmacandra refers to all fifteen yogas as variants of Rājayoga in his initial definition of yoga, and no explicit hierarchy is recognisable from his formulations in the text, all variants of Rājayoga appear to have been regarded by him as equally effective. All yogas aim towards the same goal: long-term durability of the body (*bahutarakālaṃ śarīrasthitiḥ*). The positioning of Kriyāyoga does not initially provide any information about the efficiency or the assignment of differently talented practitioners to a particular type of

yoga, as was the case in i.e. the widespread fourfold taxonomies.⁵¹² Implicit hierarchical aspects are nevertheless present—although all yoga types are a type of Rājayoga, Rāmacandra nonetheless places Rājayoga in the final and topmost position of his taxonomy. The only apparent reason why Rāmacandra specifies Kriyāyoga as the first yoga seems to be that his primary source text, whose content structure he largely follows, specifies this type of yoga as the first.

Mental waves to be cultivated	Mental waves to be reduced
Patience (<i>kṣamā</i>)	Envy (<i>matsārya</i>)
Discrimination (<i>viveka</i>)	Selfishness (<i>mamatā</i>)
Equanimity (<i>vairāgya</i>)	Cheating (<i>māyā</i>)
Peace (<i>śānti</i>)	Violence (<i>himsā</i>)
Modesty (<i>santoṣa</i>)	Intoxication (<i>madā</i>)
Desirelessness (<i>niṣpraha</i>)	Pride (<i>garvita</i>)
	Lust (<i>kāma</i>)
	Anger (<i>krodha</i>)
	Fear (<i>bhaya</i>)
	Laziness (<i>lajjā</i>)
	Greed (<i>lobha</i>)
	Error (<i>moha</i>)
	Impurity (<i>aśuci</i>)
	Attachment and aversion (<i>rāga dveṣau</i>)
	Disgust and laziness (<i>ghṛṇā lasyā</i>)
	error (<i>bhrānti</i>)
	Deceit (<i>daṁbha</i>)
	Envy (repeatedly) (<i>akṣamā</i>)
	Confusion (<i>bhrama</i>)

Table 3: Mental waves of Rāmacandra’s Kriyāyoga

The *Tattvayogabindu*’s section on Kriyāyoga is brief. Rāmacandra quotes four verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* without attribution, followed by a prose summary. Kriyāyoga is defined as “liberation through [mental] action” (*kriyā-*

⁵¹² According to amaraugh2024prabodha 18–24, Mantrayoga is best suited for the weak, Layayoga for the average, Haṭhayoga for the talented and Rājayoga for the exceptionally talented practitioner. In datta2024 14, one finds the statement that the lowest practitioner should perform Mantrayoga, which is then also referred to as the lowest yoga. mallinson2007 12–28 expands this fourfold scheme of yogas and practitioners with a temporal dimension. The weak practitioner needs twelve years to succeed with Mantrayoga, the average practitioner needs eight years with Laya, the able practitioner six years with Haṭha and the exceptional practitioner three years with Rājayoga.

muktir ayaṃ yogaḥ), emphasizing *mukti* over worldly goals, with the practitioner also attaining “success in one’s own body” (*svaṇḍe siddhidāyakaḥ*). Its method involves restraining mental waves before action, reducing negative and cultivating positive waves.

The practitioner who does this is a *kriyāyogī*. Table 3 details which waves to cultivate or reduce.

3.3.2 Kriyāyoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*

A closer examination of the Kriyāyoga section in the *Yogasvarodaya* reveals Rāmacandra’s reductionism since he excludes significant aspects of the original concept of the *Yogasvarodaya*’s Kriyāyoga.

dhyānapūjādānayaññajapahomādikāḥ kriyāḥ |
kriyāmuktimayo yogaḥ svaṇḍe siddhidāyakaḥ || 1 ||

5 Actions are meditation, ritual veneration, donation, recitation, fire sacrifice, etc. The yoga made of liberation through action[s] bestows success in one’s own body.

yat karomīti saṅkalpaṃ kāryārambhe manaḥ sadā |
tat sāṅgācaraṇaṃ kurvan kriyāyogato bhavet || 2 ||

10 When the mind, when starting an activity, performs the definite intention “I am acting” together with its auxiliaries, then one is devoted to Kriyāyoga.

kṣamāvivekavairāgyaśāntiśantoṣanisprhāḥ |
etad yuktiyuto yo ’sau kriyāyogo nigadyate || 3 ||

Patience, discrimination, equanimity, peace, modesty, desirelessness: The one endowed with these means is said to be a Kriyāyogī.

15 *mātsaryaṃ mamatā māyā hiṃsā ca madagarvitā |*
kāmaḥ krodho bhayaṃ lajjā lobho mohas tathāśuciḥ || 4 ||

² *svaṇḍe siddhidāyakaḥ* TYB] *sapaṇḍisiddhidāyakaḥ* PT, *sapaṇḍisiddhidāyakaḥ* YK

Envy, selfishness, cheating, violence, intoxication and pride, lust, anger, fear, laziness, greed, error, and impurity.

*rāgadveṣau ghrṇālasyaśrāntidambhakṣamābhramāḥ |
yasyaitāni na vidyante kriyāyogī sa ucyate || 5 ||*

5 Attachment and aversion, disgust and laziness, error, deceit, envy [and] confusion: Whoever does not experience these is called a Kriyāyogī.

*sa eva muktaḥ sa jñānī caṇḍināśena īśvaraḥ |
kriyāmuktikaro yo 'sau rājayogaḥ sa muktidaḥ || 6 || (om. YK)*

10 He alone, the wise one, the lord, through the destruction of gruesome [behaviour] who performs the liberation through action[s] is liberated. This Rājayoga is the bestower of liberation.

*yāvan mano layaṃ yāti kṛṣṇe svātmani cinmaye |
bhaved iṣṭamanā mantri japahomau samabhyaset || 7 ||⁵¹³ (om. YSv)*

15 Until the mind enters absorption into Kṛṣṇa, in one's own self, which is consciousness, the mantra practitioner (*mantrin*) should practise recitation and fire sacrifice with a valid mind.

*vidite paratattve tu samastair niyamair alam |
tālavr̥ntena kiṃ kāryaṃ labdhe malayamārute || 8 ||⁵¹⁴ (om. YSv)*

20 When the highest principle has been realised, forget all the *niyamas*. Why should one wave the palm frond when the wind from the Himalayas has already reached?

*tāvat karmāṇi kurvanti yāvaj jñānaṃ na vidyate |
jñāne jāte pareśāni karmākarma na vidyate || 9 || (om. YSv)*

25 Actions are performed, as long as knowledge is lacking. When knowledge ensues, oh, Supreme Goddess, neither action nor non-action is known.

⁵¹³7ab ≈ rudrayamala 1937 38.58cd.

⁵¹⁴≈ kularnavatantra 9.28 & yuktabhavadeva 1.80.

These verses⁵¹⁵ stem from the only two currently available sources of the *Yogasvarodaya*, namely the quotations from the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*⁵¹⁶ and the *Yogakarṇikā*.⁵¹⁷ The quotations of both texts essentially correspond, but the last verses of the passage differ. It cannot be ruled out that the last three verses of the *Yogakarṇikā* in particular come from a different source and were not present within the *Yogasvarodaya*. However, their content is so closely interwoven with the preceding verses that this scenario can be considered unlikely.

The main difference to the Kriyāyoga that Rāmacandra has constructed from these verses is the definition of the actions (*kriyāḥ*) mentioned immediately at the beginning of the verses, of which the actions (*kriyās*) of Kriyāyoga are predominantly composed, namely of (1) meditation, (2) ritual worship of God, (3) offerings, (4) recitation and (5) fire sacrifice, etc. Furthermore, while Rāmacandra declares the elements mentioned in the table 3 as waves (*kallola*) of the mind which are either required to be cultivated or reduced before any action is executed, the same elements are conceptualised in the *Yogasvarodaya* as the intentions (*saṅkalpa*) preceding the previously defined actions (*kriyās*), which should be observed.

In the three verses concluding this section, which are only handed down in the *Yogakarṇikā*, the practitioner is referred to as *mantrin* and should perform recitation and fire offerings until entering absorption (*laya*).

A possible historical link, particularly in front of the Vaiṣṇava background, is the model of Kriyāyoga as found in the *Uddhavaḡita*⁵¹⁸ which is a part of the famous *Bhāḡavatapurāṇa*.⁵¹⁹ Here, in chapter XXII.1–55 Kṛṣṇa describes a Vaiṣṇava form of Kriyāyoga in response to a request by his disci-

⁵¹⁵The numbering used here was introduced by me for practical reasons and does not correspond to the original numbering of the verses in the citations of the source texts. The *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* does not number the verses at all. The verses can be found in the printed edition of the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* on p. 831. The verses here are in the *Yogakarṇikā* with the numbering 1.209–216 and can be found in the edition on p. 17.

⁵¹⁶A considerable part of the *Yogasvarodaya* is quoted with reference “*yogasvarodaye*”.

⁵¹⁷Normally the *Yogakarṇikā* quotes its sources. This passage is one of the few exceptional cases in which the verses have been taken from the *Yogasvarodaya* without citing the source. However, this passage ends after verse 1.216 with “*iti yogasaṅketāḥ*”.

⁵¹⁸See e.g., *uddhavaḡita*2007.

⁵¹⁹See e.g., *bhagavata*.

ple Uddhava. The practice entails a very complex and devotional ceremonial veneration of the deity through offerings such as flowers and food, accompanied by the recitation of prescribed mantras, meditation, and the ritual consecration of the deity, among other rites. According to the text, this type of yoga is the most beneficial for women and the working class (22.4) and is considered a means for liberation from the fetters of Karma (22.5). The Kriyāyoga described here is presented to be in line with both the Vedas and the Tantras, considering enjoyment (*bhukti*) and liberation (*mukti*) and is promised to bestow perfection in both this life and the next, by the Lord's grace (22.49).

Furthermore, this concept of Kriyāyoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* might be related to the ritual domain designated as *kriyā* in Śaiva tantric traditions. Śaiva Siddhānta scriptures are commonly associated with the four domains of *jñāna*, *kriyā*, *yoga*, and *caryā*. This conceptual tetrad should not, however, be confused with a fixed four-*pāda* textual structure. As Goodall has shown, such a fourfold textual division is attested only in a limited number of works and may in individual cases represent a secondary organisation of the textual material.⁵²⁰

The occurrence of Jñānayoga, Kriyāyoga, and Caryāyoga as separate categories within the fifteenfold yoga taxonomy nevertheless invites comparison with this familiar Śaiva tetrad. The parallel is therefore more safely located at the level of the four domains of Śaiva teaching and practice than at the level of a fixed four-*pāda* textual structure. In particular, the *kriyās* mentioned at the beginning of the *Yogasvarodaya*—meditation, ritual veneration, donation, recitation, fire sacrifice, and so forth—show clear affinities with the ritual sphere conventionally designated by *kriyā* in Śaiva scriptures, which includes initiation (*dikṣā*), ritual worship, mantra practice, and related procedures. *Prāṇāyāma*, meditation, *mudrās*, *maṇḍalas*, and *mantras* may also occur within this ritual context.⁵²¹ The other component, however, namely the cultivation

⁵²⁰ See goodall1998.

⁵²¹ A number of Śaiva Tantras have now been translated, either completely or in substantial part. These include the *svayambhuva*1994, *ajitamahatantra*2005, *kiranatantra*1998, *raurava*2000, *nisvasa*2015, *mrghendrahulin*1980, and the *Śatika-Kālottara*. With the exception of the *Ajita mahātāntra*. Four of these works have been translated completely, although

or reduction of particular mental configurations preceding action (*saṅkalpa*) or mental waves (*kallola*), has not yet been located in the Śaiva sources examined. It may instead reflect a simplified adaptation of the Pātañjala model of Kriyāyoga.

3.3.3 Kriyāyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

The Kriyāyoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's commentary on *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* entitled *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* presents Kriyāyoga as the first of his fifteen yogas, which he locates in Pātañjalayoga.⁵²² The term Kriyāyoga occurs in *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 2.1. According to the introduction to this *sūtra*, in the *bhāṣya*-part of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, Kriyāyoga is the means by which someone with a distracted mind can also attain yoga (*vyutthitacitto 'pi yogayuktaḥ*). In *yogasutra* 2.1, Kriyāyoga is defined as follows:

tapahsvādhyāyeśvarapraṇidhānāni kriyāyogaḥ |

Kriyāyoga consists of austerity, the self-study and devotion to the supreme lord.

Kriyāyoga, or “yoga of action”, is the action-oriented method of yoga consisting of three elements, namely, austerity (*tapas*), which according to the *bhāṣya* should be practised both mentally and physically, the repetition of *mantras* or the study of sacred literature (*svādhyāya*) and devotion to the supreme lord (*īśvarapraṇidhāna*). According to *yogasutra* 2.2, these three elements of Kriyāyoga should lead the practitioner to attain *samādhi* by reducing the so-called *kleśas*. This explanatory model is picked up by Nārāyaṇatīrtha.⁵²³ The five *kleśas* consist of ignorance (*avidyā*), self-centredness (*asmitā*), attachment (*rāga*), aversion (*dveṣa*) and fear of death

only one is a Tantra divided into *pādas*; on the problems surrounding this fourfold textual division, see goodall1998. The first half of the *Mṛgendra* was translated into French by mrgendrahulin1980 (1980); mrgendragama's 1962 publication provides the Sanskrit edition.

⁵²²For an earlier brief discussion of Kriyāyoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *yogacandrika* see penna2004.

⁵²³*yogacandrika*.

(*abhiniveśa*). All three main components of Patañjali's Kriyāyoga are not mentioned in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*. Nevertheless, a practice similar to the reduction of the *kleśas* can also be found here. Although the specific fear of death (*abhiniveśa*) is not mentioned, the more general term for fear (*bhaya*) is cited.⁵²⁴ The Kriyāyoga of the *Tattvayogabindu* could, therefore, be perhaps regarded as a degenerated or simplified variant of the Pātañjalean model, which restricts itself predominantly to the aspect of the reduction of negative waves of the mind, which is comparable to the reduction of *kleśas* and adds the aspect of cultivating positive mind waves to the mix. In both systems, Kriyāyoga is a means for liberation.⁵²⁵

3.3.4 Kriyāyoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Kriyāyoga within the complex yoga taxonomies reveals two distinct models. One is Nārāyaṇatīrtha's model, which draws directly on the Kriyāyoga of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*. The other, attested in sixteenth-century texts such as the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu*, appears to combine elements derived from Śaiva ritual traditions with a concern for the cultivation and reduction of mental configurations that is loosely comparable to the Pātañjala model.

The specifically defined *kriyās* of the *Yogasvarodaya* show clear affinities with the ritual domain conventionally designated as *kriyā* in Śaiva traditions, while the cultivation and reduction of mental configurations before action may reflect a simplified adaptation of the Kriyāyoga of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*. The occurrence of Kriyāyoga, Caryāyoga, and Jñānayoga within the fifteenfold taxonomy is also suggestive when compared with the familiar Śaiva categories of *kriyā*, *caryā*, *jñāna*, and *yoga*. This correspondence need not presuppose dependence on a fixed four-*pāda* textual structure, but it strengthens the possibility that the taxonomy developed within an intellec-

⁵²⁴The details of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's understanding of Kriyāyoga have already been discussed by pennazoo4 (2004: 62–66) and will therefore not be covered here again.

⁵²⁵The Kriyāyoga of the *yogasutra* will not be dealt with in detail here, as this has already been done in countless academic and informal publications. For the *sūtras* related to Kriyāyoga and Patañjali's autocommentary in Sanskrit with English translation, see *yogasutra*. For a comprehensible and more accessible overview, see bryant2009.

tual environment in which Śaiva classifications of religious knowledge and practice were familiar.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha, as a proponent of Pātañjalayoga, therefore seems unlikely to have originated the fifteenfold taxonomy. Rather, he appears to have incorporated an already circulating classification into the framework of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, presenting the various forms of yoga current in his intellectual milieu as aspects of the authoritative Pātañjala system.

3.3.5 Excursus: Popularisation of a new Kriyāyoga in a global context

⁵²⁶The comparatively unique treatises on Kriyāyoga, which can only be found in the yoga literature of the 16th-century⁵²⁷ in *Yogasvarodaya* and Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*, which deviate from the Pātañjala model, albeit not entirely, and, as shown, show clear influences of tantric origin, can be regarded as marginal phenomena, or, a rather short-lived intellectual trend, for the time being. The briefly touched upon model of *Uddhavaḡitā*, which describes a Kriyāyoga method for *mukti* and *bhukti* through ritual worship of god, is also comparatively rare in the literature. The overwhelming majority of the Sanskrit yoga texts written in the second millennium CE, as in the case of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, are based on the model of Kriyāyoga propagated in the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* and the commentary literature. Accordingly, it was above all the publication of the *Yogasūtra* in the West, beginning with the translation by Henry Thomas Colebrooke in 1805,⁵²⁸ which ensured that the concept of Kriyāyoga contained therein also dominated the understanding of the term in academic and informal discourse in the West for a long time.

⁵²⁶This excursus was created primarily for my personal research interest and is irrelevant to the comparative analysis conducted here. One can safely ignore this section if one is not interested in this topic. Since Paramahansa Yogānanda's *Autobiography of a Yogi* was one of the first books I read on the subject of yoga, I became curious about how exactly Yogānanda's Kriyāyoga is historically located and whether there is a historical connection between the early modern forms of Kriyāyoga and the modern forms of Kriyāyoga.

⁵²⁷The terminus *ante quem* for the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* is 1591 CE, see p. 6 for the details.

⁵²⁸See [colebrooke2014](#) for a detailed discussion.

The Western discourse only changed with the global success and popularity of Paramahansa Yogānanda (1893–1952) and the *Self Realisation Fellowship* he founded in 1920, which, measured against the predecessor models forms of Kriyāyoga outlined above, spread an innovative yoga practice under the generic term Kriyāyoga. The influence of Yogānanda and others significantly changed and expanded the range of meanings of the term Kriyāyoga. In addition to various books published by Yogānanda, it was above all, the book **autobioyogi**, the autobiography of Yogānanda himself, published in 1946, which paved the way for Yogānanda's success. To this day, this work is considered a classic in popular yoga literature, has been in print for over seventy years and has been translated into more than 50 languages.⁵²⁹ It retains a significant global following even now. Yogānanda, his books, his followers and the numerous books written by his followers have popularised this innovative and new form of Kriyāyoga beyond the Indian subcontinent. The term Kriyāyoga was allegedly already defined by Yogānanda's predecessors, namely Lahīḍi Mahāśaya (1828–1895) and Śrī Yukteśvar Giri (1855–1936), as the central generic term for the yoga practice of this specific lineage.⁵³⁰

One of Yogānanda's contemporaries was Svāmī Śivānanda Sarasvatī (1887–1963), who similarly propagated a new form of Kriyāyoga. Although his Kriyāyoga was initially based mainly on the Pātāñjalayoga model, it was expanded under the same umbrella term with Haṭhayoga practices and possibly influenced by Yogānanda's model. This expansion and integration of new practices under the umbrella term Kriyāyoga was continued by his students, above all Svāmī Satyānanda Sarasvatī (1923–2009), the founder of the famous *Bihar School of Yoga* (since 1962).

The resulting popularity of Kriyāyoga triggered a global wave and inspired others, who in turn developed similar but sometimes differently nuanced Kriyāyoga systems. One example is S. A. A. Ramaiah, who founded the *Kriya Babaji Yoga Sangam* in 1952. In this case, too, there is a global following.⁵³¹

⁵²⁹ See yoganandawebsite.com.

⁵³⁰ govindan2010.com.

⁵³¹ kriyababajiyoga.com.

It was the actors mentioned above, above all Yogānanda, who ensured the global popularisation of this new form of Kriyāyoga so that their concepts are at least as well known in recent public discourse, if not better known, than the Kriyāyoga of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*.

These new forms of Kriyāyoga, which can only be traced from the beginning of the 19th century, are, as will be shown, a reservoir for innovative combinations and further developments of numerous practices already codified in yoga texts in the medieval to pre-colonial period, which were integrated into seemingly coherent practice systems by actors such as Yogānanda, Śivānanda, Ramaiah, etc. The statements made by their traditions about the historicity of their yoga practice utilise established narratives to lend this form of Kriyāyoga a tradition and historical legitimacy.⁵³²

3.3.6 The Kriyāyogas of the lineages of Paramahansa Yogānanda, Svāmī Śivānanda Sarasvatī and Ramaiah

So what constitutes these new forms of Kriyāyoga? To answer this question, recent publications on this topic were consulted.⁵³³ The following is a brief outline of the main features of the Yogānanda, Śivānanda and Ramaiah models of Kriyāyoga without claiming to be exhaustive. To my knowledge, a comprehensive and complete historical study of Kriyāyoga has not yet been carried out and cannot be done within this framework. This attempt is an outline and should be understood as a first approach to the topic in order to differentiate between the models circulating in public discourse on the one

⁵³²For example, tracing back yoga traditions to a legendary founding figure, the master's stay in the Himalayas, lost writings that suddenly reappear and legitimise the yoga practices can also be found in similar forms in other traditions. For example, in the lineage of T. Krishnamacharya. See [singleton2013gurus](#).

⁵³³This list is certainly not exhaustive. Nevertheless, I have consulted a wide range of these publications available to me. 1. For the Yogānanda model: [autobioyogi's autobioyogi](#) (1949); [kriyayogalowenstein's kriyayogalowenstein](#) (2021); [kriyayogasarasvatii981's kriyayogasarasvatii981](#) (1981); [hariharananda1989's hariharananda1989](#) (1989); [kriyayogaupanishad1993's kriyayogaupanishad1993](#) (1993) and [kriyayogasturgess2015's kriyayogasturgess2015](#) (2015). 2. For the Śivānanda model: [shivanandakriyai982's shivanandakriyai982](#) (1955) and [kriyayoganityananda2013's kriyayoganityananda2013](#) (2013). 3. For the Ramaiah model: [govindan2010's govindan2010](#) (2010).

hand and, on the other, to formulate a hypothesis on the transition from the older models to the newer models, as these are very close in time.

3.3.6.1 Definitions

The publications consulted contain various creative etymologies and explanations of the term Kriyāyoga. **hariharananda1989**, a Kriyāyoga teacher authorised by Yogānanda⁵³⁴ himself explains in his book **hariharananda1989** (1989):

'Kriya Yoga' are Sanskrit words, a combination of two root words. One is Kriya and the other is yoga. In the word Kriya there are two syllables: kri and ya. Kri means to pursue your work in daily life and ya means to be ever aware of the invisible God who is abiding in you and is directing and accomplishing work through you. ...The second word, 'yoga,' literally means union of the visible body with the invisible body. This union is always present in everyone.⁵³⁵

Another etymology of the term *kriyā* can be found in the book **kriyayogalowenstein** (2021):

...kri meaning "work" and ya meaning "soul" or "breath" = The Work to be done with the Soul's breath.⁵³⁶

The most complex explanation of the term can be found in the book **kriyayoganityananda2013** of **kriyayoganityananda2013**, who also situates himself in the Yogānanda tradition:

The word *kriyā* is composed of the letters *k*, *r*, *i*, *y*, and *ā*. The letter -*k* (or *ka*), *ka-kāra*, represents the Lord, *Īśvara*. The Transcendental Lord, *Parama Śiva*, when he manifests Himself in the subtle world and makes Himself ready for creation He becomes *Īśvara*. The

⁵³⁴ **hariharananda1989**.

⁵³⁵ See **hariharananda1989**.

⁵³⁶ **kriyayogalowenstein**.

letter-*r* (or *ra*), *ra-kāra*, represents fire, light and manifestation. Creation is not seen by us with the ether and air elements since these are subtle elements. We are able to see manifestation from the fire element onwards. The letter -*i*, *i-kāra*, represents energy or *śakti*. So *kri* is the activating power of the Lord manifested in creation. The activating power is called *prāṇa* or vital force. The letter -*y* (or *ya*), *ya-kāra*, represents the air element and the letter -*ā*, *ā-kāra*, represents form. For the manifestations to take a form, *ākāra*, the Lord acts with the air element. With the ether element there is no form. The air element or gaseous state is the first created form although we only see the forms from the fire element onwards. Through the action of air the whole universe is manifested. This is the action of the Life-force, *prāṇakarma*, of the Lord. The word *kriyā* normally means action, but this is the action of god. We are made with the same principle God is. Our identification with the physical body makes us separate from God and this is the state of ignorance. We have to eradicate this ignorance by the action of God, i.e., the action of the breath, *prāṇakarma*. Our mind is the result of ignorance and is responsible for the wrong identification. Breath-practice, *prāṇakarma*, absorbs the mind into the vital force. This action of God reverses the process and leads us from body to God. This is why it is so necessary to perform that action. That is our spiritual practice. Then that action, *kriyā*, becomes yoga.⁵³⁷

kriyayogasarasvati1981 Sarasvati, an important proponent of the Śivānanda model, defines Kriyāyoga in his book **kriyayogasarasvati1981** (1981) as follows:

The Sanskrit word *kriya* means ‘action’ or ‘movement’. *Kriya Yoga* is so called because it is a system where one intentionally rotates one’s attention along fixed pathways. This movement of awareness is done, however with control. Also *kriya yoga* is so

⁵³⁷**kriyayoganityananda2013**.

called because one moves the body into specific mudras, bandhas and asanas according to a fixed scheme of practice. The word *kriya* is often translated as meaning 'practical'. This is indeed a good definition, for kriya yoga is indeed practical. It is concerned solely with practice, without the slightest philosophical speculation. The system is designed to bring results, not merely to talk about them. Sometimes the word *kriya* is translated as 'preliminary'. This too is a good definition, for kriya yoga is a preliminary practice that leads first to dharana and then eventually to the transcendental state of dhyana (meditation) and yoga (union). It is a technique which has been designed to lead to that state of being which is beyond all techniques. Finally, the word *kriya* is used to describe each individual practice. Thus the process of kriya yoga consists of a number of kriyas each being done one after the other in a fixed sequence.⁵³⁸

In the book **govindan2010** (2010), Govindan, a student of Ramaiah, offers a simple explanation of the term:

Kriyā is an activity performed with mindfulness.⁵³⁹

As different as the concepts presented here may seem, they have in common that they are about consciously performed actions or practices that connect people with God or are intended to bring about a transcendent state, a state of yoga. In his definition, Nityānanda defines the central action (*kriyā*) that should lead to a connection with God, namely breathing practice (*prāṇakarma*). Satyānanda associates other practices with the term such as directing attention, *mudrās*, *bandhas* and *āsanas*.

Further definitions can be found in the consulted texts. However, these are sufficient for the purposes here, as they illustrate the basic idea of the new models of Kriyāyoga on the one hand and show the fundamental diversity and openness of the model, which permeates all areas of these new forms of Kriyāyoga, on the other.

⁵³⁸ **kriyayogasarasvati1981**.

⁵³⁹ **govindan2010**.

3.3.6.2 Histories of the new forms of Kriyāyoga from an emic perspective

kriyayoganityananda2013, who places himself in the lineage of Yogānanda, explains that Kriyāyoga is an eternal tradition that stands at the beginning of human history. He explains that this is why many of the scriptures, such as the *Śivasūtrā*, the *Āgamas* and the writings of the Siddhas, teach the techniques and principles of Kriyāyoga in many different ways. Moreover, remnants of this primal Kriyāyoga can be found in almost all philosophies, be it Buddhism, Jainism, Sāṃkhya, Vaiśeṣika, Nyāya, Mimāṃsā or Vedānta.⁵⁴⁰

Satyānanda (1981: 699), the founder of the *Bihar school of Yoga*, explains that there is no history of Kriyāyoga and that its origins and development have been lost. Furthermore, the system of Kriyāyoga was so secret that there is not even a myth to explain its origin. Next, he describes that parts of the Kriyāyoga taught by him are contained in the texts of Haṭhayoga, such as *āsanas*, *mudrās* and *bandhas*, but that these are not “integrated together”. Satyānanda speculates that Kriyāyoga must have been known in China, as he sees strong parallels to practices in *Tai Chi Chuan*. He clearly distances himself from the Kriyāyoga of the *Yogasūtra*, which has nothing to do with the Kriyāyoga of his book **kriyayogasarasvati1981** and serves solely as a preparation for Rājayoga. However, the only definitive historical statement he can commit himself to is the following:

Of history, all we will say is that kriya yoga was passed on by Swami Sivananda of Rishikesh.⁵⁴¹

Surprisingly, this same Śivānanda of Rishikesh in his book **shivanandakriya1982** (1955) explicitly traces the Kriyāyoga he taught back to *Yogasūtra* 2.1. Śivānanda uses the Kriyāyoga of the *Yogasūtra* as the overarching framework of his teaching, which also integrates *śaṭkarma* and breathing exercises from Haṭhayoga into it.⁵⁴²

⁵⁴⁰ **kriyayoganityananda2013**.

⁵⁴¹ **kriyayogasarasvati1981**.

⁵⁴² See **shivanandakriya1982**.

It is important to emphasise that Satyānanda recognises that the traditional lineage of Yogānanda practises the same Kriyāyoga he teaches. However, he explicitly distances himself from their narrative:

Of course, there are various other groups of people in India who have practiced and taught kriya yoga. For example, Swami Yogananda, Yukteshwar Giri, Lahiri Mahasaya, Mahatma Gandhi and so forth practiced kriya yoga. In fact, a thriving organization still propagates it throughout the world. They also do not know the origin of kriya yoga, but they say that it was reintroduced by the great yogi Babaji as the ideal practice for sincere seekers of wisdom in the present Kali Yuga (Dark Age).⁵⁴³

This narrative is by far the most widespread explanation of the origins of the new Kriyāyoga and is adopted not only in the tradition of Yogānanda, but also in the tradition of Ramaiah. In his book *govindan* 2010 (2010: 31–64), Govindan, a disciple of Ramaiah, has compiled this narrative in detail, which I would now like to summarise in a nutshell.

Mahāvātara Bābājī, who according to Govindan is considered an incarnation of the Buddha, was born in 203 CE in Parangipetta in Tamil Nadu under the name Najaraj into a Brahmin family, joined a group of wandering Saṃnyāsins at a young age and studied the holy scriptures. His path soon led him to Śrī Laṅka in Katirkāma (now Kataragama), where he became a disciple of Siddha Boganathar and was initiated by him into various *kriyās* such as *dhyāna*, *āsana*, *mantra* and *bhaktiyoga*. Bhoganathar later sent Bābājī to another teacher, namely Siddha Agastya in Courtallam in the Pothihai hills of Tamil Nadu, located in today's Tinnevely district. He learnt the particularly important *kriyā* called *kuṇḍalinīprāṇāyāma* from him. Agastya then sent Bābājī to Badrinath in the Himalayas, where he practised for many months and finally attained *samādhi*. After his enlightenment and attaining immortality at the tender age of 16, Bābājī set himself the task of helping suffering humanity in its search for God-realisation. As an immortal, Bābājī initiated great personalities such as Śaṅkarācārya (788–820) and Kabīr (1440–1518)

⁵⁴³kriyayogasarasvati1981.

into the techniques of Kriyāyoga over the centuries. Finally, in 1861, he initiated Lahiḍi Mahāśaya (1828–1895) into Kriyāyoga and gave him the task of passing it on to serious seekers. At this point, Govindan quotes the autobiography of Yogānanda,⁵⁴⁴ which states that Bābājī explained to Lahiḍi Mahāśaya that Kṛṣṇa had once passed on Kriyāyoga to Arjuna and that not only Patañjali knew it, but also Jesus Christ, who in turn had passed it on to John, Paul and other disciples. Among Lahiḍi Mahāśaya's 100 disciples was Śrī Yukteśvar (1855–1936), to whom Bābājī is also said to have appeared three times. On one of these occasions, Bābājī decided that he should send his disciple Yogānanda (1893–1952) to America to spread Kriyāyoga, which he did, gaining global fame and founding the *Self Realisation Fellowship* in 1920, which is still very active today.

3.3.6.3 The practice of the new Kriyāyoga

In the following, the practices of the new Kriyāyoga are presented in outline based on the publications mentioned and consulted above.⁵⁴⁵ The words of **hariharananda1989** (1989: 144) are surprisingly apt to give an essential first impression of this complex phenomenon:

Kriya Yoga is the essence and synthesis of all yoga techniques taught in the world.

kriyayogasarasvati1981 (1981: 703) explains that each Kriyā consists of a certain number of subordinate techniques. These always consist of a combination of the following six tools: *āsana*, *mudrā*, *bandha*, *mantra*, *prāṇāyāma* and, as he calls it, “psychic passage awareness”. This last point includes a group of exercises mainly involving “circulating awareness through the *cakras* in an ascending and descending way” or similar. A single Kriyā is an exercise unit comprising individual exercises from the six categories mentioned.

⁵⁴⁴ **autobiogyogi**.

⁵⁴⁵ A comprehensive presentation and comparative analysis of the practices in the various traditions of the new Kriyāyoga would be too far-reaching for this chapter. The most detailed written practice instructions that I have consulted can be found for the Śivānanda/Satyānanda model in **kriyayogasarasvati1981**, and for the Yogānanda model in **kriyayoganityananda2013**.

However, these are not arbitrary but are integrated into a specific, and, as the protagonists of this tradition say “scientific way” in order to induce the process of concentration (*dhāraṇā*), meditation (*dhyāna*) and meditative absorption (*samādhi*). The main distinguishing feature from other yoga systems is the innovative and specific combination of the individual techniques into a practical and particularly effective sequence of exercises, referred to here as “Kriyā”.

In every model the individual exercises are drawn from the vast body of yoga literature but primarily from the exercises taught in the medieval to pre-colonial texts of the Haṭha- and Rājayoga genre. This always takes place against the background of tantric and medieval concepts of the yogic body, such as *cakra*, *nāḍī* and *vāyu* systems. A common phenomenon in the new Kriyāyoga literature are scientific explanatory models that are used as a means of legitimisation. For example, certain *nāḍīs* are located in schematic sketches of the brain⁵⁴⁶, or positive effects of Kriyāyoga practice are legitimised with evolutionary biology theories, such as the polyvagal theory.⁵⁴⁷

govindan2010 (2010: 216–225) distinguishes a total of seven main categories of Kriyāyoga. The first category he mentions is *Kriya Hatha Yoga*. According to him, this is the starting point for every student of Kriya Yoga. This includes eighteen basic relaxation postures (*āsanas*), muscle blocks (*bandhas*), certain gestures (*mudrās*) and the sun salutation (*sūryanamaskāra*) defined by Bābājī.

The second main category is what **govindan2010** calls *Kriya Kundalini Pranayama*. According to him, this practice is the art and science of mastering the breath and is considered to be the most essential and effective tool in Bābājī’s Kriyāyoga. This is not only meant to awaken the *kuṇḍaliṇī* but with regular practice, the student awakens all *cakras* and the associated levels of consciousness, which is supposed to ultimately lead to the breathless state of *samādhi* and self-realisation.

⁵⁴⁶ **kriyayoganityananda2013**.

⁵⁴⁷ **kriyayogalowenstein**.

The third main category is *Kriya Dhyana Yoga*, which is intended to include meditation techniques that are not explained in detail but are supposed to awaken the mind's hidden faculties.

The fourth main category is *Kriya Mantra Yoga*. This involves the recitation or murmuring (*japa*) of mantras discovered by the Siddhas. The recitation of mantras must take place with faith, love and concentration.

govindan2010 specifies the fifth category as *Kriya Bhakti Yoga*, the yoga of love and devotion. In **govindan2010**'s words, this is the "turbojet" of self-realisation. This type of Kriyāyoga includes devotional love, chanting, ritual worship and pilgrimages to holy places.

Furthermore, *Kriya Karma Yoga* is presented as the sixth category. In this case he refers to **kaushik1993** (2.47 et seqq.) and thus defines this subtype as selfless service that is performed consciously. All actions are supposed to be performed without the expectation of receiving anything in return, free from anger, selfishness, greed and personal desires. Thus, the practitioner is meant to examine his motivation before every action and is always supposed to act without selfish motives.

The seventh and final category is *Kriya Tantra Yoga*. According to this, the followers of Kriyāyoga, just like the Siddhas, lead a family life. This subtype of Kriyāyoga involves retaining the energy normally wasted during sexual activity and transporting it to the higher *cakras*. The partner is supposed to be loved as an embodiment of the divine.

A similar system is taught by **kriyayogalowenstein**. This initially includes a total of twelve *āsanas* and the five Tibetans, as well as typical *prāṇāyāma* techniques, *ujjāyī*, *kapālabhātī*, various *bandha* techniques such as *uḍḍiyānabandha* or *mahābandha*, various *mudrā* techniques such as *mahāmudrā*, *śāmbhavīmudrā*, *yonimudrā*, or the so-called *Kriya Breath*. *Kriya Breath* is referred to as *kevalakumbhaka*. In addition, classical gymnastic exercises are also added.⁵⁴⁸ In addition to the *āsanas* of Haṭhayoga, **kriyayogalowenstein** also recommend *Tai Chi*, *Qigong*, physiotherapy or a personal trainer to stay fit. Now and then, a biblical quotation is used. For example, in the case

⁵⁴⁸**kriyayogalowenstein**.
kriyayogasturgess2015.

Gymnastic exercises can also be found in

of the *Third Eye Gazing* practice, he quotes Matthew (6.22). Furthermore, **kriyayogalowenstein** emphasise the practice of *Hong Sau* as an important element of the practice. For **kriyayoganityananda2013**, *Hong Sau*, or in this case the indologically correct transliteration *haṃsa*, is also referred to by him as *Haṃsa Sādhanā*,⁵⁴⁹ “the very foundation” of Kriyāyoga.

As indicated at the beginning of this section, it is clear that the term Kriyāyoga has given rise to a proliferation of different yoga techniques from earlier yoga traditions, which are integrated into innovative exercise systems and attempted to be historically legitimised in different ways. Depending on the lineage and the teacher, individual characteristics and different explanatory models exist.⁵⁵⁰

One last exemplary publication is **kriyayogaupanishad1993** (1993) by **kriyayogaupanishad1993**. This book offers translations of ten well-known *Yoga Upaniṣads* and one *Kriya Yoga Upanishad*. The translator claims that the name of the author of this Sanskrit Yoga Upaniṣad was lost in the course of history. His book has no bibliography, nor are the sources of the translations mentioned. Further searches for a verifiable source text of the *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* remain unsuccessful. The *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* is neither to be found in the known publications and translations of the *Yoga Upaniṣads*,⁵⁵¹ nor in publications of previously unpublished Upaniṣads.⁵⁵² Searching through various catalogues of Sanskrit manuscripts was also unsuccessful.⁵⁵³ Fur-

⁵⁴⁹The *ajapājapa*, recitation of the non-recitation of the *haṃsa* mantra.

⁵⁵⁰In these books, one repeatedly comes across pseudo-scientific explanatory models and stumbles across parallels drawn here and there to other religions, such as Christianity, Buddhism, or esoteric traditions to emphasise the effectiveness and importance of certain practices and views. Particularly in the more recent publications, it can be seen that, depending on the author, typically individual expressions of the ideal type of postmodern spirituality and religiosity are expressed, which **bochinger2009** have labelled “spiritueller Wanderer”, see **bochinger2009**.

⁵⁵¹See *Yoga Upaniṣads* (1938).

⁵⁵²Cf. **upanishads1938** (1938).

⁵⁵³In **kaivalyadamanuscripts2005** (2005: 50), two manuscripts with the title *Kriyāyoga* (AGJ 665/1 and TSM 6716) are listed, which, unfortunately, I was unable to consult. Neither manuscript is dated. AGJ 665/1 (Ganganath Jha Kendriya Sanskrit Vidyapitha, Allahabad) is a Devanāgarī manuscript on paper, and TSM 6716 (Sanskrit Mss. at the Tanjore Palace) is a

thermore, it is striking that the *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* is not mentioned in any other publications on Kriyāyoga consulted. For the time being, therefore, the possibility must be considered that **kriyayogaupanishad1993** is not only the translator of the *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* but also the secret author. Perhaps he wrote this supposedly ancient source text in order to legitimise his own Kriyāyoga doctrine.

Goswami **kriyayogaupanishad1993** learnt Kriyāyoga from his teacher Shelly Trimmer, who, according to the official website of the *Temple of Kriya Yoga*⁵⁵⁴ founded by **kriyayogaupanishad1993**, was a guru, yogi, kabbalist and direct disciple of Yogānanda. **kriyayogaupanishad1993** studied philosophy for four years at the University of Illinois and then embarked on a business career. Whether **kriyayogaupanishad1993** would have acquired the qualifications to translate a Sanskrit source text remains to be seen. Possibly, he was a gifted autodidact.

In the *Kriya Yoga Upanishad*, the disciple Sanskriti⁵⁵⁵ asks the guru Dattatreya to teach him the doctrine of Kriyāyoga. The latter agrees and explains Kriyāyoga in a total of ten chapters. The framework is formed by the eight-limbed yoga system presented in 1.5, similar to the eight limbs of the Pātañjala scheme. The first chapter (1.6–25) presents the *Ten Spiritual Restraints*. Dattatreya explains the *Ten Spiritual Observances* in the second chapter (2.1–16). Chapter three, *The Nine Postures* (3.1–13), deals with nine āsanās with six sitting postures, one standing posture and one complex posture. The fourth chapter (4.1–63) discusses what **kriyayogaupanishad1993** calls *Mystical Anatomy*. Here, six cakras named after the planets (i.e. the mūlādhāracakra is called the “Saturn mass-energy converter cakra”), fourteen primary nāḍīs and Kriya Kūṇḍalīni, which covers the ‘divine creative channel’ with its mouth, are taught.

Telugu manuscript on palm leaf. The author of the latter is named Venkaṭayogin. I suspect these manuscripts are probably later works that were created in the 18th century at the earliest. For now, however, no definitive statement can be made on this. However, their consultation could shed further light on the historical development of Kriyāyoga.

⁵⁵⁴ **goswamikriyananda**.

⁵⁵⁵ In the **datta2024** Dattatreya teaches the so-called Sāṃkṛti. The contents of the *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* sound similar to those of the Dattātryayogaśāstra and Yogatattvopaniṣad but are not the same. The author of this Upaniṣad may have used these two texts as a source of inspiration.

The fifth chapter (5.1–14) is entitled *Inner Purification* and contains *prāṇāyāma* techniques such as *sūryabhedana* and *candrabhedana*. Chapter six (6.1–39), entitled *Breath Control*, instructs another breathing exercise in combination with meditation on the three *akṣaras* that constitute the sacred syllable *aum*. During the inhalation (*pūraka*), the yogi is supposed to meditate on *a*, during the breath retention on *u* and during the exhalation on *ṃ*. In addition, the breathing technique *śitalī* (6.25) and a technique called *yonimudrā* (6.33–34) are presented. Chapter seven (7.1–10) is about *Withdrawal of the Senses*. The practitioner is instructed to let the breath move through the body in a specific order. The eighth chapter (8.1–9) is entitled *Concentration*. Here, the yogin is meant to inhale and hold the breath at specific bodily locations (not the *cakras*), which are associated with the five elements and the syllables *ya*, *ra*, *va*, *la* and *ha*, as well as specific deities. The even shorter ninth chapter, *Meditation* (9.1–6), basically only states that the practice of concentration leads to meditation after a while. The tenth chapter, *Samadhi* (10.1–12), then describes the final state of yoga, which is defined as the “deep conscious trance in which the yogi experiences Absolute Wisdom”.

3.3.6.4 From early modern to modern models of Kriyāyoga

The *Yogasvarodaya* and Rāmacandra’s *Tattvayogabindu* were written before 1591 CE. Nārāyaṇatīrtha must have lived between 1600 and 1690 CE., and because of that, his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* was also written in this timeframe. Sant Sundardās, the author of the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* lived from 1596 to 1689 CE. Interestingly, Nārāyaṇatīrtha and Sundardās lived in Benares.⁵⁵⁶ The earliest quotations of the *Tattvayogabindu* are found in Sundaradeva’s *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*, who also must have lived in Benares before 1659 CE. Text-internal evidence strongly suggests that Rāmacandra, too, is to be located in northern India.⁵⁵⁷ Thus, we can safely assume that the complex taxonomies of twelve-fifteen yogas were part of the local discourse of 16th to 17th-century Benares.

⁵⁵⁶ See burger2014sarvangayogapradipika for dating and location of Sundardās and pennaz2004 for dating and location of Nārāyaṇatīrtha.

⁵⁵⁷ The detailed discussion of the place of origin of the *Tattvayogabindu* is found on p. 223, n. 383.

Lahiḍi Mahāśaya, the person to whom the new forms of Kriyāyoga seem to go back, lived more than a century later, from 1828 to 1895 CE. Interestingly, Lahiḍi Mahāśaya is also said to have spent much of his life in Benares. It is, of course, utterly unclear whether Lahiḍi Mahāśaya ever read any of the works mentioned above. At least we know that he not only enjoyed an education in philosophy in Benares but also learnt English and Sanskrit.⁵⁵⁸ However, it is likely that the local discourse regarding the religious-spiritual marketplace within Benares did not change abruptly. Lahiḍi Mahāśaya lived as a family man and householder,⁵⁵⁹ no sectarian affiliations are known so that the whole variety of religious-spiritual market of his time were open to him. He was able to combine them freely. As can be seen from the yoga texts examined in this book, there was no lack of different yoga categories in Benares between the 16th and 19th centuries CE. Although these were still labelled differently, they were without a doubt freely combined in practice by many. Moreover, given the plethora of yoga practices from different yoga traditions and yoga texts presented in the previous chapter and evident in the publications of the new Kriyāyoga consulted, it is not only credible but also plausible that this phenomenon already began with Lahiḍi Mahāśaya, as Yogānanda claims in his autobiography. However, why Lahiḍi Mahāśaya chose the category of Kriyāyoga as the generic term for his yoga system cannot be answered conclusively. However, I would like to offer an educated guess.

I hypothesise that the term Kriyāyoga, as the generic term for his system of yoga, was a strategic decision of Lahiḍi Mahāśaya. It is unlikely, and there is no clear evidence that Lahiḍi Mahāśaya knew the *Yogasvarodaya*, *Tattvayogabindu* or *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. It is impossible to determine whether these texts ever influenced Lahiḍi Mahāśaya and his new Kriyāyoga system. However, if they did, it could only have been the fact that the three texts mention Kriyāyoga as the first item in their taxonomies and freely integrate a large number of contemporary yoga practices. This may have influenced his decision to use Kriyāyoga as one central term that unites all yogas and their

⁵⁵⁸ [jones2008encyclopedia](#).

⁵⁵⁹ See [autobiogyogi](#).

techniques of his time. Another factor could have been that he was consciously or unconsciously driven by the emerging *Yogasūtra* hype in the West, which triggered a wave of enthusiasm in India. One wonders why he did not choose the term Rājayoga to integrate many systems as others have done before him. Maybe because the term Rājayoga was already used as a generic term for Pātāñjalayoga by then.⁵⁶⁰ In comparison to all other known terms for categories of yoga,⁵⁶¹ the term Kriyāyoga had the advantage that it not only formed a link to the popular and hyped *Yogasūtra*, but also provided a basic framework that was open to interpretation due to the three constitutional practices *tapas*, *svādhyāya* and *īśvarapraṇidhāna*. Thus, the term opened up the possibility to integrate the variety of post-Pātāñjalean physical and non-physical yoga practices from the Tantras and texts of Haṭha- and Rājayoga through a literal interpretation of the compound prefix *kriyā*° in the sense of “action”. This was likely the crucial aspect. As birch2020 (2020: 471–472) demonstrated in his article “*Haṭhayoga’s Floruit on the Eve of Colonialism*”, the popularity of medieval and early modern Haṭhayoga practices reached an unprecedented peak across India during this period. What could be more logical than reducing the complex diversity of circulating yogas labels to a simple, practice-oriented umbrella term? This apparently aligned with the *Zeitgeist*. The formation of a new Hindu identity, which began in the 16th century, also culminated during the lifetime of Lahīḍi Mahāśaya. Therefore, it is not surprising that in creating his Kriyāyoga, he operated in line with the “*identifikatorischer Habitus*” that Axel michael1998 (1998: 19–27) described as a characteristic mode of thinking in Hindu religion and Paul hacker1979’s (1979) concept of “Inklusivismus”.⁵⁶² Whether his thoughts consciously or unconsciously went in a similar direction must of course remain open. How-

⁵⁶⁰ See birch2014.

⁵⁶¹ Cf. p. 474 for a list of the twenty-three early modern categories of yoga.

⁵⁶² “Inklusivismus” refers to the inclination of a religion or religious tradition to integrate other religious doctrines and practices into its own system and to view them as partial aspects of its own truth. The idea is not to see other religions as fundamentally false or opposing, but to integrate them into one’s own worldview and recognise them as partially true. In the context of Hinduism, “Inklusivismus” means that different religious concepts, deities and rituals of other traditions are regarded as acceptable and valid expressions of one’s own beliefs. This stance allows a variety of beliefs and practices to be harmonised and seen as complementary paths to the same ultimate truth.

ever, we must assume that the discursive environment of Benares at his time certainly played its part in encouraging Lahiḍi Mahāśaya to integrate the various yogas and basically all yoga practices circulating in the local discourse of his time under this specific term.

3.4 Jñānayoga

Jñānayoga,⁵⁶³ the “Yoga of gnosis”, is the second method of Rājayoga in Rāmacandra’s list of the fifteen yogas as well as in his source text, the *Yogasvarodaya*. In Nārāyaṇatīrtha’s list of the fifteen yogas presented within the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Jñānayoga takes sixth place. In the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* Sundardās presents Jñānayoga as a form of Sāṃkhyayoga. Here, it is the second among the four types of Sāṃkhyayoga together with Brahmayoga and Advaitayoga.

3.4.1 Jñānayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*

Jñānayoga occupies the second place in Rāmacandra’s taxonomy of the fifteen yogas but is not described according to this order in his text.⁵⁶⁴ The description is given from section XXI–XXII. The overarching goal of Rāmacandra’s Jñānayoga is the long-term durability of the body (*bahutarakālaṃ śarīrasthitiḥ*) already mentioned in the introduction (section I), which is expressed here once again with other words: “From the execution of this [Jñānayoga], time does not bring about the destruction of the body.” (*tasya kāraṇāt kālaḥ śarīranāśaṃ na karoti*). Simultaneously, Rāmacandra’s Jñānayoga leads to the attainment of the “reality of Śambhu” (*śāmbhavi sattā*).⁵⁶⁵ This Jñānayoga can be practised in two ways. The first method (XXI.1) arises through the application of “non-dualistic thinking” (*avikalpatayā yuktyā*), and the second method (XXI.2) arises “through the realisation that the entire world consists of all knowledge” (*...sarvajñānamayaṃ jagat | ya evaṃ vetti bodhena ...*). However,

⁵⁶³See section XXI and XXII on pp. 156–171

⁵⁶⁴The description of Jñānayoga is preceded by Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga (III–XII), Lakṣyayoga (XIII–XV), Rājayoga (XVI–XVII), Caryāyoga (XVIII) and Haṭhayoga (XIX–XX).

⁵⁶⁵This refers to the highest reality and the state of Rājayoga, see p. 157.

the first method is briefly referenced, but the text discusses only the second method in detail. The method consists of viewing the world as a unity that is enlightened by the highest self (*viśvātman*). If one perceives this unity, one finds oneself in the “reality of Śaṃbhu”. However, this supreme reality cannot be recognised without further ado since it does not show itself as the desired unity but as a tenfold multiplicity (XXI.4ab). He compares this relationship to a seed from which a whole tree with its parts grows (XXI.4–XXI.5). The seed stands for the invisible unity of world and self. The tree, with its various parts, stands for the multiplicity of the visible world. The fundamental unity of the world is like the seed from which a whole tree has grown. The original seed is no longer visible and is not perceived. However, what is perceived is a world consisting of a multiplicity. In the case of the seed, a tree with its branches, leaves, etc. In the case of the world ten basic principles (*tattvas*): the one [the primordial source of being, the *viśvātmā*] as modifications (*vikriyā*) of five [great] elements (*pañcatattva*), thinking mind (*manas*), intellect (*buddhi*), illusion (*māya*) and individuation (*ahaṃkāra*).⁵⁶⁶ Jñānayoga is supposed to produce the realisation of this oneness (XXI.7). In order to realise this, the practitioner is supposed to apply the view of unity (*aikyena darśanam*) to recognise the identity between the visible world of multiplicity⁵⁶⁷, and the invisible self of the universe (*viśvātmā*). Through Jñānayoga, the practitioner then realises that the self is one with the world⁵⁶⁸ and that the changing forms of the world’s material appearance are empty.⁵⁶⁹

3.4.2 Jñānayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*

If we assume a correct transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya* in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, then the text, in fact, describes two different types of Jñānayoga.

⁵⁶⁶ For a discussion of the tenfold *tattva* system, see n. on p. 165

⁵⁶⁷ This is also referred to by Rāmacandra as *saṃsāra* (XXI ll. 7–9).

⁵⁶⁸ *Tattvayogabindu* XXII 162 l. 5: *jñānayogaprabhāvād eka eva ātmā iti niścayo bhavati* | “Because of the power of Jñānayoga, there arises the conviction that the self is truly one.”

⁵⁶⁹ *Tattvayogabindu* XXII p.164 l. 3: *jñānayogād vikārarūparahito jñāyate* | “Through Jñānayoga he realises the emptiness of the mutability of form.”

The Jñānayoga of the first passage⁵⁷⁰ contains a description of the major components of the yogic body which the yogin is supposed to know. Gaining knowledge about the body is the aim of this Jñānayoga.⁵⁷¹ In particular, the knowledge of the three primary channels (*nāḍīs*),⁵⁷² as well as a system with a total of nine *cakras* is mandatory. These elements are described in detail. The introduction to this first form of Jñānayoga mentions other things the yogin should know, such as the three targets [for fixing the mind] (*lakṣyas*),⁵⁷³ sixteen containers [for holding mind and often breath in the context of this type of yogic practice] (*ādhāras*) and the five [meditative] spaces (*vyomans*) through which the yogin progresses on the path to the highest state of yoga.

This first form of Jñānayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*, like much of its content and its overall structure, is adopted by Rāmacandra in his *Tattvayogabindu*. Surprisingly, Rāmacandra presents the first form of Jñānayoga under a different name for unknown reasons.⁵⁷⁴ Instead of Jñānayoga, Rāmacandra calls it Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga. We can only draw speculative conclusions why Rāmacandra made this change. Perhaps Rāmacandra did not want to teach two different forms of Jñānayoga, or he was convinced that Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga were the more appropriate terms for this type of yoga. There is also the possibility that Rāmacandra knew Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, because he classifies Jñānayoga as a form of Mantrayoga, as will be shown in the next subsection. However, apart from similarities between the complex yoga taxonomies, there are no other noticeable overlaps or even citations. A detailed discussion of Siddhakuṇḍal-

⁵⁷⁰ *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, Ed. p. 831–833.

⁵⁷¹ *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, Ed. p. 831: *jñānayogam pravakṣyāmi tajjñānī śivatām vrajet | paṭhanāt smaraṇād vyānān maṇḍanāt brahmasādhakāḥ | tadbhedasyaikaśandhānam aṣṭaiśvaryamayo bhavet | tritirthaṃ yatra nāḍī ca tripuṇyaṃ parameśvarī | svadehe yo na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhāraḥ | navacakram kalādhāraṃ trilakṣaṃ vyomapañcakam | svadehe yo na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhāraḥ |*

⁵⁷² The left lunar channel (*idā*), the right solar channel (*piṅgalā*) and the central channel (*suṣūmnā*).

⁵⁷³ In the sections on Lakṣyayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* five targets (*lakṣyas*) are described in total. This is one of many inconsistencies in the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Yogattvabindu*.

⁵⁷⁴ Perhaps, the designation *jñānayoga* in this context is a result of textual corruption, as the second Jñānayoga presented later on in the text lives up to its name much better. However, without further textual evidence, this remains unproven.

inīyoga and Mantrayoga in Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* can be found on p. 430.

The second type of Jñānayoga of the *Yogasvarodaya*⁵⁷⁵ is largely identical with Rāmacandra's Jñānayoga. Rāmacandra borrows most of the verses verbatim from the *Yogasvarodaya*. There are minor details that Rāmacandra modifies, but they do not change the overall concept and aim of this type of Jñānayoga. For this reason, it will not be repeated here. The passage is reproduced in its entirety in the first layer of the critical apparatus in section XXI on p. 156 of the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu* and can be consulted there.

3.4.3 Jñānayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates his Jñānayoga⁵⁷⁶ in the context of *yogasūtra*'s *sūtra* 1.28, which says:

tajjāpas tadarthabhāvanam || 28 ||

It's muttering; manifesting its meaning.

This is the last *sūtra* of an extensive section (1.23–28) in the *yogasūtra*,⁵⁷⁷ which is entirely dedicated to one of the means of attaining *samādhi*, namely *īśvarapraṇidhāna*, devotion to Īśvara, the Supreme Lord.

Īśvara is most aptly represented by the sacred syllable *oṃ*. The above *sūtra* instructs the quiet murmuring of this syllable while contemplating its meaning (*tadarthabhāvanam*) as a practical method of *īśvarapraṇidhāna* to attain the highest state of yoga, which is called Rājayoga or *asamprajñātasamādhi*.

In this *sūtra*, Nārāyaṇatīrtha takes *japa* ("muttering") to denote Mantrayoga, while *arthabhāvanā* ("manifesting its meaning") is linked to Jñānayoga, understood as the cultivation of discriminative knowledge (see

⁵⁷⁵ *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, Ed. p. 835–837.

⁵⁷⁶ For an earlier brief discussion of Jñānayoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *yogacandrika* see pennaz2004.

⁵⁷⁷ An entire monograph entitled harimoto2014 is dedicated to this section by harimoto2014 (2014). It provides an edition, translation and detailed discussion of this critical passage in the *Pātañjalayogaśāstravivaraṇa*.

previous paragraph). He further extends the interpretation by associating the same *sūtra* with Advaitayoga, which is grounded in the non-dualistic realization of the identity of the individual and the supreme self. The *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 46) reads:

kiñ ca japa ity anena mantrayogaḥ arthabhāvanam ity anena viveka-jñānābhyāsarūpo jñānayogaḥ abhedabhāvarūpo 'dvaitayogaś ca saṃgr̥hitah |

Furthermore, by [the term] *japa* the practice of Mantrayoga [is indicated]; by [the term] *arthabhavana*, the cultivation of discriminative knowledge [is meant], which is the form of practice [called] Jñānayoga, [and] Advaitayoga is understood to be the form of cultivating non-differentiation.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha, thus, offers two alternatives about the specific performance of the contemplation. Either, while quietly murmuring the *praṇava* syllable, which symbolises Īśvara and his qualities, the mind shall be focused on the distinction between consciousness (*puruṣa*) and primordial nature (*prakṛti*) including its effects (*tatkārya*).⁵⁷⁸ This is Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Jñānayoga. Alternatively, one is supposed to reflect on the non-difference between the highest self (*paramātman*) and the individual self (*jīva*).⁵⁷⁹ This is Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Advaitayoga.

3.4.4 Jñānayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

The Jñānayoga of Dādūpanthī Sundardās (*Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.13–24) is strikingly similar to the Jñānayoga of Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* and

⁵⁷⁸ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 45): *tasya praṇavasya japaḥ vidhivad uccāraṇam, tadarthasya praṇavārthasya acintyaīśvaryaśaktiyuktasya paramātmano bhāvanam prakṛtītatkāryapurūṣebhyo vivekenānusaṃdhānam ...* "The low-voice muttering of *praṇava* [and] pronunciation according to the rules [along with] the contemplation of the meaning of that *praṇava*, [being associated with] the Supreme Self endowed with inconceivable power and supremacy, is the fixation of the attention with discernment from the individual self and nature with its effects."

⁵⁷⁹ Ibid. (Ed. p. 45): *athavā tadarthasya paramātmanaḥ pūrṇasya bhāvanam jīvābhedenā punaḥ punaś cetasi niveśanam |* "Alternatively, its meaning is the repeated memorization in the mind of the non-distinction between the individual self and the total supreme self."

the *Yogasvarodaya*. Jñānayoga is the first subcategory of Sāṃkhyayoga.⁵⁸⁰ Brahmayoga⁵⁸¹ and Advaitayoga⁵⁸² follow it. While Sundardās introduces Sāṃkhyayoga to teach how to distinguish the self (*ātman*) from the not-self (*anātman*) by differentiating twenty-four *tattvas* of the world, Jñānayoga goes one step further and conveys the gnosis (*jñāna*) that the world and the self nevertheless form an inseparable unity. As a result of this gnosis, Brahmayoga arises. Brahmayoga is a specific form of contemplation or state in which the yogin experiences himself as one with the Absolute and the entire universe within himself. Finally, this sequence culminates in Advaitayoga, by which the practitioner finally overcomes the state of duality and conceptualisation. Jñānayoga is the second step of the four-stage Sāṃkhyayoga.

This Jñānayoga emphasises the recognition of the unity of the self and the universe.⁵⁸³ According to Sundardās, the self is the cause, and the whole universe is the effect.⁵⁸⁴ To illustrate the relationship of cause and effect between self and universe, Sundardās presents the same metaphor of the seed and the tree as Rāmacandra in *Tattvayogabindu* XXI.4–5.⁵⁸⁵ The rest of the section consists of different comparisons, which are supposed to illustrate the non-difference between the self and the whole or the universe.⁵⁸⁶

⁵⁸⁰ Sundardās' Sāṃkhyayoga is discussed on p. 468.

⁵⁸¹ Sundardās' Brahmayoga is discussed on p. 422.

⁵⁸² Sundardās' Advaitayoga is discussed on p. 426.

⁵⁸³ See **burger2014sarvangayogapradipika** (2014: 702) for an earlier brief discussion of Sundardās's Jñānayoga in French.

⁵⁸⁴ **sarvangayoga** 4.13: *jñāna yoga aba esaiṃ jānaiṃ | kāraṇa aru kāraya pahicānaiṃ | kāraṇa ātama āhi akhāṇḍā | kāraya bhayau sakala brahmaṇḍā* || 13 || "Now understand Jñānayoga. Recognise the cause and effect. The cause is the indivisible soul. The effect is the whole universe."

⁵⁸⁵ **sarvangayoga** 4.14: *jyaum amkuru teṃ taru vistārā | bahuta bhāṃti kari nikasī ḍārā | śāṣā patra aura pharaphulā | yaum ātamā viśva kau mūlā* || 14 || "Just as the tree [grows] out of the seed, bringing forth countless branches, leaves, fruits and flowers, in the same way the self is the root of the universe."

⁵⁸⁶ For example **sarvangayoga** 4.20: *jyaum kuñcana ke bhūṣana nānā | bhinna bhinna kari nāṃva baṣaṇā | gāre sarba eka hi huvā | yaiṃ ātamā biśva nahiṃ juvā* || 20 || "Just like various ornaments made of gold, are worn with different names and forms. However, in essence, all become one in the melting pot. In the same way, the self is not separate from the universe."

3.4.5 Jñānayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Jñānayoga within the intricate and multifaceted texts of the early modern yoga taxonomies unveils four distinct models of Jñānayoga. These models circulated at least among the yoga traditions that were present in the North Indian subcontinent during the 16th and 17th centuries CE.

1. The dominant model is the application of non-dualistic thinking, leading to the perception of the unity of self and world, found in the *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. The first two classify Jñānayoga under Rājayoga, while the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* places it under Sāṃkhyayoga.
2. Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* contrasts this: Jñānayoga is treated as a form of Mantrayoga, involving *praṇavajapa* and contemplation of the distinction between *puruṣa* and *prakṛti* (and its effects).
3. The *Tattvayogabindu* briefly mentions a second model, defining Jñānayoga as contemplation on the world as consisting of all knowledge, though without further detail.
4. The *Yogasvarodaya* presents another type: Jñānayoga as knowledge of the yogic body—its three channels and paradigms (*lakṣyas*, *ādhāras*, *cakras*, and *vyomans*).

3.5 Caryāyoga

CARYĀYOGA, “the Yoga of conduct” occupies third place in Rāmcandra's list of the methods of Rājayoga. However, it is entirely absent in the *Yogasvarodaya*. Nevertheless, Caryāyoga is mentioned as the second method in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's fifteen yogas. It is absent in Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. However, Sundardās describes a yoga with the almost homophonic name Carcāyoga. Sundardās's Carcāyoga is considered the fourth and final method of his Bhaktiyoga after Mantrayoga and Layayoga.

3.5.1 Caryāyoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*

Rāmacandra keeps the section on Caryāyoga (section XVIII) extremely short, with only eight prose sentences. After characterising the self as “formless, permanent, immovable and indivisible,” Rāmacandra lets the reader know that by stabilising the mind in such a self, the self does not come into contact with sin and merit. When the mind is absorbed into the formless [self], this is Cāryayoga. That is all that Rāmacandra has to say on this subject. The brevity of the passage and the fact that the testimony of the *Yogasvarodaya* does not contain this type of yoga, but Rāmacandra clearly constructs its description on the basis of a passage on Rājayoga of the *Yogasvarodaya*,⁵⁸⁷ suggests that Rāmacandra did not understand Caryāyoga and merely wanted to do justice to his taxonomy mentioned at the beginning of his text.⁵⁸⁸ It is puzzling why this particular yoga with this particular description bears the name Caryāyoga. The apparent association of the first four yogas in Rāmacandra’s and *Yogasvarodaya*’s list with the four *pādas* of the Śaiva Āgamas (*kriyā*-, *jñāna*-, *caryā*- and *yogapāda*) does not offer a convincing solution in this case, as *caryā*° in this context has nothing to do with the original ritual discipline or day-to-day conduct of the śaivite practices, as would be the case in the *caryāpāda* of a Śaiva Āgamas. It seems, therefore, unlikely that any yoga practitioners back then practised a Caryāyoga according to Rāmacandra’s concept.

3.5.2 Caryāyoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*

The term Caryāyoga does not appear in the sources of the *Yogasvarodaya*, namely the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* and *Yogakarnīkā*. Thus, the term is absent from its yoga taxonomy.⁵⁸⁹ Although the verses postulate a total of fifteen yogas, only eight are mentioned. Whether Caryāyoga is one of the seven unnamed ones is unclear. However, its presence in the taxonomies of the *Tattvayo-*

⁵⁸⁷ Cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XVIII, p. 150

⁵⁸⁸ One could argue that Rāmacandra may not have done so, since not all fifteen yogas announced at the beginning are described in the course of his text anyway. I suspect that this may nevertheless have been his original intention but that Rāmacandra discarded this intention while writing his text, perhaps due to inconsistencies in his source text

⁵⁸⁹ *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, Ed. p. 831.

*gabindu*⁵⁹⁰ and the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*⁵⁹¹ would support this. For this reason, Caryāyoga was possibly a member of the *Yogasvarodaya*'s fifteen-fold yoga taxonomy. The original appearance and structure of the *Yogasvarodaya* remains conjectural. While it almost appears that the entirety of the *Yogasvarodaya* has been preserved in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, the *Yogakarnīkā* includes several verses attributed to the *Yogasvarodaya* not found in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*.⁵⁹² Hence, it is plausible that the text was more extensive and may have included a transmission of Caryāyoga.

The *Yogakarnīkā* provides detailed descriptions of daily ritual conduct for the yoga practitioner under the heading *dinacaryā* ("daily conduct") in verses 1.23–61. It is notable that for a significant portion of the first chapter (1.1–168), the source(s) of the verses are not indicated, which is surprising given that the remainder of the first chapter and all other chapters of the text primarily consist of compilations of verses from other texts on typical yogic topics quoted with reference. Thus, throughout the *Yogakarnīkā*, larger sections of the *Yogasvarodaya* are repeatedly but not always quoted with reference. Is it possible that Nāth Aghorānanda, the compiler of the *Yogakarnīkā*, also drew on verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* here?

In the second part of the first chapter of the *Yogakarnīkā* (verses 1.169–280), 37 verses (1.244–280) are quoted from the *Yogasvarodaya* with reference, alongside at least four verses (1.210–213) of the *Yogasvarodaya* without reference.⁵⁹³

The possibility of further verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* within the first 168 verses of the *Yogakarnīkā* cannot be definitively addressed without a close examination of manuscripts of the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Yogakarnīkā*. However, it remains one of the most plausible scenarios that the original Caryāyoga within the taxonomy of the fifteen yogas of the *Yogasvarodaya* resembles the content of the *dinacaryā* section of the *Yogakarnīkā*. This section delin-

⁵⁹⁰*Tattvayogabindu* I. ll. 1–4.

⁵⁹¹*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 2.

⁵⁹²It is striking that Rāmacandra's rewriting of his source texts is based almost exclusively on the verses of the *Yogasvarodaya* quoted by the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*. Is it possible that this was the very recension that Rāmacandra used for his *Tattvayogabindu*? Or, was he even the creator of this very recension found in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*?

⁵⁹³The verses lacking attribution were identified as originating from the *Yogasvarodaya* due to their presence in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*.

eates daily ritual ablutions, mantra recitation, visualisation, and meditation (1.23–36), as well as other ritual acts such as dressing, applying sectarian markings (*tilaka*), including tying the hair into a knot (1.38), offerings, and the devotional performance of prostrations in front of one's own *iṣṭadevatā* (1.39–61). As they are part of the daily yoga practices, presenting them as a yogic discipline would seem natural.⁵⁹⁴

⁵⁹⁴As discussed in more detail on p. 409, the *Śivayogapradīpikā* contains numerous similarities in content with the *Tattvayogabindu*, the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. With ten yogas described in total, the *Śivayogapradīpikā* even comes very close to the numbers of yogas within the late medieval yoga taxonomies. These parallels strongly suggest a close connection in terms of reception history. There may not be a direct connection, but all these texts likely drew on the same intertextual network when compiling their own texts. In his dissertation on the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, **powell2023** (2023: 115) presents excerpts from a translation of a Kannada commentary on the *Śivayogapradīpikā* (*ṭike*) by the commentator Basavārādhya. Basavārādhya precedes his commentary with the following praise of the author of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*:

“The *ācārya* called Cennasādāśivayogisadāśivayogīśvara, who was skilled in the *jñāna*, *kriyā*, *caryā* and *yoga* [*pādas*] of the Śivāgamas, which are the means of personal liberation, who had the intellect capable of grasping the Veda and Vedānta, who was not caught up in the confusion of the many Śāstras such as the Sāṃkhya and Pātañjala, who was accomplished in the eternal true yoga, who could visualise the many worlds such as *bindu* and *nāda* in the middle of his body (*piṇḍa*), who was an expert in *mantra*, whose mind was absorbed in *laya*, who was devoted to *haṭha*, who was worthy of worship in Rājayoga, who was an expert practitioner and who was knowledgeable in many branches of learning such as Tāraka and the teachings on Brahman (*brahmopadeśa*), engaging in creating the Yogaśāstra called the *Śivayogapradīpikā* in order to illuminate the inner soul of those desirous of liberation.”

This eulogy not only suggests the great variety of different yoga teachings of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, but also confirms that authors such as Cennasādāśivayogin were familiar with Śaiva Āgamic traditions within this intertextual network, which also influenced the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Tattvayogabindu*. This strengthens the possibility that the first three yogas in the fifteenfold taxonomy were shaped by the familiar Śaiva categories of *jñāna*, *kriyā*, and *caryā*, without necessarily presupposing dependence on a fixed four-*pāda* textual structure. It also supports the hypothesis that the original Caryāyoga referred to a form of yoga that included day-to-day ritual conduct.

3.5.3 Caryāyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

In his *yogacandrika*⁵⁹⁵ Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents Caryāyoga⁵⁹⁶ in the context of Yogasūtra I.33:⁵⁹⁷

tasya cittasyāsūyādimalavato yogāsambhavāt tannirāśopāyaṃ caryāyogaṃ āha—maitrīkaruṇāmuditopekṣāṇāṃ sukhaduḥkhaṇyāpūṇyavīṣayāṇāṃ bhāvanātaś cittaprasādanam || 33 ||

Because Yoga is impossible for that mind which possesses defilements such as envy, [the text] said the means of eliminating that is Caryāyoga -

Calming of the mind arises through the cultivation of friendliness, compassion, joy and equanimity in circumstances of happiness, suffering, virtue and vice.

Caryāyoga is to cultivate kindness towards those in fortunate circumstances to prevent jealousy. Towards those who are in sorrowful circumstances, compassion is supposed to be cultivated to prevent ill-will. Towards those who act virtuously, one is supposed to cultivate joy to prevent aversion; and towards those who act unvirtuously, one is supposed to cultivate equanimity to prevent anger.⁵⁹⁸

With this practice of Caryāyoga, which gradually purifies the mind, the sattvic nature of the mind is brought forth. This leads to a clear and serene mind.⁵⁹⁹

Since the word *caryā*^o in this context refers to purposeful behaviour designed to give rise to the sattvic nature of the mind, the Caryāyoga of the

⁵⁹⁵ *yogacandrika*, Ed. pp. 2, 52–53, 100–101, 150.

⁵⁹⁶ For an earlier brief discussion of Caryāyoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *yogacandrika* see penna2004.

⁵⁹⁷ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 52.

⁵⁹⁸ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 52): *tathā ca sukhiteṣu maitrīm sauhārdam īrṣyākāluṣyanivarttakam, duḥkhiṣu karuṇām dayāmasūyākāluṣyanivarttikam, puṇyavṛttiṣu harṣam dveṣanivarttakam, apuṇyaśabditapāpiṣu upekṣām amarśakāluṣyanivarttikam bhāvayet |*

⁵⁹⁹ Ibid. (Ed. pp. 52–53): *tad evaṃ caryāyogena cittamalanirāsakena mukhyādiṣu yathākramamuktabhāvanārūpeṇa sāttviko dharmo jāyate | tena ca śuklena dharmeṇa citam prasannaṃ bhavati | prasāde ca sthitipadaṃ labhate | etac ca puṣkalaṃ viraktasyaiva sambhavatiti mukhyacaryāyogo vairāgyameveti saṃkṣepaḥ || 33 ||*

Yogasiddhāntacandrikā can be meaningfully translated as “Yoga of [beneficial] behaviour”.

3.5.4 Carcāyoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Within *sarvaṅgayoga* (2.40–51), Sundardās describes Cārcāyoga as one of the three subtypes of Bhaktiyoga which is *bhakti* towards unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*) in delightful devotion.⁶⁰⁰ He extensively describes the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*) as being formless and eternal and so on (40), as beginningless and endless, and so on (41). Next, Sundardās describes the various layers of creation emanating from *om* (42–45). He says the unmanifest consciousness illuminates every corner of existence (46), being the inner knower of all (47). Then, Sundardās expresses the importance of deep awe towards the infinite, divine, all-knowing and incomprehensible (48–49) unmanifest consciousness.

The entire passage on Carcāyoga is characterised by a discussion and description of the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*). This aspect is the core of this type of yoga. Unlimited unmanifested consciousness can be put into limiting words only, and yet the practitioner is confronted with the question of how it is supposed to be defined and determined.⁶⁰¹ And this is precisely the practice of Carcāyoga. The term *carcā*^o here refers to “discussing” or “putting into words” and emphasising individual details of unmanifest consciousness to generate deep reverence for the cultivation of Bhaktiyoga, the yoga of devotional worship of *avyakta puruṣa*. *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.47 illustrates this:

carcā karaṇṇ kahāṇ laga svāmī | tum saba hī ke antarjāmī |
śṛṣṭi kahat kachu anta na āvai | terā pāra kaimṇa dhaim pāvai || 47 ||

Up to what extent can I describe you [in words], O Lord? You are the inner knower of everything. There is no end to describing creation. Your limit cannot be reached by any means.

⁶⁰⁰ See [burger2014sarvaṅgayogapradīpika](#) (2014: 694–695) for an earlier brief discussion of Sundardās’s Carcāyoga in French.

⁶⁰¹ *sarvaṅgayoga* 2.41ab: *avyakta puruṣa agama apārā | kaisaim kai kariye nirdhārā |*

Thus, it is clear that no direct conceptual connection exists between the Caryāyogas described above and Carcāyoga. A meaningful explanation for the conspicuous homophony of both terms cannot be offered for the time being. However, the term raises the suspicion that Sundardās may have constructed this yoga in response to the term Caryāyoga, which would suggest that he was aware of other complex yoga taxonomies.

3.5.5 Caryāyoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Caryāyoga within the intricate and multifaceted texts of early modern yoga taxonomies reveals two distinct models. Additionally, the initial question regarding any connection between Caryāyogas and Carcāyoga was addressed, and a hypothesis was formulated on the original form of Caryāyoga.

In the *Tattvayogabindu*, Caryāyoga is described as stabilising the mind in the self. This rather banal description was likely an attempt to define Caryāyoga as mentioned in the initial list. It is plausible that Rāmacandra invented this description without any real understanding of Caryāyoga, as it seems to be derived from a description of Rājayoga in his source text. It appears highly unlikely that this form of Caryāyoga was ever practiced by anyone.

Caryāyoga is absent from the testimony of the *Yogasvarodaya* and is not listed therein. However, the *Yogakarnikā*, which extensively quotes the *Yogasvarodaya*, suggests that Caryāyoga was originally closely related to the practices within the *caryāpādas* of the Śaiva Āgamas, and thus consisted of daily ritual conduct as part of the yogic routine.

Furthermore, the comparison of Caryāyogas with Carcāyoga in Sundardās's work showed that they are entirely unrelated. In this context, Carcāyoga represents the final method of Bhaktiyoga, which aims to articulate the unmanifest consciousness in order to generate the profound awe necessary for progress on the yogic path, as presented by Sundardās in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

3.6 Haṭhayoga

HAṬHAYOGA, “the Yoga of force”, appears without exception in all complex late medieval yoga taxonomies. In the taxonomies with fifteen yogas of the *Tattvayogabindu*, the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, it occupies the fourth position. In the yoga taxonomy of Sundardās’s *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, it is the second main type of Yoga. Here, Haṭhayoga is a category in itself and the superordinate category for the three subsequent Yogas described by Sundardās, namely Rāja, Lakṣa and Aṣṭāṅgayoga which are all considered to be methods of Haṭhayoga.

3.6.1 Haṭhayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Both texts consider Haṭhayoga as another method of Rājayoga. In section XIX–XX of the *Tattvayogabindu*, two categories of Haṭhayoga are distinguished. Both are based on the explanations of the *Yogasvarodaya*, differ only slightly in formulation, and can, therefore, be considered together.⁶⁰² Both passages in these two texts are characterised by their brevity.

The first type of Haṭhayoga described teaches the control of the breath through exhalation (*recaka*), inhalation (*pūraka*) and breath retention (*kumbhaka*) etc. With the term “etc.” (*°ādi°*), the text probably indicates other known practices of *Haṭhayoga*. In addition to other breathing exercises, this could also refer to the other known basic building blocks of Haṭhayoga, which have been associated with Haṭhayoga since Svātmarāma’s *Haṭhapradīpikā*: *āsana*, *mudrā* and *nādānusandhāna*. Both texts mention the six actions that purify the body (*ṣaṭkarma*) next. Then Rāmacandra states that when the full breath dwells within the solar channel (*sūryanāḍi*), the mind becomes immobile. Through the immobility of the mind, bliss arises, and the mind is absorbed into emptiness (*śūnya*). The resulting state leads to the delay of the time of death (*kālaḥ samīpe nāgachati*). The naming of the sun channel is striking in this context. The *Yogasvarodaya* is no concrete help here, as it merely speaks

⁶⁰² See *ramatosana* (Ed. p. 835) and *shabdakalpadruma* (Ed. p. 501). These passages contain quotations from the *Yogasvarodaya* of both types of Haṭhayoga. See also *yogakarnika* 12.23–26. Here, verses of the second category of Haṭhayoga are reproduced

of an unspecified *nāḍī*,⁶⁰³ in which, triggered by the preceding practice, the fullness of breath is established.⁶⁰⁴ In most Haṭhayoga texts, the state of “immobility of the mind” characteristic of *samādhi* is linked to the central channel *suṣūmnā*, not to the sun-associated right channel *piṅgalā*. *Samādhi* generally occurs when the breath enters the central channel.⁶⁰⁵ Either the term *sūryanāḍī* is to be understood here as an unfortunate synonym,⁶⁰⁶ or the text is corrupt.⁶⁰⁷ Another possibility would be to assume a practice associated with the *piṅgalā* channel. This could be the best understanding of the term since *sūryanāḍī* is found in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, a text that also served as a model for Rāmacandra. Here, it is explicitly associated with the *piṅgalā* channel.⁶⁰⁸

The second type of Haṭhayoga in *Tattvayogabindu* instructs the yogin to contemplate a non-specific form (*kiṃcidrūpā*) in the colours white, yellow, blue and red equal to the radiance of ten million suns in one’s own body from head to toe. This is supposed to burn away all diseases of the body and prolong life. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, there is no mention of an unspecific form. Instead, these colours and the sun’s radiance are meant to be contemplated in the area of the tip of the nose.⁶⁰⁹ Rāmacandra and the *Yogasvarodaya* describe the second type of Haṭhayoga so briefly and vaguely that the reader is denied

⁶⁰³ Since the YSv mentions no specific *nāḍī*, it is likely that it is the *nāḍī par excellence*, the *suṣūmnā*

⁶⁰⁴ Cf. *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 835): *etan nāḍyān tu deveśi vāyupūrṇaṃ pratiṣṭhitam | tato mano niścalaṃ syāt tata ānanda eva hi |*

⁶⁰⁵ This is already evident, for example, in the oldest written testimony of the Haṭhyoga genre, the *Amṛtasiddhi* 26.1–2: *yo 'sau siddhimayo vāyur madhyamāpadaniścalaḥ | tadānandamayaṃ cittam ekarūpaṃ nabhaḥsamam || 26.1 || yadānandamayaṃ cittam bāhyakleśāvivarjitam | bhavaduḥkhāni saṃhṛtya samādhir jāyate tadā || 26.2 || asiddhi* translate: (1) “When Breath is perfected and fixed in the place of the Goddess of the Centre, then consciousness has the nature of bliss, uniform like the sky.” (2) “When consciousness has the nature of bliss, free from external afflictions, then, having the sorrows of existence, Samādhi arises.” This idea, which can be found in this genre from the 11th century at the latest, subsequently permeates the entire genre.

⁶⁰⁶ In the sense of being ambiguous and overlapping with the *piṅgalā* channel.

⁶⁰⁷ A conjecture of *sūryanāḍī* to *sūryanāḍī* would be obvious. In *Jyotsnā* 4.10, Brahmānanda understands “the void” (*śūnya*) as the central channel. In *Haṭhāpradīpikā* 3.4, *śūnyapādavi* is a synonym of *suṣūmnā*.

⁶⁰⁸ *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.5: *pañcamam kaṇṭhacakraṃ caturāṅgulaṃ tatra vāme idā candranāḍī dakṣiṇe piṅgalā sūryanāḍī tanmadhye suṣūmnāṃ dhyāyet saivānāhatakalā anāhataśiddhir bhavati |*

⁶⁰⁹ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 835): *ākāśe nāsikāgre tu sūryakoṭisamaṃ smaret | śvetaṃ raktaṃ tathā pītaṃ kṛṣṇaṃ ityādirūpataḥ |*

a clearer picture. It should be noted at this point that the formulation is very reminiscent of Bāhyalakṣya's explanations in section XXIII.⁶¹⁰ Interestingly, in Sundardās's *sarvangayoga*, Lakṣ(y)ayoga is a subcategory, i.e. a partial practice, of Haṭhayoga. Is this hinting the source for this differentiation? Further parallels to practices of other texts of Haṭhayoga involving coloured or non-coloured light exist but are still conceptually too distant to convincingly assign Rāmacandra's second type,⁶¹¹ and thus remain enigmatic for the time being.

3.6.2 Haṭhayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

In the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, the discussion and description of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Haṭhayoga is spread over several *sūtras* of the first two chapters, the *samādhipāda* (1.34) and the *sādhana-pāda* (2.46–52). The commentary by Nārāyaṇatīrtha is particularly extensive and detailed here.⁶¹²

Initially, Nārāyaṇatīrtha locates Haṭhayoga in the context of *sūtra* 1.34. This *sūtra* is one of several options (1.32–40) that can be applied to overcome the distractions described in *sūtras* 1.30–31, which hinder the attainment of the final state of yoga (*asaṃprajñātasamādhi*, *nirbijasamādhi*, or *kaivalya*).⁶¹³

pracchardanavidhāraṇābhyāṃ vā prāṇasya || 34 ||

Or, through exhaling and restraining of the breath.

This method serves to establish a clear mind and is referred to by Nārāyaṇatīrtha as Haṭhayoga. He explains that *pracchardana* denotes the slow outward emptying of the abdominal breath through one nostril in measured quantities.⁶¹⁴ *Vidhāraṇa* is the continuous external retention of exhaled

⁶¹⁰Cf. p. 170.

⁶¹¹See p. 171 for the parallel passages.

⁶¹²For an earlier, short discussion of Haṭhayoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *yogacandrika* see penna2004.

⁶¹³This final state of yoga is called *rājayoga* by Nārāyaṇatīrtha.

⁶¹⁴*yogacandrika* 1.34 (Ed. p. 53): *kauṣṭhyasya vāyoh pracchardanam, ekataranāsāpuṭena mātrāpramāṇena śanaiḥ śanair bahir niḥsāraṇam* |

air.⁶¹⁵ Nārāyaṇatīrtha identifies this form of breath retention as *recitakumbhaka*, the first of seven *kumbhakas* (*saptakumbhaka*), considered particularly praiseworthy due to its minimal restrictions. The group—*recita*, *pūrīta*, *śānta*, *pratyāhāra*, *uttara*, *adhāra*, and *sama*—is elaborated later in the second chapter within the discussion of *prāṇāyāma* (2.49–53), where seven of the eight *kumbhakas* of the *Haṭhapradīpikā* are also addressed.⁶¹⁶

According to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, mastery of the breath is inseparable from mastery of the mind. Additionally, *prāṇāyāma* has the power to eradicate all sins, which in turn enables the mind to focus and remain steady on a chosen meditative object (*lakṣya*).⁶¹⁷

Finally, Nārāyaṇatīrtha authenticates the linking of *prāṇāyāma* and Haṭhayoga (*prāṇāyāmasya haṭhayogatvam uktaṃ smṛtau*) with the famous verse of the *yogabija* (148cd–149ab), in which the syllable “*ha*” is linked to the sun and the syllable “*ṭha*” to the moon. Thus, he understands the term *haṭha* as the union of sun and moon.⁶¹⁸

The next section of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, addressing aspects of Haṭhayoga, appears in the context of the third limb of *aṣṭāṅgayoga*, beginning with *sūtra* 2.46.

*itaḥ param sakalarogādīnivr̥ttidvārā haṭhayogasyopāyam āsanam āha—
sthīrasukham āsanam || 46 ||*

Hereafter, posture, being the means of Haṭhayoga, is said to be the gateway to preventing all diseases etc.

A comfortable and steady position.

⁶¹⁵Ibid. 1.34 (Ed. p. 53): *vidhāraṇaṃ recitasya vāyor bahir eva sthāpanaṃ kumbhakaṃ |*

⁶¹⁶Ibid. 1.34 (Ed. p. 53): *tathā cātra pūrakavarjanād recitapūrītaśāntapratyāhārottārādhārasam-abhedena saptakumbhakeṣu madhye recitakumbhako 'yaṃ prathamābhyāse 'nekanīyamānapekṣatayā praśastaḥ | sarvaṃ etad agre prāṇāyāmaprakaraṇe sphuṭibhaviṣyati |*

⁶¹⁷Ibid. 1.34 (Ed. p. 53): *tad etābhyāṃ prāṇajaye cittajayas tayoṃ avinābhāvāt prāṇāyāmasya sarvapāpanāśakatvāt pāpanivr̥tṭyā ca cittam ekatra lakṣye sthīraṃ bhavati |*

⁶¹⁸Ibid. 1.34 (Ed. p. 53): *hakāreṇa tu sūryo 'sau ṭhakāreṇendur ucyate | sūryācandramasor aikyaṃ haṭha ity abhidhiyate ||* The context suggests here, that Nārāyaṇatīrtha associates the sun and moon with the *piṅgalānāḍī* (representing the sun) and *iḍānāḍī* (representing the moon). Their union would then be the inhalation through these channels with a subsequent breath retention.

In his commentary Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents various *āsanas*. Of a total of 84 *āsanas*, he describes 38 in detail. birch2018proliferation (2018) observed⁶¹⁹ that Nārāyaṇatīrtha's descriptions of the *āsanas* were borrowed from earlier yoga texts, such as the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (which Nārāyaṇatīrtha refers to as *Yogapradīpa*), the *vasisthasamhita* and the *Dharmaputrikā*.^{620,621} In 2.47–48, Nārāyaṇatīrtha provides further details on the execution of the yoga postures, which will not be elaborated upon here.⁶²²

Of greater significance for understanding Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Haṭhayoga are 2.49–51. Beyond a detailed discussion of the three basic elements of *prāṇāyāma*—exhalation (*recaka*), inhalation (*pūra*), and breath retention (*kumbhaka*)—and their specifics in the commentary to 2.49–50, he then addresses *kevalakumbhaka* in 2.51, the fourth aspect of *prāṇāyāma* and the ultimate goal of breath retention.^{623,624} This *kevalakumbhaka* is attained through a gradual process, advancing subtly from the practice of ordinary *kumbhaka*, specified as *sahitakumbhaka*.⁶²⁵ *Kevalakumbhaka* arises only when the bodily channels have been purified through practice and the movements of inhalation and exhalation have completely ceased. It may be aptly translated as “isolated breath retention,” since it is independent of inhalation and exha-

⁶¹⁹ See birch2018proliferation.

⁶²⁰ A list of the 38 of 84 *āsanas* can be found in *yogacandrika* 2.46 (Ed. p. 107–108): *tac ca padma-siddha-bhadra-vīra-svastika-siṃha-daṇḍa-sopāśraya-paryāṅka-mayūra-kukkuṭa-uttānakukkuṭa-pāścimatāna-matsyendrapīṭha-cakra-gomukha-karma-dhanu-mṛgasvastika-arddhacandra-añjalika-pīṭha-vajra-mukta-candra-arddhaprasāritaśava-kapāla-garuḍa-arddhāsana-kamala-krauñcaṇiṣadana-hastiniṣadana-uṣṭraniṣadanakapiniṣadana-yogāsana-yonyāsana-samasthāna-ādibhedena caturāṣṭiprakāram | eteṣāṃ lakṣaṇāni yogapradīpādāv uktāni* | The detailed descriptions of the 38 *āsanas* immediately follows on pp. 108–114.

⁶²¹ penn2004 (2004: 207–209) has briefly discussed the *āsanas* of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.

⁶²² A detailed sketch of the *prāṇāyāma*-system of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* can be found in penn2004.

⁶²³ *yogacandrika* 1.34 (Ed. p. 116): *asya ca lakṣaṇaṃ yājñavalkya āha—recakaṃ pūraṃ tyaktvā yat sukhaṃ vāyudhāraṇam | prāṇāyāmo 'yam ity uktah sa vai kevalakumbhakah ||* “Yājñavalkya declares its characteristic as follows—Having abandoned inhalation and exhalation, that comfortable restraint of breath is breath-control. This indeed is indeed taught as ‘isolated retention.’”

⁶²⁴ See *hathapradīpikā* 2.72–80 for the *locus classicus* of all descriptions of *kevalakumbhaka*.

⁶²⁵ This *kumbhaka* is “accompanied” (*sahita*) because, unlike *kevalakumbhaka*, it still involves inhalation and exhalation, cf. *hathapradīpikā* 2.73.

lation.⁶²⁶ The yogin who masters *kevalakumbhaka* can hold the breath for an indefinite period.⁶²⁷ Nārāyaṇatīrtha quotes seven of the eight *kumbhaka*s⁶²⁸ of **hathapradipika2024** (except *plāvanī*, cf. **hathapradipika2024** 2.71).⁶²⁹ Next, he explains the other seven *kumbhaka*s already mentioned in the commentary to 1.54 but in more detail.⁶³⁰ Subsequently, the commentary to 2.50 quotes further explanations from various texts, such as *Yogabhāskara*, *Nandipurāṇa* and *Mārkaṇḍeyapurāṇa* on the subject of *prāṇāyāma*. In addition, the four stages (*avasthā*) of yoga practice—*ārambha*, *ghāṭa*, *paricaya* and *niṣpatti* are introduced,⁶³¹ as well as, for example, the yogic dietary guidelines and the dwelling of the yogin based on the explanations of the first chapter of **hathapradipika2024**.

Therefore, Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Haṭhayoga consists mainly of two categories listed in the **hathapradipika2024**⁶³²: *āsana* and *kumbhaka*, both integrated into Pātañjalayoga. The third category, *mudrā*, as well as the *śaṭkarmas*, appear not within Haṭhayoga but in the section on Karmayoga—an unexpected placement given that these practices typically distinguish Haṭhayoga from other yoga systems. Nārāyaṇatīrtha acknowledges their connection to Haṭhayoga, yet deliberately treats them under Karmayoga; accordingly, they will be discussed later in that context. The fourth Haṭhayoga category, *nāḍānu-sandhāna*, is absent from the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. Crucially, Nārāyaṇatīrtha

⁶²⁶ Cf. **yogacandrika** 2.51: *evambhūta ubhayoḥ śvāsapraśvāsayor gativicchedaś caturthaḥ prāṇāyāma ity arthaḥ | etena sahitakumbhakābhyāsa evāsyā 'śādhāraṇam | yadā nāḍīviśuddhiḥ syād yogīnaḥ tattvadarśinaḥ | tadā vidhvastadoṣasya bhavet kevalasambhavaḥ ||*

⁶²⁷ Cf. **hathapradipika2024** 2.76.

⁶²⁸ **yogacandrika** 2.51, Ed. p. 118–121. The seven *kumbhaka*s mentioned by Nārāyaṇatīrtha are: 1. *sūryabhedana*; 2. *ujjāyī*; 3. *sītka(ra)*; 4. *śītalī*; 5. *brahmarī*; 6. *mūrchā*; and 7. *bhastrikā*.

⁶²⁹ Cf. **hathapradipika2024** 2.48–71.

⁶³⁰ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 2.51, p. 121: *kumbhaḥ saptavidho jñeyo recitāḍiprabhedataḥ | recitaṃ pūratiḥ śāntaḥ pratyāhārottoro'dharaḥ || samaś ceti vinirdiṣṭaḥ kumbhakaḥ saptabhedataḥ iti eteṣāṃ lakṣaṇāni cāha— recitasya bahistambho vāyo recitakumbhakaḥ | pūrakeṇa vinā samyag yogo 'yaṃ sukhado nṛṇāṃ || 1 || pūritasyodare rodhaḥ paścādrecaḥ samyutaḥ | nāḍīśuddhikaraḥ samyak proktaḥ pūritakumbhakaḥ || 2 || kāyasyāntarbahir vyāptir yā sa syāc chāntakumbhakaḥ || 3 || sthānāyor antare rodhaḥ pratyāhārākhyakumbhakaḥ || 4 || āpūrayet kramād ūrdhvam ūrdhvarodho hṛdādiṣu || 5 || uttaraḥ kumbhakaḥ sa syād adho 'dho mūrddhato 'dharaḥ || 6 || recanāpūraṇe tyaktvā manasā maruto dhṛtiḥ | yā nābhyād pradeśeṣu samaḥ kumbhaḥ prakīrtitaḥ || 7 ||*

⁶³¹ See **asiddhi viveka** 19, 21, 29 and 31 for the oldest account of the four stages. Also cf. **hathapradipika2024** 4.16–25.

⁶³² Cf. **hathapradipika2024** 1.56.

states at the end of his commentary on *sūtra* 2.28 that Haṭhayoga yields only bodily perfection and does not directly lead to Rājayoga.⁶³³

3.6.3 Haṭhayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

In the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (3.1–52), Haṭhayoga is both an individual category (3.1–12) and a superordinate category. In the following, Haṭhayoga is primarily discussed as the individual category. As a superordinate category, it subsumes three other yogas, namely Rājayoga (3.13–24), Lakṣayoga (3.25–36) and Aṣṭāṅgayoga (3.37–52). These subcategories will be only briefly characterised in this section. They are then discussed in detail in the respective section of this comparative analysis according to the order of the list of the fifteen yogas of the *Tattvayogabindu*.⁶³⁴

Sundardās traces his Haṭhayoga back to Ādināth, Matsyendra, Gorakṣa, Carpaṭa, Kāṇeri and Cauraṅga.⁶³⁵ He specifies the union of sun and moon as its definition.⁶³⁶ This is followed by describing the ideal environment for yoga practice, short practice instructions and dietary rules (3.2–8). These are closely reminiscent of the explanations in the first chapter of the *Haṭhapradīpikā*.⁶³⁷ The chapter concludes with the naming of the six actions (*ṣaṭkarmas*). Due to the lack of details in his descriptions, it is hardly comprehensible to perform the practices without a teacher or other instructive texts. Sundardās could not have conceived his chapter on Haṭhayoga as an instruction manual. Instead, his primary aim must have been to characterise it and integrate Haṭhayoga into the overall context of his successive sequence of yogas.

⁶³³ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 98): *etac ca sarvaṃ yogāṅgānuṣṭhānād iti sūtre sūtritam api haṭhayogāṅgatvena dehasiddhamātraphalatvena sāksād rājayogān āngatvāt kaṇṭharaveṇa sūtrakṛtā noktām iti mantavyam iti saṃkṣepaḥ* || 28 ||

⁶³⁴ A French description of the Haṭhayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* can be found in burger2014sarvangayogapradipika.

⁶³⁵ *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 1.4: *ādinātha matsyendra aru, goraṣa carpaṭa mīna | kāṇeri cauraṅga puni, haṭha su yoga ini kinā* || 4 ||

⁶³⁶ *sarvangayoga* 3.1: *abahi hahūṃ haṭhayoga sunāi | ādinātha ke bandaiṃ pāi | ravi śaśi dōu eka milāvai | yāhi teṃ haṭhayoga kahāvai* || 1 ||

⁶³⁷ See *hathapradipika*2024 1.57–60.

The ideal environment for Haṭhayoga is in a well-governed country where justice prevails. Here, the yogin is supposed to build a hut (*maṭhikā*) with a small door and no holes. The yogin shall smear the hut with cow dung for this purpose. A small well is dug into the ground next to the hut.^{638,639} The yogin is supposed to sit in the hut, devote himself to Haṭhayoga and regulate the breath.⁶⁴⁰ Accordingly, for Sundardās, as in all texts with complex yoga taxonomies without exception, breath cultivation is the central element of Haṭhayoga. In the following, he specifies the practice of yoga postures (*āsana*).⁶⁴¹ Furthermore, Sundardās recommends ritual washing and god worship in the morning.⁶⁴² The diet is supposed to be regulated.⁶⁴³ For Sundardās, this means avoiding hot, spicy and sour foods. Specifically mustard, sesame, alcohol, meat, green vegetables, ginger and garlic, shall be avoided, too.⁶⁴⁴ A diet of rice, milk,⁶⁴⁵ ghee, honey and gourd vegetables is recommenced. Furthermore, pure water is supposed to be ingested.⁶⁴⁶ When the haṭhayogin eats in this way, his body is freed from disease.⁶⁴⁷

Verses 3.9–11 mention the six actions (*ṣaṭkarmas*)—*dhauti*, *basti*, *neti*, *trāṭaka*, *naulī* and *kapālabhātī*. They are supposed to purify the channels,⁶⁴⁸ and lead to success.⁶⁴⁹ In the last verse of this section, we learn that the power of Haṭhayoga leads to bliss.⁶⁵⁰

⁶³⁸Ibid. 3.2–3ab: *prathama sudharma deśa kahuṃ tākai | bhalau rājya kachu deśala na jākai | tāhām jāi kai maṭhikā kari | alpa dvāra aru chidra su bharaī || 2 || līpta karai cahūṃ ora sugandhā | kūpa sahita maṭha ihiṃ bidhi baṃdhā |*

⁶³⁹Cf. *hathapradīpikā* 2024 1.12–13.

⁶⁴⁰*Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.3cd: *tāmahiṃ paiṭhi karai abhyāsā | gutu gami haṭha kari jātai svāsā || 3 ||*

⁶⁴¹*Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.5ab: *haṭhi kari āsana sādhaiṃ bhāi haṭha kari nidrā tajatau jāi |*

⁶⁴²Ibid. 3.7b: *prāta sanāna upāsana koī |* What this might have looked like is described in great detail within the first chapter of the *Yogakarnikā*.

⁶⁴³Ibid. 3.5c: *haṭha hi kari āhāra ghaṭavai |*

⁶⁴⁴Ibid. 3.6: *haṭha kari tikṣaṇa kaṭuka sutyāgai | sarasoṃ tila mada māṃsa na māṃgai | harita śāka kabahū nahim šai | hiṃgu lasanu saba deśa bahāi || 6 ||*

⁶⁴⁵Ibid. 3.7c: *gohūṃ śālī su karai ahārā |*

⁶⁴⁶Ibid. 3.8ab: *šira śāṃḍa ghrta madhi puni sāṃnī sūṃṭhi paṭola nirmala ati pāṃnī |*

⁶⁴⁷Ibid. 3.8cd: *yahu bhojana su karai haṭha yogi dina dina kāyā hoi nirogi || 8 ||*

⁶⁴⁸Ibid. 3.9b: *nāḍi śuddha homhi mala ṭalai |*

⁶⁴⁹Ibid. 3.10c: *ye ṣaṭa karma siddhi ke dātā |*

⁶⁵⁰Ibid. 3.12a: *yā haṭha yoga prabhāva teṃ, pragaṭa hoi ānanda |*

As already mentioned at the beginning, Sundardās also subsumes Rājayoga (3.13–24), Lakṣayoga (3.25–36) and Aṣṭāṅgayoga (3.37–52) under the superordinate category Haṭhayoga. Sundardās' Rājayoga practice is that which is commonly known as *vajrolīmudrā*.⁶⁵¹ Lakṣ(y)ayoga, a practice found in all complex late medieval taxonomies, is the fixation of the gaze (*dṛṣṭi*) on differently located foci (focal points or objects) inside or outside the body. With regard to Aṣṭāṅgayoga, Sundardās discusses the generally known eight limbs individually. Similar to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, characteristic practices of Haṭhayoga such as *āsanas*, *kumbhakas*, *mudrās* and *bandhas* are assigned to the individual limbs. A detailed comparative discussion of the subcategories takes place in the following chapters.

3.6.4 Haṭhayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Haṭhayoga across the examined yoga taxonomies demonstrates that, while the defining practices of Haṭhayoga are largely agreed upon, the texts differ markedly in how they classify, prioritise, and situate these practices within their broader soteriological systems. In all cases, Haṭhayoga is defined primarily through bodily and respiratory techniques, yet its doctrinal framing varies substantially. The *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* present a twofold model of Haṭhayoga, comprising *prāṇāyāma* and the *śaṭkarmas* on one hand, and contemplation on coloured light on the other, and both ultimately frame Haṭhayoga as a technique in service of Rājayoga. In the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Haṭhayoga is defined chiefly through *prāṇāyāma* and *āsana*, while *śaṭkarma* and *mudrā* are reassigned to Karmayoga; for Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Haṭhayoga serves bodily perfection but cannot directly yield Rājayoga. Sundardās reverses this hierarchy, placing Rājayoga within the domain of Haṭhayoga and identifying it with *vajrolīmudrā*. His system integrates *prāṇāyāma*, *āsana* and *śaṭkarma* as core elements of Haṭhayoga, while *mudrā* and *bandha* appear under *Aṣṭāṅgayoga*; his twelve yogas function not as alternatives but as interdependent limbs culminating in Advaitayoga.

⁶⁵¹The verses do not specify the term, but the practice is identical.

Taken together, the variation of implementations across the texts containing complex yoga taxonomies demonstrates the remarkable flexibility of the Haṭhayoga concept in early modern yogic thought. Rather than presenting a fixed or self-contained system, Haṭhayoga emerges as a versatile constellation of techniques—one that can be hierarchised, integrated, subordinated, or expanded according to shifting doctrinal priorities. Its meaning, therefore, resides not merely in its techniques but in how it is positioned relationally within broader yogic frameworks. Haṭhayoga becomes a dynamic category, shaped by its context, negotiable in scope, and continually redefined through its interaction with other forms of yoga.

3.7 Karmayoga

KARMAYOGA, the “Yoga of deeds”, is well-known from the **kaushikī**1993⁶⁵². The concept of the Karmayoga of the **kaushikī**1993 is absent in our four complex early modern taxonomies of yogas. Instead, other concepts of Karmayoga emerged. Rāmacandra lists Karmayoga as the fifth method of Rājayoga within the yoga taxonomy of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Karmayoga is the third yoga mentioned in the yoga taxonomy of the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. The *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* does not mention Karmayoga at all.

3.7.1 Karmayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Both texts mention Karmayoga in their taxonomies. However, they do not explicitly describe a Karmayoga in the course of the text, unlike other yoga categories. The absence surprises the reader, as the initial list of fifteen yogas and the subsequent description of Kriyāyoga, as the first entry in the list, is immediately treated first within a separate section of the text. The expectation is reinforced by the subsequent sections that more or less follow the order provided by the initial taxonomy. However, this expected structure fades away as the text progresses. This observation results in at least three

⁶⁵² See for example **kaushikī**1993 2.47–49, 3.1–7, & 4.20. Here, Karmayoga is a path (*mārga*) to liberation (*mokṣa*) through action (*karma*) without attachment to one’s deeds.

possible explanations. Either the list merely served to illustrate the diversity of the different categories of yoga, and it was never the authors' intention to cover all the yogas in the text, or the transmission of the text has fallen victim to corruption. The third possibility is that some yogas are present not explicitly but only implicitly in the text. Regarding the latter possibility, there exists one passage in both texts that could hypothetically cover the Karmayoga aspect of the text.

The passage under consideration belongs to section *Tattvayogabindu* XLI. Like the previous sections, starting with XXXII, this section deals with the microcosmic equivalents of the macrocosm in the yogic body. In particular, it deals with the listing of various macrocosmic contents which are situated
5 in specific bodily locations, such as twenty-seven stars, twelve signs of the zodiac, nine planets, etc. At the very end of this topic, in both texts, the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, a passage appears that speaks of liberation (*mukti*) through a specific action (*karma*). The *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, Ed. pp. 843–844) reads:

10 *samagradarśanān muktaḥ svargabhogañ ca matsukham |*
tad etaccintayā yāti rogaśokavivarjitaḥ ||
yat karmakarṇā śāṅkā manomadhye bhaved bahiḥ |
tat karmakaraṇaṁ muktir ity āha bhagavān śivaḥ ||

Freed as a result of complete vision,⁶⁵³ [there is] heavenly pleasure and my bliss.⁶⁵⁴ By contemplating that, one becomes free from sorrow and disease. That action which causes doubt in the mind should be abandoned. Performing such an action leads to liberation, says the exalted Śiva.

Thus, the specific action which leads to liberation is initiated by the complete vision of the contents of the yogic body, resulting in pleasure and bliss.

⁶⁵³The formulation *samagradarśanāt* refers back to the previously mentioned microcosmic contents of the macrocosm.

⁶⁵⁴Since Śiva is speaking, *matsukham* must refer to Śiva's bliss.

One is supposed to contemplate the contents of the yogic body and abandon doubt. It is this very action (*karma*) which leads to liberation *mukti* in the *Yogasvarodaya*. Rāmacandra's reformulations paint a different picture. This passage almost appears out of place since he fails to express the thematic reference—the yogic body—clearly. Rāmacandra seems to miss the point by proclaiming that deeds that lead to nothing good bind man⁶⁵⁵ and that deeds that do not produce fear are the cause of liberation. The connection to the yogic body, which also in Rāmacandra's text precedes this formulation is bypassed. The end of *Tattvayogabindu* XLI reads:

*puruṣasya nṛtyadarśanāt || gītaśravaṇāt || vallabhavastuno darśanāt ||
ya ānanda utpadyate saḥ svargalokaḥ kathyate | rogaṇḍādurdurjanebhyah
puruṣasya yad duḥkhaṁ utpadyate | tad bahutaraṁ naraḥ kathyate |
atha ca yatkarmakaraṇāt sarveṣāṁ lokānāṁ svamanasi ca śubhaṁ na
bharate tat karma bandhanam ity ucyate | atha ca yatkarmakaraṇān
manomadhye śaṅkā na bhavati tat karma muktikāraṇam |*

The person's bliss that is generated as a result of seeing dance, listening to songs, [and] viewing beloved objects, that [bliss] is called heaven. The person's suffering that arises as a result of the pain caused by disease and wicked people, that great [suffering] is called hell. Moreover, an action that does not bring goodness to all people and one's mind, that action is said to be bondage. And furthermore, the action that, when performed, does not cause doubt in the mind, that action is the cause of liberation.

Thus, even though both texts do not introduce Karmayoga as a separate topic, they at least present a path to liberation through action (*karma*). In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the action (*karma*) is the contemplation of the microcosmic equivalents of the macrocosm within the yogic body without doubts. Whereas in the *Tattvayogabindu*, it is the cultivation of all actions that bring goodness and the renunciation of actions that lead to dread.

⁶⁵⁵ Presumably to the cycle of rebirth (*saṁsāra*).

3.7.2 Karmayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates his Karmayoga⁶⁵⁶ in the context of his commentary on *sūtra* 2.28:⁶⁵⁷

yogāṅgānuṣṭhānād asuddhikṣaye jñānadīptir āvivekakhyāteḥ || 28 ||

As a result of the execution of the limbs of yoga upon the destruction of impurities, the lamp of knowledge arises up to the realisation of discrimination.

This *sūtra* introduces a description of the eight well-known limbs of Pātañjalayoga. Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains that the practice of the eight limbs leads to the realisation of the overarching goal of yoga, the discriminating knowledge of *puruṣa* and *prakṛti*, thereby removing ignorance (*vidyā*) and manifesting liberation. He then presents Karmayoga as an alternative for attaining the lamp of knowledge.⁶⁵⁸

*athavā yogāṅgānām dhautivastityādiṣaṭkarmaṇām mahāmudrādīnām
ca anuṣṭhānād dṛḍhābhyāsaj jñānadīptiḥ | jñāyate 'neneti jñānam
karaṇavargah | tasya dīptiḥ rogādyanabhighātena tejasvitā dṛḍhatā ca,
āvivekakhyāteḥ vivekakhyātiparyantaṁ bhavatīty arthaḥ | rogādīnā
jñānasya kuṇṭhabhāvas tu prasiddha eva | sa caiteṣv aṅgeṣv anuṣṭhiteṣu
rogapratibandhān na bhavatīty arthaḥ | tathā ca karaṇadārḍhyadvārā
samādhidārḍhyārthārthakarmayogo 'pi prathamato 'nuṣṭheyo rogab-
hīruṇeti bhāvaḥ | sa ca karmayogaḥ ṣaṭkarmarūpo mudrārūpaś ceti
dvividho nirūpita ākare yathā |*

Alternatively, as a result of executing consistent practice of the limbs of yoga, [particularly] of the six actions like Dhauti, Vasti etc. and the great seal etc., the lamp of knowledge arises. By

⁶⁵⁶See penna2004 (2004: 67–20) for an earlier discussion of Karmayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.

⁶⁵⁷*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. pp. 92–98.

⁶⁵⁸This differentiation inevitably awakens the association with the differentiation of the eight-fold yoga according to Yajñavalkya and the Hatha yoga with *mudrās* etc. of Kapila already stated in datta2024 29.

the [word] “*jñāna* (knowledge)”, the group of sense organs is to be understood. Its “*dīpti* (lamp)” becomes brilliant and robust without damage through diseases, etc. The meaning of [the word] “*āvivekakhyāteḥ* (up to the realisation of discrimination)” extends as far as the realisation of discrimination. Through diseases, etc., the state of the inefficiency of the sense organs (*jñāna*) is thus established. Furthermore, the meaning of “after having practised these limbs” is [that] there are no obstacles from diseases. And thus, Karmayoga is the means for acquiring resilience of the sense organs for the steadfastness of *samādhi*, which shall be practised first so that one does not become afraid of disease. And that Karmayoga, having the nature of the six actions and having the nature of the seals is discussed twofold accordingly.

Next, Nārāyaṇatīrtha simply lists the *ṣaṭkarmas* and nine *mudrās*:

dhautī vastī tathā neti trāṭakaṃ naulikam tathā |
kapālabhātī caitāni ṣaṭ karmāṇi pracakṣate ||
karmaṣaṭkam idaṃ gopyaṃ dehaśodhanakāraṇam iti |
mahāmudrā mahābandho mahāvedhaś ca khecarī ||
śakticālo mūlabandha uḍḍiyānaṃ tataḥ param |
jālandharābhidho yogo viparītakṛtis tatheti ||
lakṣaṇāni ca tatraivoktāni |

Dhautī, Vastī, as well as Neti, Trāṭaka and Nauli, and also Kapālabhāti—these six actions are being told. This hexade of action is to be kept secret as it produces the purification of the body. The great seal, the great lock, the great piercing and Khecarī, the stimulation of the goddess, the root lock, Uḍḍiyāna [and] thereafter [that] yoga [practice which is] known as Jālandhara as well as the act of inversion. The characteristics are described there [in the following].

Subsequently, Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents verses containing instructive descriptions of every practice borrowed from earlier yoga texts.⁶⁵⁹ Even though Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates the *śaṭkarmas* and *mudrās* within his Karmayoga, at the very end of the section on Karmayoga he notes that they are part of the practice of Haṭhayoga.⁶⁶⁰

3.7.3 Karmayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Karmayoga within the complex yoga taxonomies contained some surprising findings. Although three texts with complex yoga taxonomies list Karmayoga, only one of them contains a concrete description of a yoga method labelled as such.

Karmayoga is explicitly mentioned in the yoga taxonomies of *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*, but is not introduced in a separate section and dedicated description. Nevertheless, both texts contain passages that describe liberation (*mukti*) through action (*karma*). Thus, even though both texts do not introduce Karmayoga as a separate topic, they at least present a path to liberation through action (*karma*). In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the action (*karma*) is the contemplation of the yogic body without doubt. Whereas in the *Tattvayogabindu*, it is the cultivation of actions (*karmas*) that bring goodness and the renunciation of actions that lead to dread.

In Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, the action (*karma*) of his Karmayoga is the practice of the *śaṭkarmas* and nine *mudrās*. As a highly educated Kṛṣṇa devotee and intellectual, Nārāyaṇatīrtha should have known the Karmayoga of the *Bhagavadgītā* well. However, there is not trace of that at all. His concept of Karmayoga is, therefore, all the more unusual and innovative. Nārāyaṇatīrtha's interpretation thus opens up another possibility for an explanation of the absence of a named description of Karmayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*. If one were willing to consider that Rāmacandra and the unknown author of the *Yogasvarodaya* shared

⁶⁵⁹The section on the *śaṭkarmas* is based on *Haṭhapradīpikā* 2.24–26, whereas the descriptions of the *mudrās* are primarily taken from the *Yogacintāmanī*, Ed. p. 132 et seqq.

⁶⁶⁰*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 98): *etac ca sarvaṃ yogāṅgānuṣṭhānād iti sūtre sūtritam api haṭhayogāṅgatvena dehasiddhamātraphalatvena sāksād rājayogān āṅgatvāt kaṇṭharaveṇa sūtrakṛtā noktam iti mantavyam iti saṃkṣepaḥ* || 28 ||

Nārāyaṇatīrtha's view of Karmayoga, the *śaṭkarmas* in both texts would already be covered in their section on Haṭhayoga, which would render repeated description redundant.

3.8 Layayoga

LAYAYOGA, the “Yoga of absorption”, was frequently discussed in recent academic discourse primarily due to the increased popularity of academic research on the early texts of Haṭhayoga and the publication of critical editions of those texts.⁶⁶¹

The Layayoga of **datta2024** (15–26) is a state of mind that one reaches through fifteen million secret methods called *saṃketas*. From this methodological variety, Dattātreyā describes a total of seven, e.g. permanent meditation on the *śūnya*, i.e. day and night while sitting still, moving, sleeping and eating⁶⁶², staring at the region between the eyebrows,⁶⁶³ or fixation of the gaze on the big toe of the right foot.⁶⁶⁴

In the **amaraugha2024** (18–19) only one method of Layayoga is mentioned. The method consists of visualising dripping nectar in the body and then meditating on Kāmarūpa, the exact location of which is not specified, on Śiva in the form of a *līṅga* that shines like a jewel.⁶⁶⁵

A text that in terms of content is particularly close to the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* is the 15th century *Śivayogapradīpikā*.⁶⁶⁶ Here, a *layayogin* is someone who has succeeded in dissolving their mind, together with their inner organ and breath, in the object of meditation, or inner resonance.⁶⁶⁷

⁶⁶¹For example the ERC-funded **hyp-website** (2015–2020), see <http://hyp.soas.ac.uk/> (Alternatively: <https://web.archive.org/web/20240516171430/http://hyp.soas.ac.uk/>; saved on archive.org: 04.10.2023).

⁶⁶²*Dattātraya yogaśāstra* 21: *tiṣṭan gacchan svapan bhuñjan dhyāyec chūnyam aharniśam | ayam eko hi saṃketa ādhināthena bhāṣitaḥ* || 21 ||

⁶⁶³*Ibid.* 23: *bhrūmadhyadṛṣṭimātreṇa paraḥ saṃketa ucyate | līlāvibhūtilepaś ca uttamaḥ parikirtitaḥ* || 23 ||

⁶⁶⁴*Ibid.* 24ab: *svasya dakṣiṇapādasya aṅguṣṭhe laya uttamaḥ* |

⁶⁶⁵**amaraugha2024** 18: *kāmarūpe sitaṃ devaṃ līṅgābhaṃ mañisannibhaṃ | dravantaṃ cāmṛtaṃ prekṣya yo dhyāyēn nijavigrahe* || 18 ||

⁶⁶⁶See p. 410 for a discussion.

⁶⁶⁷*Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.6: *yasya cittam nijadhyeye manasā marutā saha | linaṃ bhavati nāde vā layayogī sa eva hi* || 6 ||

The term *laya*, in these texts, thus refers to the “dissolution” of the mind through specific methods. In other contexts, the term *laya* is also used as a synonym for *samādhi*. There are even Buddhist and Vedic texts in which the term *laya* has negative connotations and is regarded as an obstacle to meditation or gnosis. However, in the texts of the complex yoga taxonomies, such negative views on different *layas* are absent.⁶⁶⁸

Layayoga occupies fifth place in the taxonomy of the *Tattvayogabindu*’s methods of Rājayoga but is not listed in the verses on the fifteen yogas of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Ultimately, however, an explicit description of Layayoga is missing in both texts. The omission of a separate section on Layayoga likely results from its thematic overlap with specific teachings of the text. According to amaraugha2024 (2024: 37, n. 86), the 14th century peterson1888 (4350–4363) contains perhaps the oldest tradition of Layayoga which aims at absorption of the mind into *cakras*. The section is introduced with the words “*atha layayoga ||*” and states that Kṛṣṇadvaipāyana and others attained the state called *laya* by performing *laya* over the nine *cakras*.⁶⁶⁹ Just as in the *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, pp. 832–833) and *Tattvayogabindu* (section IV–XII), peterson1888 presents a description of the nine *cakras* together with instructions and results of the respective meditation on every single *cakra*. Other “classical” methods of Layayoga from earlier texts can also be found scattered in the *Yogasvarodaya* or *Tattvayogabindu*, such as the fixation of the gaze on the big toe⁶⁷⁰ or the centre of the eyebrows.⁶⁷¹ Summa summarum, the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya* actually do include many practices typically associated with Layayoga, but these are not referred to as Layayoga when presented in the text.

In the taxonomy of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Layayoga occupies the thirteenth place. In Sundardās’s *Sarvāṅgayogaṇḍīkā*, Layayoga is presented as one of the methods of Bhaktiyoga.

⁶⁶⁸See amaraugha2024 (2024: 35–37) for the detailed documentation of the complex reception-historical scope of the term *layayoga* based on evidence from numerous texts of yoga’s relevant subgenres.

⁶⁶⁹peterson1888 4350: *kṛṣṇadvaipāyanādyais tu sādhitō layasaṃjñitāḥ | navasv eva hi cakreṣu layaṃ kṛtvā mahātmabhiḥ ||4||*

⁶⁷⁰*Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 839; YK 2.16) as well as *Tattvayogabindu* section XXX.

⁶⁷¹*Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 839; YK 2.35) and *Tattvayogabindu* section XXX.

3.8.1 Layayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha places his discussion of Layayoga⁶⁷² in the context of his commentary on *sūtra* 1.41:⁶⁷³

samprajñātasya viṣayaṃ pradarśayan na samprajñātā 'paraparyāyaṃ layayogam āha—kṣīṇavṛtter abhijātasyeva maṇer grahīṭṛgrahaṇa-grāhyeṣu tatsthatadañjanatā samāpattiḥ || 41 ||

[In] pointing out the object of [the] *samprajñāta*[-type of *samādhi*], [the text] does not state [that the] *samprajñāta* is [merely] another designation for Layayoga—[rather,] *samāpatti*, [the state of complete absorption of the mind] of one who is devoid of its mental fluctuations, happens when the mind becomes like a pure crystal that takes the form of the object placed before it, whether it is the knower, the instrument of knowing, or that which is to be known.

After the previous *sūtras* introduced various objects that can support the mind in meditation, this *sūtra* now continues the analysis of different stages within the state of meditation, regardless of its object.⁶⁷⁴ When the *vṛttis* of the mind fade, the mind becomes more and more like a crystal (*maṇi*). Just as a crystal takes on the colouring (*añjanatā*) of any object placed in front of it, the clear mind focusing on any object also takes on the colouring of that very object.⁶⁷⁵ With regard to the objects that serve absorption, here, the *sūtra* specifies the hierarchical sequence of the knower (*grahīṭṛ*), the instrument of knowledge (*grahaṇa*) and that what is to be known (*grāhya*). For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, the knower is *puruṣa*. The instrument of knowledge is the sense organs, and what is to be known is the object that can be grasped by

⁶⁷²For an earlier discussion see penn2004.

⁶⁷³*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 64.

⁶⁷⁴This analysis already began in *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 1.17.

⁶⁷⁵*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 1.34 (Ed. p. 64): *uparāgeṇa tadākāratāyāṃ dṛṣṭāntam āha—abhijātasyeva maṇer iti | nirmalasya sphaṭikāder yathā japākusumādyuparāgeṇa raktādyākāratā tathety arthaḥ |*

the mind.⁶⁷⁶ Depending on which object the mind focuses on, it takes on its colour and nature. The term *samāpatti* refers to the complete identification of the mind with the object of meditation. Nārāyaṇatīrtha then equates the term *samāpatti* with *laya*.⁶⁷⁷

*teṣu yā tatsthatadañjanatā tatsthena uparāgeṇa tadañjanatā tanmayatā
samyak tadākāratā samāpattiḥ samyagāpattir layaḥ samprajñātalakṣaṇo
yogo bhavatīty arthaḥ |*

In those [objects] that are [in the] “state of being colored by residing in that”, by [the act of] residing in that, [and] by coloration, the state of being colored [arises], [which is] the complete identification of that form; [that] is absorption (*samāpatti*); the complete immersion into [that] state is Laya, which is a yoga characterised as *samprajñāta*. This is the meaning.

For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Layayoga is therefore a synonym for the state of *samāpatti* and is attributed to the *samprajñāta* form of *samādhi*, in which the consciousness is still focussed on one of the aforementioned objects. *Samprajñātasamādhi* is also known as “*samādhi* with discrimination”, as the meditator retains awareness of the distinction between the meditator, the meditation object and the process of meditation itself. It is therefore a *samādhi* in which there is still a minimal remainder of *vṛtti*s, in contrast to the final *asamprajñāta* form of *samādhi* in which the last *vṛtti* also expires and final liberation—the state called *kaivalya* (“isolation” [of *puruṣa*]) occurs.⁶⁷⁸

⁶⁷⁶Ibid. I.34 (Ed. p. 64): *kṣīṇavṛtter iti | abhyāsavairāgyābhyām apagamavṛtityantarasya cittasya grahitṛgrahaṇagrāhyeṣu, grahitā puruṣaḥ sthūlasūkṣmabhedena, grahaṇam grhyate 'rtho 'nenetīndriyam, evam grāhyam ca grahitṛgrahaṇagrāhyāni |*

⁶⁷⁷*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 64.

⁶⁷⁸See *yogasūtra* I.17–22 for more detailed explanations of the *samprajñāta* and *asamprajñāta* forms of *samādhi*.

3.8.2 Layayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

For Sundardās, Layayoga (2.28–39) is a subcategory of Bhaktiyoga.^{679,680} He describes it as a method for the liberation from the cycle of birth and death.⁶⁸¹ Sundardās emphasises that Layayoga is an incomparable method and therefore attaches great importance to it among the yoga methods he presents.⁶⁸² Layayoga dispels all illusion,⁶⁸³ makes one attain the highest state,⁶⁸⁴ dispels anger and difficulties,⁶⁸⁵ and makes one equal to Brahman.⁶⁸⁶ The main emphasis of the practice is the continuous absorption of the mind into a specific goal, which he defines as Rāma⁶⁸⁷ or Hari.⁶⁸⁸ This absorption is supposed to be continued throughout day and night.⁶⁸⁹ To illustrate how exactly this practice is to be carried out, he draws various comparisons. For example, *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* reads 2.35:

*jaisaiṃ gāu jaṃgala kauṃ dhāvai | pānī pivai ghāsa carī āvai |
citta rahai bacharā kai pāsā | aisī laya lāvai haridāsā || 2.35 ||*

Just as a cow walks towards the forest, drinks water, and grazes, but its mind remains near the calf, in such a way, Haridāsā practices Laya.

Another example is *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.36:

*jyaum janani gr̥ha kāja karāi | putra piṃghrau pauḍhata bhāi |
ura apnai taiṃ chana na bisārai | aisī laya jana kauṃ nistārai || 36 ||*

⁶⁷⁹A description of Layayoga in French can be found in burger2014sarvangayogapradipika.

⁶⁸⁰See p. 455 for a discussion of Bhaktiyoga in the complex yoga taxonomies.

⁶⁸¹*Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.28c: *laya binu janma marana nahim chūtai |*

⁶⁸²*Ibid.* 2.29a: *laya samāna nahim aura upāi |*

⁶⁸³*Ibid.* 2.29c: *āvāgamana sakala bhrama bhāgai || 29 ||*

⁶⁸⁴*Ibid.* 2.30d: *parama sthāna samāvai soi || 30 ||*

⁶⁸⁵*Ibid.* 2.32cd: *eśi laya jo kōi lāvai | jonī saṃkṣa bahuri na āvai || 32 ||*

⁶⁸⁶*Ibid.* 2.31a: *yaha laya yoga anupa hai karai brahma samāna |*

⁶⁸⁷*Ibid.* 2.29b: *jo jana rahai rāma laya lāi |*

⁶⁸⁸*Ibid.* 2.38ab: *sa saṃprakāra hari saum lavai | kōi videha parama pada pāvai |*

⁶⁸⁹*Ibid.* 2.29c: *niśi vāsara esaiṃ lai lāgai |*

Just as a mother does the housework while her son plays or crawls nearby and never for a moment forgets him in her heart, *laya* liberates the person who practices it.

As illustrated by these comparisons, Sundardās's concept of Layayoga is the continuous absorption or centring of the mind on Rāma or Hari while performing the necessary daily activities. The examples of the cow and the mother emphasise that this is supposed to be done in a way that resembles the tireless love and attention of a mother towards her child.

3.8.3 Layayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Layayoga within the complex yoga taxonomies displays the full range of historical meanings of Layayoga. While the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* mention Layayoga in their taxonomies, they do not dedicate specific sections to the subject, likely because many of the techniques they teach overlap with practices described in medieval Haṭhayoga texts. In contrast, the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* propagate differing concepts.

For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Layayoga is a synonym for the state of *samāpatti* and is attributed to the *samprajñāta* form of *samādhi*. His concept of *laya* closely aligns with those of earlier commentators on the *Yogasūtra*, such as Bhojadeva in his *patanjalayoga* 1904,⁶⁹⁰ or Vijñānabhikṣu in his *patanjabhasyavartika*,⁶⁹¹ who use *laya* in the sense of *nirodha*, or Śivananda's *yogacintamani*,⁶⁹² for whom *laya* is equated with *samprajñāta*.

For Sundardās, Layayoga belongs to the Bhaktiyoga branch of yoga. It is the continuous absorption or centring of the mind on Rāma or Hari while performing the necessary daily activities. Remarkably, this concept resem-

⁶⁹⁰ *patanjalayoga* 1904 1.2: *tāsām nirodho [...] svakāraṇe layo yoga ity ākhyāyate* | amaraughaz2024 translates: "The cessation of those [mental activities, that is to say,] the dissolution [of them] in their own cause is known as yoga."

⁶⁹¹ *patanjabhasyavartika* 1.2 reads: [...] *vṛttayas tāsām nirodhas tāsām layākhyo* [...] "Their mental fluctuations are restrained; this restraint is called absorption."

⁶⁹² *Yogacintāmaṇi* (Ed. p. 11) reads: *layaḥ samprajñātaḥ*. "Laya is *samprajñāta*."

bles the *saṅketa* described above in *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* 21,⁶⁹³ which prescribes meditation on *śūnya* day and night while sitting still, moving, sleeping, and eating. Basically, the fixation of the mind on *śūnya* is replaced by Rāma or Hari. A distant historical connection between these practices is plausible, as both texts originate from the Vaiṣṇava milieu. The observed shift in practice reflects the central position *bhakti* among Sants like Sundardās.

3.9 Dhyānayoga

DHYĀNAYOGA, the “Yoga of meditation”, occupies the seventh place of the *Tattvayogabindu*’s taxonomy of the fifteen methods of Rājayoga. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, Dhyānayoga is to be found at the fifth position. In both cases, Dhyānayoga as a single subcategory and method of Rājayoga is not discussed explicitly in the remainder of the text. Nevertheless, in the case of Dhyānayoga, the situation in these two texts seems to be similar to the treatment of Layayoga analysed above. Even if not explicitly labelled as Dhyānayoga, both texts inherently contain many specific techniques that could be assigned to this term and are labelled as *dhyānas*. As will be shown, it seems plausible that Rāmacandra and the author of the *Yogasvarodaya* did not dedicate a separate section to Dhyānayoga, as they might have been aware of the various categorical overlaps and wanted to avoid redundancy.⁶⁹⁴

In the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Dhyānayoga is the fourteenth method of Rājayoga Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents, and as with all other yogas, he locates the method within the framework of the *Yogasūtra*.

Sundardās, in his taxonomy of the three yoga tetrads presented in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, does not list Dhyānayoga at all.

⁶⁹³A technique strikingly similar to the *saṅketa* of *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* 21 is the practice of *antarlakṣya* within the *Yogasvarodaya*, cf. *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 824) and *Yogakarṇikā* 2.8–13. The passage is translated and discussed on p. 397.

⁶⁹⁴The avoidance of redundancy must be considered here as a motive for the omission of Dhyānayoga. Text-internal evidence is provided by *Tattvayogabindu* XXXI, p. 206. Here, in the context of a presentation of the eight limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, Rāmacandra writes concerning *dhyāna*: *dhyānaṃ ca bahutaraṃ prāg uktam tenātra nocyate* | “Meditation has been taught many times before. Because of that, it is not discussed here.”

Thus, the only explicit description of Dhyānayoga within the texts of the complex yoga taxonomies occurs in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. For this reason I decided to discuss it first. Interestingly, Nārāyaṇatīrtha's description parallels various *dhyāna*-related contents of the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*.

3.9.1 Dhyānayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates Dhyānayoga in the context of his comparatively extensive commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.39:⁶⁹⁵

*dhyānayogam āha—
yathābhimatadhyānād vā || 39 ||*

[With regard to] Dhyānayoga, it is said—
Or, as a result of meditation on what one favours.

Below, Nārāyaṇatīrtha's commentary explains the various possibilities of Dhyānayoga:

*yatheti | kim bahunā, harirāmādirūpaṃ parameśvaraṃ bāhyaṃ can-
drasūryādijyotiṣaṃ vā yad eveṣṭaṃ tad eva dhyāyetaḥ | tasmād api dhyānāl lab-
dhasthītikasya cittasya sādhanāntaraṃ vināpi kevale paramātmāni sthī-
tau yogyatā bhavātīty arthaḥ | ayam eva dhyānayoga ukto yogagrantheṣu
|
vinā deśādibandhena vṛttir yā 'bhimate sthīrā |
dhyānayogo bhaved eva cittacāñcālyanāśakaḥ ||
ity ādinā |*

[Regarding the term] “yathā”. Why [say] more? One should meditate on the supreme lord in the form of Hari, Rāma, etc., or on an external light such as the moon, sun, etc. [or] just onto what is favoured. Because of that, as a result of meditation alone, the stability of the mind is attained without the need for any other means, enabling one to reside in the supreme self. This is the

⁶⁹⁵ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. pp. 56–63.

meaning. This very Dhyānayoga is taught in the texts of yoga; [for example] in quotations such as:

Without being confined by place, etc., the fluctuations of the mind become stable in the preferred [object]. In fact, Dhyānayoga is the destroyer of the fickleness of the mind.⁶⁹⁶

In his commentary, Nārāyaṇatīrtha addresses common objects for meditation that will lead to the reduction of fluctuations in the mind. An important set of meditation objects he presents in the following lines:

yad vā yathābhimatānāṃ tīrthadevalokavarṇatattvādīnāṃ yathābhimateṣu svadehādiṣu dhyānād bhāvanāviśeṣān manasaḥ sthitir bhavatīty arthaḥ | tatra yady api brahmavido brahmayatvādīnā sarvam eva tīrthaṃ pratilomakūpaṃ ca tīrthāni bhavanti tathāpi yuñjānena cit-tasūddhyarthaṃ prathamatas tīrthādīkam avaśyaṃ bhāvanīyam |

Or, it means that the stability of the mind arises from a specific contemplation, [viz.] from meditation onto favoured [objects] like, for example, sacred sites, deities, worlds, letters, principles, etc., with regard to favoured locations within one's own body. In that case, it is stated, although the knowers of Brahman assert that because of the pervasiveness of Brahman, everything indeed is a sacred place, and even the pores of the skin become places of pilgrimage. Nevertheless, the yogin (*yuñjāna*) who is aiming at the purification of the mind, must inevitably contemplate sacred places, etc. in the beginning [of practice].

Here, Nārāyaṇatīrtha differentiates an alternative form of Dhyānayoga that is suitable particularly for beginners in meditation practice. Nārāyaṇatīrtha devotes the rest of his commentary on *sūtra* 1.39 to this type of meditation, which is aimed at objects located inside the body. He first specifies *tīrthabhāvanā*,⁶⁹⁷ the meditation on sacred places, in which the

⁶⁹⁶ I am yet to identify the source of this *śloka*.

⁶⁹⁷ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 57–59

practitioner is supposed to meditate on various sacred places of the Indian subcontinent in different body parts. Then, he specifies *devabhāvanā*,⁶⁹⁸ the meditation of different deities, which are located in body parts, and *lokabhāvanā*,⁶⁹⁹ the meditation on the worlds in the body and *varṇabhāvanā*,⁷⁰⁰ the meditation on letters in the body. These letters are visualised in one of six *cakras*.⁷⁰¹ Finally, Nārāyaṇatīrtha describes *tattvabhāvanā*, the meditation on the principles.⁷⁰² The commentary concludes by discussing manipulating air currents through the nostrils for beneficial results, such as in heat or cold exposure, intercourse, travelling, etc.⁷⁰³

3.9.2 Dhyānayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Dhyānayoga is mentioned in the taxonomies of both texts⁷⁰⁴ but is not treated as an individual topic. However, various *dhyāna* practices can be found throughout the texts, as the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*, particularly with regards to the *dhyāna*-related practices share the concepts and even the order in which they occur, they are discussed together in this section.

The first mention of the term *dhyāna* occurs in the context of nine *cakras* in the sections of *Tattvayogabindu* IV–XII.⁷⁰⁵ Rāmacandra and the unknown author of the *Yogasvarodaya* instruct *dhyāna* on the respective *cakra*, or a *mūrti* located within the *cakra*. The scribe-author of manuscript U₂ even adds more precise instructions on the duration of the meditations on the respective *cakras*. However, as we discover in section III, Rāmacandra attributes this meditation practice to Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga or Mantrayoga and not to Dhyā-

⁶⁹⁸Ibid. (Ed. p. 59).

⁶⁹⁹Ibid. (Ed. p. 59).

⁷⁰⁰Ibid. (Ed. p. 59).

⁷⁰¹Ibid. (Ed. p. 59–61).

⁷⁰²Ibid. (Ed. p. 61–63).

⁷⁰³A summary of the details of this part of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's commentary has already been sufficiently worked out by pennazoo4 (2004: 91–97). Thus, it is not necessary to repeat it here.

⁷⁰⁴The various mentions of *dhyāna* in this section follow the sections of the *Tattvayogabindu*. For the Sanskrit and the corresponding passages of the *Yogasvarodaya* see the critical edition of the text starting on p. 102.

⁷⁰⁵≈*Yogasvarodaya* (PT, pp. 832–833).

nayoga. The author of the *Yogasvarodaya*, on the other hand, associates the category of Jñānayoga with it.

Next, we encounter the term *dhyāna* in the description of *adholakṣya* in section XV,⁷⁰⁶ in the second subtype of Haṭhayoga in section XX,⁷⁰⁷ in the description of *bāhyalakṣya* in section XXIII,⁷⁰⁸ as well as within *antaralakṣya* in section XXIV.⁷⁰⁹ Another mention can be detected within the list and the eight limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga in section XXXI.⁷¹⁰ Here, Rāmacandra states that *dhyāna* will not be discussed in this context, as this has happened many times before. That instance demonstrates Rāmacandra's attitude towards redundancy. His approach towards redundancy possibly extends to his treatment of certain yoga methods that he initially mentions but does not elaborate on in separate sections of his text, unlike his treatment of other yogas. Unlike Rāmacandra, the *Yogasvarodaya* describes *dhyāna* in the context of its short presentation of Aṣṭāṅgayoga. The unknown author mentions two types of *dhyāna*, a gross and subtle form. The gross form is associated with mantras, and the subtle form is without mantras.⁷¹¹ The text does not provide any further details in this regard.

In *Tattvayogabindu* XXXII–XLI⁷¹² the identity of the external universe with the body is taught. Microcosmic equivalents of various contents, such as the fourteen worlds, mountains and rivers, etc., are located in the body, similar to what we have previously observed in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. However, Rāmacandra fails to provide a concrete reason for listing these physical equivalents of the external universe in the body. However, this is not true for the parallel passages of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Here, the yogic body is listed not only for purely informal reasons but also for meditation. According to the statements of the *Yogasvarodaya*, contemplation of the contents of the yogic body leads to freedom from sorrow and disease and brings about

⁷⁰⁶ ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 834).

⁷⁰⁷ ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 835).

⁷⁰⁸ ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 837).

⁷⁰⁹ ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 838).

⁷¹⁰ ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841).

⁷¹¹ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841 = YK 7.8): *dhyānan tu dvividhaṃ proktaṃ sthūlasūkṣmavibhedataḥ | sthūlaṃ mantramayaṃ viddhi sūkṣmaṃ tu mantravarjitam |*

⁷¹² ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, pp. 841–843).

liberation.⁷¹³ That position is also found in *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 3.1, which says:

piṇḍamadhye carācaram yo jānāti sa yogi piṇḍasaṃvittir bhavati || 1 ||

He who knows the movable and immovable [viz. the whole world] as being in his body, he is a yogin; he has [complete] knowledge of the body.

In section XLVII,⁷¹⁴ in the context of the divisions of the lotus in the heart, Rāmacandra precribes a meditation on the inner eight-petalled heart lotus which is initially downward facing. When the practitioner meditates on it, the light of the self arises, and, caused by the light of meditation, which is compared to sunlight, the inner lotus becomes upward-facing and blooms. This meditation is supposed to lead to the illumination of the self and enhance vitality.

In conclusion, we can state that although Dhyānayoga is not provided with its own section in either text, it is at least implicitly present in both texts and the generic term of meditation (*dhyāna*) is nevertheless a central theme. Due to the numerous overlaps with the previously presented yoga methods, both authors likely omitted a separate description of Dhyānayoga to avoid redundancy.

3.9.3 Dhyānayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Dhyānayoga within the three yoga taxonomies considered here shows that it is consistently situated as a method of Rājayoga. Nārāyaṇatīrtha defines Dhyānayoga as a means to stabilise the mind, distinguishing two groups of meditation techniques: a general group, including meditations on the supreme deity in various forms, light, etc., and a set of practices particularly suited for beginners. The latter comprises *tīrthabhāvanā* (“meditation on microcosmic sacred places”), *devabhāvanā* (“meditation on deities”), *lokabhāvanā* (“meditation on worlds within the

⁷¹³ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, Ed. pp. 843–844). For a translation of the passage, see p. 361.

⁷¹⁴ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, pp. 844).

microcosm of the body”), *varṇabhāvanā* (“meditation on letters within *cakras*”), and *tattvabhāvanā* (“meditation on fundamental principles”).

Dhyānayoga appears in the taxonomies of both the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, although neither text treats it as a discrete topic. Nevertheless, meditation practices are found throughout both works. They mention various forms of *dhyāna*, including meditation on *cakras*, *lakṣyas* (focal points), and bodily locations. In its discussion of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, the *Yogasvarodaya* further distinguishes between a gross form of *dhyāna* employing mantras and a subtle form without mantras. Although Dhyānayoga lacks a dedicated section in these texts, it remains pervasive: meditation is one of the central concerns within both, and its omission as an independent chapter likely serves to avoid redundancy, given its integration into most other methods of Rājayoga.

3.10 Mantrayoga

MANTRAYOGA, the “Yoga of mantra(s)”, appears without exception in all complex early modern yoga taxonomies under consideration. Similarly, in earlier basic fourfold yoga taxonomies, Mantrayoga is always one of the four representatives. In the Vaiṣṇava text called *Dattātrayayogaśāstra* (13th century), Mantrayoga, succeeded by Layayoga, Haṭhayoga and Rājayoga, is the first yoga in the scheme. In this text, the four yogas follow a clearly defined hierarchical order. Mantrayoga is considered the method for the lowest yogis, those with low intellect. With a duration of twelve years, the goal of this Mantrayoga, namely supernatural abilities (*siddhis*), is achieved after a relatively long time. This practice consists of reciting a single mantra after installing the letters of the alphabet on one’s body.⁷¹⁵

The *Amararaugha* (12th century) was composed within a Śaiva milieu and describes the same yogas, albeit in a different order. The scheme begins with Laya- and Haṭha-, followed by Mantra- and Rājayoga. This shows a different form of hierarchy. Here, all yogas are subordinated to Rājayoga only,

⁷¹⁵ *Dattātrayayogaśāstra* 12–14.

although the relatively low status of Mantrayoga is implied as well.⁷¹⁶ The practice of Mantrayoga consists of meditation on the *om* mantra, followed by meditation on a white deity and a mantra beginning with *om* in the heart and then in a *maṇḍala*. After one hundred thousand repetitions and a fire offering (*homa*) after every tenth repetition, this seemingly arduous practice can not only liberate from suffering and death but also ultimately leads to Rājayoga.⁷¹⁷ However, this implicit or explicit hierarchical view which manifested itself within the early medieval texts with basic taxonomies changed a few centuries later in certain discourses. In our complex early modern yoga taxonomies, different perspectives on Mantrayoga dominate.

Mantrayoga occupies the eighth position in the taxonomy of the Rājayoga methods within the *Tattvayogabindu*. It occupies the sixth position in the *Yogasvarodaya*. In both texts, all yogas are considered equally valuable forms of Rājayoga. However, the identification of practices involving mantras is tricky in both texts. As I will argue, the *Tattvayogabindu*, or, at least some of its recipients, might have taught the repetition of *so 'ham* which sometimes is called the *ajapā* mantra.⁷¹⁸ In the available textual evidence of the *Yogasvarodaya*, a description of Mantrayoga is absent. In Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* Mantrayoga is the fifth method for his Pātañjala based model of Rājayoga. His innovation is in directly integrating Mantrayoga with Jñānayoga and Advaitayoga. Among the sequence of yogas in Sūradās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* Mantrayoga is considered to be one of the four methods of Bhaktiyoga.

In none of these texts exists an implicit or explicit statement that the practices of Mantrayoga are an inferior form of yoga practice to be performed by remarkably untalented people, or that they would take a comparatively

⁷¹⁶ amaraugha2024 6: *nityaṃ mantraparo labheta bhavatāṃ naivādhipatyam tathā divyastri-navasaṅgamo 'py anuḍinaṃ na dhyāyato labhyate | hastinyas turagāḥ kareṇukarabhāḥ śālyān nadā gopradā jāyante haṭhayoginas tu vaśagā naitat prasādam vinā || 3 ||* amaraugha2024 translates: "One devoted to [reciting] mantras would never obtain śivahood and sovereignty; one meditating every day does not obtain even the first union with divine women, and a *haṭhayogī* cannot control cow elephants, horses, bull elephants, camels, givers of gruel and givers of cows without the serenity of [Rājayoga]."

⁷¹⁷ For an exhaustive discussion of Mantrayoga in the *Amarauḡha*, see amaraugha2024.

⁷¹⁸ Repetition of *so 'ham* or *ajapā* mantra are e.g. attested in *Yogabīja* 106–107 and *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 29–31.

long time to achieve the overarching yogic goals. This observation suggests that practices labelled Mantrayoga were regaining popularity despite the disparaging voices of earlier texts.

3.10.1 Mantrayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Apart from the mention of Mantrayoga in the initial verses quoted from the *Yogasvarodaya* in the *Prāṇatoṣinī*⁷¹⁹, the quotations we have do not contain a dedicated description of Mantrayoga, similar to the case of Layayoga and Dhyānayoga. However, in the context of the *Yogasvarodaya*'s description of Aṣṭāṅgayoga⁷²⁰ a practice involving *mantras* is mentioned in passing. The unknown author distinguishes two types of *dhyāna*—one is said to be gross and the other subtle. The gross type is associated with *mantras*, while the subtle type is devoid of *mantras*. The available testimonies of the *Yogasvarodaya* do not provide further details.

In the *Tattvayogabindu*, however, the term Mantrayoga appears again in section III:

*idānīm rājayogasya bhedaḥ kathyante | ke te | ekaḥ siddhakuṇḍalinīyogaḥ
mantrayogaḥ amū rājayogau kathyete |*

Now, varieties of Rājayoga are described. Which are these? One is Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and one is Mantrayoga. These two Rājayogas are described [in the following].

After that, Rāmacandra discusses the three primary channels of the yogic body: Idā, Piṅgalā and Suṣumnā. The section concludes with the assertion that the practitioner becomes omniscient once knowledge about the central channel is generated. The subsequent sections (IV–XII) present a system consisting of nine *cakras*.

This passage is problematic from a text-critical perspective. Rāmacandra is very much orientated towards his textual source, the *Yogasvarodaya*, in terms of structure and content, particularly in the first half of his text.

⁷¹⁹ See *Prāṇatoṣinī* (Ed. p. 831) quoted with reference *yogasvarodaye*.

⁷²⁰ See *Yogasvarodaya* PT, p. 841.

However, the *Yogasvarodaya* specifies *jñānayoga* instead of *siddhakuṇḍalinīyogaḥ mantrayogaḥ*. As usual, the remainder of the section is very similar in content to the *Yogasvarodaya*. Nevertheless, the manuscripts offer no alternatives for the conspicuous passage, so that the text must be accepted for the time being. Another reason is the seemingly strange sentence construction, which is ultimately unsurprising if one knows the rest of the text and can be accepted. Right after the term *mantrayogaḥ*, the reader would have wished for a *ca* (“and”). Only the manuscript L omits the term *mantrayogaḥ* but preserves the following dual forms, so this is not a solution either.

The first *cakra* named *mūlacakra* is provided with the following introduction:

*idānīm suṣumṇāyāḥ jñānotpattāv upāyāḥ kathyante | ādau caturdalaṃ
mūlacakraṃ vartate |*

Now, the means for the genesis of gnosis of the central channel is described. At the beginning [of the central channel] exists the four-petalled root-cakra.

Based on this description which promises the genesis of gnosis, against the background that the *Yogasvarodaya* teaches *Jñānayoga* here, one is forced to infer that Rāmacandra assigns the sections IV–XII, which describe the nine *cakras*, to *Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga* and *Mantrayoga*. However, almost all manuscripts, with the exception of *U₂*, do not provide any conclusive evidence for a practice that could be classified as *Mantrayoga*.

Manuscript *U₂* contains detailed additional passages that address this issue and describes a practice that can be identified as *Mantrayoga*. For each *cakra*, all manuscripts instruct *dhyāna* (meditation) on the respective *cakra*. Manuscript *U₂*, in addition to various supplementary details, always includes an indication of the duration of the meditation, measured in *ajapājāpas* (“the recitations of the non-recitation”).⁷²¹ Finally, the additional material in sec-

⁷²¹The *cakras* additionally receive the same time indication measured in *ghaṭis*, *palas* and *akṣaras*. Instructions for the duration of the practice of meditation are in most of the additions of *U₂* for each *cakra*, except the seventh *cakra* at the palate and the ninth *cakra* named

tion XI of manuscript U₂ makes it clear that the so-called *ajapā mantra* or *haṃsa mantra* must be meant here:⁷²²

sakāreṇa bahir yāti hakāreṇa viśet punaḥ |
haṃsaḥ so 'haṃ tato mantram jīvo japati sarvadā ||

With the sound “sa”, he exhales. With the sound “ha”, he inhales again: “I am he, he is I”. Because of that, the embodied soul constantly utters the Mantra.

The *ajapā mantra* (“unmuttered mantra”) consists of the two syllables *haṃ* and *saḥ* according to the phonological association with the sound of inhalation and exhalation. Because all living beings inhale and exhale, they recite the *ajapā mantra* continuously day and night. At the same time, *haṃsa*,

mahāśūnyacakra. For example, manuscript U₂ instructs a total of 600 *ajapājapa*s as the duration of meditation onto the *mūlacakra*. This refers to the duration of the voiceless uttering of the natural *mantra* of the breath: so ‘*haṃ*’ (“he is I”)—*haṃ sa* (“I am him”). As in many other yoga texts, the total amount of *ajapājapa* per day is declared to be 21600 (cf. section XI. on p. 130, l. 7). If 21600 *ajapājapa* equals 24 hours, then 600 *ajapājapa* would equal 40 minutes. In the additions of U₂, one finds the same numbers of *ajapājapa* as in the instructions for meditation onto the seven *cakra*-system of Jayatārāma (cf. *jogpradīpyaka* and *jogpradīpyaka* 889–912). The redactor of the text as found in U₂ applied the system of the durations for seven *cakras* to the ninefold *cakra* system of Rāmacandra. Next, the duration that was mentioned before as 600 *ajapājapa* is repeated in another scheme by stating “*ghaṭi 1 palāni 40*”. One *ghaṭi* equals 1/60 of a day (see *sircar*1966), which is 24 minutes. One *pala* equals 1/60 of a *ghaṭi*, which is 24 seconds (see *petersburger*4). The *Amanaska* in 1.35 (cf. *birch*2013) uses the same concept. For a more detailed tracing of the usage of the system in yogic and tantric literature, see *birch*2013. In our case, the 24 minutes of the one *ghaṭi* plus the 16 minutes (40x24 seconds) of 40 *palas* once more sums up to 40 minutes for the instructed duration of meditation onto the first *cakra*. Other systems are less specific. *kumbhaka* 208, e.g. states: *ṣaṇṇimeṣo bhavat prāṇaḥ ṣaḍbhiḥ prāṇaiḥ palaṃ smṛtaṃ | palaiḥ ṣaṣṭibhir eva syād ghaṭikākālasammitā ||* “Six winkings are one *prāṇa*, six *prāṇas* make up one *pala*. Sixty *palas* equal the time-period of a *ghaṭikā*.” According to *birch*2013 (2013) the time unit *akṣara* appears in Bhāskara’s *siddharoma* (17cd – 18ab of the *Kālamānādhyaṃya* in the *Madhyamādhikāra*): *gurvākṣaraiḥ khendumitair asus taiḥ | ṣaḍbhiḥ palaṃ tair ghaṭikā kṣaṣṭibhiḥ || syād vā ghaṭiṣaṣṭir ahaḥ kharāmair māso dinaiḥ tair dvikubhiḥ ca varṣam |* *birch*2013 translates: “A breath is ten long syllables, and a *Pala* is six breaths, sixty *Palas* is one *Ghaṭikā*, sixty *Ghaṭikās* is a day, thirty days is a month, and twelve months is a year.” If one assumes an *akṣara* to be 1/10 of a breath and 21600 breaths per day, one hour would have 900 breaths, one minute would equal 16 breaths, one breath would equal 4 seconds, and one *akṣara* would be 0,4 seconds or 400 milliseconds.

⁷²²The earliest mention of the *ajapā mantra* or *haṃsa mantra* in yoga literature is likely found in *vivekamartanda* olda 28–30.

most often translated as “swan” or “goose” in English, is a famous and ancient metaphor for the soul travelling through the wheel of Brahman or Samsāra.⁷²³ Sometimes this mantra is also specified as *ajapāgāyatrī*.⁷²⁴

Manuscript U₂ explains that the total daily number of all silent recitations of the *haṃsa mantra* is 21600.⁷²⁵ The association of the term Mantrayoga with the practice of *haṃsa mantra* is widespread in Sanskrit yoga literature.⁷²⁶

From a text-critical perspective, there is ambivalent evidence regarding the authenticity of the passages under discussion. All manuscripts mention Mantrayoga in the above passage. We must, therefore, assume that Mantrayoga was originally and perhaps even deliberately specified here by Rāmacandra, even if, or precisely because, he reads the source text differently. But why?⁷²⁷

The fact that only the manuscript U₂ explicitly teaches a Mantrayoga must make one suspicious. This manuscript only contains additional material in the sections IV–XII. The most likely scenario is that the scribe of the manuscript U₂ made these additions to provide the missing explanations

⁷²³ See **hauschild1927** 1.6 and 3.18.

⁷²⁴ The *ajapā* can be seen as a yogic appropriation of the Vedic *gāyatrīmantra*, cf. **rootsofyoga2017**.

⁷²⁵ The number of total breaths is based on the assumption of an average breath duration of four seconds. Each day has 86400 seconds. If one divides this total number by four, one gets the 21600 breaths of the *ajapā mantra*. **birch2013** (2013: 265, n. 46) argues that this assumption comes from **svacchandatantra** 7.54–55. In addition to the U₂ manuscript of *Tattvayogabindu*, this yogic axiom is widely used in Sanskrit yoga literature. See for example *Amaraughaprabodha* 58, Hemacandra's *hemacandras* 5.232, *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 46, *Gheraṇḍasamhitā* 5.79, *Dhyānabindūpaniṣad* 62ab–63ab or *jogpradīpyaka* 913.

⁷²⁶ See e.g. **yogabija** 147; **shivayogapradīpika** 2.26–27 and 2.29–32. **powell2023** (2023: 205) explains that in his text “mantra is reframed and interiorised within a *prāṇāyāma* environment, specifically in the form of the *ajapā*, the ‘unuttered’ mantra”; **yogacintamani** (Ed. p. 12); **hathatattvakaumudi** 55.28; and **yogasikhopanisad** 132.

⁷²⁷ Mantrayoga, which in the *Tattvayogabindu* III is introduced within the context of an explanation of the channels, followed by a description of the *cakras* could make sense in this context if we apply a perspective similar to *Śivayogapradīpikā* 2.34: *so 'haṃ kṛtvātma-mantram svapadaparapadam vyaktavarṇadvayaṃ tad vyālumped vyañjane dve punar api racayed divyam omkāra-mantram | kṛtvānusvārayuktaṃ sakalamanuvaram brahmanāḍiṃ nayed yaḥ pūrṇānandaḥ sa kuṇḍalyanubhavavikalah karmaṇo muktim eti || 34 ||* **powell2023** (2023: 322) translates: “Having made so 'haṃ one's personal mantra—in which the two syllables are expressed as one's self and the Supreme—[the yogin] should take away the two consonants and refashion it as the divine mantra *om*. Having joined it with the nasal sound (*anusvāra*), it is the best of all mantras. He who leads it to the *brahmanāḍī* (i.e. *suṣumṇā*) is full of bliss, [even if] deprived of the experience of Kuṇḍalinī. He attains release from [all] *karma*.”

on Mantrayoga.⁷²⁸ As a γ -group manuscript, U_2 preserves a later stage of transmission than the β -group. Nevertheless, the γ -group remains important for reconstructing the text, as the β -group is relied upon precisely in those sections where its transmission is clearly defective, and U_2 is among the best representatives of the γ -group.⁷²⁹

Given these considerations, the supplementary material of U_2 is included in greyscale in the edition rather than in footnotes, both because it resolves textual issues and is of interest for reception history. The stemmatic evidence suggests the scribe likely added this material to specify Mantrayoga, but its originality cannot be entirely ruled out. Overall, the only reasonable conclusion is that Mantrayoga was present in the original text: Rāmacandra probably conceived of it in relation to the *cakras*, but did not fully incorporate it in his final wording. This conception may have resembled that of U_2 or *Śivayogapradīpikā* 2.34, consistent with other textual inconsistencies Rāmacandra produced.

3.10.2 Mantrayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha locates Mantrayoga, like Jñānayoga before it, in the context of *Yogasūtra* 1.28.⁷³⁰ This *sūtra* and the corresponding commentary by Nārāyaṇatīrtha have already been discussed in the section on Jñānayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*⁷³¹ and therefore need not be repeated here.⁷³² Mantrayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* is *japa* (“low-voice muttering”) of *praṇava* (“sacred syllable *om*”), which can be performed in two alternative ways, as Jñānayoga⁷³³ or Advaitayoga.⁷³⁴

⁷²⁸The connection between Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga established in U_2 is found in a similar form in *saradaavalon* 25.37ab: “The *kuṇḍali* Śakti abides in the *haṃsaḥ* [and] supports the [individual] Self.” (*bibharti kuṇḍali śaktir ātmānaṃ haṃsaṃ āśritā* |), see *saradatīlakafull* 2011: 218, 228.

⁷²⁹E.g., it preserves the only possible correct variant of a sentence in III: *bhuktimuktidā śivarūpiṇi suṣumṇānāḍi pravartate | asyā jñānotpattau satyāṃ puruṣaḥ sarvajño bhavati* |

⁷³⁰For a discussion of meditation on *praṇava* in the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, see *maas*2009.

⁷³¹See p. 341 et seqq.

⁷³²For another discussion of Mantrayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* see *penna*2004.

⁷³³For a discussion of Jñānayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, see p. 341.

⁷³⁴The concept of Advaitayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* is discussed on p. 342.

3.10.3 Mantrayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Sundardās introduces his Mantrayoga (2.16–27) with the question of how the formless and featureless highest reality can be described.⁷³⁵ For without naming it, one cannot refer to it.⁷³⁶ A personal surrender, a devotion to the highest reality, is the basic prerequisite for Bhaktiyoga, the superordinate category of Sundardās's Mantrayoga. According to Sundardās, the best, or verbatim, the crown of all names for the highest reality is *rāma*.⁷³⁷ After several verses of praise of the *rāma mantra* Sundardās explains that the *rāma mantra* has to be learnt from the Guru. At the beginning of Mantrayoga practice, one is supposed to recite the *rāma mantra* with the tongue, i.e. audibly.⁷³⁸ In the course of the practice, the *rāma mantra* is then supposed to be recited mentally, constantly, day and night, in order to unite the practitioner with the omnipresent supreme reality:

++*pīchai hiradai maiṃ dhārai | jīhvā rahita maṃtra uccārai |*
nīśa dina mana tāsaṃ raha lāgau | kabahūṃ naiṃka na tūṭai dhāgau ||
 24 ||
puni tahāṃ pragaṭa hoī raṃkārā | āpu hi āpu akhaṇḍita dhārā |
tana mana bisari jāi tahāṃ soī | romahi roma rāma dhuni hoī || 25 ||

(24) Afterwards, retain it [the mantra] in the heart; recite the mantra without the tongue. Night and day, let your mind stay attached to it; may the thread never break.

(25) Then there, the omnipresent one manifests; an unbroken stream by itself, Body and mind forgotten there, in that state; in every hair, the sound of Rāma resonates.

Thus, Mantrayoga in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* is a form of Bhaktiyoga that seeks union with the highest reality in the form of devotional recitation of the *rāma mantra*.

⁷³⁵ *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.16cd: *jākaī kachū rūpa nahiṃ reṣā kauna prakāra jāi so deṣā ||* 16 ||

⁷³⁶ *Ibid.* 2.17b: *nāma binā nahiṃ lagai piyārā |*

⁷³⁷ *Ibid.* 2.19cd: *rāma mantra sabakai siramaurā tāhi na koī pūjata aurā ||* 19 ||

⁷³⁸ *Ibid.* 2.23cd: *prathama ..vana suni guru kai pāsā puni so rasanā karat abhyāsā ||* 23 ||

3.10.4 Mantrayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Mantrayoga within the four texts of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies reveals a broad range of applied variants of this form of yoga. It reflects the variety of adaption of the practice across different traditions during the 16th and 17th centuries.

Rāmacandra, or at least some of the readers of his *Tattvayogabindu*, understood Mantrayoga as a practice involving meditation on one of the nine *cakras* while mentally reciting the *ajapā mantra*.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha understands Mantrayoga as *japa* of *om*, which symbolises Īśvara and his qualities. This can either be performed as Jñānayoga—while silently reciting *om*, the mind is focused on the distinction between consciousness (*puruṣa*) and primordial nature (*prakṛti*) including its effects (*tatkārya*). Or, it is performed as Advaitayoga—while silently reciting *om* one is supposed to reflect on the non-difference between the supreme self (*paramātman*) and the individual self (*jīva*).

Finally, Sundardās' Mantrayoga is the devotional recitation of the *rāma mantra*.

We discovered that Mantrayoga has evolved in various forms across different traditions. The practices and the practitioners have undergone significant changes over the centuries, and intriguingly, Mantrayoga has seemingly shed its negative image, which was prevalent in some early Haṭhayoga traditions, and has gained in popularity.

3.11 Lakṣyayoga

LAKṢYAYOGA, the “Yoga of foci”, is one of the most voluminous and most important topics⁷³⁹ in the *Tattvayogabindu*.⁷⁴⁰ The concept of this type

⁷³⁹In the *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.8, the one who has attained the realisation of Brahman using the (in this case) three *lakṣyas* is called a knower of Rājayoga. In this text, the practice of *lakṣyas* is the primary characteristic practice of Rājayoga. In addition, being free from mental fluctuation through gnosis is specified as the second characteristic practice: *triṣu lakṣyeṣu yo brahmasākṣātkāraṃ gamiṣyati | jñāne vātha manovṛttirahito rājayogavit || 1.8 ||*

⁷⁴⁰The sections XIII (overview of the five *lakṣyas*), XIV (*adholakṣya*), XV (*ūrdhvalakṣya*), XXIII (*bāhyalakṣya*), XXIV (*antaralakṣya*) and XXVII (*madhyalakṣya*) of the *Tattvayogabindu* deal exclusively with the types of Lakṣyayoga.

of yoga has a complex history of reception, and its origins as a category of specific yoga techniques can be traced far back into early Tantric texts.

The yoga practice of *lakṣyas* derives from an ancient Śaiva paradigm. The roots of this paradigm are difficult to reconstruct precisely. In many cases, the *lakṣyas* are taught together with a system of six to nine *cakras*, sixteen *ād-hāras* and five *vyomas*, *ākāśas* or *khas*. In most texts that take up this paradigm, there is a variant of a verse also contained in the *Tattvayogabindu*, which lists the elements just mentioned as essential components of yoga.⁷⁴¹ Perhaps the oldest datable textual evidence for the practice of yogic *lakṣyas* can be found in *Netratantra* 7.1–2, which was composed between 700–850 CE.⁷⁴² Here, the *lakṣyas* are only listed but not explained in detail, so we can assume that this practice is probably even older than the *Netratantra* itself. Kṣemarāja, in his *Netroddyota* commentary, further elaborates on the three *lakṣyas*. Enveloped in enigmatic language, he briefly states in the context of *Netratantra* 7.27:

trīṇy antarbahirubhayarūpāṇi lakṣyāṇi lakṣaṇīyāni yatra |
nirāvaraṇarūpatvāt “khamanantaṃ tu janmākhyam”]

The three foci, internal, external or both, are to be attained, and because they are unobstructed, “The endless void is called the birth.”

After this, the *lakṣyas* are not mentioned explicitly. Yet *Netratantra* 8.39–44 clearly alludes to *lakṣya* techniques: the yogin, already in *samādhi*, is instructed to abandon meditation on various foci. The rejected foci closely parallel the three to five *lakṣyas* found in early modern yoga taxonomies. For example, *Netratantra* 8.42 states:

nāntaḥ śarīrasaṃsthāne na bāhye bhāvayet kvacit |
nākāśe bandhayel lakṣyam nādhō dṛṣṭiṃ niveśayet || 42 ||

⁷⁴¹See *Tattvayogabindu* section XXVIII.1 for the verse and its variants in other contemporary and earlier texts.

⁷⁴²sanderson2004.

One should not contemplate any place of the body inside or outside. One should not fix one's attention towards the sky (open space), nor should one direct one's gaze downwards.⁷⁴³

The *Mālinīvijayottaratantra* (12.9) and other linked Tantras⁷⁴⁴ also contain a system of *lakṣyas*. In the *Mālinīvijayottaratantra*, there are six *lakṣyas*. These six *lakṣyas* are labelled as follows: 1. emptiness (*vyoman*), 2. body (*vigraha*), 3. drop (*bindu*), 4. phoneme (*arṇa*), 5. world (*bhuvana*) and 6. resonance (*dhvani*). According to **vasudeva2004** (2004: 255), *lakṣyabheda* in *Mālinīvijayottaratantra* denotes “the ultimate destination upon which the Yogin must fix his attention”. These *lakṣyas* are “different manifestations through which Śiva can be approached”. He further states: “To the Yogin engaged in the conquest of realities the *lakṣyas* serve as teleological magnets drawing him towards the sought after rewards”. Despite the same basic concept, the *lakṣyas* of the *Mālinīvijayottaratantra* appear very different at the first glance. On closer inspection, however, there are striking parallels with the *lakṣya* systems found in the late medieval texts treated in this chapter. For example, the first *lakṣya* of the *Mālinīvijayottaratantra* 12.10abc is described as follows:

bāhyābhyantarabhedena samuccayakṛtena ca trividhaṃ kīrtitaṃ vyoma |

The void is said to be threefold by the division of external, internal and that arising from accumulation.

vasudeva2004 (2004: 263) maintains that this elliptical definition can only be explained on the basis of the teachings on the voids of other Śaiva Tantras but notes that none of the systems he consulted show complete congruence with the position of the *Mālinīvijayottaratantra*. Nevertheless, he cites, for example, the passages from *Dikṣottara* 3.10c–11 and *Svacchandatantra* 4.289 that are particularly interesting for our context, in which an upper emptiness (*ūrdhvaśūnya*), a lower emptiness (*adhaśūnya*) and a middle emptiness (*madhyaśūnya*) are distinguished.

⁷⁴³ Additionally, cf. *Netratantra* 8.44ab.

⁷⁴⁴ E.g. *Kiraṇatantra* 2.22–23 and *Dikṣottara* 2.2–3.

Taken together, the basic features of the late medieval differentiation of the five *lakṣyas* into *ūrdhva-*, *adho-*, *bāhya-*, *antara-*, and *madhyalakṣya* can already be discerned here.⁷⁴⁵ This rough overview illustrates that different systems of yogic *lakṣya* practices have been circulating in the Śaiva Tantras for a very long time. Over the centuries, the techniques were passed on, copied and reused in the yoga traditions of Haṭha- and Rājayoga.

In addition to the four texts analysed in this chapter, different forms of *lakṣya* practice can also be found, for example, in *Vivekamārtaṇḍa*, *Śivayogapradīpikā*, (recensions of the *Haṭhapradīpikā*), *Yogasvarodaya*, *Nityanāthapaddhati*, *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, *Yogacūḍāmaṇyupaniṣad*, *Maṇḍalabrāhmaṇopaniṣat*, *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* and *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā*. However, it was not labelled as an independent yoga category until the texts of the complex late medieval yoga taxonomies emerged. In the fifteen-fold yoga taxonomy of the *Tattvayogabindu*, Lakṣyayoga is listed as the ninth method of Rājayoga. The *Yogasvarodaya* does not mention Lakṣyayoga in its introductory verses. The *Yogasvarodaya* dedicates two verses to listing the fifteen yogas. Although the verses announce fifteen yogas, only eight yogas are specified, probably for metrical reasons. Lakṣyayoga is not among the eight yogas mentioned but is dealt with in detail throughout the text. In the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Lakṣyayoga is the eighth yoga method Nārāyaṇatīrtha mentions.⁷⁴⁶ Within the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* Sundardās presents Lakṣayoga⁷⁴⁷ as one of the four methods of Haṭhayoga alongside Rāja- and Aṣṭāṅgayoga.⁷⁴⁸ In contrast to the yoga categories discussed so far, Lakṣyayoga is conceptually largely congruent within the late medieval texts of the complex yoga taxonomies and differs only in a few details.

⁷⁴⁵The *lakṣyas* of the *Mālinīvijayottaratantra* are discussed in detail in [vasudeva2004](#).

⁷⁴⁶For an earlier discussion of *Lakṣyayoga* in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, see [penna2004](#).

⁷⁴⁷The terms vary in the literature. The most common term is *lakṣya*, but *lakṣa* or *lakṣana* were also commonly specified.

⁷⁴⁸See [burger2014sarvangayogapradipika](#) (2014: 697–98) for another discussion of Lakṣayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* in French.

3.II.1 Lakṣyayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya* and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

The three texts present Lakṣyayoga as an explicitly simple yoga method right at the beginning of their respective discourses. The descriptions of the texts are very similar in the majority of instances. Thus, a separate analysis of them, as in the previous chapters, would be redundant. The word *lakṣya* means “goal”. In the practice of Lakṣyayoga, it refers to goals on which the gaze (*drṣṭi*) and the mind are directed, i.e. a “focus” for stabilising the mind on which one constantly meditates. The three texts distinguish five categories from one another, depending on the place to be focussed. The following order⁷⁴⁹ is given in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*: 1. the upper focus (*ūrdhvalakṣya*), 2. the lower focus (*adholakṣya*), 3. the outer focus (*bāhyalakṣya*), 4. the middle focus (*madhyalakṣya*) and 5. the inner focus (*antar(a)lakṣya*).^{750, 751} Meditation on particular foci produces specific results.

3.II.1.1 Ūrdhvalakṣya

In the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*, the upper focus (*ūrdhvalakṣya*)⁷⁵² refers to the fixation of the gaze (*drṣṭi*) and the mind (*manas*) on the centre of the sky, or the zenith (*ākāśamadhye*). This results in the unity of the gaze with the splendour of the Supreme God (*parameśvara*). In addition, an object arises in the sky within the practitioner’s scope of vision, an object that was previously unseen.⁷⁵³ The latter effect is cryptic. The source text, the *Yogasvarodaya*, also does not contribute to clarity in this case, as there is no parallel passage. The *Haṭhasamketacandrikā*⁷⁵⁴ quotes this passage literally,

⁷⁴⁹The order in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* is not identical, but as follows: 1. *adho lakṣa*, 2. *ūrdha lakṣa*, 3. *madhya lakṣa*, 4. *bāhya lakṣa* and 5. *aṃtar lakṣa*.

⁷⁵⁰Only in *Tattvayogabindu* is this *lakṣya* is designated as *antaralakṣya*. In all other texts, including the *Haṭhasamketacandrikā*, which quotes the *Tattvayogabindu*, the term *antaralakṣya* is used.

⁷⁵¹In the *Tattvayogabindu* section XIII, in the *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, Ed. pp. 833–834) and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.25–36.

⁷⁵²*Tattvayogabindu* XV, *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 834) and *Yogakarnīkā* 2.5.

⁷⁵³*Tattvayogabindu* XIV (Ed. p. 142): *etasya lakṣyasya dṛḍhikaraṇāt parameśvarasya tejasā saha dṛṣṭer aikyaṃ bhavati | atha cākāśamadhye yaḥ kaścīd adṛṣṭaḥ padārtho bhavati | sa sādhakasya dṛṣṭigo-care bhavati |*

⁷⁵⁴*Haṭhasamketacandrikā* MMPP MS. No. 2244 f. 124v ll. 1–2.

without further explanation. The only clue lies in the description of *ūrdhha lakṣa* in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.27. The technique described here is identical. The practitioner shall focus the gaze on the sky day and night. Sundardās explains the effect resulting from the practice in similar terms.⁷⁵⁵ In 3.27cd Sundardās states: “Various kinds of splendour manifest, the essence of the Gopīs’ object of consideration becomes visible.” Due to the striking similarity of the formulations and the fact that Sundardās must have been a contemporary of Rāmacandra, a correlation is probable. Sundardās was a disciple of Dādū Dayāl (1544–1603) and a member of the school named after him, and therefore a Vaiṣṇava, so the phrase “the essence of the object of the Gopīs’ consideration” is probably the essence of Kṛṣṇa. Gopīs are paradigmatic figures of devotion (*bhakti*) to Kṛṣṇa.⁷⁵⁶ Since Kṛṣṇa is considered the eighth *avatāra* of Viṣṇu, the essence or being of Kṛṣṇa is probably Viṣṇu, who is sometimes called *puruṣottama* or *parameśvara*. Whether the *adrṣtaḥ padārthaḥ* of Rāmacandra derives from the *gopi padāratha* is uncertain, but the parallels to the wording of the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* are striking. Rāmacandra does not seem to favour any sectarian affiliation, and despite the clear Śaiva orientation of the main source text of his compilation, he is remarkably neutral in his formulations. Here, once more, he maintains his neutrality.

3.II.1.2 Adholakṣya

The lower focus (*adholakṣya*) as presented in the *Tattvayogabindu* requires the stabilisation of the gaze (*drṣṭi*) at a distance of twelve fingers’ breadth from the tip of the nose or on the tip of the nose itself. The technique stabilises the *drṣṭi*, the breath and prolongs life.^{757,758} Afterwards, the

⁷⁵⁵ *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.27: *ūrdhha lakṣa karai ihiṃ bhāṃti | duṣṭy ākāśa rahai dina rāti | bibidh prakāra hoi ujyārā | gopi padāratha dīsaḥim sārā || 27 ||*

⁷⁵⁶ See e.g. *bhagavata* 10.29.

⁷⁵⁷ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT): *nāsikopari deveśi dvādaśāṅgulamānataḥ drṣṭiḥ sthirā (drṣṭisthiran YK 2.5) tu karttavyā (karttavyam YK 2.5) adholakṣam idaṃ bhaja (bhajet YK 2. 5) | athavā (tathā ca YK 2.5) nāsikāgre tu sthirā drṣṭir iyaṃ bhavet (śṛṇu YK 2. 5) sthirā drṣṭiś cirāyuh syāt tathāsau (yasya bhavet sthirā drṣṭiś cirāyuh YK 2. 6) sthiradrṣṭimān |*

⁷⁵⁸ Rāmacandra, in contrast to *Yogasvarodaya*, notes at this point that both options are taught as techniques of external focus (*bāhyalakṣya*). The difference for Rāmacandra appears to be not only the designation but, above all, the subsequent focussing on *sūnya*.

practitioner is supposed to focus inwardly and outwardly on emptiness (*śūnya*), which leads to freedom from the fear of death (*maraṇatrāsa*).⁷⁵⁹

Sundaradeva, in his *hathasamketacandrikachennai*,⁷⁶⁰ quotes the full passage of *Tattvayogabindu*'s *adholakṣya* without attribution. However, the *hathasamketacandrikachennai* transmits further techniques to the description of *adholakṣya*.⁷⁶¹

⁷⁵⁹Rāmacandra reduces and massively changes his source text; see p. 144. Rāmacandra's *adholakṣya* on *śūnya* is attributed to *antarlakṣya* in the *Yogasvarodaya*. For a translation of the passage, see p. 397.

⁷⁶⁰The collation of the passages of the *hathasamketacandrikachennai* I based on ORI B 220 (f. 239r l. 8 to f. 240r l. 13), GOML R 3239 (f. 258 l. 14 to f. 259 l. 10) and MMPP 2244 (f. 124r ll. 5–9 to f. 125r ll. 1–2).

⁷⁶¹This passage may represent material composed by Sundaradeva himself, or is derived from an as yet unidentified source.

athavā dr̥ṣṭir netrayor dvayor netrādhobhāgayor akṣikūṭayos tad ad-
 hogallayor ubhayor upari sthirā kartavyā | ekānte vijane dīpam āvarake
 samsthāpya ciraṃ gatvāvalokya stheyam | ghaṭimātram vā ghaṭikārd-
 haṃ vā tato dīpam ācchādyā bhūmau sarvatrāvalokane sarvaṃ sve-
 5 tanīlapītasphulingasphulingakaṇānte maṇḍalākārīṇi ceti jyotiścakrāṇi
 pañca śad vā dr̥śyante | tataś cāṃdhakāre dr̥śyate | dīptimat sarvaṃ
 svaśariraṃ dr̥śyate | bhāṣate sarvo 'pi sapradeśo dīptimān sphuṭo dr̥śy-
 ate | ekadārḍhye jyotirmayacakrānte parameśvarasya tejomūrtir dr̥śyate |
 puṃsaḥ paramānandotpattir jāyate | svadehavismṛtiś ca saṃbhavati |
 10 athavā svanetrayor vartamanīr dakṣahastamadhyamātarjanībhyām
 akṣikūṭayor adhaḥ kṛtvā akṣivartmanī dṛḍhaṃ cālani ye ghaṭikārdhaṃ
 vā ghaṭimātram tata evaṃ kṛte sādhakasyāgre suśvetajyotiḥ prākāśaḥ
 prāg bhavatīti |

Alternatively, the gaze should be fixed on the lower parts of both
 eyes, at the rim of the eye sockets, just above the cheeks. In a
 lonely place without people, a lamp shall be placed in a darkened
 [room][and] after some time has passed, one should remain there
 watching it. After one *ghaṭikā* (24 minutes), or half a *ghaṭikā* (12
 minutes)[already], having covered the lamp and then, while look-
 ing all around on the ground, five or six circles of light appear,
 which are shaped like *maṇḍalas* and occur amidst white, blue, and
 yellow sparks.

1–13 Jo = Jodhpur MS. No. 2244; G = Chennai GOML Ms. No. R 3239; G_{pc} = ibid. *post correc-*
tionem; M = Mysore ORI Ms. No. B 220.

1 dr̥ṣṭir Jo] dr̥ṣṭi GG_{pc}M dvayor GG_{pc}M] dvayo Jo netrādhobhāgayor GG_{pc}M] netrā 'dhob-
 hāgayor Jo 1–2 adhogallayor em.] adhogallayo cett. 2 ubhayor GG_{pc}] rūpayor CJo, rūpa
 M upari GG_{pc}Jo] pari M āvarake Jo] āvake GG_{pc}M 3 ghaṭimātram GG_{pc}M] ghaṭimātra
 J 5 °pīta° Jo] yomta M, yomta GG_{pc} °kaṇānte MGG_{pc}] °kaṇām 'te Jo maṇḍalākārīṇi
 em.] maṇḍalākārīṇiś cett. ceti GG_{pc}M] ceta Jo 6 cāṃdhakāre GG_{pc}Jo] vāṃdhakāre
 M 8 ekadārḍhye em.] ekadārḍye G_{pc}, etadārḍye G 9 saṃbhavati GG_{pc}M] saṃbhavati |
 athavā svanetrayor vartmanīr dakṣahastamadhyamātarjanībhyām akṣikū dehavismṛtiś ca
 saṃbhavati | Jo 10 vartamanīr Jo] vartmanā GG_{pc}M 11 akṣikūṭayor em.] ākṣikoṭayor M,
 akṣikūṭakūṭayor GG_{pc}, akṣikūtvā Jo adhaḥ kṛtvā GG_{pc}M] om. Jo akṣivartmanī GG_{pc}M]
 akṣivanmanī Jo 12 sādhakasyāgre em.] sādhyakasyāgre GJoM suśvetajyotiḥ GJo] suśvi-
 tajyotiḥ M 13 prāg GG_{pc}M] prāgvad Jo

As a result, one is able to see in the dark. One's entire body is seen as luminous. Also, the entire surrounding area appears radiant [and] becomes clearly visible. When one becomes firmly established in one of the circles of light, the luminous form of the supreme lord is seen. Supreme bliss arises for the person. Forgetting of one's own body occurs.

Alternatively, having placed the thumb and index finger of the right hand below the edge of the eye socket at the eyelids of the own eyes, and steadily causing to move [the fingers] at the eyelids, either for a half *ghaṭikā* (12 minutes) or for a *ghaṭikā* (24 minutes), as a result of having done this, very bright white light becomes visible in front of the practitioner.

Sundardās's *adho lakṣa* is the simple focusing of the gaze on the tip of the nose, which leads to the stabilisation of breath and mind.⁷⁶²

3.II.1.3 Bāhyalakṣya

The external focus (*bāhyalakṣya*)⁷⁶³ is the fixation of the gaze (*dṛṣṭi*) on one of the five gross elements at different distances from the tip of the nose or, in one case, directly on the tip of the nose. The texts present the foci as alternatives. The presentation of the three texts follows the same pattern in every case. They list a specific location, followed by an element (in most cases) and a characteristic, such as an associated colour. A table is the best way to illustrate the spread of the various techniques across the texts.

⁷⁶² *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.26: *prathamahim adho lakṣa kauṃ jānaim | nāsā agra dṛṣṭi sthira ānaim | yātom mana pavanā thira hoī | adho lakṣa jo sādhai koī || 26 ||*

⁷⁶³ *Tattvayogabindu* XXIII; *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 837).

Table 4: Foci of Bāhyalakṣya

Location	Element	Characteristic	<i>Yogatattva-bindu</i>	<i>Yoga-svarodaya</i>	<i>Haṭha-saṃketa-candrikā</i>	<i>Sarvāṅga-yogapradīpikā</i>
Four finger breadths from the nose	Space	Appearing blue, full of splendour	x ⁷⁶⁴	x ⁷⁶⁵	x ⁷⁶⁶	x
Six finger breadths from the nose	Wind	In the shape of smoke	x	x	-	x
Eight finger breadths from the nose	Fire	Very red	x	x	x	x
Ten finger breadths from the nose	Water	White, fickle	x	-	-	x
Twelve finger breadths from the nose	Earth	Yellow-coloured	x	-	-	x
At the tip of the nose	Space	Full of fire, shining like ten million suns	x	-	-	-
Above the space-element	Space	Connected to the sun without the sun (thousand rays)	x	-	-	-
Seventeen-finger wide distance above the head	Light	Mass of light	x	x	-	-
In front of the gaze	Earth	Appearing in the colour of molten gold	x	x	-	-

⁷⁶⁴ A “x” signifies the presence, and a “-” the absence of the focus in the text.

⁷⁶⁵ Here, the *Yogasvarodaya* mentions no element.

⁷⁶⁶ The *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* provides the wind as the element and the shape of smoke as the characteristic of this focus.

Table 4 shows that the *Tattvayogabindu* contains the greatest variety of foci of the *bāhyalakṣya* category. Sundaradeva does not adopt all the foci in his *Yogasamketacandrikā*. However, here, the transmission of this passage appears partially corrupt, since the witnesses mix up the first two foci. The *Yogasvarodaya* only contains five of the nine foci in the table. Thus, it seems natural, that Rāmacandra has added further foci based on the explanations of Bahirlakṣya in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.28 (Ed. 38–40).⁷⁶⁷ Sundardās describes the first five foci for the five elements in a perfectly analogous fashion.⁷⁶⁸ In the last verse of his explanation of *bāhya lakṣa*, he explains that there are many more *bāhya lakṣas*, but they must be revealed by the Guru.⁷⁶⁹ The effects attributed to the practice of *bāhyalakṣya* are similar throughout the texts. Regardless of the variant practised, the practice promises rejuvenation, improved health, sometimes even an improved social life⁷⁷⁰ and a longer life span etc.

3.II.I.4 Antar(a)lakṣya

The inner focus (*antar(a)lakṣya*) is a special case, as there are noticeable deviations between Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*. Although Rāmacandra continues to follow the *Yogasvarodaya* in terms of structure and content for the description of his *antar(a)lakṣya*, the passages in the *Yogasvarodaya* are not explicitly attributed to *antaralakṣya*, but are evidently assigned to the preceding *bāhyalakṣya*.⁷⁷¹ In addition, Rāmacandra simultaneously uses the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (2.26–27) as a template for this passage, which attributes largely similar practices to the category of *antar(a)lakṣya*. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, there is a separate description of *antaralakṣya*, the core practice

⁷⁶⁷The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* teaches only three instead of five Lakṣyas: *antaralakṣya* (2.26–27); *bahirlakṣya* (2.28); and *madhyalakṣya* (2.29).

⁷⁶⁸*Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.29–31.

⁷⁶⁹*Ibid.* 2.32: *bāhya lakṣa aur bahuteri so jānam jo pāvai seri | sataguru kṛpā karai jau kabahī | dei batāi chinak maim sabahī || 32 ||*

⁷⁷⁰*Tattvayogabindu* XXIII: *samagrāḥ śatravaḥ svapne 'pi mitratām ayānti |*

⁷⁷¹Cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XXIV and *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, pp. 837–38).

of which was already integrated by Rāmacandra in the context of his *adho-lakṣya*.⁷⁷² The concept of the *antar lakṣa* of Sundardās is essentially identical.

In the XXIV section of the *Tattvayogabindu*, Rāmacandra specifies a total of three alternative *antar(a)lakṣyas*. As part of the explanations of the first *antar(a)lakṣya*, Rāmacandra first presents a description of the central channel in the yogic body, which is labelled here as *brahmanāḍī*. It originates from the spine (*brahmadanḍa*) and passes through the spine from bottom to top. The central channel extends from the root-bulb (*mūlakanda*) to the opening of Brahman (*brahmarandhra*) at the top of the head. It is shaped like the stem of a lotus flower and shines like ten million suns. The practice of *antar(a)lakṣya* consists of meditating on it, which allows the practitioner to acquire supernatural abilities. Just the first of the three techniques appears in the context of *antar lakṣa* in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* of Sundardās, albeit in less detail. According to Sundardās, one is supposed to meditate on the central channel also called *brahmanāḍī*, which brings about the eight supernatural abilities.⁷⁷³

Rāmacandra's second technique for the practice of *antaralakṣya* is a meditation on a bright light above the forehead, preventing certain diseases.

His third alternative for the practice of *antaralakṣya* is meditation on the very fine red light in the centre between the eyebrows, which causes the yogin to be loved by everyone in the royal court and ensures that no one can take their eyes off him.⁷⁷⁴

Interestingly, the *antar(a)lakṣya* of the *Yogasvarodaya*,⁷⁷⁵ differs greatly from the models in *Tattvayogabindu*, *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. It is exclusively about meditation on emptiness (*śūnya*):

⁷⁷²This is the meditation on emptiness (*śūnya*), cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XV and *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 834).

⁷⁷³*Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.33: *am̐tar lakṣa ju sunahum̐ prakāśā | brahma nāḍikā karahu abhyāsā | aṣṭa siddhi nava niddhi jahāṁlaum̐ | ṭarahim̐ na kabahūṁ jivai jahāṁ laum̐ || 33 ||*

⁷⁷⁴All three techniques of *antar(a)lakṣya* are also specified in the *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 837–838), but still in the context of *bāhyalakṣya*: *mūlakandotthatalato brahmanāḍisamudbhavā | śvetavarṇā brahmarandhraparyantam̐ eva tiṣṭhati | eṣā tu brahmarandhrākhyā tanmadhye varṭtate parā | padmatantusamākārā koṭisūryataditprabhā | calatya ūrddham̐ mahāmūrttir asya dhyānād bhavet chivah | aṇimādy aṣṭasiddhis tu samagreṇa prasīdati | lalāṭopari vā dhyātvā candram̐ vā jyotir īśvaram | nāśayet kuṣṭharogādīn mahāyusmān śivah paraḥ | bhruvor madhye 'thavā dhyātvā arkan tu teja īśvaram | sthiraḍṛṣṭau rājapūjyo jīvanmuktaḥ śivo yathā | ātmānam ātmarūpaṁ hi dhyātvā yo niṣkriyo bhavet | nirāśīryatattvo 'yaṁ itaro na nṛpasthitiḥ |*

⁷⁷⁵*Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 824) and *Yogakarnikā* 2.8–13.

antarlakṣaṃ śṛṇu subhru digvidigādivarjitam |
bāhyābhyantara ākāśaṃ vādhāmantram paraṃ matam ||

Listen to the internal focus, oh lovely-browed [Goddess], being devoid of the major and minor directions, etc. The internal and external space is the magical formula against pain, the supreme view.

calajjāgratsusupteṣu bhojaneṣu ca sarvadā |
sarvāvasthāsu deveśi cittam śūnye niyojayet ||

While walking, waking, sleeping and eating at all times [and] in all states, oh Goddess, the mind shall be focussed onto emptiness.

5 *karttā kārayitā śūnyaṃ mūrtimān śūnya īśvaraḥ |*
harṣaśokaghaṭastho 'yaṃ janmamṛtyū labhet svayam ||

The actor and he who causes to act are void; the form-bearer in the void is the supreme lord. Situated in a vessel⁷⁷⁶ of joy and sorrow, he himself experiences both birth and death.

ghaṭasthāṃ cintayen mūrtimitaś cintāsvarūpadhr̥k |
viṣayaṃ viṣavad dr̥ṣṭvā tyaktvā jñātvā tu mārutam ||

He shall contemplate [himself as] being situated in a vessel, established as form [and] carrying the nature of thought. Having abandoned sense objects as defective like poison, having realised them as consisting of the Maruts, ...

⁷⁷⁶ Obviously, the human body or body of living beings.

1 PT= *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* quotes *Yogavarodaya* with reference *yogasvarodaye*. YK= *Yogakarnīkā* quotes *Yogavarodaya* with reference *yogasvarodaye*.

1 *subhru*° PT] *śukra*° YK 2 *bāhyābhyantara ākāśaṃ vādhāmantram paraṃ matam* YK] *om.* PT 5 *śūnyaṃ* YK] *śunyaḥ* PT 7 *ghaṭasthāṃ* YK] *ghaṭasthā* PT *cintayen* YK] *cintayor* PT *mūrtimitaś* YK] *mūrtir hata*° PT 8 *dr̥ṣṭvā* YK] *duṣṭam* PT

*saṃjñāsūnyamanā bhūtvā puṇyapāpair na lipyate |
bāhyam ābhyantaram khaṃ yad antarlakṣam iti smṛtam ||*

...having become aware of the emptiness of conception, he is not tainted by merits or sin. That which is the inner and outer space is taught as the internal focus.

*etaddhyānāt sadā kiñcid duḥkhaṃ na syāc chivo bhavet |
śūnyam tu saccidānandaṃ niḥśabdaṃ brahmaśabditam |
śaśabdaṃ jñeyam ākāśam iti bhedadvayan tv iha ||*

Because of this meditation, any kind of suffering will no longer arise [and] one would become Śiva. Emptiness is being-consciousness-bliss, [and] called the soundless Brahman; space [on the other hand] is to be understood as with sound. Indeed, this is the twofold distinction in this world.

3.II.1.5 Madhyalakṣya

The concept of the central focus (*madhyalakṣya*) is very similar in all three texts. In the *Tattvayogabindu*,⁷⁷⁷ a light is visualised by the mind. The light is supposed to be the size of one's own body. Like a room on fire, this body shall be envisioned as filled with light. The light shall be white, yellow, red, grey or blue. The envisioned light is compared to the light of the sun, lightning or a crescent moon. *Madhyalakṣya* leads to the burning of the impurities of the mind. It also produces the sattvic quality of the mind. The practitioner becomes blissful. Rāmacandra remains very close to his original text regarding the choice of terminology and the content. Thus, there is no significant conceptual difference in comparison with the *madhyalakṣya* of the *Yogasvarodaya*.⁷⁷⁸ Sundarāś's descriptions in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* are shorter,

⁷⁷⁷See *Tattvayogabindu* XXVII, Ed. p. 184.

⁷⁷⁸Cf. *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 839): *idāniṃ madhyalakṣaṃ tu kathyate siddhikāraṃ | śvetaṃ raktaṃ tathā pītaṃ dhūmrākāraṃ tu nīlabham | agnijvālāsamānābhā vidyutpuñjasamaprabhā | āditya-*

but equally similar. The mind is supposed to dwell in its centre and focus on the form of the body. The practice brings about the sattvic quality of the mind. However, Sundarāś does not specify any visualisation of a light.⁷⁷⁹

3.11.2 Lakṣyayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha neither divides Lakṣyayoga into five,⁷⁸⁰ nor in three sub-categories.⁷⁸¹ His explanations are of a more general nature. He locates Lakṣyayoga within the framework of his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.35.

*lakṣyayogasvarūpam upāyāntaram āha—
viśayavatī vā pravṛttir utpannā manasaḥ sthitinibandhinī || 35 ||*

It is said [there is] another method having the nature of Lakṣyayoga—Alternatively, activity directed to a sense object is generated, causes the stopping of the mind.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains:

*viśayavatitī | nāsāgrādaḥ cittasya samyamārūpāl lakṣyayogād divyagand-
hādisākṣātkāro bhavati | seyaṃ viśayavatī pravṛttir viśvāsam utpādya
parameśvarādāv atisūkṣme manasaḥ sthitiṃ sampādayatīty arthaḥ |
tathā ca śāstrīyānubhavaṇiśāye jāte śraddhayā yogino dhyānādaḥ sthīrā
bhavatīty ayaṃ lakṣyayogaḥ |
yā hi nāsādidēśeṣu dṛṣṭiḥ pumsām sthīrā bhavet |
sa lakṣyayoga ākhyāto yoge śraddhākaraḥ paraḥ ||
iti smṛter iti || 35 ||*

[Regarding the term] “viśayavatī”. As a result of Lakṣyayoga, which has the nature of concentration of the mind (*samyama*)

*maṇḍalākāram athavā candramaṇḍalam | jvaladākāśatulyaṃ vā bhāvayed rūpam ātmanaḥ | etaj jyotir-
mayaṃ dehaṃ manomadhye tu lakṣayet | eteṣāṃ ca kṛte lakṣe nānāduḥkhaṃ praṇaśyati | manasas tu
malo yāti mahānando bhavet tataḥ |*

⁷⁷⁹ *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.28: *madhya lakṣa mana madhya bicārai | vapu pramāna koi rūpa nihārai
| yāte sātvik upajai āi | madhya lakṣa jo sādhai bhāi ||*

⁷⁸⁰ As in the *Tattvayogabindu*, the *Yogasvarodaya* or in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

⁷⁸¹ As in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* or the *śhivayogapradīpika*.

on the tip of the nose, etc., a direct perception of divine fragrances and other objects occurs. This activity being directed to sense objects, having produced confidence, causes to generate fixedness of the mind in [something] very subtle, in [something like] the supreme Lord, etc. Such is the meaning. And thus, stability in meditation, etc., arises for the yogin after the sense object from the experience of scripture has been produced with confidence. This is Lakṣyayoga.

For indeed, when the gaze of the person becomes steady at places like the tip of the nose, etc., that is called Lakṣyayoga, which in yoga, is considered the supreme faith-inspiring [practice].

Thus, it is remembered.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha is referring to the *bhāṣya*-part of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* concerning *sūtra* 1.35.⁷⁸² In the *bhāṣya*, various foci for meditation and specific effects that arise through concentration on the respective point are listed. Concentration on the tip of the nose creates absolute perception of odour. Concentration on the tip of the tongue leads to absolute perception of flavour. Concentration on the palate leads to absolute perception of form. Concentration on the centre of the tongue leads to absolute perception of touch. Concentration on the root of the tongue leads to absolute perception

⁷⁸² *yogasūtra* (Ed. p. 80): *nāsikāgre dhārayato 'sya yā divyagandhasaṃvit sā gandhapravṛttiḥ | jihvāgre rasasaṃvit | tāluni rūpasamvit | jihvāmadhye sparśasaṃvit | jihvāmūle śabdasaṃvid ity etā vṛttaya utpannāś cittam sthitau nibadhnanti, saṃśayaṃ vidhamanti, samādhiprajñāyāṃ ca dvārībhavevantīti | etena candrādityagrahamaṇipradīparaśmyādīṣu pravṛttir utpannā viśayavaty eva veditavyā yady api hi tattacchāstrānumānācāryopadeśair avagatam arthatattvaṃ sadbhūtam eva bhavati | eteṣāṃ yathābhūtarthapratipādanasāmarthyāt, tathāpi yāvad ekadeśo 'pi kaścin na svakaraṇasaṃvedyo bhavati tāvat sarvaṃ paroḥṣam ivāpavargādīṣu sūkṣmeṣv artheṣu na dṛm buddhim utpādayati | tasmāc chāstrānumānācāryopadeśopodbalanārtham evāvaśyaṃ kaścid arthaviśeṣaḥ pratyakṣikartavyaḥ | tatra tadupadiṣṭārthaikadeśapratyakṣatve sati sarvaṃ sūkṣmaviśayam api āpavargāc chraddhīyate | etadartham evedaṃ cittaparikarma nirdīśyate | aniyatāsu vṛttiṣu tadviśayāyāṃ vaśīkārasaṃjñāyām upajātāyāṃ samartham syāt tasya tasyārthasya pratyakṣīkaraṇāyeti | tathā ca sati śraddhāvīryasmṛti-samādhayo 'syāpratibandhena bhaviṣyanti |*

of sound. In addition, the *bhāṣya* lists the moon, sun, planets, jewels and lamps as sensory objects for focussing the mind. The resulting heightened perceptions stabilise the mind, remove doubt and are a gateway to *samādhi*. Furthermore, the *bhāṣya* explains that although the true nature of reality can be revealed through scriptures, inferences or instructions from teachers, these must be experienced personally, through one's own senses, so that the experience is not second-hand. Otherwise doubts occur for the practitioner. However, if these heightened perceptions referred to in this *sūtra* are experienced personally, then faith, trust or confidence (*śraddhā*) in the statements of the scriptures etc., the entire yogic endeavour and especially the possibility of the desired liberation is strengthened.

3.II.3 Lakṣyayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Lakṣyayoga across the four early modern yoga taxonomies reveals that these texts are the first to treat Lakṣyayoga as an independent category, even though practices involving *lakṣyas* are considerably older. Earlier sources describe only a threefold scheme (*antar-*, *bahir-* and *madhyalakṣya*), whereas all texts that present Lakṣyayoga as a distinct type adopt the fivefold model (*ūrdhva-*, *adho-*, *bāhya-*, *antara-* and *madhyalakṣya*). Although various texts—such as the *Netratantra*, *Śivayogapradīpikā*, *Maṇḍalabrāhmaṇopaniṣat* and *Advayatāraṅkopaniṣat*—mention three *lakṣyas*, none presents them as a separate yoga. The earliest works to teach Lakṣyayoga as an autonomous yoga category were very likely the *Tattvayogabindu*, and the lost *Yogasvarodaya*. From the *Yogasvarodaya*, the category passed into the *Prāṇatoṣinī*, *Yogakarnikā* and *Tattvayogabindu*, and from the latter into the *Haṭhasaṃketatandrikā*. Nārāyaṇatīrtha's presentation of Lakṣyayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntatandrikā* may be understood as an attempt to integrate this increasingly influential category into the *Yogasūtra*. In a similar vein, and possibly in response to its growing prominence, Sundardās appears to have incorporated Lakṣ(y)ayoga into his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. Across the corpus, the conceptual treatment of Lakṣyayoga remains strikingly consistent. Lakṣyayoga thus emerges as a defining category of texts with complex yoga taxonomies.

3.12 Vāsanāyoga

VĀSANĀYOGA, the “Yoga of mental residues”, is in the tenth position of the methods of Rājayoga presented at the beginning of *Tattvayogabindu*. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, it is the eighth method mentioned. However, neither text contains a specific description of Vāsanāyoga. However, the term *vāsanā* appears in several places in the texts. In the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Vāsanāyoga is the twelfth method for Rājayoga Nārāyaṇatīrtha mentions.⁷⁸³ The *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* does not list Vāsanāyoga. The term *vāsanāyoga* is scarce in the entire yoga literature and only appears in the context of early modern yoga taxonomies. It is not found at all in the early and medieval yoga texts. The compound *vāsanāyoga* appears in a few places in tantric literature but never as an independent yoga category.

However, the term *vāsanā* itself is a technical term frequently used in Indian philosophy, especially in the context of the concept of *karma*. It plays a significant role in yoga and Advaita Vedānta but the term is equally important in Buddhist philosophy. The concept of the term *vāsanā* can be characterised as follows in the yoga philosophy of Pātañjalayoga and Advaita Vedānta, which is congruent with the context of the texts discussed here. *Vāsanā* denotes a certain type of karmic imprint. In the commentary literature of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, the term and concept of *vāsanā* is closely linked to the term and concept of *saṃskāra*. Both terms are often even used synonymously. However, there is a nuanced difference: A *saṃskāra* is a mental imprint that is left in the mind (*citta*) by every action (*karma*). *Saṃskāras* trigger thoughts, memories and further actions (*karma*). *Vāsanā*, on the other hand, refers primarily to cumulative inherent imprints (*saṃskāras*) that exert a subconscious influence on the person’s personality and actions, a behavioural tendency caused by past actions. *Vāsanās* are also those *saṃskāras* that exert an influence on later rebirths or control the configuration of rebirth.⁷⁸⁴ Every action performed by a subject leaves an imprint or trace in the *karma* storage (*karmāśaya*) of the mind (*citta*).

⁷⁸³For an earlier discussion of Vāsanāyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* see penna2004.

⁷⁸⁴Cf. bryant2009.

Because the mind in Pātañjalayoga is the main component of the trans-migrating subtle body (*sūkṣmaśarīra*), the configuration of the *karma* storage of the mind will determine the nature of future rebirth.⁷⁸⁵ Literally, *vāsanā* even means “scent” or, in this context, “scent trail”. Metaphorically speaking, the actions leave behind a certain scent within the mental faculty (*citta*). This scent permeates the person and will continue to be felt in future actions for a long time because the accumulation of these habitual tendencies predisposes the person to certain future patterns of thought and behaviour. Thus, I think “mental residues” is a suitable translation. These patterns of thought and behaviour can be activated at any time, for example, triggered by sensory stimuli. In the context of a meditative yoga practice aimed at achieving the state called *samādhi* using concentration, a state characterised by a temporary standstill of mental activity, the *saṃskāras* and *vāsanās* in the yogin’s mind, when activated by sensory stimuli, would repeatedly lead to newly arising mental activity and thus to distraction from this desired goal.

If these are active, most are considered a hindrance to the ultimate goal of yoga practice and are either to be reduced or at least should be rendered inactive or latent. If the yogin is free from activated *saṃskāras* and *vāsanās* through yoga practice, he can not only reach the *samādhi* state, but he will also no longer be reborn. Only then he is able to be freed from the cycle of rebirth (*saṃsāra*). It is important to emphasise that certain *saṃskāras* and *vāsanās* are considered positive and work in favour of yoga practice, such as the habit of regular yoga practice (*yogābhyāsa*) itself or good eating habits. However, all *saṃskāras* and *vāsanās* must be rendered inactive, for the final goal of the yoga of *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, the *asaṃprajñātasamādhi*.⁷⁸⁶

Thus, when we encounter the term *Vāsanāyoga*, we naturally expect a yoga that aims at reducing the *vāsanās* in order to achieve mental stillness and thereby *mokṣa*.

⁷⁸⁵ Cf. *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 4.7–11.

⁷⁸⁶ See *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 1.18, 1.50–51 and bryant2009 on 1.18 and ibid. 2009: 164–68 on 1.50–51 for a summary of the classical commentaries.

3.12.1 The term *vāsanā* in *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Just as Dhyānayoga is mentioned in the taxonomies of the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* without being treated as an independent category, the concept of *dhyāna* can still be inferred from the texts. Likewise, even without a dedicated section on Vāsanāyoga, the usage and conception of *vāsana* can be reconstructed.

In *Tattvayogabindu*, the term plays a role in the etymological word explanation (*nirukti*) of the word *avadhūta*. This *nirukti* is explained in XLIV.3 and XLIV.4:⁷⁸⁷

ātmā hy akāro vijñeyo vakāro bhavavāsanā |
dhūtas tatkaṃpanaṃ proktaṃ so 'vadhūta nigadyate || XLIV.3 ||

The letter *a* is, in fact, to be known as the self and the letter *va* as mental residues of [mundane] existence; *dhūta* is said to be the shaking off of those [mental residues]; he is called an Avadhūta.

akārārtho jīvabhūto vakārārtho 'tha vāsanā |
etad dvayaṃ yaḥ jānati so 'vadhūta udāhṛtaḥ || XLIV.4 ||

The meaning of the letter *a* is the existence of the embodied soul, the meaning of the letter *va* then mental residues. He who knows this couple is declared to be an Avadhūta.

Accordingly, an Avadhūta is characterised by not only knowing the being of the embodied soul (*jīva*) and the *vāsanās* (“mental residues”) produced by action (*karma*), but the Avadhūta is an embodied soul (*jīva*) who has already shaken off all *vāsanās* and, as the following verses XLIV. 5–10, let us know, has become a perfected yogin (*siddhayogin*) through yoga.

The term *vāsanā* reappears in the context of *Tattvayogabindu* LIII. This section is part of a thematic sequence of sections (XLVIII–LVII) that differentiate metaphysical concepts of cosmogony.

⁷⁸⁷ Although most of the verses and passages in *Tattvayogabindu* XLIV are taken from *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, there is no correspondence to the verses XLIV.3–4 in this case. These verses may be authorial. The *Yogasvarodaya* does not thematise the *avadhūta* at all.

That which existed even before the Creator Rāmacandra calls the unmanifest (*avyakta*), nameless (*anāmā*) supreme reality (*param tattvaṃ*). According to *Tattvayogabindu* XLVIII–LVII, the creation unfolds in pentads, giving rise to five qualities each. In section LIII, Rāmacandra introduces the next pentad. The pentad is based on the explanations of the pentad on *vyaktaśakti* of *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.⁷⁸⁸ The specific pentad consists of will (*icchā*), activity (*kriyā*), illusion (*māyā*), primordial nature (*prakṛti*) and speech (*vācā*). Each pentad has five properties. The will (*icchā*) consists of the five properties—intense passion (*unmāda*), mental residues (*vāsanā*), desire (*vāñchā*), mental state (*caitta*) and behaviour (*ceṣṭā*). The pentad can also be identified in the *Yogasvarodaya*.⁷⁸⁹ None of the texts provides additional information on these five qualities.

The last mention of *vāsanā* occurs in section LVIII which is one of the largest sections of the entire text. Therefore, Rāmacandra probably considered this topic particularly important. It bears the title “Majesty of yoga” (*yogasya mātmyam*) and vehemently emphasises the indispensability of a teacher (*guru*) for the attainment of the reality of yoga (*yogatattva*). However, this should not be just any teacher, but a true teacher (*sadguru*):

*vikalpa etādṛśo yathā samudramadhye mahattarakallolāḍambaraḥ
prapañcavāsanā etādṛśī yathodakamadhye mahattaraṅgāḥ | tādṛśāt
saṃsārārṇavād yo nāvā param pāram prāpayati | sa sadguruḥ kathyate |*

Such discursive thinking is like the roar of mighty waves within the ocean [and] such manifold mental residues (*vāsanā*) are like great waves within the water, one who causes [the disciple] to reach the farther shore of such an ocean of Saṃsāra with a boat is called the true teacher.

In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the term *vāsanā* appears only within a cosmogonic context. In the *Tattvayogabindu*, its three occurrences—in discussions of the *avadhūta*, cosmogony, and the teacher’s role—are likewise insufficient to

⁷⁸⁸ *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.54.

⁷⁸⁹ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 847).

imply a distinct method of Vāsanāyoga. Vāsanāyoga is therefore absent from both texts. Nonetheless, the analysis shows that the reduction of *vāsanās* constitutes a central motif in Rāmacandra's yoga system.

3.12.2 Vāsanāyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

The *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* is the only text amongst the texts of the complex late medieval taxonomies that contains a dedicated description of a Vāsanāyoga.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha locates Vāsanāyoga in the framework of his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.37 and 1.38⁷⁹⁰ and distinguishes two different methods of Vāsanāyoga. Let us first look at the first:

avāntaravāsanāyogam āha— - vītarāgaviṣayaṃ vā cittam || 37 ||

With regard to [the two different methods of] Vāsanāyoga, it is said—Or, [the mind becomes stable when directed], on a mind without the desire for sense objects.

This *sūtra* presents one among several methods for attaining *śamādhi*. In this case, mental stability is achieved by meditating on the mind (*citta*) of someone already free from craving for sense objects—typically one's realised teacher or a renowned master of the past. Crucially, the person's mind must be free of *vāsanās*. Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains:

*vīteṭi | vītarāgaṃ nirvāsaṇaṃ yat sanakādīnāṃ cittam tadviṣayaṃ tad-
vibhāvanaparaṃ kuryāt | nirvāsanavāsitam antaḥkaraṇaṃ kuryād iti
yāvat | anenātra yogino mumukṣālābhena vāsanāyogo darśitaḥ |*

[Regarding] *vīta* [etc.]—One should make the mind the object [of meditation], [on] that [mind] which is without desire [and] without mental residues, [namely, the mind] of Sanaka and others; one should be intent on contemplating that.

⁷⁹⁰ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 55–56.

The most important characteristic of the chosen mind is freedom from *vāsanās*. The key indicator of having chosen the right mind as the object of meditation is the practitioner's increased desire for liberation (*mokṣa*). In the further course of his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.37, Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains that Vāsanāyoga primarily leads to an increase in the sattvic quality of mind. This increase of *sattva*, in turn, increases the efficiency of all other practised yoga methods.⁷⁹¹ The key to this practice is that by meditating on a mind free of *vāsanās*, one's own *vāsanās* are naturally extinguished.⁷⁹² Let us now turn towards the second method of Vāsanāyoga. Nārāyaṇatīrtha introduces this method as follows:

*vāsanāyogasyāvāntaram bhedaṃ āha—
svapnanidrājñānāmbanam vā || 38 ||*

With regards to the [other] distinction of Vāsanāyoga, it is said—
Or, [onto] the support of knowledge from dreams and sleep.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains in this regard that during sleep in dreams, some people have a vision of the favoured form of the divine, and others experience happiness through sleep. If this is the case, one can use these experiences as objects of meditation. This method works well because these experiences are based on previous very sattvic *vāsanās*. Meditating on them, therefore, also increases the sattvic quality in the waking state and thus leads to liberation.⁷⁹³

⁷⁹¹ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 56) regarding *sūtra* 1.37: *uktañ ca smṛtau—sattvāvalambanam yat tad bījaṃ cittaviśodhane | bhavet sa vāsanāyogo yogāntaravivardhakaḥ || iti ||* "It is said in the Smṛti: That which supports the sattvic constitution is the primary cause for the purification of the mind, this is the Vāsanāyoga which enhances the other yogas." I have not yet succeeded in identifying the source text of this verse.

⁷⁹² *Ibid.*: *tejaḥpratibandhajalāsaityaavad iti vinaiva sādhanāntaram yogino mokṣasukhaniṣṭhāsambhavāt | ayaṃ śubho vāsanāyogo viruddhavāsanānivarttaka iti || 37 ||* "Just as coolness arises from water when heat is obstructed, thus, without any other means, it is impossible for a yogin to be firmly established in the bliss of liberation. This auspicious Vāsanāyoga is the remover of the suppressed mental residues, so it is said."

⁷⁹³ *Ibid.*: *svapne bhagavato yadrūpaṃ priyaṃ ārādhayann eva prabuddha, evaṃ nidrādau yatsukham anubhūyate tad avalambanam tad vibhāvanaparam cittaṃ kuryāt | pūrvavāsanāprāptasattvapradhānam evāntaḥkaraṇam kuryād iti yāvat || 38 ||* "With regard to a dream, worshipping the divine in the favoured form, similarly, when one is awake, the mind should make the happiness

3.12.3 Vāsanāyoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The term Vāsanāyoga appears as an independent yoga category only in the early modern yoga taxonomies, apart from Sundardās' *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. No Haṭha- or Rājayoga text outside this corpus treats it as a distinct method. Although both the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* list Vāsanāyoga in their taxonomies, neither explains it. Only Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* provides a definition: a practice that refines the mind by diminishing negative *vāsanās* or cultivating positive ones, functioning as an auxiliary to all other yogas.

Given that Nārāyaṇatīrtha wrote in Benares, while the *Yogasvarodaya*—the source of the North Indian *Tattvayogabindu*—likely has South Indian roots, the unelaborated Vāsanāyoga in both texts is unlikely to reflect his influence. It seems more probable that Rāmacandra omitted a description because none existed in his source text. Whether a recension of the *Yogasvarodaya* once contained such a passage remains uncertain. Considering the importance of *vāsanā* in yoga literature, the missing method was likely similar in intent to Nārāyaṇatīrtha's: reducing negative *vāsanās* or cultivating beneficial ones.

3.13 Śivayoga

ŚIVAYOGA, “the yoga of Śiva” is in the eleventh yoga of Rāmacandra's taxonomy of the fifteen methods of Rājayoga. Rāmacandra does not dedicate a specific section to Śivayoga, nor is the term mentioned again in the course of the text. The two verses mentioning the total number of fifteen yogas in the *Yogasvarodaya* only list eight. Śivayoga is not included in this incomplete list nor introduced as a separate topic in the *Yogasvarodaya*. However, Śivayoga likely was one of the missing seven yogas in the *Yogasvarodaya* for the following reasons. On the one hand, the *Yogasvarodaya* is a yoga text that originates from a Śaiva milieu. On the other hand, all other texts that deal with fifteen yogas also mention Śivayoga. Although the *Tattvayogabindu*

experienced during sleep, etc., the support; that is what should be contemplated. To put it plainly: The mind should indeed cultivate the predominance of purity obtained from previous impressions.”

adopts much of the content of the *Yogasvarodaya*, it conceals almost all traces of religious affiliation that were present in its source text. When Rāmacandra speaks of a god, he exclusively uses the neutral term *īśvara*. Śīvayoga is not mentioned at all in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. In the Vaiṣṇava *bhakti* milieu of a sant like Sundardās, a Śīvayoga would not have been expected.⁷⁹⁴ Once more, the only explicit description of a Śīvayoga within the texts of the complex taxonomies is again found exclusively in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.⁷⁹⁵

3.13.1 Śīvayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu*?

The *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Tattvayogabindu* do not dedicate a separate section to Śīvayoga as a subcategory of Rājayoga, as was the case with other subcategories of Rājayoga listed in the taxonomies of the fifteen yogas. Nonetheless, at least Rāmacandra incorporated the term within his list. The question of why Śīvayoga is listed at all but then not described raises another question. Namely, what would have been expected in such a description of Śīvayoga as a method of Rājayoga? The comparison of the teachings of both texts with those of the *Śīvayogapradīpikā*,⁷⁹⁶ the first text ever to postulate Śīvayoga as a unique system of yoga in relation to other yoga systems,⁷⁹⁷ shows striking parallels in content to the texts examined here. There are also clear connections between these texts from the perspective of reception history, as will be shown in this section. These observations, in turn, raise a further question, namely whether the entire yoga system presented in the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* could also be understood as Śīvayoga, or instead whether there is a sufficiently big difference to describe Śīvayoga separately after its mention in the taxonomy. Notably, Cennasādāśīvayogin, the author of the *Śīvayogapradīpikā*, equates Śīvayoga and Rājayoga in verse 1.13:

⁷⁹⁴ See horstmann2023shrine.

⁷⁹⁵ See penna2004 (2004: 80–82) for an earlier discussion of Śīvayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.

⁷⁹⁶ A critical edition was only recently completed as part of a dissertation by powell2023 (2023). I want to take this opportunity to thank Dr. Seth powell2023 for making his work available for consultation before the actual publication.

⁷⁹⁷ A textual history of the Sanskrit compound *śīvayoga* is presented by powell2023.

In reality, there is no difference between Śivayoga and Rājayoga. Yet for those who worship Śiva [a difference] is thus declared, in order to increase wisdom.^{798,799}

The *yogasarasangraha* contains a similar statement. Rājayoga, Śivayoga, *samādhi* and other terms for the highest soteriological state are equated here.⁸⁰⁰

The *Yogasvarodaya* constitutes a Rājayoga treatise produced in a Śaiva doctrinal environment. For instance, the text states that a yogin, as a knower of Jñānayoga, becomes Śiva,⁸⁰¹ that the yogin becomes equal to Śiva through the practice of Haṭhayoga,⁸⁰² or that the yogin, as a result of the practice of *madhyalakṣya*, wanders the world like Śiva, devoid of sin or merit.⁸⁰³ Furthermore, in the section on *yogamāhātmya*, a true teacher (*sadguru*) is equated with Śiva.⁸⁰⁴ Additional references to Śiva can be found throughout the *Yogasvarodaya*. In contrast, while Rāmacandra draws extensively from the *Yogasvarodaya* for the compilation of his text, he largely omits Śaiva terminology from his source to maintain religious neutrality.⁸⁰⁵ The parallels in content between our texts and the *Śivayogapradīpikā* are striking, making it pertinent to delineate the fundamental aspects of this similarity in light of the inquiry of this section. The *Śivayogapradīpikā* by Cennasādāśivayogin is dated by **powell2023** to approximately 1400–1450 CE.⁸⁰⁶ Thus,

⁷⁹⁸Translated by **powell2023**.

⁷⁹⁹*Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.13: *na bhedaḥ śivayogasya rājayogasya tattvataḥ | śivārcināṃ evaṃ ukto buddeḥ pravṛddhaye || 13 ||*

⁸⁰⁰*yogasarasangraha*, Ed. p. 60: *rājayogaḥ samādhiś conmanī ca manonmanī | śivayogo layas tatvaṃ śūnyāśūnyaṃ nirañjanam || amanaskaṃ yathā caitannirālambaṃ nirañjanam | jīvanmuktis ca sahaḥ ity adir hy ekavācakaḥ ||*

⁸⁰¹*Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 831): *jñānayogaṃ pravakṣyāmi taj jñānī śivatāṃ vrajet |*

⁸⁰²Ibid. (PT, p. 835): *śivatulyo mahātmāsau haṭhayogaprasādataḥ |*

⁸⁰³Ibid. (PT, p. 839): *śivavaḍ vihareḍ viśve pāpapuṇyavivarjitāḥ |*

⁸⁰⁴Ibid. (PT, p. 848): *nānāvikalpavibhrāntināśaṇ ca kurute tu yaḥ | sadguruḥ sa tu vijñeyo na tu vairaprakalpakaḥ | ata eva maheśāni sadguruḥ śiva āditaḥ |*

⁸⁰⁵Only one passage in the *Tattvayogabindu* explicitly reveals the Śaiva origins of its content: In section XXI.3, the highest soteriological state attainable through Jñānayoga is described as *śāmbhavi sattā* (“the reality belonging to Śiva”). Īśvara and Śakti, however, Rāmacandra mentions quite frequently.

⁸⁰⁶**powell2023** 2023: 157.

we are situated around two hundred years prior to the composition of the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*.

In contrast to the fifteenfold yoga taxonomy of our texts, Cennasadāśivayogin employs the model often used in medieval yoga literature, comprising Mantra, Laya, Haṭha, and Rājayoga, which are considered subcategories of Śivayoga.⁸⁰⁷ As mentioned in the above quote from *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.13, Cennasadāśivayogin equates Śivayoga with Rājayoga, which he further subdivides into three categories: Sāṃkhyayoga, Tārakayoga, and Amanaska Rājayoga.⁸⁰⁸ Cennasadāśivayogin also refers to his Sāṃkhyayoga as Jñānayoga.⁸⁰⁹ To structure his text and teachings, Cennasadāśivayogin utilises the eight limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga.⁸¹⁰ This Aṣṭāṅgayoga, however, is not the standard model of the eight-limbed yoga of the *Pātāñjalayogasāstra* tradition, but rather a specific model of a group of texts that interchange *dhyāna* and *dhāraṇā*—a phenomenon otherwise only found in *śaḍāṅga* or *pañcāṅga* yoga systems.⁸¹¹ **powell2023** (2023: 168) explains that this interchange of *dhyāna* and *dhāraṇā* in an eight-limbed system is found only in the *Śivayogapradīpikā*. During the work on the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu*, especially the inspection of the oldest manuscripts, could show that other texts with eight-limbed systems also conserve this sequence.⁸¹² Moreover, it turned out that this reversed sequence is also found in the transmission of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, which is closely linked to the *Śivayogapradīpikā* and the *Tattvayogabindu*, in the manuscripts J₁ and J₂.⁸¹³ The transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya* is problematic: it professes an eight-limbed yoga, yet the verse

⁸⁰⁷ *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.3–4: *śivatattvavidāṃ śreṣṭha vakṣyāmi śṛṇu te 'dhūna | śivayogaṃ paraṃ guhyam api tvadbhaktigauravāt || 3 || mantrō layo haṭho rājayogaś ceti caturvidham | tam āhuḥ pūrvamunayāḥ siddhāḥ śambhuprabodhitāḥ || 4 ||*

⁸⁰⁸ *Ibid.* *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.10–11: *so 'pi tridhā bhavet sāṅkhyas tārakaś cāmanā iti | pañcaviṃśati-tattvānāṃ jñānaṃ tat sāṅkhyāṃ ucyate || 10 || bahirmudrāparijñānād yogas tāraka ucyate | antarmudrā-parijñānād amanaska itīritāḥ || 11 ||*

⁸⁰⁹ *Ibid.* 4.31.

⁸¹⁰ *Ibid.* 2.4–5: *śivayogaḥ sādhanānāṃ sādhyas tatsādhanaṃ haṭhaḥ | tasmād ādau prayoktavyaṃ haṭhayogaṃ imam śṛṇu || 4 || aṅgāny aṣṭau haṭhasyāpi bāhyāny abhyantarāṇi ca | yamādir ato 'ṣṭāṅgair devapūjāṃ samācāret || 5 ||*

⁸¹¹ See table 10: *Yogāṅgas with Dhyāna before Dhāraṇā* in **powell2023** (2023: 166) for an overview.

⁸¹² See Section XXXI in the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu* on p. 204.

⁸¹³ See the edition of the *ssplonavlā* by *ssplonavlā* (2016) in 2.32, Ed. p. 45.

mentions only *dhāraṇā*, while discussion is devoted to *dhyāna* and *dhāraṇā* remains unexamined. This discrepancy, however, already betrays a tight historical reception between the four works. Furthermore, the *Śivayogapradīpikā* teaches a great variety of yogas, and thus presents a similar diversity of yoga categories as found in the texts with complex yoga taxonomies. The *Śivayogapradīpikā* includes ten interwoven yoga categories. The entire system is a system called 1. Śivayoga embedded in a system of 2. Aṣṭāṅgayoga. Within this, 3. Mantrayoga, 4. Layayoga, 5. Haṭhayoga, and 6. Rājayoga are situated. The latter is further divided into 7. Sāṅkhyayoga (= 8. Jñānayoga), 9. Tārakayoga, and 10. Amanaska Rājayoga.

In the context of the fourth limb of the eight-limbed framework of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* named *prāṇāyāma*, Cennasadāśivayogin differentiates between three types of *prāṇāyāma*: 1. natural (*prākṛta*), 2. modified (*vaikṛta*), and 3. *kevalakumbhaka*, which unfolds by itself, with or without the practice of the first two variants.⁸¹⁴ The first variant⁸¹⁵ actually refers to the *ajapā mantra*, which is possibly alluded to by Rāmacandra in section III, and explicitly instructed in the context of meditations (*dhyānas*) on the nine *cakras* in the manuscript U₂. However, the Mantrayoga of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* is subordinated to *prāṇāyāma*.⁸¹⁶ The second variant of *prāṇāyāma* aligns with that in *Tattvayogabindu* Section XXXI.⁸¹⁷ In the third chapter of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, which is dedicated to the fifth limb named *dhyāna*, we find detailed descriptions of the nine *cakras*,⁸¹⁸ and the sixteen *ādhāras*,⁸¹⁹ central themes also found in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*. The descriptions of the individual elements of both themes are largely congruent.

Alongside various similarities, there are also significant differences between the texts. For example, both texts include variants of Jñānayoga (*Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.31 refers to Sāṅkhyayoga as Jñānayoga). The *Śivayogapradīpikā*

⁸¹⁴ *Śivayogapradīpikā* 2.22: *prāṇāyāmas tridhā proktaḥ prākṛto vaikṛtas tathā | dvābhyāṃ vinā jṛmbhate 'sau kevalaḥ kumbhakaḥ svayam* || 22 ||

⁸¹⁵ Ibid. 2.29–34

⁸¹⁶ See powell2023.

⁸¹⁷ Ibid. 22.4: *āgamoktavidhānena recapūrasvabhāvataḥ | yadi prāṇanīrodhaḥ syād vaikṛtaḥ sa udīritaḥ* || 24 ||

⁸¹⁸ Ibid. 3.7–16.

⁸¹⁹ Ibid. 3.17–32.

teaches a system with a total of twenty-five *tattvas* plus *puruṣa*.⁸²⁰ In contrast, the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* teach a simpler system with only ten *tattvas*.⁸²¹ While Cennasadāśivayogin initially defines a great soul (*mahātman*) as a soul that understands the true self (*ātman*) as ontologically distinct from the evolutes of *prakṛti*,⁸²² he immediately thereafter proclaims the non-duality of *ātman* and *brahman* in the sense of Advaita Vedānta or the *bhedābheda* schools of Vedānta.⁸²³ In contrast, *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* teach a radical non-duality, the radical unity of the universal soul, individual soul, and creation,⁸²⁴ reminiscent of forms of Śuddhādvaita.⁸²⁵ In the context of Tārakayoga in the fourth chapter of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*,⁸²⁶ the three *lakṣyas antar, bāhya*, and *madhyalakṣya* are taught, whereas *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* teach five *lakṣyas*. There are additional divergences, but the most significant is that Cennasadāśivayogin's *Śivayogapradīpikā* situates all its teachings within the ritual and devotional framework of the Viraśaivas.⁸²⁷ Thus, Cennasadāśivayogin defines Śivayoga in verse 1.15 as:

Śivayoga is five-fold, indeed: gnosis (*jñāna*) comprised of Śiva,
devotion (*bhakti*) to Śiva, meditation (*dhyāna*) comprised of Śiva,
Śaiva religious observance (*vrata*), and worship of Śiva (*arcā*).⁸²⁸

Despite the clear Śaiva affiliation of the *Yogasvarodaya*, these elements are nowhere to be found. The same applies to the *Tattvayogabindu*. Even the eight-limbed (*aṣṭāṅga*) scheme of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* is regarded as a ritual worship of Śiva (*śivapūjā*)⁸²⁹ and **powell2023** (2023) concludes that it is pre-

⁸²⁰ See *Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.19–31. Additionally, the *tattva* system of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* is thoroughly analysed by **powell2023**.

⁸²¹ Cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XXXI.6 and *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 836).

⁸²² *Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.28: *dehatrayaṃ prathitaṣoḍaśadhāvikārān liṅgāni saptadaśadhā navadhā padārthān | ātmānam aṣṭavidhayā prakṛtisvabhāvaṃ jñātvā tad anyā iti jīvati yo mahātmā* || 28 ||

⁸²³ *Ibid.* 4.29–30: *satyaṃ jñānam anantaṃ yad brahmeti vadati śrutiḥ | muktānandasvarūpaṃ ca nanu tat tvam asi sthiraṃ* || 29 || *naitad ahaṃ naitad ahaṃ ceti yad anyāṃ vibhāvayātmānam | so 'haṃ iti so 'haṃ iti nanu bhāvaya sarvaṃ tvam ātmānam* || 30 ||

⁸²⁴ See *Tattvayogabindu* XXI.7 and *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 836).

⁸²⁵ See **glasenapp1949philosophie**.

⁸²⁶ *Ibid.* 4.32–52.

⁸²⁷ **powell2023** 2023: 8.

⁸²⁸ *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.15: *jñānam śivamayaṃ bhaktiḥ śaivī dhyānam śivātmakam | śaivavratam śivārceti śivayogo hi pañcadhā* || 15 || Translation by **powell2023**.

⁸²⁹ *Ibid.* 2.1–5.

cisely this devotional and ritual orientation that renders the yoga system of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* as Śivayoga.

Can we say from this comparative study that the yoga systems of *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* implicitly teach Śivayoga? This question cannot be answered definitively. It is a fact that, at the level of doctrinal content, all three texts exhibit numerous commonalities. Content-wise, this question could tentatively be answered in the affirmative. However, the strong Śaiva orientation,⁸³⁰ as observed in the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, is largely absent in the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Tattvayogabindu*, with both texts effectively subordinating Śivayoga to Rājayoga. The degree of Śaiva orientation in the *Yogasvarodaya* based on the quotations in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* appears moderate, with ten mentions of the word *śiva*, and it is almost entirely extinguished in the *Tattvayogabindu*. From this perspective, the question posed in this subsection must be answered in the negative. Nevertheless, given the background presented here, the mysterious presence of the category Śivayoga in the fifteenfold taxonomies, which lists Śivayoga as a subcategory of Rājayoga and regrettably does not explicitly explain it, is easily elucidated. Śivayoga and Rājayoga would be essentially synonymous in content, as per the view initially mentioned by Cennasādāśivayogin. The fact that both systems also teach essentially the same practices would render the absence of a dedicated section explicitly explaining Śivayoga superfluous. Thus, it is quite possible that Rāmacandra shared a perspective similar to Cennasādāśivayogin. Furthermore, the striking content similarities, such as the specific sequence of the eight limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, lead to the conclusion that the *Śivayogapradīpikā* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, and thereby also the *Tattvayogabindu*, which also draws upon the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, a text closely related to the *Śivayogapradīpikā*,⁸³¹ originate from the same intertextual network. For this reason, I find it highly likely that the concept of Śivayoga, not explicitly described in the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, should broadly align with that of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*.

⁸³⁰The word *śiva* is mentioned a total of seventy-nine times in the *Śivayogapradīpikā*.

⁸³¹For a discussion of the relationship between the *Śivayogapradīpikā* and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, see [powell2023](#).

3.13.2 Śivayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates Śivayoga, along with Brahmayoga,⁸³² in his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.36:⁸³³

*brahmayogaṃ śivayogañ cāha—
viśokā vā jyotiṣmatī || 36 ||*

It is said about Brahmayoga and Śivayoga—
Or, [steadiness of the mind is gained when it is directed onto that
which is] without sorrow [and] luminous.

According to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Śivayoga consists in fixing the gaze—internally and externally—on the inner light at the brow-centre, a form of samyama that dispels sorrow.⁸³⁴ He further states that Śivayoga, aided by the disciplines of Haṭhayoga, is free from strain and, through the luminous awareness of the witness, stabilises the mind; he identifies it with śāmbhavī-mudrā.⁸³⁵ His explicit appeal to Haṭhayoga indicates that Śivayoga/śāmbhavī-mudrā is not an alternative path but a complementary practice, plausibly drawing—like his other Haṭhayoga teachings—on the Haṭhapradīpikā as its source.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha then quotes the *Amanaska*⁸³⁶ without reference:

*antarlakṣyā bahirdṛṣṭir nimeṣonmeṣavarjitā |
eṣā hi śāmbhavī mudrā sarvatantreṣu gopitā ||*

The focus is internal, the gaze external, unblinking: this is the
śāmbhavī-mudrā concealed in all the Tantras.⁸³⁷

⁸³²For a discussion of Brahmayoga, see p. 418.

⁸³³See pennazoo4 (2004: 80–82) for another discussion of Śivayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.

⁸³⁴*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 55): athavā bhrūmadhyādaṃ jyotīrūpe pratyagātmani bahirdṛṣṭibandhena manasaḥ samyamād viśokā |

⁸³⁵*Ibid.* (Ed. p. 55): haṭhayogādāv ivāyāsakṛtakleśarahitā jyotiṣmatī sākṣiṣiṣayā samvin manasaḥ sthairyahetur iti śivayogaḥ | ayam eva śāmbhavī mudrety ucyate |

⁸³⁶*Amanaska* 2.10; *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.6.

⁸³⁷This is the translation of our critical Edition of the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (2024), which also quotes this verse in 4.6.

Immediately after that, Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains that *śāmbhavīmudrā* can also be mastered through *yogāsana-*, *cāñcarī-*, *bhūcarī-*, *khecarī-*, *agaucarī-* [and] *nirvāṇamudrā*. However, the instructions for these needing to be obtained from a teacher.^{838,839} Nārāyaṇatīrtha's association of *śāmbhavīmudrā* and Śivayoga is insightful, as *śāmbhavīmudrā* is the central practice of the Rājayoga of the *Amanaska*,⁸⁴⁰ and Cennasadāśivayogin also teaches *śāmbhavīmudrā* as part of his Śivayoga system⁸⁴¹ which establishes yet another conceptual bridge between Rāja- and Śivayoga.

3.13.3 Śivayoga in the complex taxonomies

Given the absence of an explicit account of Śivayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, despite its inclusion in their complex yoga taxonomies, a comparative examination of Śivayoga across the four early modern taxonomic texts yields important insights into this category and its reception-history, particularly in relation to the authoritative *Śivayogapradīpikā*. Moreover, Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*—the only one of these texts to offer a detailed treatment—provides a valuable perspective on how a 17th century Brahmin *saṃnyāsīn* and learned author in Benares understood the practice termed Śivayoga.

The lack of a concrete description in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* makes a comparison with the *Śivayogapradīpikā* particularly instructive, especially since the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* cannot have served as their source. This comparison reveals that the *Yogasvarodaya* and, by extension, the *Tattvayogabindu* participate in the same intertextual network as the *Śivayogapradīpikā*.

⁸³⁸ Ibid.: *sā ca yogāsana cāñcarī bhūcarī khecarī gaucarī nirvāṇamudrābhiḥ siddhyati | prakāras guru-mukhād avagantayah |*

⁸³⁹ Some of the *mudrās* mentioned here by Nārāyaṇatīrtha, but not explained, are given more detailed descriptions under the same or similar names in the *Jogpradīpyakā* of Jayatārāma. Jayatārāma teaches a total of twenty-five *mudrā* techniques. For the *cāñcarīmudrā*, which Jayatārāma calls *cācarīmudrā*, see verses 688–690. The *bhūcarīmudrā* is described in verses 691–693. For the *agocarīmudrā*, see verses 694–695. A brief description of the techniques in English can be found in the introduction to the Kaivalyadhama edition at *jogpradīpyaka*. I have not yet been able to identify descriptions of *yogāsanamudrā* and *nirvāṇamudrā* in other texts. For a detailed discussion of *khecarīmudrā* see *mallinson2010*.

⁸⁴⁰ *Amanaska* 2.2–10.

⁸⁴¹ *Śivayogapradīpikā* 5.3.

They share core doctrinal features, such as a system of nine *cakras*, sixteen *ād-hāras*, a set of three to five *lakṣyas*, and five *vyomas*. All three texts also present an Aṣṭāṅgayoga in which the classical Pātañjalean sequence is inverted, placing *dhyāna* before *dhāraṇā*. Although the Śaiva orientation is attenuated in the *Yogasvarodaya* and almost entirely absent from the *Tattvayogabindu*, their doctrinal architecture nonetheless remains strikingly similar. This suggests that a separate exposition of Śivayoga within these works would have been redundant, since a Śivayoga matching that of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* would overlap almost entirely with what these texts already teach.

For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, whose principal aim in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* was to anchor the fifteen yogas circulating in Benares within the *Yogasūtra*, thereby reinforcing the universality and superiority of his own system, Śivayoga is identified with *śāmbhavīmudrā*. He appears to have drawn the practice from the *Haṭhapradīpikā* and seems unaware of independently organised systems bearing the name Śivayoga. His alignment of *śāmbhavīmudrā* with haṭhayogic practice—further supported by his assertion that it may be mastered with the aid of other *mudrās*—confirms that his conception of Śivayoga is rooted in Haṭhayoga rather than in the older Śaiva Śivayoga traditions represented by the *Śivayogapradīpikā*.

3.14 Brahmayoga

BRAHMAYOGA, the “Yoga of Brahman”, is linked to the key Vedāntic term *brahman*. In the early *Upaniṣads* (750–500 BCE), *brahman* denotes the immortal, infinite Absolute—the causeless ground of all being from which everything originates. From this philosophical notion also emerged the anthropomorphic male principal deity Brahmā, with all goddesses and gods, including Brahmā, being aspects of Brahman. A significant concept linked to this is the essential identity of Brahman with the individual self or essence of a person, the Ātman. A paramount goal, especially in early Vedāntic yoga texts, such as the *kathaup*,⁸⁴² is to realize this identity between one’s microcosmic self and the macrocosmic Brahman, thereby recognising one’s

⁸⁴² See *haas2018vom* (2018) for a recent comprehensive study on the *kathaup*.

essential immortality and achieving liberation (*mokṣa*) from the cycle of re-birth (*saṃsāra*). The preferred means here, and in many other Vedāntic yoga texts, is meditative absorption through reciting the syllable *om*. This syllable is considered the ideal sonic representation of Brahman and thus capable of making the essential unity between the individual self and the transcendent Brahman experientially accessible.⁸⁴³ Here, originally Vedic ideas are combined with concepts from the Śramaṇa movement's Proto-Sāṃkhyayoga. These concepts and terms, already circulating on the Indian subcontinent in pre-Christian times, exerted significant influence on later yoga traditions so that various core elements and fundamental ideas from that time can still be found in yoga literature centuries, even millennia later. For this reason, these core elements and fundamental ideas also resonate in early modern descriptions of Brahmayoga, the "Yoga of Brahman".

In the taxonomy of the fifteen methods of Rājayoga, Rāmacandra places Brahmayoga in twelfth position. Apart from this mention, no further discussion appears. It is possible that, as with Śivayoga, Brahmayoga in the *Yoga-tattva-bindu* is treated as synonymous with Rājayoga and therefore omitted.⁸⁴⁴

In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the term Brahmayoga does not occur. The two verses that give the total number of fifteen yogas list only eight; Brahmayoga is missing from this partial list and is not introduced elsewhere. Since all other complex yoga taxonomies include Brahmayoga, it is likely among the seven lost yogas of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Nārāyaṇatīrtha places Brahmayoga ninth in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. In the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, Sundardās groups it under Sāṃkhyayoga together with Jñānayoga and Advaitayoga, making it the eleventh and thus one of the penultimate yogas in his progressive system of twelve. Both Nārāyaṇatīrtha and Sundardās provide detailed accounts of their versions of Brahmayoga.

⁸⁴³Cf. *kathaup* 2.15–17.

⁸⁴⁴In the introductory verse of the *Yogasvarodaya* (Ed. p. 831) it is said of the fifteen methods of Rājayoga: *rājatya etad brahmaśiva ebhiś ca pañcadaśadhā* || "By these fifteen yogas, this person who abides in Brahman shines [like a king]."

3.14.1 Brahmayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

As with Śivayoga, Nārāyaṇatīrtha discusses Brahmayoga in his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.36.^{845,846} Here, Brahmayoga entails focusing the mind on a luminous (*jyotṣmatī*), sorrowless (*viśokā*) meditation object—Brahman in the form of *nāda* (“resonance”) located in the eight-petalled lotus of the heart. Union of the mind with this *nāda* is said to be free from the distress caused by other yogic efforts and is “luminous” because its object is light, namely the gnosis inherent in the *nāda*, composed of consciousness and bliss. When the practitioner unites the mind with the *nāda*, the mind becomes still.⁸⁴⁷ The practice involves a combination of meditation, visualisation, *prāṇāyāma*, and the recitation of the three letters A–U–M forming the mantra *om*:

tathā hy ayam atra kramah |
hrdayādho 'dhomukham aṣṭadalaṃ kamalaṃ recakenordhvamukhaṃ
vibhāvya, tatra sūryamaṇḍalaṃ dvādaśakalātmakaṃ jāgaritasthānam
akāraṃ, tadupari candramaṇḍalaṃ ṣoḍaśakalātmakaṃ svapnasthānam
ukāraṃ, tadupari vahnimaṇḍalaṃ daśakalātmakaṃ suṣuptisthānam
makāraṃ, tadupari nādākhyam turīyam brahma vibhāvayed iti brah-
mayogaḥ |

Thus, indeed this is the respective sequence:

In the lower [part of] the heart there is an eight-petalled lotus facing downward, by means of *recaka*[-*kumbhaka*?]⁸⁴⁸ it should be made upward facing, there, one should contemplate the orb of the sun, consisting of twelve digits, the wakeful state [and] the letter A; above that the orb of the moon, consisting of sixteen digits, the dream state [and] the letter U; above that the orb of fire, consisting of ten digits, the deep sleep state [and] the letter

⁸⁴⁵ See p. 416 for the translation of this *sūtra*.

⁸⁴⁶ For a discussion of Brahmayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, see [penna2004](#).

⁸⁴⁷ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 54): *viśoketi...saṃvin manasaḥ sthithetur ity arthaḥ*.

⁸⁴⁸ Since the yoga technique described here is complex and takes some time, *recaka* likely refers either to a very prolonged exhalation or an exhalation followed by a breath retention (*kumbhaka*) with empty lungs.

M; above that, that which is known as *Nāda*, the fourth state, the Brahman. This is Brahmayoga.

The exact execution of the practice is not clearly discernible. Nārāyaṇatīrtha leaves it ambiguous whether the practitioner of Brahmayoga should perform all the individual steps of the visualization during precisely one *recaka*, or if one or even several *recakas* should be performed per individual step of the visualization. The practice could also be interpreted in such a way that a single *recaka* suffices to make the eight-petaled lotus face upward, and the meditation steps are then carried out without further breath technique. Similarly, it could be understood that several *recakas* are practiced until the eight-petaled lotus faces upward, after which the meditation steps are practiced without additional breath techniques. The execution of the meditation is easier to comprehend. The three steps are apparently to be performed in immediate succession to [mentally] recite an elongated *om*, whose concluding M (*makāra*) transitions into the *nāda*, which is associated with Brahman and the fourth state (*turiya*). Subsequently, Nārāyaṇatīrtha specifies this *nāda* by means of a quotation he draws from the *Gītāsāra*:⁸⁴⁹

anāhatasya śabdasya tasya śabdasya yo dhvaniḥ |
dhvaner antargataṃ jyotir jyotir antargataṃ manaḥ ||
tan mano vimalaṃ yāti tad viśṇoḥ paramaṃ padam |

The tone of that sound is that of the unstruck sound. A light is inside the tone [and] the mind is inside the light. That mind becomes pure. That is the supreme state of Viṣṇu.

Thereafter, Nārāyaṇatīrtha cites the *Haṃsopaniṣad*, which prescribes not the recitation of *om* but that of *haṃsa*, the *ajapā* mantra.⁸⁵⁰ It remains unclear whether both recitations are alternatives or whether the *ajapā* follows an

⁸⁴⁹=*Uttaragīta* 41cd–42 and *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.49.

⁸⁵⁰*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. pp. 54–55): *haṃsopaniṣadi coktaḥ – haṃsānusaṃdhānaphalabhūto 'nekavidhaḥ saphalaḥ*.

initial recitation of *om*. Concentration on the *nāda* then leads the practitioner through a sequence of ten sounds perceived during contemplation:

*asyaiva japakotyā nādam anubhāvayati yas tasya daśavidha upajāyate |
ciṇīti prathamah, ciṇciṇīti dvitīyaḥ ghaṇṭānādas tṛtīyaḥ, śaṅkhanādaś
caturthaḥ, pañcamas tantrīnādaḥ, śaṣṭhas talanādaḥ, saptamo veṇunā-
daḥ, aṣṭamo bherīnādo, navamo mṛdaṅganādo, daśamo meghanādaḥ |
navamaṇ parityaiya daśamam evābhyaset |*

Thus, caused by practicing 10 million repetitions (*japa*) of that sound, then types of that [sound] arise: The first sound is *ciṇī*, the second *ciṇciṇī*,⁸⁵¹ the third the sound of a bell, the fourth the sound of a conch, the fifth the sound of strings (*tantrī*), the sixth the sound of [clasping?] palms, the seventh the sound of a flute, the eighth the sound of the *bherī*-drum, the ninth the sound of the *mṛdaṅga*-drum, and tenth the sound of a cloud. Having given up the ninth, he shall practice the tenth only.

When the mind is fixed on *nāda*, according to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, the mind enters a state of absorption, and mental activity dissipates. Sin and merit are burned away. By the nature of pure potency (*maśakti*),⁸⁵² Sadāśiva is revealed as the all-encompassing peace of mind.⁸⁵³

3.14.2 Brahmayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Sundardās's Brahmayoga, as described in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (4.25–35),⁸⁵⁴ is a form of contemplation,⁸⁵⁵ which he presents as difficult.⁸⁵⁶

⁸⁵¹These terms may be meant onomatopoeically. The sound is reminiscent of the chirping of a bird or the chirping of a cricket.

⁸⁵²According to *rodrigues2023* (2023) the term *maśakti* is a synonym of the well-known *citśakti*. For a discussion of the term, see *rodrigues2023*.

⁸⁵³*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 55): *tasmān manoviline manasi gate saṃkalpavikalpe dagdha-punyaḥ sadāśivo maśaktyātmanā sarvatrāvasthitah śāntaḥ prakāśayati | ity ādinā |*

⁸⁵⁴See *burger2014sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (2014: 703–704) for her discussion of Brahmayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

⁸⁵⁵*Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.25c: *brahmayoga kā kaṭhina bicārā |*

⁸⁵⁶*Ibid.* 4.26a: *brahmayoga ati dūrlabha kahiye |*

Without experience, one cannot reach its end.⁸⁵⁷ Sundardās describes that only a selfless person attains Brahmayoga, whereas one who indulges in sensory pleasures wanders aimlessly.⁸⁵⁸ In *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.27 Sundardās writes:

*brahmayoga soī bhala pāvai | pahile sakala sādhi kari āvai |
brahmayoga saba ūpara soī | brahmayoga bina mukti na hoī || 27 ||*

That person truly attains Brahmayoga who first masters all practices and then comes to it. Brahmayoga is supreme above all, [and] without Brahmayoga, there is no liberation.

With Brahmayoga, Sundardās initially seems to describe a state that must be attained. As an independent practice, Brahmayoga is an advanced form of yoga, because, as Sundardās explains, all preliminary exercises must have been mastered to practice it. This likely refers to a prolonged yoga practice comprising the previously described yogas, which qualify the practitioner for Brahmayoga. One must have progressed far enough on the yogic path that, as mentioned earlier, selflessness has been achieved and one no longer indulges in sensory pleasures. In verses 4.29–35, Sundardās then describes what can either be interpreted as a mystical form of contemplation or as an introspective experience of mystical unity. This is articulated in the form of a verbalization from the first-person perspective, demonstrated by two of these verses. In *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.29 and 4.33, Sundardās writes:

*saba saṁsāra āpa maiṁ deṣai | pūraṇa āpu jagata mahiṁ peṣai |
āpuhi karatā āpuhi haratā | āpuhi dātā āpuhi bharatā || 29 ||*

All of existence reveals itself within me, the world is to be seen completely in the self. I am the creator, I am the destroyer. I am the giver, I am the sustainer.

⁸⁵⁷Ibid. 4.25d: *anubhava vinā na pāvai pārā || 25 ||*

⁸⁵⁸Ibid. 4.26bd: *paracā hoī tabahiṁ tau lahiye | brahmayoga pāvai niḥkāmī | bhramata su phirai indriyārāmī || 26 ||*

*ahaṃ abhedya achedya aleṣā | ahaṃ agādha su akala adeṣā |
ahaṃ sadodīta sadā prakāśā | sakṣī ahaṃ sarva mahiṃ vāsā || 33 ||*

I am inseparable, I am unassailable, without stain. I am unfathomable, supremely timeless, and unseen. I am eternally arisen, always luminous. I am the witness, dwelling in all the universe.

In the last verse, Brahmayoga is even equated with Brahman itself:

*ahaṃ parama ānandamaya ahaṃ jyoti nija soī |
brahmayoga brahmahi bhayā dubidhyā rahī na koī || 36 ||*

I am supremely filled with bliss, I am the self-luminous light. Brahmayoga is Brahman itself, fear and doubt do not remain anymore.

3.14.3 Brahmayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Brahmayoga within the four texts of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies reveals, on the one hand, the underlying continuities of the Vedāntic concept of Brahman and, on the other hand, exciting developments in the yoga practices associated with the term Brahmayoga in the 16th and 17th centuries.

For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Brahmayoga is a form of yoga distinguished by a complex technique involving the syllable *om*, associated with Brahman, culminating in absorption into its *nāda*. After the practitioner has performed this practice and passed through various stages of perceiving the *nāda*, Sadāśiva is ultimately revealed as all-encompassing inner peace. Notably, the practice culminates not in the revelation of Brahman but in the revelation of Sadāśiva.

For Sundardās, Brahmayoga is both a state and a practice. It is a state in which the practitioner must have already reached a very advanced level of yoga practice. In the context of his twelve-limbed yoga system, one must first have mastered Bhaktiyoga and Haṭhayoga. Through Bhaktiyoga, one's devotion to Rāma, Sundardās' term for the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta*

puruṣa), must have become unwavering.⁸⁵⁹ Through the diverse practices of Haṭhayoga, body, breath, and mind are cultivated to a degree that allows Brahmayoga to arise. This initially occurs through the overarching category of Sāṃkhyayoga, where duality becomes conscious. In the state and contemplation of Brahmayoga, the practitioner experiences and realises both self and world as a unity, eventually dissolving duality and unity in the non-duality of Advaitayoga, the final stage of his system. It is fascinating to observe how Sundardās attempts to harmonise the philosophical differences of Sāṃkhya, Vedānta, and Advaita Vedānta by merging them into a progressive sequence. His descriptions of Brahmayoga read like a collection of Upaniṣadic statements on the essential identity of Ātman and Brahman.

In light of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* and the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, despite the absence of specific descriptions of Brahmayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu*, it seems plausible that the undescribed Brahmayoga in these two texts would have incorporated core elements and fundamental ideas of Vedānta. Perhaps the authors understood Brahmayoga, as in the case of Śivayoga, as another synonym for Rājayoga.

3.15 Advaitayoga

ADVAITAYOGA, the “Yoga of non-duality” is a rare term in yoga literature. A search for the term *advaitayoga* in the digitised collections of Sanskrit [yoga] texts yielded an astonishingly low number of results. The compound *advaitayoga* in the sense of a distinct yoga category appears only in the yoga texts of the 16th and 17th centuries. Besides the texts of the complex yoga taxonomies, I found the term only in one other text, namely in the *Haṭhapradīpikā Siddhāntamuktāvalī*,⁸⁶⁰ where a total of 48 verses (6.115–162) are dedicated to this yoga.

⁸⁵⁹For an analysis of Bhaktiyoga in Sundardās’s *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, see p. 459.

⁸⁶⁰The *muktāvalī* survives in a single manuscript (MMPP Ms. No. 6756) from 1708 CE. The manuscript contains a recension of the *Haṭhapradīpikā* with a total of six chapters and 1553 verses, making it by far the most extensive recension of the *Haṭhapradīpikā*.

In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the term *advaitayoga* is entirely absent in the extant transmission. However, Advaitayoga is present in the three other complex yoga taxonomies.

Advaitayoga is the thirteenth method of Rājayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Beyond this mention, the term *advaitayoga* does not appear in the text, and it is not treated as an independent topic. Similar to the cases of Śivayoga and Brahmayoga, Advaitayoga could be implicitly present in the text, making a separate description redundant for Rāmacandra. Indeed, in the context of Section XXI, there is an explicit reference to applying non-dualistic thinking to achieve Jñānayoga.⁸⁶¹ Rāmacandra states that one who is devoted to non-duality will always attain the reality of Śaṃbhu.⁸⁶²

Sundardās presents Advaitayoga as the final non-dual state, viz. the goal in his twelve-limbed sequence of yogas and not as an independent method. For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Advaitayoga is a specific method of meditative murmuring (*japa*) of the mantra *om* or *praṇava*. Since Advaitayoga has already been covered in the context of the analysis of Jñānayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* on p. 341, it need not be repeated here. Therefore, only the determination of Advaitayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* remains to be addressed.

3.15.1 Advaitayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Sundardās's description of Advaitayoga (4.37–50)⁸⁶³ follows his description of Brahmayoga. As previously mentioned, this is not a practice but rather the final state of yoga, the description of which begins in verses 4.30–36. While the mystical experience described in the Brahmayoga verses, which can be articulated as an infinite and absolute experience of unity, remains within the realm of the comprehensible, Sundardās uses his formulations to immerse the reader into the ultimate dissolution of the non-duality state, the final step in his progression through the twelve yogas. Subsequently, Advaitayoga

⁸⁶¹ *Tattvayogabindu* XXI.1: *ekam eva jagat paśyed viśvātmā suvibhāsvaram | avikalpatayā yuktyā jñānayogaṃ samācaret* || "He shall see the world as only one, illumined by the supreme self. By the method of non-dualistic thinking, he shall accomplish Jñānayoga."

⁸⁶² Ibid. XXI.3ab: *prāpnoti śāmbhavīm sattām sadādvaitaparāyaṇaḥ* |

⁸⁶³ See burger2014sarvangayogapradipika (2014: 703–704) for her discussion of Advaitayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

is the direct result of the preceding contemplation of Brahmayoga. Through numerous negations, Sundarāś attempts to show what lies beyond any form of description or comprehension. This can be illustrated with some examples:

*aba advaita sunahum ju prakāśā | nāhaṃ nā tvaṃ nāṃ yahu bhāśā |
nahim prapañca tahāṃ nahim pasārā | na tahāṃ sṛṣṭi na sirajanahārā ||
37 ||*

Now listen to the realisation of non-duality: there is no “I”, no “you” and nothing that arises. There is no mundane world, no spaciousness, no creation and no creator.

*na tahāṃ prakṛti puruṣa nahim icchā | na tahāṃ kāla karma nahim
vaṃchā | na tahāṃ śūnya aśūnya na mūlā | na tahāṃ sukṣma nahim
sathūla || 38 ||*

There, neither primordial nature nor consciousness exists, there is no desire. There, neither time nor activity nor aspirations exist. There is neither void nor non-void nor root. There, neither subtle nor gross matter exist.

*na tahāṃ bhāva nahim tahāṃ bhakti | na tahāṃ mokṣa nahim tahāṃ
muktī | na tahāṃ jāpya nahim tahāṃ jāpī | na tahāṃ mantra nahim laya
thāpī || 46 ||*

There, neither existence nor devotion exists. There, neither liberation nor salvation exists. There, neither the recitation nor the one who recites exists. There, neither Mantra nor absorption exists.

Various other negations follow, which also negate specific yoga practices:

*na tahāṃ sādhaśiddha samādhī | na tahāṃ yoga na yuktyārādhī | na
tahāṃ mudrā baṃdhana lāgai | na tahāṃ kuṇḍalinī nahim jāgai || 47 ||*

There, neither the practitioner nor the accomplished dwelling in *samādhi* exists. There, neither yoga nor the means of worship exists. There, neither seals nor locks apply. There, the Kuṇḍalinī does not awaken.

In conclusion, Sundardās states:

*jñe jñātā nahim jñāna tahaṃ dhye dhyātā nahim dhyāna | kahanahāra
sundara nahim yaha advaita baṣāna || 50 ||*

There, neither the knower, the known, nor knowledge exists. There, neither the meditator, the meditated upon, nor meditation exists. Sundar says, there is no speaker; this is the abode of non-duality.

Structurally, Advaitayoga, along with Jñānayoga and Brahmayoga, is situated within the overarching category of Sāṃkhyayoga. Sundardās depicts a progression through these four yogas. Sāṃkhyayoga initially teaches the distinction between the Self and the Non-Self, the doctrine of dualism between consciousness and matter from the perspective of the classical Sāṃkhya system. The goal of Sāṃkhyayoga is to recognise this duality as the difference between what is the Self and what is not the Self. Following this is Jñānayoga, which fundamentally shifts the perspective from duality to identification. The aim of Jñānayoga is to recognise the non-difference between the Self (*ātman*), the body, and the world. Only after the practitioner has recognised this fundamental unity can he, through Brahmayoga, perceive the entire world within himself. Ultimately, in the resulting Advaitayoga, the state of duality and conceptual distinctions are transcended, and all opposites dissolve. The practitioner is detached from the world, maintaining equanimity toward all existing phenomena without negating their existence. All the yogas described by Sundardās within the framework of the twelve yogas ultimately aim at this non-dual state. In the state of Advaitayoga, where duality is overcome, no limiting concepts remain, and the practitioner attains the state of final liberation.

3.15.2 Advaitayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Advaitayoga within the four texts of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies sharpens our understanding of this yoga category. While Rāmacandra's Jñānayoga involves the application of non-dualistic thinking, Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates both Jñānayoga and Advaitayoga in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* within the context of his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.28. For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, both methods are based on the murmuring (*japa*) of the mantra *om* or *praṇava*. This *japa* practice only differs in its accompanying contemplation method. The variant of Jñānayoga involves contemplation focused on the distinction between consciousness (*puruṣa*), primal nature (*prakṛti*), and its effects (*tatkārya*). In contrast, the Advaitayoga variant involves an alternative contemplation focused on the non-difference between the supreme Self (*paramātmān*) and the individual self (*jīva*).⁸⁶⁴

In Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, Jñānayoga and Advaitayoga are situated within the same tetrad along with Brahmayoga. All three yogas are forms of Sāṃkhyayoga. However, Sundardās presents Advaitayoga as the final non-dual state of yoga and no longer as a specific method that can be applied to reach this state. If Rāmacandra held a similar perspective, it would be plausible why he did not dedicate a separate section to Advaitayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*, even though one searches in vain for Advaitayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*. Thus, only the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* explicitly includes a method of Advaitayoga among the early modern texts with complex taxonomies.

Remarkably, the **muktavali** describes Advaitayoga as a practice or method and state. The state is the identity of Ātman and Brahman (6.124, 6.121). The practitioner transcends all dualistic perceptions and realises the omnipresent nature of the Self (6.130, 6.150). As a practice, Advaitayoga involves deep meditation and contemplation, whereby the mind is centred on the Self and unity with Brahman. This is represented by the focus on the inner and outer merging of the Self with the universe (6.120) and the contemplation of *nāda* (6.133).

⁸⁶⁴ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 46): *kiñ ca, japa ity anena mantrayogaḥ, arthabhāvanam ity anena vivekajñānā 'bhyāsarūpo jñānayogaḥ, abhedabhāvarūpo 'dvaitayogaś ca saṃgrhītaḥ* |

3.16 Siddhayoga

SIDDHAYOGA, the “Yoga of the Siddhas,” is the fourteenth method of Rājayoga in Rāmacandra’s *Tattvayogabindu*. The text distinguishes between two variants of Siddhayoga. In the transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya*, however, it is entirely absent—neither listed nor mentioned elsewhere. Nārāyaṇatīrtha does not describe a Siddhayoga but a Siddhiyoga, which appears as the eleventh yoga in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. Sundarādās includes neither Siddhayoga nor Siddhiyoga in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

3.16.1 Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Siddhayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*

In *Tattvayogabindu* III, a yoga is described that is referred to as Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga (“The Kuṇḍalinīyoga of the Siddhas”).⁸⁶⁵ The presence of the second element of the compound “*kuṇḍalinī*” is difficult to explain, as *kuṇḍalinī* is neither mentioned in the sections about this yoga nor in the rest of the text. Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga is also mentioned immediately alongside Mantrayoga.⁸⁶⁶ In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the corresponding passage in the transmission of the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* (Ed. pp. 831–823) is designated as Jñānayoga. However, the content of both passages is essentially identical. It seems that Rāmacandra

⁸⁶⁵ Siddhas, often called masters of yogic and tantric practices, are highly renowned figures who cannot be confined to a single religious tradition or order. These accomplished practitioners appear in medieval Sanskrit and Tibetan texts associated with Haṭhayoga, Śaiva Tantra, and Vajrayāna Buddhism, spanning the Indian subcontinent and the Himalayan regions. For example, the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (1.4–9) is an early fifteenth-century text that provides a famous list of Siddhas. Svātmārāma, the author, refers to a lineage beginning with Ādinātha and Matsyendranātha. However, he lists twenty-nine great adepts (*mahāsiddhas*) who are described as “used the power of Haṭhayoga to smash the rod of death and [so] are roaming the worlds.” Although Nātha figures such as Gorakṣa and Caurāṅgī are included, the list is not exclusive to the Nātha order. It is not a traditional lineage or order of succession. Many of the personalities listed, such as Manthānabhairava, Kākacaṇḍīśvara, and Pūjyapāda, are associated with the alchemical traditions of the Rasāyana Siddhas. Figures such as Virūpākṣa are revered in both the Śaiva and Buddhist traditions. Therefore, Siddhas embody the ideals of Tantra and Haṭhayoga and illustrate the different sectarian roots of these practices; see [powell2023](#).

⁸⁶⁶ For a discussion of Mantrayoga and the terminological issues arising in this context, see p. 380.

only exchanged the name. Before we address why this yoga is named Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga, we should first characterise its practice.

The section about Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga describes the names and paths of the three main channels of the yogic body: Idā, Piṅgalā, and Suṣumnā. Rāmacandra emphasises the importance of the central channel by explaining that the central channel grants both enjoyment and liberation (*bhuktimuktipradā*). He then explains that the practitioner attains omniscience once the knowledge of the central channel arises. This leads into the subsequent sections IV–XII, where a system consisting of nine *cakras* is described.⁸⁶⁷ The presentation of the *cakras* is introduced with the statement: “Now, the means for the genesis of gnosis of the central channel are described.”⁸⁶⁸ Rāmacandra teaches a meditation onto each individual *cakra*, resulting in extravagant outcomes, as table 5 demonstrates.

Table 5: The nine *cakras* of Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga

Name	Location	Focus of Meditation	Result of the Meditation
1. <i>mūlacakram</i>	Beginning of the central channel.	A flame-shaped <i>mūrti</i> inside <i>kāmapīṭha</i> within the <i>cakra</i> .	Spontaneous literary knowledge.
2. <i>svādhiṣṭhānacakram</i>	Penis	An extremely red light in its centre.	Enhanced attractiveness.
3. <i>nābhīsthāne padmam</i>	Navel	In its middle exists a <i>cakra</i> with five angles. In the middle of it is a single form.	The body of the person becomes durable.
4. <i>hṛdayamadhe kamalam</i>	Heart	The <i>jīva</i> within the central receptacle of the eight-petalled lotus inside the twelve-petalled lotus.	Women's obedience.
5. <i>kaṇṭhasthāne kamalam</i>	Throat	The <i>puruṣa</i> inside the <i>cakra</i> .	Freedom from diseases and long life.
Continued on next page			

⁸⁶⁷The reception history and genesis of the ninefold *cakra* system have been convincingly presented by Seth **powell2023**, and thus do not need to be repeated here. See **powell2023**.

⁸⁶⁸*Tattvayogabindu IV: idāṇīm suṣumṇāyāḥ jñānotpattāv upāyāḥ kathyante* |

Table 5: (continued)

Name	Location	Focus of Meditation	Result of the Meditation
6. <i>ājñācakram</i>	Middle of the eyebrows.	Blazing, indivisible fire in its middle.	A non-ageing and immortal body.
7. <i>cakram tālumadhye</i>	Centre of the palate.	The hidden digit of the moon within the <i>ghāṇṭikā</i> .	Immortality and initiating the flow of <i>amṛta</i> .
8. <i>aṣṭamacakra brahmarandhra-sthāne</i>	Fontanelle on the head.	Smoke-like streak in its centre.	Direct perception of the soul, earth element immunity, omniperception and separation from matter and longevity.
9. <i>mahāsūnyacakram</i> aka. <i>mahāsiddhacakram</i>	Above the previous <i>cakra</i> .	The <i>ūrdhvaśakti</i> as a unique digit.	Eradication of suffering, immediate manifestation of wishes, equanimity despite material wealth, merit and sin no longer affect the body, realising one's nature and remote viewing.

Why does Rāmacandra specify this form of yoga as *Siddhakunḍalinīyoga*, even though *kunḍalinī* plays no explicit role here? A straightforward explanation could be a corruption in the archetype of the *Tattvayogabindu* from which all surviving manuscripts derive. The term would be entirely unproblematic if Rāmacandra had referred to this yoga simply as *Siddhayoga*. However, if the transmission is correct and Rāmacandra indeed consciously chose this term, why did he do so?

Sections III–XII of the *Tattvayogabindu* are largely a prose adaptation of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Unlike the *Tattvayogabindu*, however, the term *kunḍalī* appears once in the latter, mentioned in connection with the fourth *cakra* in the heart.⁸⁶⁹ It is puzzling why Rāmacandra, in his prose adaptation of this passage, did not include the term *kunḍalī*. Therefore, another plausible ex-

⁸⁶⁹ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 832): *prāṇavāyoḥ sthalaṁ cāśya liṅgākāraṇa tu karṇikā | kālīkāhyā karṇikeyaṁ aśyā madhye tu kunḍalī |*.

planation could be a lack of diligence in rephrasing and transforming of the source text.

Additionally, Rāmacandra's sections on the nine *cakras* shows clear influences from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.⁸⁷⁰ The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* locates the *kuṇḍalinī* in the context of the third *cakra* at the navel, a concept that Rāmacandra does not adopt.⁸⁷¹ Moreover, *kuṇḍalinī* is an important central element in the metaphysics of the Nāths.⁸⁷² According to mallinsonnath (2011: 20), the composition of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* marks the moment when the Nāth Sampradāya established a solid sectarian identity. The Nāth Sampradāya traces itself back to the so-called “nine Nāths,” a list of Siddhas whose names closely follow early lists of Siddhas.⁸⁷³ A key yogic technique associated with the Nāth Siddhas is the awakening of the *kuṇḍalinī*, which, as a result of its awakening, ascends through a certain number of *cakras* up the central channel.⁸⁷⁴

In light of the prominence of *kuṇḍalinī* within the traditions underlying the sources Rāmacandra drew upon, the appearance of the term *siddhakūṇḍalinīyoga* in a section that does not mention *kuṇḍalinī* at all is, understandably, unsatisfactory. One hint to understand this phenomenon might be the occurrence of the term Mantrayoga, which Rāmacandra places right next to

⁸⁷⁰This is evident, for example, in the inclusion of the concept of *ūrdhvaśakti* in the context of the ninth *cakra* in Section XII.

⁸⁷¹ssplonavlā 2.3: *ṛṭriyaṃ nābhicakraṃ pañcāvartam sarpavat kuṇḍalākāram | tanmadhye kuṇḍalinīm śaktim bālārakatoṣisannibhām dhyāyet | sāmādhya śaktiḥ sarvasiddhidā bhavati ||*

⁸⁷²See for example *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.7, 1.12, 1.14, 2.3, 4.21.

⁸⁷³mallinsonnath.

⁸⁷⁴*Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 6.86: *śaktyākuñcanam agnidiptikaraṇaṃ tv ādhārasaṃpīḍanāt sthānāt kuṇḍaliniprabodhanam atah kṛtvā tato mūrdhani || nītvā pūrṇagiriṃ nīpātanam adhaḥ kurvanti tasyāś ca ye khaṇḍajñānaratās te nīpādaṃ teṣāṃ hi dūraṃ padam || Cf. yogataranginī 1.48–49: kim ca, yena dvāreṇa gantavyaṃ brahmasthānam anāmayaṃ | mukhenācchādyā tad dvāraṃ prasuptā paramēśvarī || 48 || yena dvāreṇa yena mārgēṇa kṛtvā anāmayaṃ jananamaraṇādīduḥkhacintārahitaṃ brahmasthānam akhaṇḍānandapadaṃ gantavyaṃ tad dvāraṃ mukhenācchādyā prasuptā paramēśvarī kuṇḍalī śaktiḥ || 48 || prabuddhā vahnīyogena manasā marutā saha | sūcivād guṇam ādāya vrajaty ūrdhvaṃ suṣūmnayā || 49 || vahnīyogena prāṇapreritānalaśikhāsambandhena kṛtvā prabuddhā tyaktanidrā sati manasā marutā prāṇena ca saha yuktā suṣūmnāyā avadhyā nādyā kṛtvā ūrdhvaṃ sahasradalābhīmukhaṃ vrajati | dr̥ṣṭāntam āha—sūcivād iti yathā sūci svasaktaṃ guṇam ādāya ūrdhvaṃ paṭasya prati tantvantarālaṃ vrajati tadvad iyam api svakalpitaṣaṭcakraṃ tad adhiṣṭhāti tat tad eva ādisakalaprapaṇcaṃ saṃhṛtya vrajati || 49 ||*

Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga in *Tattvayogabindu* III. An explicit connection between Kuṇḍalinī and Mantra is established in *Śāradātilakatantra* 25.37ab:

bibharti kuṇḍalī śaktir ātmānaṃ haṃsaṃ āśritā |

The *kuṇḍalī* Śakti abides in the *haṃsaḥ* [and] supports the [individual] Self.⁸⁷⁵

However, only manuscript U₂ introduces the *haṃsaḥ mantra* in the context of *Tattvayogabindu*'s nine *cakras*. Be it as it may, another hint to unlock the mystery surrounding Rāmacandra's deployment of the term *siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga* is the following. Already in the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* (1363 CE), the oldest text presenting a ninefold *cakra* system within the framework of Layayoga, the *cakra* system is linked with the concept of *kuṇḍalinī*. *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4351–4352 reads:

prathamam brahmacakraṃ syāt trir āvartam bhagākr̥tiḥ |
apāne mūlakandākhye kāmarūpaṃ ca taj jaguḥ ||5||

The Brahmacakra is the first. [It has] three windings [and] the appearance of the perineum. [Situating] within *apāna* [it is] known as the root-bulb and that is praised as Kāmarūpa.

tad eva vahnikuṇḍam syāc chaktiḥ kuṇḍalinī tathā |
tām jīvarūpiṇīm dhyāyej jyotiṣkāṃ muktihetave ||6||

That [*cakra*] is the firepit and the *śakti* is *kuṇḍalinī*. One should meditate on her as the embodiment of life, as she who is luminous, for the sake of liberation.

Immediately following the presentation of the nine *cakras*, one encounters Śārṅgadharā's section on Rājayoga, which includes two methods. The first method is attributed to Dattātreyā. This method involves guiding the breath and mind by contracting the *mūlādhāra* along the posterior path in the back (*paścime danḍamārge*) to the end of the Śaṅkhinī channel. After the three

⁸⁷⁵Translated by saradatilakafull.

*granthi*s are pierced and the mind and breath reach the *brahmarakandara*, the sound-born *bindu* dissolves into the void.⁸⁷⁶ The second method, however, involves the awakening of *kuṇḍalinī*, which ascends through the *cakras* (in this case, notably only five *cakras*), uniting as *śakti* with *śiva* in the head, producing nectar that floods the entire body, leading to *samādhi* and transforming the yogin into a Siddha. This is described in *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4368–4371:

athavā mūlasamsthānām udghātais tu prabodhayet |
suptām kuṇḍalinīm śaktim bisatantunibhākr̥tim ||

Alternatively, one should awaken the dormant Kuṇḍalinī Śakti, which has a form that resembles a lotus stalk, by striking the place of the *mūla*[-*ādhāra*].

suṣumṇāntaḥ praveśyaiva pañca cakrāṇi bhedayet |
tataḥ śive śaśāṅkābhe sphurannirmalatejasi ||

Causing [Kuṇḍalinī Śakti] to enter the interior of the Suṣumṇā, one should pierce the five *cakras*. Then, in the pure, radiant light resembling the moon, in Śiva ...

sahasradalapadmāntaḥsthithe śaktim niyojayet |
atha tatsudhayā sarvām sabāhyābhyantarām tanum ||

who resides in the thousand-petalled lotus, one should join the Śakti. Then, with that nectar, one should flood the entire body inside and out.

plāvayitvā tato yogī na kiṃcid api cintayet |
tata utpadyate tasya samādhir nistarāṅgitaḥ |
evam nirantarābhyāsād yogi siddhaḥ sa jāyate ||

Having flooded [the body with that nectar], the yogi should not think of anything. Then arises his unwavering *samādhi*. Thus, as a result of practising constantly, the yogin becomes a Siddha.

⁸⁷⁶ *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4364–4367.

This passage indicates that the ninefold *cakra* system described by Rāmacandra was originally intrinsically linked with the concept of *kuṇḍalinī* and Siddhahood. This conclusion is confirmed by the *Nāḍīcakra* scroll (ORIS 1334), which, in its system of nine *cakras*, likewise refers to the third *cakra* as the locus of Kuṇḍalinī.⁸⁷⁷ From this perspective, Rāmacandra's designation "Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga" is understandable and could be seen as a remnant of the intrinsic connection of the ninefold *cakra* system with *kuṇḍalinī*.

In *Tattvayogabindu* XLIV, the second, and this time explicit, mention of Siddhayoga is found, including a description of the characteristics that define a Siddhayogin. This passage is not based on the *Yogasvarodaya*, but most of the verses presented here are derived from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* with some significant editorial changes. Some verses of this passage are possibly even from Rāmacandra's own hand. The entire section revolves around the characteristics of an Avadhūta person (*avadhūtapuruṣa*).⁸⁷⁸ In the last three verses of this passage, the Avadhūta is equated with a Siddhayogin, in the sense of a "yogin who has perfected yoga." Through Siddhayoga, one becomes a *siddhayogin*:

viśvātītāt tayā viśvam ekam eva virājate |
saṃyogena sadā yasya siddhayogī sa gadyate || XLIV.8 ||

Through that the universe shines forth as only one, as a result of being beyond the universe. One who is always united with it is said to be a perfected yogin.

sarvāsāṃ nijavṛttināṃ viśmṛtiṃ bhajet tu yaḥ |
sa bhavet siddhasiddhānte siddhayogī sa gadyate || XLIV.9 ||

⁸⁷⁷ *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334 ll. 155–63) reads: *om tṛtīyaṃ kuṇḍalinīsthānaṃ sindhūravarnam sarpākāraṃ adhomukhī agnir devatā kuhūriṇī śaktiḥ brahmārṣiḥ kūrmaḥ kalā udyānabandhakā varuṇa-maṇḍala kāmākhyā devī mālāgnir bhāvāsthāna kāmānavami 2 yoginī mokṣadāyini jaṭharāgnipraveśe nābhīsthāne kuṇḍalinī śaktiḥ raktavarṇā adhomukhī dhūmrakalā jaganmātā yoginām abhiseṭ sadāḥ garbhapuṭam*. It is important to note that the supplementary material concerning the nine *cakras* preserved in witness U₂ corresponds almost entirely with the content of the *Nāḍīcakra* scroll, apart from the omission of the passage cited above.

⁸⁷⁸ A recent discussion of the reception history of the term *avadhūta* can be found in *pudi2023*.

He who forgets all inherent fluctuations [of the mind], he is called a perfected yogin according to the doctrine of the Siddhas.

*udāsīnaḥ sadā śānto mahānandamayo 'pi ca |
yo bhavet siddhayogena siddhayogī sa kathyate || XLIV.10 ||*

One who is always indifferent, peaceful and immersed in great bliss by means of Siddhayoga⁸⁷⁹ is said to be a Siddhayogin.

Thus, a Siddhayogin has realised the unity of the universe, has stilled his mind, and is always indifferent, peaceful, and immersed in great bliss. He has attained all this by means of Siddhayoga. The use of the instrumental *siddhayogena* in this context confirms that the compound *siddhayoga* is a genitive *tatpuruṣa* and not a *karmadhāraya* compound. Unfortunately, there are no clear instructions or explicit descriptive statements that would define the practice of Siddhayoga in this second context. Nonetheless, it is possible to derive them from the previous statements.

Verse XLIV.2, for example, says that the alms of the Avadhūta⁸⁸⁰ are “difference and non-difference” (*bhedābheda*). A similar perspective can already be found in the Jñānayoga section XXI. Although the term *bhedābheda* is not here, we can infer that the practice of Siddhayoga should involve the cultivation of this specific philosophical perspective.

In the preceding verse XLIV.3, there is an etymological explanation (*nirukti*) of the term *avadhūta*. The letter *a°* stands for the self (*ātman*), the letter *°va°* stands for the mental impressions (*vāsanās*), and *°dhūta* is said to be the shaking off of those *vāsanās*. Thus, an Avadhūta or Siddhayogin dedicates himself to a yogic practice that ensures the reduction of the *vāsanās* and strives for self-realisation.

Furthermore, no other statements could specify Siddhayoga’s method.

⁸⁷⁹ Interestingly, the term *siddhayogena* is not attested in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.

⁸⁸⁰ Originally, the Avadhūta was considered an antinomian ascetic who detached himself from all societal bonds and did as he pleased. Over the centuries, in the words of **pudi2023** (2023), he became “sanitised” and more socially acceptable. The Avadhūta was integrated into the Brahmanical *āśrama* system, his unconventional traits and unorthodox practices were tamed, and the Avadhūta was thereby elevated to a legitimate and eventually even the highest class of the *saṃnyāsa āśrama*.

3.16.2 Siddhiyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Siddhiyoga, the “Yoga of supernatural powers” in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* denotes an advanced stage of Yogic practice on the path to *samādhi*. This stage is reached when a high degree of mastery over the mind ensues. From this mastery, various supernatural abilities can be acquired through specific practices such as austerity (*tapas*) or meditative exercises (*saṃyama*), which are presented in the second chapter (*sāadhanapāda*), but especially in the third chapter (*vibhūtipāda*) of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*. According to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, this stage is conducive to the attainment of *samādhi*.⁸⁸¹ As with all other yogas, Nārāyaṇatīrtha locates Siddhiyoga in the first chapter, specifically within his commentary on *sūtra* 1.40:

*cittasthitijayasya jñāpakam siddhiyogam samādhy anukūlam āha—
paramāṇuparamamahattvānto 'sya vaśīkārah || 40 ||*

It is said that Siddhiyoga indicates mastery of the stability of the mind, which is conducive to *samādhi*—His [the yogins] mastery extends from the smallest particle of matter up the greatest extend.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains that the control of the yogin encompasses total and unhindered mastery over everything. This mastery is conducive to *samādhi* because it prevents afflictions such as hunger and thirst. It is a significant indicator that the yogin has mastered his mind.⁸⁸²

Towards the end of his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.40, Nārāyaṇatīrtha states that this advanced stage of yogic practice can be achieved through various methods and leads to the highest possible firmness (*dṛḍhatā parā*).

⁸⁸¹The description of Siddhiyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* by pennazoo4 (2004: 84–85) portrays Siddhiyoga solely as a state that facilitates *samādhi*, but completely overlooks the practical aspect of Siddhiyoga, which is the cultivation of particular supernatural abilities (*siddhis*).

⁸⁸²*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 106): *parameti | asya sthiracittasya yoginaḥ paramamahattvāntaḥ paramamahattvaṃ yeṣāṃ viyatpuruṣādīnāṃ tatparyanto vaśīkārah apratighātaḥ kenāpy apratibandhyatā | saiva kṣutpipāsādi—piḍāpratibandhadvārā samādhisādhikā cittajayasya ca jñāpiketi bhāvah*

*ayam eva siddhiyogaḥ prāṇaspandanirodhādyair upāyair dṛḍhatā parā |
siddhiyogo bhaved atra yogaḥ siddhikaraḥ paraḥ || ity ādinā || 40 ||*

This indeed is Siddhiyoga. By means such as the cessation of the movement of breath, supreme firmness arises. Here, Siddhiyoga means the supreme yoga that brings about accomplishment. Thus it is stated.

Next, Nārāyaṇatīrtha links Siddhiyoga with specific supernatural abilities (*siddhis*) as he illustrates in his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 2.35. Siddhiyoga is exemplified here by the result of the practice of non-violence (*ahiṃsā*).⁸⁸³ Once the yogin has achieved stability in non-violence through the practice of *pratipakṣabhāvana*,⁸⁸⁴ he creates a sphere of non-violence where no enmity exists. This sphere of non-violence even neutralises natural enmities, such as those between the mongoose and the snake, as Nārāyaṇatīrtha informs us.⁸⁸⁵ Finally, we encounter Siddhiyoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's commentary on *Yogasūtra* 2.43, where Siddhiyoga is explicitly linked with a broader spectrum of attaining supernatural abilities (*siddhis*). In particular, asceticism (*tapas*) is the crucial catalyst for success in Siddhiyoga. It is here that the full scope of the concept of Siddhiyoga becomes comprehensible, as it explicitly builds upon and expands the explanations from *Yogasūtra* 1.40:

*tapasḥ sādhyāṃ siddhim āha—
kāyendriyasiddhir aśuddhikṣayāt tapasaḥ || 43 ||*

Ascetic heat is said to cultivate perfection—
Perfection of the senses and the body manifests as a result of
ascetic heat on account of the removal of impurities.

⁸⁸³The supernatural ability resulting from the practice of *ahiṃsā* is the creation of a sphere of non-violence. The yogin who has perfected *ahiṃsā* can no longer suffer any violence. This is, incidentally, the first supernatural ability that manifests for the yogin who practices Pātāñjalayoga.

⁸⁸⁴The intentional cultivation of opposing thoughts, e.g., when one feels sorrow or anxiety and then concentrates on positive or pleasurable thoughts.

⁸⁸⁵*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 104): *evam ahiṃsāparasya yoginas tatphalabhūtaṃ siddhiyogaṃ darśayati—ahiṃsāpratiṣṭhāyāṃ tatsannidhau vairatyāgaḥ || 35 || ahiṃseti | uktapratipakṣabhāvanenāhiṃsāsthairyē sati tatsannidhau ahiṃsāṃ bhāvayataḥ samīpe vairatyāgaḥ | sahajavirodhinaḥ mahinakuḷādīnāṃ api nirmatsaratayā 'vasthitiḥ bhavatīty arthaḥ || 35 ||*

*kāyeti | tapasaḥ tapo 'bhyasād, aśuddhikṣayād yatheṣṭagatyādipratibandhakapāpamalāder nāśāt, kāyendriyasiddhiḥ kāyendriyāṇām alpatvamahattvadūrārthadarśitvādisāmarthyarūpā siddhir bhavatīty arthaḥ | kāyasyātilāghavena dūradeśagamanādikaṃ dharmav-
iṣeṣāyattam mahattvenānyair abādhyatvādi ca bhavati | indriyāṇām dūrārthasūkṣmārthavyavahitānekārthagrāhitā bhavatīti yāvat |
etena paramāṇuparamamahattvānto 'sya vaśīkāra iti sūtreṇokta—
siddhiyogasyātrāntarbhāvo jñātavyaḥ |*

[Regarding the term] *kāya* (“body”). Ascetic heat (*tapas*) [arises] from repeated practice of ascetic heat [i.e. austerities, etc.].⁸⁸⁶ As a result of the destruction of impurities and other obstructions such as sin and filth, which hinder free movement and the like, perfection of the senses and the body manifests, meaning the ability of the body and senses to become small, large, see distant objects, etc. Through the extreme lightness of the body, there is the ability to travel to distant places, etc. and through other capacities dependent on special qualities, unobstructedness, etc., arises. To be precise, the [ability] of the senses to perceive distant, subtle, covered, and multiple objects arises. This is indicated by the *sūtra* “his control extends from the smallest atom to the greatest magnitude.”—It should be understood that Siddhiyoga is included here.

3.16.3 Siddhayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Siddhayoga across the four early modern yoga taxonomies clarifies the term's use as a yoga category in the 16th and 17th centuries. The *Tattvayogabindu* mentions Siddhayoga in two forms: *Siddhakunḍalinīyoga* and Siddhayoga. The former denotes a practice centred on the three channels and meditation on a ninefold *cakra* system associated with the Siddhas, leading the yogin to perfection (*siddha*). Although *kunḍalinī* would be

⁸⁸⁶The heat of *tapas* bakes the body and destroys impurities that are mentioned in the following.

expected in this context, it remains unmentioned. The latter term lacks an explicit practice but is clearly linked to the Siddha doctrine (*siddhasiddhānta*), indicating that for Rāmacandra Siddhayoga was the “Yoga of the Siddhas,” a usage not unique to him.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha, by contrast, speaks of Siddhiyoga. His alignment of fifteen yogas with the *Yogasūtra* responds to the contemporary prominence of this taxonomy and suggests familiarity with the term Siddhayoga in Rāmacandra’s sense. Advocating the superiority of Pātāñjalayoga, he sought to subsume all fifteen yogas within it. As the Siddha doctrine of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* could scarcely be integrated into the *Yogasūtra*, he likely adopted the phonologically similar Siddhiyoga to encompass practices leading to supernatural powers (*siddhi*), a central concern of the *Pātāñjalayogaśāstra*.

3.17 Rājayoga

RĀJAYOGA⁸⁸⁷ occupies the fifteenth—and thus the final and most elevated—position in Rāmacandra’s taxonomy. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, Rājayoga assumes a similarly superior role. In both works, it designates a path comprising several methods, each named as a distinct yoga, all of which culminate in the state of Rājayoga. The term thus functions both as an umbrella category and as the name of an exalted state with specific effects.

Strikingly, neither text explicitly associates Rājayoga with *samādhi*. The term is rare in both: it appears only in the brief accounts of Aṣṭāṅgayoga. The *Tattvayogabindu* merely lists *samādhi* as one of the eight limbs, without explanation; the *Yogasvarodaya* offers only a single sentence. By contrast, in texts from the twelfth to fifteenth centuries Rājayoga is primarily a synonym for *samādhi*.⁸⁸⁸ The *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* therefore exemplify the sustained early-modern tendency, visible from the sixteenth century onward, to reinterpret Rājayoga and align it with alternative yogic systems.

⁸⁸⁷ An outstanding reconstruction of the reception history of the term is birch2014 (2014) by Jason Birch. See also datta2024 on the emergence of the term in early Haṭhayoga sources.

⁸⁸⁸ birch2014.

A different interpretation is observed in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhānta-candrikā*. Here, Rājayoga is synonymous with *samādhi*, or, to provide the technical term for the final overarching goal of this system *asamprajñātasamādhi*, the final state of Pātāñjalayoga. Rājayoga is, therefore, only the goal and not a method. However, in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's text, Rājayoga can be achieved through fifteen methods, all of which he situates within his yoga system, aiming to demonstrate its superiority by subordinating various other contemporary yoga methods to Pātāñjalayoga.

In stark contrast, Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* attributes Rājayoga differently. Here, Rājayoga, along with Lakṣayoga and Aṣṭāṅgayoga, is considered a subcategory of Haṭhayoga, primarily denoting a specific technique widely known as *vajrolī mudrā*.

Thus, once more, we can observe how the competitive environment of Hinduism's diverse soteriological practices plays out in thematically, spatially, and temporally precisely delimited discourses manifesting in such negotiation processes.

3.17.1 Rājayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*

Rājayoga is the overarching theme of Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. Rāmacandra's text aims to document the method of Rājayoga. That is clearly stated at the very beginning of the treatise.⁸⁸⁹ Rāmacandra's Rājayoga encompasses a total of fifteen variants, which are listed as follows: Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Caryāyoga, Haṭhayoga, Karmayoga, Layayoga, Dhyānayoga, Mantrayoga, Lakṣayoga, Vāsanāyoga, Śivayoga, Brahmayoga, Advaitayoga, Siddhayoga, and Rājayoga itself. However, only Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Caryāyoga, Haṭhayoga, Mantrayoga, Lakṣayoga, and Siddha[kuṇḍalinī]yoga are explicitly introduced as methods with their own sections. Dhyānayoga, Vāsanāyoga, Karmayoga, and Advaitayoga are at least implicitly present. Śivayoga and Brahmayoga are mentioned initially as methods but are not further elaborated upon in the text. We can, however,

⁸⁸⁹ *Tattvayogabindu* I l. 1: *śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ || atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate* |

infer that Śivayoga⁸⁹⁰ and Brahmayoga⁸⁹¹ were regarded as synonyms for Rājayoga, and thus Rāmacandra did not see the need to introduce them as independent categories. The mention of Rājayoga in the list of methods for Rājayoga appears redundant. However, it was probably placed at the end of the list to express its superiority as the “king of yogas,”⁸⁹² as there is no separate yoga method named Rājayoga found in the text. However, other terms that might suggest distinctive yoga categories not listed among the initial fifteen methods of Rājayoga are mentioned. These include Aṣṭāṅgayoga,⁸⁹³ Satyayoga,⁸⁹⁴ and Sahajayoga.⁸⁹⁵ The reasons for their absence in the initial list are not entirely clear. However, the final statement with regards to Sahajayoga,⁸⁹⁶ presented as the final method of Rājayoga, is followed by the statement: “This is the explanation for those named *cakravartin*.”⁸⁹⁷ This is the final sentence of *Tattvayogabindu*. Sahajayoga must, therefore, be understood as Rājayoga in the sense of “Yoga for royals”, “Royal Yoga”, or “Yoga for kings”, which would plausibly explain the final position of Rājayoga in the taxonomy of Rāmacandra due to its final position.

A distinctive feature of the *Tattvayogabindu* is the result of Rājayoga mentioned directly in the introduction. Here, Rāmacandra speaks of “long-term durability of the body,”⁸⁹⁸ which, as Rāmacandra explicitly emphasises, occurs under special circumstances, namely “even if the practitioner is enjoying manifold royal pleasures and even when there is manifold royal entertain-

⁸⁹⁰The Śivayoga of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* closely aligns with the overall content of the *Tattvayogabindu*, suggesting the possibility of synonymous usage.

⁸⁹¹For instance, Divākara comments on the first verse of the *Bodhasāra*: *rājayogo rājñāṃ nṛpāṇāṃ svasthāne sthītivāpi sādhayitum śakyatvāt tatsambandhi yogo jīvaibrahmaikyaviśayakajñānalakṣaṇo ...* *birch2014* (2014: 430, n. 51) translates: “Rājayoga is the yoga of kings, because rulers can accomplish it even while remaining in their position (that is, as kings). In this connection, its [main] characteristic is knowledge concerning the union of the individual self with Brahman.” The *Tattvayogabindu* occupies a similar position. Here, too, Rājayoga is yoga for kings. Thus, it is possible that Rāmacandra shared this view and considered Brahmayoga synonymous with Rājayoga.

⁸⁹²Much in the sense of the *Amanaska* 2.3cd: *rājatvāt yogānām rājayoga iti smṛtaḥ* |

⁸⁹³For the discussion of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, see p. 461.

⁸⁹⁴For the discussion of Satyayoga, see p. 471.

⁸⁹⁵For the discussion of Sahajayoga, see p. 472.

⁸⁹⁶*Tattvayogabindu* LIX: ...*sa sahajayogaḥ kathyate rājayogamadhye* |

⁸⁹⁷*Tattvayogabindu* LIX: *iti cakravartināmakathanam* |

⁸⁹⁸*Tattvayogabindu* I: ...*bahutarakālaṃ śārīrasthitir bhavati* |

ment and spectacle.”⁸⁹⁹ The name Rājayoga here implies that the practitioner can live like a king and, despite engaging in excessive forms of worldly enjoyment, still experience the positive effects of yoga without renouncing the world and becoming an ascetic. Numerous passages in the text suggest that the Rājayoga of the *Tattvayogabindu* was indeed directly addressed to members of the royal court, aristocracy, young princes (*kumāras*), and perhaps the king himself. Due to the scope and significance of this topic, it is addressed elsewhere in this work.⁹⁰⁰

Besides the *śarīrasthiti*, various other effects or signs of the Rājayoga methods are explicitly addressed in *Tattvayogabindu* XVI,⁹⁰¹ XVII,⁹⁰² and XLII.^{903,904} The table 6 lists these effects according to the *Tattvayogabindu*’s sections.

3.17.2 Rājayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*

Just like in the *Tattvayogabindu*, Rājayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* has fifteen variants. Of these fifteen, however, only eight yogas are named: Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Karmayoga, Haṭhayoga, Dhyānayoga, Mantrayoga, Urayoga⁹⁰⁶ and Vāsanāyoga. The other variants are not named, presumably for metrical reasons. In this case, Rājayoga is again considered both as a fifteenfold method and as a state. All fifteen methods lead to the practitioner dwelling

⁸⁹⁹Ibid. I: ...yena rājayogenañekarājyabhogasamaya eva anekapārthivavinodaprekṣaṇasamaya eva ...

⁹⁰⁰See p. 12.

⁹⁰¹*Tattvayogabindu* XVI: idāniṃ rājayogayuktasya puruṣasya yac charīracihnaṃ tat kathyate |

⁹⁰²Ibid. XVII: anyad rājayogasya cihnaṃ kathyate |

⁹⁰³Ibid. XLII: idāniṃ rājayogāc charīre etādṛśāni cihnāni bhavanti |

⁹⁰⁴Additionally, the individual methods of Rājayoga most often have their own effects.

⁹⁰⁶The term Urayoga is possibly a corruption of the text. Jason Birch suggested emending to *lakṣyayoga*, as Lakṣyayoga plays a central role in the course of the text. Karen O’Brien-Kop suggested *ūha*° as a possible reading for *ura*°—a term derived from the older meditation framework of Sāṃkhya, which emphasises *ūha* (reflection), *śabda* (speech), and *adhyayana* (study). Oberhammer, for example, discusses this term in his analysis of the *Yuktidīpikā* (commentary on the *Sāṃkhyakārikā*). Unfortunately, the term is not found a second time in the surviving material of the *Yogasvarodaya*. In view of the mention of Sāṃkhyayoga in Sundarāś’s *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, this possibility cannot be ruled out. Unfortunately, the surviving material of the *Yogasvarodaya* does not support this idea. Sven Sellmer suggested that it may not be a mistake, but an abbreviated form of *uraga*°. Urayayoga translated as “Snake yoga” and could be a synonym for Kuṇḍalinīyoga. However, I could not find this word attested anywhere else.

TYB XVI	TYB XVII	TYB XLII
• He is rich at all times. • He dwells distant from the world. He dwells in the world, having permeated it. • Neither birth nor death exists for him. • Happiness does not exist. • Suffering does not exist. • Descent does not exist. • Moral conduct does not exist. • Abode does not exist. • In the mind of this perfected one, a light appears immediately before him, which is the connection with God. • Neither does he have a caste, nor does he have any sign. • He is without parts, immaculate and uncharacterised. • Whatever wish for the most excellent fruit, affectionate woman, etc. arises, he obtains that very enjoyment. His mind truly does not suffer attachment in this situation.	• Even when there is the attainment of a kingdom, etc., the perception of a reward does not arise. • Even in loss, suffering does not arise within the mind, and neither does desire arise. • Even when whatever object has been obtained, aversion towards any object does not arise; and concerning this object, affection of the mind does not arise. • The mind is equal towards a person who has expertise in sacred scriptures, a friend or an enemy. • An indifferent view arises. • When for him who freely moves across the entire world being furnished with enjoyment and happiness, the pride of the ability to do these things does not arise within the mind; and one does not proclaim the ability to do these things among all his followers—this is also said to be of Rājayoga. • Whether one has new clothes made of silk, or old, worn clothes with holes, whether one is smeared with sandalwood and musk, or smeared with mud—when delight and grief do not reside within the mind, it is that which is Rājayoga. • When the mind is neither bored nor overwhelmed situated in a city, a forest, an uninhabited village, or a village full of people.	• The eradication of all diseases occurs. • He has a vision of the entire earth. • Knowledge of the principles (<i>tattvas</i>) arises. • He understands all languages. • The body becomes as strong as a diamond. • Even with the bite of a snake, death does not occur. • Hunger, thirst, drowsiness, and heat do not trouble the person. • Perfection of speech arises. • Fatigue does not occur in the body. • The person assumes the nature of the wind. • He sees the entire earth with a glance. • The eight supernatural powers beginning with “becoming infinitely small” etc. (<i>aṇimādi</i>) arise. • The nine treasures (<i>navanidhi</i>) approach nearby.⁹⁰⁵ • Within the ten cardinal points in space, the power over death and rebirth arises. • Wherever there is a desire to go in the world, one goes there. • Ignorance disappears everywhere. • One sees the supreme Lord nearby. • There is the capability of accomplishing tasks and removing obstacles.

Table 6: The *Tattvayogabindu*’s effects of Rājayoga

in Brahman. The term here implies both the highest or most superior form of yoga and the highest yogic state. Rājayoga leads to a long life and the attain-

ment of the eight supernatural powers. In comparison to the *Tattvayogabindu*, which presents Rājayoga as a yoga that can be practiced despite royal sensual pleasures, the introduction in this text merely states that the practitioner is worthy of being revered by kings. The quotation of the *Yogasvarodaya* in the

5 *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* (Ed. p. 831) reads:

atha rājayogaḥ || yogasvarodaye |
īśvara uvāca |
rājayogaṃ pravakṣyāmi śṛṇu sarvatra siddhidam |
guhyād guhyataraṃ devi nānādharmāṃ parāt param ||
10 *rājayogena deveśi nṛpapūjyo bhaven naraḥ |*
rājayogī cirāyus ca aṣṭaiśvāryamayo bhavet ||
pañcadaśaprakāro'yaṃ rājayogaḥ ||
kriyāyogo jñānayogaḥ karmayogo haṭhas tathā |
dhyānayogo mantrayoga urayogaś ca vāsanā |
15 *rājaty etad brahmavāsy ebhiś ca pañcadaśadhā ||*

Now Rājayoga. [As described] in the *Yogasvarodaya*. God said: “I will teach Rājayoga, listen! In every case it bestows completion. [It is] more secret than secret, oh goddess, [its] nature is manifold, [and it is] higher than the highest. By means of Rājayoga, oh goddess, a man becomes [worthy] of being worshipped by kings. The Rājayogin may have a long life and he may be equipped with the eight [supernatural] powers. This Rājayoga has fifteen varieties: Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Karmayoga, Haṭhayoga, Dhyānayoga, Mantrayoga, Urayoga and Vāsanāyoga. By [means of] these fifteen [yogas], that [person] who is resting in Brahman shines [like a king].”

3.17.3 Rājayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

In his introduction to the first *sūtra*, Nārāyaṇatīrtha takes Rājayoga as a synonym of *samādhi* (“meditative absorption”) and *nididhyāsana* (“profound

15 *brahmavāsy* em.] *brahmavaśīva unm.* PT

meditation”). Later on, he equates Rājayoga more specifically with *asamprajñātasamādhi* and *nirbījasamādhi*.⁹⁰⁷ Thus, the Rājayoga of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* designates the final state, the goal of the Pātañjalayoga system,⁹⁰⁸ and not a method to achieve the state. He provides fifteen different yogas to reach this state. All yoga methods are, in turn, embedded within the eight limbs of Pātañjalayoga. In his commentary, Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates and explains all of them within the *samādhipāda* and *sādhanaṣṭāyoga* of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*. This can best be understood from Nārāyaṇatīrtha’s own words:

*brahmavid āpnoti param | brahmavid brahmaiva bhavati | tam eva viditvā 'timṛtyum eti nānyaḥ panthā vidyate 'yanāya | tarati śokam ātmavit | ity ādisrutisiddhaparamapurusaṁśādhanaśāntānandātmasākṣātkārasādhanaśāntāyā śravaṇamananānididhyāsanādini, ātmā vā 're draṣṭavyaḥ śrotavyo mantavyo nididhyāsitavyaḥ | ity ādināmnātāni | tatra nididhyāsanam pradhānam | tatsahakṛtād eva manaso 'laukikā 'bādhitātmagocarapramāśambhavāt, sarvavijñānādirūpaphalasaṁvādāc ca | nididhyāsanaṁ caikatānatādirūpo rājayogāparaparyāyaḥ samādhiḥ | tatsādhanaṁ tu kriyāyogaḥ, caryāyogaḥ, karmayogo, haṭhayogo, mantrayogo, jñānayogaḥ, advaitayogo, lakṣyayogo, brahmayogaḥ, śivayogaḥ, siddhiyogo, vāsanāyogo, layayogo, dhyānayogaḥ, premabhaktiyogaś ca | tad etat sarvaṁ sāmānyaviśeṣabhāvenāṣṭāṅgayogena kavalikṛtam iti manasi nidhāya sāṣṭāṅgaṁ saphalaṁ yogaṁ samādhisādhana vibhūtikaivalyārthakaiś caturbhiḥ pādair vyutpādayiṣyan prekṣāvat pravṛttaye viśayaprayojanādhikārisambandhān darśayan prathamam sāstrasyārambham pratijānīte bhagavān patañjaliḥ | atha yogānuśāsanam || I ||*⁹⁰⁹

⁹⁰⁷ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 1.20 (Ed. p. 25): *tataḥ paravairāgyād asamprajñāta itareṣāṁ pūrvavilakṣaṇānāṁ manuṣyāṇāṁ mumukṣūṇāṁ bhavatīty arthaḥ | ayam eva ca rājayoga ity ucyate | tad uktaṁ smṛtau—samādhis tatra nirbījo rājayogaḥ prakīrtitaḥ | dipavad rājate yasmā ātmā sacchinmayāḥ prabhuh ||*

⁹⁰⁸ This has previously been noted within the article by Jason birch2014 (2014: 414–415) on the reception history of yoga named birch2014. Here, birch2014 states that the first occurrence of the term “rājayoga” in a commentary on the *Yogasūtra* may be Vijñānabhikṣu’s *Yogasārasaṁgraha* (16th century). Here, too, Vijñānabhikṣu understood Rājayoga as *samādhi*.

⁹⁰⁹ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 2.

Hearing (*śravaṇa*), reflection (*manana*), [and] profound meditation (*nidhidhyāsana*), etc. are transmitted through quotations such as—“Oh, the self, indeed, must be seen, heard, reflected upon, and profoundly meditated upon”—as a means to the blissful realisation and as the means to the supreme goal of human beings, which is established in the sacred scriptures in quotations such as “the knower of Brahman attains the supreme”; “the knower of Brahman is Brahman [itself]”; “having realised that alone, one transcends death; no other path is known for advancing”; [and] “the knower of the self traverses sorrow.” Among these, profound meditation is the most essential part. Only because of that, the extraordinary perceptions of the mind arise—as a result of the occurrence of the right idea of the dwelling place of the unobstructed self and, as a result, the information of the fruits of the first appearance of all-encompassing insight. Profound meditation, characterised by being towards unity, is another synonym for Rājayoga or *samādhi*. The means to this include Kriyāyoga, Cāryāyoga, Karmayoga, Haṭhayoga, Mantrayoga, Jñānayoga, Advaitayoga, Lakṣyayoga, Brahmayoga, Śivayoga, Siddhiyoga, Vāsanāyoga, Layayoga, Dhyānayoga, and Premabhaktiyoga. All these are encompassed generally and specifically through the eight-limbed yoga. Keeping this in mind, the yoga with eight limbs which is fruitful, through the chapters regarding the subjects *samādhi* (“meditative absorption”), *sādhana* (“practice”), *vibhūti* (*supernatural powers*) and *kaivalya* (*isolation*) teaching the connections regarding the objective of the topic for its application in a comprehensible manner the venerable Patañjali revealing the most excellent beginning of his treatise states: Now, the teaching of yoga begins.

3.17.4 Rājayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

The Rājayoga of Sundardās (3.13–24) is subsumed along with Lakṣyayoga and Aṣṭāṅgayoga in the tetrad of Haṭhayoga.⁹¹⁰ In contrast to Rāmacandra, who portrays Haṭhayoga as a form of Rājayoga, Sundardās understands Rājayoga as a form of Haṭhayoga. This form exclusively refers to what is generally known as *vajrolimudrā*.⁹¹¹

Although the association of Rājayoga and *vajrolī* might seem surprising in light of the modern understanding of Rājayoga as meditation,⁹¹² or its use in medieval yoga texts (12th–15th centuries CE) as a synonym for *samādhi*,⁹¹³ *vajrolimudrā* was already regarded in early *haṭha* texts, such as the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra*,⁹¹⁴ as a suitable method to achieve Rājayoga. Śrīnivāsayogī goes even further in the *Haṭharatnāvalī*. For him, one can only become a *rājayogī* through the practice of *vajrolī*.⁹¹⁵ According to **mallinson2018vajrolimudra** (2018: 205), *vajrolimudrā* was originally used by ancient ascetic traditions as a technique for the retention and conservation of semen (*bindudhārana*) by reabsorbing the fluids emitted by both sexes during the act through the urethra, thus maintaining the celibacy so crucial to these traditions under all circumstances. **mallinson2018vajrolimudra** showed through texts written from the second millennium CE onward that these practices were first made accessible to an audience beyond their ascetic originators, allowing householders to benefit from yoga practice without having to forgo the pleasures of sexual intercourse. Simultaneously, this technique was adapted by tantric Śaiva traditions. They synthesised the originally purely physiological concept of *vajrolimudrā* with two of their own concepts: the use of sexual fluids as the ultimate offering in rituals and its internalisation as a visualisation of the united sexual fluids being directed upward through the central channel.

⁹¹⁰For another discussion of Rājayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, see **burger2014sarvangayogapradipika**.

⁹¹¹In his brilliant article titled **mallinson2018vajrolimudra** (2018), **mallinson2018vajrolimudra** determined the history, method, and purpose of *vajrolimudrā* based on textual, ethnographic, experiential, and anatomical data.

⁹¹²See **demichelishistory2004**.

⁹¹³**birch2014** 2014: 401.

⁹¹⁴*Dattātreyayogaśāstra* 183–184.

⁹¹⁵*Haṭharatnāvalī* 2.104.

As a result, *vajrolimudrā* was no longer considered merely a physiological method for maintaining celibate efforts but, through this synthesis with tantric ideas, became a method leading to a divine body,⁹¹⁶ the attainment of all supernatural powers (*siddhis*),⁹¹⁷ or the awakening of *kuṇḍalini*.⁹¹⁸

Only against this background can the Rājayoga of Dādūpanthī Sundardās be adequately understood, whose practical aspect must be derived from only two verses:⁹¹⁹

rājayoga kīnā śiva rāi | gaurā saṁga anaṁga na jāi |
ghṛta nahiṁ ḍharai agni ke pāsā | rājayoga kā baḍā tamāsā || 14 ||

Śiva performed Rājayoga with Gaurī (Parvatī), without being overcome by the god of love (*anaṁga*).⁹²⁰ Just as clarified butter cannot stay near fire, Rājayoga is a great challenge.

nāḍīcakra bheda jau pāvai | tau caḍhi biṁda apūṭhau āvai |
karanī kaṭhina āhi ati bhārī | baśabarttanī hoi jau nārī || 15 ||

Having pierced the network of channels (*nāḍīcakra*), then the rising semen arrives unbroken. The practice is hard and very difficult, even when the women is under control.

The name *vajrolimudrā* is not mentioned. However, the practice referred to as Rājayoga in these verses is practically identical to the medieval models of *vajrolimudrā* described above.⁹²¹ Rājayoga consists of a practice involving sexual intercourse between a man and a woman, which leads to not being overpowered by the god of love, the personification of desire.⁹²² The yogin

⁹¹⁶ Śivasamhitā 4.87

⁹¹⁷ Dattātreyayogaśāstra 175

⁹¹⁸ See *hatharatnavali* 2.82

⁹¹⁹ *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.14–15.

⁹²⁰ Anaṁga is another name for Kāma (lit. “desire”), the god of love.

⁹²¹ The same conclusion is drawn by *burger2014sarvangayogapradīpika* (2014: 696) and *mallinson2018vajrolimudra* (2018: 195).

⁹²² *mallinson2018vajrolimudra* (2018) mentions *hbp* (f. 28r, ll. 6–9), which describes that the yogin can have sex with sixteen women a day without giving up celibacy and without succumbing to passion once the practice of *vajrolī* is well established. For the new critical edition of the *hathabhyasapaddhatī*2025, see *hathabhyasapaddhatī*2025.

is encouraged to make the semen rise after it has pierced the network of channels (*nāḍīcakra*). The entire process is described as extremely difficult, even if the woman cooperates.

The first verse describes Śiva practicing Rājayoga with Pārvatī. Due to subsequent references to *vajrolī*, this implies engaging in sexual intercourse. Despite the physical union with Pārvatī, who symbolises beauty and passion, Śiva was not overpowered by the god of love (*anaṅga*), who represents desire and passion. To illustrate the difficulty of Rājayoga, Sundardās uses the image of clarified butter, which cannot remain near the fire without melting and burning. This image symbolises how something very pure, like ghee, typically cannot withstand the presence of something that could consume or destroy it. This purity, the clarified butter, represents yogic celibacy, while the fire represents the source of desire, namely the woman, Pārvatī. The celibacy of a yogin in this situation is highly threatened, as it is extremely difficult to resist the urge. Unlike anyone else, Śiva can enjoy the sexual act with Pārvatī without being consumed by her flames and without giving up his celibacy. He succeeds in using Rājayoga to pierce the network of channels with the semen⁹²³ and then make it rise within himself. The comparison illustrates the high degree of self-control and difficulty required to practice this form of Rājayoga, as it is natural for desire to arise in the presence of attractive stimuli. Accordingly, the last verse of this chapter states:

*rājayoga cinha ye jānaiṃ biralā koi |
triyā saṃga mati kījīyahu jo aisā nahīṃ hoi || 24 ||*

Those who truly understand the characteristic of Rājayoga are rare indeed; he who does not, should shun the company of women.

The other verses describe the one who has mastered Rājayoga. These descriptions are similar to those in the *Tattvayogabindu*. The positive effects of

⁹²³It remains unclear whether this refers to his own semen or a mixture of male and female semen, as in the *yogasikhopanisad* 1.137cd: *rajaso retaso yogād rājayoga iti smṛtaḥ* | Here, Rājayoga is defined as the union of female generative fluid or menstrual blood (*rajas*) and semen (*retas*).

Rājayoga are far-reaching. The practitioner's resilience is increased immeasurably. Neither hunger nor thirst, sleep or laziness, cold and heat, nor old age can affect him (3.19). Fire cannot burn, nor can water drown him; he does not age and becomes immortal with a body as hard as a diamond (3.20). He goes wherever he wants; nothing in the world can stop him, and he can dwell in heaven with the gods or in the netherworld with the demons if he desires (3.21) etc. The *rājayogin* presented here strongly resembles the archetypal Avadhūta, who can do as he pleases. Particularly interesting is the statement that he is liberated (*muktā*) and yet enjoys the eight pleasures, untouched by sin and merit.⁹²⁴ I could only identify the eight pleasures in the *Tattvayogabindu* (Section XXII) and here. They are listed there and include: 1. Silken clothes, 2. A mansion with five or seven rooms, 3. A large bed with a soft mattress and cover, 4. A woman belonging to the Padminī class of women,⁹²⁵ 5. A comfortable seat, 6. An exceptionally valuable horse, 7. Appetizing food, and 8. Various drinks. The original idea of *vajrolī*, namely maintaining celibacy despite the enjoyment of sexual intercourse, is further expanded here. As a result of the Rājayoga of Sundardās, the yogin apparently need not renounce anything in the world. That demonstrates the character of the comprehensive syncretistic equation of *vajrolī* and Rājayoga that Sundardās undertakes here. He reduces the practice of Rājayoga to one of the fundamental practices of Haṭhayoga, namely *vajrolī*. This practice allows the yogin to enjoy the world's pleasures without facing the consequences that would affect the overarching goals of yoga. That opens the door for Sundardās to unreservedly transfer the general characteristics of the results of Rājayoga from other traditions to his own model. The very classification of Rājayoga as a subcategory of Haṭhayoga shows that Sundardās certainly did not understand Rājayoga as the king of all yogas as in *Amanaska*,⁹²⁶ rather the term Rājayoga here implies that the practitioner can live like a king, indulge in the associated sensual pleasures, and remain a yogin, without wandering as a possessionless, world-renouncing ascetic seeking liberation. This aligns

⁹²⁴ *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.17: *disai saṁga pūni muktā | aṣṭa prakāra bhoga kau bhuktā | pāpa punya kachu parasai nāmhiṁ | jaisaiṁ kamala rahai jala māṁhiṁ ||* 16 ||

⁹²⁵ See n. 265 on p. 169.

⁹²⁶ *Amanaska* 2.3cd: *rājatvāt yogānām rājayoga iti smṛtaḥ |*

with his explicit criticism of groups such as the *kāpālikās*, *paśūpatas* and other ascetics, mainly for their extreme behaviour.⁹²⁷

3.17.5 Rājayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Rājayoga within the four texts of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies demonstrates the complex cross-traditional negotiation processes of the 16th and 17th centuries. It underscores the prominence of Rājayoga as a universal category in an interplay between continuity and innovation.

The analysis of the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* shows the use of the term Rājayoga as a superior and at the same time universal category. All yogas listed in these texts are presented as methods of Rājayoga. Here, Rājayoga carries multiple connotations. At the first level, Rājayoga must be understood as the “king of yogas” since it is placed at the top of the lists, as seen in the earlier fourfold taxonomies. At the same time, Rājayoga is a specific state to be attained but can be reached through very different yoga methods. Regarding the desired state, the *Tattvayogabindu* notably departs from the earlier connotations with *samādhi* and shifts the interpretation of this once primarily soteriological state, which still resonates but surprisingly weakly, towards a state that emphasises more worldly concerns. Specifically, one property of Rājayoga is unmistakably highlighted. Despite extensive involvement in sensual pleasures, the practitioner attains all the mental and physical benefits of a yoga practice. That occurs against the backdrop that the *Yogasvarodaya* targets householders and ascetics,⁹²⁸ and the *Tattvayogabindu* targets wealthier social strata, probably *kṣatriyas*. Therefore, in the latter text, the meaning of “Yoga for kings” is also clearly implied at a second level. The inclusivist schema⁹²⁹ that emerges in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* also appears in Nārāyaṇatīrtha’s *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. In Nārāyaṇatīrtha’s text, Rājayoga can be achieved through fifteen yogas or yoga methods, all

⁹²⁷ See p. 312.

⁹²⁸ The quotations from *Yogasvarodaya* in the *Yogakarnīkā* make it clear that some of the practices attributed to *Yogasvarodaya* – such as *nāḍikṣālanam* (YK 4.74–77) – were undoubtedly only performed by professional ascetics.

⁹²⁹ Inclusivist in the sense of Paul hacker1979’s “Inklusivismus” (1979).

of which he situates within his own yoga system, aiming to demonstrate its superiority by subordinating all other contemporary yoga methods he knew to Pātañjalayoga. Nārāyaṇatīrtha equates Rājayoga with *asaṃprajñātasamādhi*, the ultimate state of Pātañjalayoga. Thus, Rājayoga is considered solely as the goal and not as a specific method. However, that reflects the discursive power and social esteem Rājayoga had in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's lifetime. Although Nārāyaṇatīrtha undoubtedly considers his Pātañjalayoga as the ultimate and superior yoga system, which is evident in his attempt to incorporate or perhaps more aptly subjugate the fifteen yogas to the *Yogasūtra*, Rājayoga was so significant in his discursive environment that he equated the term Rājayoga, a term that originated from Śaiva traditions, with the final goal, the quintessence of Pātañjalayoga, namely *asaṃprajñātasamādhi*.

Sundardās, as an author with a clear Vaiṣṇava orientation, naturally sought to distinguish himself from other discursive authorities and degrades Rājayoga in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* to a method of Haṭhayoga, namely *vajrolīmudrā*, which, according to his descriptions, is not only difficult to master but was also widely considered disreputable and frowned upon.⁹³⁰ He keeps his descriptions so vague and brief that it is unimaginable that this description could have served as a practical guide. This categorisation could only have served a strategic purpose, namely, similar to the *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, and the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, to strengthen and propagate his own yoga model in contrast to other models, especially those models that place Rājayoga at the top of the hierarchy. Sundardās deliberately knocks Rājayoga off its throne with his model. Through this categorisation, he manages to subtly undermine the authority of Rājayoga without having to ignore it. In comparison to the other texts of the complex yoga taxonomies, his yoga taxonomy proceeds more skillfully in terms of eloquence, systematics, and diplomatic finesse.

⁹³⁰The fact that participants in the discourse were troubled by *vajrolīmudrā* is shown, for example, in the datta2024. The new critical edition by datta2024 (2024) has shown that in the most widely disseminated recension of the text, the section on *vajrolīmudrā* was significantly shortened, likely due to disapproval of these practices. The same phenomenon was observed in the new critical edition of the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (2025). In most recensions of this text, the section on *vajrolīmudrā* was either moved to the end or removed entirely.

Taken together, we witness a struggle for interpretive authority, a competitive environment of yoga traditions entangled in discursive processes, where each actor tries to assert themselves.

3.18 Other yogas

Up to this point, the comparison of individual yoga categories has been based on the order set out in *Tattvayogabindu*. Thus, most of the yoga categories used in our texts have already been covered. However, there are still some yogas that need to be addressed. These will be described in the following sections and, if they appear in more than one text, they will be contrasted with each other.

3.19 Bhaktiyoga

BHAKTIYOGA, the “Yoga of devotion” is entirely absent in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*. Nārāyaṇatīrtha, however, places his Premabhaktiyoga at the topmost position in the yoga taxonomy of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. For him, this method of yoga is the final and most important element for attaining Rājayoga or *samādhi*.⁹³¹ Sundardās, on the other hand, places Bhaktiyoga at the very beginning in his treatise on all limbs of yoga, the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.⁹³² In his progressive sequence of twelve yogas, Bhaktiyoga forms the very foundation of his yoga system. In Sundardās’s system, Bhaktiyoga is both an individual category and an overarching term of the first tetrad, subsuming the three methods already discussed: Mantrayoga,⁹³³ Layayoga,⁹³⁴ and Carcāyoga.⁹³⁵

⁹³¹For another description of Premabhaktiyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* see penna2004 2004: 97–102. Unlike penna2004, Nārāyaṇatīrtha does not mention the four types of *prāṇīdhāna* merely for informational purposes. Rather, Nārāyaṇatīrtha illustrates the superiority of his concept of Premabhaktiyoga, which encompasses all four methods.

⁹³²For a discussion of Bhaktiyoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* in French, see burger2014sarvangayogapradipika.

⁹³³See p. 385.

⁹³⁴See p. 370.

⁹³⁵See p. 349.

3.19.1 Premabhaktiyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha introduces Premabhaktiyoga, the “Yoga of devotion with unconditional love”, in his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.32:

tatpratiṣedhārtham ekatattvābhyāsaḥ || 32 ||

For the purpose of their repulsion, the practice of concentrating on a single principle [should be performed].

This *sūtra* refers back to the disturbances (*vikṣepas*) mentioned in *Yogasūtra* 1.30, which lists the obstacles to the stilling of the fluctuations of the mind (*cittavṛttinirodha*). These disturbances are disease (*vyādhi*), incompetence (*sthyāna*), doubt (*saṁśaya*), carelessness (*pramāda*), sloth (*ālasya*), lack of detachment (*avirati*), erroneous conception (*bhrāntidarśana*), not obtaining a base for concentration (*alabdhabhūmikatva*), and instability (*anavasthitatva*).

According to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, the devout worship of Īśvara (*īśvara-praṇidhāna*) is indispensable for the repulsion of the nine disturbances. Nārāyaṇatīrtha asserts that even minimal or incomplete practice of *praṇidhāna* can yield remarkable results. Simply uttering the name of Īśvara destroys accumulated sins. This destruction, along with faith, etc., results in complete devotion, thereby achieving all desired outcomes.⁹³⁶

Praṇidhāna can be practiced in four ways: the highest (*paramamukhya*), the most excellent (*mukhya*), the one belonging to the most excellent (*mukhyajātiya*), and the almost excellent (*mukhyakalpa*).⁹³⁷ All four methods serve the progressive fixation of the mind on Īśvara and are based on the expositions of the *Bhagavadgītā* 12.8–11.

The first type (*paramamukhya*) of devout worship is the loving and continuous fixation of the mind and intellect on Īśvara. This form of *praṇidhāna* is compared to the devotion and love of the Gopīs for Kṛṣṇa. The mind of the

⁹³⁶ *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 1.32 (Ed. pp. 49–50): *yathā 'gnikaṇo 'tisvalpo 'pi tṛṇarāśaṃ jvālayaṃ tenaiva varddhitaḥ pūrṇaḥ sarvāṇi sūcitāni kāryāṇi janayati | tathā bhagavato yathākathaṃ cinnāmocāraṇādirūpam api praṇidhānam ajāmilāder iva pāparāśiṃ nāsayat tena nāśenaivādhikaṃ sampādyamānaṃ śraddhādīnā pūrṇaṃ bhajaniya icchāsahakṛtaṃ sarvābhilaṣitaṃ sādhayate | tasmāt praṇidhānam evāvaśyakam |*

⁹³⁷ *Ibid.* 1.32 (Ed. p. 50): *tac ca caturvidham paramamukhyaṃ, mukhyaṃ mukhyajātiyaṃ, mukhyakalpaṃ ceti |*

Gopī melts upon hearing the multitude of divine qualities and, like molten copper poured into a mold, firmly takes its shape.⁹³⁸

The second type (*mukhya*) is also known as the practice of *nididhyāsana*. If the first type is impossible, this form should be adopted initially. It is characterised by repeatedly drawing back the outwardly directed and wandering mind through practice and focusing it on the exalted self within.⁹³⁹ This variant is intended for practitioners who are unable to maintain the mental constancy required for the first method.

For those who cannot fix their mind on the Supreme God through love or constant repetition, the third type (*mukhyajātīya*) is recommended. That primarily involves devout service to God, such as recitation of God's name, fasting, etc. This service and all actions, good or bad, should be dedicated to the Supreme God without attachment to the results.⁹⁴⁰

The fourth type (*mukhyakalpa*) is finally for those who cannot yet practice the third type, the devout service to God. Here, the practitioner is encouraged to renounce the fruits of all actions and to rest in the self.⁹⁴¹

In the context of the repeated practice [of concentration] on a single principle to eliminate the nine disturbances of *Yogasūtra* 1.32, Nārāyaṇatīrtha identifies the one principle (*ekatattva*) as the Supreme God, and the practice (*abhyāsa*) as Premabhaktiyoga. Premabhaktiyoga, he asserts, is the culmination of all the methods above. Moreover, according to Nārāyaṇatīrtha,

⁹³⁸Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. p. 50): *tatrādyam gopīnām iva tadguṇagaṇaśravaṇādīnā drutacetaso druta-tāmarasyeva dṛḍhataḍākārataḥ tadviśayakavṛttipravāharūpaṁ prema mayy eva mana ādhatsva mayiṁ buddhiṁ niveśaya | ityādinoktam | anena premabhaktiyogo darśitaḥ | sa ca parameśvaracaraṇāravin-daviśayakaikāntikātyantikapremapravāho 'navacchinna ity arthaḥ |*

⁹³⁹Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. p. 50): *dvitīyam tadasāmarthyē bahiḥpravṛttisvabhāvasya manasaḥ pratyāhāreṇa punaḥ punarbhagavatyaṭmani niveśanarūpo 'bhyāso nididhyāsanākhyah |* To illustrate this explanation, Nārāyaṇatīrtha quotes *Bhagavadgītā* 12.9: *atha cittam samādhātum na śaknoṣi mayi sthiram | abhyāsayogena tato mām icchāptum dhanañjaya || ityādy uktam |*

⁹⁴⁰Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. p. 50): *trīṭīyam tu tadasāmarthyē 'pi svabhāvata eva kṛtānām api karmaṇām phalecchām tyaktvā parameśvare paramagurāv arpaṇam sādhu vā 'sādhu vā karma yad yad ācaritaṁ mayā | tatsarvaṁ tvayi samṇyastaṁ tvatprayuktaḥ karomy aham || iti saṁkalpaviśeṣarūpaṁ |*

⁹⁴¹Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. p. 50): *athaitad apy aśakto 'si kartum madhyogam āśritaḥ | sarvakarmaphalatyāgaṁ tataḥ kuru yatātmanā || ity ādinoktam bhagavadgītādvādaśādhyāye |*

Premabhaktiyoga unites both results: the removal of disturbances and the reception of God's grace.⁹⁴²

The continuous flow of mental fluctuations (*vyṛttipravāha*) generated within the framework of Premabhaktiyoga can be practised either with qualities (*saguṇa*) and distinctions (*savikalpa*), focusing on a specific form of God, such as Vāsudeva mentioned by Nārāyaṇatīrtha, or without qualities (*nirguṇa*) and without distinctions (*nirvikalpa*), focusing on the “one reality free from internal, external, and contradictory distinctions, [a reality having an] unattributed, undivided nature.” (*ekaṃ sajātī vijātiyasvagatabhedarahitaṃ tattvam anāropitaṃ akhaṇḍārtha*).⁹⁴³

Nārāyaṇatīrtha further emphasises the particular significance of Premabhaktiyoga in his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 2.45. Here, it is *īśvarapraṇidhāna* in the form of *prembhakti*, which leads the yogin to the grace of God, which is required for the perfection of *samādhi*.⁹⁴⁴ Thus, the passage clarifies why Nārāyaṇatīrtha positions Premabhaktiyoga at the summit of his yoga system.

⁹⁴² *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 1.32 (Ed. pp. 50–51): *atra ca praṇidhānaśabdenoktam | tatra nididhyāsanam samānaviśayatayā sāṅgātkārajanakatvasādhanaṃ karmādi yogebhyaś cāntaraṅgam ity abhipretya, arthabhāvanaśabdena pūrvam ādr̥tam yady api tathāpy adṛṣṭadvārā kṛpātīśayaphalakād antaryābhāvaphalakāc ca | tasmāt paramaṃ mukhyaṃ bhaktiyogaṃ sarvopāyaphalabhūtamayaṃ ata eva tadubhayaphalakaṃ premākhyam abhyāsam āha—tatpratiśedhārthamekatattvābhyāsaḥ || 32 || tatpratiśedheti | teṣāṃ vikṣepānāṃ pratiśedhārtham anāyāsena nāśārtham ekasmimś tattve mukhyabhagati, abhyāsaḥ gopinām iva tadguṇagaṇaśravaṇādīnā dravibhūtasya cetaso mūṣānikṣiptadrutatāmrasyeva dṛḍhatadākāratārūpaprema abhyāsayogayuktena cetasā nānyagāminā | ity ādinā bhagavatsūcitaḥ kārya ity arthaḥ | yadbalād anāyāsena sampannāyāṃ jīvanmuktau vikṣepāḥ praśamam upayānti | na vāsudevabhaktānām aśubhaṃ vidyate kvacit | ity ādismr̥teḥ |*

⁹⁴³ *Ibid.* 1.32 (Ed. pp. 51–52): *athavā ekaṃ sajātīvijātiyasvagatabhedarahitaṃ tattvam anāropitaṃ akhaṇḍārtha ity yāvat | tasya abhyāsaḥ tad ekaṃ ajaram amṛtam abhayam iti vyṛttipravāhaḥ kārya ity arthaḥ | atrātmanavyatirekeṇa dvitīyaṃ yo na paśyati | ātmarāmaḥ sa yogīndro brahmībhūto bhaved iha || ātmakriyāsya satatam sadātmamithunasya ca | ātmany eva sūtr̥ptasya yogasiddhir adūrataḥ || abhiyogāt sadābhyāsāt tatraiva ca viniścayāt | punaḥ punaranirvedāt siddhyed yogo na cānyathā || iti skandokteḥ | tasmāt saguṇātmavadākārākāradhārāvāhivṛttipravāhaḥ savikalpo nirguṇagocarō dhārāvāhiko nirvikalpako vā kāryō 'nāyāsena mokṣam icchateti yāvat || 32 ||*

⁹⁴⁴ *Ibid.* 1.32 (Ed. p. 107): *īśvarapraṇidhānasādhyaśiddhim āha—samādhisiddhīśīśvarapraṇidhānāt || 45 || samādhiti | īśvarapraṇidhānaṃ pūrvam vyākhyātam | samādher uktalakṣaṇasya siddhir apratibandhenānāyāsena tatkr̥payā gurvādidvārā ca dṛḍhā prāptir bhavatīty arthaḥ | etac ca phalaṃ prembhakteḥ svataḥ puruṣārtharūpāyā nāntariyakaṃ yathā phalārthino vṛkṣādisānnidhyec chāyāṃ gandhādīr ity anyatra vistarāḥ || 45 ||*

3.19.2 Bhaktiyoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Sundardās specifies Sanaka, Nāradamūnī, Śuka, Dhruva and Prahlāda as important representatives of his Bhaktiyoga.⁹⁴⁵ He describes Bhaktiyoga in verses 2.1–15. Initially, Sundardās emphasises the attitude necessary for Bhaktiyoga in verses 2.2–7. One should control the senses. Regardless of where one is situated, one should not become attached to them.⁹⁴⁶ Without falling into illusion (*māyā*) and deception, one should remain equanimous towards everything. Gold and women should be banished, and one should not be overwhelmed by desire.⁹⁴⁷ Moreover, virtues such as good conduct, contentment, forgiveness, patience, and compassion should be cultivated.⁹⁴⁸ Furthermore, one should view all beings as equal, from the king to the insect,⁹⁴⁹ and keep the words of the true Guru in the heart, etc. These verses are reminiscent of the elements of *yamas* and *niyamas* from Aṣṭāṅgayoga systems.⁹⁵⁰ Furthermore, Sundardās' writes in verse 2.7:

*sāra grahai kūkasa saba nāṣai | ramitā rāma iṣṭa sira rāṣai |
āṁna deva kī karai na sevā | pūjai eka niraṁjana devā || 7 ||*

One should seize the essence and abandon all impurities, keeping the beloved Rama at the forefront of the mind. One should not serve any other gods, but worship only the one pure and formless deity.

Although Sundardās refers to the Divine as Rāma here, he represents the Nirguṇa type of Bhaktiyoga.⁹⁵¹ For Sundardās, Rāma is nothing other than a designation of the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*).

⁹⁴⁵ *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 1.3: *sanakādika nārada mūnī, śuka aru dhruva prahalāda | bhakti yoha so ina kiyau, sadguru kaiṁ ju prasāda || 3 ||*

⁹⁴⁶ *Ibid.* 2.2cd: *jitendriya aru rahai udāsi | athavā gṛha athavā bana vāsi || 2 ||*

⁹⁴⁷ *Ibid.* 2.3cd: *māyā moha karai nahim kāhū | rahai sabani saum beparavāhū | kanaka kāmīnī chāḍai saṁgā | āśā tṛṣṇā karai na aṁgā || 3 ||*

⁹⁴⁸ *Ibid.* 2.4ab: *śīla santoṣa kṣamā ura ghārai | dhīraja sahita dayā pratipārai |*

⁹⁴⁹ *Ibid.* 2.5d: *kīrī kuṁjara sama kari jānaim || 5 ||*

⁹⁵⁰ In fact, in the presentation of his variant of Aṣṭāṅgayoga 3.37–52, Sundardās refrains from giving a concrete description of the *yamas* and *niyamas*. He only specifies them in verse 3.37.

⁹⁵¹ In *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.15, Sundardās himself describes this form of Bhakti as without attributes: *yaha so bhakti alimṅani |*

The ritual worship (*pūjā*) mentioned in 2.7d is used by Sundardās as a metaphor and comparison for the form of Bhaktiyoga he describes in verses 2.9–11. The external *pūjā* is performed internally in Bhaktiyoga. One's discipline is the ritual washing, and one offers the flowers of love and devotion.⁹⁵² The lamp (*ārati*) for the worship is knowledge, and the bell (*ghaṇṭā*) is the unstruck sound (*anāhata śabda*) he contemplates, etc. He offers his entire body and mind, becomes humble, and falls at the feet of the Divine.⁹⁵³ From this, a clear criticism of the ritualistic worship of God can be inferred, which Sundardās already expresses in the first chapter.⁹⁵⁴

The concluding verses illustrate the deep emotional devotion. One never abandons the attitude of the servant, and love grows day by day.⁹⁵⁵ This inner attitude of service is compared to the attitude of a faithful wife towards her husband.⁹⁵⁶ She serves continuously without interruption. Sundardās calls this form of devotion “incomparable” (*bhakti ananya*).⁹⁵⁷

3.19.3 Bhaktiyoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Bhaktiyoga across the four early modern yoga taxonomies clarifies the status of this category in the seventeenth century. For Sundardās, Bhaktiyoga is the foundational, devotional core of his system, reflecting the centrality of Sant Bhakti, which had spread widely from the fourteenth century onward across Maharashtra, Sindh, Punjab, Haryana, Gujarat, Rajasthan, and the Gangetic plains.⁹⁵⁸

Nārāyaṇatīrtha's placement of Premabhaktiyoga at the summit of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* taxonomy likely responds to the contemporary prominence of the Bhakti movement and underscores his insistence on the universality and superiority of Pātañjalayoga.

⁹⁵² Ibid. 2.9cd: *saṃjama udaka sanāna karāvai | prema prīti ke puṣpa caḍhāvai || 9 ||*

⁹⁵³ Ibid. 2.11: *jñāna dīpa āratī utārai | ghaṇṭā anahata śabda vacārai | tana mana sakala samarpana karai | dīna hoi puni pāyani parai || 11 ||*

⁹⁵⁴ Ibid. 1.12–49.

⁹⁵⁵ Ibid. 2.12cd: *sevaka bhāva kadai nahim caurai | dina dina prīti adhika hī jorai || 12 ||*

⁹⁵⁶ Ibid. 2.13ab: *jyaum pratibratā rahai pati pāsā | aisaim svāmi kī ḍhimga dāsā |*

⁹⁵⁷ Ibid. 2.14cd: *sadā aṣaṇḍita sevā lāvai | soi bhakti ananya kahāvai || 14 ||*

⁹⁵⁸ See horstmann2023shrine (2023: 3–16) for an introduction to the Sant traditions.

In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the absence of Bhaktiyoga can be explained by the text's probable southern provenance. The references to the rivers Godāvarī and Kāverī suggest a regional context in which the Bhakti movement exerted comparatively less influence.⁹⁵⁹

The absence of Bhaktiyoga in Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* is partly due to its sources, the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, which do not mention this category. Yet Rāmacandra composed his text in northern India, as indicated by his substitution of the southern rivers with Vipāśā (Beas) and Śātarudrā (Sutlej), regions where Bhakti was widespread. A further explanation is therefore likely: since the *Tattvayogabindu* was intended for elite audiences, Bhaktiyoga—associated with Sant traditions rooted in lower castes and marked by egalitarian, anti-ritualistic critiques of caste—was deemed unsuitable. It is thus understandable that Bhaktiyoga has no place in Rāmacandra's "Yoga for Kings."

3.20 Aṣṭāṅgayoga

A ṢṬĀṆGAYOGA, the "eight-limbed yoga" is invariably incorporated by all four authors who present complex yoga taxonomies in their texts, yet in entirely different manners. Rāmacandra does not mention Aṣṭāṅgayoga within his enumeration of the fifteen methods for Rājayoga but introduces it in a separate section of his text. The author of the *Yogasvarodaya* presents an incomplete enumeration of the fifteen yogas, naming only eight of them, excluding Aṣṭāṅgayoga by name. However, similar to Rāmacandra, he presents Aṣṭāṅgayoga within his text. Unlike the *Tattvayogabindu*, it appears that Aṣṭāṅgayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* is considered part of the fifteen methods of Rājayoga. Rāmacandra, in compiling his text, which heavily relies on the *Yogasvarodaya*, seems to have inadequately considered this when establishing his variant of the fifteen yogas, which he describes inconsistently and unsystematically throughout the text. Nonetheless, the Aṣṭāṅgayoga of the *Tattvayogabindu* remains part of Rāmacandra's Rājayoga.

⁹⁵⁹On the rivers of the *Yogasvarodaya*, *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, and *Yogasvarodaya*, see p. 223, n. 383.

In contrast, Nārāyaṇatīrtha does not include Aṣṭāṅgayoga among his fifteen methods for achieving Rājayoga. Strictly speaking, Aṣṭāṅgayoga is not one of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's methods for Rājayoga. Nevertheless, he situates his fifteen yogas within the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, the *locus classicus* of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, thus allowing Aṣṭāṅgayoga to frame the fifteen yogas in the *Yogasiddhānta-candrikā*.⁹⁶⁰

Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* presents a starkly different scenario. Here, Aṣṭāṅgayoga is the last of the four methods of Haṭhayoga.

3.20.1 Aṣṭāṅgayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Since Rāmacandra's compilation of his Aṣṭāṅgayoga section largely follows the *Yogasvarodaya*,⁹⁶¹ yet deviates in some interesting places, it is insightful to compare both texts.⁹⁶² Both texts begin with an enumeration of the limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga. Notably, the *Yogasvarodaya* lists only seven of the eight limbs, omitting *dhyāna*.⁹⁶³ Intriguingly, subsequent verses describe *dhyāna* but not *dhāraṇā*. The *Tattvayogabindu* lists all eight limbs, but Rāmacandra deviates from the Pātañjalayoga model, presenting *dhyāna* before *dhāraṇā*.⁹⁶⁴ However, following his source, Rāmacandra omits subsequent explanations of *dhāraṇā*. He also does not explain *samādhi*. Both texts provide detailed

⁹⁶⁰ Due to the absence within Nārāyaṇatīrtha's fifteen yogas and because Aṣṭāṅgayoga of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* has been extensively discussed in secondary literature, a renewed discussion is omitted here. Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents the eight limbs in his commentary on *sūtra* 2.29 as follows: *yamaniyamāsanapṛāṇāyāmapratyāhāradhāraṇādhyānasamādhayo 'ṣṭāvaṅgāni* || 29 || *yameti* | *tatra yamāḥ svata eva saphalatvādātyāvaśyakāḥ* | *sarvamumukṣujanasevyā ādau, paścāt tatsāpekṣā niyamāḥ* | *etad ubhayādhina cittasthairyasāpekṣānyāsanāni* | *tatsāpekṣaḥ pṛāṇāyāmāḥ* | *tatsāpekṣaḥ pratyāhārah* | *tatsāpekṣā dhāraṇā* | *tatsāpekṣaḥ dhyānam* | *tatsāpekṣaḥ samādhiḥ savikalpa ity aṣṭau sākṣāt paramparayā vā nirvikalpasya samādher aṅgānity arthaḥ* | *aṣṭāṅgamaithune kriyāniṣ-patteraṅgino 'ṅgatvavat samādhiḥ savikalpa ity aṣṭau sākṣāt paramparayā vā nirvikalpasya samādher aṅgānity arthaḥ* | *aṣṭāṅgamaithune kriyāniṣpatter aṅgino 'ṅgatvavat samādher aṅgino 'ṅgatvaṃ vā bodhyam* | *tena na ko 'pi doṣaḥ* || 29 || In summary, Nārāyaṇatīrtha states that the limbs, beginning with the *yamas*, build upon each other and culminate in *samādhi*, which he also calls Rājayoga at the beginning of his commentary.

⁹⁶¹ Additionally, influences from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.32–38 can be identified in this passage.

⁹⁶² See *Tattvayogabindu* wection XXXI and *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841).

⁹⁶³ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841): *idāniṃ yogamaṣṭāṅgaṃ śṛṇu lakṣaṇasaṃyutam* | *yamaś ca niyamaś caiva cāsanam pṛāṇasaṃyamāḥ* | *pratyāhāro dhāraṇā ca samādhiś ca viśeṣataḥ* |

⁹⁶⁴ See p. 169 n.265 for a discussion and further references on the reversed order of the limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga.

lists of six *yamas* and *niyamas*. Variations in the *Tattvayogabindu* reflect the influence of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, as well as Rāmacandra's ideas.⁹⁶⁵ For the similarities and differences of the *yamas* see table 7 and for the *niyamas* see table 8. Notably, both texts omit non-violence (*ahimsā*) and sexual abstinence (*brahmacarya*).

The <i>yamas</i> of the <i>Tattvayogabindu</i>	The <i>yamas</i> of the <i>Yogasvarodaya</i>
• peace (<i>śāntiḥ</i>) • conquest of the six senses (<i>saṅṇāṃ indriyāṇāṃ jayaḥ</i>) • little food (<i>āhāraḥ svalpaḥ</i>) • conquer of sleep (<i>nidrājayaḥ</i>) • conquer of cold (<i>śaityajayaḥ</i>) • conquer of heat (<i>uṣṇajayaḥ</i>)	• peace (<i>śāntiḥ</i>) • contentment (<i>santoṣaḥ</i>) • appropriate diet (<i>āhāraḥ</i>) • minimal sleep (<i>nidrālpā</i>) • control of the mind (<i>manaso damaḥ</i>) • an empty mental faculty (<i>śūnyāntaḥkaraṇam</i>)

Table 7: The *yamas* of the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*

The discussion of postures (*āsanas*) in both texts is brief. The *Yogasvarodaya* addresses *āsana* in half a verse, stating that there are as many postures as there are living beings.⁹⁶⁶ Rāmacandra explains that the characteristics of postures are discussed in many other treatises. Therefore, he does not cover this topic.⁹⁶⁷

The *Yogasvarodaya* states that breath control (*prāṇāyāma*) is of three types and takes various forms. It asserts that young people are not capable of practising *āsana* and *prāṇāyāma*, but through the great power of spiritual merit (*mahāpunyaprabhāva*), the great soul (*mahātmā*) can do so.⁹⁶⁸ The author

⁹⁶⁵The *yamas* of *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.32 are: calmness (*upaśamaḥ*), conquest of all senses (*sarvendriyajayaḥ*) and conquest of food, sleep, cold, wind, and heat (*āhāranidrāśītavātātāpajayaḥ*). The *niyamas* of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.33 are: living in solitude (*ekāntavāsa*), detachment (*niḥsaṅgatā*), indifference (*udāsīnyam*), contentment with what is obtained (*yathāprāptisaṃtuṣṭiḥ*), aversion (*vairasyam*), and dedication to the feet of the guru (*gurucaraṇāvarūḍhatvam*).

⁹⁶⁶*Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841): *āsanāni ca tāvanti yāvanto jīvajantavaḥ* | The author of this verse alludes to the numerous animal names of many yoga positions. See e.g. *encyclopediaasana* of *encyclopediaasana* (2006).

⁹⁶⁷*Tattvayogabindu* section XXXI: *āsanasya lakṣaṇam bahūgranthēṣu nirūpitam asti | tenātra na nirūpyate* |

⁹⁶⁸*Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841): *prāṇāyāmas tridhā ceti bahudhā prathamam śṛṇu | āsane prāṇasaṃnyāme na śaktāḥ sukumārakāḥ | mahāpunyaprabhāveṇa śakyate tu mahātmanā* |

The <i>niyamas</i> of the <i>Tattvayogabindu</i>	The <i>niyamas</i> of the <i>Yogasvarodaya</i>
• restraining the mind from fickleness and establishing steadiness (<i>khalu manaḥ cāpalabhāvān nivārya sthairyē sthāpyate</i>) • seeking solitude (<i>ekānte sevanam</i>) • equanimity towards all living beings (<i>prāṇimātre samābuddhiḥ</i>) • indifference • one shall not desire any object (<i>udāsīnyam kasyāpi vastuni icchā na kartavyā</i>) • contentment with whatever is obtained (<i>yathā lābhasantoṣaḥ</i>) • never forgetting the name of the Supreme Lord (<i>parameśvaranāma na vismaraṇyam</i>) • not indulging in self-pity (<i>manomadhye dainyaṃ na kartavyam</i>)	• discarding fickleness (<i>cāpalyan tu dūre tyaktvā</i>) • establishing steadiness of mind (<i>manaḥsthairyaṃ vidhāya</i>) • constantly uniting the mind with the breath (<i>ekatra melanaṃ nityaṃ prāṇamātreṇa sā matiḥ</i>) • always maintaining a detached attitude (<i>sadodāsinabhāva</i>) • renouncing all desires (<i>sarvatrecchāvivarjana</i>) • being satisfied with whatever comes (<i>yathālābhena santuṣṭaḥ</i>) • keeping the mind fixed on the Supreme Lord (<i>parameśvaramānasah</i>) • giving up pride and oblations (<i>mānadānaparityāga</i>)

Table 8: The *niyamas* of the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*

explains only the first type of *prāṇāyāma*, which is a standard form of alternate nostril breathing accompanied by visualisation. The *mahātmā* inhales through the left channel (*iḍā*), i.e., the left nostril, meditating on its moon-like appearance. Then he holds his breath (*kumbhaka*) for as long as possible. When his mind is filled with great splendour, and his body with air, and fear of the power of intense trembling arises, he should then exhale very slowly through the right channel (*piṅgalā*), i.e., the right nostril, meditating on its sunlike nature. He should repeat this like a moth repeatedly flying into the fire, which ultimately leads to the purification of the body.⁹⁶⁹

Rāmacandra only mentions that *prāṇāyāma* is unsuitable for young practitioners (*sukūmāra*), thus omitting any explanation of its practice.⁹⁷⁰ Taking

⁹⁶⁹ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841): *iḍāṃ śaṣiprabhāṃ dhyātvā mandendunā tu pūrayet | pūrayitvā yathāśakti dhyānayogī tu kumbhayet | mahājyotirmanō bhūtvā vāyuhpūrṇakalevaraḥ | śaktitrāsan tu santrāsya recayed vāyum arhitaḥ | piṅgalāṃ arkavarṇān tu tyajed dhyātvā śanaiḥ śanaiḥ | ayaṃ pataṅgaḥ kāṣṭhāgnipratyāsena punaḥ punaḥ | kṛtvā kalevaram śuddhaṃ kuryād yatnair mahātmanā |*

⁹⁷⁰ *Tattvayogabindu* section XXXI: *prāṇāyāmas tu sukūmāreṇa sādhituṃ na śakyate | atas tasya nāmamātram kathyate |*

Rāmacandra at his word, this statement may indicate his intended audience. Why would he not describe a single breathing technique in his entire text?⁹⁷¹ Both texts briefly explain the withdrawal of the senses (*pratyāhāra*). In the *Yogasvarodaya*, *pratyāhāra* means withdrawing the mind from the cyclical existence (*saṃsāra*) and from the engagements with sensory objects. After the yogin has thus discarded the states and transformations of the mind, he remains composed of emptiness. Similarly, in the *Tattvayogabindu*, the yogin should turn his mind away from cyclical existence and dwell in the self, thereby restraining the emerging transformations of the mind.

The description of meditation (*dhyāna*) is similarly concise in both texts. The *Yogasvarodaya* mentions two types of meditation: a gross one consisting of *mantra* (*mantramaya*) and a subtle one without *mantra*. Further details are not provided. The *Tattvayogabindu* merely states that meditation has been taught many times before⁹⁷² and is therefore not discussed.⁹⁷³

In the *Yogasvarodaya*, *samādhi* is the state of the motionless intellect (*buddhi*), free from inhalation and exhalation. Rāmacandra does not mention *samādhi* at all in the *Tattvayogabindu*. At first glance, this seems peculiar, as the reader might expect a commentary on the highest state of yoga. However, if Rāmacandra addresses young practitioners (*sukūmāras*), it is entirely reasonable why he does not recommend them to cease breathing.

3.20.2 Aṣṭāṅgayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

For Sundardās, Aṣṭāṅgayoga (3.37–52) is the final method in his four-method system of Haṭhayoga.⁹⁷⁴ It supplements the preceding three methods of Haṭhayoga (environment for yoga practice, dietary rules, and *śaṭkarmas*), Lakṣayoga (foci for meditation), and Rājayoga (*vajrolīmudrā* for celibacy

⁹⁷¹For a discussion of the intended audience, see p. 12.

⁹⁷²Probably Rāmacandra refers to the descriptions of *dhyāna* in his own text. See p. 375 for the references.

⁹⁷³*Tattvayogabindu* section XXXI: *dhyānaṃ ca bahutaraṃ prāg uktam tenātra nocyate* |

⁹⁷⁴Already in the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4372–4375, a six-limbed yoga system, a variant without *yama* and *niyama*, is subordinated to Haṭhayoga: *atha haṭhayogaḥ dvidhā haṭhaḥ syād ekas tu gorakṣādisādhitaḥ | anyo mṛkaṇḍaputrādyaiḥ sādrito 'nīśam udyataiḥ ||1|| tatra gorakṣasadrśaiḥ sādrito yaḥ sa kathyate | dhīrair api hi duḥsādhyaḥ kiṃ punaḥ prākṛtair janaiḥ ||2|| āsanaṃ prāṇasaṃrodhaḥ pratyāhāraś ca dhāraṇā | dhyānaṃ samādhir etāni yogāṅgāni smṛtāni śaṭ ||3||*

preservation), giving the entire *haṭha* practice a framework. It is precisely here, within the context of Aṣṭāṅgayoga that most of the characteristic hathayogic practices, namely *āsanas*, *kumbhakas*, *mudrās*, and *bandhas*, are introduced. The order of the eight limbs follows the Pātañjalayoga model.

Sundardās first mentions the two initial limbs, observances *yama* and restrictions *niyama*, each with ten different aspects, which he spares himself from listing.⁹⁷⁵

The second limb, the practice of postures (*āsana*), should be performed regularly to purify the body. For Sundardās, the two most important *āsanas* are the accomplished posture (*siddhāsana*) and the lotus posture (*padmāsana*).⁹⁷⁶ In the context of breath control (*prāṇāyāma*), Sundardās initially emphasises that these exercises must be learned from a Guru. He then describes the basic form of alternate nostril breathing. That involves inhaling through the left nostril (*iḍā nāḍī*), followed by a retention phase, and then exhaling through the right nostril (*piṅgalā nāḍī*). During the retention phases, one should mentally recite the mantra twelve times. At this point, no further details about the mantra are provided. However, retrospectively, it could be the *rāma mantra* mentioned in Sundardās's Mantrayoga (2.16–27). The retention phases should be doubled and tripled over time and are accordingly named upper (*uttama*), middle (*madhyama*), and lower (*kaniṣṭha*) stages.⁹⁷⁷ Additionally, Sundardās mentions the eight breath retentions (*kumbhakas*) and five types of seals (*mudrās*), as well as the three locks (*bandhas*). Further differentiations must be provided by the Guru.⁹⁷⁸ Sundardās does not offer detailed descriptions of these practices. Regarding the fifth limb, the withdrawal of the senses (*pratyāhāra*), Sundardās is very brief. He defines *pratyāhāra* as controlling the mind so that one never craves the “taste of sensory objects”

⁹⁷⁵ *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.37cd: *prathamahiṃ yama aru niyama bicārai | palari ṭeka daśa daśahiṃ prakārai || 37 ||* This omission may be due to Sundardās's earlier treatment of many typical elements of *yama* and *niyama*; see p. 459.

⁹⁷⁶ *Ibid.* 3.38: *bahuryau karai su āsana sabahī | nirma śarīra hoi puni tabahī | tāmahīṃ sārabhūta dvai sādhai | siddhāsana padmāsana baṃdhai || 38 ||*

⁹⁷⁷ *Ibid.* 3.39–40: *prāṇāyāma karai bibhi aisi | sata guru saṃdhi batāvai jaisi | iḍā nāḍī kati pūrai bāi | recaka karai piṅgalā jāi || 39 || pūri piṅgalā iḍā nikārai | dvādaśa vāra mantra bidhi dhārai | dviguṇa triguṇa kari prāṇāyāmaṃ | uttama madhyama kaniṣṭha nāmaṃ || 40 ||*

⁹⁷⁸ *Ibid.* 3.41: *kumbhaka aṣṭa bhānti ke jānaiṃ | mudrā pañca prakāra su ṭhanaiṃ | baṃdha tini niki bidhi lāvai | aura bheda sadaguru taiṃ pāvai || 41 ||*

(*biṣai svāda*). He uses the metaphor of a turtle retracting its limbs into its shell to illustrate *pratyāhāra*.⁹⁷⁹

Sundardās's sixth limb, concentration (*dhāraṇā*), involves focusing on one of the five elements: earth (*pr̥thvī*), water (*apa*), fire (*teja*), air (*vāyu*), and ether (*ākāśa*), along with their associated deities, for five *ghaṭikās* each.^{980, 981}

Sundardās divides meditation (*dhyāna*), the seventh limb of his Aṣṭāṅgayoga, into two categories: meditation with qualities (*saguṇa*) and meditation without qualities (*nirguṇa*). The former involves meditation on one of six *cakras*, while the latter pertains to meditation on the formless self.⁹⁸²

Verses 3.45–48 describe the system of the six *cakras*, which is widely spread in medieval Haṭhayoga texts: *ādhāra*, *svādhiṣṭhāna*, *maṇipūra*, *anāhata*, *viśuddha*, and *ājñā*. Sundardās concludes by stating that only through meditation on the six *cakras* can the realisation of the formless (*nirguṇa*), the second form or stage of meditation, be achieved.⁹⁸³

From the *nirguṇa* stage of meditation arises the eighth limb, meditative absorption (*samādhi*). When the fluctuations of the mind and senses are absorbed, in the final stage of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, the individual self (*jīvātman*) and the supreme self (*paramātmā*) merge like salt in water.⁹⁸⁴ Sundardās characterises this state as follows:

kāla na śāi śāstra nahim lāgai | yaṁtra maṁtra tā deṣata bhāgai |
śīta uṣṇa kabahūṁ nahim hoī | parama sāmādhi kahāvai soī || 51 ||

⁹⁷⁹Ibid. 3.42: *pratyāhāra pakari mana rāṣai | biṣai svāda kabahūṁ nahim cāṣai | jaisaiṁ kurama sakucāi aṁgā | esaiṁ indri rāṣai saṁgā || 42 ||*

⁹⁸⁰One *ghaṭikā* equals 1/60 of a day, see *sircar*1966 (1966: 114). 1/60 of a day corresponds to 24 minutes. Five *ghaṭikās* equal exactly two hours.

⁹⁸¹Ibid. 3.43: *paṁca dhāraṇā tatva prakāśā | pr̥thi apa teja vāyu ākāśā | akṣara sahita devatani dhyāvai | paṁca paṁca ghaṭikā laya lāvai || 43 ||*

⁹⁸²Ibid. 3.44: *dhyāna su āhi ubhai ja prakāra | eka saguṇa ika nirguṇa sārā | saguṇa su kahiye cakra sthānam | nirguṇa rūpa ātamā dhyānam || 44 ||*

⁹⁸³Ibid. 3.48: *iti ṣaṭa cakra dhyāna jau tānai | tabahiṁ jāi nirguṇa pahacānai | gaganākāra dhyāya saba ṭhairā | prabhā marici jala nahim aurā || 48 ||*

⁹⁸⁴Ibid. 3.49–50: *aba samādhi aisi bidhi karai | jaisaiṁ laiṁna nira mahim garaī | mana indri ki vṛtya samāvai | tākau nāma samādhi kahāvai || 49 || jīvātma paramātmā doī | sama rasa kari jaba ekai hoī | bisarai āpa kachu nahim jānai | tākau nāma samadhi vaṣānai || 50 ||*

Time cannot affect it and no weapon can violate it. *Yantra* and *mantra* flee at the sight of it. It is not affected by cold or heat; this is called the supreme *samādhi*.

3.20.3 Aṣṭāṅgayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Aṣṭāṅgayoga across the four early modern yoga taxonomies reveals the diverse and nuanced uses of the term in the 16th and 17th century. Despite shared terminology, three distinct models emerge.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha follows the *locus classicus* of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, the Pātañjalayoga system, without alteration, seeking to incorporate the popular yogas of his milieu into this framework.

By contrast, the Aṣṭāṅgayoga of the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* reflects Śaiva milieus, indicated by the reversed order of *dhyāna* and *dhāraṇā* and by distinct readings of *samādhi*. These texts pursue the opposite strategy: rather than integrating other yogas into the Pātañjala model, they subsume Aṣṭāṅgayoga within a Śaiva hierarchy headed by a form of Rājayoga.

Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* likewise embeds Aṣṭāṅgayoga within a sequence of yogas, treating it as a subcategory of Haṭhayoga and subordinating it to Advaitayoga. Nevertheless, he refrains from explicit hierarchisation and instead integrates all yogas into an interlocking system in which each is a part of progression on the yogic path. His limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga incorporate characteristic Haṭhayoga practices (*mudrā*, *bandha*) and structure a *cakra* system, reinforcing the impression of a cohesive twelvefold whole.

These models illustrate both cross-traditional competition for interpretive authority and the ongoing negotiation between innovation and tradition. The incorporation of regional and popular practices into established frameworks reflects a dynamic, cross-traditional reshaping of yogic systems in the 16th and 17th century.

3.21 Sāṃkhyayoga

SĀM̐KHYAYOGA, the “Yoga of the enumerative philosophical method” appears only in Sundardās' *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (4.1–12). All other texts of

the complex early modern yoga taxonomy do not deal with Sāṃkhyayoga.⁹⁸⁵ Sundardās specifies Rṣabhadeva, Kapilamūni, Dattātreyā, Vaśiṣṭha, Aṣṭāvakra, and Jaḍabharata as important representatives of Sāṃkhyayoga.⁹⁸⁶ After Bhaktiyoga and Haṭhayoga, Sāṃkhyayoga is the third and final main category in Sundardās's yoga system. Sāṃkhyayoga forms the starting point for the three subsequent yogas associated with it, namely Jñānayoga,⁹⁸⁷ Brahmayoga,⁹⁸⁸ and Advaitayoga.⁹⁸⁹ Before the Yogi recognises unity with the world through Jñānayoga, experiences unity with the universe through Brahmayoga, and ultimately overcomes duality in Advaitayoga, Sāṃkhyayoga primarily serves to create initial awareness of the duality to be transcended by differentiating the self from the non-self.⁹⁹⁰ Compared to classical Sāṃkhya, consciousness (*puruṣa*) here (4.2–3) is referred to as the self (*ātama*) and primordial nature (*prakṛti*) as the non-self (*anātama*):

ātama śuddha su nitya prakāśā | ana ātamā deha kā nāsā |
ātama suksma vyāpaka mūlā | ana ātamā so paṃca sthūlā || 2 ||

The self is pure, eternal and illuminating. The not-self relates to the destructible body. The self is subtle, omnipresent and the fundamental cause, while the non-self is composed of the five gross elements.

prṛthi apu teja vāyu aru gaganā | ye paṃcauṃ ātama saṃlagnā |
paṃcani maiṃ mila aura bikārā | tini yaha kiyā prapaṃca pasārā || 3 ||

Earth, water, fire, air and ether—these five are attached to the self. In these five elements, other transformations occur, and

⁹⁸⁵ However, Sāṃkhyayoga also appears in *Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.19–31. Here, it belongs to Rājayoga within the description of *samādhi* and is thus embedded in the basic structure of an Aṣṭāṅgayoga.

⁹⁸⁶ *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 1.5: *rṣabhadeva aru kapila mūni, dattātreyā vaśiṣṭha | aṣṭāvakra ru jaḍabharata, ina kai sāmkhya sudṛṣṭa || 5 ||*

⁹⁸⁷ For the discussion of Jñānayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, see p. 341.

⁹⁸⁸ For the discussion of Brahmayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, see p. 422.

⁹⁸⁹ For the discussion of Advaitayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, see p. 426.

⁹⁹⁰ *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.1: *aba sāmkhya su yoga hi suni lehū | pichai hamako doṣa na dehū | ātama ana ātamā bicārā | yāhi teṃ sāmkhya su nirdhārā || 1 ||*

these three [self, non-self and transformations] have created the proliferation of the universe.

The non-self consists of the five gross elements: earth (*pr̥thi*), water (*apu*), fire (*teja*), air (*vāyu*), and ether (*gāganā*); the five subtle elements: sound (*śabda*), touch (*sparśa*), form (*rūpa*), taste (*rasa*), and smell (*gandhā*); the five senses of perception (*jñānendriyas*): hearing (*śrotra*), touch (*tvak*), sight (*cakṣu*), taste (*jihvā*), and smell (*ghrāṇa*); the five organs of action: speech (*vākya*), grasping (*pāṇi*), moving (*pāda*), excreting (*pāyu*), and reproducing (*upastha*); and the inner organ (*antahkaraṇa*) consisting of mind (*mana*), intellect (*buddhi*), consciousness (*citta*), and ego (*ahaṃkāra*).⁹⁹¹ These comprise twenty-four *tattvas* in total.

Sundardās then elaborates on the inner organ. The thinking mind (*manas*) generates thoughts and doubts. The intellect (*buddhi*) discerns and recognises what is good or bad. Consciousness (*citta*) generates awareness. The ego (*ahaṃkāra*) produces self-awareness and pride.⁹⁹²

Finally, Sundardās distinguishes the subtle transmigratory body (*liṅga śarīra*), composed of the five subtle elements and the inner organ, totalling nine *tattvas*, from the gross body, which is subject to decay and comprises the gross elements, the senses of perception, and the organs of action.⁹⁹³

Sundardās concludes by explaining that these twenty-four elements work together, with the soul (*jīva*) as the driving force behind them. He also refers to the soul as the knower of the field (*kṣetrajñā*) or eternally auspicious (*nirantara śīvā*). The soul permeates everything and is omnipresent. It appears to be involved in everything but is ultimately unbound. As the witness, it is distinct from all else, the twenty-four *tattvas* of the non-self. The self and the non-

⁹⁹¹Ibid. 4.4–6: *śabda sparśa rūpa rasa gaṃdhā | tanmātrkā pañca tana baṃdhā | śrotra tvak cakṣu jihvā ghrāṇaṃ | jñāna su indriya kiyau baśāṇaṃ || 4 || vākya hi pāṇi pāda aru pāyuh | upastha sahita pañca samajñāyuh | karma su indriya ina kau nāmā | tatpara apanai apanai kāmā || 5 || mana uru buddhi citta ahaṃkāra | catuṣṭa antahakaraṇa vicārā | tina kai lakṣaṇa bhinnai bhinnā | mahāpuruṣa samujñāye cinhā || 6 ||*

⁹⁹²Ibid. 4.7–8ab: *saṃkalpai aru bikalapa karai | mana so lakṣaṇa esau dharai | buddhi su lakṣaṇa bodhahiṃ jāṃni | kikai burau lei pahicāni || 7 || caitana lakṣaṇa citta anūpā | ahaṃkāra abhimāna svarūpā |*

⁹⁹³Ibid. 4.8cd: *nau tatvani kau liṅga śarīrā | paṃdraha tatva sthūla gaṃbhīrā || 8 ||*

self are eternal and not subject to ageing and death. However, the gross body (*deha*) is transient.⁹⁹⁴

3.22 Satyayoga

SATYAYOGA, the “true Yoga” is a term that appears in the *Tattvayogabindu* in XLIV.7 in the section on *avadhūtapuruṣasya lakṣaṇam*:

prasaraṃ bhāsate śaktiḥ saṃkocaṃ bhāsate 'pi ca |
tayoḥ saṃyogakartā yaḥ sa bhavet satyayogabhāk ||

Śakti shines forth as expansion and as contraction. He who unites those two experiences true yoga.

The term *satyayoga* is not included in the initial taxonomy of the fifteen methods for Rājayoga. Rāmacandra adopted the verse from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 6.64 and redacted it according to his own agenda and mingled it with *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 4.19.⁹⁹⁵ All manuscripts of the *Tattvayogabindu* read *satyayogabhāk* in the fourth *pāda* of the verse. Here, the source text reads *siddhayogirāt*. Rāmacandra might have used the term as a synonym for *Siddhayoga*⁹⁹⁶ or it might be a typographical error of *Siddhayoga*. By the definition of this verse, *Satyayoga* would be a practice in which the practitioner dedicates himself to the union of two aspects of Śakti, here defined as expansion (*prasāra*) and contraction (*saṃkoca*). In the light of the source text, it could be a corruption of the term *siddhayoga*^o which could have arisen from the homoioteleutic ending of the preceding verse. Furthermore, no other medieval or premodern yoga texts use the term to designate a distinct type of yoga. For this reason, it seems unlikely that this term is a specific category or method of yoga.

⁹⁹⁴Ibid. 4.9-12: *ye caubīsa tatva baṃdhānaṃ | bhinna-bhinna karikiyau vaṣānaṃ | saba kau preraka kahiye jīvā | so kṣetajña nirantara śivā || 9 || sakala viyāpaka aru sarvagā | dīśai saṃgī āhi asaṃgā | sāṅṣī rūpa sabani teṃ nyārā | tāhi kachū nahim lipai bikārā || 10 || yaha ātama ana ātama niranā | sagajñai takaum jarā na maraṇā | sāmṅhya su mata yāhi saum kahiye | sataguru binā kahaum kyauṃ lahiye || 11 || sāmṅhya yoga so yaha kahyau, bhinna hi hbinna prakāra | ātama nitya svarūpa hai, deha anitya vicāra || 12 ||*

⁹⁹⁵See p. 242.

⁹⁹⁶For the discussion of *Siddhayoga* in the *Tattvayogabindu*, see p. 430.

3.23 Sahajayoga

SAHAJAYOGA, among the texts of the complex yoga taxonomies, is exclusively mentioned in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Generally, in Sanskrit literature, the term is often linked to the “classical” Avadhūta. The archetypal Avadhūta has renounced *saṃsāra* and rejects both worldly and religious activities. He is typically associated with *nirguṇa bhakti*, devotion to the formless Divine, and, rather than complex spiritual disciplines, pursues the sole true and natural practice: the repetition of the Divine name.⁹⁹⁷

The model of the Avadhūta that emerges in Rāmacandra’s *Tattvayogabindu* continues a trend that **puḍi** (2023: 18) calls the “sanitisation” of the Avadhūta. In her study, she describes the term’s history and identifies a clear development. Over the centuries, the Avadhūta, the original antinomian ascetic, was gradually integrated into the Brahmanical *āśrama* system. His antinomian behaviour, unconventional traits, and unorthodox practice were tamed, and according to Kanamarlapudi, the Avadhūta became a legitimate and eventually even the highest class of the *saṃnyāsa āśrama*.

An aspect of this development can be observed, for example, in the early history of Haṭhayoga. **mallinsonnath** (2011: 17) notes that in the early history of Haṭhayoga attributed to Gorakṣa (11th–13th centuries), “the antinomian external practices of Tantra were internalised and, together with the visualisation techniques of *kuṇḍalinīyoga*, were melted with the physical practices of early Haṭha Yoga, whose original aim was the sublimation of sexual continence into liberation.”

Rāmacandra continues this process of sanitisation, reshaping the Avadhūta for royal or courtly adoption. In the *Tattvayogabindu*, the Avadhūta becomes the ideal type of the Rājayoga-practicing *kṣatriya* or king. Rāmacandra cuts off the last threads of the image of Avadhūta that is still connected to the antinomian ascetic.⁹⁹⁸ On the contrary, Rāmacandra’s Avadhūta does not scorn worldly activity; rather, he is indifferent to it yet fully involved in it and extremely positive towards worldly pleasures. The natural consequence

⁹⁹⁷ **mallinsonnath**.

⁹⁹⁸ *Tattvayogabindu* XLIV p. 238.

is that Rāmacandra elevates Sahajayoga to the practice *par excellence* for a king.

Rāmacandra defines Sahajayoga, the “natural yoga,” at the very end of his work, in section LIX. This passage is presented as the “esoteric yoga doctrine in all of the scriptures,” forming the grand climax of the text. This secret is explicitly directed at kings, princes or aristocrats at the royal court.⁹⁹⁹ More specifically, the secret is addressed to a good king characterised by being honest, fearless, reputable, trusting of good people, always blissful, and surrounded by enchanting objects.

Then Rāmacandra explains to whom this secret should explicitly not be revealed: not to those who blame others, criticise, misbehave, do not speak the truth, lack compassion, and enjoy conflict.¹⁰⁰⁰

Finally, Rāmacandra reveals the secret. The esoteric yoga teaching evokes the person of one who embodies the highest reality, free from existence and non-existence (*bhāvābhāvavinirmuktaḥ*).¹⁰⁰¹ And although this person, viz. the king or a *kṣatriya*, as the enjoyer of the earth, is constantly exposed to worldly pleasures, he is free from all attachments. This person is a yogin made of perpetual bliss (*sadānandamayo yogī*) and dwells in constant equanimity towards happiness and sorrow. The person has realised the indivisible highest self and performs actions without personal desires or attachments.¹⁰⁰²

While an ordinary person must constantly stabilise the gaze (*drṣṭiḥ sthīrā kartavyā*), stabilise the sitting posture (*āsanam drḍham kartavyam*), and stabilise

⁹⁹⁹Tattvayogabindu LIX: *yasya rājño manomadhye kapaṭam nāsti | yasmin drṣṭe deśakasya trāso na bhavati | yasya manaḥ śuddham bhavati | yasya prthivyām kīrtir bhavati | yasya manomadhye sat-puruṣavacanaviśvāso bhavati | yo rājā sadānandapūrño bhavati | yasya pārśve pratyakṣam anekam manohārivastūni bhavanti | etādrśasya rājño 'gre yogarahasyam kathaniyam |*

¹⁰⁰⁰Ibid. LIX: *yaḥ paranindā rato bhavati | dūrācāro bhavati | bhrātumitrasya ca yogaḥ vastu na dadāti | yo satyaḥ na vati | yo yoginām manomadhye nindām karoti | yasya manomadhye dayā na bhavati | yaḥ kalahapriyo bhavati | svakāryakaraṇe sāvadhāno bhavati | guroḥ kāryakaraṇe 'nādito bhavati | etādrśasyāgre na yogaḥ kriyate na paṭhyate |*

¹⁰⁰¹This statement implies a characterisation of the highest reality (*tattva*), which in *Amanaska* 2.62 is described as free from the duality of existence and non-existence: *bhāvābhāvadvayātitaḥ svapnajāgarānātigam | mrtyujīvananirmuktaḥ tattvaḥ tattvavido viduḥ || 62 ||* “The knowers of the highest reality know that the highest reality is beyond the duality of existence and non-existence, passes beyond [both] sleep and waking and is free from dying and living.” (Translated by birch2013).

¹⁰⁰²Tattvayogabindu LIX. 1–8.

the breath (*pavanah sthirah kartavyah*) to achieve this state, a perfected person no longer needs to adhere to this discipline (*etādṛśah kaścin niyamaḥ siddhasya noktaḥ* |).

manaḥpavanābhyāṃ yadā saajānandaḥ svasvarūpeṇa prakāśyate | sa sahajayogaḥ kathyate rājayogamadhye | iti cakravartināmakathanam |

When by means of mind and breath, the natural bliss appears through one's own true nature, it is called Sahajayoga ("natural yoga") [in this system] of Rajayoga. This is the explanation for those named *cakravartin* ("Universal Ruler").

That is Rāmacandra's core message of his secret of yoga in all yoga scriptures. It recalls the *rājaguhyam* of the Mokṣopāya, a teaching through which rulers could attain a state free from suffering.¹⁰⁰³ These words conclude Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. Thus, Sahajayoga is the ideal yoga for a king. For a king who rules and enjoys the amenities of this position, this is the aspired state, the ultimate. As a *kṣatriya*, he can maintain the soteriological state of salvation through Sahajayoga and continue fulfilling his caste duties without continuous practice. The duties of a ruler sometimes involve "cruel" actions, such as enforcing laws, possibly through war. Additionally, Sahajayoga enables the king, despite being an "enjoyer of the earth," to achieve soteriological completion without the deprivations typical for ascetics.¹⁰⁰⁴ The term *sahaja*° in this context thus primarily means natural but in the sense of "preserving its original nature" and "not undergoing further change."¹⁰⁰⁵

3.24 Conclusion

THE comparison of the medieval complex yoga taxonomies in the four texts *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* reveals a remarkable diversity of a total of twenty-three

¹⁰⁰³ Mokṣopaya 2.II.10–17.

¹⁰⁰⁴ See also hanneder2006.

¹⁰⁰⁵ petersburger7.

different yoga categories. These categories are contextualised and structured differently depending on the text and show significant differences even within overlapping yoga categories in most cases.

1. Kriyāyoga
2. Jñānayoga
3. Caryāyoga
4. Carcāyoga
5. Haṭhayoga
6. Karmayoga
7. Layayoga
8. Dhyānayoga
9. Mantrayoga
10. Lakṣyayoga
11. Vāsanāyoga
12. Śivayoga
13. Brahmayoga
14. Advaitayoga
15. Siddhayoga
16. Siddhakuṇḍaliniyoga
17. Siddhiyoga
18. Aṣṭāṅgayoga
19. Bhaktiyoga
20. Premabhaktiyoga
21. Sāṃkhyayoga
22. Sahajayoga
23. Rājayoga

The degree of difference in the taxonomies and the significantly divergent interpretations of the yoga categories among the texts indicates that the transmission was not a purely textual phenomenon with a linear reception history. Instead, the complex yoga taxonomies were likely part of cross-traditional and overlapping oral discourses. That is supported by the fact that the authors of the texts containing these complex early modern yoga taxonomies come from different religious traditions. Nevertheless, it must be stated clearly that the *Yogasvarodaya* (A) is, at present, the oldest known text to articulate a complex taxonomy of fifteen yogic methods. It constitutes the source text of the *Tattvayogabindu* (B), which likewise presents a fifteenfold taxonomy, and must therefore predate both Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (C) and Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (D). Given that the present investigation establishes only the relative chronology of texts exhibiting complex taxonomies, any reception-historical influence at the purely textual level—if such influence occurred at all—can be assumed to have followed the following simplified pattern: $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \leftrightarrow D$.

Text	Dating
<i>Yogasvarodaya</i>	before 1591 CE
<i>Tattvayogabindu</i>	before 1591 CE and after YSV
<i>Yogasiddhāntacandrikā</i>	1659–1690 CE
<i>Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā</i>	before 1685 CE

Table 9: Chronology of the texts with complex yoga taxonomies.

While Rāmacandra, the author of the *Tattvayogabindu*, promoted a form of religious universalism that is almost profane in character and oriented towards Advaita Vedānta—despite the many Śaiva features of his source texts that naturally entered his own composition—the author of the *Yogasvarodaya* likely emerged from a South Indian Śaiva milieu. Nārāyaṇatīrtha was a renowned *saṃnyāsa* intellectual and prolific author, born a Brahmin and a follower of Kṛṣṇa,¹⁰⁰⁶ whereas Sant Sundardās was regarded as one

¹⁰⁰⁶endo1993.

of the most learned Dādūpanthī and, in his writings, propagated the Sant belief system as a representative Vaiṣṇava *bhakta*.¹⁰⁰⁷

It is noteworthy that two of the authors, namely Sundardās and Nārāyaṇatīrtha, spent a significant part of their lives in Benares. Sundardās lived in Benares between the first decade of the 17th century and around 1625 CE, where he was trained in the dominant knowledge systems of the time, including aesthetics and the tradition of artistic poetry (*kāvya*).¹⁰⁰⁸ endo1993 (1993: 56) convincingly narrows the flourishing period of Nārāyaṇatīrtha to 1600–1690 CE. It is generally agreed that Nārāyaṇatīrtha also spent much of his life in Benares, though the exact period is yet to be determined.¹⁰⁰⁹ It is possible that both authors lived in Benares simultaneously.

Text	Religious Context
<i>Yogasvarodaya</i>	Śaiva (Vaiṣṇava influence)
<i>Tattvayogabindu</i>	almost Profane, Advaita Vedānta (Śaiva influence)
<i>Yogasiddhāntacandrikā</i>	Vaiṣṇava, Brāhmaṇa, Pātañjalayoga
<i>Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā</i>	Dādūpanthī, Sant Vaiṣṇava Bhakti

Table 10: Religious context of the texts with complex yoga taxonomies.

The few clues that exist for locating Rāmacandra and the *Tattvayogabindu* first of all narrow the place of its composition to the northern part of India. One of the most compelling reasons for this conclusion is the list of nine rivers in section XL. Compared to Rāmacandra's primary source text, the *Yogasvarodaya*, the *Tattvayogabindu* mentions the rivers Vipāśā (modern Beas) and Śatarudrā (modern Sutlej) instead of the central-southern Indian rivers Godāvārī and Kāverī, indicating a northern context.¹⁰¹⁰ Although the *Yogasvarodaya* was likely composed much further south, this work circulated in northeastern India. This observation is based on the fact that it is currently known only through specific citations, namely in the *Prāṇatoṣinī*,

¹⁰⁰⁷horstmann2023shrine.

¹⁰⁰⁸Ibid. p. 86.

¹⁰⁰⁹penna2004.

¹⁰¹⁰See n. 383 on p. 223.

written near Calcutta,¹⁰¹¹ the *Yogakarnikā*, whose origin is unknown,¹⁰¹² and the *shabdakalpadruma*, which Radhakanta Deva (1784–1867) also compiled in Calcutta. Thus, it can be inferred that northeastern India was a significant area for the circulation of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Given that Rāmacandra extensively drew from the *Yogasvarodaya* for the compilation of the *Tattvayogabindu*, and since his fifteen yogas were part of an oral and literary discourse centred in Benares, it would be plausible that Rāmacandra also resided in Benares for some time. Finally, this hypothesis is supported by the fact that Sundaradeva lived in Benares¹⁰¹³ and his citations of the *Tattvayogabindu* in the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* represent the second oldest verifiable testimony of the *Tattvayogabindu*.¹⁰¹⁴ Based on the cumulative evidence, the hypothesis of Rāmacandra compiling the *Tattvayogabindu* in northern India can be considered secured. It seems possible that Rāmacandra may have spent some time of his life in the Benares area.

What is certain is that both the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Tattvayogabindu*, as has been shown,¹⁰¹⁵ must have been written before 1591 CE. Thus, all complex early modern yoga taxonomies emerged within a remarkably narrow timeframe—most likely from the middle of the sixteenth century to around 1690 CE—with a significant proportion of these texts produced in the discursive milieu of Benares. Each author and text has individual reasons for addressing or codifying the complex yoga taxonomies. Rāmacandra's text, for instance, appears to have been intended for the education of young princes or potential kings. The taxonomy serves both as an encyclopedia and a way to convey the superiority of Rājayoga, in the sense of a “Yoga for Kings,” and its methods through a hierarchical taxonomy. Integrating the fifteenfold yoga taxonomy from the *Yogasvarodaya* is undoubtedly a continuation of an older Śaiva strategy. This strategy aimed to integrate yogas from various traditions into a hierarchical schema, emphasizing a Śaiva interpretation of *samādhi*

¹⁰¹¹shastrir1905 1905.

¹⁰¹²The only available printed edition of the *Yogakarnikā* by *yogakarnika* (2004) is based on a manuscript presumably from Benares, see *yogakarnika*.

¹⁰¹³birch2018proliferation.

¹⁰¹⁴See p. 6.

¹⁰¹⁵For the dating of the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, see p. 6.

and liberation in life (*jīvanmukti*).¹⁰¹⁶ Fundamentally, this is an extension of the older fourfold taxonomy that subordinated Mantra, Laya, and Haṭhayoga in hierarchical order to Rājayoga.

In the case of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, endo1998 (1998: 34–35) suggests that Nārāyaṇatīrtha, in line with Paul hacker1979's concept of "inclusivism" (1979), sought to integrate the increasingly popular medieval yogas into his context. endo1998 sees this as an attempt by Nārāyaṇatīrtha to not only equate the perceived inferior foreign and popular forms of medieval yoga with his form, the Pātañjalayoga model but also to subordinate them to it.

Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* has a less instructional and more informal or encyclopedic character, placing great emphasis on both systematics and aesthetics. However, it also follows a clear agenda much less hierarchical than those taxonomies that place Rājayoga at the top. Instead, Sundardās seeks to find a common thread and establishes an overarching context between the yoga categories he discusses. He creates a harmonious order through a successive and logical sequence, beginning with Bhaktiyoga, with an evident Vaiṣṇava influence, moving through Haṭhayoga, encompassing various body-oriented yogas. His system culminates in philosophically oriented yogas, starting with Sāṃkhyayoga, which creates awareness of duality through the philosophical contemplation of the world's components. This differentiation is then resolved in the experience of unity in Brahmayoga, ultimately leading to the state he considers the *summum bonum*, Advaitayoga.¹⁰¹⁷

This categorical and interpretative diversity reflected in the complex taxonomies suggests a veritable cross-traditional yoga boom in the milieu of the authors considered, marking an unprecedented wave of popularity, particularly for medieval and body-oriented yoga forms like Haṭhayoga, which various traditions and the educated elite increasingly engaged with. At the same time, the comparison of the texts of the yoga taxonomies revealed

¹⁰¹⁶The Śaiva subordination of yogas into a Rājayoga model began after the 10th century CE and was first described by birch2019.

¹⁰¹⁷As burger2014sarvāṅgayogapradīpika (2004: 706) observed, Sundardās's three yoga tetrads strongly recall the tripartite division of yogas in the *Bhagavadgītā* with Bhakti, Karma, and Jñāna.

a genuine struggle for asserting interpretive authority, a contest over the interpretation and classification of yoga categories, and an attempt to highlight one's conception of the best yoga. In our case study, within its clearly defined discursive framework, the previously mentioned popularity at that time permeated many social strata. Yoga and its efficacy were endowed with high soteriological significance to the extent that by the 16th century, yoga could not be absent from the curriculum in the circles of the ruling classes. Furthermore, it becomes evident that the meanings of the various yoga categories were very fluid and were discursively negotiated in lively and dynamic exchange processes. It is therefore not surprising that the phenomenon of early modern complex yoga taxonomies developed in a specific fertile ground. One such fertile ground was sixteenth–seventeenth-century Benares, located in northeastern India.

Benares has always been a centre of knowledge, attracting scholars from near and far for centuries. However, with the onset of Muslim rule in India, many prominent scholars teaching in Benares left the city for fear of religious persecution. By the 16th century, Benares experienced a cultural revival, primarily sparked by the open religious policy of the Mughal Emperor Akbar and his immediate successors, the “Pax Mughalia”.¹⁰¹⁸ That was

¹⁰¹⁸In 1556, at the age of 13, Akbar ascended the throne of the Mughal Empire, which had been partially reconquered by his father but collapsed immediately after his death under almost hopeless circumstances; see *stietencron*1989. Following a period of military consolidation of his empire, a divided situation marked by social and religious tensions prevailed in northern India. Hindus, in particular, were humiliated and exploited. Rajasthan, Gujarat, and central India were not part of his empire. Beginning with his marriage to the daughter of the Rajput prince Rājā Bihārī Mal of Amber in 1562, Akbar initiated a policy of pacification. More wives from the princely houses of Rajasthan followed, all of whom retained their religious customs. He issued decrees allowing Hindus to rebuild temples and perform religious practices in public. Overall, Akbar's reign was characterised by a very open religious policy. For instance, he promoted Hindus like Todar Mal and Mān Singh to high political positions for the first time; see *ibid.*, p. 70. Akbar encouraged interfaith dialogue and even created a lodge-like free-thinking order, the Dīn-i-Ilāhī, the “divine faith,” aiming to collect the best from all religions and discard anything that was rationally unconvincing to find a common truth; see *ibid.* p. 62. During this time, numerous previously destroyed Hindu temples were rebuilt in Benares; see *ibid.*, pp. 58–59. Later vassals of the Mughal emperors, especially the later Kachwaha Rajput rulers of Amber, notably under Rājā Man Singh I, constructed numerous temples and *ghāṭs* in the city; see *hooj*2006. Akbar's immediate successor, Jahāngir (1605–1627), continued the open religious policy; see *jahangir*1999 (1999). It was only during the reign of Shāh Jahān, who ruled the Mughal Empire from 1628–1658 that

a significant catalyst for the emerging formation of not just the solidification of religious identities in northern India,¹⁰¹⁹ but also a general increasingly pronounced “Hindu” identity, which both took shape during the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries.¹⁰²⁰ Yoga played a crucial role in the development of this new identity. Under the patronage of the Mughal emperors, Benares once again became a melting pot of intellectual and religious exchange, attracting many scholars to resettle there, as evidenced by the examples of Sundardās and Nārāyaṇatīrtha. Concurrently, as **birch2020** (2020: 471–472) demonstrated in his article **birch2020**, there was a general flourishing of Haṭhayoga literature in both North and South India. From the 16th century onwards, Haṭhayoga literature became increasingly diverse. Authors from various traditions, mainly learned Brahmins, sought to expand Haṭhayoga and integrate other yogas and religions. The beginnings of this development, highlighted by **birch2020**, are discernible here.

Another catalyst that initiated the floruit of Haṭhayoga literature was the acquisition of corporate identities of the four main ascetic orders of North India (Nāths, Daśanāmī saṃnyāsīs, Rāmānandīs, and Udāsīs). By 1600, the Nāth yogīs were reportedly organised into 12 panths, with all their headquarters located in North India.¹⁰²¹ This acquisition of corporate identities of the ascetic orders strengthened the discursive weight of their views, teachings and texts on the market of religious options in northern India. Thus, other religious traditions were stimulated to deal with those impulses.

the government’s general attitude became less favourable towards Hindus again from 1632 onwards. Shāh Jahān ordered a law for the destruction of Hindu temples under construction, as his Islamic theologians sought to prevent the construction and renovation of temples of other religions. However, it remains unclear how strictly this law was enforced and to what extent this religious policy shift after three-quarters of a century of religious dialogue and tolerance affected the population. The impacts were at most marginal. During Shāh Jahān’s reign, seven instances of temple destruction are documented; see **eaton2001**. How his rule specifically impacted Benares is unclear but presumably minimal. For example, the then Rāja of Amber, Jai Singh I, who ruled from 1627–1667, was an important military ally, and his father, Man Singh I, had invested large sums in the construction of Hindu temples in Benares. It was only under Aurangzeb (1658–1707) that a distinct of anti-Hindu policy resurged.

¹⁰¹⁹ **ohanlon2011religious**.

¹⁰²⁰ **clark2006**.

¹⁰²¹ **mallinsonnath**.

Thus, the complex early modern yoga taxonomies of medieval yogas resulted from the convergence of various yogic traditions and associated religions in melting pots of intellectual and religious exchange during the early blossoming phase of a new, more diversified wave of yoga literature, mainly disseminated through hubs like Benares.¹⁰²² Moreover, they are a literary testament to this process and reflect the discursive negotiations and repositioning of authors from different traditions in response to new yogic impulses affecting them.

¹⁰²² Given the high likelihood that the *Yogasvarodaya* was composed in more southern regions, we can assume that the discourse surrounding complex Yoga taxonomies had another area of dissemination. There is no doubt that South Indian scholars were drawn to Benares. This is evidenced by the authors discussed here: on one hand, Nārāyaṇatīrtha, who was originally from Kaza in the Guntur District of present-day Andhra Pradesh and then spent a significant part of his life in Benares, see [endo1993](#). On the other hand, Sundaradeva, the author of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*, also originated from more southern regions before moving to Benares, see [birch2018proliferation](#).

Appendix

Figures



Figure 1: The *dehasvarūpa* of *ajapāgāyatrī*. The image, reminiscent of a hippogriff, is part of an illustrated Sanskrit manuscript written in the Śāradā script. Preserved as a single large scroll under Acc. No. 1334 at the Oriental Institute in Srinagar (Kashmir), it is entitled *Nāḍicakra*. The manuscript contains a depiction of the yogic body's *cakras*, *nāḍīs* and the yogic cosmos. The text surrounding the figure closely corresponds to the additional material found in manuscript U₂ of the *Tattvayogabindu*. The manuscript reads (diplomatic transcription): *om daśame pūrṇagiripīṭhe lalāṭamaṇḍale candro devatā amṛtāśaktiḥ paramātmā rṣiḥ dvāvīṃśaddalāni amṛtavāsīnikalā 4: ambikā 1 lambikā 2 gha(m)ṭkā 3 tālikā 4 dehasvarūpaṃ kākamukhaṃ 1 naranetraṃ 2 gośṛṅgaṃ 3 lalāṭa brahmapara 4 hayagrīvā 5 mayūramuśchaṃ haṃsacāritāni 7 sthāna.*



Figure 2: Viṣṇu Viśvarūpa, India, Rajasthan, Jaipur, ca. 1800–1820, Opaque watercolor and gold on paper, 38.5 × 28 cm, Victoria and Albert Museum, London, Given by Mrs. Gerald Clark.



Figure 3: The Equivalence of the Self and the Universe (detail), folio 6 from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (Bulaki), India, Rajasthan, Jodhpur, 1824 (Samvat 1881), 122 x 46 cm, RJS 2378, Mehragarh Museum Trust.

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